



NORTH DEVON AND TORRIDGE LOCAL PLAN 2011-2031

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i Foreword	i
Setting the Context	
1 Introduction	1
2 Spatial Planning Vision	7
PART ONE: Strategic Policies of the Local Plan	
3 Sustainable Development	16
Principles of Sustainable Development	16
Mitigating Climate Change	17
Adapting to Climate Change	19
Improving the Quality of Development	22
Sustainable Construction and Buildings	23
4 Spatial Strategy	27
Spatial Development Strategy	27
Rural Areas Strategy	29
Distribution Strategy	32
Coast and Estuary Strategy	37
Transport Strategy	42
5 Enabling a Vibrant Economy	49
Delivering Employment and Economic Development	49
Town and District Centres	53
Tourism	55
6 A World Class Environment	58
Enhancing Environmental Assets	58
Conserving Heritage Assets	62
Renewable Energy and Heat	63
7 Delivering a Balanced Local Housing Market	67
A Balanced Local Housing Market	67
Delivering Affordable Housing	72
Providing Homes for Travelling Communities	80
Managing the Delivery of Housing	81
8 Strong and Inclusive Communities	85
Community Services and Facilities	85
Delivering Infrastructure	87

9 Neighbourhood Planning	90
10 Town Strategies	92
Barnstaple	92
Bideford	123
Braunton and Wrafton	137
Fremington and Yelland	147
Great Torrington	156
Holsworthy	166
Ilfracombe	179
Northam	191
South Molton	204
11 Monitoring Framework	216
PART TWO: Rural Strategies	
12 Rural Strategies	218
Introduction	218
Local Centres	218
Bradworthy	219
Bratton Fleming	222
Buckland Brewer	226
Chulmleigh	231
Combe Martin	235
Dolton	239
Halwill Junction	243
Hartland	247
High Bickington	251
Instow	255
North Molton	259
Shebbear	263
Winkleigh	267
Witheridge	273
Woolacombe and Mortehoe	277
Villages	280
Abbotsham	281
Ashwater	284
Atherington	286
Beaford	289
Berrynarbor	293
Bishop's Nympton	296
Bishop's Tawton	299
Black Torrington	303

Bridgerule	305
Bucks Cross	308
Burrington	310
Chilsworthy	314
Chittlehampton	317
Clawton	320
Clovelly and Higher Clovelly	323
Croyde and Georgeham	326
East Anstey	330
East Worlington	333
Filleigh	336
Goodleigh	339
Kentisbury and Kentisbury Ford	343
King's Nympton	346
Knowle	348
Landkey	351
Langtree and Stibb Cross	355
Lower Lovacott and Newton Tracey	359
Merton	362
Milton Damerel and Venn Green	366
Monkleigh	368
Parkham	371
Pyworthy	374
Rackenford	377
Sheepwash	382
Shirwell	384
St Giles on the Heath	386
Sutcombe	388
Swimbridge	391
Tetcott	393
Umberleigh	397
Welcombe and Daracott	399
West Down	401
Woolfardisworthy (Woolsery)	405

PART THREE: Development Management Policies

13 Development Management Policies	408
---	------------

14 Glossary	450
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Appendices

Appendix 1 Superseded Policies	463
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Appendix 2 Housing Trajectory	472
Appendix 3 Monitoring Framework	498
Appendix 4 Policies Map Legend	503
Appendix 5 Schedule of Non-strategic Housing Sites	504
Figures	
Figure 1.1 Key Diagram	6
Figure 4.1 Settlement Hierarchy and Distribution	27
Figure 4.2 Spatial Strategy for the Coast and Estuary	39
Figure 4.3 Strategic transport links for the South West	43
Figure 4.4 Road links of strategic importance for northern Devon	44
Figure 4.5 Strategic Recreational Routes in northern Devon	47
Figure 5.1 Wards Within Northern Devon With Assisted Area Status	50
Figure 6.1 Devon's Tranquil Areas	60
Figure 7.1 Extent of Northern Peninsula Housing Market Area	67
Figure 7.2 Housing Sub-Market Areas	68
Figure 10.1 Barnstaple Cross-Town Cycle Route	121
Figure 13.1 Waste Hierarchy	413
Policies	
Policy ST01: Principles of Sustainable Development	16
Policy ST02: Mitigating Climate Change	17
Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience	19
Policy ST04: Improving the Quality of Development	22
Policy ST05: Sustainable Construction and Buildings	23
Policy ST06: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Sub-regional, Strategic and Main Centres	28
Policy ST07: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Rural Area	29
Policy ST08: Scale and Distribution of New Development in Northern Devon	32
Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy	37
Policy ST10: Transport Strategy	42
Policy ST11: Delivering Employment and Economic Development	51
Policy ST12: Town and District Centres	53
Policy ST13: Sustainable Tourism	55
Policy ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets	58
Policy ST15: Conserving Heritage Assets	62
Policy ST16: Delivering Renewable Energy and Heat	63
Policy ST17: A Balanced Local Housing Market	70
Policy ST18: Affordable Housing on Development Sites	73
Policy ST19: Affordable Housing on Exception Sites	76
Policy ST19A: Starter Homes Exception Sites	78
Policy ST20: Providing Homes for Traveller Communities	80

Policy ST21: Managing the Delivery of Housing	82
Policy ST22: Community Services and Facilities	85
Policy ST23: Infrastructure	87
Policy BAR: Barnstaple Spatial Vision and Development Strategy	93
Policy BAR01: Westacott Strategic Extension	97
Policy BAR02: Larkbear Strategic Extension	100
Policy BAR02a: Old Torrington Road, Roundswell	102
Policy BAR03: Tews Lane, Roundswell	103
Policy BAR04: Mount Sandford Green	104
Policy BAR05: Westaway Plain, Pilton	105
Policy BAR06: South of North Devon District Hospital	106
Policy BAR07: North Lane, Bickington	107
Policy BAR08: Former School Site, Roundswell	108
Policy BAR09: Glenwood Farm, Roundswell	110
Policy BAR10: Roundswell Business Park	111
Policy BAR11: Queen Street / Bear Street	112
Policy BAR12: Anchorwood Bank	113
Policy BAR13: Seven Brethren	114
Policy BAR14: Evans Transport, Two Rivers Industrial Estate	115
Policy BAR15: Land South of Braunton Road	116
Policy BAR16: Lynton and Barnstaple Railway	117
Policy BAR17: Petroc	117
Policy BAR18: Park Community School and Pilton Academy	118
Policy BAR19: Local Green Spaces	118
Policy BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links	120
Policy BAR21: Flood Management Strategy	122
Policy BAR22: Green Wedges	122
Policy BID: Bideford Spatial Vision and Development Strategy	124
Policy BID01: Bideford West Urban Extension	127
Policy BID02: Cleave Wood	128
Policy BID03: Land adjoining Manteo Way	129
Policy BID04: Site South of East-the-Water	130
Policy BID05: Land adjoining Caddsdow Business Park	131
Policy BID06: Bideford Port	133
Policy BID07: Bideford Regeneration Sites	133
Policy BID08: Former Bideford to Appledore Railway	134
Policy BID09: South of Clovelly Road	134
Policy BID10: Bideford Clovelly Road	136
Policy BRA: Braunton and Wrafton Spatial Vision and Development Strategy	138
Policy BRA01: Wrafton South Eastern Extension	141
Policy BRA02: Wrafton Glebefield	142
Policy BRA02A: Land East and West of Staggers Lane	143
Policy BRA03: Local Green Spaces	144

Policy FRE: Fremington and Yelland Spatial Vision and Development Strategy	148
Policy FRE01: Fremington Army Camp	150
Policy FRE02: Yelland Quay	152
Policy GTT: Great Torrington Spatial Vision and Development Strategy	157
Policy GTT01: The Former Creamery Site	159
Policy GTT02: East of Hatchmoor	160
Policy GTT03: Hatchmoor Common Lane	161
Policy GTT04: Adjacent to Dartington Fields	162
Policy GTT05: North of Burwood Lane	163
Policy GTT06: Local Green Spaces	163
Policy GTT07: East of School Lane	164
Policy HOL: Holsworthy Spatial Vision and Development Strategy	167
Policy HOL01: Agri-Business Park	170
Policy HOL02: Land South of Under Lane	171
Policy HOL03: Land between Rydon Road and Trewyn Road	173
Policy HOL04: West of Dobles Lane Industrial Estate	174
Policy HOL05: Land between Dobles Lane and North Road	175
Policy HOL06: Land East of North Road	176
Policy HOL07: Land off Menors Place	177
Policy HOL08: Safeguarded Pedestrian and Cycle Route	178
Policy ILF: Ilfracombe Spatial Vision and Development Strategy	180
Policy ILF01: Ilfracombe Strategic Southern Extension	183
Policy ILF02: Land at The Shields/Fernway	185
Policy ILF04: Mullacott Business Park	186
Policy ILF05: Harbour / Seafront Tourist Area	187
Policy ILF06: Local Green Space	188
Policy NOR: Northam Spatial Vision and Development Strategy	193
Policy NOR01: Daddon Hill Farm	195
Policy NOR02: Site West of Buckleigh Road	197
Policy NOR03: Land adjacent to Landsdowne Park	198
Policy NOR04: Tadworthy Road (Northam)	198
Policy NOR05: Westward Ho! - Core Tourist Area	199
Policy NOR06: Westward Ho! - Tourism and Recreation Sites	200
Policy NOR07: Site Adjoining Pitt Hill (Appledore)	201
Policy NOR08: Land North of Cleveland Park	201
Policy NOR09: Land South-West of Heywood Road Roundabout	202
Policy NOR10: Green Wedge	203
Policy SMO: South Molton Spatial Vision and Development Strategy	205
Policy SM01: South Molton Strategic Western Extension	207
Policy SM02: Sports Hub and Football Club	210
Policy SM03: Pathfields Business Park	211
Policy SM04: South Molton Town Centre	212
Policy SM05: Local Green Space	213

Policy BRD: Bradworthy Spatial Strategy	219
Policy BRD01: Land North of Elizabeth Lea Close	220
Policy BRD02: Land at Mill Road	221
Policy BRF: Bratton Fleming Spatial Strategy	222
Policy BRF01: Land off The Glebe	223
Policy BRF02: Local Green Space	224
Policy BBR: Buckland Brewer Spatial Strategy	226
Policy BBR01: Land Adjoining Football Pitch	227
Policy BBR02: Land at Orleigh Close	228
Policy BBR03: Land to the South East of Orleigh Close	229
Policy BBR04: Land to the West of Tower Hill	229
Policy CHU: Chulmleigh Spatial Strategy	231
Policy CHU01: Land off Leigh Road	232
Policy CHU02: Land at Back Lane	233
Policy CMA: Combe Martin Spatial Strategy	235
Policy CMA01: Land North of Rectory Road	236
Policy CMA03: Land North of Park Hills	237
Policy CMA04: Combe Martin Field System	238
Policy DOL: Dolton Spatial Strategy	239
Policy DOL01: Land at Aller Road	240
Policy DOL02: Land South of Village Hall	241
Policy HAL: Halwill Junction Spatial Strategy	243
Policy HAL01: Land at Halwill Industrial Estate	244
Policy HAL02: Land East of Chilla Road	245
Policy HAR: Hartland Spatial Strategy	247
Policy HAR01: Land East of Pengilly Way	248
Policy HAR02: Land at Eastdown Park	249
Policy HBK: High Bickington Spatial Strategy	251
Policy HBK01: Land at Little Bickington Lane	252
Policy HBK02: Land at North Farm	253
Policy HBK03: Land South of Community Centre	254
Policy HBK04: Land at Little Bickington Lane	254
Policy INS: Instow Spatial Strategy	255
Policy INS01: Land at Barton Cross	256
Policy INS02: Land at Anstey Way	257
Policy INS03: Land North of Marine Parade	257
Policy NMO: North Molton Spatial Strategy	259
Policy NMO01: Land off Back Lane	260
Policy NMO02: Land at Old Road	261
Policy SHB: Shebbear Spatial Strategy	263
Policy SHB01: Land at Lake Workshops	264
Policy SHB02: Land West of Haycross Hill	265
Policy WIN: Winkleigh Spatial Strategy	267

Policy WIN01: Winkleigh Airfield	268
Policy WIN02: Land North of Chulmleigh Road	270
Policy WIT: Witheridge Spatial Strategy	273
Policy WIT01: Land off Butts Close	274
Policy WIT02: North of St John the Baptist Church	276
Policy MOR: Woolacombe and Morteheo Spatial Strategy	277
Policy ABS: Abbotsham Spatial Strategy	281
Policy ABS01: Land at The Glebe	282
Policy ASH: Ashwater Spatial Strategy	284
Policy ATH: Atherington Spatial Strategy	286
Policy ATH01: Land North of Torrington Road	287
Policy BEA: Beaford Spatial Strategy	289
Policy BEA01: Land North of Towell Lane / Towell Meadow	290
Policy BEA02: Land at Rye Park Close, Beaford Garage and Land to Rear	291
Policy BER: Berrynarbor Spatial Strategy	293
Policy BNY: Bishop's Nympton Spatial Strategy	296
Policy BNY01: Glebe Field	297
Policy BTA: Bishop's Tawton Spatial Strategy	299
Policy BTA01: Former Engineering Works, Village Street	300
Policy BTA02: Land off Exeter Road	301
Policy BTR: Black Torrington Spatial Strategy	303
Policy BTR01: Land at Long Cross Farm	304
Policy BRI: Bridgerule Spatial Strategy	305
Policy BRI01: Land at Merrifield Cross	306
Policy BRI02: Land West of Southfields	307
Policy BUC: Bucks Cross Spatial Strategy	308
Policy BUR: Burrington Spatial Strategy	310
Policy BUR01: Land off Meadow Park Drive	311
Policy BUR02: Land Rear of Barnstaple Inn, 'Mayfair' and 'Cavok Cottage'	312
Policy BUR03: Land South of Hayne View, Balls Corner	313
Policy HOH: Chilsworthy Spatial Strategy	314
Policy HOH01: Land West of Meadowside	315
Policy CHI: Chittlehampton Spatial Strategy	317
Policy CHI01: Land at Cobbaton Road	318
Policy CLW: Clawton Spatial Strategy	320
Policy CLW01: Land at Riverside	321
Policy CLO: Clovelly/Higher Clovelly Spatial Strategy	323
Policy CLO01: Land at Lower Burscott Farmyard	324
Policy GEO: Georgeham and Croyde Spatial Strategy	326
Policy GEO01: Land off Frogstreet Hill, Georgeham	328
Policy GEO02: Land off Croyde Road, Croyde	328
Policy EAN: East Anstey Spatial Strategy	330
Policy EAN01 : Land at East Anstey	331

Policy EWO: East Worlington Spatial Strategy	333
Policy EWO01: Land at Town Barton, East Worlington	334
Policy FIL: Filleigh Spatial Strategy	336
Policy FIL01: Land adjoining Filleigh Village Hall	337
Policy GDL: Goodleigh Spatial Strategy	339
Policy GDL01: Land adjacent Village Hall, Coombe Cross	340
Policy GDL02: Land off Northleigh Hill	341
Policy GDL03: Land adjacent Goodleigh Primary School	342
Policy KKF: Kentisbury / Kentisbury Ford Spatial Strategy	343
Policy KGN: King's Nympton Spatial Strategy	346
Policy KNW: Knowle Spatial Strategy	348
Policy KNW01 : Land South of Chalwells	349
Policy LAN: Landkey Spatial Strategy	351
Policy LAN01 : Land South of Birch Road	352
Policy LAG: Langtree/Stibb Cross Spatial Strategy	355
Policy LAG01: Land West of The Crescent	356
Policy LAG02: Land at the Former Cattle Market and Land to North	357
Policy LAG03: Land at Langtree Park	358
Policy HLN: Lower Lovacott / Newton Tracey Spatial Strategy	359
Policy HLN01 : Land South of Orchard Cottages, Lower Lovacott	360
Policy MER: Merton Spatial Strategy	362
Policy MER01: Land to the South of the Primary School	363
Policy MER02: Site at Limers Lane	364
Policy MER03: Land at Back Lane	364
Policy MIL: Milton Damerel/Venn Green Spatial Strategy	366
Policy MON: Monkleigh Spatial Strategy	368
Policy MON01: Land North of Barton Farm	369
Policy PAR: Parkham Spatial Strategy	371
Policy PAR01: Land South of Allardice Hall	372
Policy PYW: Pyworthy Spatial Strategy	374
Policy PYW01: Land adjacent to Pyworthy Village Hall	375
Policy RAC: Rackenford Spatial Strategy	377
Policy RAC01: Land at Rackenford Cross	378
Policy RAC02: Land at Prospect Farm	379
Policy RAC03: Land at Coles Yard	379
Policy RAC04: Land South of Meadow View	380
Policy SHP: Sheepwash Spatial Strategy	382
Policy SHW: Shirwell Spatial Strategy	384
Policy STG: St Giles on the Heath Spatial Strategy	386
Policy SUT: Sutcombe Spatial Strategy	388
Policy SUT01: Land to North of Sutcombe Primary School	389
Policy SUT02: Land adjacent to the Parish Hall	389
Policy SWM: Swimbridge Spatial Strategy	391

Policy TET: Tetcott Spatial Strategy	393
Policy TET01: Land at Tetcott	394
Policy UMB: Umberleigh Spatial Strategy	397
Policy WDA: Welcombe / Darracott Spatial Strategy	399
Policy WED: West Down Spatial Strategy	401
Policy WED01: Former Foxhunters Garage	402
Policy WED02 : Land off Ilfracombe Hill	403
Policy WFD: Woolfardisworthy (Woolsery) Spatial Strategy	405
Policy DM01: Amenity Considerations	408
Policy DM02: Environmental Protection	409
Policy DM03: Construction and Environmental Management	412
Policy DM04: Design Principles	415
Policy DM05: Highways	417
Policy DM06: Parking Provision	418
Policy DM07: Historic Environment	419
Policy DM08: Biodiversity and Geodiversity	420
Policy DM08A: Landscape and Seascape Character	423
Policy DM09: Safeguarding Green Infrastructure	423
Policy DM10: Green Infrastructure Provision	424
Policy DM11: Planning Enforcement	426
Policy DM11A: Telecommunications	426
Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages	427
Policy DM13: Safeguarding Employment Land	428
Policy DM14: Rural Economy	429
Policy DM15: Farm Diversification	430
Policy DM16: Equine Development	431
Policy DM17: Tourism and Leisure Attractions	432
Policy DM18: Tourism Accommodation	433
Policy DM19: Town and District Centres	435
Policy DM20: Development Outside Town and District Centres	436
Policy DM21: Local and Rural Shops	437
Policy DM22: Shop Front Design and Signage	439
Policy DM23: Residential Development in defined Settlements without development boundaries	440
Policy DM24: Rural Settlements	441
Policy DM25: Residential Extensions and Ancillary Development	442
Policy DM26: Replacement Dwellings in the Countryside	443
Policy DM27: Re-use of Disused and Redundant Rural Buildings	444
Policy DM28: Rural Worker Accommodation	445
Policy DM29: Farmer Family Attached Accommodation	447
Policy DM30: Sites for Traveller Accommodation	448

i Foreword

We are pleased to introduce the adopted North Devon and Torridge Local Plan. Our two Councils have worked together to prepare this final document which sets out the policies that will encourage and facilitate sustainable development and growth within northern Devon during the period to 2031.

Our shared vision includes a statement that northern Devon will remain '*a highly desirable place where people are able to live well, work productively, move freely, benefit from excellent education, health and leisure facilities and live in harmony with nature and our world-class environment*'. The ambition of the Local Plan is that this vision becomes a reality.

This Local Plan has been prepared as a result of extensive community engagement and consultation to help shape how northern Devon develops towards achieving this vision. Throughout its preparation we have tried to strike a balance between the requirements of changing national planning policy guidance, identifying sufficient land to accommodate housing and employment, the protection of our high quality environment and the views and priorities of our communities. During the process we have consulted residents, the development industry, and a broad range of private, public, and voluntary sector organisations. We would like to express our thanks to all of the individuals and organisations who have contributed constructively to the preparation of the final Plan.

While we acknowledge that decisions about the development of land can sometimes be controversial, we believe that we have produced the most appropriate strategy to meet the needs of northern Devon. Following public hearings, an independent Inspector found that the Local Plan, with some modifications, was 'sound'. In essence this means that the Local Plan has been found to have been positively prepared to meet development and infrastructure requirements, is justified by proportionate evidence, and is effective deliverable, and consistent with national planning policy.

Both our Councils are proud of what has been achieved through this collaborative process and we look forward to the plan underpinning and supporting local development that will protect and enhance our natural, built and historic environments, supply a suitable range of housing and related infrastructure, and help to create a more diverse and resilient economy.



Councillor Des Brailey

Leader

North Devon Council



Councillor Jane Whittaker

Leader

Torridge District Council

1 Introduction

1.1 The purpose of the North Devon and Torridge District Local Plan (the Local Plan) is to set out the long-term vision for how the towns, villages and countryside of northern Devon will develop and evolve in the period up to 2031. The Local Plan will set out how this vision will be delivered through a strategy of supporting, distributing and delivering sustainable development and growth.

1.2 The 'northern Devon' area is defined as comprising the districts of North Devon and Torridge, but excluding that part of North Devon District within Exmoor National Park ([see Key Diagram figure 1.1](#)). This Local Plan forms part of the statutory development plan for North Devon⁽¹⁾ and Torridge District Councils and will be used to guide planning decisions. It will be the starting point for the development of Neighbourhood Plans prepared by local communities and for decisions on all new development proposals.

1.3 The Local Plan's strategic aims and objectives seek to promote economic and job growth and provide for new homes to meet northern Devon's future needs, as well as land for other activities including retail, sport and leisure. The Local Plan also seeks to support the world-class environment of the Biosphere Reserve and to protect and enhance valued environmental assets, including the undeveloped coastline and estuaries.

1.4 Both Councils have a statutory duty to prepare, monitor and review a development plan for their respective local planning authority areas. Preparation of the Local Plan began following the Planning and Compulsory Purchase Act in 2004 and was then set within the context of the draft Regional Spatial Strategy for the South West (now revoked) with its emphasis on a sustainable future for the South West.

1.5 Both Councils began work on a plan for northern Devon in 2006. Initially this took the form of a document called the Joint Core Strategy, and its focus was to set the overall vision and objectives that would guide the future pattern and form of development in northern Devon to 2026. Since 2011 the planning system has undergone significant alterations to the legislative framework, including the Localism Act 2011 and its introduction of the Duty to Co-operate, the National Planning Policy Framework 2012, the Growth and Infrastructure Act 2013 and the National Planning Practice Guidance 2014.

1.6 This Local Plan has been developed during a challenging economic environment and reflects current national planning guidance. This has resulted in the move from preparing a suite of documents as part of a Local Development Framework (LDF) to a single document approach as presented in this Local Plan. The work that was progressed under the LDF, and in particular the Joint Core Strategy, has evolved to form the basis of this Local Plan.

1.7 The Local Plan replaces the policies saved from the Torridge District Local Plan (adopted September 2004) and the North Devon Local Plan (adopted July 2006) as set out in Appendix 1.

Format

1.8 The Local Plan is split into three parts. **PART ONE forms the strategic element of the plan, and includes:**

- A **spatial portrait** describing northern Devon at the beginning of the plan period;
- A **spatial planning vision** of how northern Devon could develop as a place to meet the future needs of its local residents, businesses and visitors;

¹ 'North Devon Council' is the operating name for North Devon District Council.

- The **challenges** the Local Plan can help to address and the **aims and objectives** for addressing these challenges;
- A suite of **strategic policies** providing a local planning framework to help achieve the vision and determine planning applications. These policies also set out the amount and distribution of new development that will take place and provide a framework for **Neighbourhood Plans**;
- **Town strategies** that set out community aspirations and the location of new infrastructure, employment and housing development proposed in Barnstaple, Bideford, Braunton and Wrafton, Fremington and Yelland, Great Torrington, Holsworthy, Ilfracombe, Northam (including Appledore and Westward Ho!) and South Molton;
- A **monitoring and implementation framework** for delivering the Local Plan. The Local Plan is supported by an Infrastructure Delivery Plan (IDP) that attempts to show how the proposed development may be delivered; and
- **Policies Maps** set out planning policy and strategy designations made in the Local Plan.

1.9 PART TWO contains **Village Plans** that set out local community aspirations and the location of new infrastructure, employment and housing development proposed in identified Local Centres and Villages.

1.10 PART THREE contains a suite of **development management policies** providing additional criteria and detail to help deliver the strategic policies and aid the determination of planning applications.

What has influenced this Plan?

1.11 The Local Plan has been and continues to be influenced by European and national government guidance, evidence studies, appraisals, assessments, local communities and businesses. The following lists provide further detail.

National planning guidance, including but not exclusively:

- a. The imperative to contribute to the achievement of sustainable development;
- b. The National Planning Policy Framework and the National Planning Practice Guidance; its presumption in favour of sustainable development, its Core Planning Principles and its requirement for the Local Plan to meet the objectively assessed needs of northern Devon;
- c. A Duty to Co-operate that requires councils to work constructively with neighbouring authorities and public bodies on an on-going basis; and
- d. A national requirement to secure economic growth and significantly boost the supply of housing.

Local strategies, including but not exclusively:

- a. Devon and Torbay Transport Plan 3 (2011 to 2026);
- b. Devon Waste Plan (adopted December 2014) and Devon Minerals Plan (adopted February 2017);

- c. Heart of the South West Local Enterprise Partnership - Strategic Economic Plan and EU structural and investment fund strategy;
- d. Northern Devon Economic Strategy 2014 to 2020;
- e. Northern Devon Joint Sustainable Community Strategy;
- f. River Basin Management Plan for the South West River Basin District;
- g. Shoreline Management Plan 2; and
- h. Other relevant plans, policies and strategies that relate to northern Devon or the wider area (for example: a neighbouring council's local plan, North Devon Coasts AONB Management Plan and the Biosphere Reserve Strategy).

Evidence from a number of technical studies about northern Devon, including but not exclusively:

- a. An Assessment of Landscape Sensitivity to onshore wind energy and large scale Photovoltaic development in Torridge District (2011) and in North Devon (2014);
- b. Annual Monitoring Reports (including land availability reports) ongoing;
- c. Devon Education and Transport Study 2013;
- d. Draft Devon Green Infrastructure Strategy 2011;
- e. Economic Viability Assessment of Future Development of Affordable Housing 2013
- f. Employment Land Review 2006 and 2013;
- g. Green Infrastructure Study 2013;
- h. Housing and Employment Study 2013;
- i. Joint Landscape Character Assessment 2010;
- j. Non-Residential Community Infrastructure Levy Viability Study 2013;
- k. Northern Peninsula Strategic Housing Market Assessment 2008 and Northern Devon update in 2012;
- l. Retail and Leisure Study 2012;
- m. Strategic Flood Risk Assessment level 1 (2009) and Strategic Flood Risk Assessments level 2 - Barnstaple area and Bideford and Northam area (2010);
- n. Settlement Hierarchy Study 2013;
- o. Strategic Housing Land Availability Assessment 2011 and 2014;
- p. Town Studies for the main centres 2011;

- q. Devon Local Flood Risk Management Strategy 2014-2020 (DCC); and
- r. Natural Character Assessments (Natural England).

Recommendations from appraisals and assessments

1.12 The Local Plan has been subject to a **Sustainability Appraisal (SA)** and has been integral to each stage of the plan making process. The SA assesses the impact of the Local Plan's objectives, policies and sites having regard to social, environmental and economic factors and helps ensure that the Local Plan accords with the principles of sustainable development.

1.13 The Local Plan is also supported by a number of assessments that form part of a continual review process, which include:

- A **Habitats Regulations Assessment (HRA)** of the Local Plan's impact on the network of sites of European importance for nature conservation;
- An **Equalities Impact Assessment (EIA)** of the Local Plan's policies on specific groups, as a result of race, gender, sexual orientation, disability, age or religion; and
- A **Health Impact Assessment (HIA)** that seeks to embed public health across the Local Plan's strategies and policies and raise awareness amongst strategic partners and service providers. The HIA is designed to systematically assess and illustrate key headline health and wellbeing related factors and become the catalyst for long term solutions to improve health and reduce health inequalities across northern Devon.

Involvement of local communities and key stakeholders, including consultation on:

- Issues and Options Core Strategy - Consultation November 2007 to January 2008;
- Pre-publication Core Strategy 2006 to 2026 - Consultation January to March 2010;
- Town Studies - Targeted consultation with local communities (during 2011);
- Draft Local Plan 2011 to 2031 - Consultation January to March 2013;
- Village Plans - Targeted Rural Strategies consultation with Parish Councils March to June 2013;
- Publication Local Plan 2011 to 2031 - Consultation June to August 2014;
- Proposed Main Changes to the Publication Local Plan - Consultation March to May 2015;
- Additional Proposed Main Changes / New Policy (affordable housing, starter homes on exception sites and wind energy - Consultation October 2015 to December 2015;
- Additional Proposed Main Changes - (starter homes on exception sites) - Consultation February to March 2016;
- Proposed Main and Minor Modifications - Consultation September to October 2016;
- Further Proposed Main Modifications - Consultation July to September 2017;

- Proposed Main Modifications - Consultation March to April 2018; and
- Proposed Main Modification (Policy BBR04) - Consultation July to August 2018.

1.14 A summary of the consultation carried out and how it has influenced the Local Plan is contained in a series of Consultation Statements, which are separate evidence base documents.

The Local Enterprise Partnership

1.15 North Devon and Torridge District are members of the Heart of the South West Local Enterprise Partnership (LEP). The LEP is a partnership managed by a voluntary board consisting of business leaders, representatives from local government and educational institutions. The role of the LEP is to lead and influence the economy of Devon, Somerset, Plymouth and Torbay by supporting economic growth through job creation, improving productivity and increasing earnings.

1.16 The LEP has prepared a number of documents that form the basis for making funding decisions for the area. These documents identify the current and future challenges and opportunities such as planning and transport, and priorities such as low carbon, social enterprise and delivering improved infrastructure.

1.17 Whilst the LEP operates at a more strategic level, policies contained within the Local Plan need to be consistent with the visions, aims and objectives of the LEP and where possible contribute towards achieving the LEP's strategic objectives.

A Duty to Co-operate

1.18 The Local Plan takes into account the implications of planning policies of neighbouring authorities as spatial planning issues are not constrained by Local Authority administrative boundaries. North Devon and Torridge District Councils have worked with neighbouring authorities and non-governmental organisations at all stages in the preparation of the Local Plan and will continue to do so as necessary and in particular on strategic cross boundary matters. The Localism Act and Local Plan Regulations (2012) set out those bodies to which the Duty applies and the National Planning Policy Framework describes the issues that it should address.

1.19 Significant cross boundary issues include, but not exclusively:

- The need, supply and distribution of new homes, jobs and retail floorspace;
- Environmental protection and enhancement of the landscape, habitat networks and dark night skies (over Exmoor National Park), together with enhancement of green infrastructure networks ecosystem services and biodiversity offsetting; and
- Requirements and pressures for new and improved infrastructure, such as transport, communications, renewable energy generation and service providers (e.g. hospitals, police, fire service and schools).

1.20 North Devon Council and Torridge District Council have worked closely to prepare a joint Local Plan for both local authority areas, built on a robust evidence base, which has made the most efficient use of resources and makes sound planning sense. Devon County Council has established a protocol that has been signed by all Devon Local Planning Authorities and key organisations. A separate document concerning the Duty to Co-operate forms part of the evidence base supporting the Local Plan.

2 Spatial Planning Vision

2.1 The overarching principle supporting the Local Plan in northern Devon is to contribute to the achievement of sustainable development⁽²⁾. It is the intention of the Councils to enable the delivery of infrastructure, jobs, accessible local services and housing for future generations while supporting the world-class environment of the Biosphere Reserve. The spatial portrait and the spatial vision both define the basis for change and its extent, which is necessary to achieve the Councils' goals for northern Devon.

2.2 The Key Diagram shows the spatial relationships between important landscape designations and the spatial context in which northern Devon is situated.

Spatial Portrait

2.3 The North Devon and Torridge area comprises about 1,903 square kilometres and has a population of around 157,500 people⁽³⁾ living in a network of historic market towns, rural settlements and coastal resorts. The sea and the moors define the limits of the area and the pattern of development shows the maritime influence (Key Diagram) and the rurality of the area.

2.4 About half the population live around the Taw and Torridge estuaries, in Barnstaple, Bideford, Braunton and Wrafton, Fremington and Yelland and Northam (including Appledore and Westward Ho!).

2.5 Barnstaple is the main location in the area for the provision of further and higher education, for the District General Hospital and for comparison shopping facilities. Bideford has a significant complementary role and is linked to Barnstaple by the A39. These settlements together provide the economic, commercial and administrative focus for many of the strategic service needs of the wider rural area.

2.6 The market and coastal towns of Braunton and Wrafton, Great Torrington, Holsworthy, Ilfracombe, Northam and South Molton have a range of facilities that serve wider rural populations. In addition, several Local Centres provide services for clusters of rural communities.

2.7 The North Devon Link Road (A361) and the Atlantic Highway (A39) run east-west, connecting the area to the M5 and to north Cornwall. The only rail link is the Tarka Line running between Barnstaple and Exeter. North-south transport links are poorer in quality and many rural communities are relatively isolated.

2.8 Exmoor National Park lies to the northeast and Dartmoor forms a barrier to the south. The area includes the majority of the catchments of the Rivers Taw and Torridge and their tributaries, which define the extent of the North Devon Biosphere Reserve, and to the west the headwaters of the River Tamar. The coastline is defined as an Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty and Heritage Coasts, which adjoins Exmoor National Park. The North Devon Coast Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty covers 9% of northern Devon. Only about 5% of the plan area is urbanised. Most of the area is farmed and about 12% of the land area is wooded⁽⁴⁾.

2.9 All of North Devon District and most of Torridge District are within the North Devon Biosphere Reserve, based on the catchment area of the Rivers Taw and Torridge and extending offshore beyond Lundy. It was designated by UNESCO in 2002 as the first new style Biosphere Reserve in England, consisting of three distinct zones (see Key Diagram) with the wider transition area promoting sustainable development principles in harmony with the natural environment. The spatial implications and opportunities arising from the Biosphere Reserve⁽⁵⁾ include: utilising

2 National Planning Policy Framework: Achieving sustainable development

3 2011 Census

4 Councils' Geographical Information Systems

5 Biosphere Reserve Technical Paper

ecosystem services in the design and delivery of development; recognising the inter-relationship of the land, estuarine and marine environments; enhancing green infrastructure networks at a landscape scale; and supporting local food production and local supply chains. The Biosphere Reserve designation will act as a catalyst for the area by demonstrating innovative approaches as an exemplar of sustainable development, by raising awareness of nature and opportunities to live sustainably in greater harmony with the natural environment. This will be achieved by capitalising on economic opportunities from the high quality environment and reinvesting in natural capital.

2.10 A range of ecosystem services contribute to northern Devon's working environment. Their important contribution is reflected by examples of delivering sustainable drainage systems to reduce flood risks, improving water quality including through the Torridge Nature Improvement Area (NIA) and Taw River Improvement Project (TRIP), generating renewable energy, enhancing green infrastructure networks, safeguarding heritage assets, promoting local identity and sense of place and producing food through local agriculture. These ecosystem services help to underpin the local economy and the area's local identity.

2.11 Northern Devon has a £2.2 billion economy which supports around 7,700 businesses and 66,000 jobs. Employment is focused in smaller firms, with 91% of businesses employing less than 10 people in 2011. The largest economic sectors (in descending order) are retail, health and social work and accommodation and food. These, together with employment in manufacturing, education and construction, account for almost three quarters of all jobs⁽⁶⁾.

2.12 Agriculture and the wider food processing supply chain employs almost 6,400 people, although a significant number of jobs are part time and casual. Leisure and tourism related sectors are important parts of the economy and evidence shows that population growth, as well as visitor numbers and spend, are important local economic drivers⁽⁷⁾. The rural area has displayed some economic diversification trends but low overall levels of growth, in marked contrast to the relatively high levels of housing and population growth that has occurred within the towns of northern Devon.

2.13 The demographic changes and housing trends are driven mainly by high net in-migration and the urban concentration strategy of past plans. The area's population is projected to increase by more than 12% between 2011-2031⁽⁸⁾, during which time the age profile of the population is expected to change dramatically. Very small growth in those aged 25 to 64. Significant growth is projected in all those of pensionable age; ranging from a 33% increase in those aged 65-74 and 63% in those aged 75-84 to a 115% increase for those aged 85+. Table 2.1 illustrates the changing nature of the area's population.

2.14 The expected demographic change will have a significant impact on the economy as well as housing need. The Housing and Employment study published in 2014 identifies that an additional 11,200 new homes are required by 2031 just to retain the same number of jobs as recorded in 2012. This reflects northern Devon's older population structure and the expected increase in those aged 65+ during the period 2011 to 2031.

2.15 The current stock of housing in northern Devon is not reflective of existing or projected need, neither in respect of type or affordability. There is an imbalance between the very high proportions of large family homes with the increasing demand for smaller accommodation. Changing patterns of household formation and the needs of an increasing elderly population requires a variation in new housing supply in both type and size from that which has historically been provided.

6 Northern Devon Employment Land Review, April 2014

7 Northern Devon Employment Land Review, April 2014

8 Population Projections ONS 2012, Office for National Statistics

Table 2.1 Population Projections for Northern Devon⁽⁹⁾ (Figures have been rounded to the nearest hundred. The total and the % change may not reflect rounded figures)

Age Cohort (years)	2011 (Census)	2021 Projection	2031 Projection	2011-2031	
	Population	Population	Population	Projected Total Change	Projected % Change
0-14	24,800	27,300	27,700	2,900	11.50
15-24	17,100	14,800	16,800	-300	-1.48
25-34	14,700	16,800	15,400	700	4.54
35-44	19,200	17,200	19,200	0	0.19
45-54	22,500	21,100	19,300	-3,200	-14.24
55-64	23,400	24,800	23,700	300	1.16
65-74	19,100	23,100	25,400	6,300	32.96
75-84	11,700	15,500	19,100	7,400	63.15
85+	5,000	6,800	10,700	5,700	115.08
All ages	157,500	167,400	177,300	19,800	12.57

2.16 There is a severe shortage of affordable housing in northern Devon. The affordability gap is significant and it is increasingly difficult for local people to access market housing. For households of working age there is a growing polarisation between the high-income minority and the majority in predominantly low waged and seasonal employment. The disparity between typical incomes and the cost of market housing is so significant as to exclude the majority of new households from ownership of their own property. The attraction of the area to second home owners adds an additional pressure on the housing market to the disadvantage of new households. The incidence of second home ownership (3.7% of dwelling stock in North Devon and 3.3% in Torridge⁽¹⁰⁾) with a significantly higher proportion in many coastal areas, is a further obstacle to the attainment of balanced communities.

2.17 Northern Devon faces a series of social and economic challenges on the basis of currently low skill, low wage and low productivity levels. Skill levels in Torridge are significantly lower than the regional and national average for all measures of qualification of NVQ2 and above. This is further reflected in the area's occupational profile where northern Devon has lower proportions of high skilled, qualified and salaried occupations when compared to the South West region or England and Wales⁽¹¹⁾.

2.18 The median average household income in Torridge is £28,198, which is 15% below the Great Britain average and North Devon at £29,538 is 10% below it⁽¹²⁾. The current under representation of high value added sectors such as high-tech manufacturing and financial services within the economy can compound the problem of low wages and deprivation. Local people are likely to be disadvantaged in terms of their incomes in a high value housing market.

9 Sub-National Population Projections ONS 2012, Office for National Statistics

10 Strategic Housing Market Assessment Update 2012

11 Strategic Housing Market Assessment Update 2012 - Table 2.3: occupational Groups for 16 to 74 year old, June 2011

12 North Devon and Torridge CACI Paycheck Reports 2017

Key Challenges

2.19 Northern Devon is a very special place offering unique opportunities and advantages over the rest of the County. We are not without challenges, but are well placed to face the future with optimism and confidence. The ambition is for northern Devon to be attractive, successful and sufficiently influential to shape its future.

2.20 Torridge District and North Devon Councils are working together to create a vibrant partnership providing a strong voice in the County. The Councils are raising the profile of the area, building on the investment to open up sites and helping remove barriers to growth that in the past have been difficult to overcome.

2.21 The Local Plan must be responsive to the specific issues facing northern Devon if it is to be successful. The challenges, spatial planning vision, aims and objectives are distilled from evidence gathering, formal and informal consultations and related Sustainability Appraisal work. The following challenges are not listed in any order of priority and inevitably overlap in some instances:

(a) **Finding solutions rather than problems to approve applications for sustainable development.** There is a need to work proactively with applicants to secure developments that improve the economic, social and environmental conditions of the area;

(b) **Delivering the housing requirement is a challenge that must be addressed.** Linked to this is the need to make existing settlements more sustainable including in rural areas and what this means for the distribution of development, particularly between the area's towns and villages;

(c) **Managing existing infrastructure and the timely provision of new infrastructure.** The scale of development and its phasing needs to be directly related to the capacity available within existing infrastructure and the delivery of new infrastructure, which reflects the needs of an ageing population;

(d) **Addressing the diverse nature of the different sizes, tenures and types of housing needed within the Districts.** Increasing the availability of affordable housing will be crucial in meeting northern Devon's housing needs and achieving balanced communities. Within the context of the housing requirement, an increasing proportion of housing must be accessible to local people in housing need;

(e) **Overcoming the dependence on low-income employment sectors.** Growth in sectors, particularly the knowledge economy, which could improve the economic prosperity of the Districts are under represented. Broadening the economic base of the area is required if employment opportunities, which are well paid and require increasing skill and training standards, are to be achieved;

(f) **Enabling diversification of the rural economy** to support sustainable rural communities and the wider countryside. The rural economy must not be overlooked through an urban focus on new development. The Local Plan must consider the need to provide and maintain employment opportunities appropriate to the rural area;

(g) **Delivering and retaining of an adequate range of services and facilities**, including arts and cultural activities and high speed broadband connections, to all communities is a key issue. Retention and enhancement of the service centre role of each of northern Devon's main towns will be crucial if commercial and community needs are to be met;

(h) **Securing the long-term sustainability of rural communities** is a key challenge, which must be addressed in the context of appropriately accommodating local needs;

(i) **Protecting the high quality natural environment** and the coastal environment in particular, is vital and underpins tourism. Future development must be sensitive to the area's environmental assets and ensure that the local character, distinctiveness and environmental quality is not eroded but where possible enhanced as a consequence of development;

(j) **Delivering necessary development while minimising the impact on the environment and responding to the implications of climate change.** Achieving sustainable development will require efforts to reduce waste, encourage recycling including prudent land use, reducing pollution and energy consumption, move towards the increased use of sustainable transport modes, promote the use of renewable energy, achieve sustainable construction and design and respond to the increased risk of flooding. The Biosphere Reserve will act as a catalyst for achieving innovative and exemplar sustainable development and for utilising opportunities arising from ecosystem services; and

(k) **Attracting sustained investment into the area and benefitting from those areas identified as Assisted Area Status,** which allows state aid to be granted to promote the economic development in disadvantaged areas within the European Union.

Spatial Planning Vision

In 2031 northern Devon remains a highly desirable place where people are able to live well, work productively, move freely and benefit from excellent education, health and leisure facilities in harmony with nature and our world-class environment.

Ecosystem services form the cornerstone of northern Devon's continued success and are enshrined in the Local Plan. The coast and estuary, the historic environment and the rolling rural landscape continue to provide a sense of identity and belonging which remain vital assets for northern Devon's economy.

The northern Devon Economic Strategy, together in partnership with the Heart of the South West Local Enterprise Partnership, has helped to create a stronger and more competitive local economy that has benefited from inward investment and significant growth in the availability of job opportunities.

The area builds on the marine environment's latent ability to attract investment to deliver port regeneration and renewable energy production. Tourism remains an important element of our economy and the Plan has supported businesses to invest in quality facilities, accommodation and services.

Businesses have access to a locally based, highly skilled workforce, thanks to the high quality educational and training provision available in the area. Petroc College builds on its success with local universities and businesses and helps to attract and retain the brightest graduates and apprentices in the area.

Residents, businesses and visitors enjoy better accessibility within and beyond the area through the implementation of major improvements to the highway network and improved links to Exeter via the Tarka Line. There will also be a series of smaller but vital infrastructure improvements across the area, including improvements to local roads, junctions, public transport provision, drainage and water infrastructure. These improvements will make a positive impact on local residents' day-to-day life.

Local residents and those working in the area will have access to a range of housing types and tenures that will help to meet the needs of single, young family and older people households.

Housing has become more affordable, adaptable and accessible for first time buyers and for those living on their pensions and wishing to stay in their communities.

The rural area has evolved, rather than stagnated, both in terms of village growth (where appropriate and supported locally) and the opportunities for rural businesses and agriculture to thrive.

The North Devon Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty (AONB) continues to protect the dramatic coastal landscape, from Marshland Mouth on the Cornish border to Combe Martin on the boundary of Exmoor National Park. The Biosphere Reserve, at the heart of the AONB, has provided the catalyst for achieving innovative and exemplar sustainable development. Local building styles and materials have been encouraged, using local trades and supply chains. The Plan has supported renewable energy production of all types where it has not damaged the environment in which it sits.

More residents enjoy an active and healthy life through the investment in Green Infrastructure, which has improved the quality of and access to a better-connected network of open spaces and achieved a net gain in biodiversity. New developments have also been designed to promote healthier living.

Barnstaple and Bideford have delivered new jobs and homes, supported with continued inward investment to deliver key infrastructure to support their roles as vibrant and innovative centres in commerce, culture, education and services.

Braunton and Wrafton, South Molton and Holsworthy have achieved significant growth in the number of new jobs, which has been supported by new homes and facilities to meet their own and wider needs. A regeneration led strategy at Ilfracombe has delivered new jobs, homes and facilities, and it has built on its reputation as a maritime hub and a centre for creative excellence.

Northam (including Appledore and Westward Ho!) and Great Torrington meet their needs and continue to offer local services and remain at the heart of the area's coastal and rural economy, respectively.

The Councils have delivered each of the following aims and objectives based on the principles of achieving sustainable development. This has been achieved by working with local communities to help deliver their ambitions to make them as self sufficient as possible.

Strategic Aims and Objectives

Aim 1: A Vibrant Northern Devon Economy – where excellent opportunities support diverse low carbon growth and moves towards an economy that supports our world class environment.

Objectives:

- (a) a rejuvenated economy, supported by appropriate infrastructure that provides excellent opportunities for all through an extended range of well paid and skilled jobs;
- (b) innovation and entrepreneurship will be encouraged through enhanced ICT opportunities and the promotion of new ways of working to create the conditions in which businesses can grow and prosper;

(c) economic development in urban and rural areas shall regenerate and diversify the local economy without adverse environmental and social impacts to create high quality employment environments;

(d) excellent learning opportunities and local facilities will deliver the skills appropriate for innovation and growth in important and enterprising economic sectors;

(e) town and village centres are sustainable vibrant places;

(f) sustainable growth in the maritime, engineering, tourism and leisure economies;

(g) an agricultural sector, which is rejuvenated and supported to maintain and enhance its essential contribution to the well being and land use management of the rural area; and

(h) an economy that supports and complements the area's world class environment.

Aim 2: A World Class Environment – where important assets are valued and enhanced for future generations.

Objectives:

(a) the undeveloped coastline, estuarine and important countryside assets of northern Devon are protected and enhanced;

(b) important wildlife habitats, protected landscapes, and our distinctive heritage are conserved and enhanced and the decline of biodiversity is reversed;

(c) land is used efficiently and effectively – optimise how ecosystem services provide and result in productive living landscapes and townscape that adapt to our changing needs;

(d) high quality sustainable building and construction minimises the risks arising from climate change and new development is designed and located to mitigate and adapt to the effects of climate change⁽¹³⁾;

(e) the demand for travel is managed – location of development minimises the need to travel, improves accessibility to jobs, facilities and services and measures associated with new development allow for achievement of the highest standards appropriate to the world-class environment of northern Devon;

(f) demand for resources including energy and water are managed sustainably for efficient and effective use; and

(g) development improves water quality in rivers, lakes, estuary and coastal waters to help deliver the South West River Basin Management Plan objectives⁽¹⁴⁾.

Aim 3: A Balanced Local Housing Market – where a choice of decent housing of all types is available and new development meets community needs.

Objectives:

(a) a choice of decent, well-designed housing for the range of needs of our existing and future communities⁽¹⁵⁾;

13 in line with the objectives and provisions of the Climate Change Act 2008

14 South West River Basin Management Plan (2009 with subsequent amendments) Environment Agency

15 in line with the provisions of national planning policy that seek local planning authorities to *meet the full, objectively assessed needs for market and affordable housing* (Paragraph 47, National Planning Policy Framework, CLG, March 2012)

- (b) a range of affordable housing tenures appropriate to meet local needs;
- (c) rural housing needs for all localities to be met in sustainable locations;
- (d) the provision of appropriately located infrastructure to support a growing population;
and
- (e) a balance between housing, employment and infrastructure provision, which are secured in step with growth to anticipate demographic trends.

Aim 4: Mixed Communities – where there is a strong community spirit and the opportunity for an excellent quality of life.

Objectives:

- (a) growth that improves the sustainable self-sufficiency of communities;
- (b) sustainable and accessible transport links are available where needed – there are improved opportunities to access the full range of services and facilities;
- (c) the investment in low carbon futures and in modern healthcare, social, sports, recreational, leisure and cultural services and facilities fulfils the requirements of our growing and changing population;
- (d) vulnerable and disadvantaged groups are fully supported by buoyant community and voluntary sectors;
- (e) inequalities within the most deprived areas are reduced and the gap between the fortunes of neighbourhoods is reduced;
- (f) there is a good work life balance – with live work opportunities and more opportunities for residents and visitors to lead healthy lives including access to high quality accessible greenspace;
- (g) community environments are safe and secure – crime and anti-social behaviour are tackled effectively;
- (h) everyone has access to a wide range of high quality education and training opportunities;
- (i) the built environment is designed to promote healthy living and support an ageing population;
- (j) the separate identities and characteristics of individual settlements are protected; and
- (k) public access to environmental assets is improved to support collective and individual wellbeing.



SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT

3 Sustainable Development

Principles of Sustainable Development

Policy ST01: Principles of Sustainable Development

(1) When considering development proposals the Councils will take a positive approach that reflects the presumption in favour of sustainable development contained in the National Planning Policy Framework. The Councils will always work proactively with applicants and local communities to find solutions which mean that proposals can be approved wherever possible, and to secure development that improves the economic, social and environmental conditions in the area.

(2) Planning applications that accord with the policies in this Local Plan (and where relevant with policies in Neighbourhood Plans) will be approved unless material considerations indicate otherwise.

(3) Where there are no policies relevant to an application, or relevant policies are out of date at the time of making the decision, then the Councils will grant permission unless material considerations indicate otherwise, taking into account whether:

(a) any adverse impacts of granting permission would significantly and demonstrably outweigh the benefits, when assessed against the policies in the National Planning Policy Framework taken as a whole; or

(b) specific policies in that Framework or guidance in the National Planning Practice Guidance indicate that development should be restricted.

3.1 The purpose of the planning system is to contribute to the achievement of sustainable development. Development will be expected to make a positive contribution towards the social, economic and environmental sustainability of northern Devon and its communities while minimising its environmental footprint. Therefore there is a need for the Local Plan to perform a number of roles:

- **An economic role:** contributing to building a diverse and resilient economy that can adapt to challenges and maximise opportunities by:
 - i. implementing the Northern Devon Economic Strategy;
 - ii. ensuring that sufficient land of the appropriate type is available in suitable locations and at the right time to support growth and innovation; and
 - iii. identifying and co-ordinating development requirements, including the provision of effective infrastructure.
- **An environmental role:** contributing to protecting and enhancing northern Devon's unique natural, built and historic environment by:
 - i. the prudent use of resources and minimise waste and pollution;
 - ii. encouraging the reuse of previously developed land; and
 - iii. mitigating and adapting to climate change including moving towards a low carbon economy.
- **A social role:** supporting strong, vibrant and healthy communities in northern Devon by:

- i. providing a supply of housing required to meet the needs of present and future generations;
- ii. creating a high-quality built environment, with accessible local services and facilities that reflect the community's needs and support its health, social and cultural well-being; and
- iii. ensuring a balanced mix of uses where development takes place in sustainable locations by reducing the need to travel.

3.2 These three roles cannot be undertaken in isolation because they are mutually dependent. To achieve sustainable development, economic, social and environmental gains will be sought jointly and concurrently wherever possible.

3.3 A better understanding of the use and management of natural resources can secure higher economic, environmental and social benefits. Our health and wellbeing depends on the services provided by ecosystems and their components: water, soil, nutrients and organisms. Locally, the Biosphere Reserve aims to show northern Devon as a world class exemplar for sustainable development.

3.4 The Local Plan will seek to guide development to achieve sustainable solutions and taken as a whole, constitute the Councils' view of what sustainable development means in practice for the area when promoted through the planning system.

Mitigating Climate Change

Policy ST02: Mitigating Climate Change

Development will be expected to make a positive contribution towards the social, economic and environmental sustainability of northern Devon and its communities while minimising its environmental footprint by:

- (a) reducing greenhouse gas emissions by locating development appropriately and achieving high standards of design;**
- (b) conserving and enhancing the natural, built and historic environment through the prudent use of key resources including land, buildings and energy, whilst protecting and enhancing the area's biodiversity, geodiversity, landscape, coastline, air, water, archaeology and culture;**
- (c) ensuring a balanced mix of uses where development takes place in environmentally, socially and economically sustainable locations by reducing the need to travel, especially by car, and facilitating a step-change towards the use of sustainable modes of transport including walking, cycling and public transport;**
- (d) promoting opportunities for renewable and low-carbon energy generation whilst conserving and enhancing the natural and built environment;**
- (e) redeveloping previously developed land and reducing, reusing and recycling resources, including construction materials, providing for more efficient use of facilities and enhanced opportunities for recycling; and**
- (f) reducing pressure on water resources and increasing their reuse through sustainable water management.**

3.5 The world's climate is changing and man-made emissions are a contributory cause. Addressing climate change is the Government's principal driver for sustainable development. The Climate Change Act 2008 sets a legally binding target for a cut in greenhouse gas emissions of at least 80% by 2050, and a reduction in emissions of at least 34% by 2020, set against a 1990 baseline. Policy ST02: Mitigating Climate Change will contribute to these targets.

3.6 There is a need for urgent progress towards making future development more sustainable. The Local Plan will play a key role in helping to achieve reductions in greenhouse gas emissions at a local level. Locally the Biosphere Reserve aims to show northern Devon as a world-class exemplar for sustainable development using innovative approaches to achieve this⁽¹⁶⁾. Reuse and redevelopment of previously developed land will be encouraged where available and environmental constraints allow.

3.7 The Local Plan will reduce greenhouse gas emissions through the sustainable location, and high standards of design of new development. The bulk of new housing and employment growth will be located within Barnstaple and Bideford with the remaining growth concentrated around the other main towns (Policy ST08: Scale and Distribution of New Development in Northern Devon). Creating mixed communities will ensure good connectivity between housing and employment provision, subsequently reducing the need to travel. Development within rural settlements will contribute to making communities more sustainable (Policy ST07: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Rural Area) and reducing the need to travel between settlements. The co-location of development will also facilitate use of sustainable modes of transport, such as public transport, walking and cycling (Policy ST10: Transport Strategy).

3.8 The Government's target is for new homes to be zero-carbon by 2016⁽¹⁷⁾, with a similar ambition to cut carbon emissions from non-domestic buildings. The Local Plan will support design that maximises energy efficiency (Policy ST05: Sustainable Construction and Buildings) and opportunities for renewable energy and heat generation (Policy ST16: Delivering Renewable Energy and Heat) whilst remaining economically viable.

3.9 New developments should also reduce their use of water as its supply requires energy through its treatment and distribution. In addition to incorporating water efficient design principles, water usage will also be reduced through sustainable water management, such as reuse of rainwater. Reducing water usage will contribute to the reduction of greenhouse gas emissions.

3.10 Construction materials will be reused to make effective use of resources and, where appropriate, recycled to reduce waste. Use of locally sourced materials, where they represent a viable option, will reduce the need to transport them over long distances, as well as supporting the local economy. Local materials with lower embodied energy should also be used, such as lime rather than cement in mortars and renders, and natural slate rather than concrete roof tiles. Use of these materials will also reflect how buildings were traditionally constructed and, together with locally sourced materials, will provide opportunities to enhance local distinctiveness (Policy ST04: Improving the Quality of Design).

3.11 Northern Devon's environment can also help to mitigate the impact of climate change through an ecosystem services approach. For example, enhancing existing habitats can mitigate climate change through 'carbon fixing', including the planting of new woodlands and bog restoration. The objective to achieve a net gain in northern Devon's biodiversity is set out in Policy ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets. Ecosystem services can also help to adapt to impacts such as flood risk, water quality and drought, as an alternative to artificial measures with a greater carbon footprint. The Councils will also support provision of new allotments and community

16 North Devon Biosphere Reserve's Strategy for Sustainable Development 2008-2012

17 Building a Greener Future: a policy statement, CLG 2007

gardens to grow local produce that will help reduce carbon emissions from food-miles whilst contributing to green infrastructure and the local economy.

Adapting to Climate Change

Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience

Development should be designed and constructed to take account of the impacts of climate change and minimise the risk to and vulnerability of people, land, infrastructure and property by:

- (a) locating and designing development to minimise flood risk through:**
 - (i) avoiding the development of land for vulnerable uses which is or will be at risk from flooding, and**
 - (ii) managing and reducing flood risk for development where that has wider sustainability or regeneration benefits to the community, or where there is no reasonable alternative site;**
- (b) reducing existing rates of surface water runoff within Critical Drainage Areas;**
- (c) upgrading flood defences and protecting key transport routes from risks of flooding;**
- (d) re-establishing functional flood plains in accordance with the Shoreline Management Plan, Flood Risk Management Plan and Catchment Action Plan;**
- (e) locating development to avoid risk from current and future coastal erosion;**
- (f) adopting effective water management including Sustainable Drainage Systems, water quality improvements, water efficiency measures and the use of rainwater;**
- (g) ensuring development is resilient to the impacts of climate change through making effective use of renewable resources, passive heating and cooling, natural light and ventilation;**
- (h) ensuring risks from potential climate change hazards, including pollutants (of air and land) are minimised to protect and promote healthy and safe environments;**
- (i) conserving and enhancing landscapes and networks of habitats, including cross-boundary green infrastructure links, strengthening the resilience of biodiversity to climate change by facilitating migration of wildlife between habitats and improving their connectivity;**
- (j) protecting and integrating green infrastructure into urban areas, improving access to natural and managed green space; and**
- (k) promoting the potential contribution from ecosystem services that support adaptation to climate change.**

3.12 Adaptation to climate change⁽¹⁸⁾, alongside mitigation measures, is an essential part of addressing the challenges and opportunities associated with the anticipated climate change in northern Devon. Adaptation will involve a mixture of approaches including enhanced design specifications, increased preparedness and in some cases the acceptance of occasional losses, such as exceptional managed realignment of the coastline. In providing for necessary development, the Local Plan must take into account the potential consequences of climate change.

3.13 The United Kingdom Climate Impacts Programme⁽¹⁹⁾ draws attention to the likelihood that we will be experiencing hotter and drier summers and milder and wetter winters. Furthermore, extreme weather events will become increasingly frequent, including heatwaves, gales, storms, tidal surges and intense rainfall. In combination with rising sea levels, the predicted results of these changes will include:

- (a) increased fluvial and coastal flooding and flooding from sewers;
- (b) increased coastal erosion;
- (c) more frequent and prolonged periods of drought; and
- (d) changes to the distribution of species and habitats.

3.14 North Devon and Torridge Strategic Flood Risk Assessments⁽²⁰⁾ indicate that northern Devon will be liable to increased flooding in a number of locations. Principally, this will be by fluvial flooding along the main river valleys, tidal flooding along the Taw-Torridge estuary and along the coastline. More localised cases of flooding will be from high surface water run-off and inadequate land and highway drainage. Level 2 Strategic Flood Risk Assessments are available for Barnstaple, Bideford and Northam which identify those areas at greatest risk from flooding. The types of development that can take place in areas with different degrees of flood risk will be informed by additional detailed flood risk assessments. These will determine the appropriate nature and siting of development in areas that are at known flood risk, most significantly in respect of opportunities for development in Barnstaple and Bideford where sustainability benefits will include regeneration objectives.

3.15 The North Devon and Somerset Shoreline Management Plan Review⁽²¹⁾ will provide the policy framework for the planning and management of coastal defences. The coastline is also subject to constant change from the effects of climate change, which will influence the use of this important asset. Managed realignment of parts of the coastline will be necessary in view of rising sea levels, especially along stretches of the Taw-Torridge estuary (Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy). The North Devon Catchment Flood Risk Management Plan⁽²²⁾ establishes flood risk management policies for all types of inland flooding to deliver sustainable flood risk management. The operational effectiveness of key transport routes will be protected from flood risk, including the Tarka Trail and Tarka railway line between Barnstaple and Exeter (Policy ST10: Transport Strategy).

3.16 New and improved flood defences will be delivered within the main towns, and along the coast in accordance with the Shoreline Management Plan, by upgrading existing defences as part of development proposals, and from funding through planning obligations, Community Infrastructure Levy and external funding sources.

18 "Adjustments in natural or human systems in response to actual or expected climatic stimuli, or their effects, which moderate harm or exploit beneficial opportunities", The Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change

19 www.ukcip.org.uk/

20 North Devon and Torridge Strategic Flood Risk Assessments – Level 1

21 www.ndascag.org

22 <http://cdn.environment-agency.gov.uk/gesw1109boun-e-e.pdf>

3.17 Functional flood plains are where water is stored during a flood event and should be safeguarded and enhanced wherever possible. Re-establishing functional flood plains in appropriate locations, including by removal of existing flood defences, will increase flood storage capacity to help address increasing flood risks as a result of rising sea levels. Re-establishing functional flood plains will also mitigate 'coastal squeeze' between rising sea levels and existing coastal defences and will potentially create additional habitats. Land around the Taw-Torridge estuary is identified within the coastal and floodplain grazing marsh strategic nature area⁽²³⁾ as one of the best places in the South West for major habitat expansion for this priority habitat.

3.18 In recognition of the increased flood risks from climate change and in line with national policy, the Local Plan will apply a precautionary approach to the location of new development. This will avoid inappropriate development in areas at risk of flooding or coastal change and minimise risks for people, property and infrastructure. In exceptional circumstances, where development or infrastructure is necessary in areas at risk, appropriate mitigation measures will be required, but must not increase flood risks elsewhere. Exceptional circumstances include where the development has wider sustainability benefits to the community, or where there is no reasonable alternative site.

3.19 There are limited opportunities for the historic environment to adapt to changing climate. The Shoreline Management Plan Review from Hartland Point to Anchor Point (in Somerset) has recognised the distribution of heritage assets and the majority of listed buildings are within the main coastal communities where they are to be protected by holding the line of existing defences. Elsewhere, heritage assets will be defended where feasible and viable.

3.20 The Water Framework Directive requires all inland and coastal waters to reach at least 'good' status by 2015. This requires water management planning at river basin level and there is a need for development to ensure water quality is not adversely impacted and opportunities for improvements are sought. Development will maximise the use of Sustainable Drainage Systems (SUDS) in order to minimise run-off onto adjacent and other downstream property and control its discharge into sewer and river systems. Provision of Sustainable Drainage Systems should be integrated with the delivery of green infrastructure and a net gain in biodiversity. These systems should be designed to maximise their multi-functionality and located away from catchments of sensitive designated features. Critical Drainage Areas are defined by the Environment Agency in areas with localised flooding and pressures from new development. Within Critical Drainage Areas all new development will utilise Sustainable Drainage Systems to reduce current runoff rates by creating additional water storage areas contributing to a reduction in flood risk downstream. The Torridge River Nature Improvement Area and Taw River Improvement Project both deliver catchment sensitive farming to improve water resource management.

3.21 Adaptation measures in the design of development are also important. As temperatures increase, natural cooling will need to be introduced through appropriate siting and orientation of new development, with landscaping and tree planting in appropriate locations. Measures to avoid internal over-heating and excessive heat generation could include passive solar design, natural ventilation and vegetation on buildings ('green roofs').

3.22 Increasing the network of green corridors and accessible natural greenspaces, known collectively as Green Infrastructure, will be important in facilitating the movement of wildlife and people. Connectivity between habitats will become increasingly important as climate change renders existing habitats less suitable and development pressures increase to ensure delivery of necessary growth. Cross-boundary linkages within green infrastructure networks will be supported. Green infrastructure will become an increasingly significant asset that provides residents, particularly in urban areas, with sustainable access for informal greenspaces, sport and leisure activities. Enhancing the green infrastructure network within the main towns will be

23 http://www.devon.gov.uk/index/environment/natural_environment/biodiversity/regionalnaturemap.htm

an important part of future developments. In the built up areas of northern Devon, strategic green spaces will also be important in minimising the urban heat island effect⁽²⁴⁾ and as functional flood plain to mitigate against flood risk. Delivery of green infrastructure will be co-ordinated through a future green infrastructure strategy and the Infrastructure Delivery Plan.

3.23 The Core Area of the UNESCO Biosphere Reserve at Braunton Burrows is the prime conservation interest and is managed to conserve the sand dune ecosystem. The Core Area is also a Special Area of Conservation (SAC) and a Site of Special Scientific Interest (SSSI). The Buffer Zone surrounds and supports the Core Area and is a continuous area of conservation management where only activities compatible with the conservation objectives can take place. The wider Transition Zone seeks to promote more sustainable use of the environment with human interaction. The Reserve's Transition Zone covers the majority of northern Devon, where the Local Plan supports the strategic objective of promoting natural environmental systems and more sustainable use of the environment.

3.24 Broad environmental systems will guide sustainable development within the Biosphere Reserve and promote adaptation to climate change. Environmental benefits can be indirectly obtained through natural processes, for example, planting trees will not only absorb carbon dioxide but will create new habitat, reduce soil erosion, provide flood attenuation and, as a consequence of this, will improve water quality downstream. Similarly, Sustainable Drainage Systems will slow down the volume of water entering our watercourses, thereby reducing the magnitude of flood risks downstream and reducing erosion as well as improving the water's quality. These would have a further benefit of helping to improve the quality of our beaches and bathing waters.

3.25 Climate change will provide some new opportunities, especially prospective economic and tourism potential, which will be embraced.

Improving the Quality of Development

Policy ST04: Improving the Quality of Development

Development will achieve high quality inclusive and sustainable design to support the creation of successful, vibrant places. Design will be based on a clear process that analyses and responds to the characteristics of the site, its wider context and the surrounding area taking full account of the principles of design found in policy DM04.

3.26 Good design is essential to produce attractive, high quality, sustainable and inclusive places in which people want to live, work and spend their recreational time. In order to promote the key objectives of improving the quality of development, high standards of design will help new developments create successful places, be visually interesting and complement their townscape or landscape.

3.27 Density standards are not defined in respect of residential development. Within the context of making efficient use of land, it is recognised that a flexible approach to density is required to create successful places, respond to site specific factors and achieve quality residential environments. Good design will result in variable densities that appropriately takes account of the principles set out in Policy DM04: Design Principles.

3.28 In support of achieving good design, the expectation is for early and meaningful engagement with the Local Planning Authority and local community through pre-application discussions and effective Design and Access Statements. New development will respond to the changing demographic needs of northern Devon over the plan period by increasing opportunities

24 www.weatherquestions.com/What_is_the_urban_heat_island.htm

for everyone to access and participate in their communities to help enjoy and feel secure in their neighbourhoods.

3.29 Within the Biosphere Reserve Transition Zone, development will be encouraged to demonstrate innovative approaches and solutions to show northern Devon as a world-class exemplar for sustainable development in accordance with the Biosphere Reserve strategy's⁽²⁵⁾ objective. Viability will not be jeopardised⁽²⁶⁾. Sustainable development will utilise natural resources more efficiently in its design, construction and future use. Energy and water efficient design will be encouraged as per the stated requirements found in Policy ST05: Sustainable Construction and Buildings.

3.30 Aspects and principles of design are provided through a more detailed development management Policy DM04: Design Principles. Development will be expected to adhere to or exceed current Building Regulations, statutory planning and design requirements and supplementary planning guidance which may be published or referenced by the local planning authority on specific allocations or certain types of development.

3.31 Streets should be places in which people want to live and spend time in, and are not just transport corridors. Guidance found in the 'Manual for Streets'⁽²⁷⁾ supports the Councils' aims to reduce the impact of vehicles on residential streets by asking practitioners to plan street design intelligently and proactively, and give a high priority to the needs of pedestrians, cyclists and users of public transport.

3.32 Applicants are encouraged to utilise Sport England's 'Active Design' principles⁽²⁸⁾ to help create environments that maximise opportunities for participation in sport and physical activity. The Councils will require applicants to adopt the criteria based approach advocated by Active Design to inform the master planning stage of major developments.

3.33 The route to successful development is through a coordinated design process. Applicants are encouraged to involve the local planning and the Highways Authority at the earliest opportunity to discuss new development proposals.

Sustainable Construction and Buildings

Policy ST05: Sustainable Construction and Buildings

(1) All new major development proposals will make a positive contribution towards the creation of resilient and cohesive communities and ensure that built and environmental assets can adapt to and be resilient to climate change.

(2) Non-domestic development of at least 1,000m² will be expected to achieve a BREEAM rating of 'Very Good'.

(3) All new major development will be encouraged to build to a standard which minimises the consumption of resources during construction and thereafter in its occupation through:

(a) incorporating passive design measures to reduce overall energy demand and improve energy efficiency through the design and layout of the site;

25 North Devon Biosphere Reserve's Strategy for Sustainable Development 2014 - 2024 or successor documents

26 <http://www.communities.gov.uk/documents/planningandbuilding/pdf/codecostanalysis.pdf>

27 Manual for streets (Department of Transport, 2007) www.gov.uk

28 Active Design is a set of design guidelines to promote opportunities for sport and physical activity in the design and layout of development. (www.sportengland.org)

(b) connecting to any existing or proposed decentralised energy scheme or developing a scheme individually or jointly within a specified time frame;

(c) maximising opportunities for renewable and low carbon technologies; and

(d) using locally sourced and/or recycled materials in construction where they are available and represent a viable option.

3.34 All new development will be expected to minimise carbon dioxide emissions in construction and operation through sustainable design and construction, energy efficiency, and incorporation of renewable energy technology as appropriate and in accordance with Policies ST04: Improving the Quality of Design, ST16: Delivering Renewable Energy and Heat, DM04: Design Principles and general principles of achieving sustainable development.

3.35 Carbon dioxide reduction and fuel poverty are key issues for northern Devon. Sustainable construction and renewable energy generation (Policy ST16: Delivering Renewable Energy and Heat) can help achieve emission reduction. The cost implications of installing carbon dioxide emissions reduction measures initially are less than if they were retrofitted.

3.36 Northern Devon's carbon dioxide emissions per capita are above the Devon and the South West median for local authorities⁽²⁹⁾. Fuel poverty levels in northern Devon are very high compared to local authorities in Devon, the South West and England.

3.37 In spite of increasingly rigorous standards at the point of build, new development often fails in practice to deliver expected carbon dioxide emissions reduction. This can be due to the way in which occupants subsequently operate their buildings rather than any fault with the building process.

3.38 The broader sustainability performance of non-domestic development is most commonly measured using BREEAM. It is expected that BREEAM standards will be used to demonstrate the environmental performance of developments for non-domestic buildings above 1,000m². The Local Plan supports and encourages alternative construction standards, such as PassivHaus, that can deliver more sustainable design beyond the requirements of Building Regulations.

3.39 Further carbon dioxide emission reductions should be met through appropriate renewable and low carbon systems where feasible and viable. Guidance on generating renewable energy from or surrounding historic buildings is set out in Policy DM07: Historic Environment.

3.40 Developments being delivered beyond 2021 will need to comply with the energy performance requirements of the EU Energy Performance Buildings Directive (EPBD) or successor⁽³⁰⁾. Early investment in low carbon energy infrastructure may help to spread the costs of subsequent compliance and improve the overall viability of developments.

3.41 The requirements are justified as an innovative approach in support of the UK's first Biosphere Reserve and will help to deliver the strategy's objectives of demonstrating innovative approach to showing northern Devon as an exemplar for sustainable development.

3.42 Developments should use local sourced and/or recycled materials where appropriate to minimise waste and make prudent use of resources. Where available, locally sourced materials will help to reinforce local distinctiveness and will help to reduce embodied energy through transport of materials.

29 Department of Energy and Climate Change: Emissions within the scope of influence of Local Authorities (National Indicator 186: Per capita CO₂ emissions in the LA area), Aug 2012

30 OJEU, Directive 2010/31/EU, June 2010

3.43 The need to reduce construction waste also complements Policy ST02: Mitigating Climate Change, which seeks to reduce, reuse and recycle resources including construction materials. Major developments will be required to provide a site waste management plan in accordance with the Devon Waste Plan.

3.44 All new development will seek to minimise flood risk through the use of Sustainable Drainage Systems and appropriate integration with green infrastructure. Controls to manage surface water runoff should be located as close as possible to where the rainwater drains, providing varying degrees of treatment for surface water through natural processes of sedimentation, filtration and biological degradation. New developments will be expected to demonstrate effective surface water management. This will include the successful assimilation of Sustainable Drainage Systems into the local landscape, where it will provide net gains in biodiversity and green infrastructure, manage run-off flow rates and enhance water quality by managing potential pollution at source.



SPATIAL STRATEGY

4 Spatial Strategy

Spatial Development Strategy

4.1 The spatial strategy for northern Devon provides a framework to deliver development that is necessary to meet the area's future needs; it takes account of area characteristics and issues and how such can be managed to achieve the northern Devon Vision. The adopted approach reflects on the: function of and relationship between settlements, growth requirements, opportunities to achieve sustainable development, the adequacy of infrastructure to accommodate growth and the implications of meeting housing and economic needs.

4.2 Growth, both urban and rural, is required to meet the increasing and changing needs of the area's population. Development, particularly affordable housing, the provision of jobs, social and community facilities is required to help sustain, enhance and make the area's towns and villages more self supporting places to live and work. In accommodating such needs the emphasis is to locate development in areas which are well located to other uses, serviced by a choice of transport modes and accessible to the communities they serve.

Figure 4.1 Settlement Hierarchy and Distribution



4.3 The development strategy, as established in Policies ST06: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Sub-regional, Strategic and Main Centres and ST07: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Rural Area, provides for the continuation of recognised roles, but also flexibility for settlements to achieve growth in accordance with locally determined aspirations having regard to local circumstances.

4.4 Development will continue to be focused at the Taw-Torridge estuary settlements of Barnstaple and Bideford with further growth planned for all northern Devon towns. The overall growth pattern is aimed at enabling communities to achieve their potential through the delivery of economic growth and secure social infrastructure improvements that contribute to increasingly balanced communities, within the context of meeting assessed needs and demands.

4.5 The hierarchy provided by Policies ST06: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Sub-regional, Strategic and Main Centres and ST07: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Rural Area, and illustrated in Figure 4.1 provides the foundation for the distribution of development and service provision in northern Devon. It sets the spatial context for the Local Plan based on a strategy that seeks to build sustainable communities that have the housing, facilities and access to jobs necessary to thrive and the social and cultural infrastructure to support and enrich community life.

4.6 A settlement broadly reflects the main built up form of a place that provides a concentrated focus for living and economic activity. The Councils' assessment of settlements (Settlement Service Availability Assessment 2012) provides evidence on the settlements role and function and is the basis for testing the qualification of classified settlements.

Policy ST06: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Sub-regional, Strategic and Main Centres

Development will be supported within the development boundaries of the Sub-regional, Strategic and Main Centres, as defined on the Policies Map in accordance with the following hierarchy:

Settlement Status	North Devon	Torridge	Definition
Sub-regional Centre	Barnstaple		Barnstaple will be the focus for future growth in northern Devon. Significant levels of development will be accommodated in Barnstaple consistent with its scale and strategic importance as a service and employment centre, leading to increased self-containment to meet its own needs and those of the surrounding area.
Strategic Centre		Bideford	Bideford will provide a focus for housing and employment development. Significant levels of development will be accommodated in Bideford consistent with its scale and its complementary role to Barnstaple. Sustainable development opportunities will be secured to increase self-containment and achieve balanced development to enable the town to meet its own needs and those of the surrounding area.
Main Centres	Braunton and Wrafton, Ilfracombe, South Molton	Great Torrington, Holsworthy, Northam (inc. Appledore and Westward Ho!)	The Main Centres will support appropriate levels of growth that will increase the towns' capacities to increase self-containment, to meet their own needs and those of surrounding communities where such is sought through the local vision.

4.7 Barnstaple will continue to develop as a Sub-regional Centre. Bideford will develop its role as an important service centre, performing a complementary role to Barnstaple, each centre building on existing strengths to increase self containment and support wider community needs. Growth at Braunton and Wrafton, South Molton and Holsworthy will achieve employment led expansion supported by housing growth to meet their own and wider needs. Northam provides a complementary role to Bideford, recognising its close relationship to it, will help to deliver housing, services and facilities to meet needs across the wider urban area. At Ilfracombe, regeneration led development will deliver significant local growth aspirations. Great Torrington will develop further to meet the settlement's own needs and those of the wider community. The development of all the towns will have regard to the contained and adjoining historic and environmental assets.

4.8 Development boundaries are defined on the Policies Maps, for the Strategic and Main Centres, within which allocations are provided to meet assessed needs and demands having regard to settlement specific visions, as set out in the Town Strategies section of the Local Plan.

4.9 The Settlement Service Availability Assessment 2012 identifies Fremington and Yelland as a 'Local Centre'. It is however recognised that the two settlements can deliver significant sustainable growth by virtue of their location between Barnstaple and Bideford and the availability of strategic sites; the settlements are consequently included in the Town Strategies section of the Local Plan.

Rural Areas Strategy

4.10 The rural area will be sustained as a living and working environment; rural communities are recognised as a vital part of the fabric of northern Devon. To maintain this positive contribution, local people will be enabled to live and work within their communities on the basis of the rural hierarchy of settlements set out in Policy ST07: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Rural Area. Allowing villages to grow is recognised as essential to sustain active and balanced communities that contribute to maintaining the viability of the rural area. While supporting appropriately located and scaled growth, the Local Plan will also seek to ensure development does not exacerbate the areas dispersed settlement pattern, that the landscape quality is not compromised and any conflicts with the principles of sustainable development are minimised.

4.11 Although diverse in character, the area's rural communities face similar challenges. The loss of rural based services, inadequate access to public transport, the changing nature of the rural economy, the limited supply of affordable housing for local people and reduced housing choice to accommodate varying household requirements are all key issues.

4.12 Planning for growth in the rural area will help sustain active and balanced villages that contribute to maintaining the viability of the rural area. The primary focus for rural development will be to maintain population numbers, which over the plan period is expected to decline by 5% due to an ageing population, smaller household sizes and second homes. Rural development will also be expected to assist in meeting local needs and supporting the facilities and services available in rural areas whilst safeguarding, and where possible, enhancing the natural and built environment. In the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty, great weight will be given to conserving landscape and scenic beauty in consideration of proposals.

Policy ST07: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Rural Area

Development will be supported, in accordance with the following hierarchy, to achieve an economically resilient and active rural area. Development in Schedule A and B settlements will be enabled: within development boundaries and on allocated sites defined on the Policies Map, and within the principal built form of settlements without development boundaries.

(1) Local Centres, defined in Schedule A, will be the primary focus for development in the rural area; development will be supported in accordance with the local spatial strategies, to enhance the sustainability of the locally important service centres and to enable wider than local needs to be met.

Schedule A: Local Centres:

North Devon	Torridge
Bratton Fleming, Chulmleigh, Combe Martin, Fremington and Yelland, Instow, North Molton, Witheridge, and Woolacombe.	Bradworthy, Buckland Brewer, Dolton, Halwill Junction, Hartland, High Bickington, Shebbear, and Winkleigh.

(2) Development in Villages, defined in Schedule B, will be enabled in accordance with the local spatial strategy to meet local needs and growth aspirations.

Schedule B: Villages:

North Devon	Torridge
Atherington, Berrynarbor, Bishop's Nympton, Bishop's Tawton, Burrington, Chittlehampton, Croyde, East Anstey, East Worlington, Filleigh, Georgeham, Goodleigh, Kentisbury / Kentisbury Ford, King's Nympton, Knowle, Landkey, Lower Lovacott / Newton Tracey, Mortehoe, Rackenford, Shirwell, Swimbridge, Umberleigh, and West Down.	Abbotsham, Ashwater, Beaford, Black Torrington, Bridgerule, Bucks Cross, Chilsworthy, Clawton, Clovelly / Higher Clovelly, Langtree, Merton, Milton Damerel / Venn Green, Monkleigh, Parkham, Pyworthy, Sheepwash, St Giles on the Heath, Stibb Cross, Sutcombe, Tetcott, Welcombe / Darracott, and Woolfardisworthy.

(3) In Rural Settlements which contain at least one prescribed service or community facility, appropriately located development of a modest scale will be enabled to meet locally generated needs.

(4) In the Countryside, beyond Local Centres, Villages and Rural Settlements, development will be limited to that which is enabled to meet local economic and social

needs, rural building reuse and development which is necessarily restricted to a Countryside location.

4.13 The Local Plan seeks to assist rural communities to become more sustainable, enabling housing, economic and community based development directed at meeting local needs. The focus for development in the rural area will be at Local Centres and Villages. Housing growth is planned in Local Centres, to support their role as rural service centres, enabling wider than local needs to be addressed. At Villages, housing growth is planned to maintain existing population levels and to support existing service levels. To enable rural communities to become more self-sustaining, the Local Plan aims to support appropriate development that will deliver:

- a. homes: a minimum of 2,000 rural dwellings across the rural area of a type, size and tenure reflecting local needs and demands, in support of the local vision and development strategy;
- b. jobs: the growth, expansion and diversification of businesses and enterprise through the conversion of existing buildings and well designed new buildings and sites;
- c. facilities and services: the retention of existing and the development of new and enhanced local services, community facilities and recreation opportunities that contribute to a community's prosperity and well-being, in accordance with Policy ST22: Community Services and Facilities; and
- d. infrastructure: measures that reduce the need to travel or utilise sustainable transport links. Where feasible in accordance with ST10: Transport Strategy for Northern Devon. High speed electronic communications links will be encouraged, particularly where they will reduce social isolation or improve business opportunities.

4.14 Part 2 of the Local Plan provides a neighbourhood planning approach to the Local Centres and Villages, which has been developed in response to community based aspirations. Community preference has also dictated the use of development boundaries, which have been established for the majority of Policy ST07: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Rural Area, defined settlements.

4.15 Beyond Local Centres and Villages, the opportunity to achieve sustainable development is diminished by the increasing absence of services and facilities. It is however recognised that there is a further tier of generally small settlements, with and without services, which contribute to the overall sustainability of the rural area. Appropriately scaled and located development to meet locally generated housing needs will be supported in qualifying Rural Settlements (requiring the settlement to have at least one service or community facility from the following:- community/village hall, post office, public house, convenience shop, place of worship, sports playing field, primary school), as enabled by Policy DM24: Rural Settlements.

4.16 In the countryside, the Local Plan seeks to control dispersed development, guarding against development in unsustainable locations. The character of the countryside should be conserved and enhanced and new development will not detract from this. Within this context the Local Plan is responsive to a range of economic and social needs and it supports the appropriate reuse of rural buildings. Support is also provided for rural employment and farm and rural business diversification schemes. Housing, adjoining a Local Centre, Village or Rural Settlement, may also be enabled on an "exceptions" basis to meet an identified local need that could not otherwise be addressed.

Distribution Strategy

4.17 The development and distribution strategy will manage the delivery of development within the framework provided by the area's Vision and in accordance with the spatial development strategy provided by Policy ST06: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Main Centres and ST07: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Rural Area.

4.18 To maximise opportunities to achieve sustainable development and balanced growth the distribution strategy directs the majority of new development to northern Devon's Sub-regional Centre, Strategic Centre and Main Towns and provides for appropriately scaled and local need focused development in the rural area.

4.19 The Local Plan establishes a requirement for the delivery of a minimum of **17,220 dwellings** across northern Devon over the plan period along with the provision of a minimum of **84.9 hectares of land for economic development**, on the basis of providing balanced housing and economic strategies. About 87% of the planned housing requirement will be located in the districts' towns, with the growth focus at Barnstaple and Bideford. Together these towns will accommodate about 48 % of the overall planned housing requirement, supported by significant employment allocations, which account for about 55% of the planned employment land provision. The Main Centres (and Fremington/Yelland) will accommodate about 39% of the overall housing requirement and 52% of the planned employment provision. The Town and Rural Strategies (set out in chapters 10 and 13, respectively) provide settlement specific guidance as to the scale and location of planned growth. Development opportunities in the rural area account for about 13% of the planned housing provision over the period 2011-2031; development opportunities in relation to which are defined in Policy ST07: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Rural Area.

Policy ST08: Scale and Distribution of New Development in Northern Devon

(1) Development will be focused at the Sub-regional, Strategic and Main Centres to increase self-containment through sustainable growth that provides balanced housing markets within environmental limits and increases access to jobs, health, education, leisure, culture and community facilities.

(2) Planned provision for a minimum of 17,220 dwellings and 84.9 hectares of employment land, to be provided on the following basis during the period 2011 - 2031:

	Planned Housing Requirement (dwellings) 2011 - 2031	Planned Employment Land (hectares) 2011 - 2031
Barnstaple*	4,139	21.6
Bideford	4,127	20.4
Braunton/Wrafton	390	12
Fremington/Yelland*	426	0
Great Torrington	632	4
Holsworthy	670	7.1
Ilfracombe	1,429	5
Northam	1,916	0
South Molton	1,240	13.6

	Planned Housing Requirement (dwellings) 2011 - 2031	Planned Employment Land (hectares) 2011 - 2031
Local Centres**	1,123	0.9
Villages	1,024	0.3
Rural Settlements and Countryside	104	0
Area Total	17,220	84.9

* Barnstaple figures include an element of housing commitments from the adjacent parishes: Bickington and Roundswell parts of Fremington, Landkey, Pilton West and Tawstock. ** Excluding Fremington and Yelland.

4.20 The overall housing requirement set out in Policy ST08 applies to northern Devon, across the joint plan area and is not disaggregated to the individual constituent local planning authorities. Recognising the opportunity afforded by national planning practice guidance⁽³¹⁾, the Councils will monitor and appraise the five year housing land supply for the plan area on a collaborative basis. As such, the need to identify and maintain a five year supply of sites for housing will apply across the plan area, rather than being applicable to each individual constituent Local Planning Authority.

4.21 Recognising the need to provide a balanced housing and employment strategy, the housing requirement has been set to ensure the availability of an appropriate workforce to meet economic growth aspirations including the provision of 84.9 hectares of land for economic development.

4.22 The minimum housing requirement for northern Devon will require an average development rate of 861 dwellings per annum over the plan period. The Housing Trajectory for North Devon and Torridge (see Appendix 2) indicates the projected delivery of housing growth across the plan period⁽³²⁾.

4.23 The Local Plan sets out a housing supply of 20,189 dwellings for northern Devon over the plan period (Table 4.2), offering a potential level of housing delivery that is approximately 17% greater than the housing requirement. The level of supply provides for an increase in choice and competition within the housing market to help secure the delivery of the requirement of a minimum of 17,220 dwellings by the end of the plan period. Delivery during the first six years of the plan period is established through dwelling completions, amounting to 7,364 dwellings as of 31st March 2017. Subsequently, sites currently under construction and those with planning permission are anticipated to come forward and, as of 31st March 2017, there were commitments for 2,837 dwellings. The Local Plan allocates further sites with capacity to deliver 12,663 dwellings, with another 699 dwellings considered to have the potential to be delivered on non-strategic housing sites (see Appendix 5). Recognising that small unidentified brownfield sites have previously contributed to the housing supply, the Local Plan makes a modest windfall allowance from this source, based for the continuation of this trend and established on evidence of historic delivery; contributing a further 990 dwellings.

4.24 For the purpose of identifying and updating annually a supply of specific deliverable sites sufficient to provide five years' worth of housing against the housing requirements of the Local Plan, the "Liverpool method" of spreading the shortfall across the remainder of the plan period,

31 Paragraph: 010 Reference ID: 2a-010-20140306

32 Based on the Strategic Housing Land Availability Assessment and subsequent work with development interests to establish likely timetables for development delivery

shall be adopted. At the time of adoption of the Local Plan, the five year housing land supply shall include a buffer of 20% to reflect past under delivery of housing. The Liverpool method of spreading the delivery of the shortfall together with the 20% buffer shall apply to all reports published for the North Devon and Torridge Local Plan area until 1 April 2031 or until the Local Plan is first reviewed. In the event that the shortfall is delivered prior to the 1 April 2031 or to the review of the Local Plan, a buffer of 5% shall be applied to the five year housing land requirement.

4.25 The five year requirement for housing at the annualised rate of 861 dwellings would be 4,305 dwellings. At 31 March 2017 the unmet requirement for housing was 1,708 dwellings. If this is averaged to be delivered over the remainder of the plan period, an additional 122 dwellings are required each year. This results in a five year requirement of 4,915 dwellings. With a 20% buffer to provide for past under delivery, the requirement for the five year housing land supply at 1st April 2017 is for 5,898 dwellings.

4.26 Table 4.1 'Five year supply of deliverable housing sites at 1st April 2017' sets out the identified supply of specific deliverable sites for northern Devon as of 1st April 2017; which will be updated annually through the preparation of the Authorities Monitoring Reports.

Table 4.1 Five year supply of deliverable housing sites at 1st April 2017

Source	Dwellings
Allocations	4,235
Non-strategic housing sites	322
Housing commitments (excluding small unimplemented) ⁽¹⁾	2,207
Small unimplemented housing commitments ⁽²⁾	420
Windfall development	180
Total deliverable supply	7,364

(1) Estimated dwelling yield from sites which are subject to planning permission or with a resolution to grant consent subject to signing of a s106 agreement as of 31st March 2017, whilst excluding such yield which results from: (1) sites with unimplemented planning commitments that are less than 0.1 hectares or providing fewer than five dwellings; and (2) allocated and non-strategic housing sites. (2) Estimated dwelling yield (subject to a 15% non-implementation allowance) from sites smaller than 0.1 hectares or providing for fewer than five dwellings, which are subject to an unimplemented planning permission or with a resolution to grant consent subject to signing of a s106 agreement as of 31st March 2017, whilst excluding such yield which result from allocated or non-strategic housing sites.

4.27 Proposals for residential development which would comply with the relevant policies of the Local Plan when taken as a whole, and unless material considerations indicate otherwise, will continue to receive support from the Councils in the determination of planning applications, irrespective of whether a supply of specific deliverable sites, sufficient to provide five years' worth of housing against the requirements of the Local Plan, can be demonstrated.

4.28 To ensure a maintained land supply and to provide for development choice, the Local Plan adopts a flexible approach to land release. Additionally, the potential dwelling capacity of sites has been calculated on the basis of a conservative estimate, in accordance with the assumptions agreed through the Strategic Housing Land Availability Assessment and a generous 15% non-implementation allowance has been applied to small sites that contribute to the land supply through unimplemented consents.

4.29 The Local Plan does not identify a programme of land release, with no phasing applied to the release of allocated sites; rather the nature and scale of committed and allocated sites provides that there will be a gradual delivery of new dwellings across the plan period. Strategic urban extensions are allocated and such will be developed in a comprehensive manner.

Table 4.2 Housing Land Supply 2011-2031

	Dwelling Completions 2011 - 2017 ⁽¹⁾	Planning Commitments ⁽²⁾	Non-strategic Housing Sites ⁽³⁾	Allocations ⁽⁴⁾	Total Identified Supply
Barnstaple*	375	473	153	3,162	4,163
Bideford	766	322	226	2,815	4,129
Braunton/Wrafton	83	69	0	420	572
Fremington/Yelland*	63	259	0	527	849
Great Torrington	104	67	0	513	684
Holsworthy	254	66	0	415	735
Ilfracombe	196	202	71	935	1,404
Northam	143	140	92	1,735	2,110
South Molton	177	145	51	949	1,322
Local Centres**	281	342	76	614	1,313
Villages	230	318	30	578	1,156
Rural Settlements and Countryside	328	434	0	0	762
Windfall Estimate					990
Northern Devon	3,000	2,837	699	12,663	20,189

Note that figures may not sum due to rounding. (1) Dwelling completions over the period 1st April 2011 to 31st March 2017, excluding those built on allocated sites. (2) Estimated dwelling yield from sites under construction, sites with planning permission subject to implementation, unimplemented sites (with small sites subject to a 15% non-implementation discount) and sites with a resolution to grant consent subject to signing of a s106 agreement as of 31st March 2017 whilst excluding planning commitments on allocations. (3) Estimated dwelling yield from non-strategic housing sites which are identified as developable through the Strategic Housing Land Availability Assessment, not subject to site specific allocations, not a commitment as of 31st March 2017 and situated within settlement development boundaries (see Appendix 5). (4) Estimated dwelling yield from sites subject to Local Plan allocations, including the yield arising from planning commitments and dwelling completions on them as at 31st March 2017. * Barnstaple figures include an element of housing commitments found in the adjacent parishes: Bickington and Roundswell parts of Fremington, Landkey, Pilton West and Tawstock. ** Excluding Fremington and Yelland.

4.30 The approximate distribution of dwellings over the plan period, taking account of current commitments and allocations, is indicated in Policy ST08: Scale and Distribution of New Development in Northern Devon and detailed in Table 4.2. The distribution takes account of the following factors and is considered to provide a sustainable overall strategy:

- (a) town visions – the spatial vision for each settlement, reflecting future town specific roles, community aspirations and preferred directions and rates of growth;
- (b) rural areas – the accommodation of rural needs at the point of generation where delivery can be achieved to make communities more sustainable;
- (c) infrastructure delivery – existing infrastructure capacities both physical and social and the potential for growth to deliver infrastructure improvements;

(d) growth aspirations for each settlement – the potential to deliver growth beyond existing needs through positive intervention, facilitating regeneration, housing and economic growth to achieve a town's vision;

(e) employment opportunities – to achieve and support balanced development, allowing people to live and work in the same place; increasing employment opportunities in sustainable locations to accommodate economic growth, ensuring market attraction to the location of employment opportunities; and

(f) availability of developable land – the Strategic Housing Land Availability Assessment indicates potential levels of development land that could accommodate residential growth, taking into account environmental constraints and site availability.

4.31 To meet the settlement housing targets set in Policy ST08: Scale and Distribution of New Development in Northern Devon, site allocations are provided at Policy ST06: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Main Centres, defined settlements and at many Local Centres and Villages in the rural area. The allocations have been tested for deliverability and are subject to site specific policies. With respect to the non-strategic housing sites (see Appendix 5), development proposals will be considered having regard to all relevant Local Plan policies and will be expected to contribute to the delivery of the relevant settlement's spatial vision and development strategy. The Councils will work with landowners and developers to bring sites forward over the lifetime of the plan.

4.32 The Local Plan seeks to ensure the development of a business environment that delivers a strong economy, quality well paid jobs and good training opportunities. The approach is based on the need to sustain and enhance the District's economic performance to make northern Devon an attractive prospect for business expansion and inward investment.

4.33 The Housing and Economic Needs Assessment (HEDNA) identifies that it would be appropriate to plan for the delivery of 72-81 hectares of land for economic development across northern Devon over the plan period. A sufficient supply of suitable employment land is fundamental to the promotion of successful business and in helping to secure the delivery of economic development and regeneration. The Local Plan therefore identifies provision for 84.9 hectares of employment land, which exceeds the minimum assessed requirement by approximately 18%. The increased level of provision is made in response to locally determined priorities and is matched by balanced housing growth. It is recognised that many types of employment in northern Devon do not place a demand on traditional employment sites, on which basis the Local Plan adopts a flexible approach that can support appropriately located employment generating businesses.

4.34 Barnstaple and Bideford will continue to provide a focus for new economic growth in northern Devon, within which over half of new site allocations are located. Significant employment led growth is also planned at Holsworthy and South Molton. In other towns and villages, employment provision will mostly be geared to serving local needs. Employment provision is made with the expectation that larger scale housing sites will be matched by new jobs.

4.35 Policy ST08: Scale and Distribution of New Development in Northern Devon, sets out a distribution strategy, indicating the level of development supply for each settlement. The distribution is based on a number of factors:

(a) the Employment Land Review assessed market demand and the indicated employment activity focus at Barnstaple, Bideford and South Molton;

(b) the need to rebalance local communities, providing for a range of opportunities across the District areas, avoiding an increasingly commuter based workforce and providing new employment with significant new housing development;

(c) community identified aspirations to achieve growth based on increasing employment opportunities and enhanced economic performance; and

(d) infrastructure and environmental constraints that would guide the location of suitable new site allocations.

4.36 The Local Plan makes limited specific provision for employment development in Local Centres and Villages. Appropriately located and scaled proposals will be supported which can be generated through diversification, expansion or new business development in the interest of enhanced rural prosperity and making rural settlements more sustainable.

Coast and Estuary Strategy

Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy

The Coastal and Estuarine Zone is identified on the Policies Map where:

(1) The sustainability of coastal communities will be maintained and enhanced with regard to their distinctive cultural heritage, diverse maritime economy, landscape setting and regeneration opportunities. The separate identity of these settlements will be maintained and enhanced.

(2) Priority will be given to employment uses and waterside infrastructure requiring a coastal location. Such uses will be directed to previously developed sites around the coastline and the Taw-Torridge estuary with existing jetties and wharves. These sites should be safeguarded for employment uses requiring a waterside location. Facilities at Appledore and Yelland Quay will be protected for their value as landing stages for marine aggregates and for other marine employment uses. Loss of traditional boating facilities that are part of the fabric of coastal communities will be discouraged.

(3) Proposals for tourism attractions, leisure developments, new tourist accommodation, associated tourism facilities and services of an appropriate scale will be supported within the Developed Coast where they enhance the quality or diversity of the local tourism offer and will not detract from the character of protected landscapes and other environmental assets.

(4) Settlements and resorts will be defended against marine inundation, coastal erosion and tidal flooding without transferring risks elsewhere. Opportunities to manage coastal realignment and re-establish functional flood plains will be supported in accordance with the Shoreline Management Plan.

(5) The integrity of the coast and estuary as an important wildlife corridor will be protected and enhanced. The importance of the undeveloped coastal, estuarine and marine environments, including the North Devon Coast Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty, will be recognised through supporting designations, plans and policies. The undeveloped character of the Heritage Coasts will be protected.

(6) Water quality will be improved where it has been affected by human activity.

(7) Development within the Undeveloped Coast and estuary will be supported where it does not detract from the unspoilt character, appearance and tranquillity of the area,

nor the undeveloped character of the Heritage Coasts, and it is required because it cannot reasonably be located outside the Undeveloped Coast and estuary.

(8) The role and operation of Bideford and Ilfracombe as commercial and leisure ports / harbours will be maintained and enhanced. Proposals to diversify Ilfracombe's role as a ferry port to South Wales and beyond will be supported. The development of port facilities to maintain and improve the competitiveness of the fishing industry at Bideford, Appledore, Clovelly and Ilfracombe and to enhance leisure opportunities in appropriate coastal locations where required to meet community needs will be supported.

(9) Military training and operational uses around the Taw-Torridge estuary will be supported in locations associated with established military activity.

(10) Delivery of onshore facilities for operational servicing of offshore renewable energy proposals will be facilitated in existing ports and at existing jetties and wharves where they:

(a) do not harm identified environmental and heritage assets; and

(b) do not prejudice the current operational effectiveness of the port.

(11) The continuity of the South West Coast Path and the Tarka Trail will be protected and a network of connecting routes will be improved. Improvements to coastal and estuarine access will be sought where rundown waterfront areas are regenerated. The Tarka Trail link between Ilfracombe and Braunton will be completed.

4.37 Approximately 65% of northern Devon's population live in the areas around the Taw-Torridge estuary and in coastal settlements. These areas experience many competing land uses and significant development pressures alongside a combination of environmental designations. The spatial strategy for northern Devon's coast and estuary is shown in Figure 4.2 'Spatial Strategy for the Coast and Estuary'. Numerous strategies, management plans and policies aim to reconcile these conflicting pressures to preserve and enhance northern Devon's coastline and estuary. The importance of the UNESCO Biosphere Reserve Strategy, North Devon Coast Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty Management Plan, Taw-Torridge Estuary Management Plan, Shoreline Management Plan, Taw-Torridge Coastal Management Study and any successor documents will be recognised.

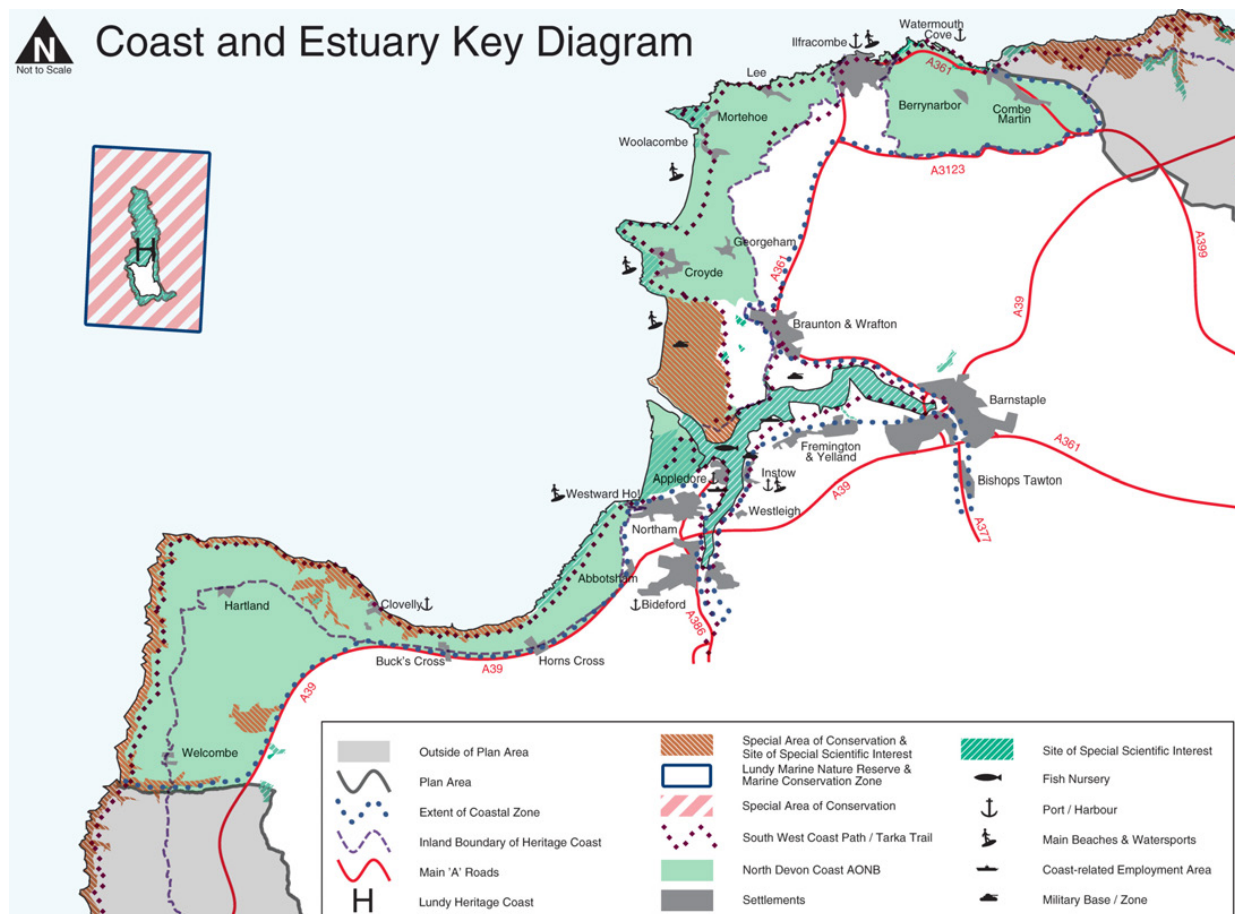
4.38 The Marine Management Organisation (MMO) is responsible for delivering clean, healthy, safe, productive and biologically diverse seas, which includes through consenting projects, marine licensing in relation to offshore activity and preparing Marine Plans. Policy guidance offshore is provided by the Marine Policy Statement prior to a Marine Plan for the South West being prepared.

4.39 Northern Devon's unspoilt coastline is a popular tourist attraction that contributes significantly to the area's environmental quality and identity. This nationally important landscape is partly designated as North Devon Coast Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty and as two separate Heritage Coasts covering northern Devon and Lundy Island. Much of the coastline, including Lundy Island and surrounding coastal waters is also designated as Special Areas of Conservation and Sites of Special Scientific Interest. The distinctive environment and cultural heritage of the coastal zone, including seascapes, will be protected and enhanced (Policies ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets and ST15: Conserving Heritage Assets). The key characteristics and extent of seascape character areas are defined through the North Devon and Exmoor Seascape Character Assessment⁽³³⁾. The undeveloped parts of this coastal zone are a finite

33 North Devon and Exmoor Seascape Character Assessment (Land Use Consultants, November 2015)

resource and their unspoilt character, appearance and tranquillity will be protected against development not related to the coast or not providing benefits for the local community. Within the Coastal and Estuarine Zone, the Developed Coast is limited to the extent of defined settlements, the edge of Rural Settlements, Defence Estates sites and large previously developed sites such as Ashford and Cornborough sewage treatment works. Sites or those parts of a site developed with permanently sited static caravans and/or other tourism related facilities form part of the Developed Coast, whereas seasonal caravan and/or camping sites or those parts of sites without a significant level of permanent structures form part of the Undeveloped Coast.

Figure 4.2 Spatial Strategy for the Coast and Estuary



4.40 North Devon's Biosphere Reserve is the first new style Biosphere Reserve to be designated in the UK. The Core Area is managed primarily for conservation of biodiversity and is defined by the Special Area of Conservation that comprises Braunton Burrows and part of the Taw-Torridge estuary. The Buffer Zone comprises the remainder of the Taw-Torridge estuary, Braunton Marsh and Great Field, and a large section of the AONB from Westward Ho! to Croyde. Land management in the Buffer Zone is promoted to be sympathetic to support the ecological value of the Core Area whereby local people can derive social and economic benefits from the ecosystem including through appropriate agriculture, recreation and tourism.

4.41 The seas around Lundy form the United Kingdom's first Marine Nature Reserve and its first Marine Conservation Zone. Further Marine Conservation Zones off northern Devon have been designated and are shown on the Policies Map. Lundy Marine Conservation Zone is encompassed within the Bristol Channel approaches candidate Special Area of Conservation to protect harbour porpoises. A Voluntary Marine Conservation Area exists from Croyde to Hangman Point in Exmoor National Park. The three 'prime biodiversity areas' identified in Natural England's maritime natural area profile for the coast between Land's End and Minehead are all situated wholly or partly in northern Devon.

4.42 Climate change and sea level rise are a significant issue for coastal areas. The Shoreline Management Plan Review from Hartland Point to Anchor Point (in Somerset) is being reviewed but has not yet been adopted. The developed and undeveloped coastal, estuarine and marine environments within northern Devon will be protected, whilst minimising risks from flooding.

4.43 Commercial fishing forms a traditional part of northern Devon's economy, with fish landed at Bideford, Ilfracombe, Appledore and Clovelly before being transported to local fish markets or retained for local shops and restaurants. Proposals to improve port-side facilities for fishing and to develop supply chains for locally landed fish are supported. The estuary is an important sea bass nursery. Mussels and oysters are farmed in parts of the Taw-Torridge estuary and a shellfish depuration plant operates at Fremington. Improving water quality in the Taw-Torridge estuary and offshore is important to support these local industries and to prevent harm to important fish and shellfish stocks, as well as supporting local tourism. Measures to improve water quality around northern Devon's beaches and in the estuary will be supported, including through changes to land management practices and the application of appropriate ecosystem services. The Taw River Improvement Project ⁽³⁴⁾ and Torridge River Nature Improvement Area ⁽³⁵⁾ will both help to improve water quality and water resource management.

4.44 Bideford and Ilfracombe are the main ports / harbours in northern Devon, both operating regular ferry links serving Lundy Island. Bideford is the mainland port serving the island. Future opportunities will be supported to provide pedestrian ferry links from Ilfracombe to South Wales and links to destinations beyond. Port infrastructure required at Bideford and Ilfracombe harbours will be supported to facilitate existing and future ferry links, operational and maintenance links to any future offshore renewable energy generation, and commercial fishing activities. Boat building will be supported and enhanced at Appledore docks where it is economically important. Proposals to safeguard the main ports from rising sea levels to facilitate their continued use as operational ports will be considered against Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience.

4.45 Ports represent an important entrance to northern Devon where sustainable transport links will be supported to facilitate visitor management for improved access to the rest of Bideford and Ilfracombe, as well as the wider countryside along the northern Devon coast including Exmoor National Park. Links to and along the South West Coast Path and Tarka Trail are particularly important.

4.46 In addition to the main ports, harbours at Clovelly, Watermouth and within the Taw-Torridge estuary provide shelter and moorings for pleasure boats. New facilities to provide opportunities for water sports, including leisure and tourism boating, at ports and harbours will be supported. Construction of a Northern Breakwater at Ilfracombe harbour would facilitate a new marina and bring significant economic benefits to the town and across northern Devon, and would provide an important contribution towards the town's regeneration through growth.

4.47 The main beaches are a focus for recreation opportunities for both tourists and the resident population. Surfing is popular on the larger sandy beaches and water sports are important to the local economy of many coastal settlements. Also within the coastal zone there are several golf courses that provide popular recreational activities. Opportunities for water sports and other outdoor recreational activities, including ancillary facilities, will be supported where the unspoilt character of the undeveloped coast is not harmed.

4.48 The South West Coast Path provides access for walkers along the whole of the northern Devon coastline. It connects to the Tarka Trail providing pedestrian and cycle links inland and around the Taw-Torridge estuary. The Tarka Trail is incomplete between Knowle and Willingcott

34 <http://www.northdevonbiosphere.org.uk/taw-river-improvement-project-2/>

35 <http://www.northdevonbiosphere.org.uk/nature-improvement-area-2/>

and should be completed to improve network linkages and recreational opportunities. A new link between Bideford and Westward Ho! through the Kenwith Valley should be pursued for similar reasons. The continuity of the Coast Path and Tarka Trail will need to be protected from rising sea levels.

4.49 Onshore facilities and operations required to maintain and service large-scale offshore renewable energy proposals will be supported within an existing port, where the port's existing operations and responsibilities are not compromised. The South West is identified as the UK's first Marine Energy Park to speed up the progress of marine technology development. Northern Devon seeks to become a hub for the manufacture, delivery and maintenance of renewable energy technologies. Impact and proposed mitigation on environmental and heritage assets from landfall for cables from offshore renewable energy generation will need to be balanced against potential social, environmental and economic benefits, recognising the national and/or international importance of some environmental assets.

4.50 Some employment uses and infrastructure provision require a waterside location for access to the sea, for water supply or to enable goods or materials to be loaded or unloaded for transportation by sea. Such uses will be directed to the limited number of previously developed sites and existing jetty and wharf facilities situated around the coastline and the Taw-Torridge estuary. Such sites will be safeguarded in accordance with Policy DM13: Safeguarding Employment Land unless subject to site specific policy provisions, such as Policy FRE02: Yelland Quay.

4.51 Existing operational MOD sites around the Taw-Torridge estuary provide a valued contribution to the local community and economy. Military sites will be safeguarded for military use on the basis of MOD operational needs. It is recognised that the long term military use of the Royal Marines barracks at Chivenor is uncertain. The site could be retained within its current use, utilised by other defence units or be released for alternative uses. If the site is determined to be surplus to MOD requirements, its future use will be addressed through a Local Plan review or a Neighbourhood Plan. Braunton Burrows also has an established use by the military for training purposes.

4.52 The main coastal resorts within northern Devon are at Ilfracombe, Westward Ho!, Woolacombe, Combe Martin, and Instow. Other towns and villages within the coastal area and around the Taw-Torridge estuary also contribute to local tourism as visitor destinations in their own right and in offering a range of local services and facilities, such as shops, restaurants and accommodation. The special character of protected landscapes will be protected (Policy ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets). Arts and festivals are also important to the culture and economy of coastal communities.

4.53 There are pressures for new tourist accommodation, including caravan and camping sites. New tourist accommodation should help to improve the quality and range of accommodation types available. The most sustainable location for them is within the main coastal resorts and other towns and villages where key services and facilities are available, in order to reduce the need to travel by car. Within other coastal villages, new tourist accommodation and improvements to existing tourism facilities can enhance the local economy where it is of an appropriate scale and conserves the protected landscape and identified environmentally assets. Protected landscapes include the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty and the Heritage Coasts. Existing buildings should be reused wherever possible. Tourism accommodation, which does not utilise existing buildings, should be located outside the Undeveloped Coast. Desire for proximity to the coast and estuary is inadequate justification for new tourism accommodation being located in the Undeveloped Coast.

Transport Strategy

Policy ST10: Transport Strategy

The Transport Strategy for northern Devon will:

(1) Provide good strategic connectivity by:

- (a) ensuring the operational effectiveness of the strategic road network (A361 and A30) and other strategic routes including the A39, linking the area to the national road network (M5 and A30) and to Exeter, Plymouth and Cornwall;
- (b) maintaining the function of the wider strategic road network serving northern Devon;
- (c) improving journey times and service quality on the Barnstaple-Exeter rail line linking northern Devon to Exeter and the wider rail network;
- (d) improving the strategic routes towards Ilfracombe along the A399 from Aller Cross and the B3230 from Barnstaple;
- (e) maintaining the function of Bideford as a commercial port and developing enhanced harbour facilities, including at Ilfracombe to support any future ferry service and operational hub for any future off-shore renewable energy schemes;
- (f) safeguarding routes and exploring opportunities for the reuse and reinstatement of former railway lines;
- (g) maintaining and enhancing the function and connectivity of the public rights of way network within northern Devon including the completion of the gap in the Tarka Trail between Willingcott and Knowle; and
- (h) locating freight generating development and local freight handling facilities close to the strategic road / rail network or Bideford port.

(2) Meet the needs of local communities and visitors to the area by:

- (a) providing transport infrastructure that facilitates the delivery of proposed strategic extensions for housing and employment development and facilitates economic regeneration;
- (b) developing quality public and community transport networks (and supporting infrastructure) within and between Barnstaple and Bideford and the networks linking these centres to northern Devon's main towns and rural communities where viable;
- (c) improving overall accessibility of northern Devon by providing a wide range of integrated practical and attractive travel options and improving interchanges for transfer between modes of travel;
- (d) developing quality strategic recreational routes and local pedestrian, cycle and bridleway networks and further integration and enhancement of the public rights of way network;
- (e) protecting and enhancing the function and safety of the road network; and

(f) recognising transport impacts from the seasonal nature of traffic in northern Devon.

(3) Reduce the environmental and social impacts of transport by:

(a) reducing the need to travel by car and enabling alternative sustainable travel options as supported by the Local Transport Plan;

(b) improving transport connectivity between rural communities and the main towns where viable;

(c) requiring a Transport Assessment or a Transport Statement and a Travel Plan for developments that generate significant traffic movements;

(d) actively managing car parking provision through type, capacity and charging to influence demand patterns;

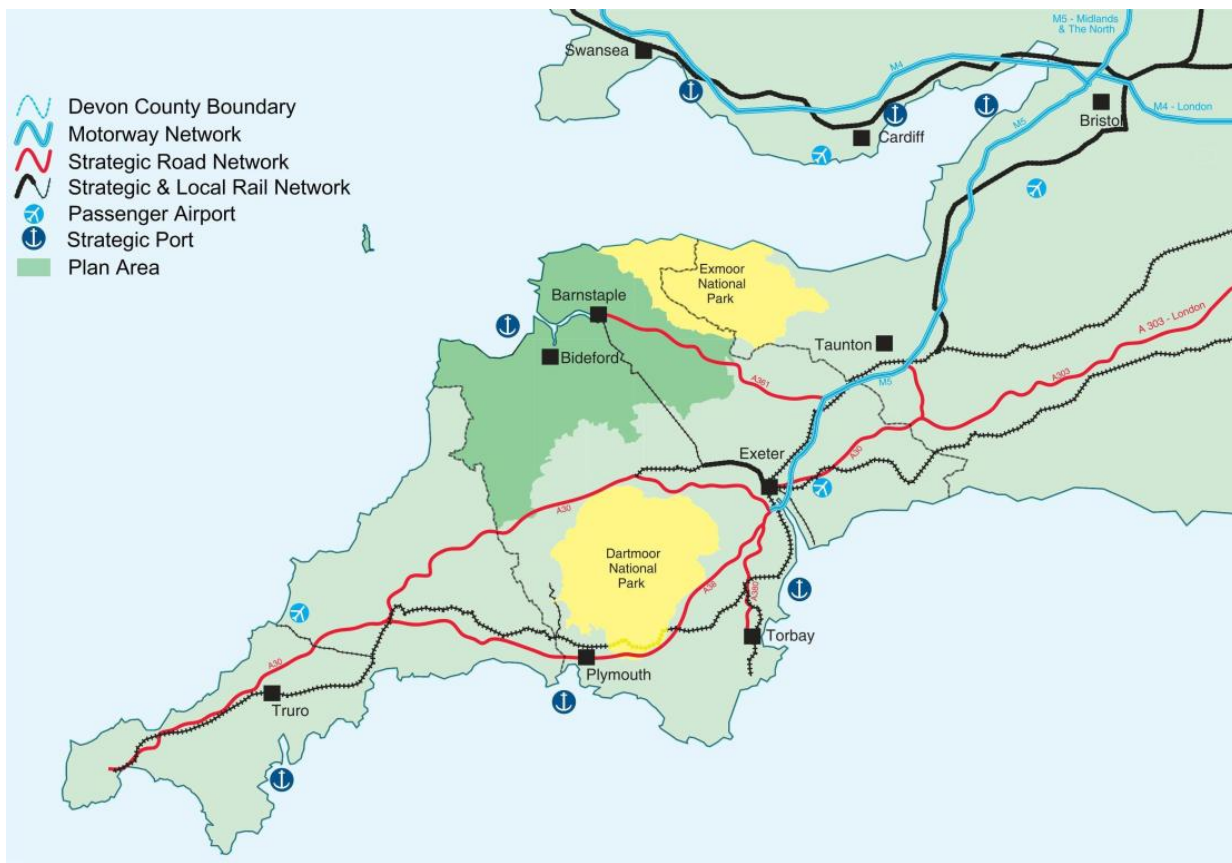
(e) developing traffic management schemes in the main towns;

(f) maximising safety on transport networks through improvements to physical infrastructure design whilst conserving historic environment assets;

(g) ensuring that access to new development is safe and appropriate; and

(h) protecting the landscape character and ecological interest along the main and minor route(s).

Figure 4.3 Strategic transport links for the South West



4.55 The A361 and A39 function as the main route between the M5 and northern Devon for tourists, visitors and business trips, as well as for long distance freight movements. Some of the key junctions on this strategic road network are busy at peak times. Development adjoining the A361 and A39 must not prejudice opportunities for future road and junction improvements. Other routes which are locally strategic are shown in Figure 4.4 including the A377, A386, A388, A399, A3123 and A3124, which provide important links to and from the strategic road network and towards Exeter, Plymouth, Bristol and Cornwall.

4.56 Locally important improvements to the B3230 corridor between Barnstaple and Ilfracombe, and along the A399 from the A361 at Aller Cross towards Ilfracombe and the north coast, form part of the strategy to alleviate traffic congestion and improve air quality as set out in the Braunton and Wrafton Spatial Strategy. Improvements to upgrade the existing Lynton Cross and Two Potts junctions on the B3230 will be supported.

Figure 4.4 Road links of strategic importance for northern Devon



4.57 The Barnstaple-Exeter corridor is of sub-regional importance as a link for business, services, retail and cultural activities. Demand management measures will improve the reliability and resilience of journey times along the A361, A377 and the Tarka Line between Barnstaple and Exeter, including reducing the risks of flooding along the railway line and A377. Opportunities will be developed to reduce congestion by improving local transport networks and promoting realistic alternatives to car travel. Such measures will be co-ordinated through the Devon Local Transport Plan.

4.58 In order to address transport and accessibility issues, the Local Plan aims to reduce the need to travel in northern Devon and to promote sustainable transport choices such as cycling, walking, public and community transport (bus, train and ferry) to ensure good accessibility to services and community facilities.

4.59 The transport strategy supports the sustainability principles set out in the sustainable development strategies within Policies ST02: Mitigating Climate Change, ST06: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Main Centres and ST08: Scale and Distribution of New Development in northern Devon. It recognises the potential of sustainable transport at Barnstaple, and Bideford and Northam by maintaining and enhancing the accessibility of other towns and settlements to the communities they serve and by facilitating economic investment that will reduce rural isolation.

4.60 For sustainable patterns of development to be pursued it is vital that spatial and transport planning are closely linked. Towards achieving this, North Devon and Torridge Councils will continue to work with Devon County Council as the Local Highway Authority and with the Highways Agency as necessary to ensure there is a close relationship between the Local Plan and the Local Transport Plan.

4.61 A Transport Assessment and a Travel Plan must accompany major development proposals that generate significant movements of traffic. Other developments will be expected to submit a Transport Assessment along with a Travel Plan where it is considered the development is likely to create or exacerbate a particular traffic problem or have an impact on the local highway network. Where it is agreed that the transport issues arising from the development are limited, a Transport Statement and a Travel Plan will be required. These documents will assess the development's travel and transport consequences and sustainability implications and as a commitment by the developer to introduce measures that will encourage future residents, staff and customers to use alternative means of travel in accordance with agreed targets. It should be carried out to the satisfaction of the local highway authority in accordance with agreed 'scoping' to establish the requirement of the assessment. The level of detail within a Transport Assessment should be proportionate to the scale of travel and transport impacts.

4.62 A key driver in the development of the spatial strategy for northern Devon is to ensure an increased proportion of the area's population has a range of transport choices to access education, retail, services, green infrastructure, leisure and employment opportunities. In addition to guiding high intensity uses to accessible locations, the consequential impacts from development must be minimised and realistic alternatives to car travel provided through development. Sustainable travel measures will contribute to reducing current air quality problems at Barnstaple and Braunton and minimising the air quality consequences of accommodating necessary growth.

4.63 Bideford and Ilfracombe are the main ports / harbours in northern Devon, both serving Lundy island. The role of these ports as entrances to northern Devon will be maintained and enhanced. Opportunities to provide new ferry links to South Wales and beyond, as well as appropriate infrastructure to facilitate an operational hub for any future off shore renewable energy schemes, will be supported.

4.64 Enhanced connectivity and integration by different modes of transport is an essential element of increasing prosperity and the attraction of northern Devon to investors and visitors to the area. It allows residents to conduct their business and day-to-day activities without hindrance and delay from an inefficient and unintegrated transport network. Improved connectivity extends beyond the capacity provided by the road network. North Devon and Torridge Councils will seek continuing improvement of and connections to road, rail and sea routes for commercial and social gains.

4.65 In addition to external connectivity, enhanced internal linkages and improved transport infrastructure capacity will be required over the plan period, the focus of which will be at the principal growth areas of Barnstaple, Bideford and Northam. As necessary, traffic management measures will be applied and improved transport infrastructure secured to accommodate the generated demands of new development through partnership working with Devon County Council as the Local Highway Authority, North Devon and Torridge District Councils and local communities. Proposed improvements to the North Devon Link Road (A39/A361) would provide additional network capacity, with land adjoining the link road and key junctions being safeguarded to facilitate future delivery of these improvements. In addition to enhanced network capacity, increasing opportunities must be provided in respect of alternative transport choice recognising the seasonal peaks in traffic movements.

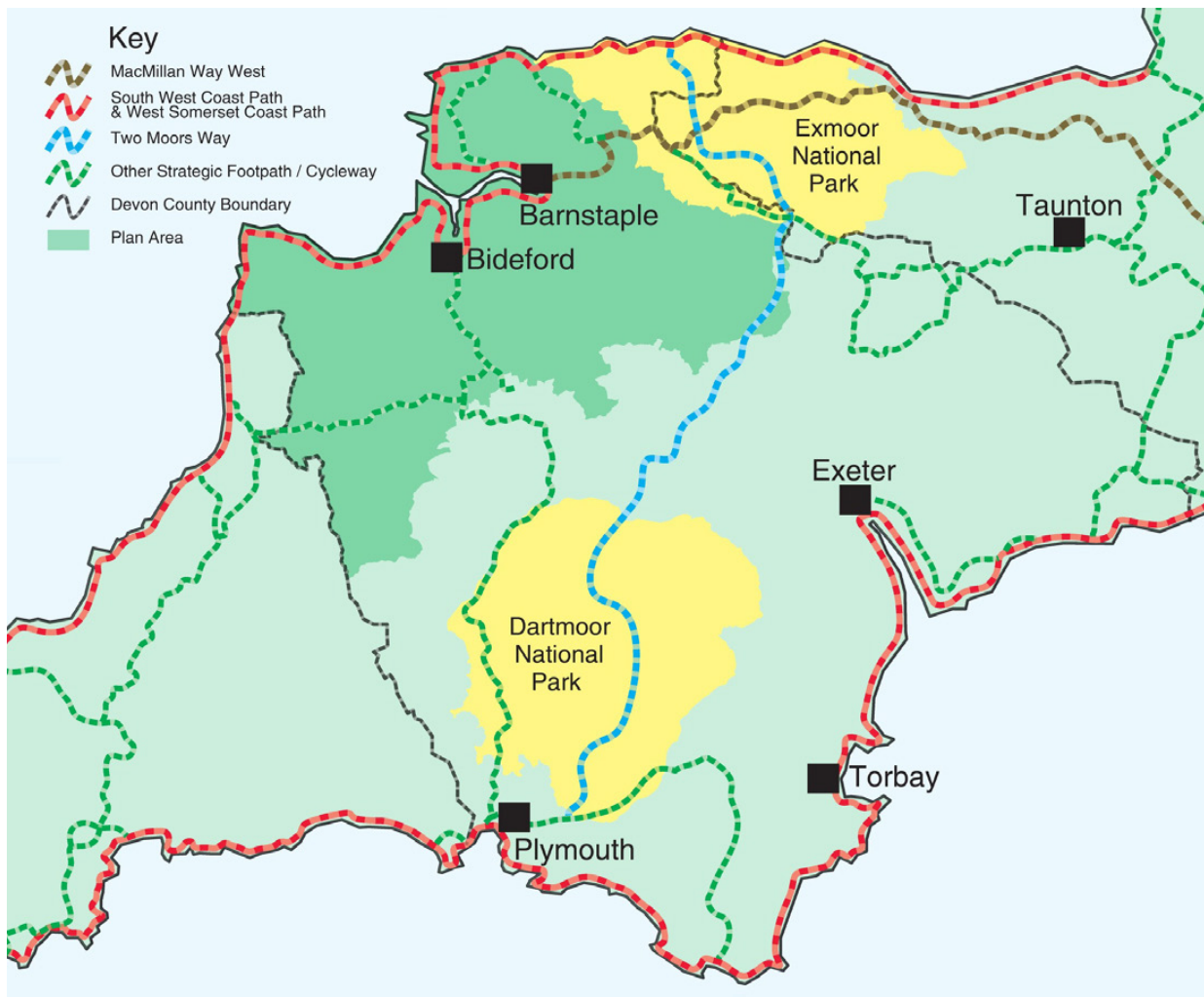
4.66 The reinstatement of the former railway line between Lynton and Barnstaple (Policy BAR16: Lynton and Barnstaple Railway) will be supported to deliver economic regeneration, tourism and sustainable travel objectives. Reinstatement of other former railway lines will also be explored towards the objective of reducing the need to travel by car although any future re-instatement must include suitable provision of an alternative walking and cycling route where existing provision will be displaced. Reinstatement of former railway lines to expand the network of strategic footpaths and cycleways will also be supported. There is a statutory responsibility to consult Network Rail for any new level crossings as a result of new or reinstated railway lines ⁽³⁶⁾.

4.67 Proposals should maximise the potential for walking, cycling and horse riding, integrating with existing footpaths, cycleways, bridleways and other green infrastructure networks to provide safe and sustainable communities as well as increasing the accessibility of the development. Strategic recreational routes in northern Devon are shown in Figure 4.5, including the South West Coast Path, the Tarka Trail, the Two Moors Way and the National Cycle Network. Recreational routes should facilitate shared use and differing mobility needs, with opportunities for enhancement and improved connectivity to these routes being supported.

4.68 The integrity and connectivity of the Coast Path and Tarka Trail will be protected from rising sea levels. The current use and popularity of the Tarka Trail is recognised and will be safeguarded. The gap in the Tarka Trail between Willingcott and Knowle should be filled to complete this strategic footpath/cycle route. The Devon and Torbay Local Transport Plan proposes a new strategic recreational route between Barnstaple, South Molton and Tiverton (in Mid Devon District), the establishment of which within North Devon District will be supported. A new trail will be supported on the route of former Bideford to Appledore Railway between the Kenwith Valley and Westward Ho! (Policy BID08: Former Bideford to Appledore Railway). A route connecting Budds Titson in the west, through Holsworthy and east towards Hatherleigh will be safeguarded for a trail. Support will be offered to proposals that seek to deliver new or enhanced access along and to the safeguarded route as identified on the Policies Map (Policy HOL08: Safeguarded Pedestrian and Cycle Route).

36 Town & Country Planning (Development Management Procedure) Order, 2010

Figure 4.5 Strategic Recreational Routes in northern Devon



4.69 In the rural areas, limited public transport services, low population density and a dispersed settlement pattern dictates that car usage will continue to be a very important means of accessing many services and will be the only option in many circumstances. The strategy for rural areas (Policy ST07: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Rural Areas) is that appropriate levels of development will make rural communities more sustainable. Facilitating the self-sufficiency of the rural areas and improving public and community transport networks will contribute to reducing the use of the private car, but car dependency will not disappear.



ENABLING A VIBRANT ECONOMY



5 Enabling a Vibrant Economy

5.1 The vision for the northern Devon economy is:

A diverse and resilient economy that can adapt to challenges and maximise opportunities, underpinned by an appropriately skilled workforce and effective infrastructure.

5.2 The strategic objectives to deliver this vision and strengthen northern Devon's economy are set out in chapter two of the Local Plan. The economy will be rejuvenated in both urban and rural areas through delivery of improved skill levels, enhanced infrastructure and opportunities for sustainable growth in key sectors. The overall aim of northern Devon's Economic Strategy is to enable economic growth and job creation, based on the area's strengths and unique assets. Northern Devon's economy is underpinned by its high quality environment and quality of life, within a productive living landscape that can adapt to and support the area's changing needs. Inward investment, tourism and economic growth can potentially provide funding to help deliver specific environmental enhancements.

5.3 The Local Plan seeks to ensure the development of a business environment focused on a strong and broadly based economy that is supported by well paid jobs achieved through an improved skills base that is reflective and responsive to business needs. The strategy is based on the need to enhance the economic performance of northern Devon to make the area an attractive prospect for business expansion and inward investment that can support increasingly sustainable communities.

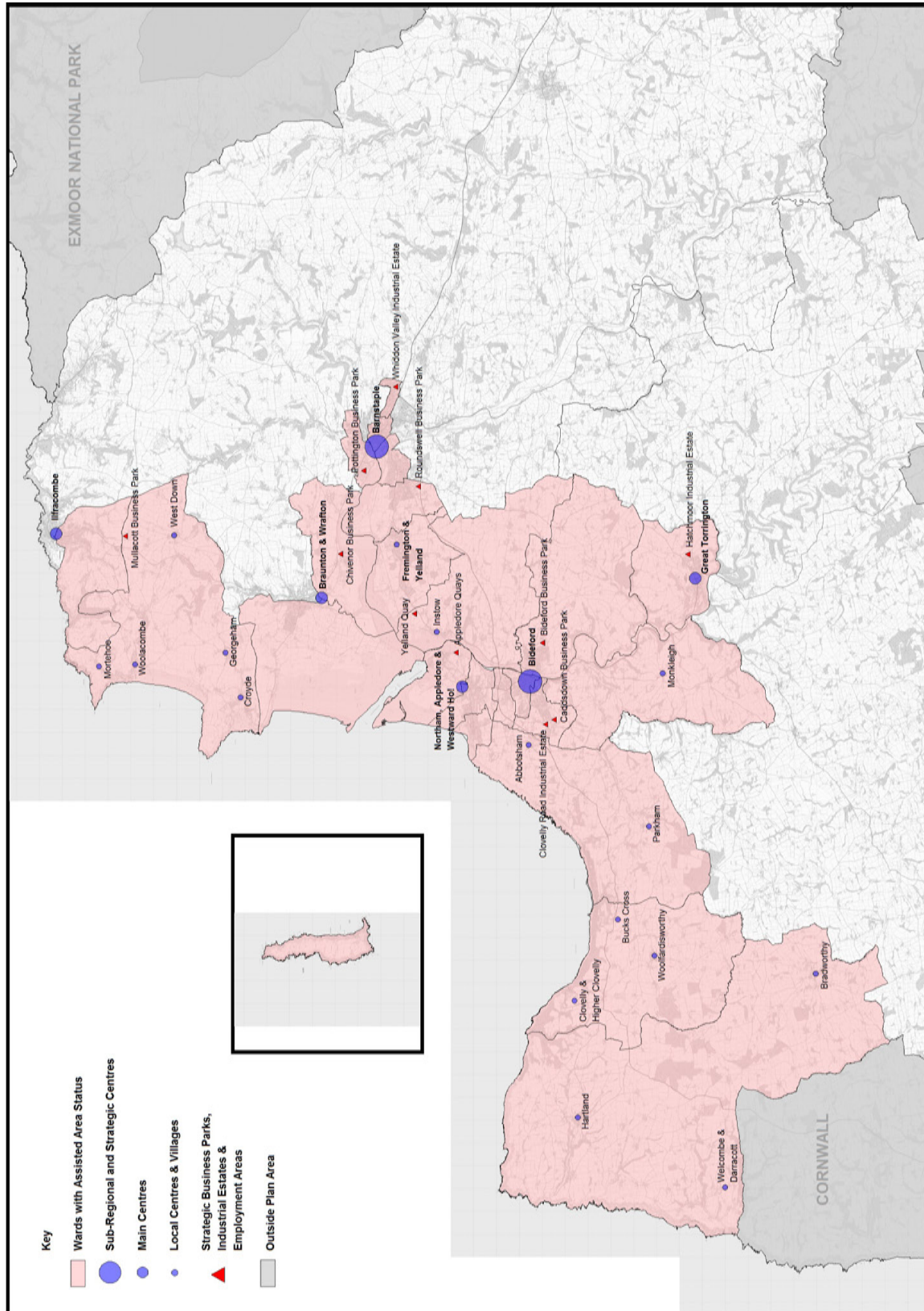
5.4 With the drive to improve the economic performance of northern Devon it is recognised that such will be achieved within environmental limits. The environment is a valued asset that is vital to maintain and the impact of growth and regeneration must be appropriately managed if this resource is to be sustained.

Delivering Employment and Economic Development

5.5 The Councils aim to build on the strengths of the existing local economy and encourage sector development and new sector growth. This will be achieved by allocating and providing land for employment development, supporting the modernisation of existing employment sites, providing a flexible and supportive environment for business development including new and more sustainable working practises and supporting opportunities for improved skills attainment through enhanced education provision focused on business and vocational training. The Local Plan seeks to provide a positive policy framework, which supports jobs, business and investment.

5.6 The coastal and estuarine parts of northern Devon between Cornwall and Ilfracombe have been awarded Assisted Area Status. The award permits the granting of higher levels of financial support through state aid to small businesses and large enterprises to deliver economic development within the defined disadvantaged areas. The wards with Assisted Areas Status in northern Devon are shown on Figure 5.1, together with the contained strategic business parks, industrial estates and employment areas. Figure 5.1 also identifies the Sub-regional Centre of Barnstaple, the Strategic Centre of Bideford, the Main Centres, Local Centres and Villages located within the Assisted Area. The Councils seek to capitalise on the enhanced assistance offered by Assisted Area Status in northern Devon to promote economic development and growth.

Figure 5.1 Wards Within Northern Devon With Assisted Area Status



5.7 The key economic drivers, as identified by the Northern Devon Housing and Employment Study, are: population growth, visitor numbers and spend, housing provision, manufacturing and exports and enterprise and small business growth. More widely opportunities for growth are also recognised within the marine and energy sectors and for growth in business which are "footloose" in terms of their location.

Policy ST11: Delivering Employment and Economic Development

Employment growth will be supported to deliver quantitative and qualitative improvements in job opportunities throughout northern Devon; the achievement of which will be supported on the following basis:

(1) Employment generating opportunities to meet identified needs and locally determined growth aspirations. Employment land requirements will be met through the release of a minimum of 84.9 hectares of land for general employment purposes and by the retention and reuse of employment sites.

(2) A flexible approach to employment land release will be adopted in response to relocation or expansion proposals that will contribute to improvements in the economy of northern Devon.

(3) The District Councils, working in partnership with business and local communities, will maintain and enhance a diverse local economy and encourage opportunities for inward investment. The high environmental qualities of northern Devon will be safeguarded to attract further investment from new and existing employers and links between the environment and the economy will be fostered.

(4) Opportunities for new business formations will be actively pursued and the long-term survival of businesses encouraged, with sustainable forms of business, including home-working, and the expansion of ICT particularly supported where this accords with other Local Plan policies. Working with partners, the Councils will encourage education and skills development in order to provide employers with access to a suitably skilled labour force.

(5) Within northern Devon, high-value jobs in business, education and research, those supporting a low carbon economy and other key growth sectors will be encouraged in sustainable locations. These jobs will retain and enhance local skills; and developers will need to demonstrate how they will work with local economic partnerships in maximising opportunities for employing local people and developing skills in northern Devon.

(6) Support will be given to existing sectors to ensure that they continue to flourish and grow in a sustainable manner. The modernisation of employment sites will be encouraged in order to meet current and future business needs.

(7) Proposals for economic development and diversification of the rural economy will be supported where they do not conflict with other Local Plan policies.

5.8 The policy focus is to increase the level of high-value employment in northern Devon through existing business growth and the attraction of new business; ensuring that appropriate skills are locally available and with strengthened links between employers and the local community.

5.9 Existing and proposed employment sites provide a range of premises and land, which are concentrated at the most populated areas and where there is greatest market demand for new

employment generating opportunities. Barnstaple, Bideford, Braunton and Wrafton, Holsworthy, Ilfracombe and South Molton will provide the focus for future employment generated growth.

5.10 The Local Plan identifies a supply of available land for economic development that provides businesses with a choice of suitable premises and locations. Policy ST08: Scale and Distribution of New Development in Northern Devon, provides for a minimum of 84.9 hectares of land to accommodate business development needs, the distribution of which, is directed by local visions and opportunities, as taken forward in each of the towns' development strategies. Further sites may also be released on an exceptional basis to address identified expansion or new business proposals that could not otherwise be accommodated within allocated sites. Land release on this basis will be to secure specific quality employment opportunities that contribute to meeting strategic economic objectives.

5.11 There are a number of large rural brownfield sites across northern Devon that are not subject to specific site allocations. The Local Plan recognises and supports opportunities to regenerate these sites where it secures economic growth and contributes to and enhances the natural and local environment.

5.12 It is recognised that not all employment generating sectors place demands on the economic development land supply and that a suitable land supply is only one element in achieving positive economic change. The availability of the right skills amongst the workforce, the ability to provide appropriately skilled entrants to the workplace, business development support and infrastructure that meets the needs of a modern economy also makes critical contributions to the achievement of economic growth.

5.13 The policy seeks to address the current need for more job opportunities for local people and to cater for the future requirements of an increasing population. In addition to quantitative improvements the Councils are focused on securing qualitative improvements to increase local skills and wage levels. In order to ensure that the local economy benefits from a wide skills base within the local population, the District Councils will work with partners to ensure that education and skills levels are improved, that employers link more effectively to the local community, and that increased numbers of young people are able to find high quality work in northern Devon rather than having to relocate to find employment.

5.14 Employment opportunities will continue to be supported within the rural area of northern Devon including through Policies DM14: Rural Economy and DM15: Farm Diversification. The Local Plan recognises the importance of a robust rural economy which is viewed as a vital component in the maintenance and development of sustainable communities and more widely in supporting an active and prosperous rural area.

5.15 Home-working by residents in rural areas is becoming a significant part of the rural economy and the expansion of high speed broadband, improved mobile phone coverage and other technological advances will help to support this sustainable form of employment. Home-working and other proposals which aim to diversify the rural economy will generally be supported in line with the National Planning Policy Framework and National Planning Practice Guidance.

5.16 The Councils will support the modernisation of employment sites and proposals that deliver quality employment facilities suited to current and future business needs. In some instances this may include support for the relocation of businesses to other locations within northern Devon to address operational and efficiency issues that could not otherwise be addressed.

5.17 Supporting infrastructure to economic development will be an important element of new and modernised facilities, particularly where other services and facilities do not exist nearby. Improving ICT connectivity is recognised as being of critical importance to the economic prospects of the area, which will be enhanced as a result of the Connecting Devon and Somerset Programme.

Town and District Centres

Town and District Centres

Retail Strategy

5.18 A range of retail and service facilities are provided at and within the environs of northern Devon's town and village centres. Barnstaple and Bideford provide a significant range of services to a substantial catchment. Barnstaple is recognised as the largest centre delivering the greatest range of convenience and comparison retail options; reflecting its status as a Sub-regional Centre. Bideford is also an important centre, which provides a reduced level and range of retail and service provision from Barnstaple but a distinctly greater range than the area's other towns. The other Main Centres at Braunton, Great Torrington, Holsworthy, Ilfracombe and South Molton are locally important but smaller and support a range of services which are strongly influenced by their proximity to other centres.

5.19 Enhancing the attraction and function of the area's seven town centres is fundamental to the delivery of sustainable communities in northern Devon. District, Local Centres and Villages also provide much needed shops and services for local residents to use on a day-to-day basis and their maintenance is recognised as an important component in sustaining urban and rural communities.

Policy ST12: Town and District Centres

(1) The role of Barnstaple as a strategic retail and cultural centre will be sustained and enhanced to achieve qualitative and quantitative improvements through investment on town centre strategic sites.

(2) In line with the retail hierarchy the vitality and viability of the town centres of Barnstaple, Bideford, Braunton, Ilfracombe, Great Torrington, Holsworthy and South Molton, as defined on the Policies Map, will be protected and enhanced by focusing development proposals for retail, leisure, office and cultural facilities within defined town centres and through the positive management of regeneration measures.

(3) Employment, residential, community and health services, leisure and tourist facilities, attractive spaces and a balanced night life will be encouraged within the town centres and environs to achieve a mix of facilities and active town centres.

(4) In District Centres, as defined on the Policies Map, development will be supported where it would enhance viability, vitality and self-containment and where it would be proportionate to the role and function of the settlement.

(5) In all Policy ST06 and ST07 defined settlements and Rural Settlements, locally important shops, services and community facilities will be protected from loss and new provisions encouraged where appropriately scaled.

5.20 The hierarchy of retail service centres referenced in Policy ST12 is:

Sub-regional Centre (many comparison and convenience shops, services, employment and entertainment which serves a much wider catchment than the local population)	Barnstaple
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Strategic Centre (a wide range of shops, and reduced range of services, employment and entertainment than provided by the Sub-regional Centre but remaining significant to an extended local population)	Bideford
Main Centres (shops and services primarily serving local catchments but providing for main weekly convenience shopping)	Braunton, Great Torrington, Holsworthy, Ilfracombe and South Molton
District Centres – Urban Areas (shops and limited services for day-to-day needs within urban neighbourhoods)	Appledore, Northam, Roundswell and Westward Ho!

5.21 The significance of Barnstaple is recognised in the Northern Devon Retail and Leisure Study, in reflection of which it will continue to develop as the area's principal retail centre. However, in focusing retail growth at Barnstaple, care will be required to ensure the related function in Bideford is not adversely impacted; the centres need to perform complementary not competing retail roles that build on existing strengths to develop their use as attractive centres for residents and visitors.

5.22 All of northern Devon's other Main Centres, as set out in the above retail hierarchy, have a vital role to play in providing for the retail and service based needs of their residents and those of the wider rural communities which they serve. The strategy for the town centres is one based on making provision for new commercial and service developments to enhance the function of the town centres, making them more active and vibrant places, without significantly altering existing shopping patterns between settlements. Policy DM19: Town and District Centres provides the detailed approach to managing development within defined Town and District Centres, Primary Shopping Areas and Primary Shopping Frontages.

5.23 A key objective in respect of Bideford and the locally significant centres of Braunton, Great Torrington, Holsworthy, Ilfracombe and South Molton is to increase levels of self-containment, to reduced expenditure leakage and the need for travel to other centres. The Local Plan gives support to opportunities that will appropriately enhance the range and accessibility of central area facilities.

5.24 Opportunities exist within and adjoining town centres through redevelopment to deliver regeneration that will improve functionality and encourage intensification of use, such as the redevelopment of the East-the-Water Wharves at Bideford. The Councils will pursue initiatives, which strengthen and support existing town centre roles, including the detailed proposals for town centre redevelopment schemes that are set out within the settlement chapters of the Local Plan. Proposals for town centre uses should follow the guidance set out in the National Planning Policy Framework and National Planning Practice Guidance directing development in the first instance to within town centre boundaries.

5.25 The favoured approach to address capacity needs is to seek improved provision within the towns through regeneration and redevelopment, such as through the delivery of a mixed retail scheme on the Queen Street/Bear Street site (Policy BAR11). The Retail and Leisure Assessment identified the need for additional retail floorspace: 21,557 sqm of comparison and 2,967 sqm of convenience floor space in Barnstaple 2012-2032; 1,480 sqm of comparison floor space in Bideford and a further requirement for 9,174 sqm of convenience and comparison floorspace across the other towns, the bulk of which being required in Braunton, Ilfracombe and South Molton. In accommodating identified needs a sequential approach to site release will be applied, as set out in Policy DM20: Development Outside Town Centres.

5.26 The Local Plan seeks to support and strengthen the vitality and attraction of northern Devon's town centres to achieve the following:

- (a) vibrant, healthy and safe shopping environments combined with high quality townscapes that include green infrastructure and attractive and accessible environments for all;
- (b) new developments which are sensitive to areas of conservation importance and which reinforce local distinctiveness;
- (c) improved retail attraction by increasing the range and quality of shops and other town centre facilities and services appropriate to the scale and function of the settlement;
- (d) an improved range of cultural, leisure and social attractions;
- (e) the introduction of measures to reduce the detrimental impact of traffic;
- (f) a variety of business opportunities, to maintain a balance between employment uses and other town centre activities; and
- (g) an improved sense of safety and security for all town centre users.

5.27 In the urban District Centres of Appledore, Northam, Westward Ho! and at Roundswell a range of services and facilities provides essential support for the resident communities and, in respect of Westward Ho! visitors to the area. The strategy for the District Centres is to at least maintain service levels for the related local communities. The Local Plan supports the continued presence, improved accessibility and the development of appropriately scaled new facilities that contribute to increasing the sustainability of northern Devon's rural and urban communities. Policy ST22: Community Services and Facilities also guards against the loss of community services and facilities, education, health, social and other publicly provided services as a result of development, as does Policy DM21: Local and Rural Shops in respect of locally important shops.

Tourism

5.28 Tourism is an integral part of the economy of northern Devon. The area has a wealth of tourism facilities and attractions, the majority of which are based on the value provided by the area's environmental assets.

5.29 During 2015/2016 the economy of northern Devon benefitted from £477 million tourist spend, which supported 11,086 related jobs⁽³⁷⁾. The facilities supporting tourism, including visitor accommodation and recreation facilities represent a major resource. The components are diverse and wide ranging in respect of resultant economic, social and environmental impacts. The challenge for the Local Plan is to ensure that the needs of the visitor, the tourism industry and the community can be met within environmental limits.

Policy ST13: Sustainable Tourism

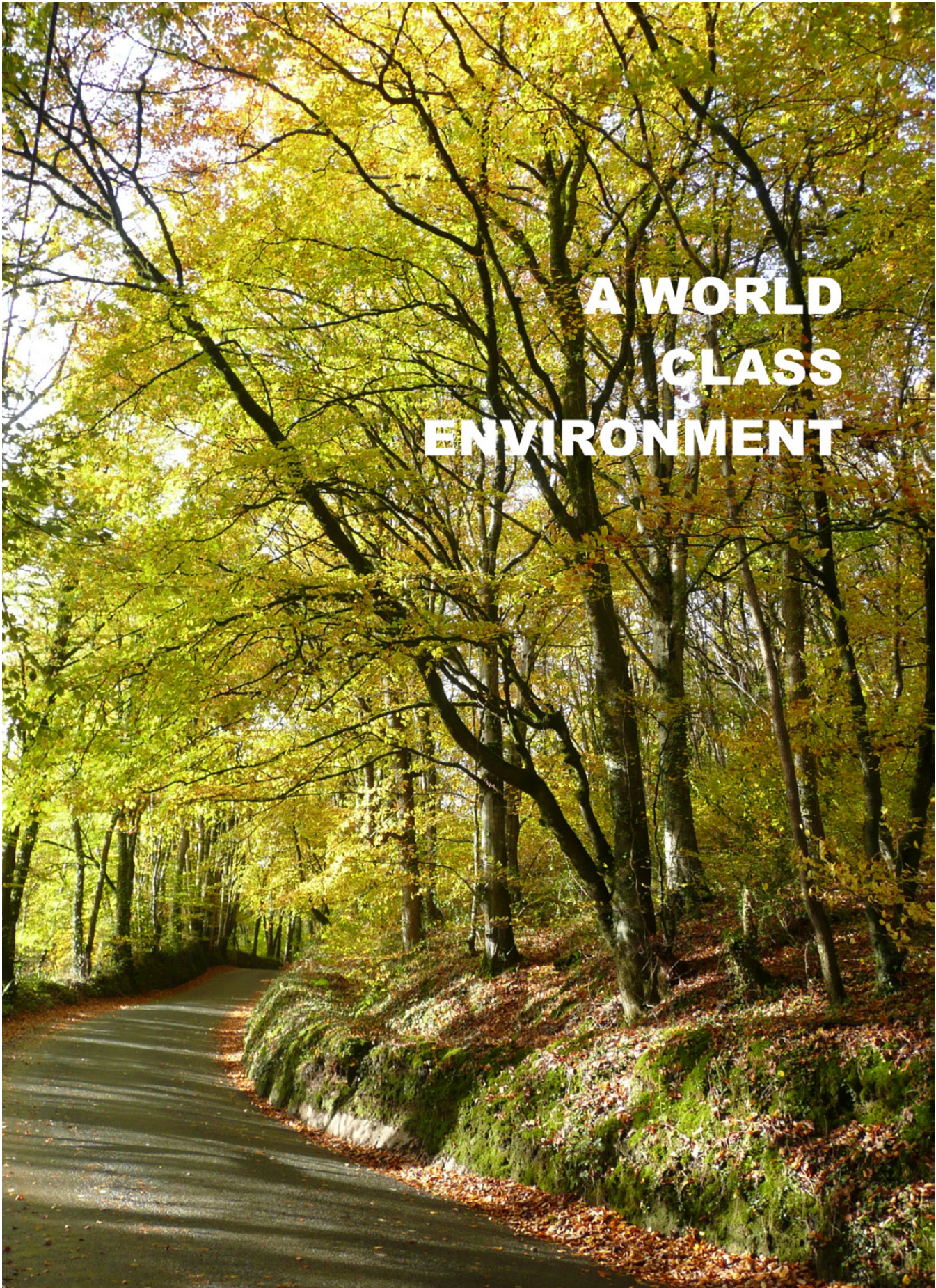
High quality tourism development that promotes a year round industry will be supported. Tourism growth should be sustainable and should not damage the natural or historic assets of northern Devon.

5.30 The Local Plan seeks to maximise the benefits to be obtained from tourism, especially in respect of income and improved employment opportunities. At the same time resultant

³⁷ The Economic Impact of Devon's Visitor Economy 2015, North Devon and the Economic Impact of Devon's Visitor Economy 2016, Torridge (The South West Research Company Ltd)

environmental disadvantage must be minimised. The tourism sector in northern Devon is based on and sustained by its natural and built environment. Key to increasing tourism derived benefits is the continued protection and enhancement of the area's environmental assets.

5.31 In order to achieve the objective of sustainable tourism, the area's tourism "offer" must be enhanced. Sustainable tourism development in northern Devon will be focused on qualitative improvements, which could include expansion of existing facilities. Delivery of a quality product, not only through environmental safeguards but also through improved standards in the quality and range of accommodation and attractions, is an important element in achieving sustainable development. A quality rather than quantity approach is required if the sector is to keep pace with continually evolving requirements and expectations. Proposals that result in the enhancement of existing attractions and destinations will be supported.



A WORLD CLASS ENVIRONMENT

6 A World Class Environment

6.1 The strategic objectives to conserve and enhance northern Devon's world-class environment are set out in chapter two of the Local Plan. The high quality local environment will provide opportunities for inward investment, tourism and economic growth, whilst economic growth can potentially provide funding to help deliver specific environmental enhancements and a net gain in biodiversity. The world-class environment includes a distinctive combination of high quality natural and built environmental assets including the coastline, landscapes, habitats, heritage and historic settlements within the UNESCO Biosphere Reserve. These assets will be protected and enhanced with some having been nationally or locally designated. Northern Devon's environment offers a high quality of life and helps to underpin the local economy, whilst providing productive living landscapes and townscapes that can adapt to and support the area's changing needs. High quality sustainable design and construction will help to mitigate and adapt to the effects of climate change whilst making effective use of natural resource availability.

Enhancing Environmental Assets

Policy ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets

The quality of northern Devon's natural environment will be protected and enhanced by ensuring that development contributes to:

- (a) providing a net gain in northern Devon's biodiversity where possible, through positive management of an enhanced and expanded network of designated sites and green infrastructure, including retention and enhancement of critical environmental capital;**
- (b) protecting the hierarchy of designated sites in accordance with their status;**
- (c) conserving European protected species and the habitats on which they depend;**
- (d) conserving northern Devon's geodiversity and its best and most versatile agricultural land;**
- (e) conserving the setting and special character and qualities of the North Devon Coast Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty whilst fostering the social and economic well being of the area;**
- (f) ensuring development conserves and enhances northern Devon's local distinctiveness including its tranquillity, and the setting and special qualities of Exmoor National Park including its dark night skies;**
- (g) protecting and enhancing local landscape and seascape character, taking into account the key characteristics, the historical dimension of the landscape and their sensitivity to change;**
- (h) recognising the importance of the undeveloped coastal, estuarine and marine environments through supporting designations, plans and policies that aim to protect and enhance northern Devon's coastline;**
- (i) conserving and enhancing the robustness of northern Devon's ecosystems and the range of ecosystem services they provide;**
- (j) increasing opportunities for access, education and appreciation of all aspects of northern Devon's environment, for all sections of the community;**

(k) meeting the Nature Improvement Area's strategic objectives; and

(l) improving failing water bodies and preventing deterioration of water quality.

6.2 Northern Devon's high quality environment includes sites of international importance, such as the UNESCO Biosphere Reserve and other Special Areas of Conservation, as well as numerous environmental assets important at national, regional and local levels. It is important that the quality and diversity of these natural biodiversity, landscape, marine and estuarine environmental assets, their local distinctiveness and their contribution to this world class environment are recognised, conserved and enhanced. Ancient woodland and ancient trees are important environmental assets. A large part of the River Torridge's catchment area is identified as a Nature Improvement Area⁽³⁸⁾ to restore it towards an integrated network of wildlife-rich habitats.

6.3 The Councils are committed, in partnership with key stakeholders, to undertake a wider study to assess the potential impact on over-wintering wildfowl and waders in the Taw-Torridge estuary Site of Special Scientific Interest arising from recreational activity, the nature of that impact and the need for appropriate mitigation to be delivered.

6.4 Green Infrastructure, including rivers and streams, is focused on environmental assets that are accessible to people and connected for wildlife movements. Local sites contribute to the wider biodiversity network. Enhancement of green infrastructure networks will help to conserve biodiversity, improve access to natural green spaces within urban areas and ensure that the quality of life and health and wellbeing is improved for existing and future communities and visitors to the area. Opportunities will be taken to enhance cross boundary green infrastructure linkages.

6.5 All development will be expected to provide a net gain in biodiversity where feasible. Where biodiversity assets cannot be retained or enhanced on site, the Councils will support 'biodiversity offsetting' to deliver a net gain in biodiversity off-site in accordance with the offsetting strategy⁽³⁹⁾. Biodiversity gain can best be achieved across northern Devon as a whole by enhancing the existing network of habitats, especially outside designated areas. Offsetting should generally occur close to where habitat has been lost, with future provision supported by a green infrastructure strategy. However, 'critical environmental capital' such as ancient woodland and veteran trees are not replaceable and should not be lost. European protected species will be conserved by protecting and enhancing the key habitats on which they depend, including for feeding, burrowing, roosting and hibernating. Flyways for bats will be protected by considering impacts from lighting.

6.6 The North Devon Coast Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty is a nationally important landscape covering the coastal area. The area's special character and qualities are identified in the Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty Management Plan and the Councils have a duty to conserve and enhance this area's natural beauty⁽⁴⁰⁾. The setting and inland areas of the AONB contribute to its special qualities. Major development in the AONB will be enabled only in exceptional circumstances where it can be demonstrated as being in the public interest. Exmoor National Park is also of national importance, the landscape setting and special qualities of which will be conserved. The Dark Sky Reserve on Exmoor National Park is the first of its kind in Europe. The Councils have a duty to have regard to the National Park's purposes in exercising any functions in relation to or affecting land in a National Park⁽⁴¹⁾. The southern edges of Exmoor Heaths Special Area of Conservation at Molland and Cussacombe Commons are within the plan

38 <http://www.naturalengland.org.uk/ourwork/conservation/biodiversity/funding/nia/projects/northerndevon.aspx>

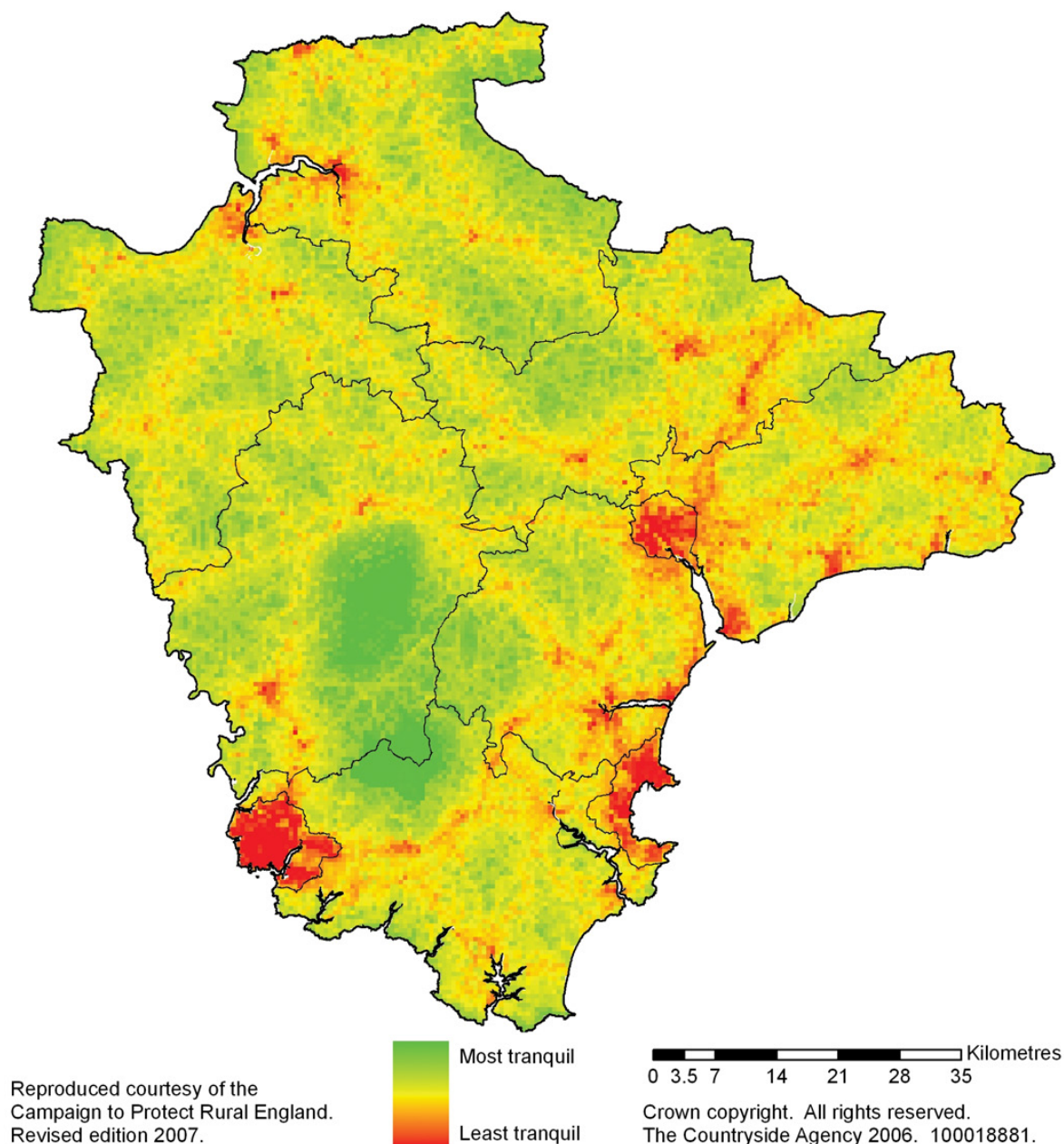
39 Rebuilding Nature in the Biosphere Reserve: North Devon UNESCO Biosphere Reserve Offsetting Strategy 2013-2018 or successor documents

40 Section 85 of Countryside and Rights of Way Act imposes a duty on relevant authorities to have regard to the purpose of conserving and enhancing the natural beauty within an AONB

41 Section 62 of the Environment Act creates a duty on relevant authorities to have regard to the statutory purposes for designating a National Park

area adjoining Exmoor National Park and will be recognised for their importance to the sensitivity and landscape setting of the National Park.

Figure 6.1 Devon's Tranquil Areas



6.7 The local distinctiveness of northern Devon's landscape reflects its topography, geology, soil and climate as well as its cultural heritage. Northern Devon is situated within The Culm and Exmoor national character areas, and distinct Devon Character Areas are defined through the Devon Landscape Character Assessment⁽⁴²⁾. The key characteristics of all landscape character types within northern Devon are identified in the Joint Landscape Character Assessment⁽⁴³⁾, including their historic dimensions. All landscape character types will be conserved and enhanced in accordance with the Joint Landscape Character Assessment's 'protect, manage and plan' landscape strategy for each landscape character type, with Policy ST04: Improving the Quality of Development, seeking to strengthen local distinctiveness. Sensitivity of landscapes to accommodate change will be assessed through landscape sensitivity assessments. Seascapes

42 Devon Character Areas (published by Devon County Council 2012)

43 Joint Landscape Character Assessment for North Devon and Torridge Districts (Land Use Consultants, November 2010)

are also environmental assets that will be protected and enhanced. The key characteristics and extent of seascape character areas are defined through the North Devon and Exmoor Seascape Character Assessment (Land Use Consultants, November 2015⁽⁴⁴⁾).

6.8 Away from the main towns, large parts of northern Devon remain tranquil ⁽⁴⁵⁾. The relatively large scale of the remaining tranquil areas (Figure 6.1'Devon's Tranquil Areas') is important to the character of Devon, which scores the highest tranquillity level in the South West. Northern Devon's relative tranquillity is an important part of its landscape character and environment and includes dark night skies without light pollution through sky glow. Development within northern Devon will safeguard these dark night skies and opportunities will be taken to enhance this tranquillity and reduce light pollution.

6.9 The best and most versatile land ⁽⁴⁶⁾ is a limited environmental resource with local concentrations across northern Devon. High-grade soils are important for local food production, although lower grade agricultural land often has the greatest ecological value. Development will be directed towards poorer quality agricultural land taking into account environmental and other sustainability issues.

6.10 The Water Framework Directive requires all inland and coastal water to reach at least 'good status' by 2015. Strategic Objective 2(g) of the Local Plan recognises this requirement and Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience provides a policy framework for new development.

6.11 There are a wide range of environmental designations covering sites and areas in northern Devon that protect its special biodiversity, geodiversity and landscape. There are additionally important environmental assets not covered by formal designations. For example, the setting of both Exmoor National Park and North Devon Coast Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty are important where the intrinsic value of these undesignated environmental assets will also be recognised and conserved. A future extension to the North Devon Coast Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty including Braunton Marsh and Great Field will be supported. A full boundary review of the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty boundary will be sought during the lifetime of the Local Plan.

6.12 Northern Devon's coastline contributes a significant part of the area's environmental quality. In addition to the North Devon Coast Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty and the Heritage Coasts, there are several Sites of Special Scientific Interest, the Tintagel-Marsland-Clovelly Coast Special Areas of Conservation and the South West Coast Path. The United Kingdom's first Marine Nature Reserve is around Lundy and a Voluntary Marine Conservation Area exists from Croyde to Hangman Point in Exmoor National Park. The Taw-Torridge estuary is also a Site of Special Scientific Interest and includes part of the buffer zone of the Biosphere Reserve. The three 'prime biodiversity areas' identified in Natural England's maritime natural area profile for the coast between Land's End and Minehead are all situated wholly or partly in northern Devon ⁽⁴⁷⁾. The strategy for the coastal area is set out in Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy.

6.13 The Marine and Coastal Access Act has introduced marine planning and will establish Marine Conservation Zones around the United Kingdom, the first of which is designated around Lundy. This changing policy framework requires coastal and inland areas to be considered together as part of a broader environmental system with terrestrial pressures affecting the quality of coastal waters. The Councils will work with the Marine Management Organisation (MMO) in preparing a Marine Plan that includes the northern Devon coast and is compatible with this Local Plan. Much of the northern Devon coast lies within the Bristol Channel and the Councils will work

44 North Devon and Exmoor Seascape Character Assessment (Land Use Consultants November 2015

45 www.cpre.org.uk/campaigns/landscape/tranquillity/national-and-regional-tranquillity-maps

46 Land in grades 1, 2 and 3a of the Agricultural Land Classification (NPPF, March 2012)

47 www.english-nature.org.uk/science/natural/profiles%5CnaProfile114.pdf

with partners to ensure that policies introduced in Marine Plans for each side of the Bristol Channel are compatible. The coast and estuary form a significant attraction for the tourism industry, with development pressures in and around coastal settlements, estuaries and undeveloped stretches of coast. The Coastal and Estuarine Zone is identified on the Policies Map and defined in Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy.

6.14 North Devon's Biosphere Reserve was designated in 2002, the first in the United Kingdom under the new designation criteria. Biosphere Reserves are uniquely modern designations with three distinct zones that are 'living laboratories' for demonstrating innovative approaches for sustainable development on a sub-regional scale within areas of high environmental quality. North Devon's Biosphere Reserve operates at an ecosystem scale, defined by the catchments of the Rivers Taw and Torridge and offshore marine areas stretching out to Lundy and beyond. It is where different aspects of sustainable development can be brought together as an exemplar of sustainable development principles, such as through utilising ecosystem services, to develop a thriving economy and a good quality of life, demonstrating the best examples of people working in harmony with the natural environment.

6.15 Northern Devon's natural environment provides a range of ecosystem services such as flood management, provision of fresh water, food production, carbon storage and climate regulation, as well as habitats for biodiversity and recreation opportunities. The integrity of the ecosystems and the services they provide must be conserved and enhanced at an ecosystem scale. Ecosystem services play a beneficial role in enhancing or maintaining aspects of human wellbeing.

6.16 Many designated environmental assets deliver ecosystem services, with opportunities for delivery of multiple ecosystems being supported. Culm grassland, for example, is a priority habitat distinctive to northern Devon, with fragmented parcels of culm grassland designated as a Special Area of Conservation. Opportunities will be supported to protect the setting of the Special Area of Conservation and to enhance corridors between the designated areas as part of a green infrastructure network. The Working Wetlands Project ⁽⁴⁸⁾ will facilitate the enhancement of existing culm grasslands, reduce fragmentation of the existing habitat network whilst achieving wider environmental benefits by reducing flooding and improving water quality downstream. At least 85 hectares of culm grassland will be restored and re-created in the Knowstone area.

Conserving Heritage Assets

Policy ST15: Conserving Heritage Assets

Great weight will be given to the desirability of preserving and enhancing northern Devon's historic environment by:

- (a) conserving the historic dimension of the landscape;**
- (b) conserving cultural, built, historic and archaeological features of national and local importance and their settings, including those that are not formally designated;**
- (c) identifying and protecting locally important buildings that contribute to the area's local character and identity; and**
- (d) increasing opportunities for access, education and appreciation of all aspects of northern Devon's historic environment, for all sections of the community.**

⁴⁸ Working Wetlands Project is run by Devon Wildlife Trust to restore and recreate culm grassland habitats by working with farmers and landowners

6.17 Northern Devon has a range of designated heritage assets including over 4,700 Listed Buildings, over 200 Scheduled Ancient Monuments, 7 Historic Parks and Gardens and 61 Conservation Areas. There are also important heritage assets not protected by formal designations, including Great Torrington Commons, Branton Great Field and other medieval field patterns, although both Great Torrington Commons (Policy GTT06) and Branton Great Field (Policy BRA03) are identified as Local Green Spaces. The range of identified heritage assets in northern Devon are listed in the Devon and Dartmoor Historic Environment Record. Some heritage assets remain undiscovered, especially archaeological remains, or their heritage value is not yet recognised, so will also remain undesignated. Buildings that are not listed but contribute to the local street scene by adding character, diversity and local distinctiveness to northern Devon's historic environment will be identified as locally important buildings. The intrinsic historic value of all of these undesignated heritage assets and the setting of all heritage assets will also be recognised and conserved. A supplementary planning document will provide further guidance on the approach to identifying and protecting undesignated heritage assets, including buildings which contribute to local character and sense of place. The setting of heritage assets will be assessed through a positive approach to development management.

6.18 The landscape is one of the most important components of our historic environment, with much of it having been shaped by centuries of human activity. The wider historic environment also contributes to the local distinctiveness of the area in terms of its dispersed rural farmsteads, irregular field patterns, Devon banks and hedges, vernacular architecture, historic townscapes and the local character of individual settlements and neighbourhoods. Buildings of cob construction are also distinctive to northern Devon. These aspects of the historic environment will all be protected and enhanced.

6.19 As a rural area with an historic economy based on agriculture, over 20% of northern Devon's listed buildings are historic farm buildings. Whilst most farmhouses remain occupied and some agricultural buildings remain in agricultural use or have already been converted, others are incompatible with modern farming practices. These buildings are vulnerable to neglect unless alternative uses can be found that safeguard their historic integrity.

6.20 There are many pressures threatening the continued existence and integrity of the historic environment. Once lost, evidence of our collective past cannot be recovered or replaced. The Councils will identify heritage assets considered to be at risk and will take steps as opportunities arise towards securing improvement in their condition to mitigate the risk.

Renewable Energy and Heat

Policy ST16: Delivering Renewable Energy and Heat

(1) Proposals for development incorporating on-site provision of renewable energy (other than wind energy) or renewable heat and/or low carbon technologies will be supported and encouraged where appropriate.

(2) Proposals by community-led enterprises and schemes that meet the needs of local communities to offset their energy and heat demand from renewable and low carbon sources (other than wind energy) will be supported where appropriate.

(3) Renewable and low carbon energy and heat generating development (other than wind energy) will be supported in the landscape character types where:

(a) landscape sensitivity is best able to accommodate them, assessed in accordance with the Councils' Landscape Sensitivity Assessments and by the landscape's sensitivity to accommodate the scale of development;

(b) there is no significant impact on local amenities; and

(c) the special qualities of nationally important landscape, biodiversity and heritage designations and their settings are conserved or enhanced.

(4) Renewable and low carbon energy development (other than wind energy) will be supported where it can demonstrate that the cumulative impact of operational, consented and proposed development on landscape character does not become a significant or defining characteristic of the wider fabric, character and quality of the landscape.

6.21 Policy ST16: Delivering Renewable Energy and Heat, relates to all forms of renewable energy and renewable heat development other than wind energy. Northern Devon's contribution towards mitigating the impact of climate change and reducing carbon dioxide emissions will include reducing energy consumption through energy conservation measures and the increasing use of renewable energy and heat. The Councils will seek to prioritise reduced carbon dioxide emissions from new development through energy efficient design. New development should incorporate sustainable design and construction principles to minimise carbon dioxide emissions during construction and throughout the lifetime of the development, as set out in Policy ST05: Sustainable Construction and Buildings.

6.22 In June 2015 a Ministerial Statement ⁽⁴⁹⁾ was issued stating that planning applications for wind energy development involving one or more wind turbines should only be granted planning permission where: the development site is in an area identified as suitable for wind energy development in a Local or Neighbourhood Plan; and following consultation, it can be demonstrated that the planning impacts identified by affected local communities have been fully addressed and therefore the proposal has their backing. The Councils have not allocated sites for the development of wind turbines in this Local Plan, but it represents the policy framework against which planning applications will be considered, should they come forward as a result of a Neighbourhood Plan allocation. All proposals for new wind turbine development must be within a Neighbourhood Plan allocation and clearly demonstrate that any impacts in terms of noise, shadow flicker, vibration, air traffic safety, radar and telecommunications have been mitigated adequately to comply with other policies within the Local Plan.

6.23 Applicants of major development proposals are encouraged to assess the current and future opportunities for decentralised energy networks, including proposals for combined heat and power facilities, which will be supported in principle where feasible. Opportunities for co-location of energy and heat producers with energy and heat users will be supported and investigated. Major mixed use developments and strategic extensions to the main towns are likely to offer the most viable opportunities for decentralised energy networks. Future development is encouraged to invest in and develop local decentralised infrastructure to facilitate both importers and exporters of heat.

6.24 Renewable heat and energy technologies occur at a wide range of scales with different characteristics affecting the relative impacts upon the natural and built environment. Northern Devon has a range of natural resources suitable for many different types of energy generation, including offshore and marine renewables. There are opportunities for community-led enterprises to benefit local communities including local businesses by generating energy directly and/or providing income for the community through energy generation. Harnessing appropriate opportunities for renewable energy complements the Biosphere Reserve's objective of utilising ecosystem services to deliver sustainable development.

⁴⁹ Local Planning: Written Ministerial Statement (HCWS42) (Greg Clarke: Secretary of State for Communities and Local Government, June 2015)

6.25 The South West region became the UK's first Low Carbon Economic Area in 2009 with a view to becoming a world centre for marine energy. In 2012 the South West was identified as the UK's first Marine Energy Park to speed up the progress of marine technology development. Northern Devon seeks to become a hub for the manufacture, delivery and maintenance of renewable energy technologies. Onshore facilities for operational servicing of large scale offshore renewable energy proposals will be supported to develop the local marine renewables and offshore wind economic sector where the size, scale and any impacts are appropriate to its setting. The Councils' strategy for economic growth includes delivery of a business hub for renewable energy technologies and enhanced opportunities for skills development and training in delivery and maintenance of both large and small scale renewable energy proposals. The tidal demonstration zone off Lynton will also bring economic benefits to the area. Policy ST11: Delivering Employment and Economic Growth, supports sub-regional economic growth and training.

6.26 Renewable energy developments can impact on the area's high quality natural and historic environment, so landscape and visual impacts, including impacts on the area's tranquility and dark night skies, should be assessed in order to minimise harm. Landscape and heritage assets of national importance and their settings will be protected. Landscape Visual Impact Assessments submitted with applications should reference: the special landscape characteristics for the relevant landscape character type identified within the Joint Landscape Character Assessment; the sensitivity of these special characteristics identified within the Landscape Sensitivity Assessments; best practice guidance within Devon's landscape policy group advice note on how to optimise siting and assess landscape impacts; and relevant national planning guidance.

6.27 Cumulative impacts of existing operational, consented and proposed developments will be assessed, and suitable mitigation measures proposed, to minimise impacts on biodiversity and landscape quality. A developer must demonstrate that cumulative impact does not become a significant or defining characteristic of the wider landscape, including across administrative boundaries and different landscape character types.

6.28 The landfall and onshore infrastructure impacts and benefits associated with offshore renewable energy will also be considered (Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy). Renewable energy can also provide a range of environmental, economic and community benefits at both national and local scales, and appropriately scaled projects should be designed to directly supply the needs of individual properties, businesses and communities.

6.29 Opportunities for renewable energy proposals will be influenced by natural resource availability and the sensitivity of the environment to accommodate different types and scales of installation including cumulative impact. The Councils have assessed the relative sensitivity of each landscape character type, as described in the Joint Landscape Character Assessment for North Devon and Torridge (2011), to accommodate different scales of wind energy and field-scale photovoltaic development. Landscape and visual impacts across administrative boundaries will be considered using Devon's landscape policy guidance.

6.30 Appropriate locations for renewable energy developments including their cumulative impact will need to conserve key environmental and heritage assets (Policies ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets and ST15: Conserving Heritage Assets) and safeguard amenities of surrounding properties and uses. A Ministerial Statement of 9th April 2014 states that the need for renewable energy does not automatically override environmental protections and the planning concerns of local communities and this will also be a consideration in determining any proposals.

(50)

50 Local Planning and Renewable Energy Development: Written Ministerial Statement (Eric Pickles: Secretary of State for Communities and Local Government)



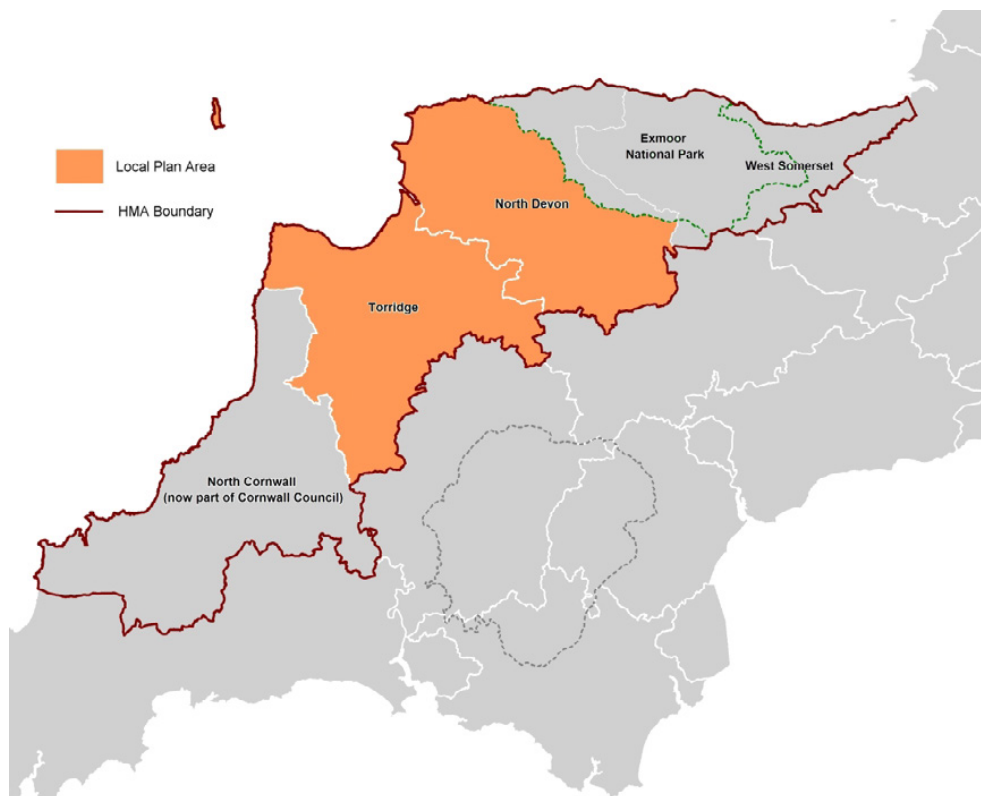
7 Delivering a Balanced Local Housing Market

7.1 The strategic objectives to deliver a balanced local housing market for northern Devon are set out in chapter two of the Local Plan. One of the overarching principles of the planning system is to support the provision of strong, vibrant and healthy communities through the supply of housing to meet the needs of present and future generations⁽⁵¹⁾. The Local Plan seeks to provide a framework to enable the delivery of the appropriate scale and type of housing, in appropriate locations, to meet the needs and demands of northern Devon's changing communities over the plan period up to 2031.

A Balanced Local Housing Market

7.2 National planning policy advocates that, through their Local Plans, local planning authorities should seek to meet the full objectively assessed needs for market and affordable housing⁽⁵²⁾. It requires that local planning authorities plan to deliver a mix of housing to meet the needs of current and future generations based on demographic trends and the needs of specific parts of the community. In doing so development should be enabled that offers a wide choice of high quality homes whilst broadening opportunities for home ownership and creating sustainable, inclusive and mixed communities.

Figure 7.1 Extent of Northern Peninsula Housing Market Area



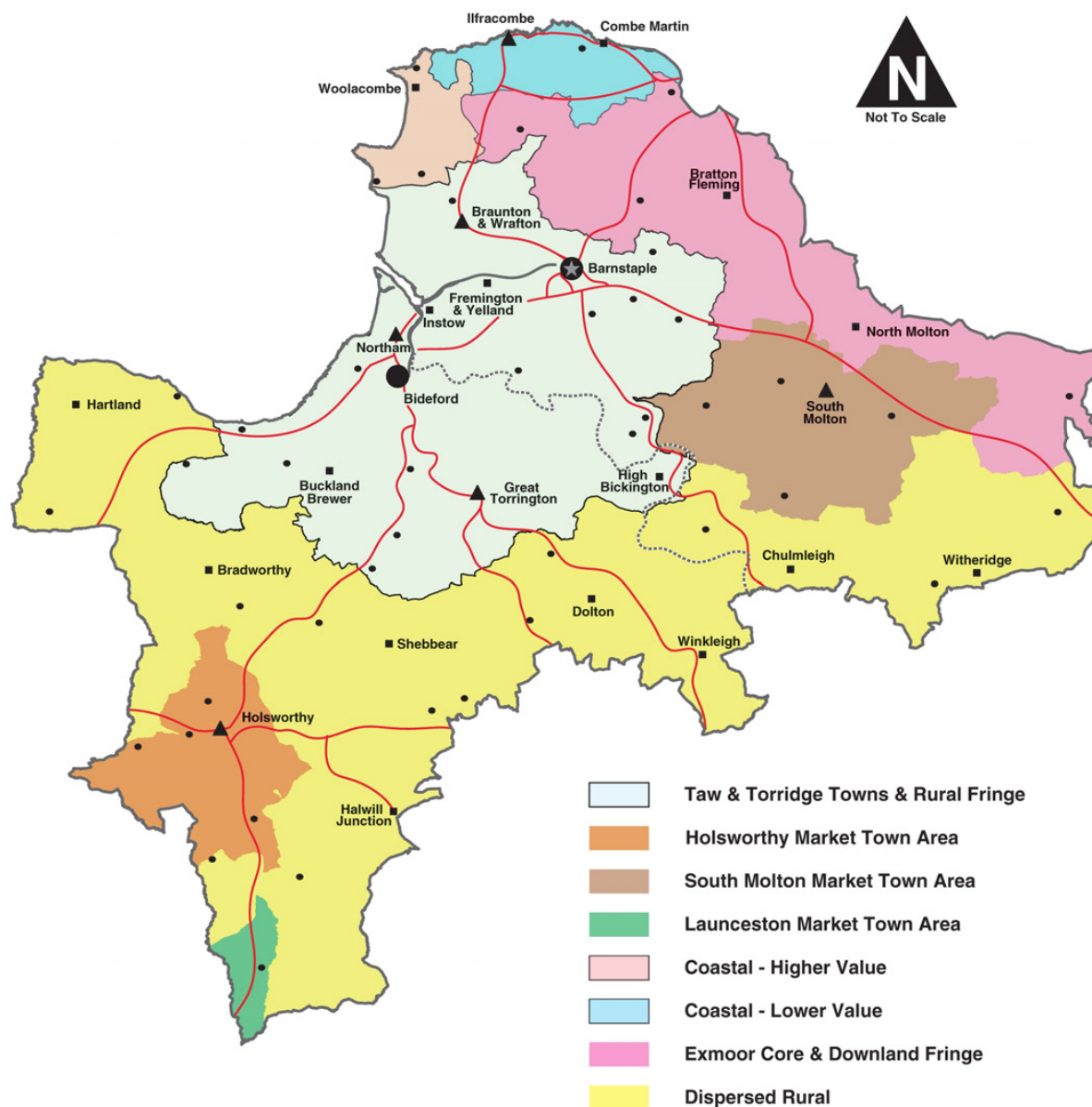
7.3 A Strategic Housing Market Assessment provides the foundation to enable the future planning of appropriate housing development. North Devon and Torridge lie within the Northern Peninsula Housing Market Area, which is identified as a 'polycentric character area' that runs from North Cornwall to West Somerset (Figure 7.1 'Extent of Northern Peninsula Housing Market Area'). The Northern Peninsula Strategic Housing Market Assessment was prepared in 2008 in partnership with the other local authorities who reside within the same housing market area with an update relating to North Devon and Torridge completed in 2012. A Housing and Economic

51 National Planning Policy Framework, paragraph 7 (CLG, March 2012)

52 National Planning Policy Framework, paragraph 47 (CLG, March 2012)

Needs Assessment (HEDNA) and associated update were subsequently completed in 2016. Together the original assessment and more recent updates provide a robust foundation to enable planning for the delivery of housing to meet existing and future needs of northern Devon's communities over the plan period.

Figure 7.2 Housing Sub-Market Areas



7.4 The wider Housing Market Area is divided into a series of housing sub-market areas, as indicated in Figure 7.2: Housing Sub-Market Areas, on the basis of their differing local housing market characteristics such as property prices, market 'gravity', accessibility and location. Within northern Devon the identified housing sub-markets are:

- (a) Taw and Torridge Towns and Rural Fringe (incorporating Barnstaple, Bideford and Northam, Branton and Wrafton and Great Torrington);
- (b) Holsworthy Market Town Area;
- (c) South Molton Market Town Area;

- (d) Launceston Market Town Area (part of);
- (e) Coastal – Higher Value (Croyde and Woolacombe);
- (f) Coastal – Lower Value (Ilfracombe);
- (g) Exmoor Core (part of) and Downland Fringe; and
- (h) Dispersed Rural.

7.5 Each of the identified housing sub-markets has its own individual local circumstances, characteristics and issues. Consequently, there may be a need for different housing interventions to achieve a balanced housing market and meet the housing requirements of their communities.

7.6 Northern Devon is home to a growing population of elderly households. This demographic is likely to have significant implications for the housing market over the plan period⁽⁵³⁾. As people grow older their housing requirements change, as their mobility decreases or they develop other disabilities or ailments that affect the way they live their life. Evidence suggests that often elderly residents live in unsuitable homes; with many single elderly residents living in large family houses that are no longer appropriate to their needs. The consequence of this is not only elderly people living in inappropriate accommodation but also that this housing is not available to meet the needs of families. This section of the community often have specialist accommodation needs that are not met by traditional open market housing. There are also a range of other residents in northern Devon's communities, such as those with disabilities, who will require specialist accommodation or adaptations to their homes to address their own needs.

7.7 Across northern Devon there is a need to re-balance the housing market to provide a range of housing that will meet the changing needs of communities. The Strategic Housing Market Assessment indicates that the mix of existing housing stock across northern Devon in terms of dwelling size, type and tenure is not aligned to the requirements of existing or future households. There is a significant stock of large dwellings coupled to a historically low supply of smaller dwellings.

7.8 It is recognised the stock of underused and empty housing provides an opportunity to help meet northern Devon's housing needs. Both Councils have adopted empty homes strategies⁽⁵⁴⁾ that seek to take a proactive approach to address the problem of long-term empty properties and aim to bring them back into use. The Councils' strategies are also supported by a range of initiatives designed to provide assistance, for example empty property action groups and loans, to bring empty homes back into use. It is however recognised that the scale of delivery from such initiatives will be limited in comparison to the scale of overall housing need and it is not possible to establish with any certainty the number of empty homes that are likely to be brought back into use across the plan period.

7.9 The Local Plan seeks to not only manage delivery of the scale of housing growth that is required to accommodate northern Devon's changing communities but also ensure that it is provided in the right location and is of the right size and type to meet the specific housing requirements.

7.10 All new residential development should contribute towards the creation of sustainable, inclusive and mixed communities by providing housing that reflects the needs of present and future generations whilst improving the balance of the local housing market and sub-markets.

53 Community Council of Devon (2011) Housing Aspirations of Older People living in Rural Devon

54 Empty Homes Strategy 2012 - 2015 (Torridge District Council, December 2012 and North Devon Council, June 2013)

Policy ST17: A Balanced Local Housing Market**Housing Scale and Mix**

(1) The scale and mix of dwellings, in terms of dwelling numbers, type, size and tenure provided through development proposals should reflect identified local housing needs, subject to consideration of:

- (a) site character and context; and**
- (b) development viability.**

Specialist Housing Accommodation

(2) Within development boundaries, or the principal built form of defined settlements without settlement boundaries, proposals for specialist housing accommodation will be supported where they:

- (a) meet an identified local need;**
- (b) are proportionate in scale to the locality;**
- (c) are located so they are accessible to local facilities; and**
- (d) provide necessary ancillary facilities as part of the development, that complement locally available amenities and, where possible, be made available to the wider community.**

7.11 The scale and distribution of housing to be delivered in northern Devon between 2011 and 2031 is established through Policy ST08: Scale and Distribution of New Development in Northern Devon. Policy ST17: A Balanced Local Housing Market, seeks to ensure that residential development proposals delivering this housing do so in a way that contributes to the re-balancing of the housing stock to help it better reflect the identified needs and demands for housing of existing and future communities of northern Devon, whilst helping foster sustainable, inclusive and mixed communities that are attractive places to live. In doing so, the policy supports residential development proposals that deliver a mix of dwellings, in terms of size and type which respond to local circumstances. All residential development proposals should aim to positively contribute to a balanced housing sub-market.

Housing Mix

7.12 The housing mix to be provided by an individual development proposal should have regard to relevant up-to-date and robust evidence. The Strategic Housing Market Assessment provides a detailed assessment of the housing required to meet existing and future needs across northern Devon and also for individual housing sub-markets. Proposals should respond to other up-to-date and relevant local evidence where available, such as District or Urban Housing Needs Surveys, Local Housing Needs Surveys and comprehensive parish plans.

7.13 In deriving an appropriate housing mix, development proposals should respond to a broad range of matters and have regard to development viability. The policy recognises that the character and context of an individual development site may influence or constrain the types of residential development that are appropriate in individual circumstances.

7.14 Major residential developments (10 or more net new dwellings) should provide a balanced and proportionate mix of dwelling sizes and types to reflect the identified housing needs and demands for the locality, subject to consideration of site character and context and development viability.

Accessible and Adaptable Homes

7.14A Recognising that a number of elderly person households and those from other sectors of the community are likely to have a need for adaptable or accessible homes over the lifetime of the plan, as part of providing a mix of housing to meet local housing needs, residential development proposals will be encouraged to provide dwellings that are accessible or adaptable where a need for such provision is identified.

Specialist Housing Accommodation

7.15 The Local Plan will support the provision of specialist accommodation to meet the identified needs of all sectors of the community. Proposals for specialist accommodation such as sheltered housing, close or extra-care housing, will be supported where they meet an identified need for the type of accommodation being proposed. Proposals should ensure that they enable occupants appropriate access to relevant local services and facilities. Proposals should also provide necessary ancillary facilities as part of the development to meet the needs of the intended occupants, in a manner that compliments those services and facilities that are available locally. Where reasonable and practical to do so, facilities provided through proposals should be made available to the wider community.

7.16 Proposals for specialist accommodation should provide a mix of units that respond to identified needs for the particular section of the community that they seek to accommodate. They will not be expected to provide a balanced and proportionate mix of dwelling types and sizes that is applicable to accommodating the identified local needs for general needs housing of the wider population. Proposals should however still contribute to re-balancing the wider housing market and the provision of a balanced housing mix as part of any larger development.

7.17 The Use Class of development proposals for the provision of specialist accommodation will be determined upon the characteristics and restrictions of the proposed development. The application of policy provisions for the delivery of affordable housing and other policy requirements will be dependent upon this determination.

7.18 The Local Plan recognises that the provision of housing is only one element of creating sustainable communities. It seeks to ensure a balance between the provision of new housing and the services, facilities and infrastructure required to accommodate its residents whilst ensuring that appropriate employment opportunities are delivered for the new residents. Residential development proposals will be expected to contribute to the timely provision of physical, social and green infrastructure made necessary by the specific and/or cumulative impact of those developments in line with the requirements of Policy ST23: Infrastructure.

Self Build Housing

7.19 The Government is seeking to increase the supply of housing through self build schemes (including individually built properties, custom built developer schemes and the provision of self build housing through co-operatives and community land trusts). The Councils will support construction of self build schemes where they accord with the wider spatial strategy and will keep under review how to provide appropriate support for such development.

Live/Work Development

7.20 Live/work development will be considered as a form of residential development and will be afforded support where it accords with the relevant policies of the Local Plan.

Affordable Housing

7.21 There is a substantial need for additional affordable housing across northern Devon. The housing market in northern Devon is subject to a fundamental problem of affordability for a large proportion of the population. Open market housing is out of reach to many due to a significant imbalance between wages and house prices with evidence showing that residents have some of the lowest earnings in the UK⁽⁵⁵⁾ whilst house prices remain relatively high.

7.22 The issue has been exacerbated by northern Devon having a relatively small stock of affordable housing allied to a historically low level of affordable housing delivery. As such there is now an overwhelming need for additional affordable housing delivery. This is reflected by the two Councils who both identify affordable housing delivery as a strategic priority⁽⁵⁶⁾.

7.23 It is recognised that providing the scale of affordable housing provision required to meet identified needs over the plan period poses a significant challenge. The mix of affordable housing provided will be optimised and prioritised to respond to identified housing need at the time of the proposal. On occasion development proposals may not be able to deliver a scale of development to fully meet affordable housing needs; the policy therefore seeks to enable the mix of affordable housing to be prioritised to meet the most essential housing need. Development proposals should reflect on and respond to up-to-date evidence of local housing need. Appropriate evidence to support affordable housing proposals could be that presented through settlement housing needs surveys, comprehensive parish plans, community consultation or analysis of local authority needs data.

7.24 Consequently, it is essential that the Local Plan maximises the range of opportunities to deliver affordable homes to improve the balance of the housing market and meet the needs of communities. The Councils will work positively with partners such as government organisations, Registered Providers and Parish Councils along with communities to support initiatives that seek to secure the delivery of affordable housing. The Councils will also work positively with Parish Councils and other local community organisations to support the delivery of neighbourhood plans or neighbourhood development orders where these would positively support the provision of additional affordable housing to meet community needs.

7.25 The Local Plan supports a range of mechanisms that are intended to increase the availability and range of affordable housing including:

- (a) securing an appropriate mix of dwelling types, sizes and tenures;
- (b) securing an element of affordable housing on qualifying open market residential proposals; and
- (c) allowing affordable housing on sites that would not otherwise allow development.

Delivering Affordable Housing

7.26 National planning policy supports the approach of requiring an element of affordable housing as part of proposals that seek to deliver open market housing. However this is subject to the approach being flexible enough to respond to market conditions and allow development

⁵⁵ Annual Survey of Hours and Earnings (ONS, November 2012)

⁵⁶ Corporate Strategy 2012-2015 (Torridge District Council, 2012) and North Devon Council Corporate Plan 2011-2015

proposals to remain viable. To help support the formation of sustainable, mixed communities, it also advocates that where there is an identified need for affordable housing, local planning authorities set policies for the delivery of affordable housing on-site as part of development proposals unless there is a robust justification for doing otherwise.

Policy ST18: Affordable Housing on Development Sites

(1) Affordable housing provision will be required on residential development proposals on the following basis, with the thresholds for the provision of affordable housing applied unless changed in national policy or guidance:

(a) proposals for 11 or more dwellings, or for the provision of greater than 1,000 square metres (gross internal area) of residential floorspace irrespective of the number of dwellings, will be expected to provide on-site delivery of affordable housing equal to 30% of the number of dwellings (gross) on site; and

(b) in rural areas designated under section 157 of the Housing Act 1985, including the North Devon Coast Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty, proposals for 6 to 10 dwellings will be expected to provide a financial contribution of broadly equivalent value to providing on-site affordable housing equal to 30% of the number of dwellings (gross) on site.

(c) If the requirement for affordable housing thresholds is removed from national planning policy or guidance then clauses (1)(a) and (1)(b) above will no longer have effect and all residential development proposals that provide for a net gain in open market housing will be required to provide affordable housing equal to 30% of the number of dwellings (gross) on site.

(2) As part of residential development proposals, where vacant buildings are brought back into any lawful use, or are demolished to be replaced by new buildings, the affordable housing requirement for the proposal will be discounted by a proportion equivalent to the existing gross floorspace of the vacant buildings unless the requirement to do so is removed or moderated by a change in national policy or guidance.

(3) Where a fraction of an affordable dwelling is required by policy, such provision will be collected through a financial contribution of broadly equivalent value to that which would have been required on-site.

(4) Where the policy seeks on-site provision, alternative off-site delivery or provision through financial contributions of broadly equivalent value may be negotiated where it can be demonstrated that on-site provision is not possible or appropriate.

(5) Negotiation to vary the scale and nature of affordable housing provision, along with the balance of other infrastructure and planning requirements, will be considered on the basis of a robust appraisal of development viability.

(6) Where it is considered that a proposal is formulated with a view to circumventing affordable housing requirements, the affordable housing provision will be re-negotiated.

(7) Affordable housing will be sought initially on the basis of a tenure mix of 75% social rented and 25% intermediate accommodation, although variation may be negotiated on the basis of identified local housing need and/or development viability.

(8) Affordable housing provision should be provided broadly in-step with market housing as development delivery progresses, be visually indistinguishable from market housing

and be intermixed with it across the site. Any proposed departure from these requirements will need to be robustly justified.

(9) All affordable housing will be subject to arrangements to ensure that it or provision of broadly equivalent value remains available to eligible households in perpetuity.

(10) Affordable housing will be subject to planning conditions, obligations or other legally defensible limitations to:

(a) restrict occupation to households identified as being in need of affordable housing; and

(b) in designated rural areas, give priority of occupation to households with a local connection.

7.27 A contribution towards affordable housing delivery will be sought from all qualifying proposals for residential development. Reflecting national provisions, affordable housing requirements for residential development proposals are subject to a series of development thresholds beneath which affordable housing will not be sought. In line with national provisions, North Devon Council and Torridge District Council have exercised the option to implement a lower threshold of five dwellings or less, beneath which affordable housing should not be sought, in designated rural areas. No affordable housing provision will be sought from proposals for residential annexes, residential extensions and occupancy restricted accommodation such as tied rural workers dwellings or dwellings provided through Starter Homes Exception Sites.

7.28 Where the policy seeks on-site provision of affordable housing, alternative off-site provision may be negotiated where it can be demonstrated that on-site provision is not possible or not appropriate. In lieu of on-site provision, off-site provision, which must be agreed with the local planning authority, may comprise a combination of financial contributions, land with planning permission for housing and/or completed dwellings. In all cases, the scale and nature of provision will be of broadly equivalent value to that which would have been required on-site. Financial contributions towards the off-site delivery of affordable housing will be subject to a negotiated position based on a phased payment programme. Collection will however, generally be required on the basis of 50% prior to the occupation of 50% of the generating site's dwellings, with the balance subject to collection on substantial completion of the site. Further detail of the means by which affordable housing contributions will be collected and utilised will be set out in a Supplementary Planning Document.

7.29 In the first instance, endeavours will be made to use financial contributions for the delivery of affordable housing, secured from residential development proposals, to achieve affordable housing delivery within the parish where the proposal site was located. Where it can be demonstrated that there is not a reasonable prospect of delivery within that parish, the contributions may be used to deliver affordable housing within adjoining parishes, or within a relevant grouping of parishes formally recognised by the local planning authority (such as the Rural Alliance). Ultimately, the use of contributions to deliver affordable housing may cascade to the wider local planning authority area where it is demonstrated that there is not a reasonable prospect of delivery within the parish where the original proposal site was located or within adjoining parishes.

7.30 The starting point for the provision of affordable housing through Policy ST18: Affordable Housing on Development Sites is an expectation of delivery without grant subsidy. Any subsidy will be expected to provide a betterment of provision over and above the baseline provisions set out within the policy (such as delivery of additional affordable dwellings above the prescribed level or an improvement of tenure mix with an increased number of social rented units).

7.31 The affordable housing requirements established through Policy ST18 are considered to be robust and capable of being achieved in the majority of circumstances⁽⁵⁷⁾. It is however accepted that there may be occasions whereby circumstances conspire to mean that the delivery of affordable housing in line with the policy requirements may compromise development viability. The obligation will lie with the developer to provide a robust financial justification to support any proposals failing to meet identified policy requirements. The local planning authority will consider such requests on the basis of an open book financial appraisal of development viability. The Local Planning Authority will normally require the appraisal to be independently verified, with the developer liable for reasonable costs incurred to the local planning authority in doing so. Where it is demonstrated that scheme viability prohibits meeting the full policy requirements for the provision of affordable housing and/or other planning obligations, the local planning authority will enter into negotiations to vary the proportion and/or mix of affordable housing provision.

7.32 Where there is reason to believe that a proposal has been formulated with a view to circumventing affordable housing requirements, the Local Planning Authority reserves the right to renegotiate the affordable housing provision that should be delivered. In determining the potential dwelling capacity, the Local Planning Authority may have regard to a range of matters including site layout, forms and/or mix of development and the housing density that might be appropriate, reflecting on the context of the site and having regard to the need to make efficient use of land. Where a proposal site is subject to phasing, is sub-divided or where there is a reasonable prospect of adjoining land coming forward for residential development, the local planning authority may consider the site(s) taken as a whole for the purpose of determining the appropriate affordable housing provisions.

7.33 Reflecting evidence of identified tenure needs, priority will generally be given to the provision of affordable housing for rent⁽⁵⁸⁾ at a social rent. The starting point for negotiating affordable housing tenure mix is to seek 75% social rented and 25% intermediate accommodation. Variation to the tenure mix may be negotiated where evidence of local housing need and/or development viability indicate that an alternative mix is appropriate. The evidence will need to demonstrate that the proposal provides a more appropriate balance between specific local affordable housing needs and development viability at the time of the proposal.

7.34 The Local Plan seeks to ensure that affordable housing is available to local communities in the long term. As such, affordable housing will usually be subject to planning conditions or legal agreements that secure its affordability, or provision of broadly equivalent value, in perpetuity. With respect to intermediate housing for sale, where receipts are received from the sale of shares, there is an expectation that any subsidy will be recycled into further affordable housing provision in the locality of the existing provision.

7.35 The occupation of affordable housing will be restricted to households in need of affordable housing. Additionally, within designated rural areas, affordable housing will be subject to provisions that afford priority to households with a local connection. For the purpose of Policy ST18: Affordable Housing on Development Sites and Policy ST19: Affordable Housing on Exception Sites, a household with a local connection to the parish, adjoining rural parish(es), or other relevant grouping of parishes, as the case may be, is defined as those where:

(a) at least one adult in the household was resident continuously in the qualifying area for a minimum of five years immediately prior to occupation; or

(b) at least one adult of the household was resident in the qualifying area for five years within the previous ten years immediately prior to occupation; or

57 As evidenced through, Update of the Economic Viability Assessment of Housing Development in North Devon and Torridge (Adams Integra, November 2015)

58 Strategic Housing Market Assessment: North Devon and Torridge Update (Housing Vision, 2012) and Housing and Economic Needs Assessment: Torridge and North Devon Councils (GL Hearn, 2016)

(c) at least one parent, guardian, child or sibling of at least one adult in the household, has been resident in the qualifying area for a minimum of 5 years immediately prior to occupation; or

(d) at least one adult in the household has been in continuous employment for at least 16 hours a week in the qualifying area for at least five years immediately prior to occupation.

7.36 For the purpose of defining a household with a local connection, a rural parish is taken as one designated as a rural area under Section 157(1) of the Housing Act 1985. Affordable housing need is sometimes assessed across an area wider than the host parish of a proposal, such as adjoining rural parishes or a relevant grouping of parishes formally recognised by the local planning authority, such as the Rural Alliance. Where that cumulative affordable housing need is to be met by a proposal on one site, then the above local connection criteria for a household will relate equally to any parish from which that need has arisen. Such dwellings will be available to households with a local connection to any qualifying parish before being cascaded across a wider spatial area. Where no household with a local connection qualifies for occupancy under these criteria, the scope for occupation will cascade to households with a local connection to an adjoining parish, or to the relevant grouping of parishes formally recognised by the local planning authority, as the case may be. Ultimately, where no household qualifies for occupancy within these areas, the scope for occupation will cascade to the wider local planning authority area.

7.37 The affordable housing priorities along with detailed matters such as the methods of assessing financial contributions, the methodology for assessing viability and other interpretations of affordable housing policy will be set out in supporting documentation, such as a practice note or Supplementary Planning Document, that will accompany the Local Plan.

Affordable Housing on Exception Sites

7.38 Ensuring housing needs are addressed locally is an essential component in delivering a long-term future for communities across northern Devon. The Local Plan seeks to ensure that housing needs can be appropriately realised to support the creation of sustainable communities, providing housing in response to locally generated social needs. The Local Plan enables exceptional land release around defined settlements for the provision of sites for affordable housing in line with the requirements of Policy ST19: Affordable Housing on Exception Sites. Recognising that viability may inhibit delivery, the Local Plan supports the delivery of an element of market housing on such proposals where this would enable the provision of significant additional affordable housing.

Policy ST19: Affordable Housing on Exception Sites

Proposals to deliver permanent affordable housing at Local Centres, Villages and Rural Settlements will be supported, subject to the following:

(a) the site is well related to or adjoining the defined development boundary; or where the settlement is not subject to a development boundary, the site is well related to the extent of the contiguous built form;

(b) the development is proportionate to the scale and nature of the existing settlement;

(c) there is an identified local need for affordable housing sufficient to justify the extent and nature of the proposed development;

(d) the housing need could not reasonably be satisfied without the exceptional release of land;

(e) arrangements are in place to ensure that the affordable housing, remains available to the local community in perpetuity;

(f) where it can be robustly demonstrated that an element of market housing is required to enable delivery of significant additional affordable housing, it will be supported provided that:

(i) the element of market housing is the minimum amount required to enable the delivery of the proposed affordable housing; and

(ii) the mix of open market dwellings, in terms of type and size, complies with the requirements of Policy ST17;

(g) environmental and heritage assets are not subject to significant harm, are conserved or enhanced, with particular respect to the setting and special qualities of nationally important landscapes, biodiversity and heritage designations and the undeveloped coast; and

(h) the use of planning conditions, obligations or other legally defensible limitations to:

(i) restrict occupation to households identified as being in need of affordable housing; and

(ii) give priority of occupation to households with a local connection.

7.39 Proposals will need to be supported by evidence to satisfy the Local Planning Authority that there are no reasonable and available alternatives, such as development of an appropriate and available site or building within the extents of a Local Centre, Village or Rural Settlement or through the development of an appropriate and available allocation for residential development, that could reasonably deliver the housing required to meet the identified local need.

7.40 Proposals enabled through this policy need to be justified on the basis of an identified local need for affordable housing. Development proposals should reflect on, and respond to up-to-date evidence of local housing needs, such as that presented through Housing Needs Surveys. Development schemes will therefore need to be accompanied by evidence to demonstrate that a local need exists for the scale and nature of affordable housing that is proposed, in terms of the number of dwellings, their size, type and tenure. The policy will not support speculative housing proposals. Further details as to the nature and extent of evidence required to support proposals will be set out in supporting documentation, such as a practice note or Supplementary Planning Document that will accompany the Local Plan.

7.41 For the purpose of this policy, the geographical scope of local housing need is taken as that arising from households that have a local connection⁽⁵⁹⁾ to the parish where the proposal is located, the adjoining rural parish(es) and/or other relevant grouping of parishes formally recognised by the Local Planning Authority (such as the Rural Alliance), as the case may be.

7.42 The mix of housing in terms of dwelling sizes, types and tenures will be expected to reflect the identified local need for housing. The affordable housing provided will be subject to appropriate arrangements to ensure that it remains available to the local community in perpetuity. This will

⁵⁹ See paragraph 7.35 and 7.36 for definition of local connection

be achieved through the imposition of appropriate planning conditions or the provision of a legal agreement.

7.43 The policy allows for an element of market housing to be provided where this would enable the delivery of significant additional affordable housing. The Local Plan recognises this can be an effective mechanism to deliver affordable housing in rural areas. The starting point for delivery of affordable housing under this policy is an expectation of providing 100% affordable housing. Where this is not viable, the level of open market housing will be the minimum required to provide the necessary financial cross-subsidy to deliver the proposed affordable housing. Where cross subsidy through the provision of open market housing is proposed, the local planning authority will expect proposals to be supported by evidence to demonstrate that it is appropriate and necessary. This will normally be on the basis of an open book financial appraisal of development viability.

7.44 To ensure that proposals contribute to the delivery of a balanced local housing market and deliver housing suitable to meet the needs of the local community, any open market housing provided to support the delivery of the affordable housing will also need to deliver a mix of housing which reflects local housing needs and demands.

7.45 In all cases, permanent affordable housing supported by Policy ST19 will be subject to restrictions that limit occupation to households identified as being in need of affordable housing. Such restrictions will be achieved through planning conditions, planning obligations or other legally defensible mechanisms available to the local planning authority. Restrictions will also ensure that priority of occupation is given to households with a local connection (as defined in Paragraphs 7.35 and 7.36).

Policy ST19A: Starter Homes Exception Sites

Proposals to deliver Starter Homes in the Sub-Regional Centre, Strategic and Main Centres, Local Centres and Villages will be supported on qualifying Starter Homes Exception Sites, subject to the following:

- (a) the site is located within the defined development boundary or, where the settlement is not subject to a development boundary, the site falls within the settlement's contiguous built form;**
- (b) the site is demonstrably unsuited for its current or former use or cannot viably be used for its current or former purpose(s);**
- (c) the mix of dwelling types and sizes reflects the identified housing needs of new entrants to the local housing market;**
- (d) where it can be robustly demonstrated that a small proportion of market housing is required to enable delivery of the proposed Starter Homes, it will be supported provided that:**
 - (i) the element of market housing is the minimum amount required to enable the delivery of the significant majority of the site for Starter Homes; and**
 - (ii) the mix of open market dwellings in terms of type and size, complies with the requirements of Policy ST17; and**
- (e) the use of planning conditions, obligations or other legally defensible limitations to:**

- (i) restrict initial occupation to first time buyers who are below the age of 40 at the time of purchase;**
- (ii) ensure that the initial sales value of each Starter Home is subject to at least 20% discount from the open market value; and**
- (iii) ensure that any resale or letting of a Starter Home must reflect the discount from an open market value achieved at the initial point of sale for a period of 5 years following the initial sale.**

7.46 To extend the opportunity for young first time buyers to enter the housing market, development proposals on Starter Homes Exception Sites will be positively considered within settlements defined in Policy ST06: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Strategic and Main Centres and Policy ST07: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Rural Area.

7.47 The scope and nature of Starter Home Exception Sites is defined in the Glossary, which provides that such sites relate only to commercial and industrial land, or other previously developed land defined as Starter Homes Exception Sites by national planning policy or guidance. The site will be required to be either underused or unviable in its current or former use and not otherwise identified for housing. To support proposals for Starter Homes, evidence will need to be provided to demonstrate that the site no longer provides a realistic prospect for the continuation of its current use and, in respect of commercial or industrial land, the loss of the site would not harm economic growth prospects, or in respect of other qualifying sites, result in the loss of locally important community services and facilities. The reuse of sites which are purposely underutilised and therefore unviable in order to be considered suitable for Starter Homes will be resisted. The tests for accepting the release of land from economic use are set out in Policy DM13: Safeguarding Employment Land.

7.48 In line with national policy the initial occupation of a Starter Home will be restricted to first time buyers who are below the age of 40 at the time of purchase and who will occupy the home as their main dwelling. The homes will be required to be initially provided at a minimum of 20% below open market value, which should have a discounted price of no more than £250,000. The subsequent resale or letting of the Starter Home will be required to reflect a market discount of at least 20% until five years from the initial point of sale. Planning conditions and obligations will be used to protect the use of the Starter Home to the extent permitted by national policy. 'Open market value' will be determined in relation to properties of a similar type, size and location within the local housing market.

7.49 The housing provided by an individual development should reflect first time buyers' needs. The Councils will not expect to consider properties which materially exceed the minimum dimensions in the national space standards⁽⁶⁰⁾ for each dwelling by type as Starter Homes. The standards are considered to represent an appropriate size for homes specifically developed under the Starter Homes policy.

7.50 To enable the delivery of Starter Homes, Section 106 affordable housing contributions and tariff-based contributions, such as CIL to support general infrastructure will not be sought. Other S106 contribution required to mitigate the impact of development to make it acceptable in planning terms will be sought as necessary with regard to Policy ST23: Infrastructure.

7.51 The starting point for the provision of housing through Policy ST19A: Starter Homes Exception Sites, is that the proposed development will comprise 100% Starter Homes. Having

60 Technical housing standards – nationally described space standard (DCLG March 2015)

regard to the nature of exception sites and the required level of discount against market value, it is recognised that the delivery of some sites may need to be supported by cross-subsidy from market housing. Where the provision of 100% Starter Homes is not viable, a small proportion of open market housing may be considered acceptable; development proposals which include a significant element of open market housing will not be supported. Additionally, the level of open market housing will be the minimum required to provide the necessary cross subsidy to deliver a Starter Homes focused scheme. Where cross subsidy through the provision of open market housing is proposed the local planning authority will expect the proposal to be supported by evidence to demonstrate that it is appropriate and necessary. This will normally be on the basis of an open book financial appraisal of development viability to be submitted to the local planning authority for independent review at the applicant's expense.

Providing Homes for Travelling Communities

7.52 Northern Devon is home to a relatively small population of travellers. The area is home to a number of travellers who live on unauthorised sites who have expressed a desire for permanent accommodation. There are also a number of travellers who pass through the area choosing to stop for only a short period of time. Due to a current lack of transit accommodation, travellers have resorted to camping on unauthorised sites. It is recognised that accommodation on unauthorised encampments can lead to conflicts between the traveller and settled communities.

7.53 The accommodation requirements of traveller communities, who include travellers and travelling showpeople, need to be considered alongside the housing needs of the settled communities.

Policy ST20: Providing Homes for Traveller Communities

(1) Delivery will be pro-actively pursued to provide adequate and appropriate accommodation to meet the identified needs and demands of traveller communities in northern Devon whilst recognising their traditional and nomadic way of life and respecting the interests of the settled community.

(2) During the period 2011-2031, provision to meet identified needs in northern Devon will be made to deliver:

(a) at least 15 pitches for permanent traveller accommodation; and

(b) at least 2 transit sites or emergency stopping places each providing for the accommodation of 4 or 5 pitches.

(3) Where allocation offers the most appropriate mechanism for delivery, sites will be allocated through a Development Plan Document to provide an appropriate range of accommodation to meet the identified accommodation needs and demands of travellers across northern Devon.

(4) Proposals for traveller accommodation will be supported where they will meet an identified need whilst respecting the principles of sustainable development and having regard to the interests of the settled community.

(5) Existing authorised sites providing traveller accommodation will be safeguarded unless it is demonstrated that they are no longer required to meet identified need.

7.54 The strategy with regard to the provision of traveller accommodation is to positively seek the delivery of appropriate accommodation to meet the needs and demands of the traveller

communities in a way that recognises their traditional and nomadic way of life and respects the interests of the settled community.

7.55 The Gypsy and Traveller Accommodation Assessment (GTTA) ⁽⁶¹⁾ identifies a need for 15 pitches for permanent traveller accommodation within northern Devon over the period 2014/15-2034/35; with a need for six pitches arising from North Devon and nine from Torridge respectively. The Report identified that there is no identified need for accommodation for travelling showpeople within northern Devon over the plan period. Whilst the study period does not fully equate to the plan period it is considered appropriate to seek to accommodate the full identified need from the study period within the Local Plan, given that only a very limited element of need is identified as arising beyond 2031.

7.56 The Gypsy and Traveller Accommodation Assessment identifies the need for four or five transit sites or emergency stopping places, each providing for four or five pitches, within the Devon GTTA Partnership area to help reduce the number of unauthorised encampments. The report recommends that the transit sites or emergency stopping places are located close to one of the main arterial routes and in respect of transit sites, close to where a large proportion of unauthorised encampments have occurred, such as North Devon and Torridge. In recognition of the evidenced occurrence of need, two transit sites or emergency stopping places are planned to be provided with North Devon and Torridge, one within each local authority area. The sites will be identified by a Traveller Site Allocations Development Plan Document.

7.57 The Councils will facilitate the provision of appropriate sites to meet the needs and demands of travellers in northern Devon. It is the intention that, in line with national planning policy, the Local Plan will seek to allocate sites for the provision of traveller accommodation. Allocations will be provided where it is considered that doing so is the most appropriate mechanism to meet the specific identified needs and demands of the northern Devon traveller communities.

7.58 A separate Development Plan Document will allocate sites for traveller accommodation and ensure that a five year land supply is maintained. This will be subject to a separate targeted consultation.

7.59 The detailed approach that will be applied to the consideration of proposals for traveller accommodation, including allocations, is set out in Policy DM30: Sites for Traveller Accommodation. In addition to sites allocated for traveller accommodation, further proposals for traveller accommodation will be supported where they will meet an identified need for accommodation that cannot be met by another means and where they have regard to the principles of sustainable development and respect the interests of the settled community.

7.60 Recognising that there is a limited supply of traveller accommodation available within northern Devon, the Local Plan seeks to safeguard existing sites that offer traveller accommodation provision. Proposals that seek to redevelop authorised traveller accommodation will need to be supported by evidence that demonstrates that the accommodation is no longer required to meet an identified need.

Managing the Delivery of Housing

7.61 In planning for the future, the Local Plan has been prepared to deliver a scale of housing development in excess of that required to meet identified housing needs and demands for northern Devon's communities. In doing so, the Local Plan supports the delivery of a significant proportion of the housing requirement through the allocation of developable land for housing. The remaining proportion is provided through existing commitments, non-strategic housing sites and an allowance

61 Devon Partnership Gypsy and Traveller Accommodation Assessment (RRR Consultancy, 2014)

for windfall provision. A positive and proactive 'plan, monitor, manage' approach to the delivery of housing will be adopted.

Policy ST21: Managing the Delivery of Housing

The delivery of housing across northern Devon will be appraised through the annual local planning authority monitoring reports and the maintenance of an up-to-date and detailed housing trajectory.

(1) If monitoring identifies that the number of dwelling completions across northern Devon in a monitoring year is less than 110% of the annualised dwelling requirement for that year, then the Councils will:

(a) implement a review to identify and understand key issues that might be affecting housing delivery; and

(b) engage proactively with development interests and work in partnership to remove barriers and facilitate the increased delivery of new homes.

(2) If monitoring identifies that the number of dwelling completions across northern Devon in a monitoring year falls below 90% of the annualised dwelling requirement, and the housing trajectory for that year indicates that the rate would not recover to an average of at least 100% for the two subsequent monitoring years, then proposals for additional residential development outside of defined settlement limits will be supported where they are:

(a) in a location and of a scale and nature commensurate to the deficit in required housing;

(b) able to demonstrate the ability to contribute in a timely manner to addressing the deficit in housing supply;

(c) broadly consistent with, not prejudicial to and contributing towards the positive achievement of the plan's overall spatial vision and strategy for northern Devon, along with the relevant settlement vision and development strategy; and

(d) in all other respects in accordance with other Local Plan policies, in so far as they apply.

(3) If monitoring identifies that it is not possible to demonstrate a five year supply of deliverable land for northern Devon, and there is no recovery of identified supply indicated for the two subsequent monitoring years, then a full or partial review of the Local Plan will be implemented.

7.62 The Councils will take a positive approach to the delivery of housing development. In doing so, the Councils will seek to work with applicants in a positive way to shape proposals and enable high quality development that contributes towards achieving the objectives of this Local Plan. The Councils will engage in constructive pre-application discussions to ensure that potential issues are addressed early in the development process and all opportunities are taken to maximise the positive benefits of development. To help improve the quality of development and decision making, the Councils will promote and support the use of Planning Performance Agreements (PPAs) for major planning applications.

7.63 The Councils will monitor housing delivery performance annually, to ensure that the delivery of housing can be appraised robustly and transparently; being reported through authority monitoring reports together with any relevant actions taken. The relevant monitoring year is the twelve months from April to March the following year. The Housing Trajectory for North Devon and Torridge (see Appendix 2) indicates the projected delivery of housing growth across the plan period. The housing trajectory will be updated annually to take account of levels of completed housing and to have regard to up-to-date information on progress with delivery of commitments and the projected delivery of future housing allocations.

7.64 The annualised dwelling requirement is the average requirement for housing across northern Devon per year (861 dwellings) managed to reflect any cumulative backlog or surplus from previous provision earlier in the plan period. Where monitoring indicates delivery of less than 110% of this (managed) annualised dwelling requirement for the previous monitoring year, then this will trigger the Councils to engage proactively with development interests to identify and understand what is impacting adversely on housing delivery and how any barriers could be removed or mitigated, either for particular sites or for delivery as a whole. This early action is intended to ensure that future housing delivery improves before it impacts adversely on the projected housing trajectory.

7.65 Where monitoring indicates that housing delivery has fallen significantly below the annualised dwelling requirement for the previous monitoring year and there is no projected recovery indicated for the two subsequent monitoring years in the latest housing trajectory, the Councils will take further remedial action. If such circumstances are triggered, Policy ST21(2) sets out the location and scale of proposals for additional residential development outside of defined settlement limits that would be supported. It is expected that such sites will be developable or potentially developable Strategic Housing Land Availability Assessment sites and will normally adjoin development boundaries or the principal built form for defined settlements without development boundaries.

7.66 A full or partial review of the Local Plan will be undertaken if it is not possible to demonstrate a five year supply of deliverable housing land for northern Devon, and evidence indicates there is no likely recovery of identified supply indicated for the two subsequent monitoring years.



8 Strong and Inclusive Communities

8.1 The strategic objectives to support strong and inclusive communities are set out in chapter two of the Local Plan. The self-sufficiency of communities will be improved through growth that makes them more balanced and sustainable delivering accessible and proportionate infrastructure. The Local Plan will improve opportunities to access housing, jobs, high quality education, training and a wide range of services and community facilities, with opportunities to lead healthy lives. Inequalities experienced within the most deprived areas will be reduced and existing community services will be protected in locations that are accessible to all sections of the community including vulnerable and disadvantaged groups.

Community Services and Facilities

Policy ST22: Community Services and Facilities

(1) Development of new, or extensions or improvements to existing community facilities that meet the needs of local communities will be supported within or adjoining defined settlements and Rural Settlements where:

- (a) it does not harm the character of the area and the amenities of the surrounding uses;**
- (b) it is well related to public transport infrastructure, where possible, and is accessible by walking or cycling; and**
- (c) it can be accessed without generating unacceptable levels of traffic on the local road network and / or reducing highway safety.**

(2) In areas poorly served by public and community transport, support will be given to innovative schemes to secure local delivery of public services. Delivery of services through the use of mobile services and technology will be encouraged where service improvements result.

(3) Development that involves the loss of community services and facilities will not be supported unless there is compelling evidence to demonstrate:

- (a) the existing use is no longer commercially viable or could not be made commercially viable; or**
- (b) there is alternative local provision that is accessible to the local community by walking or cycling; and in either case**
- (c) the premises are no longer required to meet the needs of the local community.**

(4) Community initiatives to deliver services and facilities, identified through Parish Plans or equivalent documents, will be supported where they meet demonstrable social or economic needs and contribute to making local communities more sustainable.

Provision of new facilities and services

8.2 In providing for new housing development, it is necessary to ensure that there is an appropriate range and distribution of community facilities and services to meet residents' needs including schools. Additionally, such facilities must be provided at the right time and in the right places to support regeneration and growth and in accessible locations to minimise the need to

travel, facilitate social inclusion, increase self-containment and minimise environmental impact. Sites for new schools have been identified in the main towns where required.

8.3 Community services and facilities such as schools and other education provision, social services, adult education, libraries, community and youth services, healthcare, culture, places of worship, parish and village halls, police and emergency services, recreation and amenity space, allotments and community gardens, green infrastructure, sport, transport and public utilities contribute to the social and economic wellbeing of urban and rural communities. Their provision can assist in meeting the needs of the local community and reducing the need to travel.

8.4 It is essential that the planned growth of northern Devon is undertaken in an integrated manner and accordingly the Councils will work with service providers, to ensure improved services are appropriately scaled in respect of future needs and located to ensure maximum advantage in respect of accessibility.

8.5 The most appropriate location for the provision of community facilities is within or adjacent to a settlement where they are readily accessible by the populations they serve and the impact on the countryside is minimised. New services and facilities will be encouraged to be delivered on a multi-functional basis.

Retention of services and facilities

8.6 Many rural communities have experienced the loss of important local services such as shops, public houses and post offices and there are concerns that primary schools are at risk of closure as a consequence of falling pupil numbers. Support will be given to community-based initiatives that result in improvements to local services, delivery of facilities and that make those settlements more sustainable. To this end, neighbourhood plans and parish plans are viewed as important vehicles for the identification of community needs and provision of locally favoured solutions.

8.7 As demands change in response to an ageing population and increase in response to projected population growth, the need to secure the retention of existing community facilities and services is supported. The Councils will seek to at least maintain established service levels and resist the net loss or reduction in the quality, diversity and accessibility of existing community services and facilities. It is recognised that mobile and online services may help to provide local services. There are opportunities for local community groups to bid for registered assets of community value in accordance with the Councils' community right to bid policies facilitated by the Localism Act.

8.8 Where a proposal can demonstrate that the use is not viable (i.e. no longer capable of being kept open either commercially or through social enterprise), a change of use may be appropriate provided the new use does not conflict with other policies in the Local Plan. Before considering a re-use of the premises, the Councils will wish to be satisfied that other uses of benefit to the rural community such as alternative community or employment use are not viable.

8.9 To assess applications for the change of use or redevelopment of existing facilities, the Councils will require a thorough analysis of the existing operation of commercially operated facilities⁽⁶²⁾ and the attempts taken to secure the future and viability of the business. In all instances, all public and commercially operated facilities and services must demonstrate:

- (a) the need for alternative community facilities has been researched and that it can be evidenced there has been no, or insufficient, demand;

⁶² Commercially operated facilities are defined as: village shops, public houses, restaurants, post offices, petrol stations, car repair/sale garages, doctors/dental/veterinary surgeries, and other commercially owned and operated businesses/facilities offering rural based services to communities.

(b) opportunities to support the facility by the introduction of other services have been explored. The dual use of premises for a number of community functions may help support the viability of facilities which may be experiencing financial difficulties;

(c) efforts have been undertaken to secure the financial viability of the facility through applications for grant aid, business advice and discussions with community groups, Parish Councils, the Council, Devon County Council and other national or local bodies with a direct interest in rural service provision. These bodies can also help to identify the need for alternative community facilities; and

(d) the facility is not commercially viable. In order to determine if this is the case, the Council will require submission of trading accounts for the last three full years in which the facility was operating as a full-time business.

8.10 Commercially operated facilities must further demonstrate a comprehensive sustained marketing campaign ⁽⁶³⁾(to be agreed in advance by the Council) has been undertaken for its existing use, offering the facility for sale using an agreed realistic valuation of the premises for a period of at least 12 months before an application is submitted.

Delivering Infrastructure

Policy ST23: Infrastructure

(1) Developments will be expected to provide, or contribute towards the timely provision of physical, social and green infrastructure made necessary by the specific and/or cumulative impact of those developments.

(2) Where on-site infrastructure provision is either not feasible or not desirable, then off-site provision or developer contributions will be sought to secure delivery of the necessary infrastructure, through methods such as planning obligations or the Community Infrastructure Levy.

(3) Developments that increase the demand for off-site services and infrastructure will only be allowed where sufficient capacity exists or where the extra capacity can be provided, if necessary through developer-funded contributions.

8.11 Infrastructure covers a range of services and facilities, including community facilities, green infrastructure, digital communications and broadband that are provided by public and private bodies. There has been a growing concern that the provision and quality of infrastructure has not kept pace with development, particularly of housing, resulting in unacceptable pressures in some service areas and capacity limitations for economic growth.

8.12 The Local Plan, in supporting sustainable communities and increasing self-reliance, seeks to ensure that the necessary infrastructure is provided to address community needs. A key component of delivering a sustainable spatial strategy is to ensure the timely provision of infrastructure in order to maximise efficiencies, reduce demand and ensure there is sufficient investment to support existing and emerging needs.

8.13 The timely provision of infrastructure is essential, whether in the form of additional capacity or new infrastructure. There is a need to ensure a co-ordinated approach to infrastructure management and investment. Accordingly the Local Plan seeks to ensure the optimum use of

⁶³ The facility will be offered for sale locally and in the region, in appropriate publications and through specialised licensed trade agents, at a price agreed with the Council

existing infrastructure, to reduce demand by promoting behavioural change for example through water efficiency savings and travel demand management, and to seek new infrastructure where required.

8.14 It is recognised that ensuring the timely delivery of infrastructure, by requiring its provision in advance of the development, could impose an additional burden on the viability of that development. For this reason, its provision prior to development would only be required where essential. In other cases, alternative methods including legally binding phasing requirements, bonding arrangements and delivery agreements may be used to ensure that the identified infrastructure is delivered at the appropriate time.

8.15 North Devon and Torridge District Councils have produced an Infrastructure Delivery Plan to ensure infrastructure is delivered in step with development proposals. The Councils will continue to work in partnership with Devon County Council, other local authorities, agencies, health service providers, utility companies and other private sector infrastructure providers to identify expected needs and determine the most effective means of delivering necessary infrastructure and services at the appropriate time to serve existing and proposed development and support the local economy.

8.16 The starting point is the appreciation of existing infrastructure capacities, deficits and existing programmes of work or capacity reduction measures. The Councils will subsequently work with their partners in the preparation and implementation of the Infrastructure Delivery Plan. It will establish the scale, costs, and timing of the additional infrastructure required to ensure delivery of development required by Policies ST06: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Strategic and Main Centres and ST07: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Rural Area. The Infrastructure Delivery Plan, the Community Infrastructure Levy charging schedule and the accompanying Regulation 123 List, plus other adopted national and local guidance will complement the policies of this Local Plan to provide a more detailed framework for the provision of infrastructure.

8.17 In accommodating the planned level of housing growth, major new education infrastructure will be required and delivered alongside new development proposals to take account of the wider strategic policy objectives of the County Council for Children's Services. A cross-boundary approach is needed for secondary, further and higher education provision in particular. In all instances expansion and enhancement of existing educational capacity will be investigated in advance of new site provision.

8.18 A key principle is that new development should contribute towards the cost of additional infrastructure, the need for which arises from it. Where new capacity is needed, developers will be expected to provide, fund or contribute towards it. Contributions may be sought through the Community Infrastructure Charging Schedule or by undertaking or agreement under Section 106 of the Town and Country Planning Act. Provision of necessary infrastructure should be phased with new development to minimise any experience of deficiencies, whilst not unacceptably affecting the viability of overall levels of development. It is recognised that infrastructure obligations on development must not, when aggregated with the impact of other policies in this Plan, make development unviable. Provision of critical infrastructure will be prioritised. An appropriate balance needs to be struck between public and private finance sources for the delivery of necessary infrastructure.



NEIGHBOURHOOD PLANNING

9 Neighbourhood Planning

9.1 The Localism Act 2011 reformed the planning system to give people new rights to shape the development of the communities in which they live. A new type of community-led planning initiative known as a Neighbourhood Plan will set out policies on the development and use of land in a parish or 'neighbourhood area'. Once adopted, Neighbourhood Plans will become part of the planning policy, alongside this Local Plan, against which planning applications will be assessed.

9.2 Communities can use neighbourhood planning to influence the type, design and location of new development by shaping it rather than blocking the building of new homes and businesses. It can be prepared by a Parish Council or an approved Neighbourhood Forum and may propose more development but not less. Neighbourhood Plans must have regard to national planning policy and be in general conformity with strategic policies in Part One of this Local Plan.

9.3 The Localism Act introduced new rights and powers to allow local communities to shape new development by coming together to prepare neighbourhood plans. The Councils recognise that some communities wish to have a greater say in where development is located and the type of development built, and may wish for additional development to help deliver a new facility. Neighbourhood Plans provide a means to achieve this. Where Parish Councils have undertaken a Parish Plan, it can be used to inform preparation of a Neighbourhood Plan.

9.4 Neighbourhood planning can be taken forward by town and parish councils or by neighbourhood fora. Neighbourhood fora are community groups that are designated to take forward neighbourhood planning in areas without parishes. The role of the Local Planning Authority is to determine who should be the neighbourhood forum for the neighbourhood area; this will be determined in consultation with the local community.

9.5 Neighbourhood fora and parish councils can use new neighbourhood planning powers to establish general planning policies for the development and use of land in a neighbourhood. These are described legally as 'Neighbourhood Development Plans.' In an important change to the planning system communities can use neighbourhood planning to permit development without the need for planning applications. These are called 'Neighbourhood Development Orders.'

9.6 The Councils support and encourage town and parish councils and neighbourhood fora to produce Neighbourhood Plans for their parishes and/or neighbourhoods. Further guidance will be provided by the Councils to assist parishes and neighbourhood fora to prepare Neighbourhood Plans.



TOWN STRATEGIES



10 Town Strategies

Barnstaple

The Place

10.1 Barnstaple is one of the largest towns in Devon with a resident population of about 31,000, including the communities of Bickington, Roundswell, Pilton, Newport and Whiddon Valley which are situated within the town's development boundary. Barnstaple has expanded rapidly over recent years with approximately 4% growth over the period 2001 to 2010. The town functions as a Sub-regional Centre serving a large rural area of northern Devon, as well as parts of North Cornwall, West Devon, Exmoor and West Somerset. Barnstaple's prosperity underpins the economy of northern Devon and, together with Bideford, forms its administrative and commercial centre.

10.2 Barnstaple is the main focus for employment, shopping and leisure opportunities and provides a range of higher order services for commercial, cultural, health, education, recreation and social activities. Petroc provides the main opportunities for further and higher education within northern Devon. The town centre has a wide range of national retailers and independent traders serving the resident population and visitors, although a significant proportion of food shopping occurs outside the town centre.

10.3 The town is located at the eastern end of the Taw estuary, surrounded by prominent undeveloped ridgelines to the north, east and south. The Taw estuary is designated as a Site of Special Scientific Interest and forms part of the buffer zone within the Biosphere Reserve. The river corridor also forms the backbone for green infrastructure across the town. Approximately a quarter of the built up area within the town is at risk of flooding. Barnstaple is a historic market town with the core situated within a large conservation area covering about 30 hectares, which includes a large number of listed buildings and the Castle Mound, a Scheduled Ancient Monument. The town also has a number of smaller conservation areas outside the town centre covering Pilton, Newport, Rumsam, Bickington, Ebberley Lawn and Lake that also contain a number of listed buildings.

10.4 Barnstaple is about 14 kilometres (9 miles) east of Bideford accessed along the A39 and about 48 kilometres (30 miles) north-west of Tiverton with good access along the A361, leading to the M5. The Tarka rail line between Barnstaple and Exeter is the only link northern Devon has to the strategic rail network which experiences peak time congestion. The South West Coast Path, Tarka Trail and the Macmillan Way are long distance footpaths and cycleways that pass through the town.

10.5 A high proportion of Barnstaple's work force is involved with retail trade, business activities, public administration and health care sectors which reflect Barnstaple's role as a Sub-regional centre and the types of jobs provided within an administrative centre of higher order services and facilities. Parts of the town have enhanced levels of assistance offered by Assisted Area status, including Roundswell and Whiddon Valley Business Parks located to the south-west and south-east of the town respectively and provide a vibrant economic centre for employment growth. They offer a wide range of business and distribution uses serving northern Devon reflecting their good links to the A361/A39 and towards the M5.

10.6 Barnstaple's population has a relatively high dependency on state benefits for all age groups and average household incomes vary widely across the different wards of the town. Many of Barnstaple's community facilities are at or close to capacity including many of the town's schools and health facilities. The main playing pitches and sports facilities within Barnstaple are at Rock Park, Seven Brethren and a range of sports pitches off Mill Road. There is a shortage of equipped play areas and informal open space provision, especially on the western side of

town, although there is good access to the community woodland at Yeo Valley to the east of the town.

The Future

10.7 The strategy for Barnstaple is to be attractive to new business with a skilled and enthusiastic workforce. Training opportunities, especially at Petroc, will raise skill levels and provide a workforce to support diversification of the local economy into emerging growth sectors of the national economy. It will also enable young people to access higher qualifications locally and find local employment in higher paid jobs. Expansion of Roundswell and Whiddon Valley Business Parks will enhance the town as a vibrant economic centre, reflecting its good links to the A361 and A39. Delivery of superfast broadband will help to strengthen the local economy.

10.8 The economic strategy for Barnstaple is to deliver a range of serviced employment land to meet the town's current and future needs and to support and attract new employers, especially high skilled businesses. Extending the range of shopping, commercial and leisure facilities and opportunities within the town centre will also improve the local economy and strengthen the town's role as the Sub-regional Centre.

10.9 Sustainable growth will be delivered through mixed use developments incorporating a combination of new housing, business development and community facilities that meets the town's own needs as well as those across northern Devon. Barnstaple will continue to develop as a vibrant and attractive centre for jobs, shops, recreation, community and service facilities to support the needs of the town and surrounding communities of northern Devon and beyond. Town centre expansion will also help to deliver enhanced community facilities and services to address the social and economic needs of the town's existing and future residents and visitors. The role of Roundswell as a District Centre will be enhanced to meet the needs of the local community.

10.10 A range of housing types, tenures and sizes will be provided to meet the community's expanding and changing needs, including its ageing population. In addition to existing committed sites, urban extensions and a range of other new sites will be delivered to provide the levels of housing growth required to support the town's development as a vibrant and sustainable economic centre, supported by necessary physical, social and green infrastructure.

10.11 Strategic public open spaces will enhance the green infrastructure network either side of the Taw estuary, delivering more accessible natural greenspace and a net gain in biodiversity. The town will maximise the potential opportunities available with its location on the waterfront. New footpath and cycle links through the town will improve opportunities for sustainable travel, including access to schools and jobs.

The Spatial Vision and Development Strategy to 2031

Policy BAR: Barnstaple Spatial Vision and Development Strategy

The Spatial Vision

Strategic housing and employment growth on the southern side of Barnstaple will support the town's economy by attracting inward investment to deliver key infrastructure and strengthen the town's lead role as a vibrant and innovative Sub-regional Centre in commerce, culture, education and service provision for northern Devon.

Barnstaple will develop as an exemplar of sustainable living to become a healthier, safer and more prosperous town with an attractive and inclusive environment that

protects the town's historic character whilst capitalising on its built heritage. The town centre will be revitalised and expanded to promote a healthy and vibrant town centre to support its vitality, viability and economic prosperity, including a vibrant and diverse evening economy. Petroc will be expanded as a university level resource with links to local businesses to improve both skills level and business productivity with access to superfast broadband, workforce and business support and increased accessibility to training opportunities and expanded employment opportunities at Roundswell Business Park and Whiddon Valley.

Housing and employment growth will deliver a mix of high quality, sustainable family and affordable housing integrated with new employment opportunities and key community infrastructure that promote greater self-sufficiency. Improved access to and dual use of community facilities will provide for the needs of all. Development will also prioritise the re-use of existing buildings and previously developed land whilst safeguarding these areas from the risks of flooding and protecting the green hills around the town. An enhanced network of green infrastructure including new public open spaces, public footpaths and cycleway links to the Tarka Trail will permeate the town. Traffic management and accessible public transport initiatives will retain and extend bus services to surrounding communities, improve the rail service to Exeter and beyond and reduce need for short journeys by private car.

The historic town will capitalise on its built heritage, cultural assets, open spaces and wildlife habitats to promote healthier lifestyles, enhance its distinctive identity, maximise the potential of its waterfront and public spaces, retain and improve access to existing community facilities.

Effective co-operation with partners will deliver key services and facilities including through the community and voluntary sectors. The empowered community will make the most of its talents and leadership to deliver the vision, with all residents able to contribute to and participate in community life.

The Spatial Development Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable substantial growth of high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Barnstaple and its surrounding area and to strengthen Barnstaple's role as a Sub-regional Centre. The spatial vision for Barnstaple will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 4,139 dwellings, including affordable and extra care housing to meet the range of the communities housing needs, with associated development and infrastructure on a continuous basis during the Plan period between 2011 and 2031;
- (b) provision of new site allocations of approximately 3,165 dwellings and non-strategic housing sites of approximately 153 dwellings;
- (c) strategic extensions to the south and south-east of Barnstaple (as part of the provision of new site allocations) to accommodate approximately 1,770 new dwellings supported by required physical, social and green infrastructure including a new primary school on each site;
- (d) provision of approximately 21.6 hectares of land for economic development that promote entrepreneurship in the town and deliver suitable start-up space for

new businesses and grow-on space for existing businesses to relocate supported by required physical, social and green infrastructure;

(e) redevelopment of previously developed sites including those at risk of flooding where effective flood management can reduce the extent and severity of flood risks both on site and elsewhere in the Taw estuary;

(f) enhancement of existing flood defences and associated flood risk mitigation measures to help realise the potential for appropriate development of sites at risk of flooding;

(g) expansion of the town centre to enhance the town's vitality and viability and strengthen its role as a Sub-regional Centre for retail, commercial, community, leisure and cultural activities;

(h) expansion of Petroc as a university level resource with improved links to local businesses to improve both skill levels and business productivity within northern Devon;

(i) economic growth through capitalising on enhanced levels of assistance offered by the Assisted Area status;

(j) provision of accessible natural green spaces to enhance the green infrastructure network adjoining the Taw estuary to deliver a net gain in biodiversity and provide betterment in addressing flood risks by reducing rates of surface water runoff;

(k) provision of additional strategic footpaths and cycle routes through and around the town to extend the green infrastructure network and improve opportunities for sustainable modes of travel and healthy living;

(l) protection of the green hilltops around the town that contribute to Barnstaple's setting and character and retention of the open land between the town and surrounding villages to help maintain their separate identities;

(m) provision of additional sport and recreation facilities, including opportunities for water sports along the Taw estuary;

(n) improvements to capacity at existing road junctions along the A39 and A361;

(o) social and community facilities required to support new development including enhanced primary and secondary provision through delivery of new schools and the expansion of existing schools and improved early years and youth provision within Barnstaple;

(p) provision of additional water storage areas within development sites to the east and west of the River Taw compared to normal sustainable drainage system design in recognition that the southern half of Barnstaple is within a Critical Drainage Area; and

(q) support for initiatives to improve and mitigate against any adverse harm to water quality in the rivers and estuary.

10.12 The total housing requirement for Barnstaple over the period 2011 to 2031 is for a minimum of 4,139 dwellings. As the largest settlement, Barnstaple has the largest housing requirement which will be delivered through a mixture of development completed since April

2011, existing commitments, identified housing allocations and non-strategic housing sites as set out in Table 10.1 'Barnstaple Housing Provision 2011-2031'.

Table 10.1 Barnstaple Housing Provision 2011-2031

Housing Land Supply 2011-2031	Number of Dwellings
Allocations⁽¹⁾ :	3,162
Non-strategic Housing Sites⁽²⁾ :	153
Other Sites Contributing to Supply :	848
Dwelling Completions (2011 to 31st March 2017) :	375
Planning Commitments ⁽³⁾ :	473
Total Supply for Barnstaple	4,163

(1) Including planning commitments and completions on allocated sites (as of 31st March 2017). (2) See Appendix 5. (3) including extant planning permissions (with small non-started permissions subject to 15% non-implementation discount), resolution to grant planning permission subject to signing of s106 agreement, permissions that have been implemented and dwellings under construction (as of 31st March 2017).

10.13 The requirement for employment land within Barnstaple over the period 2011 to 2031 is for approximately 21.6 hectares of additional land for economic development. This will be supplemented by reuse, redevelopment and intensification of existing employment sites, especially at Pottington and the Two Rivers Business Parks which have a degraded appearance and require environmental enhancement and intensification where opportunities exist. Proposals that enhance businesses, promote entrepreneurship and create additional job opportunities or improve the attractiveness of the area will be supported.

10.14 The overall requirement for employment land will be delivered through intensification of existing employment sites, provision of serviced employment land as part of mixed use allocations and extension to existing employment land as set out in Table 10.2 'Employment/Economic Development Land Supply for Barnstaple 2011-2031'.

Table 10.2 Employment/Economic Development Land Supply for Barnstaple 2011-2031

Employment/Economic Development Land Supply for Barnstaple 2011-2031	Hectares of Employment/Economic Development Land Proposed
Westacott Urban Extension (BAR01)	5.0
Adjoining Petroc (BAR02)	1.5
Mount Sandford Green (BAR04)	2.8
Glenwood Farm, Roundswell (BAR09)	0.8
Fishleigh Road, Roundswell (BAR10)	4.0
Brannam Crescent, Roundswell (BAR10)	1.4
South of A39, Roundswell (BAR10)	6.1
Total Supply for Barnstaple	21.6

The Development Proposals

10.15 A range of proposals are enabled through the Local Plan to support the delivery of the spatial vision for the town. The spatial extent of proposals are depicted on Policies Map 1 and

each is subject to a specific Local Plan policy, included below, which sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with any site specific development principles.

The Vision for the Westacott Strategic Extension:

A strategic extension on the south-eastern edge of Barnstaple will contribute to the town's economic growth and future prosperity. It will deliver a new community and gateway to the town with a distinctive sense of place and quality of life, incorporating a network of green infrastructure that enhances and connects existing biodiversity assets across the site and enhances ecosystem services. The development will be of high quality and sustainable design through its construction and future occupation, facilitating reductions in carbon emissions as well as delivering new opportunities for sustainable travel within and around Barnstaple. A neighbourhood hub will provide a focus for the new community, incorporating primary education and community facilities complementing facilities available elsewhere in the town.

Policy BAR01: Westacott Strategic Extension

(1) Land at Westacott, (about 80 hectares) as identified on Policies Map 1, is allocated for a comprehensive, sustainable, high quality, mixed use development that includes:

- (a) approximately 950 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs;**
- (b) approximately 5 hectares of land for economic development;**
- (c) a neighbourhood hub to include an additional 420 place primary school including early years and youth provision for the town, community hall, formal and informal open space and recreation and sports facilities;**
- (d) a new park and change facility close to the A361 junction to facilitate opportunities to use public transport links between Landkey and Barnstaple; and**
- (e) provision within the site for physical infrastructure, community facilities, and green infrastructure required by the development.**

(2) This strategic extension will be developed in a comprehensive manner to deliver the following site specific development principles:

- (a) create a distinctive, safe, sustainable, high quality urban extension and new neighbourhood for Barnstaple;**
- (b) establish a new gateway into Barnstaple and create an appropriate boundary between the development and the adjoining countryside;**
- (c) provide new business and employment opportunities with good access to the A361;**
- (d) safeguard the historic setting of the listed buildings at Acland Barton, Westacott House and Thornfield Barn;**
- (e) provide a neighbourhood hub that forms a focus to meet the community's needs and offers complementary services and facilities rather than replacing those available elsewhere in the town centre;**

(f) enhance and make connections to the existing network of local and strategic green infrastructure through and around the site, including the protection and enhancement of Acland Wood county wildlife site and provision of new footpaths, cycleways, public open spaces, wildlife corridors and sport and recreation facilities;

(g) provide a mix of house types, tenures and sizes of open market and affordable homes contributing towards the identified local needs; and

(h) provide a sustainable water strategy that reduces water usage, manages surface water runoff through water storage and sustainable drainage systems in combination with tree planting to reduce the risk of flooding along the Coney Gut and elsewhere in Barnstaple.

(3) The transport and connectivity strategy for this strategic site will:

(a) provide improvements at the Landkey junction on the A361 to deliver the primary vehicular access to all parts of the development and provide a new vehicular link between the development and Westacott Road;

(b) provide a new park and change facility close to the Landkey junction and improve public transport links between Landkey, Whiddon Valley and the town centre; and

(c) establish a permeable and connected network of footpaths and cycleways across the site that facilitates connections for pedestrians and cyclists between the proposed development, Landkey and Whiddon Valley and the Tarka Trail, to improve opportunities for sustainable travel choices within and around Barnstaple to reduce reliance on the private motor car.

10.16 Development of a strategic extension to the east of the town will be developed in a comprehensive manner. In addition to about 950 dwellings comprising a mix of house types including a proportion of affordable housing in accordance with Policy ST18: Affordable Housing on Development Sites, development of the site will provide approximately 5 hectares of land for economic development, a new neighbourhood hub to address the needs of the town including a new 420 place primary school, additional early years and youth provision, and additional sport and leisure facilities. A new 210 place primary school will be delivered within the neighbourhood hub during the early phases of construction with land for its future expansion. The land for economic development should be delivered as serviced employment land in the early phases of the development within a high quality business park.

10.17 The principal vehicular access to the site will be through an improvement to the existing Landkey junction on the A361, which will provide an active and attractive gateway to the development and the town. A main road through the development should provide vehicular access to the northern parts of the site. Land adjacent to the A361 should be safeguarded for any future improvements in accordance with Policy ST10: Transport Strategy. The Council considers the new junction should be in the form of a roundabout although alternative solutions may be considered acceptable where highway safety and the operational effectiveness of the strategic road network can be clearly demonstrated. A new road through the site will link to Westacott Road, which will provide improved links between Whiddon Valley and the North Devon Link Road (A361), helping to alleviate congestion at the Rose Lane (Tesco) roundabout. At least one of the alternative routes shown on Policies Map 1 will be delivered. The new road should be well designed and sympathetic to the surrounding area with appropriate landscaping and planting to help screen the new route from surrounding residential properties and contribute toward the green infrastructure network. If the secondary access is delivered through the existing industrial units on Castle Park

Road, then the development will be required to relocate the current occupier (or future successor) within the area of land proposed for economic development together with the provision of additional car parking to serve the remaining units on the existing industrial estate as part of a comprehensive traffic management plan. It will also facilitate a new route for buses between Landkey and Whiddon Valley, without them having to retrace their route, as well as provision of a park and change facility close to the A361 junction to provide use of enhanced public transport links into Barnstaple town centre. The siting and design of the park and change facility must not prejudice an active and attractive gateway to the site and town. A permeable network of streets, footpaths and cycleways through the development will improve connectivity for pedestrians and cyclists to the existing rights of way network. It will contribute to an enhanced cross-town cycle route across Barnstaple and a footpath around the eastern side of Barnstaple connecting Westacott with the hospital (Policy BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links).

10.18 As a new gateway to the town, the development should be designed to complement its landscape setting and provide a transitional boundary between the development and adjacent countryside that reflects the local landscape character. The existing planting along the southern boundary should be retained and enhanced to screen the development from the A361 as well as contributing to the green infrastructure network including the protection and enhancement of Acland Wood County Wildlife Site. Public open space and sports and recreation facilities should be located towards the eastern end of the development, apart from any new play area to replace that lost by the new road link through to Westacott Road. If a replacement play area is needed then it should be provided as close as possible to the existing play area to serve the residents of Whiddon Valley and be delivered prior to the loss of the existing park if required to provide the new road link.

10.19 Provision of ecosystem services across the site should be enhanced by extending woodland coverage adjoining Coney Gut and reducing rates of surface water runoff. The site is within a critical drainage area because land on this side of town is at risk of flooding. Development of the Westacott strategic extension will be required to incorporate a comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme that reduces the rate of surface water runoff entering the Coney Gut and does not increase flood risk in Newport in accordance with Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience. The sustainable drainage scheme should incorporate water storage areas across the site, which can be integrated with the provision of new green infrastructure creating linkages with existing biodiversity networks in the area.

10.20 The setting of historic assets at Acland Barton, Westacott House and Thornfield Barn will be protected under Policy ST15: Conserving Heritage Assets.

The Vision for the Larkbear Strategic Extension:

A strategic extension on the southern side of Barnstaple will contribute to the town's economic growth and future prosperity by attracting inward investment and facilitating opportunities for enhanced training and economic innovation. The development will deliver a new community with a distinctive sense of place and quality of life, incorporating a network of green infrastructure that enhances and connects existing biodiversity assets across the site. The development will be of high quality and sustainable design through its construction and future occupation, facilitating reductions in carbon emissions as well as delivering new opportunities for sustainable travel within and around Barnstaple. A neighbourhood hub will provide a focus for the new community, incorporating primary education, healthcare and community facilities complementing facilities available elsewhere in the town.

Policy BAR02: Larkbear Strategic Extension

(1) Land at Larkbear, (about 31 hectares) as identified on Policies Map 1, is allocated for a comprehensive, sustainable, high quality, mixed use development that includes:

- (a) approximately 820 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs;**
- (b) approximately 1.5 hectare of land adjoining Petroc for innovation and incubation units;**
- (c) a neighbourhood hub to include an additional 420 place primary school and medical centre;**
- (d) formal and informal open space and recreation facilities; and**
- (e) provision within the site for physical infrastructure, community facilities, and green infrastructure required by the development.**

(2) This strategic extension will be developed in a comprehensive manner to deliver the following site specific development principles:

- (a) create a distinctive, safe, sustainable, high quality urban extension and new neighbourhood for Barnstaple;**
- (b) safeguard the historic character and setting of Lake;**
- (c) provide a neighbourhood hub that forms a focus to meet the community's needs, and provides complementary services and facilities rather than replacing those available elsewhere in the town;**
- (d) provide a new vehicular access to the boundary of Petroc and facilitate its growth as a university level resource;**
- (e) provide new business and employment opportunities that relate directly to Petroc to facilitate growth of higher value sectors of the northern Devon economy;**
- (f) enhance and make connections to the existing network of local and strategic green infrastructure through and around the site including the provision of new footpaths, cycleways, public open spaces, wildlife corridors and recreation facilities;**
- (g) provide a mix of house types, tenures and sizes of open market and affordable homes contributing towards the identified local needs; and**
- (h) provide a sustainable water strategy that reduces water usage, manages surface water runoff through water storage and sustainable drainage systems to reduce the risk of flooding around Lake and elsewhere in Barnstaple.**

(3) The transport and connectivity strategy for this strategic extension will:

- (a) provide a new junction on the A361 to deliver the primary vehicular access to the development and a new main vehicular access to Petroc and the adjoining innovation and incubation units;**
- (b) improve public transport links between Roundswell, Seven Brethren and the Town Centre;**

(c) establish a permeable and connected network of footpaths and cycleways across the site that facilitate connections for pedestrians and cyclists between the proposed development, Roundswell, Seven Brethren, the town centre and the Tarka Trail, to improve opportunities for sustainable travel choices within and around Barnstaple to reduce reliance on the private motor car; and

(d) provide a foot and cycle bridge over the A361 and railway line to deliver safer pedestrian access to Seven Brethren and towards Park School.

10.21 Development of a strategic urban extension to the south of the town will be developed in a comprehensive manner. In addition to approximately 820 dwellings comprising a mix of house types including a proportion of affordable housing in accordance with Policy ST17: Affordable Housing on Development Sites, development will also provide approximately 1.5 hectares of land adjoining Petroc for innovation and incubation units. A neighbourhood hub will deliver a new 420 place primary school including a 52 place nursery provision and children's centre, a new medical centre and formal and informal open space and recreation facilities. A new 210 place primary school will be delivered within the neighbourhood hub during the early phases of construction with sufficient land safeguarded for its future expansion.

10.22 The expansion and redevelopment of Petroc is key to raising qualifications, training opportunities and career aspirations for northern Devon (Policy BAR17: Petroc). A new vehicular access to the Sticklepath campus will facilitate redevelopment opportunities and its growth as a university level resource. The provision of innovation and incubation units to the east of Petroc will facilitate new business, research and development opportunities in partnership with Petroc, that are also close to Barnstaple railway station and the town centre. Pedestrian and cycle links to the Brannams campus of Petroc at Roundswell will be enhanced by improved infrastructure linkages through the development.

10.23 The development will be accessed by a new junction on the A361 as part of the first phase of construction which will facilitate the delivery of a new vehicular access to Petroc. The new access will help to reduce traffic congestion at the Sticklepath roundabout and reduce on-street parking in residential streets to the west of Petroc. A secondary vehicular access from Old Torrington Road will facilitate a new route through the site between Roundswell and the town centre. The bus priority gate on Gratton Way will be moved onto Old Torrington Road.

10.24 A new foot and cycle bridge over the A361 and railway line will deliver safer pedestrian access to Seven Brethren and towards Park School, as well as facilitating improved access from these areas towards Petroc. These links will contribute towards an enhanced cross-town cycle route across Barnstaple (Policy BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links). A permeable network of streets, footpaths and cycleways through the development will improve connectivity to the existing rights of way network and to services and facilities at Roundswell, Seven Brethren and the town centre. There will be no vehicular links between the development and Elizabeth Drive/Philip Avenue, although new pedestrian and cycle links will provide access to facilities and services in the new neighbourhood hub from the adjoining residential areas.

10.25 The development should be designed to complement its landscape setting and provide a transitional boundary between the development and adjacent countryside that reflects the local landscape character. The existing hedgerows throughout the development should be retained and enhanced, especially along the eastern boundary, to enhance the green infrastructure network. The existing trees within Larkbear Plantation should be retained, although public access through the woodland is supported, including a pedestrian link between the site and proposed housing off Old Torrington Road (Policy BAR02a: Old Torrington Road, Roundswell). The setting of Lake village and conservation area will be protected.

10.26 The area around Larkbear is within a critical drainage area where it has been identified that land on this side of town is at risk of flooding. Development of the Larkbear urban extension will be required to incorporate a comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme that reduces the rate of surface water runoff and does not increase flood risk in Lake or elsewhere in Barnstaple in accordance with Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience. A comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme should be integrated within the provision of green infrastructure that will be required to incorporate additional water storage areas to be created that should permeate throughout the site, creating linkages with existing biodiversity networks in the area.

Policy BAR02a: Old Torrington Road, Roundswell

(1) Land east of Old Torrington Road, (about 6 hectares) as identified on Policies Map 1, is allocated for a sustainable, high quality development that includes:

- (a) approximately 138 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs; and**
- (b) provision within the site for physical infrastructure, community facilities, and green infrastructure required by the development.**

(2) The site will be developed to deliver the following site specific development principles:

- (a) provide a mix of house types, tenures and sizes of open market and affordable homes contributing towards the identified local needs;**
- (b) provide a sustainable water strategy that reduces water usage, manages surface water runoff through water storage and sustainable drainage systems to reduce the risk of flooding elsewhere in Barnstaple; and**
- (c) safeguard an area of woodland on the boundary immediately east of the Crematorium for the future extension of the existing memorial garden.**

(3) The transport and connectivity strategy for the site will:

- (a) provide vehicular access from Old Torrington Road; and**
- (b) provide a footpath and cycle link between the development site and Larkbear strategic extension (BAR02) through the Larkbear Plantation.**

10.27 Land east of Old Torrington Road is well related to existing employment and retail opportunities at Roundswell and could deliver approximately 138 dwellings, including a proportion of affordable housing. Vehicular access should be from Old Torrington Road with a new footpath and cycle link provided between the development and Larkbear (BAR02: Larkbear Strategic Extension) to facilitate connection towards the cross-town cycle route (BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links). Structural planting along the southern boundary will help to separate the development from the A39 contributing toward and extending the local green infrastructure network.

10.28 The site is within a critical drainage area where it has been identified that land on this side of town is at risk of flooding. Development will be required to incorporate a comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme that reduces the rate of surface water runoff entering the Muddlebrook, reduces flood risk in Lake and elsewhere in Barnstaple in accordance with Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience, as well as water storage areas

being integrated within the provision of green infrastructure, creating linkages with existing biodiversity networks in the area.

10.29 The North Devon Crematorium is situated on the northern boundary. An area of woodland on the boundary of approximately 0.4 hectares immediately east of the existing Crematorium will be required for its future expansion to meet the future needs of northern Devon over the plan period. This land will be safeguarded from development for other purposes.

Policy BAR03: Tews Lane, Roundswell

(1) Land west of Tews Lane, (about 10 hectares) as identified on Policies Map 1, is allocated for a sustainable, high quality development that includes:

(a) approximately 350 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs; and

(b) provision within the site for physical infrastructure, community facilities, and green infrastructure required by the development.

(2) The site will be developed to deliver the following site specific development principles:

(a) create a distinctive, safe, sustainable, high quality urban extension and new neighbourhood for Barnstaple;

(b) enhance and make connections to the existing network of local and strategic green infrastructure through and around the site, including a green buffer along the northern boundary and provision of this stretch of the cross-town cycle route;

(c) provide a mix of house types, tenures and sizes of open market and affordable homes contributing towards the identified local needs;

(d) avoid or mitigate any impact on the adjacent county wildlife site and Site of Special Scientific Interest; and

(e) provide a sustainable water strategy that reduces water usage, manages surface water runoff through water storage areas and sustainable drainage systems to reduce the risk of flooding along Muddlebrook and elsewhere in Barnstaple.

(3) The transport and connectivity strategy for the site will:

(a) facilitate delivery of a future road link through the site between Old Bideford Road and Bickington Road; and

(b) improve public transport and cycle links between Bickington, Roundswell and the Town Centre.

10.30 Development to the west of Tews Lane, both north and south of the playing fields, will deliver approximately 350 dwellings comprising a mix of house types, tenures and sizes towards meeting identified local needs, including a proportion of affordable housing.

10.31 Part of the site includes clay reserves at Fremington Claypits, safeguarded through the Devon Minerals Local Plan. Any development on this land must be in accordance with adopted policies within that document (or successor documents) to prevent undesirable sterilisation of clay deposits. Fremington Claypits geological Site of Special Scientific Interest and Higher Gorse Claypits County Wildlife Site are situated to the west of the southern part of the site. The

development must enhance or avoid any adverse impact on the biodiversity and geodiversity value of these designations, and existing hedgerows alongside Tews Lane should be retained and enhanced.

10.32 The site is within a critical drainage area where it has been identified that land in this part of town is at risk of flooding. Development will be required to incorporate a comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme that reduces the rate of surface water runoff entering the Muddlebrook and does not increase flood risk in Bickington or elsewhere in Barnstaple in accordance with Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience. The comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme should be integrated within the provision of green infrastructure to incorporate additional water storage areas that create linkages with existing biodiversity networks in the area. The northern edge of the site is at risk of flooding and enhanced green infrastructure provision along this boundary will protect the amenities of properties to the north, as well as facilitating provision towards a cross-town cycle route across Barnstaple (Policy BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links).

10.33 Vehicular access to the site will be off Tews Lane, served by a new vehicular link from the A39 delivered through Glenwood Farm (Policy BAR09: Glenwood Farm, Roundswell). This new junction will deliver a western entrance to Roundswell which, together with an improved roundabout at Roundswell (Policy BAR10: Roundswell Business Park), will help to reduce congestion along the A39.

Policy BAR04: Mount Sandford Green

(1) Land at Mount Sandford Green, (about 9.5 hectares) as identified on Policies Map 1, is allocated for a sustainable, high quality, mixed use development that includes:

- (a) approximately 175 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs;**
- (b) approximately 2.8 hectares of land for economic development at the northern part of the site; and**
- (c) provision within the site for physical infrastructure, community facilities, and green infrastructure required by the development.**

(2) The site will be developed to deliver the following site specific development principles:

- (a) create a distinctive, safe, sustainable, high quality urban extension and new neighbourhood for Barnstaple;**
- (b) provide new business opportunities with good access to the A361;**
- (c) enhance and make connections to the existing network of local and strategic green infrastructure through and around the site, including provision of new or improved grade separated pedestrian and cycle links across the A361;**
- (d) provide a mix of house types, tenures and sizes of open market and affordable homes contributing towards the identified local needs;**
- (e) provide a sustainable water strategy that reduces water usage, manages surface water runoff through water storage and sustainable drainage systems to reduce the risk of flooding along the Coney Gut and elsewhere in Barnstaple; and**
- (f) safeguard the historic setting of the listed buildings at Whiddon.**

(3) The transport and connectivity strategy for the site will:

(a) provide a new junction on the A361 to deliver the primary vehicular access to the development with a secondary vehicular access to the development from Landkey Road; and

(b) facilitate connections for pedestrians and cyclists between the proposed development and Fairacre Avenue to improve opportunities for sustainable travel choices within and around Barnstaple to reduce reliance on the private motor car.

10.34 A sustainable, mixed use development to the south-east of the town, adjacent to the A361 will deliver approximately 175 dwellings, including a proportion of affordable housing and approximately 2.8 hectares of land for economic development. The employment land will be located towards the north of the site with a new vehicular access from the A361 serving the business uses and the majority of the housing. The principal vehicular access to the site off the A361 will provide an active and attractive gateway to the development. A secondary access from Landkey Road will serve the remainder of the development, providing opportunities for a new bus route and an alternative emergency vehicular access. The development will need to contribute to improvements of the existing Landkey junction on the A361, in combination with strategic extension at Westacott (Policy BAR01: Westacott Strategic Extension), as part of any transport assessment.

10.35 The site's connectivity to existing services and facilities north-west of the site will be enhanced by provision of new or improved pedestrian and cycle links across the A361, together with a permeable network of streets, footpaths and cycleways through the development to enhance green infrastructure links.

10.36 The area around Westacott and Mount Sandford Green is within a critical drainage area where it has been identified that land on this side of town is at risk of flooding. Development of Mount Sandford Green will be required to incorporate a comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme that reduces the rate of surface water runoff entering the Coney Gut and reduces flood risk in Newport and elsewhere in Barnstaple in accordance with Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience. The comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme should be integrated within the provision of green infrastructure that will be required to incorporate additional water storage areas permeating throughout the site, creating linkages with existing biodiversity networks in the area. The development should be designed to complement the local landscape character, with a transitional boundary between the development and adjacent local green space (Policy BAR19: Local Green Spaces).

10.37 The setting of listed buildings at Whiddon will be protected under Policy ST15: Conserving Heritage Assets.

Policy BAR05: Westaway Plain, Pilton

(1) Land adjoining Westaway Plain, (about 6.5 hectares) as identified on Policies Map 1, is allocated for high quality residential development that includes:

(a) approximately 130 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs; and

(b) provision within the site for physical infrastructure, community facilities, and green infrastructure required by the development.

(2) The site will be developed to deliver the following site specific development principles:

(a) provide a mix of house types, tenures and sizes of open market and affordable homes contributing towards the identified local needs;

(b) retain and enhance existing hedgerows and provide strategic green infrastructure on the northern part of the site as identified on Policies Map 1;

(c) retain and enhance Shearford Lane as a key feature of the green infrastructure network, and retain existing hedgerow boundaries;

(d) safeguard the historic setting of the listed buildings at Westaway and Westaway Cottage; and

(e) provide a sustainable water strategy that reduces water usage, manages surface water runoff through water storage and sustainable drainage systems to avoid increasing the risk of flooding along Bradiford Water and elsewhere in Barnstaple.

(3) The transport and connectivity strategy for the site will provide:

(a) separate vehicular accesses to Westaway Plain from land either side of Shearford Lane, without any vehicular link through Shearford Lane; and

(b) an alternative vehicular route through the site to link Westaway Plain to Northfield Lane.

10.38 Residential development to the north of Westaway Plain is allocated to deliver approximately 130 dwellings, including a proportion of affordable housing. The two parcels of land can be developed separately with either site delivered first, but each site must provide the required proportion of affordable homes. Development to the west of Shearford Lane is proposed on the upper slopes of the valley of Bradiford Water where a new vehicular route provided through the site to link Westaway Plain to Northfield Lane would bypass the existing single-width stretch of Northfield Lane and its sub-standard access into Westaway Plain. Vehicular access will not be permitted on to Lynbro Road. Development to the east of Shearford Lane will need to protect the historic setting of the listed buildings at Westaway and Westaway Cottage.

10.39 The County Wildlife Site along Shearford Lane is an important component of the local biodiversity network and must be retained and enhanced without being breached to link the allocated sites on either side. Strategic green infrastructure along the northern part of the site will provide a sustainable drainage scheme that does not increase the rate of surface water runoff entering Bradiford Water to avoid increasing flood risk in Bradiford, as well as enhancing the local biodiversity network and providing a transitional boundary between the development and the adjoining countryside. External street lighting will need to be designed to minimise light pollution on Shearford Lane and Bradiford Scarp County Wildlife Site.

10.40 The development will put pressure on the junction of Westaway Plain and the A39 (North Road) close to North Devon District Hospital. It will also put further pressure on the primary and secondary schools in Pilton. Contributions will be required towards improving the capacity of this junction and enhancing education infrastructure in the locality.

Policy BAR06: South of North Devon District Hospital

(1) Land south of North Devon District Hospital, (about 4.5 hectares) as identified on Policies Map 1, is allocated for high quality residential development that includes:

(a) approximately 105 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs; and

(b) provision within the site for physical infrastructure, community facilities, and green infrastructure required by the development.

(2) The site will be developed to deliver the following site specific development principles:

(a) provide a mix of house types, tenures and sizes of open market and affordable homes contributing towards the identified local needs; and

(b) provide a sustainable water strategy that reduces water usage, manages surface water runoff through water storage and sustainable drainage systems in combination with tree planting to reduce the risk of flooding along Old Mill Leat, River Yeo and elsewhere in Barnstaple.

(3) The transport and connectivity strategy for the site will provide:

(a) vehicular access from a new junction on North Road; and

(b) a footpath across the site linking to the existing footpath along the western boundary.

10.41 Residential development to the south of North Devon District Hospital is identified to deliver approximately 105 dwellings, including a proportion of affordable housing. The main vehicular access will be from a new junction on the A39 (North Road) in the north-west corner of the site. There can be no vehicular or pedestrian access to Lower Raleigh Road or Pitt Lane which is a private road, although pedestrian links will be required across the site to connect to the existing footpath to the west of the development.

10.42 The development will be required to provide a green buffer alongside the leat incorporating a sustainable drainage scheme that reduces the rate of surface water runoff along Old Mill Leat and the River Yeo to avoid increasing flood risk elsewhere in the town, especially for existing properties to the south of the site. The sustainable drainage scheme should be integrated within the provision of green infrastructure to enhance existing biodiversity networks in the area. The hedgerows along the southern and eastern boundaries should be retained and enhanced to provide a transitional boundary between the development and the adjoining countryside.

Policy BAR07: North Lane, Bickington

(1) Land west of North Lane in Bickington, (about 5 hectares) as identified on Policies Map 1, is allocated for high quality residential development that includes:

(a) approximately 65 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs;

(b) private car parking for existing dwellings along Union Terrace; and

(c) provision within the site for physical infrastructure, community facilities, and green infrastructure required by the development, including a new village green.

(2) The site will be developed to deliver the following site specific development principles:

(a) provide a mix of house types, tenures and sizes of open market and affordable homes contributing towards the identified local needs;

(b) provide a sustainable water strategy that reduces water usage, manages surface water runoff through water storage and sustainable drainage systems to reduce the risk of flooding along Muddlebrook and elsewhere in Barnstaple;

(c) reinstate and enhance hedgerows along the northern boundary; and

(d) conserve the historic character, appearance and setting of Bickington Conservation Area and the setting of listed buildings off North Lane.

(3) The transport and connectivity strategy for the site will:

(a) provide vehicular access from North Lane, with improvements to the junction at Bickington Road; and

(b) facilitate connections for pedestrians and cyclists between Bickington and the Tarka Trail to improve opportunities for sustainable travel choices within and around Barnstaple.

10.43 Land north of Bickington Road and west of North Lane is identified to deliver approximately 65 dwellings, including a proportion of affordable housing, as well as a new village green and private parking north of Union Terrace to facilitate a reduction in on-street parking along Bickington Road. The vehicular access will be from North Lane in the south-east corner of the site, with improvements to the junction of North Lane and Bickington Road. A safe and convenient route for pedestrians will be provided between the development and Bickington Road. Opportunities to link the development to the Tarka Trail and green infrastructure and biodiversity enhancements south of the Tarka Trail will also be supported, in accordance with Policies BAR19: Local Green Spaces and BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links.

10.44 The eastern part of the site including the site access is within Bickington Conservation Area and adjacent to listed buildings in North Lane. The development should conserve and enhance the area's heritage assets in accordance with Policy ST15: Conserving Heritage Assets. The ridge to the north of this site is an important landscape feature defining the southern edge of the valley enclosing the Taw estuary. Development will be restricted to the southern side of this ridge and should not intrude above the skyline when viewed across the estuary from the north.

10.45 The site is within a critical drainage area where it has been identified that land on this side of town is at risk of flooding. Development will be required to provide a sustainable water strategy that reduces water usage, manages surface water runoff through water storage and sustainable drainage systems that reduces the rate of surface water runoff entering the Muddlebrook and reduces flood risk elsewhere in Barnstaple in accordance with Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience. A comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme should be integrated within the provision of green infrastructure that will be required to incorporate additional water storage areas to be created that should permeate throughout the site, creating linkages with existing biodiversity networks in the area. Reinstatement and enhancement of existing hedgerows is required along the northern site boundary to contribute to and extend the local green infrastructure network.

Policy BAR08: Former School Site, Roundswell

(1) Land east of Roundswell Community Centre, (about 3 hectares) as identified on Policies Map 1, is allocated for high quality residential development that includes:

(a) approximately a 50-bed unit of self-contained extra care housing, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs; and

(b) provision within the site for physical infrastructure, community facilities, and green infrastructure required by the development.

(2) Development will provide a sustainable water strategy that reduces water usage, manages surface water runoff through water storage and sustainable drainage systems to reduce the risk of flooding along Muddlebrook and elsewhere in Barnstaple.

(3) The transport and connectivity strategy for the site will:

(a) provide vehicular access from Old Bideford Road; and

(b) provide a footpath and cycle link between Old Bideford Road and Old Torrington Road to contribute towards delivery of the cross-town cycle route.

(4) The development will not be commenced until an alternative primary school within the Roundswell / Bickington area has been started.

10.46 Land east of Sainsburys and Roundswell community centre has been safeguarded for many years to provide a new primary school to serve Roundswell, although it has not yet been delivered. A new 420 place primary school is proposed as part of the Larkbear urban extension (Policy BAR02: Larkbear Strategic Extension) and the proposal west of Tews Lane (BAR03: Tews Lane, Roundswell). Either of these sites could accommodate future educational needs in this area of town. Once a new primary school has been started elsewhere within the locality, the site at Roundswell will no longer be required for a new primary school.

10.47 The site is well related to existing employment and retail opportunities at Roundswell and could deliver some housing in addition to a 50-bed self-contained extra care housing scheme including a proportion of affordable units that will contribute towards creating a mixed and balanced community in accordance with Policy ST17: A Balanced Local Housing Market. The principal vehicular access should be from Old Bideford Road, although a secondary access could be provided off Old Torrington Road as long as it would not create a vehicular link through the site. A new footpath and cycleway will be provided between Old Bideford Road and Old Torrington Road to extend the green infrastructure network through Roundswell and contribute to the provision of a cross-town cycle route across Barnstaple (Policy BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links).

10.48 The site is within a critical drainage area where it has been identified that land on this side of town is at risk of flooding. Development will be required to incorporate a comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme that reduces the rate of surface water runoff entering Muddlebrook and reduces flood risk elsewhere in Barnstaple and Fremington in accordance with Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience. A comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme should be integrated within the provision of green infrastructure that will be required to incorporate additional water storage areas to be created that should permeate throughout the site, creating linkages with existing biodiversity networks in the area.

10.49 Structural planting along the southern boundary will help to separate the dwellings from the adjoining business units along Gratton Way. Enhancement of existing hedgerows is required along the northern site boundary to contribute to and extend the local green infrastructure network.

Policy BAR09: Glenwood Farm, Roundswell

(1) Land west of Roundswell Business Park, (approximately 11 hectares) as identified on Policies Map 1, is allocated for a sustainable, high quality, residential development that includes:

- (a) approximately 210 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs;**
- (b) provision within the site for physical infrastructure, community facilities, and green infrastructure required by the development; and**
- (c) approximately 0.8 hectares for economic development.**

(2) The site will be developed to deliver the following site specific development principles:

- (a) provide new serviced employment land that facilitates economic growth;**
- (b) provide a mix of house types, tenures and sizes of open market and affordable homes contributing towards the identified local needs;**
- (c) retain existing hedgerows and enhance planting along the eastern and southern boundaries;**
- (d) establish a new western gateway into Barnstaple; and**
- (e) provide a sustainable water strategy that reduces water usage, manages surface water runoff through water storage and sustainable drainage systems in combination with tree planting to reduce the risk of flooding along Muddlebrook and elsewhere in Barnstaple.**

(3) The transport and connectivity strategy for the site will provide a road link through the site between the A39 and Old Bideford Road.

10.50 Land west of Roundswell Business Park will provide approximately 210 dwellings, including a proportion of affordable housing. A new vehicular access will be provided from the A39 linking through to Old Bideford Road, which will facilitate access to the western side of Roundswell and future development west of Tews Lane (Policy BAR03: Tews Lane, Roundswell), thereby helping to relieve congestion at the Roundswell roundabout on the A39. A small amount of employment development, approximately 0.8 hectares is proposed on the eastern edge immediately adjacent to Brynsworthy Lane with housing across the remainder of the site either side of the new road link. The new road through the site should be well designed with appropriate landscaping to contribute towards the green infrastructure network. Enhancement of the hedgerow along the southern boundary (A39) will safeguard residential amenities. Where opportunities exist, the Local Plan will encourage the necessary infrastructure to support a district heating network to serve the proposed development at Glenwood Farm, Roundswell.

10.51 The existing hedgerow along Brynsworthy Lane will be retained and enhanced, although a vehicular link through to Brannam Crescent on Roundswell Business Park will be supported to serve the proposed employment uses. Fremington Claypits geological Site of Special Scientific Interest and Higher Gorse Claypits County Wildlife Site are situated to the north of Old Bideford Road. The development must avoid or mitigate any adverse impact on the biodiversity value of these designations, enhance the green infrastructure network and deliver a net gain in biodiversity (Policy ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets). A new gateway to the town will be designed to

complement its landscape setting and provide a transitional boundary between the development and adjoining countryside that reflects the local landscape character.

10.52 The site is within a critical drainage area where it has been identified that land on this side of town is at risk of flooding. Development will be required to incorporate a comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme that reduces the rate of surface water runoff entering Muddlebrook and reduces flood risk elsewhere in Barnstaple in accordance with Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience. A comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme should be integrated within the provision of green infrastructure that will be required to incorporate additional water storage areas that create linkages with existing biodiversity networks in the area.

Policy BAR10: Roundswell Business Park

(1) Approximately 5.4 hectares of land is allocated for economic development in the following locations within and adjoining Roundswell Business Park, as identified on Policies Map 1:

- (a) 4 hectares south of Fishleigh Road; and**
- (b) 1.4 hectares north of Brannam Crescent.**

(2) Approximately 6.9 hectares (gross) of land south of the A39 is identified for a high quality business campus, including approximately 0.8 hectares for a park and change facility, as shown on Policies Map 1, including the following site specific development principles:

- (a) vehicular access to the B3232 towards Torrington; and**
- (b) strategic structural landscaping along the A39 and the B3232 boundaries.**

10.53 Roundswell Business Park is a strategic employment site with good accessibility to the strategic road network and opportunities to improve accessibility from the public transport networks (Policy BAR02: Larkbear Strategic Extension) and by a cross-town cycle route (Policy BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links). A total of approximately 5.4 hectares of employment land is proposed at Roundswell north of the A39 as an intensification of the existing business park on land south of Fishleigh Road and north of Brannam Crescent. Where opportunities exist, the Plan will encourage the necessary infrastructure to support a district heating network to serve the existing and proposed development in the Roundswell area. The sites north of the A39 are to be delivered in the early phases of the Plan period. A vehicular access will be supported from Brannam Crescent to Brynsworthy Lane as part of the Glenwood Farm development (Policy BAR09: Glenwood Farm, Roundswell).

10.54 Land to the south of the A39 and west of the B3232 is identified for a business campus including offices, research and development, high technology uses and a park and change facility. A total of approximately 6.1 hectares of land is proposed for economic development with an additional 0.8 hectares for the park and change facility, with development confined to the lower slopes. Proposals for retailing and other identified town centre uses should be considered against Policy DM20: Development Outside Town and District Centres. The A39 provides a visual limit to Barnstaple so any development to the south will be required to deliver a high quality, sustainable, landscaped campus incorporating enhancements to the green infrastructure network. Vehicular access will be from the B3232 towards Torrington. Development must safeguard the opportunity for the provision of a future pedestrian footbridge over the A39 towards Roundswell Business Park to the north. Enhanced hedgerows and green infrastructure along the relevant boundaries will protect the amenities of existing residential properties along this road and establish a new

landscaped gateway into Barnstaple from the A39. The development should be designed to complement its landscape setting and provide a transitional boundary between the development and adjacent countryside that reflects the local landscape character. Green infrastructure should be provided on site to meet the needs of future employees working from here.

10.55 Development at Roundswell Business Park, within the Ward of Bickington and Roundswell, will capitalise on enhanced levels of assistance offered by Assisted Area status. If the site south of the A39 were to be developed out during the early part of the Plan period and the local economy were to dictate the need for additional land for economic uses at Roundswell, an extension would be supported including appropriate structural landscaping along the northern boundary subject to other policies within the Local Plan. Any additional land should be accessed through the existing land proposed under BAR10: Roundswell Business Park (south of the A39) and should reserve land for a continuous route west through the site to make provision for a future link to the new roundabout on the A39 serving (BAR09: Glenwood Farm, Roundswell).

10.56 The site is within a critical drainage area where it has been identified that land on this side of town is at risk of flooding. Development will be required to incorporate a comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme that reduces the rate of surface water runoff entering Muddlebrook does not increase flood risk elsewhere in Barnstaple in accordance with Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience. A comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme should be integrated with green infrastructure provision to incorporate additional water storage areas that create linkages with existing biodiversity networks in the area.

Policy BAR11: Queen Street / Bear Street

Land between Queen Street and Bear Street, of approximately 4 hectares as shown on Policies Map 1, is identified for the expansion and enhancement of the town centre to deliver a sustainable, high quality, mixed use development that includes:

- (a) a mix of retail and other town centre uses that support the vitality and viability of the town centre;**
- (b) safe and accessible pedestrian linkages through the site between Boutport Street, Queen Street and Bear Street, including improved connectivity with existing shopping frontages on the High Street, Boutport Street and with Barnstaple Bus Station;**
- (c) provision of a short-stay car park, together with secure cycle parking, adequate service provision and traffic management measures; and**
- (d) enhancement of the area's built heritage including the special character and appearance of the Barnstaple Town Centre and Ebberly Lawn Conservation Areas.**

10.57 Land between Queen Street, Bear Street, Boutport Street and Alexandra Road provides the principal opportunity for new retail and other town centre uses that support the vitality and viability of the town centre. The site will provide a substantial proportion of the retail floorspace requirements for North Devon District over the plan period as identified in the 2012 Retail and Leisure Study⁽⁶⁴⁾. The site is located within the town centre and currently provides a large area of public car parking and the Royal Mail delivery office.

10.58 Whilst the Councils propose redevelopment of this site in a comprehensive manner, a phased approach to development would be supported to facilitate its delivery towards a

64 Joint Retail and Leisure Study for North Devon and Torridge Districts (Peter Brett Associates LLP, September 2012)

comprehensive master plan and in recognition of the need to relocate the Royal Mail delivery office to a suitable location elsewhere in Barnstaple. The site shown on Policies Map 1 includes properties along the Bear Street, Boutport Street and Queen Street frontages to facilitate pedestrian linkages into the site, although the existing buildings along these road frontages will be retained wherever feasible. Improved pedestrian linkages between the development and the High Street along Butchers Row will be established to support enhanced connectivity and continuity between the two areas.

10.59 Development may include residential development above the ground floor level in the form of flats, particularly along the frontage of Alexandra Road. Any redevelopment scheme will also incorporate short-stay car parking provision in accordance with the latest Traffic and Parking Strategy for Barnstaple. The design concept for a comprehensive redevelopment of the site will include hard and soft landscaping, sustainable design and construction principles (Policy ST05: Sustainable Construction and Buildings), provision of public art as part of a high quality design and measures to reduce opportunities for crime and disorder (Policy ST04: Improving the Quality of Development). Part of the site is within Barnstaple Town Centre Conservation Area and is visible from Ebberly Lawn Conservation Area on the opposite side of Alexandra Road, where the character and appearance of the area's built heritage will be conserved and enhanced.

Town Centre

10.60 Provision of additional retailing and services within the town centre will be supported to meet the future needs of the town where they enhance the vitality and viability of the town centre. The town centre core area and primary shopping frontage are identified on Policies Map 1. The primary frontage is focused along the High Street, Greens Lanes and Butchers Row, where Policy DM19: Town and District Centres, will seek to retain its attractiveness to shoppers.

10.61 Within the defined town centre but outside the primary shopping frontage, a wider range of uses may be permitted at ground floor level providing there is no harm to the vitality and viability of the town centre (Policy DM19: Town and District Centres). Residential and commercial uses will be supported on upper floors to enhance the vitality and viability of the town centre.

Policy BAR12: Anchorwood Bank

(1) Land at Anchorwood Bank, (approximately 10 hectares) as shown on Policies Map 1, is identified for a comprehensive, sustainable, high quality, mixed use development that includes:

- (a) approximately 172 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs;**
- (b) approximately 6,000 square metres net retail floorspace and additional leisure, tourism, commercial and community facilities;**
- (c) new pedestrian and cycle links along the river frontage between the Tarka Trail and the Longbridge and enhanced pedestrian and cycle links over the River Taw; and**
- (d) provision within the site for physical infrastructure, community facilities, and green infrastructure required by the development.**

(2) The site will be developed to deliver the following site specific development principles:

- (a) retention and conversion of the Oliver buildings;**

- (b) adequate flood alleviation measures to manage and mitigate risks from flooding;**
- (c) vehicular access to the A3125; and**
- (d) balancing ponds to control surface water runoff and prevent increasing the risks of flooding elsewhere in Barnstaple.**

10.62 Land to the south of the River Taw between the Longbridge and A361 (downstream bridge) is a large, previously developed site in need of redevelopment and regeneration. The site provides an opportunity for town centre uses including retail, commercial, tourism and leisure development that cannot be located within Barnstaple Town Centre, as well as approximately 172 new dwellings including a proportion of affordable housing. The site is identified for approximately 6,000 square metres (net) retail floorspace as well as community and leisure facilities to meet the town's future needs over the plan period and to strengthen Barnstaple's role as a Sub-regional shopping centre.

10.63 Redevelopment of this prominent, previously developed, site will deliver regeneration and sustainability benefits that require flood risk management, including the raising of ground levels, to reduce the extent and severity of flood risks both on site and elsewhere in the Taw Estuary in accordance with Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience. Land to the west of the A361 will provide balancing ponds to control rates of surface water runoff from the site. These areas will be managed as wetland areas to contribute to the wider biodiversity network within the town and deliver a net gain in biodiversity.

10.64 The Oliver buildings provide an important townscape feature along the river frontage and will be retained and converted for residential, community, tourism or commercial uses. They will contribute to an attractive architectural statement at the entrance to the site to reflect Barnstaple's maritime heritage. Development across the rest of the site should be no higher than the ridgeline of the Oliver buildings. The roofscape of the development will be prominent when seen from the A361 and downstream bridge as well as the hills around the town and should reflect locally distinctive styles and materials (Policy ST04: Improving the Quality of Development and DM07: Historic Environment). The character and appearance of the conservation area and setting of the historic assets of the Longbridge and Old Slaughterhouse (Halfords) will be protected under Policy ST15: Conserving Heritage Assets.

10.65 The site is outside the town centre and is currently connected to the town centre over the Grade I listed Longbridge. A new pedestrian and cycle route along the River Taw frontage linking the Longbridge and the Tarka Trail will be required. Also, a new pedestrian and cycle bridge over the River Taw, will enhance connectivity to and from the town centre (Policy BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links). The design of the new pedestrian and cycle bridge over the River Taw must protect and enhance the historic setting of the conservation area and listed buildings along The Strand. Any waterfront development, including any flood risk alleviation measures, will protect and enhance biodiversity value of the Taw-Torridge estuary Site of Special Scientific Interest and Anchorwood Bank County Wildlife Site.

Policy BAR13: Seven Brethren

(1) Land at Seven Brethren, as shown on Policies Map 1, is identified for regeneration and environmental enhancement to deliver new economic development, recreation and leisure uses, including enhanced pedestrian and cycle links along the river frontage between the Longbridge and the iron bridge.

(2) Improvements to the highway network and transport interchange facilities at Barnstaple railway station and surrounding area will enhance this gateway to the town and facilitate a more attractive and accessible approach for pedestrians and cyclists towards the town centre.

(3) Land north of the civic amenity recycling centre, as shown on Policies Map 1, is identified to facilitate provision of new footpath/cycle bridges over the A361 and railway line.

10.66 Land at Seven Brethren includes Barnstaple railway station, a civic amenity recycling centre and a range of employment, retail and leisure uses, including North Devon leisure centre and Tarka tennis centre. This area is identified for environmental enhancement and regeneration to deliver further economic, recreation and leisure development that cannot be located within Barnstaple town centre. Where no sequentially preferable site is available in the town centre, additional comparison floorspace will be acceptable but should be directed towards the Station Road area. Seven Brethren is at risk of flooding so any redevelopment supported by regeneration and sustainability benefits will need to demonstrate how flood risk management measures reduce the extent and severity of flooding. The character and appearance of the adjacent conservation area and setting of the historic assets of Longbridge and Old Slaughterhouse (Halfords) will be protected under Policy ST15: Conserving Heritage Assets.

10.67 The configuration of car parking, dropping off and picking up points for buses, coaches and taxis around Barnstaple railway station as well as vehicular traffic movements in the surrounding area causes conflict between users. Improvements to the configuration of transport interchange facilities and surrounding highway network will provide a safer approach to and from the station, as well as a more attractive and accessible gateway to the town. To improve Seven Brethren's role as an important transport hub and interchange, opportunities will be explored for a freight depot in close proximity to the existing train station. Redesign around the station will also facilitate a safer and more attractive approach towards the town centre for pedestrians and cyclists.

10.68 New footpath and cycle bridges over the A361 and railway line will be delivered as part of the Larkbear strategic extension (Policy BAR02: Larkbear Strategic Extension) and will provide safer pedestrian access from Seven Brethren towards Petroc and Roundswell. It will also facilitate improved access between Larkbear and the iron bridge towards Park School. Improved pedestrian and cycle links along the River Taw frontage through Seven Brethren will contribute towards enhanced connectivity between the town centre, Rock Park and the proposed cross-town cycle route across Barnstaple (Policy BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links). Such a link could include an underpass at the western end of the Longbridge where feasible and viable.

Policy BAR14: Evans Transport, Two Rivers Industrial Estate

(1) Land at Two Rivers Industrial Estate, (approximately 5 hectares) as shown on Policies Map 1, is identified for redevelopment and environmental enhancement to deliver new employment and leisure uses where:

- (a) a detailed flood risk assessment does not raise public safety issues;**
- (b) a high quality design including a landmark building enhancing this key gateway to the town;**
- (c) green infrastructure and biodiversity networks are enhanced along the western boundary; and**

(d) vehicular access is from Braunton Road, which provides a link through to a new park and change facility.

(2) Land east of the A361, (approximately 1.5 hectares) as shown on Policies Map 1, is identified for a park and change facility that includes:

(a) vehicular access from Braunton Road;

(b) potential for a future road link towards the former Gliddon and Squires site; and

(c) good pedestrian and cycle links to the Tarka Trail.

10.69 Land to the south of Braunton Road is an established but underutilised employment area that is prominent from both Braunton Road and the A361 (downstream bridge) at a key junction within the town. The site is at risk of flooding where only less vulnerable uses will be appropriate, including employment, commercial and leisure uses. A wider range of uses may be acceptable on this site after flood defence improvements have been delivered. Opportunities to develop the site in combination with enhanced sport, recreation and leisure facilities between Braunton Road and the Tarka Trail (Policy BAR15: Land South of Braunton Road) are supported. Redevelopment of this previously developed site will deliver regeneration and sustainability benefits that require flood risk management in order to reduce the extent and severity of flood risks both on site and elsewhere in the Taw estuary, in accordance with Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience.

10.70 Any redevelopment will be of a high quality incorporating a landmark building that is designed to reflect its prominent location at a key gateway to the town. The red brick old bakery building on Two Rivers Industrial Estate is a locally important building that should be retained. The wetland habitat along the western boundary will be retained and enhanced as part of the green infrastructure network.

10.71 Vehicular access to this site will be from Braunton Road, which will facilitate and be designed to accommodate traffic generation to a park and change facility further south. The park and change facility will serve existing and new sports facilities (Policy BAR15: Land South of Braunton Road), as well as providing access to the Tarka Trail and a flat walk towards the town centre. Development of the park and change facility will be required to avoid increasing the rate of surface water runoff in order to avoid increasing flood risk elsewhere in Barnstaple.

Policy BAR15: Land South of Braunton Road

Land between Braunton Road and the Tarka Trail, as shown on Policies Map 1, is identified for new or enhanced sport, recreation and leisure facilities where:

(a) a detailed flood risk assessment does not raise public safety issues;

(b) there is good connectivity to the Tarka Trail for pedestrians and cyclists; and

(c) the highway network can accommodate the anticipated levels of traffic generation.

10.72 Land between Braunton Road, Mill Road, the River Taw and the A361 (downstream bridge) provides a cluster of sports pitches and facilities including Barnstaple rugby and football clubs and a local bowling green. The area is well connected to the Tarka Trail but is at risk of

flooding where only water compatible uses would be appropriate. A wider range of uses may be acceptable on this site after flood defence improvements have been delivered. Proposals for new or enhanced sports facilities in this area, including opportunities for water sports fronting the rivers Taw and Ye, would be acceptable to strengthen its role as a sports hub for the town if anticipated traffic generation can be accommodated, based on the modal split identified in the Transport Assessment or Travel Plan required in accordance with Policy ST10: Transport Strategy.

Policy BAR16: Lynton and Barnstaple Railway

(1) Land east of Pilton Causeway, as shown on Policies Map 1, is identified for a station to serve a reinstated railway line between Lynton and Barnstaple that includes:

(a) provision of a locomotive shed, platform, ticket office, car parking and ancillary facilities and buildings; and

(b) enhancement of the area's built heritage including the special character and appearance of the adjacent Barnstaple Town Centre and Pilton Conservation Areas.

(2) The route identified for the reinstated railway line, as shown on Policies Map 1, is safeguarded from development that would prevent or jeopardise its delivery. Operational buildings and platforms alongside the reinstated railway line will reuse original or existing buildings and structures where feasible and viable.

10.73 The reinstatement of the former Lynton and Barnstaple railway line is proposed along its former route. The car park to the east of Pilton Causeway is allocated for a new railway station including a ticket office, locomotive store and ancillary buildings, as well as for car parking to serve the station and the town centre. The site for the new railway station lies between the Conservation Areas of Barnstaple Town Centre and Pilton, as well as the adjacent heritage assets along Pilton Causeway and the former Sheepskin shop. The character and appearance of the area's heritage will be conserved and enhanced in accordance with Policy ST15: Conserving Heritage Assets. Development will be required to provide a detailed flood risk assessment in accordance with Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience to ensure development does not raise public safety issues.

10.74 The reinstated railway line will be a tourism and leisure attraction for the town as well as helping to deliver the transport strategy (Policy ST10: Transport Strategy). Existing buildings and structures alongside the reinstated railway line, including original station buildings and platforms where they still survive, should be reused to provide new stations, platforms and buildings for the operation of the railway where available, unless it can be demonstrated to the satisfaction of the local planning authority that this is not feasible or viable.

10.75 Opportunities to provide stretches of footpath, bridleway or cycleway alongside the railway line will be supported where they do not impede the line's reinstatement and they are facilitated by land ownership and topography. Such routes should enhance the public rights of way network and ensure public safety is not compromised.

Policy BAR17: Petroc

Development and provision of new facilities at Petroc, as shown on Policies Map 1, will deliver enhanced educational and training facilities to help raise skill levels, facilitate delivery of a university level resource and opportunities for partnerships with high-tech businesses.

10.76 Petroc is key to raising skill levels and aspirations in northern Devon, which underpins the economic strategy for the area. Petroc has two separate campuses at Sticklepath and Oakwood Close, the latter being within the Roundswell District Centre, which offer a range of further and higher education courses, and in future will provide a university level resource serving northern Devon. The provision of a new vehicular access through the Larkbear strategic extension (Policy BAR02: Larkbear Strategic Extension) will facilitate redevelopment and reorganisation of the Sticklepath site as well as helping to reduce traffic congestion at the Sticklepath roundabout and reduce on-street parking in residential streets to the west of Petroc. The new access will also facilitate delivery of innovation and incubation units to the east of the campus for new business, research and development opportunities.

10.77 The Larkbear strategic extension (Policy BAR02: Larkbear Strategic Extension) will also improve green infrastructure links between the two campuses, including its contribution towards a cross-town cycle route (Policy BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links), as well as facilitating a new bus route between the two sites. Opportunities for training and partnerships between Petroc and high-tech businesses will be supported, including employment land identified on Roundswell Business Park (Policy BAR10: Roundswell Business Park). The area around Petroc is within a Critical Drainage Area. Development at Petroc will be required to incorporate a comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme that reduces the rate of surface water runoff and does not increase flood risk elsewhere in Barnstaple in accordance with Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience. A comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme should be integrated within the provision of green infrastructure that will be required to incorporate additional water storage areas to be created, creating linkages with existing biodiversity networks in the area.

Policy BAR18: Park Community School and Pilton Academy

(1) Land west of Park Community School, as shown on Policies Map 1, is identified for the provision of additional secondary education.

(2) Land south of Park Community School, (approximately 1 hectare) as shown on Policies Map 1, is identified for a new park and change facility.

(3) Land at Pilton Academy, as shown on Policies Map 1, is identified for the provision of additional secondary education.

10.78 The car park west of Park Community School accommodates Barnstaple's first park and change facility. The land is identified to deliver new and enhanced secondary education facilities to meet the educational needs of a growing population. Land to the south of the school is identified for a new, larger, relocated park and change facility to promote opportunities for sustainable transport into the town centre.

10.79 Land at Pilton Academy outside of the indicative flood zone is also identified for future expansion to deliver new and enhanced secondary education facilities to meet the educational needs of a growing population. Any expansion must include appropriate traffic management measures in order to reduce congestion on Chaddiford Lane and the surrounding highway network during peak times.

Green Infrastructure

Policy BAR19: Local Green Spaces

(1) Land at Portmore Golf Course, as shown on Policies Map 1, is identified as a local green space where any development must:

- (a) enhance opportunities for outdoor sport and recreation;
- (b) enhance the site's contribution to the local biodiversity network; and
- (c) protect the site's open character with any new buildings or structures sited and designed to minimise their visual impact.

(2) The community woodlands at Yeo Valley and Whiddon Valley, as shown on Policies Map 1, are identified as local green spaces where their biodiversity and recreational value will be protected and enhanced.

(3) Land between the Tarka Trail and the A361 north-west of Bradiford Water and land south of the Tarka Trail to the north of Bickington and Sticklepath, as shown on Policies Map 1, are identified as accessible natural green spaces where the green infrastructure network will be enhanced through habitat creation, provision of new outdoor recreation and leisure opportunities and improved pedestrian and cycle links to the Tarka Trail.

(4) Land off Portmarsh Lane, as shown on Policies Map 1, is identified as a local green space where its biodiversity and recreational value will be protected and enhanced.

10.80 Portmore Golf Course to the south of the A361 provides a local recreational facility to the south of Barnstaple and forms a prominent entrance to the town along the A361. The open character of this course also provides an important visual gap between Barnstaple and Landkey. Development that enhances the site's opportunities for outdoor recreation and/or its biodiversity value will be supported. Any development must safeguard the open character of this important setting at the southern gateway to the town. Any additional buildings or structures must be sited to minimise their visual impact.

10.81 The community woodlands at Whiddon Valley and Yeo Valley, which are both in public ownership, provide important contributions to the green infrastructure network on the eastern side of Barnstaple in terms of their biodiversity and recreational value. The Yeo Valley community woodland is a designated Local Nature Reserve. Any future designation of the woodland at Whiddon Valley as a Local Nature Reserve will be supported, subject to appropriate proposals for management of identified biodiversity value. A proposed footpath on the eastern side of Barnstaple will improve connectivity between these sites (Policy BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links).

10.82 The valley slope and floor on both sides of the Taw estuary contribute to its open landscape character. The Taw estuary is a Site of Special Scientific Interest, it forms part of the buffer zone for the Biosphere Reserve and forms a strategic green infrastructure corridor. This stretch of the Tarka Trail, which also forms part of the South West Coast Path and the National Cycle Network, is a key recreational facility that contributes to the green infrastructure network. Land around the Taw-Torridge estuary is identified within the coastal and floodplain grazing marsh strategic nature area as one of the best places in the South West for major habitat expansion for this priority habitat. The lower slopes are at risk of flooding.

10.83 Accessible natural green space between the Tarka Trail and the existing development at Sticklepath and Bickington, and to the north-west of Bradiford Water adjoining the Bradiford Reserve, provides opportunities for enhancement of the green infrastructure network through habitat creation or restoration and provision of new outdoor recreation and leisure opportunities. This land is within the Coastal and Estuarine Zone (Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy). It is proposed to establish a strategic public open space on either side of the River Taw with potential to become future Local Nature Reserves. To facilitate the creation of these green spaces, it may require some development (including Policy BAR07: North Lane, Bickington) south of the

prominent ridge-line which defines the southern edge of the Taw valley. Functional flood plains could be re-established to mitigate 'coastal squeeze' and create additional habitats.

10.84 Public access to these sites will enhance the green infrastructure network around the town. Additional pedestrian and cycle links will be provided between Bickington/Sticklepath and the Tarka Trail (Policy BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links). Conveniently located car parking provision will be required, either at Pottington Business Park with a new access on to the Tarka Trail, or from a new car park alongside the A361, to provide access to the accessible natural green space on the northern side of the river.

10.85 Land south of Portmarsh Lane provides an area of informal open space within Newport with recreational and biodiversity value. The land should be protected to retain its importance as a footpath/cycle link between the town centre and Newport and as part of the wider green infrastructure network. The land also contributes an important functional flood plain and area for flood storage from the Coney Gut, reducing flood risk elsewhere in the town.

Policy BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links

The strategic green infrastructure network within and around Barnstaple will be enhanced by providing:

- (a) improved footpath and cycle links to the Tarka Trail from Pottington, Sticklepath and Bickington;**
- (b) a cross-town cycle route from the Tarka Trail (at Fremington) towards Landkey through Bickington, Roundswell, Larkbear, Newport, Whiddon Valley and Westacott;**
- (c) a footpath link around the eastern side of Barnstaple between the Hospital and Westacott;**
- (d) improved footpath and cycle links along the eastern side of the River Taw between Rock Park and the centre of Bishops Tawton; and**
- (e) a new pedestrian and cycle bridge across the River Taw between Anchorwood Bank and the town centre.**

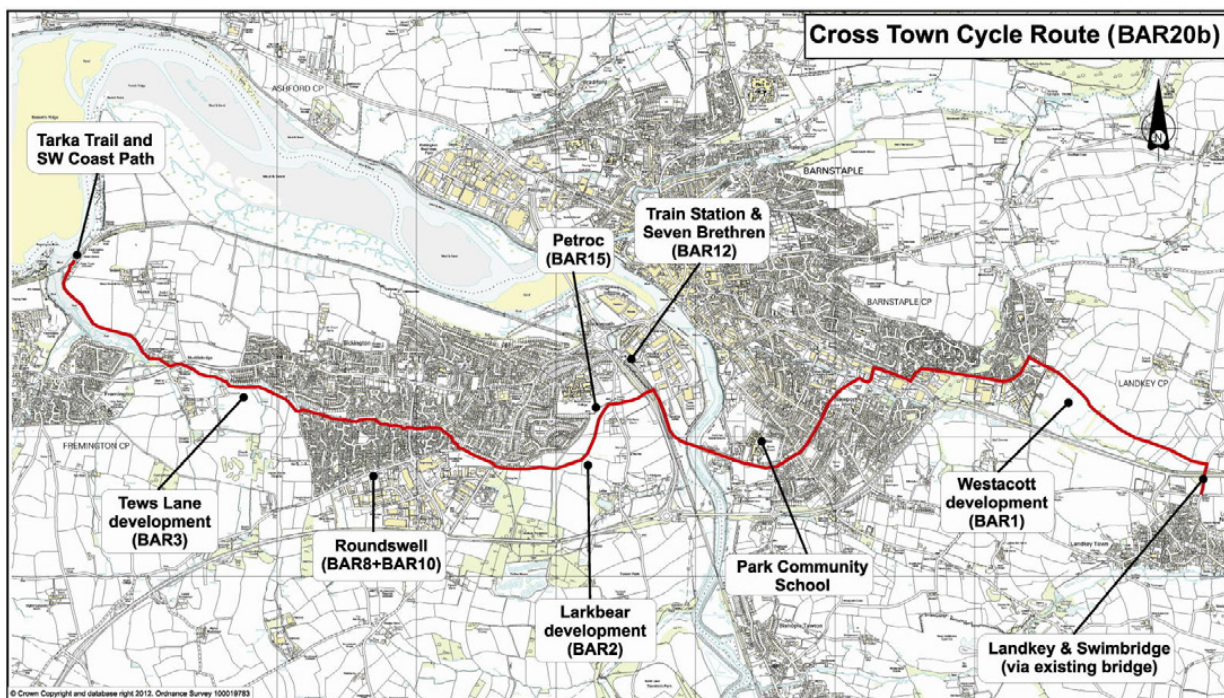
10.86 The Tarka Trail and South West Coast Path on either side of the Taw estuary provide strategic footpath and cycle routes into and through Barnstaple. The Macmillan Way is a long distance footpath that starts at Barnstaple before heading to Bishops Tawton, Landkey and across Exmoor to Boston in Lincolnshire. Improved links will be provided to the Tarka Trail from Pottington, Bickington and Sticklepath (Policies BAR07: North Lane, Bickington; BAR19: Local Green Spaces and BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links). The Tarka Trail will also be extended along the Taw waterfront as well as a new footbridge across the River Taw, linking to the town centre through the Anchorwood Bank redevelopment (Policy BAR12: Anchorwood Bank). The design of the new pedestrian and cycle bridge over the River Taw must protect and enhance the historic setting of the conservation area and listed buildings along The Strand. A riverside footpath between Barnstaple and Bishops Tawton (Policy BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links) will connect to both the Tarka Trail and the Macmillan Way. Other opportunities to link to these strategic footpaths and cyclepaths will also be supported.

10.87 A cross-town cycle route (Policy BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links) will enhance and connect existing stretches of cyclepaths within Barnstaple to provide a strategic cycle route through the town as shown in Figure 10.1 'Barnstaple Cross-Town Cycle Route'. Links will be enhanced through developments at Tews Lane (Policy BAR03: Tews Lane, Roundswell),

Roundswell (Policy BAR08: Former School Site, Roundswell), Larkbear (Policy BAR02: Larkbear Strategic Extension), Seven Brethren (Policy BAR13: Seven Brethren) and Westacott (Policy BAR01: Westacott Strategic Extension). This route will provide access to employment opportunities at Roundswell, Seven Brethren and Whiddon Valley, as well as connecting to both Petroc and Park Community School. New footpath and cycle bridges over the A361 and railway line are critical to this cross-town cycle route, which will be delivered as part of the Larkbear strategic extension (Policy BAR02).

10.88 A footpath on the eastern side of Barnstaple will enhance and connect existing footpaths to provide a strategic route between the hospital, Westacott and Whiddon Valley (Policy BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links). It will improve access to existing community woodlands at Yeo Valley and Whiddon Valley and will improve opportunities for healthy living. Development at Westacott (Policy BAR01: Westacott Strategic Extension) will help to facilitate a section of this route and other stretches will be delivered as opportunities arise.

Figure 10.1 Barnstaple Cross-Town Cycle Route



10.89 The green infrastructure network within and around town will be enhanced through the provision of additional footpaths, cycleways and bridleways, including routes linking to and extending the existing rights of way network. Where opportunities exist, the Local Plan will support environmental enhancement along the existing network of green infrastructure around Barnstaple. The Local Plan will also support the aspiration for a strategic footpath/cycling route between Barnstaple and Tiverton (Mid Devon) via South Molton to enhance the network of green infrastructure across Devon in accordance with Policy ST10: Transport Strategy.

10.90 Barnstaple has a deficiency of most types of public open space, and provision will be made for additional equipped play areas within each housing allocation. The allocated urban extension at Westacott (Policy BAR01: Westacott Strategic Extension) will provide new sports pitches on site, with developments elsewhere in the town contributing to new sports facilities south of Braunton Road (Policy BAR15: Land South of Braunton Road). Strategic informal open spaces are proposed west of Pottington adjacent to the Bradiford Reserve, south of the A361 and north of Bickington (Policy BAR19: Local Green Spaces), with provision of smaller informal open spaces as part of individual development sites where they are well designed and contribute to the town's green infrastructure network. Rock Park, the sports facilities at Pottington and the

sports pitches off Tews Lane are identified as hub sites (Policy DM10: Green Infrastructure Provision).

Policy BAR21: Flood Management Strategy

Flood management measures along the River Taw and its tributaries will re-establish functional flood plains in the Taw estuary and upstream of Barnstaple.

10.91 Barnstaple is situated on the tidal stretch of the River Taw, with substantial parts of the town being at risk of flooding from the rivers Taw and Yeo, Coney Gut and Bradford Water and their associated tributaries which flow through Barnstaple. The flood risks and identified flood hazards will increase as sea levels rise. The Councils' strategy for adapting to climate change is set out in Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience, which includes locating and designing new development to minimise its risk of flooding including additional flood storage areas within development sites in those parts of town identified as critical drainage areas. However, flood risks will still increase for existing properties and businesses within the town.

10.92 Re-establishing functional flood plains along the Taw estuary, in accordance with the Shoreline Management Plan and the North Devon Catchment Flood Risk Management Plan, will help to reduce the frequency and/or severity of future flood risks within Barnstaple and help to mitigate the impact of increasing flood risks and deliver sustainable flood risk management. Managed realignment is proposed within local green spaces in the Taw-Torridge estuary (Policy BAR19: Local Green Spaces). Other opportunities for re-establishing functional flood plains upstream of Barnstaple along the Taw or one of its tributaries will be supported, which recognises the potential contribution of ecosystem services to addressing flood risks.

Policy BAR22: Green Wedges

Green wedges between Barnstaple and the villages of Fremington and Landkey are identified on Policies Maps 1, 4 and 51 to protect the individual identities of these settlements. Within these green wedges, development that could lead to or contribute towards the coalescence of these settlements will be resisted.

10.93 There are small but locally important undeveloped gaps between Barnstaple and some of its surrounding villages. To prevent coalescence of these settlements, it is important to retain open land between them thus helping to maintain their separate identities, protect their landscape settings and avoid creation of continuous development. However, delivery of the cross-town cycle route (Policy BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links) between Fremington and Bickington will be supported here.

Bideford

The Place

10.94 Bideford is the second largest settlement in northern Devon; it acts as a locally significant centre providing vital services to Westward Ho!, Northam and Appledore and surrounding rural communities. The town fulfils this role by providing a range of services, retail options, education, health and community facilities and employment opportunities. The linking of Bideford and Barnstaple via the A39 Atlantic Highway also results in strong linkages between the towns and significant levels of cross commuting and travel.

10.95 The town has been a focus for housing and employment development, which has resulted in steady growth over the last 20 years. The town is home to a population of 16,610 people, as established by the 2011 Census. The parish population increased by 28% over the period 1991-2011 representing an annualised rate of 180 persons, which was supported by an average dwelling completion rate of 103 homes.

10.96 Bideford is an important local employment centre, providing a range of economic activities within and beyond its traditional industrial areas. The economic importance of the town is recognised within the Employment Land Review; it provides the focus for economic activity in Torridge District. Relatively high unemployment rates, low skills levels with lower than average wage levels and significant levels of outward economic commuting are nevertheless a concern. The attraction of competing centres also represents a challenge to the objective of strengthening the town's economic performance and securing improved quantitative and qualitative employment opportunities.

10.97 Bideford town lies on the River Torridge estuary at the principal river crossing in a beautiful setting surrounded by attractive countryside with a coastal hinterland that is protected as an Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty and within the UNESCO Biosphere.

10.98 The town's location and form, with regard to environmental and historic assets, act as both a constraint and opportunity for development, for marine related activities, tourism and recreation. The River Torridge, the Bideford Long Bridge, the quay, historic buildings, narrow streets and topography all play a role in defining the character of Bideford. The issue of flood risk is significant in and around the town centre and has implications for regeneration opportunities, the delivery of which are sought in support of a more vibrant town centre. Torridge District Council are pursuing the redevelopment and revitalisation of key town centre sites to improve the character of the town, increase investment into the area and improve the local economy and generate social and community benefits.

10.99 The focus for retail provision in Bideford is contained within the town centre, in addition to an extended offer at the Atlantic Village outlet centre. The Peter Brett Retail and Leisure Study determined Bideford to have a restricted retail offer, with regard to the presence of a very limited national/multiple offer with a high presence of independent retailers. The success of the combined retail offer of the town centre and Atlantic Village is important to the prosperity of the town in respect of extending its use by residents and visitors. Continued improvements to the shopping environment will be required to achieve town centre vitality and viability.

The future

10.100 Bideford will act as a focal point for jobs, shopping, recreation and cultural facilities to serve its community needs and those generated from the rural area beyond. The aspiration will be to deliver an enhanced range of services and employment opportunities to increase self-containment and deliver a complementary role to Barnstaple that strengthens the overall economic and service capacity provided by the area's principal town. Sustainable growth, to meet

needs and demands, will be delivered through a range of developments incorporating a combination of new housing, business development and community facilities with supporting infrastructure.

10.101 A key contributor to the town's aspirations will be providing opportunities that facilitate an increase in employment and skill levels, extending quantitative and qualitative choice to the town's residents and to the surrounding communities which are dependent on Bideford to provide economic support. Developing the areas economic base, with a focus on high skill and better waged jobs will be achieved by: delivering serviced employment land, providing support for appropriately located business development and through a business orientated expansion of training facilities.

10.102 The population of the town will continue to grow and it will be necessary for a range of housing types, tenures and sizes to be provided to meet the community's expanding and changing needs and demands. The town already offers a range of committed housing sites, in addition to which urban extensions and a range of other new sites will be delivered to provide the levels of housing growth required to support the town's development as a vibrant and sustainable economic centre, supported by necessary physical, social and green infrastructure. Significant housing development will be delivered through the Bideford west urban extension and substantial sites to the south of Clovelly Road and to the south of East-the-Water.

10.103 Bideford town centre will develop as a vibrant retail and leisure centre that is well used by residents and visitors. Recognising changing retail patterns and the complementary role provided by Atlantic Village, the scope for retail expansion in the town is limited. Increased town centre use will be secured by developing the range and quality of town centre uses, undertaking public realm enhancements and intensifying activity levels on underused sites. Bideford Port will continue to be influential in respect of the form and function of the town, the future development of which will be enabled in a manner which is integrated with the town centre and East-the-Water Wharves regeneration proposals.

The Spatial Vision and Development Strategy to 2031

10.104 The vision will be delivered through an integrated package of development proposals that seek to deliver against the identified needs of the town and also meet community aspirations. In doing so, development will seek to maximise the positive benefits that it can achieve whilst respecting the sensitive landscape and environmental setting of the town, its heritage, community spirit and sense of place.

10.105 The preferred strategy is to reinforce the town's role as a locally significant centre whilst strengthening its economic role as a main centre of employment.

Policy BID: Bideford Spatial Vision and Development Strategy

The Spatial Vision

Bideford will continue to be a focus for growth in northern Devon, which will be delivered without prejudice to valued environmental assets having due regard to the importance of the areas setting and landscape quality.

Bideford will provide an enhanced range of services and facilities to meet the needs of its residents and hinterland. The town will offer a choice of well-designed housing which meets lifetime needs with a network of greenspaces linking the surrounding countryside. There will be a diverse range of local employment supported by a skilled workforce with strong linkages to enhanced educational infrastructure. Bideford Port, together with associated infrastructure will develop

as an asset that contributes to the economic significance of the town. The town centre will be vibrant, attractive and safe for all users with a range of retail and leisure activities achieved through a programme of regeneration and public realm enhancements that encourages increased use and investment.

The Spatial Development Strategy

(1) Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable significant growth of high quality development which is supported by necessary infrastructure that will meet the needs of Bideford and its surrounding communities and to strengthen Bideford's role as a Strategic Centre. Achieved development will be delivered having regard to the setting of the town in the landscape and its special character provided by the coastal location. Specifically, the Local Plan will support:

(a) provision of a minimum of 4,127 dwellings including affordable and supported homes to meet all of the community's housing needs, with associated development and infrastructure;

(b) in addition to existing commitments, new site allocations, including capacity provided by previously developed sites, will be required to provide approximately 2,815 dwellings;

(c) urban extensions to the west and south-west of Bideford and to the south of East-the-Water (as part of the provision of new site allocations) will accommodate strategically significant levels of housing growth of approximately 2,130 dwellings that is supported by required social and physical infrastructure;

(d) employment capacity will be maintained and enhanced on established industrial estates and additional provision made to develop the town's role as a locally significant employment centre. Additional employment capacity will be provided on new site allocations: approximately 8 hectares to the south of the Caddsdow Industrial Park and 5 hectares for commercial development on Atlantic Park as part of the Bideford West urban extension;

(e) support for initiatives within Bideford town centre and environs that improves the town's functionality and vitality through an expansion and enhanced range of appropriate uses. To achieve the objectives of the Bideford Regeneration Framework, regeneration and revitalisation schemes at the former Livestock Market, The Pill, Bridge Street and East-the-Water Wharves will provide the focus for town centre, quayside and waterfront improvements;

(f) social and community facilities, will be required to support new development including an expansion of educational capacity at primary and secondary levels and new and expanded sports and recreation facilities, including the hub site at Victoria Park;

(g) deliver economic growth through capitalising on enhanced levels of assistance offered by the Assisted Areas status;

(h) new developments will meet their own infrastructure requirements and will contribute to sustainable movement into and around Bideford and Northam, including the promotion of public transport use and improved routes and facilities for cycling and walking. Improved capacity at the Heywood Road roundabout will also be required to accommodate increased traffic movements from Bideford and Northam; and

(i) provision of enhanced Sustainable Drainage Systems on sites which fall within or feed into the Bideford 'Critical Drainage Area' and improvements to the Kenwith Flood Risk Defence Scheme.

10.106 The spatial vision and strategy for the town will be principally delivered through an integrated package of development proposals identified within this Local Plan. Other opportunities that arise and that demonstrate that they will offer a positive contribution towards the delivery of the spatial vision and strategy, whilst meeting the requirements of the policies of this Local Plan when taken as a whole, will also be supported.

10.107 Housing development will be enabled in Bideford over the period 2011 to 2031 to deliver a minimum of 4,127 dwellings. This overall housing requirement will be delivered through a mixture of development completed since April 2011, existing commitments, identified housing allocations and non-strategic housing sites as set out in Table 10.3'Bideford Housing Provision 2011-2031'.

Table 10.3 Bideford Housing Provision 2011-2031

Housing Land Supply 2011-2031	Number of Dwellings
Allocations⁽¹⁾ :	2,815
Non-strategic Housing Sites⁽²⁾ :	226
Other Sites Contributing to Supply :	1,088
Dwelling Completions (2011 to 31st March 2017) :	766
Planning Commitments ⁽³⁾ :	322
Total Supply for Bideford	4,129

(1) Including planning commitments and completions on allocated sites (as of 31st March 2017). (2) See Appendix 5. (3) Including extant planning permissions (with small non-started permissions subject to 15% non-implementation discount), resolution to grant planning permission subject to signing of s106 agreement, permissions that have been implemented and dwellings under construction (as of 31st March 2017).

10.108 The employment land supply provided at Bideford for the period 2011 to 2031 is 20.4 hectares, as set out in Table 10.4'Employment/Economic Development Land Supply for Bideford 2011-2031'. The land supply is provided by a mix of available sites within existing employment estates and business parks and new site allocations.

Table 10.4 Employment/Economic Development Land Supply for Bideford 2011-2031

Employment/Economic Development Land Supply for Bideford 2011-2031	Hectares of Employment/Economic Development Land Proposed
Alversdiscott Road	5.0
Clovelly Road (BID10)	1.2
Caddsdwn *	1.2
Atlantic Park (BID01)	5.0
Extension to Caddsdwn Business Park (BID05)	8.0
Total Supply for Bideford	20.4

*Land within existing Business Park

The Development Proposals

10.109 A range of proposals are enabled through the Local Plan to support the delivery of the spatial vision for the town. The spatial extent of proposals are depicted on Policies Map 2 and each is subject to a specific Local Plan Policy, included below, which sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with any site specific development principles.

Vision: Bideford West Urban Extension - Winsford Park and Atlantic Park

An urban extension to the west of Bideford will be comprehensively developed to provide an attractive and desirable place to live, work and visit; it will complement and be well connected to Bideford's established neighbourhoods. Within a strong network of green and open spaces, Winsford Park will make a significant contribution to meeting the areas housing needs, providing a range of quality new housing with accessible community facilities. It will respect its landscape and historic buildings and create new opportunities for wildlife, biodiversity and sustainable travel and living. Atlantic Park will contribute to improving the area's economic performance, providing for a range of commercial activities within a quality environment that fully respect the sites setting within the landscape and importance as a gateway site into Bideford.

Policy BID01: Bideford West Urban Extension

(1) A site of about 71 hectares West of Bideford, between Abbotsham Road and Clovelly Road, as defined on Policies Map 2, is allocated to deliver a sustainable, high quality mixed use development that will be developed in a comprehensive manner and includes:

- (a) approximately 1,050 dwellings, providing a mix of housing types and size to reflect local need, including affordable housing, of which approximately 1,000 are expected to be delivered in the plan period;**
- (b) a mix of commercial and employment uses on about 5 hectares at Atlantic Park, provided on the basis of a low density, high quality development contained within a wooded area, which reflects the existing nature of the site and safeguards the wider landscape contribution provided by the former woodland; and**
- (c) integrated social and community infrastructure, including a 420 place primary school with early years provision and a children's centre delivery base, with associated sports and play facilities and a mixed-use local centre providing a range of facilities.**

(2) This strategic extension will be developed in a comprehensive manner to deliver the following site specific development principles;

- (a) a landscape structure that builds on and enhances existing assets, providing accessible green infrastructure and strengthening a distinctive edge to Bideford;**
- (b) enhanced on site management of surface water and drainage so as not to increase flood risk on the site and beyond and, as necessary, a contribution to improvements to the Kenwith Flood Defence Scheme;**
- (c) integrated pedestrian, cycle and public transport networks that provide connections to neighbouring residential and commercial areas; and**
- (d) delivery of a transport strategy that includes: a vehicular route connecting Abbotsham Road and Clovelly Road, a separate access to the commercial**

development off Clovelly Road, a new access junction onto the A39 and highway improvement at the junction of A39 and Abbotsham Road.

10.110 A strategic urban extension of about 71 hectares is allocated to the west of Bideford. The site will be required to be developed in a comprehensive manner having regard to the principles of Garden Cities. In addition to housing, the site should be developed to include a new primary school with early years provision and a children's centre delivery base and commercial uses that can gain advantage from the sites location.

10.111 The development will make a significant contribution to meeting the areas future housing needs, providing about 1,000 new homes in the plan period, the sizes and tenures of which will be reflective of local needs. Fundamental to the development of the site will be the delivery of a high quality living and working environment that fully respects its setting and enhances key features within the site that achieves an integration and connectivity with the towns existing form.

10.112 In delivering strategic housing numbers, the site will be developed with an emphasis on green infrastructure within a strong landscape framework that integrates development with significant natural and historic features. The presence of features, including: areas of Local Conservation Importance, mature trees of high landscape, ecological and arboriculture value and the setting of listed buildings at Moreton House east of the site, will be accommodated to achieve an acceptable site layout, which must also take into account the consequences of the sites topography which results in points of exposure from some distant views, from along A39 and the North Devon Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty. As necessary appropriately funded management plans will be secured to maintain the quality open space and recreational facilities delivered through the sites development.

10.113 The Atlantic Park component of the site will deliver a range of commercial uses as part of the wider focus of economic activity around the Caddsdawn and Clovelly Road employment areas. Development will be delivered at a low density and to a high standard utilising natural materials to reflect the wooded setting. In providing for carefully integrated development the current wooded area will be reduced but improved in quality through a programme of replacement and management. Development and the replaced trees will be required to maintain the landscape value provided by the current wooded area, which is important from distant views and along Clovelly Road.

10.114 The site will be accessed from points at Clovelly Road, Abbotsham Road and at a new left in/left out access junction onto A39. A spine road will be required to provide a connection between Abbotsham Road and Clovelly Road, which will also provide a new bus route and highway improvements will be required at the A39/Abbotsham Road junction. To support the vision of an attractive and desirable place to live and work, attention will be required to ensure internal movement and good connections to adjacent and internal facilities are provided, which will include a range of sustainable transport modes that will contribute to the high quality design standards required from the development. Included within the sustainability gains supported by the site's development will be enhanced connectivity between Abbotsham Road and Abbotsham village, by way of a shared foot/cycleway.

Policy BID02: Cleave Wood

(1) Land at Cleave Wood, extending to about 13 hectares and as defined on Policies Map 2, is allocated as a mixed use development that includes:

(a) approximately 250 dwellings including affordable homes, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes that reflects local needs;

(b) health care facilities, including related car parking on a site of about 0.6 hectares; and

(c) a neighbourhood community centre, including a Children's Centre base and satellite youth facilities.

(2) The site will be comprehensively developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

(a) the primary vehicular access provided from Manteo Way with a secondary access from Alverdiscott Road to the eastern element of the allocation; and

(b) a wide belt of tree planting and other appropriate screening around Broomhayes and adjoining employment uses.

10.115 An area of about 13 hectares at Cleave Wood, formed by two sites divided by Manteo Way is allocated for a mixed use development. The site is intended to deliver approximately 250 dwellings on the basis that the housing mix, in tenure and size appropriately reflects local housing needs in the interest of achieving a balanced housing market, which will include affordable housing.

10.116 The primary vehicular access onto the sites will be provided at single points from Manteo Way, having regard to the need to limited access points from this road. A secondary vehicular access will also be provided onto the eastern site from Alverdiscott Road, which provides for a linked route through the site.

10.117 The currently undeveloped site is subject to some flood risk to the west of Manteo Way, which should be avoided in providing for the required vulnerable uses and sustainable drainage systems will be required to ensure the rate of surface water runoff does not increase flood risk in accordance with Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience.

10.118 To ensure the community of East-the-Water continues to achieve improved social infrastructure, new health care facilities and a neighbourhood community centre will be provided. The neighbourhood community centre will focus on accommodating young person's needs, including a children's centre and satellite youth facilities to support existing provision serving Bideford. The new facility should be located to maximise accessibility and ease of access to the wider community.

10.119 The boundaries of the site, which abut Broomhayes should be planted to provide a 25 metre wide belt of trees and other appropriate screening provided on the site's southern boundaries to mitigate impacts of neighbouring employment uses.

Policy BID03: Land adjoining Manteo Way

(1) Land adjoining Manteo Way, extending to 17 hectares, as defined on Policies Map 2, is allocated for residential and associated development, that includes:

(a) approximately 310 dwellings, providing a mix of housing types and size to reflect local need, including affordable housing; and

(b) a 2.5 hectare site for open space and recreation facilities.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

- (a) development to be carried out in a comprehensive basis;
- (b) landscape structure that builds on and enhances existing assets, providing accessible green infrastructure and strengthening a distinctive edge on the site's eastern boundary;
- (c) financial contribution to the cost of built sports facilities and multi-functional community facilities needed to serve the area;
- (d) access to be taken only from Manteo Way; and
- (e) a high quality of design that minimises use of the car, incorporating cycle and footpath links between, throughout and adjoining the site.

10.120 A site of approximately 17 hectares is allocated for residential development adjoining Manteo Way. Development of the site will be carried out on a comprehensive basis.

10.121 In addition to providing about 310 dwellings, the development will be required to provide for and contribute to the delivery of a range of facilities and infrastructure to increase the degree to which the local community can access services locally.

10.122 The currently undeveloped site is subject to some flood risk to the west of Manteo Way. Development of the site, in form and location will have regard to the contained watercourse and related functional floodplain.

10.123 Vehicle access to all housing areas will be from Manteo Way only, taking account that only a limited number of access points will be acceptable from this road.

Policy BID04: Site South of East-the-Water

(1) A site of about 34 hectares south of East-the-Water, as defined on the Policies Map 2, is allocated to deliver a sustainable, high quality mixed use development that includes:

- (a) approximately 600 dwellings, providing a mix of housing types and size to reflect local need, including affordable housing, of which approximately 430 are expected to be delivered in the plan period;
- (b) a 420 place primary school, including a nursery and a children's centre delivery base;
- (c) a hill top park; and
- (d) strategic planting along the site's southern and eastern boundaries.

(2) The site will be developed in a comprehensive manner to deliver the following site specific development principles;

- (a) development to be carried out in a comprehensive basis in accordance with the requirements and provisions of an agreed masterplan;
- (b) integration of strategic landscaping and Green Infrastructure, including public open space, to integrate the development into its setting and mitigate its impact on the wider countryside;

(c) integrated pedestrian, cycle and public transport networks that provide connections to neighbouring residential, commercial areas and the Tarka Trail;

(d) access from Gammaton Road, through junction improvements at Manteo Way; and

(e) provide a sustainable water strategy that reduces water usage, manages surface water runoff through water storage and sustainable drainage systems to reduce the risk of flooding on the site and beyond at East-the-Water.

10.124 An urban extension of about 34 hectares, to the south of East-the-Water is allocated for housing to contribute to meeting the areas longer term needs. The developable site area is about 28 hectares having regard to the topography to the western element of the site. The site will be required to be developed in a comprehensive manner.

10.125 The site's physical form should be utilised to support a green infrastructure focused development that provides for a hill top park. The development should be designed to take account of the setting and views having regard to the consequences of the sites topography. Existing hedgerows and trees should be retained where possible and incorporated into the site design which should provide the basis for strategic planning along the sites southern boundary to provide a transition to the countryside beyond.

10.126 The site to the south of East-the-Water is located within the Bideford 'Critical Drainage Area' on which basis its development will be required to incorporate a sustainable water strategy that includes a comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme. The scheme should be integrated with the required green infrastructure.

10.127 A new primary school will be accommodated on the site that will provide for the expanding educational needs of East-the-Water. A site of about 1.2 hectares will be required to be provided, which should be located to maximise accessibility and ease of access to the wider community.

10.128 The site will be accessed from Gammaton Road, junction improvements will be required and pedestrian linkages to the north and west should be pursued.

Policy BID05: Land adjoining Caddsdawn Business Park

(1) Land adjoining Caddsdawn Business Park, extending to about 18 hectares and as defined on Policies Map 2, will be developed comprehensively to deliver a sustainable, high quality mixed use development that includes:

(a) approximately 8 hectares of land for economic development focused on BI, B2 and B8 uses as appropriate to the site and its wider context, ensuring that there is a mix of unit sizes to enable business start up and expansion;

(b) approximately 130 dwellings, including affordable homes, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes that reflects local needs; and

(c) an integrated highway network that incorporates:

(i) the formation of a new east-west aligned vehicular link, as part of a wider distributor road through BID09 and extending to the site's eastern boundary;

(ii) the provision of an extended spinal estate road for Caddsdwn Business Park to service the new economic development; and

(iii) the formation of a new junction onto Clovelly Road, providing access to the site from its north-eastern boundary.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

(a) strategic landscaping measures to ensure the development respects the sensitivity of the existing landscape setting;

(b) areas of green infrastructure providing opportunities for biodiversity enhancement and informal recreation;

(c) integrated pedestrian, cycle and public transport networks that provides connections to neighbouring residential and commercial areas;

(d) appropriate design and layout to ensure effective site use and co-existence of housing and economic development; and

(e) noise mitigation measures as necessary to avoid a prejudicial impact on the future operation of businesses within and beyond the site.

10.129 A site to the south of Bideford is allocated for mixed use development. The site adjoining the Caddsdwn Business Park will make a significant contribution to meeting the economic needs of the area and will deliver approximately 130 dwellings, including a proportion of affordable housing. The site will be required to be developed in a comprehensive manner to ensure the appropriate delivery of both housing and employment.

10.130 Serviced employment land should be delivered in an early phase of the plan period to provide new business and employment opportunities, as part of a high quality business park, facilitated by the delivery of housing as part of a mixed use development. The form and layout of development, including the location and configuration of the required uses, together with any included noise alleviation measures, must ensure that any prejudicial impacts on the operation of businesses are avoided and the amenity of future residents is safeguarded.

10.131 Vehicular access will be from a new junction on Clovelly Road at the north-east corner of the site and through an extension of the Caddsdwn spinal estate road. From the new access points an internal highway network will result in connections to a wider distributor road, which should extend from the adjoining site subject to Policy BID09: South of Clovelly Road and to the site's eastern boundary, to enable its continuation beyond the site.

10.132 The development should be designed to take account of the setting and views, with appropriate landscaping to frame, not hide, the structures. Existing hedgerows and trees should be retained where possible and incorporated into the design. Where removal is unavoidable there should be replacement provision. The scheme should include elements of green infrastructure, providing opportunities for habitat enhancement and recreation.

10.133 The area to the north and south of Clovelly Road, around the established industrial estates, provides a strong focus for employment in Bideford. The Local Plan provides for a continuation and expansion of the economic focus in this location, which has proved to be attractive to the market and is well located to proposed housing growth.

Policy BID06: Bideford Port

Land at Bideford Port, as defined on Policies Map 2, will be safeguarded for appropriate port related uses that require a quayside location, subject to the provision of the following:

- (a) access to The Quay for service and commercial vehicles; and**
- (b) a high standard of design that respects the historic character and appearance of the Quay, the Bideford Conservation Areas and adjoining listed buildings.**

10.134 The importance of Bideford Port to the local economy has grown as a consequence of the increasing use of sustainable modes of freight transport. It is recognised as an economic asset and an important feature of the town, which the Local Plan seeks to safeguard.

10.135 To further appreciate future demands on the port and how such should be addressed, Torridge District Council has commissioned a Torridge Estuary Strategy which may identify the need for additional port related facilities within the Taw/Torridge estuary.

10.136 Any proposals relating to the port and harbour facilities will be examined carefully with a focus on operational capabilities and the context provided by its town centre location. Proposals must be acceptable in terms of local transport and amenity considerations within and adjoining the port including the weight restrictions on the Bideford Long Bridge. The adequacy of storage and supporting facilities must also be maintained as a consequence of any development together continued access for flood defence maintenance and at least current standards of flood protection provided for by The Quay.

10.137 In addition to functional considerations proposals should be of an appropriate design quality having regard to the location of The Quay within the Bideford Conservation Area and its proximity to numerous listed buildings including the Bideford Long Bridge.

Policy BID07: Bideford Regeneration Sites

Regeneration and revitalisation of the town centre will be supported through schemes on the following sites, as defined on Policies Map 2, that will be delivered in a comprehensive manner:

- (a) East-the-Water Wharfs - a mix of housing, leisure and retail uses to improve connectivity with Bideford West and secure an active and attractive waterfront use;**
- (b) the former Livestock Market – an extension to existing leisure and recreation facilities supported by an improved public car parking facilities;**
- (c) the Pill – providing a range of commercial and leisure facilities supported by an at least maintained level of public car parking; bringing together a disparate range of uses to increase the areas use and attraction;**
- (d) Bridge Street Car Parks – residential focused development with retail uses and maintained levels of public car parking, improving the intensity of site use and encouraging movement to the Pannier Market area of the town;**
- (e) New Road (North) - development that results in an enhancement to the southern gateway to Bideford, and**

(f) New Road (South) - development that results in an enhancement to the southern gateway to Bideford.

10.138 Extending the use and attraction of the town centre will be central to improving its economic performance and its ability to support the town's residents and those of the wider hinterland. Improving the quality and accessibility of attractions and services will also be central to increasing the potential benefit to be made from visitors to the area. Six key sites are identified to provide the main focus for change in and around the town centre to achieve the overall objective of improving town centre vitality and viability. The sites are generally in high profile locations, with the potential to create successful urban spaces that positively contribute to the sustainability of the town. A range of uses are proposed for the regeneration sites, the scope of which is in the majority of instances shaped by the presence of flood risk.

10.139 Site development briefs have been prepared to guide development at East-the-Water Wharves and Bridge Street Car Parks, in the interest of securing quality and comprehensive developments. Development Briefs, to be agreed by Torridge District Council, will additionally be required to guide development on the site of the former Livestock Market and the Pill, such being significant and complex in respect of delivery. On this basis, the means by which comprehensive development is to be achieved must be demonstrated.

Policy BID08: Former Bideford to Appledore Railway

In association with landowners, voluntary organisations, the Highway Authority, and other interested parties, Torridge District Council will seek the establishment of a trail, following where possible the route of the former Bideford to Appledore Railway from Northam Road to Westward Ho!

10.140 Additions to the network of cycle routes can be pursued where opportunities allow. A number of specific proposals include requirements for cycle access. The Policies Map identifies the route of the former Bideford to Appledore Railway as a proposed trail from the flood control lakes in the Kenwith Valley to Westward Ho! Such trails provide benefits in terms of health, the economy and well being. Journeys may be for recreation and tourism as well as providing for local utility purposes.

10.141 Between Westward Ho! and Appledore much of the former railway line has been redeveloped or replaced by public highway. The cycle route is therefore expected to use public highways (including Golf Links Road, Jackets Lane and Torridge Road) to reach Appledore. Access through Northam Burrows exists and there may be potential for improved cycle access through the site and to Appledore, subject to further investigation. Limited variation from the precise route of the former railway may be accepted to enable delivery of the cycleway.

Policy BID09: South of Clovelly Road

(1) Land at Adjavin Farm, south of Clovelly Road, extending to 41 hectares and as defined on Policies Map 2, is allocated for residential and associated development, that includes:

- (a) approximately 700 dwellings including affordable homes, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes that reflects local needs;**
- (b) integrated social and community infrastructure, including a neighbourhood community centre;**

(c) on site provision of sport and recreation facilities, including sports pitches adjoining Clovelly Road/Atlantic Village;

(d) a vehicular link forming part of a wider distributor link to the south of Clovelly Road connecting with the Caddsdwn Industrial Park Extension, allocated by Policy BID05; and

(e) strategic planting along the site's southern boundary and western boundaries.

(2) The site will be developed in a comprehensive manner to deliver the following site specific development principles;

(a) a landscape structure that builds on and enhances existing assets, providing accessible green infrastructure and strengthening a distinctive edge to Bideford;

(b) noise and odour mitigation measures as necessary to avoid a prejudicial impact on the future operation of High Park Farm;

(c) integrated pedestrian, cycle and public transport networks that provide connections to neighbouring residential and commercial areas;

(d) vehicular access from Clovelly Road, the location and design of which will be achieved in conjunction with the development of Winsford Park and Atlantic Way, allocated by Policy BID01; and

(e) provision of off-site highway improvements as necessitated by the development.

10.142 An urban extension to the southwest of Bideford is allocated to provide a housing focused development that will make a significant contribute to meeting the areas housing needs and demands. The site will be required to be developed in a comprehensive manner.

10.143 About 700 homes will be delivered, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs. Fundamental to the development of the site will be the delivery of a high quality living environment that fully respects its setting and enhances key features within the site. Community and recreational facilities will be provided on site to meet generated needs. A community centre should be located to ensure accessibility to the majority of the sites residents and as part of generated open space and recreation needs, pitch provision should be located on site.

10.144 The site should be developed within a strong landscape framework that integrates development with existing features and integrates green infrastructure enhancements. Strategic landscaping will be required on the site's southern and western boundaries with appropriate treatment at Clovelly Road to minimise the impact of urbanisation. A transitional boundary between the development and adjacent countryside should be provided on the site's southern and western boundaries, which should include a buffer to avoid any prejudice between agricultural activity and new residents of the developed site. Specific noise and odour mitigation measures will be required to avoid prejudicial impact on the adjoining High Park Farm.

10.145 The site will be accessed from Clovelly Road, the form and siting of which will be determined in association with the development proposed through Policy BID01: Bideford West Urban Extension. The access will be developed to form part of a wider distributor route that will link with the adjoining site, allocated by Policy BID05: Land adjoining Caddsdwn Business Park.

Policy BID10: Bideford Clovelly Road

Land at Clovelly Road Industrial Estate, extending to approximately 1.2 hectares as defined on Policies Map 2, is allocated for economic development. The site will be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principle:

(a) vehicular access to be provided from the Clovelly Road Industrial Estate Road.

10.146 The Clovelly Road Industrial estate is a strategic employment site with good accessibility to the strategic road network. The industrial estate together with Caddsdow Business Park, including its planned expansion, and Atlantic Park provide an important commercial hub in support of future growth in Bideford.

10.147 A site of 1.2 hectares, at the Clovelly Road Industrial estate is allocated for economic development, the achievement of which will complete the industrial estate's development other than if undertaken as a result of intensification or redevelopment. The site is prominently located on a significant corner plot of the industrial estate which fronts onto Clovelly Road. The prominence of the site provides an opportunity for commercial uses which would benefit from a visible presence.

Braunton and Wrafton

The Place

10.148 Braunton and Wrafton are situated on the northern side of the Taw Estuary and both sides of the River Caen. Although Braunton is classed as a village, it is one of the larger settlements in northern Devon and is an important local service centre providing a range of retail, education, health and community facilities and employment opportunities. Substantial postwar development has resulted in modern residential estates to the west, east and south of Braunton village centre. Growth has been more limited over recent decades constrained by landscape and environmental designations surrounding the villages, particularly to the south and west, as well as by flood risk through the middle of the villages.

10.149 Braunton and Wrafton's current population is about 8,100, which has increased by less than 4% over the period 2001-2010, lower than rates of population growth elsewhere in northern Devon. In 2011, there were just over 4,000 households in the villages with a relatively small proportion of flats (9%). House prices are above the average for North Devon and, with a lower than average level of social housing, it is a priority area for the delivery of affordable housing.

10.150 The villages are located about 8 kilometres (5 miles) north-west of Barnstaple, and Braunton has a compact settlement pattern centred around the junction of the A361 (Barnstaple to Ilfracombe) and the B3231 to Croyde via Saunton. Wrafton is situated immediately to the south of Braunton where it is separated by an undeveloped gap. There is substantial congestion in Braunton village centre, especially in the summer, arising from the capacity of the main crossroads, which has resulted in the recent designation of an air quality management area along Caen Street.

10.151 The villages are surrounded by hills to the north and east with Braunton Great Field, Braunton Marsh and Braunton Burrows situated to the south and west that provide a more open landscape setting towards the mouth of the Taw estuary. Braunton Great Field is one of the few open field systems remaining nationally that retains its medieval character of strip cultivation. The South West Coast Path and Tarka Trail pass through the villages providing good sustainable travel options towards Barnstaple and beyond. The North Devon Coast Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty surrounds the village to the north and west.

10.152 Braunton Burrows is 3 kilometres (approximately 1.8 miles) west of the village centre, which is designated by UNESCO as the core of a Biosphere Reserve, the only new style Biosphere Reserve in England. Braunton and Wrafton are within the transition zone around the core area that is a test-bed for sustainable development within an area of high environmental quality and demonstrates the best examples of people working in harmony with nature for the benefit of all.

10.153 Braunton has a number of historic buildings, especially in the village centre and around the Parish Church, which are included within a large conservation area that covers around 23 hectares and includes 40 listed buildings. Wrafton has fewer listed buildings and does not have a conservation area. There are a number of listed lincays on Braunton Marsh.

10.154 Perrigo in Wrafton is a well established major employer specialising in pharmaceuticals. RMB Chivenor provides a high proportion of defence related jobs, which helps support local shops and services within Braunton and the wider area. Braunton West and Heanton Punchardon Wards have Assisted Area status. The tourism sector (accommodation, shops and restaurants) and retail trade are also very important to the local economy. However, there is limited employment land within the villages with substantial commuting to Barnstaple and Ilfracombe. Unemployment rates are amongst the lowest in northern Devon and average household incomes are amongst the highest, particularly in the East Ward.

10.155 Many of Branton's community facilities are at, or close to, capacity including the village schools and health centre. The villages are very well served with sports pitches and informal open space, with good access to Branton Burrows, the local beaches, coast path and the countryside surrounding the village.

The Future

10.156 Growth of Branton and Wrafton, whilst protecting the high quality landscape around the villages and their separate identities, will facilitate improved access to employment opportunities, key services and facilities as well as meeting housing needs. This will strengthen Branton's existing role as a local service centre for shopping, employment, recreation and cultural facilities, whilst providing services and facilities for rural communities and tourists along the west coast. Existing flood risks will be addressed through enhancement of existing flood defences, including through the surface water management plan.

10.157 A range of housing will be provided to meet the community's expanding and changing needs. In addition to existing committed sites, growth to the south-east of Wrafton will provide high quality development that makes a substantial contribution to the villages' housing and employment needs, supported by necessary physical and social infrastructure. Housing growth will help to deliver serviced employment land to facilitate new high skill and better waged jobs.

10.158 Development to the south-east of the village will minimise additional impact on Branton village centre, whilst delivering opportunities for sustainable travel along the Tarka Trail and increasing use of existing bus routes. An improved network of public footpaths and cycleways will enhance the green infrastructure network and link the Tarka Trail and local beaches. The designation of a new local nature reserve will be supported.

10.159 A park and change facility linked to existing bus routes will help to reduce vehicle movements in Branton village centre. Re-direction of motor vehicles on the North Devon Link Road via the A399 at Aller Cross to access Ilfracombe, coastal villages and tourism related facilities on the north coast will also reduce levels of through traffic within Branton, thereby reducing traffic congestion and helping to improve air quality (Policy ST10:Transport Strategy).

The Spatial Vision and Development Strategy to 2031

Policy BRA: Branton and Wrafton Spatial Vision and Development Strategy

The Spatial Vision

Housing and employment growth to the south-east of Branton and Wrafton will deliver a mix of high quality, sustainable family and affordable housing integrated with serviced employment land and key community infrastructure. Development will also make use of previously developed land and retain and improve access to community facilities for the villages that delivers a greater sense of self-sufficiency. The high quality built and natural environments of Branton and Wrafton and their separate identities will be respected and managed.

Branton and Wrafton will become healthier and more accessible by improving traffic management to reduce congestion and improve air quality in Branton village centre. An enhanced network of public footpaths and cycleways will link with the Tarka Trail and local beaches. Superfast broadband will support the growth of existing businesses and provide new employment opportunities, including through tourism with the provision of a Biosphere Reserve visitor centre.

Effective cooperation with partners will deliver key services and facilities including through the community and voluntary sectors. The empowered community will make the most of its talents and leadership to deliver the vision, with all residents able to contribute to and participate in community life.

The Spatial Development Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable growth of high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Braunton and Wrafton. The spatial vision for Braunton and Wrafton will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 390 dwellings, including affordable homes, to meet the range of the community's housing needs, with associated development and infrastructure on a continuous basis during the Plan period between 2011 and 2031;
- (b) provision of new site allocations of approximately 420 dwellings;
- (c) two strategic extensions to the south-east of Braunton and Wrafton (as part of the provision of new site allocations) to accommodate approximately 370 new family dwellings and serviced employment land plus land safeguarded for expansion of Perrigo supported by required physical, social and green infrastructure;
- (d) economic growth through capitalising on enhanced levels of assistance offered by the Assisted Area status;
- (e) enhancement of and improved access to Chivenor Business Park;
- (f) delivery of superfast broadband connections;
- (g) support for initiatives that provide opportunities for new tourism, leisure and recreation facilities including improved cycle and pedestrian linkages between Braunton and Saunton;
- (h) improved traffic management and improved air quality in the village centre;
- (i) social and community facilities required to support new development including increased primary and secondary school capacity, early years provision and additional formal open space;
- (j) support for initiatives to improve and mitigate against any adverse harm on water quality in the rivers and estuary; and
- (k) enhancement of existing flood defences and associated flood risk mitigation measures to address flooding issues in the villages.

10.160 The total housing requirement for Braunton and Wrafton over the period 2011 to 2031 is for a minimum of 390 dwellings. This overall housing requirement will be delivered through a mixture of development completed since April 2011, existing commitments and identified housing allocations as set out in Table 10.5'Braunton and Wrafton Housing Provision 2011-2031'.

Table 10.5 Braunton and Wrafton Housing Provision 2011-2031

Housing Land Supply 2011-2031	Number of Dwellings
Allocations⁽¹⁾ :	420
Non-strategic Housing Sites⁽²⁾ :	0
Other Sites Contributing to Supply :	152
Dwelling Completions (2011 to 31st March 2017) :	83
Planning Commitments ⁽³⁾ :	69
Total Supply for Braunton and Wrafton	572

(1) Including planning commitments and completions on allocated sites (as of 31st March 2017). (2) See Appendix 5. (3) Including extant planning permissions (with small non-started permissions subject to 15% non-implementation discount), resolution to grant planning permission subject to signing of s106 agreement, permissions that have been implemented and dwellings under construction (as of 31st March 2017). (4) Figures exclude the village of Knowle.

10.161 The total employment requirement for Braunton and Wrafton over the period 2011 to 2031 is for approximately 12 hectares of additional land for economic development. This overall employment requirement will be delivered through the provision of serviced employment land as part of the south-eastern extension (Policy BRA01: Wrafton South-Eastern Extension) and expansion of Perrigo (Policy BRA02A: Land East and West of Staggers Lane) as set out in Table 10.6 'Employment/Economic Development Land Supply for Braunton and Wrafton 2011-2031'.

Table 10.6 Employment/Economic Development Land Supply for Braunton and Wrafton 2011-2031

Employment/Economic Development Land Supply for Braunton and Wrafton 2011-2031	Hectares of Employment/Economic Development Land Proposed
Wrafton South-Eastern Extension (BRA01)	10
South of Perrigo (BRA02A)	2
Total Supply for Braunton and Wrafton	12

The Development Proposals

10.162 A series of proposals are enabled through the Local Plan to support the delivery of the spatial vision for the villages. The spatial extent of proposals are depicted on Policies Map 3 and each is subject to a specific Local Plan Policy, included below, which sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with any site specific development principles.

The Vision for the Wrafton South-Eastern Extension:

A strategic, mixed use extension on the south-eastern side of Wrafton will deliver serviced employment land contributing to North Devon's economic growth and future prosperity by attracting inward investment and delivering an increased supply of local jobs. The development will deliver a distinctive sense of place and quality of life enhancing the network of green infrastructure across the site. The development will be of high quality and sustainable design through its construction and future occupation, incorporating measures that will reduce carbon emissions as well as making better use of opportunities for sustainable travel within and around Braunton and Wrafton.

Policy BRA01: Wrafton South Eastern Extension

(1) Land between Wrafton and Chivenor (about 27 hectares), as identified on Policies Map 3, is allocated for a mixed use development including:

- (a) approximately 10 hectares of new land for economic development;**
- (b) approximately 150 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs; and**
- (c) provision within the site, or financial contributions towards, physical infrastructure, community facilities, and green infrastructure required by the development.**

(2) The South-Eastern Extension will be developed in a comprehensive manner to deliver the following site specific development principles:

- (a) provide new serviced employment land for business and employment opportunities that facilitate growth of higher value sectors of the northern Devon economy;**
- (b) provide a mix of house types, tenures and sizes of open market and affordable homes contributing towards the identified local needs and facilitating delivery of the serviced employment land;**
- (c) create an active frontage along the southern boundary overlooking the Tarka Trail;**
- (d) enhance and make connections to the existing network of local and strategic green infrastructure through and around the site including the provision of public open spaces, biodiversity networks and recreation facilities; and**
- (e) provide a sustainable water strategy that reduces water usage, incorporates sustainable drainage systems and does not increase the risk of flooding elsewhere in the locality.**

(3) The transport and connectivity strategy for the South-Eastern Extension will:

- (a) provide a new junction on the A361 to deliver the primary vehicular access to the development;**
- (b) provide a new park and change facility close to the A361 junction to facilitate opportunities to use existing public transport links between Branton and Barnstaple;**
- (c) establish new footpath and cycleway access points onto the Tarka Trail; and**
- (d) safeguard an opportunity for a future vehicular access to the land west of the site.**

10.163 An extension to the south-east of Wrafton will deliver approximately 10 hectares of serviced employment land. This site has Assisted Area status. The serviced employment land will be delivered in the early phases of the Plan period to provide new business and employment opportunities for Branton and Wrafton within a high quality business park, facilitated by delivery of housing as part of a mixed use development. Proposals for retailing and other identified town

centre uses should be considered against Policy DM19: Town Centres. The site will provide approximately 150 dwellings, including a proportion of affordable housing and an equipped play area. The development should be designed to a high quality in order to complement its landscape setting with an active frontage to the Tarka Trail. A sustainable drainage scheme should be integrated with the provision of green infrastructure that will permeate throughout the site, creating linkages to the existing biodiversity network.

10.164 Vehicular access to the site from the A361 is required from a new roundabout. The entrance to the site should provide an active and attractive gateway, with an opportunity safeguarded to extend the main road through the site (Policy BRA02A: Land East and West of Staggers Lane) leading towards Staggers Lane, where the existing access at Rectory Close Cross will need to be upgraded. Each phase of development will provide a link road through to its boundary, with the upgraded junction at Rectory Close Cross being delivered as part of the expansion of Perrigo. This junction improvement should be delivered comprehensively with improvements at Rectory Close Cross required by Policy BRA02: Wrafton Glebefield and Policy BRA02A: Land East and West of Staggers Lane. Pedestrian and cycle links to the Tarka Trail will serve both the housing and employment development. A park and change facility will be provided close to the A361 junction to facilitate use of existing public transport links into Branton village centre and for access to the Tarka Trail. These measures will contribute to reducing traffic congestion and improving air quality within Branton village centre.

Policy BRA02: Wrafton Glebefield

A site of about 1.8 hectares at Wrafton Glebefield, as identified on Policies Map 3, is allocated for a residential development that includes:

- (a) approximately 50 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs;**
- (b) vehicular access from Rectory Close Cross, incorporating improvements to the existing junction, together with the provision of a pedestrian crossing of the A361;**
- (c) noise attenuation measures along the southern and eastern boundaries; and**
- (d) contributions towards additional physical, social and green infrastructure within the town.**

10.165 Development of about 50 dwellings at Wrafton Glebefield should include a proportion of affordable housing, contributing towards the identified local needs. Noise attenuation measures are required along the southern and eastern boundaries to safeguard residential amenities from traffic associated with Perrigo.

10.166 This site adjoins Perrigo where the existing access off Rectory Close Cross is at capacity. In preference to a new access onto the A361, which would intensify the existing number of junctions on this section of the main road, development should improve the existing junction on the A361. This junction improvement at Rectory Close Cross will facilitate safe pedestrian crossing of the A361 and should be delivered comprehensively with improvements required by Policy BRA02A: Land East and West of Staggers Lane.

Policy BRA02A: Land East and West of Staggers Lane

Land East and West of Staggers Lane (approximately 15 hectares), as identified on Policies Map 3, will be planned comprehensively to deliver a mixed-use development that includes:

- (a) approximately 220 dwellings on land east of Staggers Lane, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs;**
- (b) approximately 2 hectares of employment land south of Perrigo for its future expansion;**
- (c) vehicular access from an improved junction at Rectory Close Cross together with the provision of a pedestrian crossing of the A361;**
- (d) noise attenuation measures along the northern, western and eastern boundaries of land east of Staggers Lane;**
- (e) a sustainable water strategy that reduces water usage, incorporates sustainable drainage systems and does not increase the risk of flooding elsewhere in the locality;**
- (f) enhancing the existing network of local and strategic green infrastructure through and around the site including the provision of public open spaces and an enhanced biodiversity network;**
- (g) new footpath and cycle access onto the Tarka Trail;**
- (h) an opportunity being safeguarded for future vehicular access and/or pedestrian access to land east of the site; and**
- (i) social and community facilities required to support new development including contributions towards the expansion of Braunton Academy and primary and early years provision.**

10.167 Development of about 220 dwellings on land east of Staggers Lane will occur in a comprehensive manner and will facilitate opportunities for the future expansion plans of Perrigo by securing delivery of an improved vehicular access. The site has Assisted Area status. Residential development will deliver a proportion of affordable housing, contributing towards the identified local needs as well as an equipped play area. Any housing and employment uses should be designed to a high quality in order to complement its landscape setting, with the housing also having an active frontage to the Tarka Trail.

10.168 A sustainable drainage scheme should be integrated with the provision of green infrastructure that will permeate throughout the site, creating linkages to the existing biodiversity network. Noise attenuation measures in the form of enhanced landscaping are required along the northern, western and eastern boundaries of the residential development to safeguard residential amenities from traffic noise associated with the A361, Perrigo and the proposed new business park (Policy BRA01: Wrafton South-Eastern Extension) respectively, especially noise arising from shift work.

10.169 The existing access off Rectory Close Cross is at capacity. In preference to a new access onto the A361, which would intensify the existing number of junctions on this section of the main road, development will improve the capacity of the existing junction on the A361. For

example, it could provide a new roundabout that would be designed to accommodate any future traffic associated with residential development on land east of Staggers Lane, expansion of Perrigo south of the existing premises and land at Wrafton Glebefield (Policy BRA02). The road through this site would be located to provide a future opportunity for provision of a road link and/or pedestrian and cycle link to that serving the economic development delivered through the Wrafton South-Eastern Extension (Policy BRA01).

10.170 The nearest primary and secondary schools are along Wrafton Road, access to which requires a new pedestrian crossing of the A361. Provision of a new pedestrian crossing should be delivered comprehensively with improvements at Rectory Close Cross required by Wrafton Glebefield (Policy BRA02). New or enhanced pedestrian and cycle links to the Tarka Trail will serve both the proposed housing and existing business at Perrigo.

Chivenor Business Park

10.171 Chivenor Business Park is occupied by a range of industrial uses. The business park has a degraded appearance and requires environmental enhancement, as well as improvements to the existing narrow site access from the A361 which crosses over the Tarka Trail. Proposals that enhance business opportunities or the attractiveness of the site will be supported with enhanced levels of assistance offered by the Assisted Area status.

Tourist Accommodation

10.172 Tourism forms an important part of Braunton's economy and a diverse range of tourist accommodation will be retained or provided where new opportunities exist. The only opportunity for caravan and camping within the village is at Lobb Fields, on the western edge of Braunton. Considering the limited availability of this type of accommodation within the village, it is important to retain these uses within the undeveloped coast (Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy). Proposals that upgrade standards of accommodation and facilities and enhance the overall quality of the site will be supported in accordance with Policies DM17: Tourism and Leisure Attractions and DM18: Tourism Accommodation.

Village Centre

10.173 Provision of additional retailing and services within Braunton village centre will be supported to meet the future needs of Braunton and surrounding communities where it enhances the vitality and viability of the village centre (Policy ST12: Town, District and Village Centres and Policy DM19: Town Centres). The village centre boundary defines the primary shopping area, which is identified on Policies Map 3.

10.174 Congestion within and around Braunton village centre has resulted in poor air quality and the designation of an air quality management area. Through extensive public consultation, there is local support for a bypass to the south-west of the village to address current air quality issues in the village centre as a solution in the longer term. Proposals to improve traffic management and circulation within and around the village, including those identified through the Air Quality Management Plan, will be supported in accordance with Policy DM02: Environmental Protection.

Local Green Spaces

Policy BRA03: Local Green Spaces

(1) Land between Braunton and Wrafton, as shown on Policies Map 3, is identified as a local green space where any development must:

- (a) provide or enhance opportunities for outdoor sport and recreation;
- (b) not harm its open character, with any new buildings or structures sited and designed to minimise their visual impact;
- (c) protect and enhance the site's features of local biodiversity value; and
- (d) not increase the risk of flooding elsewhere in Braunton and Wrafton.

(2) Braunton Great Field, as shown on Policies Map 3, is identified as a local green space where its archaeological heritage and setting will be protected.

(3) The Recreation Ground, as shown on Policies Map 3, is identified as a local green space where any development must:

- (a) enhance opportunities for outdoor sport and recreation; and
- (b) not harm its open character, with any new buildings or structures sited and designed to minimise their visual impact.

10.175 Land between Braunton and Wrafton provides an all weather sports pitch, tennis courts, car park and an athletics track, which is a sports facility of sub-regional importance. The open character of this gap should be protected to help retain the separate identities for Braunton and Wrafton. Proposals for additional public open space and sports provision are supported, but any new buildings or structures should share or improve existing facilities at the athletics track or Braunton Academy where possible or be sited to minimise their visual impact. Knowl Water flows between Braunton and Wrafton and most of this undeveloped gap is at risk of flooding, where it provides an important element within the local biodiversity network.

10.176 Braunton Great Field is not protected by any formal statutory protection or heritage designation but is nationally important as one of the few remaining medieval open field systems. The area protected by Policy BRA03: Local Green Spaces is effectively the last remaining vestiges of this open-field and includes fields on its fringes that were formed by the enclosure of former open strips. These enclosed fields are of a later medieval date but form part of the setting of the open field as well as being historic assets in their own right. The area identified in Policy BRA03: Local Green Spaces is an area defined by the B3231 to the north, Moor Lane to the west, the existing built development on the north-eastern edge, Field Lane to the east and the lane running between Velator to the east and Sandy Lane to the west and represents the area still farmed as an open-field as well as fields formed by the enclosure of former open strips.

10.177 It is particularly vulnerable to the amalgamation of individual strips and the loss of baulks and headstones. The intrinsic value of this heritage asset and its contribution to the wider historic landscape will be recognised and conserved. A future extension to the North Devon Coast Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty around Braunton Marsh and Great Field will be supported.

10.178 The recreation ground is a large open space close to Braunton village centre. It should be protected to retain an important venue for outdoor sport, recreation and community uses. Any new buildings or structures should be sited to minimise their visual impact and retain the area's open character.

Green Infrastructure

10.179 Braunton and Wrafton have relatively good provision of sports facilities, informal open spaces and equipped play areas, although there is a deficiency for facilities for young people, including an identified need for a BMX track and a local need to deliver additional sports pitches.

Proposals for a BMX track will be supported where it has good accessibility from the Tarka Trail. Lobb Fields, to the west of the village, and sports facilities around Braunton Academy are identified as hub sites (Policy DM10: Green Infrastructure Provision).

10.180 Improvements will be made to the green infrastructure networks within and around Braunton and Wrafton. The gap in the Tarka Trail between Willingcott and Knowle should be filled to complete this strategic footpath/cycle route and improve tourism and recreational opportunities for walking and cycling between Braunton and Ilfracombe. Opportunities to improve pedestrian and cycle links between Braunton and Wrafton, Braunton Burrows and Saunton beach, avoiding the road, will also be supported.

10.181 Whilst Braunton has a number of designated wildlife sites and is set within a high quality natural environment, it does not have a Local Nature Reserve. Potential sites for a Local Nature Reserve include the Tarka Trail along the River Caen corridor, wetlands at Velator and woodlands at West Hill. Proposals for designation of future Local Nature Reserves in these locations will be supported, subject to appropriate proposals for management of identified biodiversity value. The countryside around Braunton and Wrafton provides an important network of hedgebanks for movement and feeding of protected species. Support will also be given to creating a wildfowl and wetlands area at Velator to enhance the green infrastructure network, local biodiversity and tourism/leisure opportunities in accordance with Policy ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets. Water quality and fish stocks in the River Caen, Knowl Water and Taw Estuary will be improved and protected in accordance with Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy.

Fremington and Yelland

The Place

10.182 The settlement of Fremington and Yelland, which excludes those parts of Fremington parish that are within the Barnstaple chapter, is identified as a Local Centre (Policy ST06: Spatial Development Strategy for northern Devon) but has a number of strategic sites that warrant site specific allocations, such as the former Fremington Army Camp (Policy FRE01) and the former Yelland Power Station site (Policy FRE02). A higher level of growth is proposed than for other Local Centres (Policy ST08: Scale and Distribution of New Development in Northern Devon).

10.183 Fremington and Yelland's current population is about 4,100, which has increased by less than 5% over the period 2001-2010. In 2011, there were approximately 2,000 households in the village with a relatively small proportion of flats (2.3%). House prices are below the average for North Devon and with a lower than average level of social housing.

10.184 Fremington and Yelland form a linear settlement about 3.5 kilometres (2.2 miles) in length along the B3233 between Barnstaple and Bideford on the southern side of the Taw estuary. Fremington is separated from Bickington by an undeveloped gap that helps to retain the separate identities of these settlements. Fremington has a range of community facilities with relatively few available in Yelland, however a wide range of services, facilities and employment opportunities are available in Barnstaple and Bideford accessible by frequent public transport links and the Tarka Trail between these strategic centres. Many of Fremington and Yelland's community facilities are at or close to capacity including the village school and health centre.

10.185 The South West Coast Path and Tarka Trail pass to the north of the village contributing to a key green infrastructure corridor along the estuary and providing good sustainable travel options towards Barnstaple and Bideford. Land on the southern side of the estuary includes a range of designated wetland habitats including Home Farm Marsh and Isley Marsh Nature Reserves, Local Nature Reserves at Fremington Pill and Mill Leat and a number of other County Wildlife Sites. It also adjoins the Taw-Torridge estuary Site of Special Scientific Interest and the buffer zone of the Biosphere Reserve.

10.186 Fremington has a number of historic buildings, especially in the village centre and around the Parish Church, which are included within a conservation area that covers approximately 24 hectares. This conservation area also includes the former Fremington Army Camp (Policy FRE1). There is a further small conservation area at Fremington Quay, whereas Yelland has fewer listed buildings and does not have a conservation area.

10.187 The retail trade, construction and health and social work sectors are important to the local economy. However, there is limited employment land within the village and substantial commuting to Barnstaple and Bideford. Fremington Ward has Assisted Areas status. Unemployment rates are amongst the lowest in northern Devon and average household incomes are slightly below average.

The Future

10.188 Redevelopment of large previously developed sites within Fremington and Yelland will deliver housing and employment growth, which will strengthen the village's existing role as a local service centre offering education, employment, recreation and community facilities. Additional and enhanced community facilities will be delivered to help make the community more self-sufficient and sustainable.

10.189 The redevelopment of Fremington Army Camp and Yelland Quay will provide high quality developments on previously developed land that will make substantial contributions to

the community's expanding and changing housing needs, supported by necessary community and social infrastructure. A mixed-use development on previously developed land at Yelland Quay will help to secure a unique opportunity for waterside development. Links to jobs at Roundswell Business Park will be enhanced by delivery of the cross-town cycle route (Policy BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links).

10.190 The open character of the landscape between the village and the estuary will be protected and the green infrastructure network to the north of Fremington and Yelland will be enhanced by new pedestrian and cycle links between the village and the Tarka Trail as well as additional recreational and biodiversity provision as part of a local green space.

The Spatial Vision and Development Strategy to 2031

Policy FRE: Fremington and Yelland Spatial Vision and Development Strategy

The Spatial Vision

Housing and employment growth at Fremington/Yelland will promote greater self-sufficiency with increased support and improved access to community facilities for the village to strengthen its community identity whilst retaining its character and distinct separation from Barnstaple/Bickington.

New development will deliver a mix of high quality, sustainable family and affordable housing integrated with employment opportunities and key community infrastructure that is designed to reflect the character of the village with improved footpath and cycle links to the Tarka Trail and Local Nature Reserves.

Community driven regeneration of the former Yelland Power Station site will facilitate a mixed use redevelopment including housing and employment opportunities with associated social, community, green and blue infrastructure through high quality design that will capitalise on the site's coastal setting within the Taw-Torridge estuary.

Fremington/Yelland will become a healthier and more accessible village with a greater sense of self-sufficiency providing for the needs of all including an enhanced network of public footpaths, cycleways and bridleways, superfast broadband and improved connectivity to Barnstaple, the A39 Atlantic Highway and Roundswell Business Park. Opportunities to promote Fremington and Yelland Quays as tourist destinations will be developed.

Increased partnership working will deliver key services and facilities including through the community and voluntary sectors. The community will be empowered to make the most of its talents and leadership to deliver the vision.

The Spatial Development Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable growth of high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Fremington and Yelland. The spatial vision for Fremington and Yelland will be delivered through:

(a) provision of a minimum of 426 dwellings, including affordable homes, to meet the range of the communities' housing needs, with associated development and infrastructure on a continuous basis during the Plan period between 2011 and 2031;

(b) the re-development of Fremington Army Camp (as a contribution towards the provision of new dwellings) for approximately 277 new family dwellings and community facilities supported by required physical, social and green infrastructure;

(c) the regeneration and re-development of Yelland Quay (as a contribution towards the provision of new dwellings) to deliver a high quality mixed-use development for approximately 250 dwellings, economic uses including opportunities for utilising the existing jetty and quay to provide supporting services and facilitate local supply chains;

(d) enhancement of the environmental green buffer and protection of the open landscape character between Fremington, Yelland and the Taw-Torridge estuary in order to support local green infrastructure and biodiversity networks including protection of bird roosting areas adjoining the Site of Special Scientific Interest with improved access to the Tarka Trail;

(e) provision of additional water storage areas within development sites compared to normal Sustainable Drainage System design in recognition that parts of Fremington and Yelland are within a Critical Drainage Area;

(f) provision of superfast broadband connections;

(g) support for initiatives that provide opportunities for new leisure and recreation facilities;

(h) improved connectivity to Barnstaple through traffic management measures at Bickington and Cedars roundabout;

(i) protection of the open land between Fremington and Bickington to help to maintain their separate identities;

(j) delivery of economic growth through capitalising on enhanced levels of assistance offered by the Assisted Areas status;

(k) social and community facilities required to support new development including additional formal and informal open space, enhancement of the existing Fremington Medical Centre and education provision through the expansion of the existing primary and secondary schools and contributions towards new primary education and early years provision; and

(l) support for initiatives to improve and mitigate against any harm to water quality in the estuary.

10.191 The total housing requirement for Fremington and Yelland over the period 2011 to 2031 is for a minimum of 426 dwellings. This overall housing requirement will be delivered through a mixture of development completed since April 2011, existing commitments and identified housing allocations as set out in Table 10.7 'Fremington and Yelland Housing Provision 2011-2031'.

Table 10.7 Fremington and Yelland Housing Provision 2011-2031

Housing Land Supply 2011-2031	Number of Dwellings
Allocations ⁽¹⁾ :	527
Non-strategic Housing Sites ⁽²⁾ :	0

Housing Land Supply 2011-2031	Number of Dwellings
Other Sites Contributing to Supply :	322
Dwelling Completions (2011 to 31st March 2017) :	63
Planning Commitments ⁽³⁾ :	259
Total Supply for Fremington and Yelland	849

(1) Including planning commitments and completions on allocated sites (as of 31st March 2017). (2) See Appendix 5. (3) Including extant planning permissions (with small non-started permissions subject to 15% non-implementation discount), resolution to grant planning permission subject to signing of s106 agreement, permissions that have been implemented and dwellings under construction (as of 31st March 2017). (4) Figures exclude Bickington and Roundswell.

The Development Proposals

10.192 A series of proposals are enabled through the Local Plan to support the delivery of the spatial vision for the villages. The spatial extent of proposals are depicted on Policies Map 4 and each is subject to a specific Local Plan Policy, included below, which sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with any site specific development principles.

Policy FRE01: Fremington Army Camp

(1) Land at the former Fremington Army Camp, (about 14 hectares), as identified on Policies Map 4, is allocated for a comprehensive, sustainable mixed use development that includes:

- (a) approximately 277 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will reflect local needs;**
- (b) provision of sports pitches and a multi-use games area; and**
- (c) provision of physical infrastructure, community facilities, and green infrastructure required by the development.**

(2) The site will deliver the following site specific development principles:

- (a) provide a mix of house types, tenures and sizes of open market and affordable homes contributing towards the identified local needs;**
- (b) safeguard the historic setting of the military buildings identified as heritage assets and retain their re-use for community uses and ensure protection of the character and appearance of the Conservation Area;**
- (c) enhance the green infrastructure buffer along the eastern boundary alongside Fremington Local Nature Reserve;**
- (d) enhance existing hedgerows along the northern and western boundaries; and**
- (e) provide a sustainable water strategy that reduces water usage, incorporates sustainable drainage systems and does not increase the risk of flooding elsewhere in the locality.**

(3) The transport and connectivity strategy for the development will:

- (a) include traffic management measures to deliver a safe access without an unacceptable impact on identified heritage assets; and**

(b) provide a footway and cycleway through the eastern part of the site between the Tarka Trail and Church Hill.

10.193 The former Army Camp is a large previously developed site situated within the Fremington conservation area. The site is in a sustainable location to the north of Fremington between the B3233 and the Tarka Trail. Redevelopment of this site will provide about 277 dwellings of predominantly family housing including a proportion of affordable housing, as well as community and sports facilities to address the needs of the development. Development will be expected to enhance the character and appearance of the Conservation Area whilst safeguarding the historic setting of the single storey military buildings on site, identified as heritage assets in accordance with Policy ST15: Conserving Heritage Assets. The retention of these buildings (Building 60 and Miniature Range Building) will retain a reference to the site's former use as a military training camp and barracks and retain their re-use for community purposes.

10.194 Transport management measures are required at the junction of Military Road and Church Hill to improve highway safety, whilst avoiding an unacceptable impact on the character and appearance of Fremington Conservation Area and the setting of listed buildings around this junction. A suitable alternative option for vehicular access to the site would be supported in principle.

10.195 Fremington Pill to the east forms part of the Taw-Torridge estuary Site of Special Scientific Interest and includes a designated Local Nature Reserve and County Wildlife Site. Green infrastructure provision along the eastern part of the site will provide a landscape buffer, enhance the biodiversity network as well as providing pedestrian and cycle links between Church Hill and the Tarka Trail. This new link will improve connectivity between the village and the Tarka Trail (including Fremington Quay) and facilitate safe access to the bus stop by the village green.

10.196 The site is within a Critical Drainage Area where it has been identified that a large area within this part of Fremington and Yelland is at risk of flooding. Development will be required to incorporate a comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme that neither increases the rate of surface water runoff entering Fremington Stream or Fremington Pill nor increases flood risk elsewhere in Fremington in accordance with Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience. A comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme should be integrated within the provision of green infrastructure that will be required to incorporate additional water storage areas to be created that should permeate throughout the site, creating linkages with existing biodiversity networks in the area.

The Vision for Yelland Quay

Redevelopment of this large previously developed site will contribute to its economic regeneration whilst safeguarding the long term future of the existing jetty and wharf. The development will deliver a high quality, mixed-use scheme incorporating new community facilities, residential and economic development that maximises opportunities associated with its waterside location. Development will complement the site's estuary landscape setting, whilst protecting sensitive ecological areas from development and enhancing the network of green infrastructure including formal and informal recreation facilities. The development will serve the existing community, whilst creating a distinctive sense of place and quality of life.

Policy FRE02: Yelland Quay

A site of about 30 hectares north of the Tarka Trail at Yelland Quay, as identified on Policies Map 4, is allocated for a high quality, mixed-use development that will deliver the following site specific development principles:

- (a) redevelopment in a comprehensive manner in accordance with an agreed master plan;
- (b) approximately 250 dwellings the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs;
- (c) approximately 6,000 square metres of economic development and community facilities, compatible with its waterside location including business development, tourism and leisure uses;
- (d) buildings and structures will be sited and designed in accordance with an agreed 'Design Code' to address their visual impact on the open landscape setting of the estuary and to avoid any harm to the protected biodiversity value of the Site of Special Scientific Interest and other designated habitats in the locality;
- (e) retention of the existing jetty and wharf and provision of associated operational land, including a safeguarded vehicular access to it;
- (f) provision of adequate flood alleviation measures with design and distribution of uses to minimise and mitigate against any risks from flooding;
- (g) assessment and remediation, prior to commencement of redevelopment, of any site contamination arising from historic uses;
- (h) contributions to and enhancement of the green infrastructure network within and adjoining the site including the provision of a new football pitch with associated facilities and provision of informal open space on the site of the former ash beds;
- (i) provision of a net gain in biodiversity through enhancement of existing habitats;
- (j) contributions towards a wider study on the potential impact of increased recreational pressure on the SSSI and nesting birds in the estuary;
- (k) provision of a public car park for users of the Tarka Trail;
- (l) improvements to the existing road junction with the B3233;
- (m) improved pedestrian and cycle links through and around the site and from the B3233 to the Tarka Trail;
- (n) appropriate traffic management measures where vehicular traffic crosses the Tarka Trail to reduce conflict with, and improve safety for, pedestrians and cyclists using the Tarka Trail;
- (o) provision of a 10 metre landscape buffer along the developable site frontage alongside the Tarka Trail; and
- (p) opportunities for the generation of renewable energy.

10.197 Yelland Quay is a prominent previously developed site, the redevelopment of which will deliver economic and physical regeneration that will be master planned in accordance with the following design principles:

- a) delivering high quality design through an agreed 'Design Code';
- b) promoting safe and healthy communities;
- c) providing a net gain in biodiversity;
- d) safeguarding existing minerals and waste infrastructure; and
- e) incorporating the development into the existing community.

10.198 The site is located to the north of the Tarka Trail adjacent to the Taw-Torridge estuary Site of Special Scientific Interest (SSSI), an area of national importance for the large number of over wintering wildfowl and waders that use the estuary and adjacent land, particularly in winter and on migration in spring and summer. For a few species, the site is of international importance. The site is also within the buffer zone of the UNESCO Biosphere Reserve. The redevelopment of Yelland Quay should avoid harm to the area's biodiversity value (Policy ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets) and will deliver a net gain in biodiversity through enhancement of existing habitats. A wider study is required to assess the potential impact on the Site of Special Scientific Interest.

10.199 The site also forms part of the developed coast and estuary, although the adjacent former ash beds that have been capped form part of the undeveloped coast and estuary (Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy). The former ash beds have an important biodiversity value whilst contributing to the wider green infrastructure along the Taw estuary. As such, new buildings will be minimised here with the open landscape character safeguarded for provision of additional green infrastructure. The jetty and wharf remain and are safeguarded through the Devon Minerals Plan to facilitate continued import and export of minerals. Redevelopment must have regard to the value of the existing concrete plant and the recycled aggregates facility in terms of the Devon Minerals Plan and the Devon Waste Plan respectively. Any development on this site must be in accordance with adopted policies within these documents (or successor documents) to retain future potential as a strategic quay facility for water-borne transport of goods. Flexible space accessible from the wharf will be provided as associated operational land.

10.200 Yelland Quay is at risk of tidal flooding. Flood risks will be managed by raising ground levels to reduce the extent and severity of flood risks both on site and elsewhere in the Taw estuary in accordance with Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience. Development will need to be designed to provide a safe means of escape from the site.

10.201 A mixed-use development at Yelland Quay will deliver a range of economic uses and community facilities including a business hub, tourism, leisure uses and approximately 250 dwellings, including a proportion of affordable housing. The provision of housing as part of a comprehensive redevelopment will facilitate a viable regeneration of North Devon's largest previously developed site. The residential development will also help to provide new facilities and social infrastructure for the wider benefit of the local community including a new football pitch and associated facilities as well as contributions towards the expansion of Fremington Medical Centre. The master plan will ensure there are no adverse impacts on residential amenities arising from the economic development and traffic associated with the existing jetty, wharf and associated operational land. Development that may have offshore implications may require licensing from the Marine Management Organisation.

10.202 Yelland Quay is prominent within the open landscape setting of the estuary. New buildings and structures should be located predominately on the site of the former power station, set back from the estuary frontage and designed to address their landscape impact, as well as securing environmental enhancement of the site. Due to the site's prominent location on the Taw-Torridge estuary and visual prominence within the wider landscape, including from Braunton Burrows, development should be designed to complement its sensitive landscape setting. External lighting will need to be designed to minimise light pollution on neighbouring protected habitats and species and the nearby Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty.

10.203 Parts of the existing site are contaminated from its historic use as a power station, which is understood to include contamination from hydrocarbons, heavy metals and a substantial amount of asbestos. The capped ash beds must be safeguarded from disturbance. Levels of contamination will need to be assessed across the entire site and appropriate remediation agreed and undertaken before redevelopment occurs in accordance with Policy DM02: Environmental Protection. A phased approach to this remedial action could be undertaken across the site to facilitate phases of redevelopment in accordance with an agreed comprehensive programme of remediation works.

10.204 Vehicular access to the site will be along the access road off an improved junction with the B3233, as well as providing pedestrian and cycle links to the Tarka Trail. A new public car park of approximately 30 spaces will be provided for users of the Tarka Trail. Development at Yelland Quay will need appropriate traffic management where it crosses the Tarka Trail and South West Coast Path in order to reduce conflict with and improve safety for pedestrians and cyclists using these routes.

Green Infrastructure

10.205 Yelland Quay provides an opportunity to enhance strategic green infrastructure corridor along the Taw estuary, including the Taw-Torridge estuary Site of Special Scientific Interest and buffer zone for the Biosphere Reserve. The majority of the land which contains the former ash beds adjacent to the Site of Special Scientific Interest is considered to have an important biodiversity value whilst contributing to the wider green infrastructure along the Taw estuary. Any public open space and recreational facilities should be managed to provide a net gain in biodiversity in accordance with Policies ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets and DM08: Biodiversity and Geodiversity.

10.206 The landscape to the north of Fremington and Yelland is characterised by the flat, open setting of the Taw estuary, which should be conserved. It is prominent from the Tarka Trail on both the northern and southern sides of the Taw estuary and contributes to its undeveloped landscape character. This stretch of the Tarka Trail, which also forms part of the South West Coast Path and the National Cycle Network, is a key recreational asset that contributes to the green infrastructure network and open character of the area.

10.207 The Tarka Trail and South West Coast Path to the north of Fremington/Yelland form part of a strategic footpath and cycle route linking Ilfracombe to Plymouth, passing through both Barnstaple and Bideford town centres. A cross-town cycle route (Policy BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links) will provide a strategic cycle route through Barnstaple between the Tarka Trail at Fremington and the western edge of Landkey. This route will provide a safe and accessible footpath and cycle route from Fremington towards employment and retail opportunities at Roundswell, Seven Brethren and Whiddon Valley, as well as connecting to both Petroc and Park Community School.

10.208 Opportunities south of the Tarka Trail will be supported for the enhancement of the green infrastructure network through habitat creation or restoration, new outdoor recreation and leisure opportunities and additional pedestrian and cycle links between the village and the Tarka

Trail. The lower slopes are at risk of flooding and functional flood plains could be re-established to mitigate 'coastal squeeze' and create additional habitats. Land around the Taw-Torridge estuary is identified within the coastal and floodplain grazing marsh strategic nature area as one of the best places in the South West for major habitat expansion for this priority habitat. Habitat creation will complement Home Farm Marsh nature reserve to the north of this stretch of the Tarka Trail.

10.209 Land between Fremington and Bickington is identified as a green wedge (Policy BAR22: Green Wedges) to prevent coalescence of these settlements, retain open land between them and help to maintain their separate identities. However, delivery of the cross-town cycle route (Policy BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links) between Fremington and Bickington will be supported here.

Great Torrington

The Place

10.210 Great Torrington is a historic market town that developed on the trading route between Barnstaple and Plymouth. It occupies an elevated site east of the River Torridge, 11km south of Bideford and 15km from Barnstaple. It is an elongated settlement accessed by the A386, B3227 and B3232.

10.211 The town has grown steadily over the last 20 years, with development focused to the north of the town. The parish population has increased by 27% over the period 1991- 2010, providing an annualised increase of about 60 persons per year. The population increased from 4,493 residents in 1991, to 5,279 in 2001 and the Census identified a population of 5,714 in 2011. The highest rate of population growth occurred 1991-2001 at 17.5%.

10.212 The town is one of the larger market towns in northern Devon and it contains a range of services and community facilities that reflect the town's role as a locally important service centre. The range of facilities include independent focused retail outlets, primary and secondary schools and a community health centre, serving the needs of both urban and rural communities. However, the accessibility of the nearby larger settlements of Bideford and Barnstaple provides strong linkages and a range of higher order service and employment dependencies.

10.213 Significant tourist attractions within and close to Great Torrington include: Dartington Crystal, Torrington 1646, the Tarka Trail and RHS Rosemoor, all of which contribute to the range of available facilities and attractions of Great Torrington. Tourism is a significant contributor to the area's economic position and a sector which is recognised as providing growth potential.

10.214 Great Torrington has a rich built and natural heritage, much of which still dictates the character, form and appearance of the settlement, part of which pre-dates the market town. An important feature of Great Torrington is the Commons and Conservator Lands which adjoin the town on three sides, extending to an area of 132.6 hectares. The Commons provides substantial informal open space. It is rich in flora and fauna, contains ancient woodland, and includes the River Torridge and Tarka Trail, both well used by local residents and tourists.

10.215 The steep sided Torridge River valley borders the town to the south and west with a tributary valley running east to west along the town's northern edge. The valleys accommodate much of the Great Torrington Commons. The character of the landscape and the landforms to the south, north and west of the town as well as the presence of the Great Torrington Commons physically define the town and contain the possibility of future expansion.

10.216 Great Torrington provides a range of local employment opportunities, which are focused at the Hatchmoor Industrial Estate, at the former Creamery to the south west and the former abattoir to the north. Additional employment is also offered as part of the provision of services and facilities found throughout the town. Just over half the town's working residents work in and around the town and there is therefore a high level of economic out commuting to other employment centres. Significant employment losses have occurred since the mid-1990's from which it has been difficult to regain the live and work balance previously provided. Opportunities for future employment will be required to be provided to address a current limited supply of available employment land.

The Future

10.217 Great Torrington will become increasingly self contained, seeking to maintain its role as an important local service and employment centre. It is proposed that this will be achieved by

modest and balanced housing and employment growth focused on meeting the needs of Great Torrington residents.

10.218 The aspiration is to deliver a mix of services, employment opportunities and housing to strengthen its appeal and to meet locally generated needs. The population of the town will continue to grow, but on a modest scale, which is reflective of identified needs, available development opportunities and community aspirations to limit expansion to the scale required to address needs but significantly to maintain the existing community strengths.

10.219 To meet future housing needs, it will be necessary to provide for a range of needs, including affordable provision and housing for older households. Development opportunities within and adjoining Great Torrington are however limited by topography and environmental sensitivities. New housing growth will be provided through a number of modest site releases, focused to the north and west of the town.

10.220 The town's special landscape setting provided by the Great Torrington Commons will be protected and opportunities will be pursued to improve connectivity between the town and the adjoining countryside, particularly in relation to the Tarka Trail. The town's historic and cultural fabric will be protected and promoted through appropriate enhancement and regeneration, which will contribute to establishing Great Torrington as a heritage based tourism destination.

The Spatial Vision and Development Strategy to 2031

10.221 The vision will be delivered through an integrated package of development proposals that seek to meet the identified development needs of the town and also reflect community aspirations. In doing so, development will seek to maximise the positive benefits that it can achieve whilst respecting the sensitive landscape and environmental setting of the town, its heritage, community spirit and sense of place.

Policy GTT: Great Torrington Spatial Vision and Development Strategy

The Spatial Vision

Great Torrington will develop as a self sufficient local service centre with a vibrant, independent retail and employment offering. Great Torrington will be enhanced and promoted through tourism and leisure utilising its unique cultural heritage as well as the natural environment of the Commons. Its future will be supported through small to medium scale employment and housing development and the successful regeneration of key sites and buildings both within the historic town centre and urban fringe. A creative and dynamic community will be fostered through improved access to arts, culture and leisure facilities.

The Spatial Development Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable growth of high quality development and supporting infrastructure to meet the needs within Great Torrington and its supporting area that will positively contribute towards the delivery of the spatial vision for the town whilst respecting the sensitive setting of the town in the landscape. Specifically, the Local Plan will support:

(a) high quality, sustainable development secured in appropriate locations that maintain the integrity of the settlement's setting within the Great Torrington Common;

- (b) provision of a minimum of 632 dwellings, including affordable and supported homes, to meet all the communities housing needs, with associated development and infrastructure;
- (c) delivery of the housing requirement will be secured through redevelopment opportunities on brownfield sites within the town and modest urban extensions to the east and south;
- (d) expanded educational capacity provided by a new primary school and enhanced early years provisions;
- (e) additional employment land, approximately 4 hectares to the east of the Hatchmoor Industrial Estate, and the safeguarding of employment activity at the former abattoir site will enhance job opportunities for residents and limit commuting to larger settlements for employment;
- (f) regeneration opportunities will be actively pursued including at the former Creamery site to the south west of the town;
- (g) deliver economic growth through capitalising on enhanced levels of assistance offered by the Assisted Areas status;
- (h) improvement and enhancement of the town's retail function; and
- (i) enhancement and promotion of the town's heritage and cultural assets, particularly within the Conservation Area, to meet the needs generated by residents and visitors.

10.222 The preferred strategy for Great Torrington is to affirm the settlement's role as a local service centre by supporting sustainable economic growth, promoting tourism and leisure development within the town and surrounding countryside and protecting the area's unique environmental and cultural heritage.

10.223 The vision will be delivered through an integrated package of development proposals that seek to deliver against the identified needs of Great Torrington and its supporting area and community aspirations. In doing so, development will seek to maximise the positive benefits that it can achieve whilst respecting the sensitive landscape, environmental and heritage assets of Great Torrington.

10.224 Housing development will be enabled in Great Torrington over the period 2011 to 2031 to deliver a minimum of 632 dwellings. Other opportunities that arise and that demonstrate that they will offer a positive contribution towards the delivery of the spatial vision and strategy, whilst meeting the requirements of the policies of this Local Plan when taken as a whole, will also be supported. Table 10.8 'Great Torrington Housing Provision 2011-2031' identifies the areas of significance and future growth points in Great Torrington.

Table 10.8 Great Torrington Housing Provision 2011-2031

Housing Land Supply 2011-2031	Number of Dwellings
Allocations ⁽¹⁾ :	513
Non-strategic Housing Sites ⁽²⁾ :	0
Other Sites Contributing to Supply :	171

Housing Land Supply 2011-2031	Number of Dwellings
Dwelling Completions (2011 to 31st March 2017) :	104
Planning Commitments :	67
Total Supply for Great Torrington	684

(1) Including planning commitments and completions on allocated sites (as of 31st March 2017). (2) See Appendix 5. (3) Including extant planning permissions with small non-started permissions subject to 15% non-implementation discount), resolution to grant planning permission subject to signing s106 agreement, permissions that have been implemented and dwellings under construction (as of 31st March 2017).

10.225 The employment land supply provided at Great Torrington for the period 2011 to 2031 is approximately 4 hectares, as set out in Table 10.9 'Employment/Economic Development Land Supply for Great Torrington 2011-2031'. The land supply is provided solely by a large extension to Hatchmoor Industrial Estate, however other opportunities for employment development exist at the Former Creamery Site (Policy GTT01) and the former abattoir to the north of town.

Table 10.9 Employment/Economic Development Land Supply for Great Torrington 2011-2031

Employment/Economic Development Land Supply for Great Torrington 2011-2031	Hectares of Employment/Economic Development Land Proposed
East of Hatchmoor (GTT02)	4
Total Supply for Great Torrington	4

The Development Proposals

10.226 A series of proposals are enabled through the Local Plan to support the delivery of the spatial vision and development strategy for the town. The spatial extent of proposals are depicted on Policies Map 5 and each is subject to a specific Local Plan Policy, included below, which sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with any site specific development principles.

Policy GTT01: The Former Creamery Site

(1) A site of about 6.9 hectares at the former Creamery site, as defined on Policies Map 5, is allocated for comprehensive redevelopment that includes:

- (a) about 190 dwellings, the type, size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs;**
- (b) strategic recreation provision; and,**
- (c) employment development that meets local needs.**

(2) The site will be developed on a comprehensive basis in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

- (a) development to be of a form, mix and layout that is sensitive to, and avoids harm to established adjoining and proposed new employment and recreation uses;**
- (b) highway access to be achieved through the formation of new or improved junction(s) onto the B3227 and the provision of off-site highway improvements as necessitated by development; and**

(c) safeguarding of the route of Rolle Road; and

(d) strategic landscaping measures to ensure the development respects the sensitivity of the existing landscape setting and adjoining biodiversity interest; and

(e) delivery of enhanced and new connections to the existing network of local and strategic green infrastructure, through and around the site, including the provision of new footpaths, cycleways, public open spaces, wildlife corridors, formal and informal sport and recreation facilities.

10.227 A substantial site, located at the foot of the valley to the south west of Great Torrington is allocated as a redevelopment site to deliver a range of uses with a focus on housing. Development will include about 190 dwellings together with strategic leisure/recreation provision and employment to meet local needs. The site, comprises the former premises of Dairy Crest, which ceased operations in the early 1990's along with adjoining parcels of greenfield land. The contained buildings are generally in a poor state of repair with much of the site derelict, although part remains operational supporting a variety of commercial activities. The site represents an underused resource by virtue of its potential at a sensitive riverside location with immediate access to the Great Torrington Commons and the Tarka Trail. It does however also present a development challenge as a consequence of its industrial heritage and the significant flood risk present on the southern portion of the site.

10.228 The 6.9 hectare site provides an opportunity to deliver a range of uses including residential, economic, leisure and tourism development. The substantial costs of redevelopment requires a significant proportion of enabling residential development although this should be minimised to that required to achieve development viability. The form, scale and mix of development proposals should respond to, and contribute towards, the delivery of the Spatial Vision for Great Torrington. Recognising the nature of the site, a flexible approach will be taken towards its development. Proposals will be expected to pursue the objective of securing development that maximises the delivery of uses specified within Policy GTT01: The Former Creamery Site.

10.229 The site will be required to be planned and developed in a comprehensive manner. Such an approach is considered necessary having regard to the development challenges presented by the site, the need to secure the effective reuse of the site in its entirety and the need to safeguard existing commercial interests operating within and adjoining the site.

Policy GTT02: East of Hatchmoor

(1) A site of approximately 4 hectares, to the east of Hatchmoor Industrial Estate, as defined on Policies Map 5, is allocated for the delivery of economic development that provides a mix of premises reflective of the site and appropriate to enable business start up and expansion.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

(a) provision of an integrated package of landscaping and green infrastructure, including the retention of existing trees and hedgerows where possible, to integrate the development into its setting and mitigate its impact on the wider countryside and surrounding uses;

(b) safeguarding of an appropriate vehicular access, extending to the northern boundary, to enable the future delivery of land for economic development to the north of the site;

(c) highway access to be achieved through the formation of new junction(s) onto Hatchmoor Road and the provision of off-site highway improvements as necessitated by development; and

(d) provision of bus, pedestrian and cycle connectivity to provide accessible sustainable transport links to the town centre and beyond.

10.230 A greenfield site to the east of the Hatchmoor Industrial Estate is allocated for economic development. The site comprises agricultural fields extending to approximately 4 hectares which are generally level and benefit from a highway frontage to Hatchmoor Road to the south. Development of the site offers an opportunity to improve the availability of employment provision in Great Torrington, to support existing business requirements and provide for balanced growth reflective of future housing development. The area to the east of Hatchmoor provides a strong focus for employment provision in Great Torrington and the allocated land provides a natural extension for employment activity.

10.231 The site adjoins the existing built form of the town however it is somewhat visible within the wider landscape. As such, existing hedgerows and trees should be retained where possible and proposals should include a package of green infrastructure and landscaping to integrate it into the wider landscape and provide opportunities for habitat enhancement and recreation.

10.232 Vehicular access will be provided via Hatchmoor Road subject to new junction provision. The site will also be developed in a form, including access arrangements to allow for its northern expansion to accommodate future employment needs.

Policy GTT03: Hatchmoor Common Lane

(1) A site of about 7.3 hectares at Hatchmoor Common Lane, as defined on Policies Map 5, is allocated for residential and educational development that includes:

(a) about 140 dwellings, the type, size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs; and

(b) provision for a 210 place primary school with early years provision and a children's centre delivery base.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

(a) highway access to be achieved through the formation of new junction(s) onto Hatchmoor Common Lane and the provision of off-site highway improvements as necessitated by development;

(b) areas of green infrastructure providing opportunities for biodiversity enhancement and informal recreation, including strong boundary treatment adjoining established and planned employment uses;

(c) enhance and make connections to the existing network of local and strategic green infrastructure through and around the site including the provision of new

footpaths, cycleways, public open spaces, wildlife corridors, formal and informal sport and recreation facilities; and

(d) facilitate connections for motor vehicles, cycles and pedestrians between the proposed development, the town centre and key employment areas including increased opportunities for public transport links and sustainable travel choices within and around Great Torrington to reduce reliance on the private motor car.

10.233 A greenfield site of about 7.3 hectares to the east and west of Hatchmoor Common Lane is allocated for the delivery of new homes and a 210 place primary school with early years provision and a children's centre delivery base. The site is allocated to deliver about 140 dwellings of a nature and mix appropriate to meet local housing needs and demands. The site will provide the single largest contribution to meeting Great Torrington's housing needs over the plan period.

10.234 The site will bring housing in close proximity to established employment uses at Hatchmoor Industrial Estate, care will be required in site design, including strong boundary treatments and landscaping to ensure the amenity of existing residents is not harmed or future employment operations are not prejudiced. Account will also need to be taken of possible flood risk on the eastern part of the site.

10.235 Vehicular access will be from Hatchmoor Common Lane; the roads leading to the site are substandard in respect of width, alignment, forward and junction visibility, which will require improvement. Provision for safe access of cycles and pedestrians will be a required element of any scheme.

Policy GTT04: Adjacent to Dartington Fields

(1) A site of about 2.7 hectares adjacent to Dartington Fields, as defined on Policies Map 5, is allocated for residential and associated development that includes:

(a) about 60 dwellings, the type, size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

(a) highway access to be achieved through the formation of new junction(s) onto the B3232 and the provision of off-site highway improvements as necessitated by development;

(b) enhance and make connections to the existing network of local and strategic green infrastructure through and around the site including the provision of new footpaths, cycleways, public open spaces, wildlife corridors, formal and informal sport and recreation facilities; and

(c) facilitate connections for motor vehicles, cycles and pedestrians between the proposed development, the town centre and key employment areas including increased opportunities for public transport links and sustainable travel choices within and around Great Torrington to reduce reliance on the private motor car.

10.236 A greenfield site of about 2.7 hectares to the north of Broad Meadow Estate is allocated for the delivery of new homes. The site is currently laid to agricultural grazing and is intended to

deliver approximately 60 dwellings of a nature and mix appropriate to meet local housing needs and demands.

10.237 Although not subject to any formal landscape character designation the site does command some long distance views across open countryside to the north of the site, as such development proposals could impact on landscape character. Development proposals will be required to be subject to a Landscape and Visual Impact Assessment. Existing hedgerows and trees should be retained where possible and incorporated into the site design. Where removal is unavoidable there should be replacement provision. The scheme should include elements of green infrastructure, providing opportunities for habitat enhancement and recreation.

Policy GTT05: North of Burwood Lane

(1) A site of about 2.5 hectares north of Burwood Lane, as defined on Policies Map 5, is allocated for residential and associated development that includes:

(a) about 60 dwellings, the type, size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

(a) enhance and make connections to the existing network of local and strategic green infrastructure through and around the site including the provision of new footpaths, cycleways, public open spaces, wildlife corridors, formal and informal sport and recreation facilities; and

(b) facilitate connections for motor vehicles, cycles and pedestrians between the proposed development, the town centre and key employment areas including increased opportunities for public transport links and sustainable travel choices within and around Great Torrington to reduce reliance on the private motor car.

10.238 A greenfield site of about 2.5 hectares to the south of Great Torrington, along Burwood Lane is allocated for the delivery of new homes. The site is currently in agricultural use and is intended to deliver approximately 60 dwellings of a nature and mix appropriate to meet local housing needs and demands. The hedge banks surrounding the site should be safeguarded and enhanced to support a natural transition between the built form and the open countryside beyond.

Policy GTT06: Local Green Spaces

(1) Great Torrington Commons and Conservator Lands, as shown on Policies Map 5, is identified as Local Green Space where development will be permissible only where necessary:

(a) to preserve the Common; or

(b) to enhance the area's contribution to the local biodiversity network; or

(c) to enhance opportunities for outdoor recreation.

10.239 The area subject to Policy GTT06: Local Green Spaces is the Great Torrington Commons which is subject to control through the Great Torrington Commons Act and is administered by

the Great Torrington Commons Conservators. Great Torrington Commons are included in the Devon Inventory of Culm Grasslands produced by Devon Wildlife Trust and have also been identified as an area of landscape character that needs to be conserved.

10.240 The value of the Great Torrington Commons to the town in terms of recreation, landscape, nature conservation and general amenity is reflected by their exclusion from the development boundary. To reinforce their protection from development, a specific policy is considered necessary.

10.241 Policy GTT06: Local Green Spaces intends to permit only the types of development that will facilitate the interpretation and enhancement of the Commons, their nature conservation assets and their public amenity value.

Policy GTT07: East of School Lane

(1) A site of about 3.6 hectares east of School Lane, as defined on Policies Map 5, is allocated for development that includes:

(a) about 70 dwellings, the type, size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

(a) the primary highway access to be achieved through the formation of new junction(s) onto School Lane and the provision of off-site highway improvements as necessitated by development;

(b) enhance and make connections to the existing network of local and strategic green infrastructure through and around the site including the provision of new footpaths, cycleways, public open spaces, wildlife corridors, formal and informal sport and recreation facilities; and

(c) facilitate connections for motor vehicles, cycles and pedestrians between the proposed development, the town centre and key employment areas including increased opportunities for public transport links and sustainable travel choices within and around Great Torrington to reduce reliance on the private motor car.

10.242 A site of 3.6 hectares is allocated for housing development and associated infrastructure on land east of School Lane. The site holds a good relationship to the towns existing built form, being bounded to the south and west by existing built development. The site is currently undeveloped and in agricultural use.

10.243 The primary vehicular access to the site is to be achieved via School Lane to the west of the site subject to necessary highway improvements and new junction provision. If appropriate access arrangements can be made, the part of the site east of Bests Lane may be accessed independently. Provision for safe access of cycles and pedestrians will be a required element of any scheme.

10.244 Mature hedgerows border the majority of the site which should be retained where possible and incorporated into development proposals. Where removal is unavoidable there should be replacement provision. The scheme should include elements of green infrastructure, providing opportunities for habitat enhancement, recreation and links to the adjoining Local Green Space (Great Torrington Commons).

10.245 For the interpretation of relevant Plan policies the site will be regarded as a single development even if the eastern portion is accessed independently.

Holsworthy

The Place

10.246 Holsworthy is a compact market town sitting close to the Cornish border in an expansive rural landscape. It forms one of a network of market and coastal towns found throughout northern Devon but lies in relative isolation, divorced from other towns and surrounded by a blanket of countryside principally set over to agriculture. Whilst the town is divorced from the strategic road network, it sits at the intersection of the A388 and A3072 which provides good local road connectivity, linking the town to the extensive network of surrounding rural communities.

10.247 The town is home to a relatively modest population of 2,641 people, as established by the 2011 Census. The town has however seen significant growth in its recent history, its population increasing by some 40% between 1991 and 2011, equating to an annualised increase of about 40 people per year. This population increase was supported by the development of 399 dwellings with a further 244 dwellings being built between 2011-2017 (31st March). Over the period 2001-2017 (31st March), Holsworthy has experienced rapid growth at around 45 dwellings per year.

10.248 The town has a strong agricultural heritage and is home to a successful livestock market which forms the basis for much of its economic success. The existing premises that house the livestock market are however coming to the end of their functional life and being in the heart of the town on a steep slope, the market premises currently blight the south of the town and cause significant transport problems. The site and premises are not considered appropriate to serve the requirements of a modern agricultural facility and provision of a new facility is required to secure the future of the livestock market.

10.249 The town is characterised by a compact low rise centre with a rich built heritage supported by low to medium density housing stretching away to the north and west. The heart of the town is wrapped by attractive and sensitive river valleys to the east and west, spanned by impressive viaducts, connecting the town to the countryside beyond. The town is blessed by a good network of green infrastructure and an excellent network of footpaths and cycleways, both in and around the town and connecting it to the countryside beyond. Stanhope Park is a significant asset to the town, offering an attractive recreational facility in an accessible location, although it is yet to fulfil its potential.

10.250 Bolstered by being home to the livestock market, and also a popular weekly street market, the town provides a strong town centre offering a good range of services and facilities to meet the day-to-day needs of the town's population and that of the surrounding rural communities. The town does however suffer from significant retail leakage to surrounding towns and currently misses the opportunity to capitalise on the strong visitor economy that is founded on the attraction of the surrounding countryside and supported by the Ruby Country Initiative.

10.251 Allied to the success of the livestock market, and its relative isolation from other centres, the town also serves as the employment focus for the rural south-west of northern Devon. The town is home to the Dobles Lane Industrial Estate, a well performing and popular area offering general employment opportunities. The estate has recently expanded, meeting the immediate needs of new and expanding businesses in the area.

The Future

10.252 The success of Holsworthy as a place is inextricably linked to its agricultural heritage. This provides a solid foundation to build upon for the future of the town. To this end, Holsworthy will develop as an agricultural hub and centre of excellence, with a role of adding value to the agricultural sector whilst offering a range of high quality employment and educational opportunities to the population of the town and the surrounding rural communities.

10.253 Given its relative isolation in an expansive rural landscape, the town will continue to act as an important local service centre, being a focus, not only for its own population but also to a large rural community, to meet their day to day needs. The town will take opportunities to increase self containment by enhancing the range and quality of services, facilities, leisure and employment opportunities that it is able to offer.

10.254 The population of the town will continue to grow and it will be necessary for the town to provide a range of housing to meet this growth. Recognising that the town supports a range of rural communities, the town will also seek to meet some of their needs on the basis that it will not be possible for these to be fully met in the communities themselves.

10.255 The town offers a range of sites already committed for housing development: the final phase of Rydon Fields and on the former Showground site that are likely to meet the immediate and short term housing needs of the community. There will however be a need to provide further housing to meet longer term housing needs. As such, a small number of accessible and well integrated sites are allocated for housing to meet the full range of community needs.

10.256 The town will offer improved recreational opportunities, principally through the enhancement of existing facilities rather than through the provision of new, with Stanhope Park, bolstered by the extension to the north which offers additional quality playing pitch provision, fulfilling its potential and becoming a recreational hub for the town.

10.257 The town's special landscape setting between the two river valleys will be protected by directing additional development to less sensitive locations to the north, with recognised downstream flood risk managed through the careful design of development. The town's already good connections to the countryside will be enhanced through the completion of the cycle way across the Holsworthy Viaduct along with new Public Rights of Way along the river valleys, secured through development. The town will build upon this connectivity to the attractive countryside beyond, along with enhancements to its town centre and through working in partnership with the Ruby Country Initiative, to become an increasingly attractive destination for visitors.

The Spatial Vision and Development Strategy to 2031

10.258 The vision will be delivered through an integrated package of development proposals that seek to meet the identified development needs of the town and also reflect community aspirations. In doing so, development will seek to maximise the positive benefits that it can achieve whilst respecting the sensitive landscape and environmental setting of the town, its heritage, community spirit and sense of place.

10.259 The preferred strategy for Holsworthy is to reinforce the town's role as a local service centre whilst strengthening its economic role, both as an agricultural hub, a focus for rural employment and a destination for visitors.

Policy HOL: Holsworthy Spatial Vision and Development Strategy

The Spatial Vision

Holsworthy will build upon its strong agricultural heritage to develop as an agricultural hub and centre of excellence that is innovative, enterprising and adds value to this important rural employment sector. This will act as a catalyst for economic prosperity offering improved employment and enhanced education opportunities for residents of the town and the surrounding rural communities. The town will continue to be a focus in the rural south-west of northern Devon for employment opportunities, bolstered by an expanded range of employment

provision in and around the town to meet the needs of both new and existing companies.

It will build upon its position as a successful market town, to thrive in its role as an important service centre, becoming more self-contained and offering a range of services and facilities appropriate to support both its own population and the surrounding rural communities which rely upon it. In doing so it will become an attractive destination for visitors, drawn by a strong, vibrant and attractive town centre and good connectivity to the surrounding countryside.

An appropriate range of housing, in accessible and well integrated locations, will be provided so as to meet the needs of the town's changing population whilst accepting its responsibility to also accommodate some of the needs of surrounding rural communities where these cannot be met elsewhere.

The town's built heritage and sensitive landscape setting will be protected, recognising that this character helps to define the town, whilst interventions and regeneration will be supported to achieve townscape improvements and deliver enhanced gateways to the town.

The Spatial Development Strategy

(1) Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable a modest scale of high quality development and supporting interventions in and around Holsworthy which positively contribute towards the delivery of the spatial vision for the town whilst respecting the sensitive setting of the town in the landscape. Specifically, the Local Plan will support:

(a) provision of a minimum of 670 new dwellings including affordable and supported homes, of sizes, types and tenures to meet the housing needs of the community and to be provided with associated supporting development and infrastructure, on a continuous basis during the Plan period between 2011 and 2031;

(b) in addition to existing commitments, provision of new site allocations, comprising of a mix of brownfield regeneration opportunities, along with accessible and well integrated greenfield sites, to deliver approximately 415 additional dwellings;

(c) provision of an agri-business park incorporating a new livestock market, agri-business centre and employment park offering associated agriculture-related employment and retail provision to the north of the town;

(d) non-car modes of transit and highway network improvements to secure safe and sustainable access to new employment based development;

(e) redevelopment of the existing livestock market site to provide a regenerated southern gateway to the town, delivering a new convenience food store to help increase self-containment and provision of a range of housing to meet community needs;

(f) delivery of an extension to the Dobles Lane Industrial Estate to offer general employment opportunities to meet the needs of town and surrounding rural hinterland;

(g) safeguarding of existing employment provision and support for enhancement and expansion where opportunities arise;

(h) support for initiatives in and around the town centre to enhance its vitality through the provision of an expanded service and retail offer and appropriate enhancements to the public realm and townscape;

(i) an expansion of educational capacity and early years provision;

(j) provision of enhanced recreation and sport facilities, focused on reinforcing Stanhope Park as a hub site;

(k) securing opportunities to improve public access to the surrounding river valleys and countryside beyond through an enhanced and expanded network of footpaths and cycleways; and

(l) enhanced Sustainable Drainage Systems will be required for developments that lie within the Critical Drainage Area affecting the town.

10.260 Whilst the Local Plan intends for the spatial vision and strategy for the town to be principally delivered through the package of development proposals and allocations identified within the Local Plan, other opportunities that arise and that demonstrate that they will offer a positive contribution towards the delivery of the spatial vision and strategy, whilst meeting the requirements of the policies of this Local Plan when taken as a whole, will also be supported.

10.261 The defined housing supply for Holsworthy over the plan period 2011 to 2031 is for a minimum of 670 dwellings. This overall housing requirement will be delivered through a mixture of development that has been completed since April 2011, sites under construction at March 2017, commitments and housing allocations as set out in Table 10.10'Holsworthy Housing Provision 2011-2031'.

Table 10.10 Holsworthy Housing Provision 2011-2031

Housing Land Supply 2011-2031	Number of Dwellings
Allocations⁽¹⁾ :	415
Non-strategic Housing Sites⁽²⁾ :	0
Other Sites Contributing to Supply :	320
Dwelling Completions (2011 to 31st March 2017) :	254
Planning Commitments ⁽³⁾ :	66
Total Supply for Holsworthy	735

(1) Including planning commitments and completions on allocated sites (as of 31st March 2017). (2) See Appendix 5. (3) Including extant planning permissions (with small non-started permissions subject to 15% non-implementation discount), resolution to grant planning permission subject to signing of a s106 agreement, permissions that have been implemented and dwellings under construction (as of 31st March 2017).

10.262 The employment land supply provided at Holsworthy over the plan period 2011-2031 is for approximately 7.1 hectares, over two allocated sites as set out in Table 10.11'Employment/Economic Development Land Supply for Holsworthy 2011-2031'.

Table 10.11 Employment/Economic Development Land Supply for Holsworthy 2011-2031

Employment/Economic Development Land Supply for Holsworthy 2011-2031	Hectares of Employment/Economic Development Land Proposed
Dobles Lane Industrial Estate extension (HOL04)	2.1
Agri-business Park (HOL01)	5*
Total Supply for Holsworthy	7.1

*Includes 2.5 hectares for agricultural related retail development.

The Development Proposals

10.263 A series of proposals are enabled through the Local Plan to support the delivery of the spatial vision for the town. The spatial extent of proposals are depicted on Policies Map 6 and each is subject to a specific Local Plan policy, included below which sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with any site specific development principles.

Policy HOL01: Agri-Business Park

(1) Land to the north of the unnamed road linking the A388 and Dobles Lane, extending to about 13.8 hectares and as defined on Policies Map 6, is allocated for the provision of a new agri-business park that includes:

- (a) a livestock market and agri-business facility on an area of about 5 hectares;
- (b) an associated business park through the provision of about 5 hectares of land for economic development including agriculture-related retail uses; and
- (c) planting of a community woodland extending to about 3 hectares.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

- (a) site to be developed in a comprehensive basis in accordance with the principles, requirements and provisions of the endorsed site development brief;
- (b) structural landscaping, planting and boundary treatments to deliver an acceptable integration of the site into its countryside location;
- (c) sustainable transport provision including:
 - (i) new public transport services linking the site to the town centre; and
 - (ii) formation of a new off-site pedestrian link connecting the site to existing footway provision at the junction of Dobles Lane and River Tamar Way;
- (d) vehicular access through the formation of new junctions only onto the unnamed road linking the A388 and Dobles Lane; and
- (e) incorporation of a sustainable water strategy.

10.264 A greenfield site to the north of Holsworthy is allocated for the development of a new agri-business park. Development will deliver a new livestock market facility, replacing the existing

facility at Under Lane (HOL02: Land South of Under Lane) which is coming to the end of its functional life, along with a range of complementary uses including an agri-business centre and an associated business park offering premises for employment and agriculture related retail uses. Development of the associated business park will not be enabled in advance of the completion of the new livestock market.

10.265 The business park will provide approximately 5 hectares of serviced land offering the opportunity to secure a range of high quality premises to deliver economic development including agriculture related retail.

10.266 Development proposals will respond to the site's rural setting in the open countryside. The design and layout of the development along with the palette of materials utilised will be reflective of this setting and proposals will incorporate strong elements of structural landscaping, planting and boundary treatments together with the establishment of a community woodland to ensure the site integrates well into the open countryside.

10.267 Recognising the out of town location, proposals will be expected to establish sustainable transport connections between the site and the town. Proposals will provide for new public transport services between the site and the Town Centre, the scale and nature of which will be informed by a Transport Assessment and Travel Plan. A new off-site pedestrian footway / footpath will be delivered to connect the site to the existing pedestrian footway network within the town.

10.268 The site lies within a Critical Drainage Area. Development proposals will need to be supported by a sustainable water strategy which will include the management of surface water run-off through an enhanced Sustainable Drainage System. In view of the nature of the use, it is expected that proposals relating to the livestock market will incorporate pollution control measures to ensure compliance with Policy DM02: Environmental Protection.

Policy HOL02: Land South of Under Lane

(1) Land to the south of Under Lane (about 4.5 hectares) as defined on Policies Map 6, is identified for a sustainable, high quality, mixed use development that includes:

- (a) approximately 90 dwellings, the type, size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs;**
- (b) provision within the site of physical infrastructure, community facilities and green infrastructure required by the development;**
- (c) a new convenience retail food store along with associated parking facilities; and**
- (d) a publicly accessible riverside park.**

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

- (a) development to be carried out in a comprehensive basis in accordance with the requirements and provisions of the endorsed site development brief;**
- (b) development not to commence until a replacement livestock market facility is provided and operational;**
- (c) vehicular access to be provided via the formation of appropriate new junctions onto Under Lane and the A388;**

- (d) -safeguarding of future highway access to potential future residential development on adjoining land to the west;**
- (e) development proposals to preserve or enhance the adjoining Conservation Area, including its wider setting;**
- (f) provision of an integrated package of strategic landscaping and green infrastructure, including public open space along and adjacent to the southern site boundary, to integrate the development into its setting and mitigate its impact on the wider countryside;**
- (g) provision of a pedestrian friendly and permeable layout including access to, and along, the River Deer corridor at the southern boundary; and**
- (h) incorporation of a sustainable water strategy.**

10.269 A site of about 4.5 hectares to the south of Under Lane is allocated for a comprehensive scheme of mixed use redevelopment including the provision of a convenience food store, new homes and public open space.

10.270 The site is currently home to the town's livestock market, however the premises are coming to the end of their functional life and the site is not considered appropriate to serve the requirements of a modern livestock market. A site to the north of Holsworthy is allocated for the provision of a replacement facility (HOL01: Agri-business Park). Redevelopment of HOL02: Land South of Under Lane, is enabled only on the basis of a replacement livestock market being provided and operational. Subject to the successful relocation, redevelopment of this brownfield site offers an opportunity to regenerate an important area of the town, including one of its principal gateways whilst delivering development that will bring benefits to the town.

10.271 Reflecting the location of the site, its proximity to the conservation area and its sensitive landscape setting, development proposals will be expected to deliver a high quality built and natural form which knits the development into the existing built form and offers an appropriate transition to the open countryside. Recognising the importance of the site as a gateway into the town, proposals should pay particular regard to the form, nature and quality of development to be delivered along the eastern boundary fronting the highway.

10.272 A new convenience retail food store and associated parking will be delivered on approximately 1 hectare of the site adjacent to the northern boundary served by a new highway access onto Under Lane. The provision of a new retail food store will help to increase the self-containment of the town by increasing the choice of convenience retail available within the town whilst reducing retail leakage to other nearby towns. In doing so, the provision may increase footfall to the town centre through 'linked trips' helping in turn to enhance the vitality and vibrancy of the town centre as a whole.

10.273 The site will deliver approximately 90 new homes, the nature and mix of which will be reflective of local housing needs and demands for Holsworthy and its rural hinterland. To support an appropriate transition between the built form and the open countryside, and in support of the spatial vision's aspiration to connect the town to the countryside, a linear riverside park will be delivered spanning the southern boundary of the site along the river corridor.

10.274 Highway access to support the development will be provided through the formation of new junctions onto the A388 and Under Lane. The development will be designed to safeguard future highway access to potential future residential land to the west.

10.275 The site lies within a Critical Drainage Area. Development proposals will need to be supported by a sustainable water strategy which will include the management of surface water run-off through an enhanced Sustainable Drainage System.

Policy HOL03: Land between Rydon Road and Trewyn Road

(1) Land between Rydon Road and Trewyn Road, extending to about 10.5 hectares, as defined on Policies Map 6, is allocated for residential development that includes:

- (a) approximately 140 dwellings, the type, size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs; and**
- (b) provision of a section of a distributor link road from Rydon Road onto the northern site boundary.**

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

- (a) retention and enhancement of existing hedgerows and provision of strategic green infrastructure on the western part of the site and to the northern boundary to facilitate integration of the site into the wider landscape;**
- (b) primary highway access from a new junction onto Rydon Road with secondary access onto Trewyn Road and Trewyn Park Road;**
- (c) development proposals that avoid or mitigate any adverse impacts on the adjacent County Wildlife Site;**
- (d) development proposals that are supported by a sustainable water strategy; and,**
- (e) proposals that safeguard the opportunities for the future operation of the quarry located to the north west of the site.**

10.276 A site of about 10.5 hectares on the western side of the town is allocated for the delivery of approximately 140 new homes, the nature and mix of which will take account of local needs and demands. The site will also deliver strategic highway benefits in the form of part of a new link between Rydon Road and Trewyn Road.

10.277 Development of this greenfield site will have an acceptable impact on local landscape and existing development and will integrate well into the existing built form of the town.

10.278 The development will provide the first, southern, section of a new distributor road that will link Rydon Road to Trewyn Road. The new junction with Rydon Road and the design of the new road will be adequate to perform this role and provide access to the new development. This road will go to the northern boundary of the site.

10.279 Suitable access will also be provided from the development to Trewyn Road and to Trewyn Park Road.

10.280 The site borders open countryside on the northern and western sides. Strategic green infrastructure on these boundaries will be required to provide a natural transition between the built area and countryside and facilitate the integration of the site into the wider landscape. Existing hedgerows will be retained and enhanced.

10.281 The Rydon Farm Grassland County Wildlife Site adjoins the western boundary of the housing site. The development will ensure there are no adverse effects on this area and will provide suitable mitigation for any unavoidable impacts.

10.282 The site lies within a Critical Drainage Area and the nearby River Deer has an identified floodplain on the western boundary and further downstream. Development of the site will be supported by a sustainable water strategy, including enhanced sustainable drainage that minimises the use of water and any off site impact.

10.283 Trewyn sandstone quarry is to the northwest of the housing area. This is an important resource and its future operation will be safeguarded while ensuring that there is no statutory nuisance likely to be generated. This will be achieved by a variety of means including not enabling housing development in close proximity and providing an appropriate transition between the area that is or may be worked and residential development. The transition area will include appropriate landscaping and planting. Additionally, an appropriate highway access to the site will be provided through the development.

Policy HOL04: West of Dobles Lane Industrial Estate

(1) Land to the west of Dobles Lane Industrial Estate, extending to about 2.1 hectares and as defined on Policies Map 6, is allocated for economic development that includes:

(a) land and premises for economic development that is reflective of the site, its wider context and focused on meeting identified local business needs; and

(b) an extended spinal estate road, connecting River Tamar Way to the southern boundary of the allocated site, appropriate to serve the proposed development, safeguard future opportunities for the delivery of economic development on the adjoining field parcel to the south and to form part of a future highway link to Trewyn Road.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

(a) provision of off-site highway improvements as necessitated by the development;

(b) appropriate layout, planting, screening and boundary treatments to:

(i) safeguard the amenity of neighbouring properties; and

(ii) provide an acceptable transition to the open countryside; and

(c) incorporation of a sustainable water strategy.

10.284 A site of about 2.1 hectares is allocated for the provision of economic development to the west of the existing Dobles Lane Industrial Estate. The allocation will deliver a further phase of expansion to the successful industrial estate and will make a significant contribution to meeting the future general employment needs of the town and its wider rural hinterland.

10.285 The type and form of employment premises and floorspace provided should be reflective of local market demand.

10.286 The site comprises open farmland and forms part of the final strip of open land that separates the existing industrial estate from Trewyn Road. Development proposals will be expected

to deliver an extended spinal estate road, continuing River Tamar Way, through the site, to the southern boundary of the allocated site. In doing so, the new highway will be appropriate to serve the proposed development whilst safeguarding opportunities to deliver appropriate highway access to serve potential future economic development on the adjoining field parcel to the south of the allocation and to form part of a distributor route connecting Dobles Lane, via River Tamar Way to Trewyn Road. The intention in the longer term is to complete a new distributor route, supporting improved highway connectivity within and around the town.

10.287 The allocated site lies at the edge of the existing built form of Holsworthy, at the transition between the town and the open countryside. Development proposals will be expected to respect this sensitive setting and deliver development of a bulk, form and layout that responds to it. A strong component of landscaping, structural planting and boundary treatments will be expected to ensure the site is appropriately integrated into its wider setting and also respect the sensitivity of any adjoining uses.

10.288 The site lies within a Critical Drainage Area. Development proposals will need to be supported by a sustainable water strategy which will include the management of surface water run-off through an enhanced Sustainable Drainage System.

Policy HOL05: Land between Dobles Lane and North Road

(1) Land between Dobles Lane and North Road, extending to about 2.2 hectares and as defined on Policies Map 6, is allocated for residential development that includes:

(a) provision of approximately 60 dwellings, the type, size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

(a) financial contributions towards off-site enhancements to recreation and sports provision;

(b) vehicular access provided only onto the A388 (North Road) in a form appropriate to serve the residential development proposed under HOL05 and HOL06;

(c) an enhanced entrance into Holsworthy Town on the A388 delivered through the development of HOL05 and HOL06;

(d) pedestrian and cycle access onto Dobles Lane; and

(e) incorporation of a sustainable water strategy.

10.289 A greenfield site of about 2.2 hectares which lies between Dobles Lane and North Road is allocated for the delivery of new homes. The site is intended to deliver approximately 60 dwellings of a nature and mix appropriate to meet local housing needs and demands.

10.290 Highway access will be provided through the formation of a new junction onto the A388 (North Road). The junction will be of a form appropriate not only to serve the development itself but also enable appropriate highway access to be provided to serve the proposed residential development on Land to the East of North Road (Policy HOL06: Land East of North Road). Recognising the nature of the other roads surrounding the site, vehicular access will not be enabled onto any alternative roads. Pedestrian and cycle links will however be provided onto

Dobles Lane to enable safe and convenient access towards the hospital, health centre and employment sites.

10.291 The site lies within a Critical Drainage Area. Development proposals will need to be supported by a sustainable water strategy which will include the management of surface water run-off through an enhanced Sustainable Drainage System.

10.292 An enhanced gateway into the town will be delivered through the development of HOL05 and HOL06. Development of the two sites will create a new entry into the town along a significant route, it is important that an attractive entrance into Holsworthy is secured with regard to the transition from the countryside into the built form of town.

Policy HOL06: Land East of North Road

(1) Land to the east of North Road, extending to about 3.9 hectares and as defined on Policies Map 6, is allocated for residential development subject to:

(a) provision of about 110 dwellings, the type, size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

(a) incorporation of a sustainable water strategy;

(b) provision of green infrastructure across the eastern part of site that lies outside of the development boundary and delivery of a footpath linking the residential development to Waterloo Road;

(c) an enhanced entrance into Holsworthy town on the A388 delivered through the development of HOL05 and HOL06;

(d) primary vehicular access through the formation of a new junction onto the A388 of a nature appropriate to serve the residential development proposed under HOL5 and HOL6;

(e) secondary vehicular access through the formation of a new junction onto the unnamed road fronting the northern boundary; and

(f) development proposals that avoid or mitigate any adverse impacts on the adjacent County Wildlife Site.

10.293 A greenfield site of approximately 3.9 hectares to the east of North Road is allocated to provide new homes to help meet the housing needs of Holsworthy and its surrounding rural hinterland. The site is intended to deliver around 110 new dwellings, the nature and mix of which will take account of local needs and demands.

10.294 The site lies within a Critical Drainage Area. Development proposals will need to be supported by a sustainable water strategy which will include the management of surface water run-off through an enhanced.

10.295 Principal highway access will be provided through the formation of a new highway junction onto the A388 (North Road). The junction will be of a form appropriate not only to serve the development itself but also enable appropriate highway access to be provided to serve the

proposed residential development on adjacent land between Dobles Lane and North Road (Policy HOL05: Land Between Dobles Lane and North Road). Secondary highway access may be enabled onto the unnamed road that adjoins the northern boundary to the site.

10.296 Responding to the aspiration to connect the town to the countryside as set out in the spatial vision, the site will deliver a new footpath to link the residential development to Waterloo Road, following the indicative route identified on the Policies Map. Further proposals enabled through the Local Plan under Policy HOL07 will deliver a continuation of the provided footpath link and a connection towards the town centre.

10.297 The Waterloo Meadows County Wildlife Site adjoins the north eastern boundary of the housing site. The development will ensure there are no adverse effects on this area and will provide suitable mitigation for any unavoidable impacts.

Policy HOL07: Land off Menors Place

(1) Land off Menors Place, extending to about 0.7 hectares and as defined on Policies Map 6, is allocated for residential development including:

(a) provision of approximately 15 dwellings, the type, size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

(a) formation of vehicular access from Menors Place;

(b) development form, mass, scale layout and design of a nature sympathetic to the existing residential development on Menors Place;

(c) provision of footpath link from site to A388 via trackway at south-west corner of site;

(d) financial contributions towards off-site enhancements to recreation and sports provision;

(e) provision of green infrastructure across the eastern part of the site that lies outside of the development boundary and delivery of a footpath linking the residential development to Waterloo Road; and

(f) incorporation of a sustainable water strategy.

10.298 A small greenfield site to the south and east of Menors Place is allocated to deliver approximately 15 new homes to help meet the future housing requirements of Holsworthy and its surrounding rural hinterland. The form of the new development should be sympathetic to the nature of the existing housing development found on Menors Place so that it integrates with the existing built form. The hedge banks surrounding the site should be safeguarded and enhanced to support a natural transition between the built form and the open countryside beyond.

10.299 The principal highway access for the development will be provided through a continuation of the estate road through Menors Place. The scale of development will be restricted to that which can be supported by the existing estate road and highway junctions.

10.300 To enable safe and convenient access to the town centre, a pedestrian and cycle access will be provided via the trackway to the south west corner of the site. Responding to the aspiration to connect the town to the countryside as set out in the spatial vision, the site will deliver a new footpath to link the residential development to Waterloo Road following the indicative route identified on the Policies Map. Further proposals enabled through the Local Plan under Policy HOL06: Land East of North Road, will deliver a continuation of the provided footpath link and enable circular walks, part of which will be in the countryside.

10.301 The site lies within a Critical Drainage Area. Development proposals will need to be supported by a sustainable water strategy which will include the management of surface water run-off through an enhanced Sustainable Drainage System.

Policy HOL08: Safeguarded Pedestrian and Cycle Route

The route, as defined on the Policies Map, is safeguarded for the existing and future provision of a trail.

10.302 The route identified on the Policies Map, running from the District boundary near Budds Titson in the west, through Holsworthy and east towards Hatherleigh, principally following the route of the former railway line, is safeguarded for the existing and future provision of a footpath/cycleway route. The Council will support proposals that seek to deliver new or enhanced pedestrian and cycle access along and to the safeguarded route.

Ilfracombe

The Place

10.303 Ilfracombe is a coastal town and working harbour situated along Devon's north coast. It is the third largest settlement in northern Devon and is an important service centre providing a range of retail, education, health and community facilities and employment opportunities. The town has an impressive landscape setting within the coastal zone, including the harbour, Hillsborough promontory fort to the east of the town and the Torrs to the west, a setting that is popular with locals and tourists alike. Development has grown up the hillsides around the harbour and town beaches and covers a natural amphitheatre facing the Bristol Channel. The town is located about 19 kilometres (12 miles) north of Barnstaple, accessed along the A361 through Braunton, and west of Combe Martin along the A399. The South West Coast Path passes through the town and the North Devon Coast Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty borders the town to the east and west. The rocky coastline in Ilfracombe and inner Harbour is part of the Voluntary Marine Conservation Area and Marine Conservation Zone. These designations recognise the ecological and geological importance of the cliffs and foreshore along this stretch of the coastline.

10.304 Ilfracombe has a large number of historic buildings, especially around the harbour and High Street. The town expanded rapidly through the 19th Century as tourism became a major economic sector including the development of several grand terraces and hotels. The harbour, seafront, topography, landscape setting and its substantial growth during the Victorian era all contribute to the town's special character. A large part of the town is included within a conservation area that covers around 79 hectares and includes 197 listed buildings. The condition of some buildings and spaces in the conservation area has led to it being identified as 'at risk' of decline.

10.305 Ilfracombe's current population is about 12,500, which has increased by less than 3% over the period 2001-2010, significantly lower than rates of population growth in other towns in northern Devon. Growth has been constrained by topography and landscape designations surrounding the town. In 2011, there were about 6,000 households in the town of which there is a high proportion of flats (about 33%) with a relatively high density of development. There is a comparatively high proportion of Houses in Multiple Occupation (HMOs) compared to the other main towns, comprising about 4% of Ilfracombe's total housing stock, concentrated in localities within the Central Ward. Ilfracombe has a large proportion (29%) of private rented dwellings and over 53% of vulnerable households live in non-decent dwellings, in part due to the number of sub-divided larger Victorian properties.

10.306 Unemployment rates are amongst the highest in northern Devon and average household incomes are amongst the lowest, influenced by relatively high dependency on seasonal employment. The tourism sector (accommodation, shops and restaurants) is very important to the local economy. There are also major employers specialising in high technology industries such as TDK Lambda and Pall both of which are within Ilfracombe West Ward, which has Assisted Area status.

10.307 Ilfracombe has relatively high levels of deprivation and the Central Ward is recorded as the most deprived ward in Devon, although there are varying levels of deprivation across the remaining town. The town's population has a high level of dependency on state benefits. Life expectancy is also the lowest in Devon and substantially below the national average. Many of Ilfracombe's community facilities are at or close to capacity including the town's schools and health centres. There is a shortage of sports pitches, constrained by the town's topography, and an identified deficiency for most types of formal open space, although there is good access to the beaches, coast path and the countryside surrounding the town.

The Future

10.308 The strategy for the town is to deliver regeneration through growth to an increased population of approximately 15,000 to support greater self sufficiency. This housing and employment growth will facilitate improved access to key services and facilities to enhance the town's existing service role, which also supports other rural communities along the north coast. Development will deliver significant growth that will address the social and economic needs of the town's existing and future residents as well as tourists who visit the town. The overall strategy for Ilfracombe is considered to be consistent with the aspirations of the Town Council within their Ilfracombe Strategic Plan 2015-2025.

10.309 A range of housing will be provided to meet the community's expanding and changing needs. In addition to existing committed sites, new sites will be delivered to provide the levels of housing growth required to support the town's development. A southern extension to the town will provide a high quality development that makes a substantial contribution to the town's housing needs and is supported by necessary physical, social and green infrastructure. It will also deliver a new primary school, extra care housing and medical facility. Existing flood risks will be addressed through enhancement of existing flood defences, including through the surface water management plan.

The Spatial Vision and Development Strategy for Ilfracombe to 2031

Policy ILF: Ilfracombe Spatial Vision and Development Strategy

The Spatial Vision

Ilfracombe will be regenerated through a strategy of population growth, with a southern extension to the town providing employment opportunities, a new neighbourhood hub and a mix of high quality, sustainable family and affordable housing. Community driven regeneration of the town centre through high quality design, including improvements to the existing housing stock, and enhancement of the harbour and sea front will capitalise on the town's built heritage, cultural assets, open spaces, high quality landscape, key habitats and coastal setting.

Tourism will be revitalised over an extended season with the town prospering as a maritime gateway for northern Devon and beyond. Opportunities for new maritime and leisure industries will be maximised, whilst safeguarding the harbour and seafront from rising sea levels and facilitating its continued operation as a port. Ilfracombe will become a vibrant, healthy, prosperous town providing for the needs of all with access to superfast broadband, workforce and business support and improved accessibility to training opportunities to improve both skills and business productivity with expanded employment opportunities at Mullacott Business Park.

Increased partnership working with 'One Ilfracombe' including other local organisations will deliver key services and facilities including through the community and voluntary sectors. The community will be empowered to make the most of its talents and leadership to deliver the vision.

The Spatial Development Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable growth of high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Ilfracombe. The spatial vision for Ilfracombe will be delivered through:

(a) provision of a minimum of 1,429 dwellings, including affordable and extra care homes, to meet the range of the communities' housing needs, with associated development and infrastructure on a continuous basis during the Plan period between 2011 and 2031;

(b) provision of new site allocations of approximately 935 dwellings and non-strategic housing sites of approximately 71 dwellings;

(c) an urban extension to the south of Ilfracombe including Worth Meadows (as part of the provision of new site allocations) to accommodate approximately 875 new family dwellings and a neighbourhood hub supported by required physical, social and green infrastructure;

(d) provision of additional employment land at Mullacott Business Park to enhance the town's role as a strategically significant employment centre, together with approximately 1 hectare of land for employment and business uses within the neighbourhood hub of the strategic southern extension;

(e) economic growth through capitalising on enhanced levels of assistance offered by the Assisted Area status;

(f) support for initiatives, including innovative ways of promoting, procuring and delivering required affordable housing for Ilfracombe, including encouraging the refurbishment of existing buildings to meet needs on and off site where justified by robust and credible evidence of need;

(g) support for initiatives within and around the harbour and seafront areas to improve sea defences, mitigate against any adverse harm on bathing waters, revitalise key regeneration sites, provide opportunities for new tourism, marine, leisure and recreation facilities, and improve traffic management around the town;

(h) encouragement of higher spend niche markets to develop Ilfracombe's tourism industry over an extended season;

(i) capitalising on opportunities for public art within the town to build on Verity's legacy including development of Ilfracombe Academy as a 'specialist' arts school;

(j) social and community facilities required to support new development including increased primary school capacity, a children's centre delivery base, early years and youth provision, additional sports pitches, allotments and extension to the existing cemetery;

(k) developments conserving and enhancing Ilfracombe's historic environment and townscape quality and identity, safeguarding and enhancing the special character and appearance of the Conservation Area at risk of decline, reinforcing its distinctive character and sense of place, and respecting its landscape setting including the special landscape character and qualities of the adjoining Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty;

(l) enhancement of Ilfracombe's transport infrastructure, as set out in the Transport Master Plan, secured through the continued support for a 'park and change' facility that reduces town centre congestion, accommodates more effectively through improved safety and capacity the vehicular traffic which is necessary for the town's continued economic regeneration, and optimises accessibility to jobs, shops and community facilities within and around the town;

(m) improved public transport linkages from the town to the strategic rail network; and

(n) provision of additional water storage areas within development sites compared to normal Sustainable Drainage System design in recognition of Ilfracombe being within a Critical Drainage Area.

10.310 The total housing requirement for Ilfracombe over the plan period 2011 to 2031 is for a minimum of 1,429 dwellings. This overall housing requirement will be delivered through a mixture of development completed since April 2011, existing commitments, identified housing allocations and non-strategic housing sites as set out in Table 10.12 'Ilfracombe Housing Provision 2011-2031'.

Table 10.12 Ilfracombe Housing Provision 2011-2031

Housing Land Supply 2011-2031	Number of Dwellings
Allocations⁽¹⁾ :	935
Non-strategic Housing Sites⁽²⁾ :	71
Other Sites Contributing to Supply :	398
Dwelling Completions (2011 to 31st March 2017) :	196
Planning Commitments ⁽³⁾ :	202
Total Supply for Ilfracombe	1,404

(1) Including planning commitments and completions on allocated sites (as of 31st March 2017). (2) See Appendix 5. (3) Including extant planning permissions (with small non-started permissions subject to 15% non-implementation discount), resolution to grant planning permission subject to signing of s106 agreement, permissions that have been implemented and dwellings under construction (as of 31st March 2017).

10.311 The total employment requirement for Ilfracombe over the period 2011 to 2031 is for approximately 5 hectares of additional land for economic development. This overall employment requirement will be delivered through intensification of existing employment sites (Policy ILF04: Mullacott Business Park) and the phased delivery of business premises as part of the southern extension (Policy ILF01: Strategic Southern Extension) as set out in Table 10.13 'Employment/Economic Development Land Supply for Ilfracombe 2011-2031'.

Table 10.13 Employment/Economic Development Land Supply for Ilfracombe 2011-2031

Employment/Economic Development Land Supply for Ilfracombe 2011-2031	Hectares of Employment/Economic Development Land Proposed
Southern Extension (ILF01)	1.0
Mullacott Business Park (ILF04)	4.0
Total Supply for Ilfracombe	5.0

The Development Proposals

10.312 A series of proposals are enabled through the Local Plan to support the delivery of the spatial vision for the town. The spatial extent of proposals are depicted on Policies Maps 7 and 7A and each is subject to a specific Local Plan Policy, included below, which sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with any site specific development principles.

The Vision for Ilfracombe Strategic Southern Extension:

A strategic southern extension to Ilfracombe will contribute to the town's economic regeneration. The development will deliver a new neighbourhood to the town, providing a new gateway on a key approach and a community with a distinctive sense of place and quality of life. The development will complement Ilfracombe's high quality landscape setting incorporating a network of green infrastructure that provides an east-west corridor across the site, a naturally landscaped southern boundary with the adjoining countryside, and formal and informal sport and recreation facilities. The new neighbourhood will be of high quality and sustainable design through its construction and future occupation. The development will incorporate measures that will reduce carbon emissions as well as facilitating opportunities for sustainable travel within and around Ilfracombe. A neighbourhood hub will provide a focus for the new community, incorporating business opportunities, primary education, healthcare and community facilities complementing but not replacing facilities available elsewhere in the town.

Policy ILF01: Ilfracombe Strategic Southern Extension

(1) Land to the south of Ilfracombe, (about 63 hectares) as identified on Policies Map 7, will deliver a sustainable, high quality, mixed use development that includes:

- (a) approximately 875 dwellings over two separate sites, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs;**
 - (i) approximately 750 dwellings on land at Channel, Winsham and Bowden Farms; and**
 - (ii) approximately 125 dwellings on land off Worth Road (Worth Meadows).**
- (b) approximately 1 hectare of land for economic development;**
- (c) a neighbourhood hub to include an additional 420 place primary school, medical facility and extra care housing scheme of approximately 50 bedspaces;**
- (d) formal and informal sport and recreation facilities; and**
- (e) provision within the sites for physical infrastructure, community facilities, and green infrastructure required by the development.**

(2) The sites will be developed in a comprehensive manner to deliver the following site specific development principles:

- (a) create a distinctive, safe, sustainable, high quality urban extension and new neighbourhood for Ilfracombe;**
- (b) integrate new development within the existing landscape setting of the town enhancing its character, minimising impacts on the adjoining North Devon Coast Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty and safeguarding the dark night skies over Exmoor National Park;**
- (c) provide an appropriate transitional boundary between the development and adjacent countryside;**
- (d) provide a neighbourhood hub that forms a focus to meet the community's needs, establishes a new 'gateway' into Ilfracombe and makes provision for new**

space for business opportunities as well as complementary services and facilities rather than replacing those available elsewhere, particularly in the town centre;

(e) enhance and make connections to the existing network of local and strategic green infrastructure through and around the site including the provision of new footpaths, cycleways, public open spaces, wildlife corridors, formal and informal sport and recreation facilities;

(f) safeguard land immediately to the south of the cemetery for a future extension to the existing burial ground;

(g) provide a mix of house types, tenures and sizes of open market and affordable homes contributing towards the identified local needs; and

(h) provide a sustainable water strategy that reduces water usage, incorporates additional water storage areas compared to normal sustainable drainage systems and does not increase the risk of flooding elsewhere in the town.

(3) The transport and connectivity strategy for the southern extension, as supported by the Ilfracombe Transport Master Plan will:

(a) establish a permeable and connected network of streets, footpaths and cycleways across the site that connect to and safeguard future linkages to adjoining parts of the town;

(b) facilitate connections for motor vehicles, cycles and pedestrians between the proposed development, the town centre and key employment areas including increased opportunities for public transport links and sustainable travel choices within and around Ilfracombe to reduce reliance on the private motor car; and

(c) contribute towards improving strategic access into Ilfracombe along New and Old Barnstaple Roads.

10.313 Development of a strategic extension to the south of the town will be developed in a comprehensive manner, albeit the land off Worth Meadow will be delivered separately from the land around Winsham, Channel and Bowden Farms. In addition to about 875 dwellings, of predominantly family housing, including a proportion of affordable housing, development of the site as a whole will provide a new 420 place primary school, -additional sport and leisure facilities, new business space, a new medical facility and a 50-bed extra care housing scheme within a new neighbourhood hub to address the needs of the expanding town. The neighbourhood hub will be located on land to the south of the Tesco store to provide services and facilities complementing those within the town centre and served by a regular public transport route from the Seafront / High Street via the Ilfracombe Academy and on to Mullacott Business Park. The strategic southern extension will be delivered in phases to a high quality sustainable design in accordance with Policies ST04: Improving the Quality of Development and ST05: Sustainable Construction and Buildings, with the neighbourhood hub and a 210 place primary school delivered during the early phases of construction with sufficient land safeguarded for its future expansion.

10.314 The development around Channel, Winsham and Bowden Farms will be accessed off the Old Barnstaple Road whereas the Worth Meadows site will provide a new junction(s) on to Worth Road. Contributions will be required towards upgrading the Lynton Cross junction on the B3230 in accordance with Policy ST10: Transport Strategy.

10.315 Ilfracombe cemetery is situated south of Marlborough Road. Land immediately south of the existing cemetery has been identified for its extension, which will be needed for the town over the plan period. This land will be safeguarded from development for other purposes. Winsham Farm County Wildlife Site will be protected and enhanced as part of a green infrastructure link between Bicclescombe Park Road and New Barnstaple Road, including a network of footpaths and cycleways to the south of the town that will improve connectivity for pedestrians and cyclists from the southern extension to TDK Lambda and Bicclescombe Park. Improved footpath and cycle linkages will also be required between Ilfracombe Academy on Worth Road and New Barnstaple Road.

10.316 Due to the site's elevated position and visual prominence within the wider landscape, including from the adjoining Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty and the Dark Sky Reserve over Exmoor, the development and new gateway to the town should be designed to complement its sensitive landscape setting and provide a transitional boundary between the development and adjacent countryside that reflects the local landscape character. External street lighting will need to be designed to minimise light pollution on the Dark Sky Reserve over Exmoor National Park and adjoining Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty.

10.317 Ilfracombe is within a Critical Drainage Area where it has been identified that large areas of the town are at risk of flooding. Development of the southern extension will be required to incorporate appropriate measures to reduce the risk of flooding elsewhere in the town, especially along East Wilder Brook to the west of the site and Hele Stream to the east, in accordance with Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience. A comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme should be integrated within the provision of green infrastructure that will be required to incorporate additional water storage areas that should permeate throughout the site, creating linkages with existing biodiversity networks in the area.

Policy ILF02: Land at The Shields/Fernway

A site of about 2.5 hectares at The Shields / Fernway, as identified on Policies Map 7, is allocated for a residential development that includes:

- (a) approximately 60 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs;**
- (b) a new road through the site linking The Shields and Marlborough Road;**
- (c) connections to the existing network of green infrastructure through and around the site including the provision of new footpaths, public open space and enhancement of the biodiversity network focused around the cemetery; and**
- (d) contributions towards additional physical, social and green infrastructure within the town.**

10.318 Development of approximately 60 houses at The Shields / Fernway should include a mix of dwelling types and sizes including a proportion of affordable housing, contributing towards the identified local needs. The site will provide a new road through the site between Marlborough Road and The Shields, thereby improving traffic circulation within the town and accessibility towards the proposed neighbourhood hub. Part of the site to the north of the cemetery is identified as a key feature within the wider biodiversity network which should be protected to enhance its biodiversity value and to safeguard its landscape prominence. The design of any development should be sensitive to its prominent landscape setting and potential impact on amenities of dwellings on the lower slopes. Development will be required to incorporate a suitable sustainable

drainage scheme with additional water storage areas to prevent any increased risk of flooding elsewhere in the town, especially along East Wilder Brook to the west of the site.

Policy ILF04: Mullacott Business Park

(1) A site of approximately 4 hectares of land is allocated for economic development, as identified on Policies Map 7A that includes:

- (a) vehicular access through the existing industrial estate;**
- (b) structural landscaping along the eastern and south-western boundaries;**
- (c) measures to safeguard the dark night skies over Exmoor National Park; and**
- (d) contributions towards the provision of bus and cycle links to connect to the town centre and proposed Southern Extension (Policy ILF01) where it does not undermine viability.**

(2) A reserve site of approximately 2 hectares east of the existing Business Park, as shown on Policies Map 7A is safeguarded for future economic development if required during the plan period. The site will be released if:

- (a) the allocated land has been fully developed or committed; and**
- (b) the land is required to meet additional demand.**

10.319 As part of Ilfracombe's strategy for regeneration through growth, new business and employment opportunities at Mullacott Business Park as an intensification of the existing business park will be supported on the following sites: Land west of Commercial Point (approximately 1 hectare); Land south of Lundy View (approximately 1 hectare); Land east of Commercial Point (approximately 0.6 hectares); Land east of Lundy View (approximately 0.3 hectares) and Land south of the A3123 (approximately 0.8 hectares). Business units will also be delivered within the new Neighbourhood Hub as part of the Southern Extension (Policy ILF01: Strategic Southern Extension) although Mullacott Business Park will continue to be the focus for general employment uses for Ilfracombe and the surrounding area. Development at Mullacott Business Park will capitalise on enhanced levels of assistance offered by the Assisted Area status. Proposals for retailing and other identified town centre uses should be considered against Policy DM19: Town and District Centres.

10.320 If the allocated sites were to be developed out during the early part of the plan period and the local economy were to dictate the need for additional land for economic uses at Mullacott, an extension eastwards of approximately 2 hectares would be supported including appropriate structural landscaping along the eastern boundary. Any additional land should be accessed through the existing estate with improvements to the junction on to the A3123 in order to increase capacity.

10.321 Mullacott Business Park will be served by improved public transport and cycle links to and from the town centre, incorporating links with the new Neighbourhood Hub as part of the Southern Extension. Improvements to the strategic highway network from Aller Cross (A3123 and A399) are required in order to reduce congestion and impacts on air quality through Braunton.

10.322 Due to the site's elevated position and visual prominence within the wider landscape, including parts of the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty, the Dark Sky Reserve over Exmoor and the adjoining the Undeveloped Coast (Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy), the

development including any external lighting should be designed to complement its sensitive landscape setting and provide a transitional boundary between the development and adjacent countryside that reflects the local landscape character.

Policy ILF05: Harbour / Seafront Tourist Area

(1) Proposals for new leisure, tourism, commercial, maritime and recreation development will be supported in the Harbour and Seafront Tourism Area, as shown on Policies Map 7, where they:

(a) conserve and enhance the area's built heritage, street scene and the special character and appearance of the Conservation Area;

(b) retain and enhance the open character and landscape quality of the Seafront Area and the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty; and

(c) do not prejudice the achievement of pedestrian priority in the area.

(2) Land at Ilfracombe Harbour, identified as the Inner and Outer Harbour, will be safeguarded for harbour related uses that require a quayside location, subject to:

(a) retaining necessary access to the quay for service and commercial vehicles; and

(b) a high standard of design that respects the heritage and historic character and appearance of the quay and harbour area.

10.323 Ilfracombe harbour is one of the oldest areas of the town and is the town's largest tourist attraction. It is situated within the conservation area and incorporates a number of listed buildings including the Grade I listed St. Nicholas' Chapel and Grade II* Old Quay Head. The impressive landscape setting of the harbour includes the Scheduled Ancient Monument and Local Nature Reserve at Hillsborough (Policy ILF06: Local Green Space), the North Devon Coast Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty and the 'Verity' statue by the world-renowned artist Damien Hirst. Development in the harbour area should be of an appropriate design quality to protect its historic character and landscape setting.

10.324 The importance of Ilfracombe harbour to the local economy has grown over recent years with increasing use for commercial fishing, mooring of visiting and local leisure boats, charter boats for fishing and diving, ferries to Lundy Island, the RNLI and an increasing demand for visits by international cruise ships. Opportunities for new or enhanced facilities for the commercial fishing industry, commercial and pleasure cruise vessels and yachts will be supported to help deliver Ilfracombe Harbour Board's Development Strategy (2012-2026). The town is an important 'gateway' destination for passengers, increasing tourism opportunities for the town, northern Devon and the wider South West region.

10.325 The future enhancement of the harbour to facilitate opportunities for larger vessels to be accommodated and for new ferry links with South Wales and Ireland will contribute towards regeneration of the town. The pier at Ilfracombe is currently used as a public pay and display car park, with peak usage being mainly during the principal tourism season. Opportunities to provide alternative car parking provision that helps to alleviate traffic congestion and achieve pedestrian priority within the quay and harbour areas will be supported.

10.326 Opportunities for water-based recreation activities within the harbour area, including the erection of a new watersports centre, will be supported where they do not prejudice its

operation as a commercial harbour. In addition, appropriate infrastructure should also be incorporated into the harbour to facilitate an operational hub for any future large-scale off-shore renewable energy schemes. Proposals to safeguard the harbour and seafront from rising sea levels and to facilitate its continued use as an operational harbour will be supported in accordance with the strategy within the Shoreline Management Plan.

10.327 The seafront area, to the west of the harbour, is characterised by large areas of public open space including Capstone Hill to the north of Wilder Road and large Victorian and Edwardian hotels to the south, both of which contribute to the town's economy. Proposals that enhance the local tourist economy along the northern side of Wilder Road will be supported, such as new public art or an art gallery, provided that the open character of the seafront is protected within the conservation area.

10.328 There are a number of shops, public houses, restaurants, take-aways and amusement arcades within the harbour and seafront area that contribute to the town's tourist economy, but are outside the defined town centre. New retail and leisure developments within the harbour and seafront area are supported where they will enhance or diversify the town's tourist economy, provided that the vitality and viability of the town centre is not harmed and the amenities of residents and tourists living in the locality are safeguarded. Enhancement of existing pedestrian links between the harbour, seafront and High Street will be supported.

10.329 The redevelopment of key regeneration sites including the former Golden Coast amusements, Berkeley Hotel, former Montebello Hotel and the former Pavilion site will be supported where development would create successful urban spaces that contribute positively to the local economy and sustainability of the town. Community-led regeneration of the harbour and seafront areas will be supported, including proposals for new tourism and leisure attractions and provision for high quality tourist accommodation.

10.330 Parts of the seafront and town centre have a high concentration of Housing in Multiple Occupation (HMOs). The contribution of HMOs to meeting Ilfracombe's current and future housing needs is recognised, particularly as a source of accommodation for people on low incomes, benefit payments and the growing number of one-person households. However, it is also recognised that the high concentration of HMOs within parts of the town impacts on the balance of local communities. The spatial strategy encourages the refurbishment of existing poor quality privately rented housing to provide much needed affordable housing for Ilfracombe. Policy ST17: A Balanced Local Housing Market, also seeks to re-balance the local housing market, with the southern extension (Policy ILF01: Strategic Southern Extension) delivering predominantly family housing to help contribute towards the creation of a sustainable, inclusive and mixed community.

10.331 Ilfracombe's Transport Master Plan will provide a holistic approach to traffic management, movement and parking within and around the town. It will facilitate visitor management within the town with improved parking and access to the town centre, harbour and seafront.

Policy ILF06: Local Green Space

Land at Brimlands and Hillsborough of approximately 21 hectares, as shown on Policies Map 7, is identified as a local green space where any development must protect and enhance:

- (a) the heritage value of Hillsborough's Scheduled Ancient Monument and its setting;**
- (b) the special character and qualities of the North Devon Coast Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty;**

(c) the site's features of local biodiversity value, including its Local Nature Reserve;

(d) opportunities for outdoor sport and recreation; and

(e) the area's open character, with any new buildings or structures sited and designed to minimise their visual impact.

10.332 Hillsborough and Larkstone form an important part of the open landscape setting for Ilfracombe harbour, which are situated within the North Devon Coast Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty. The Cliff Castle at Hillsborough is a major promontory fort from the Iron Age, which is designated as a Scheduled Ancient Monument. It is also designated as a Local Nature Reserve that contributes to the green infrastructure along the coast and provides a large public open space crossed by the South West Coast Path. The local green space designation will enhance the heritage and biodiversity value of Hillsborough, whilst providing opportunities for enhanced outdoor recreation.

10.333 Land at Brimlands to the south of Hillsborough provides formal and informal sport and recreation facilities including a swimming pool, rugby, football and cricket pitches and a pitch and putt course. Proposals for new or enhanced sport and recreation facilities are supported, with any new buildings or structures sited adjacent to existing buildings to minimise their impact on the open landscape character and the special qualities of the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty. Any indoor sports and recreation facilities or proposals to enhance the local economy that would harm the special qualities of the local green space will be directed towards Larkstone, within the Harbour and Seafront Tourism Area (Policy ILF05), subject to its environmental impact. Development close to residential areas must safeguard the amenities of residents in accordance with Policy DM01: Amenity Considerations. Brimlands, the sports facilities in the vicinity of Ilfracombe Academy and Bicclescombe Park and Mill are identified as hub sites (Policy DM10: Green Infrastructure Provision).

Tourist Accommodation

10.334 Ilfracombe is an established tourism resort where tourist accommodation forms an important part of the town's economy. The majority of existing tourist bedspaces in the town are within serviced accommodation such as hotels and guest houses, which are mainly focused on Wilder Road and Torrs Park. It is important for a diverse range of serviced accommodation to be retained, or high quality accommodation provided where new opportunities exist.

10.335 Another key sector is self catering accommodation which includes camping and holiday parks. The only caravan and camping sites within the town are located at Hele where Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy will apply to alternative proposals within the Developed and Undeveloped Coast. Considering the limited availability of this type of accommodation within the town, it is important to retain these uses. Proposals that upgrade standards of accommodation and facilities and enhance the overall quality of the sites will be supported in accordance with Policies DM18: Tourism Accommodation.

Town Centre

10.336 Provision of additional retailing and services within the town centre will be supported to meet the future needs of the town where they enhance the vitality and viability of the town centre (Policies ST12: Town and District Centres and DM19: Town and District Centres). Regeneration of the town centre should support its strong independent retail offer whilst promoting new business opportunities in to the town centre, encourage improvements to the existing retail offer and enhance the quality of the town's built heritage. The Local Plan would support opportunities for enhanced pedestrian linkages between the town centre and the seafront and

harbour area as detailed within the Ilfracombe Transport Master Plan and in recognition of the holistic approach the business community has to promote the town centre, harbour and seafront areas as the overall retail offer of the town.

10.337 The Town Centre, Primary Shopping Area and Primary Shopping Frontage are identified on Policies Map 7. The primary frontage is focused along the High Street between Springfield Road and Northfield Road, where Policy DM19: Town and District Centres, will seek to retain its attractiveness to shoppers.

10.338 Within the defined town centre but outside the primary shopping frontage, a wider range of uses including residential may be permitted at ground floor level providing there is no harm to the vitality and viability of the town centre. Residential and commercial uses will also be supported on upper floors to enhance the vitality and viability of the town centre.

Green Infrastructure

10.339 Ilfracombe has a substantial deficiency of existing sports facilities within the town. Provision will be made for additional sports facilities through a new sports hub at Larkstone/Brimlands (Policy ILF05: Harbour/Seafront Tourist Area) and within the southern extension (Policy ILF01: Strategic Southern Extension). The development of an artificial grass pitch for community use and associated infrastructure at Ilfracombe Academy has been delivered which will enhance existing sports facilities on the site. Bicclescombe Park and Mill, Brimlands and Ilfracombe Academy including the adjoining sports pitches are identified as hub sites (Policy DM10: Green Infrastructure Provision).

10.340 Improvements will be made to the green infrastructure networks within and around the town including the creation of a new footpath and cycle route to the south of the town within the Southern Extension (Policy ILF01). The gap in the Tarka Trail and strategic footpath/cycle network between Ilfracombe and Knowle should be filled to improve tourism and recreational opportunities for walking and cycling to and from Ilfracombe (Policy ST10: Transport Strategy).

Northam

The Place

10.341 There are three distinct settlements within the Northam Parish: Northam, Westward Ho! and Appledore. Northam is located adjacent to A386, approximately 3km north of Bideford and 2.5km south of Appledore. A westerly bypass, the B3236, leads to the tourist resort of Westward Ho! which is approximately 1.5km west of Northam. The town is located on the eastern end of a ridge of land overlooking Northam Burrows and Bideford Bay to the north.

10.342 Northam Parish has been subject to variable growth over the last twenty years, which has occurred most significantly in Westward Ho! as a result of the redevelopment of tourist accommodations. The parish population has increased by 26%, over the period 1991-2011 providing an annualised increase of about 123 persons, supported by an average dwelling completion rate of 93 homes. The parish population in 2011 was 12,062, as established by the 2011 Census. In 2012 the population within the Parish was estimated to be: Appledore 2,816 residents, Northam 5,430 residents, Orchard Hill 1,709 residents and Westward Ho! 2,114 residents.

10.343 A significant feature of the population of Northam Parish is its ageing nature. The age distribution within the parish presents a range of variances from the characteristics of the wider area. The proportion of younger residents (0-19 age band) is significantly lower, at 16% than elsewhere in Torridge, at 20%, but the greatest degree of difference is in the proportion of the resident population in the over 60 age bands. Nearly 40% of Northam's population is over 60, compared to a northern Devon average of 31%.

10.344 The three centres present distinct and common characteristics. Northam is demographically the largest settlement and provides a traditional market centre, with historic elements. Appledore, which is divorced from the other centres, is strongly influenced in its form and function by its location on the Taw/Torridge estuary. Appledore has a strong maritime history, reflected in the maintained character of the area with the presence of a fish dock, active port facilities and significantly for the wider area the operation of Babcock Marine at Appledore Shipyard. The form and facilities provided at Westward Ho! are influenced by the centres role as a beach resort. Although historic levels of tourist accommodation have been reduced and the industry is subject to changing customer demands, Westward Ho! remains an important visitor destination.

10.345 A range of services and facilities are available across the three centres, the range is however limited and generally relates only to meeting local needs. There is a strong functional link between Northam and Bideford where residents in Northam Parish are reliant on services provided in Bideford in respect of an extended retail choice, financial services, secondary educational and hospital based health services. Convenient and quick access to Barnstaple also supports strong links to the areas Sub-regional Centre, which provides an increasingly comprehensive range of services and facilities.

10.346 The employment base in Northam is limited. The Appledore Shipyard is exceptional in providing significant employment opportunities on a quantitative and qualitative basis. Elsewhere there is a reliance on service and tourism based sectors, which are present in settlement centres. In the absence of an employment focus the majority of the working population travel out of the parish for employment.

10.347 The built form of the three settlements is variable in respect of age and character. The Appledore and Northam centres are historic in nature, as reflected by the number of contained listed buildings and the presence of three conservation areas. Westward Ho! is predominantly 20th Century and recent high density development in the seafront area has impacted on the form of the centre. Beyond the historic centres, modern development to accommodate the areas

housing needs has occurred. Within the domestic scale of the majority of development in Northam Parish the Appledore Shipyard is a significant structure, which from vantage points along the River Torridge and from Instow is a strong feature within the landscape, as is the Torridge Bridge which provides an essential link between the A39 and Bideford/Northam.

10.348 The area's physical features, the presence of national and local landscape designations and a maintained desire to avoid coalescence between the settlements has influenced the current form of Appledore, Westward Ho! and Northam.

The Future

10.349 In planning to meet the areas future needs the symbiotic relationships between the settlements and the strong links to Bideford will continue to influence the range and location of new investment and development. The settlements of Northam, Westward Ho! and Appledore will however, continue to act as local service centres, providing for a range of community needs and delivering housing to meet locally generated needs. The aspiration will be to achieve greater self sufficiency in jobs and community facilities and the enhancement of the village centres having regard to the individual nature of each settlement.

10.350 Northam, Westward Ho! and Appledore will continue to be distinct in form and function, building on historic strengths and established roles. In accommodating additional development the integrity of each settlement will be preserved and the nature of achieved development will provide an appropriate transition to the wider countryside and take account of the wider landscape setting.

10.351 Appledore will provide a continuing focus for maritime based industries and activities. Related employment and leisure development will be supported and encouraged through the safeguarding of existing assets and facilitating the intensification of use on underused sites that contribute to the areas estuary portage requirements. In accommodating growth within Appledore, for housing and other uses, the historic character of the village will be protected and where possible enhanced by development that is sympathetic to its character. The facilities within Appledore will be at a level to meet everyday needs and to support tourism interests related to the settlements cultural and historic assets.

10.352 Westward Ho! will have developed further as a coastal resort that provides for a range of tourist needs; increasing the quality offer to visitors to the area in respect of accommodation and attractions that encourages year round use. In addition to meeting visitor needs, local services and facilities will be enhanced to meet the needs of an expanding community.

10.353 Northam will continue to provide a range of services to meet its community's needs on the basis of a local service centre. The town will principally remain a dormitory centre from which residents travel for employment and higher order services.

10.354 The population of the parish will continue to grow and it will be necessary for a range of housing to be provided to meet the community's expanded and changing needs. Recognising the high and increasing levels of elderly residents in Northam, a particular focus will be required to ensure housing and other needs of an ageing population are catered for. The area will meet its own housing needs, which will include a significant element of affordable housing across each settlement. In addition to meeting housing needs, necessary social and physical infrastructure will be provided in a timely manner.

The Spatial Vision and Development Strategy to 2031

10.355 The vision will be delivered through an integrated package of development proposals that seek to deliver against the identified needs of Northam Parish and community aspirations. In doing so, development will seek to maximise the positive benefits that it can achieve whilst

respecting the sensitive landscape and environmental setting of Appledore, Northam and Westward Ho!, the contained heritage, community spirit and distinct sense of place between the settlements within the parish. Development that would contribute to coalescence between Northam and Appledore will be resisted to ensure the distinct identities of the respective settlements are maintained and in recognition of the value of the undeveloped coast which forms the countryside beyond the settlements' defined development boundaries.

10.356 The preferred strategy is to reinforce the settlement's roles as local service centres whilst facilitating economic growth as appropriate to each of the parish's settlements, significantly in relation to tourism in Westward Ho! and marine based industries at Appledore.

Policy NOR: Northam Spatial Vision and Development Strategy

The Spatial Vision

Northam will build upon its strengths taking advantage of its coastal location. Westward Ho! will be established as a thriving coastal resort and Appledore will develop further as a centre for maritime activities. The development of marine based industries and a quality tourism offer will contribute to re-balancing Northam's community and add economic value to the area.

The three centres will continue to provide a range of services and facilities to meet locally generated needs and to accommodate the expanded needs of visitors to the area. Across Appledore, Northam and Westward Ho! a range of housing appropriate to local needs will be provided. Development will be supported by necessary infrastructure that will be delivered in a manner to minimise deficiencies against service capacity.

In meeting the future growth needs of the area, development will be delivered without prejudice to valued environment and historic assets having due regard to the importance of the areas setting and landscape quality.

The Spatial Development Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable significant growth of high quality development which is supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Northam Parish. Achieved development will be delivered having regard to the settlements setting in the landscape and the special character of the area provided by a coastal location. Specifically, the Local Plan will support:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 1,916 dwellings to meet all the communities housing needs, including affordable and supported homes together with an expanded supply to meet the increasing needs of the area's ageing population, which will be supported with associated development and infrastructure on a continuous basis;**
- (b) in addition to existing commitments, new site allocations, including capacity provided by previously developed sites, will be required to provide approximately 1,740 dwellings;**
- (c) urban extensions to the south of Westward Ho! and Northam (as part of the provision of new site allocations) will accommodate significant levels of housing growth of approximately 1,240 dwellings that is supported by social and physical infrastructure;**

(d) employment will be supported by safeguarding and developing upon important economic resources, significantly in relation to Appledore Shipyard, port facilities and tourism assets;

(e) deliver economic growth through capitalising on enhanced levels of assistance offered by the Assisted Areas status;

(f) support for key site regeneration and new site development in Westward Ho! that would positively contribute to the centre's role as a coastal resort and result in an extension of the tourism season, through securing improved access to the resort and qualitative improvements to facilities, attractions and visitor accommodation;

(g) support for development at Northam Burrows that would improve the visitor offer through the provision of enhanced facilities and infrastructure;

(h) avoidance of development that would contribute to coalescence between Appledore and Northam and the designated Green Wedge in Northam;

(i) social and community facilities will be required to support new development and address established needs, including an expansion of education capacity and recreation and sports facilities;

(j) new developments will meet their own infrastructure requirements and will contribute to sustainable movement, including improved routes and facilities for cycling and walking. Improved capacity at Heywood Road roundabout will also be required together with improvements to A39/B3236 junction to accommodate increased traffic movements from Bideford and Northam. Improved sea defences at Westward Ho! will also be pursued as necessary to address the consequences of climate change; and

(k) development that respects the landscape setting including the special landscape character and qualities of the adjoining Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty.

10.357 The spatial vision and strategy for Northam Parish will be principally delivered through an integrated package of development proposals identified within this Local Plan. Other opportunities that arise and that demonstrate that they will offer a positive contribution towards the delivery of the spatial vision and strategy, whilst meeting the requirements of the policies of this Local Plan when taken as a whole, will also be supported.

10.358 Housing development will be enabled in Northam Parish to deliver a minimum of 1,916 dwellings. This overall housing requirement will be delivered through a mixture of development completed since April 2011, existing commitments, identified housing allocations and non-strategic housing sites as set out in Table 10.14 'Northam (including Appledore and Westward Ho!) Housing Provision 2011-2031'.

Table 10.14 Northam (including Appledore and Westward Ho!) Housing Provision 2011-2031

Housing Land Supply 2011-2031	Number of Dwellings
Allocations ⁽¹⁾ :	1,735
Non-strategic Housing Sites ⁽²⁾ :	92
Other Sites Contributing to Supply :	283

Housing Land Supply 2011-2031	Number of Dwellings
Dwelling Completions (2011 to 31st March 2017) :	143
Planning Commitments ⁽³⁾ :	140
Total Supply for Northam (including Appledore and Westward Ho!)	2,110

(1) Including planning commitments and completions on allocated sites (as of 31st March 2017). (2) See Appendix 5. (3) Including extant planning permissions (with small non-started permissions subject to 15% non-implementation discount), resolution to grant planning permission subject to signing of s106 agreement, permissions that have been implemented and dwellings under construction (as of 31st March 2017).

The Development Proposals

10.359 A range of proposals are enabled through the Local Plan to support the delivery of the spatial vision for the town. The spatial extent of proposals are depicted on the Policies Map and each is subject to a specific Local Plan Policy, included below, which sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with any site specific development principles.

Policy NOR01: Daddon Hill Farm

(1) A site of about 32 hectares at Daddon Hill, as defined on Policies Map 8A, is allocated to deliver a sustainable, high quality mixed use development that includes:

- (a) approximately 500 dwellings, providing a mix of housing types and size to reflect local need, including affordable housing and an Extra Care facility;**
- (b) a 420 place primary school with an associated nursery and children's centre delivery base, located to maximise accessibility to the resident catchment; and**
- (c) a neighbourhood community centre.**

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

- (a) development to be carried out in a comprehensive basis in accordance with the requirements and provisions of an agreed Master Plan;**
- (b) vehicular access onto Buckleigh Road from Daddon Hill/Laundry Lane;**
- (c) restricted vehicle movements along Daddon Hill/Laundry Lane which will become a Sustainable Transport Link;**
- (d) highway improvements from and including the A39/Buckleigh Road to the site, including junction improvements at Silford Cross and at the junction of Buckleigh Road and the A39 ;**
- (e) enhanced on site management of surface water and drainage so as not to increase flood risk on the site and beyond, including as necessary contributions to secure improvements to the Kenwith Flood Risk Defence Scheme;**
- (f) strategic landscaping measures to ensure the development respects the sensitivity of the existing landscape setting;**

(g) integration of strategic landscaping and green infrastructure, including public open space, to integrate the development into its setting and mitigate its impact on the wider countryside;

(h) integrated pedestrian, cycle and public transport networks that provide connections to neighbouring residential areas.

10.360 A strategic extension of approximately 32 hectares to the south of Northam and Westward Ho! is allocated for a mixed use development. The site will be required to be developed in a comprehensive manner in accordance with a Council agreed Master Plan that provides for a mix of uses in addition to housing that will include a new primary school and community uses. The Master Plan will ensure the site is developed with high design standards in a manner which is sensitive to adjoining built development and to the wider landscape.

10.361 The development will make a significant contribution to meeting the area's longer term housing needs and demands. About 500 new homes will be delivered, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs, which may include a range of accommodation to address needs relating to the communities ageing population. The development will provide a high quality living environment that fully respects its setting and safeguards the integrity of the adjoining residential areas.

10.362 The Daddon Hill site drains toward the Bideford Critical Drainage Area on which basis its development will be required to incorporate a comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme. Contributions to secure improvements to the Kenwith Valley Flood Defence Scheme may also be required, as guided by the Environment Agency to secure appropriate standards of flood defence.

10.363 The comprehensive drainage scheme should be integrated with the required green infrastructure. The site will be delivered with an emphasis on green infrastructure, which should be integrated throughout the site and will include strategic boundary treatments. The layout of the site must take account of the consequences of the sites topography, including the consideration of the amenity of existing residents and the sites points of exposure when viewed from the south. Development proposals will be informed by and subject to satisfactory findings of a Landscape and Visual Impact Assessment.

10.364 Delivery of highway improvements is fundamental to the acceptability of the site's development. Access to the site will be onto Buckleigh Road from Daddon Hill/Laundry Lane. Highway widening will be required, including along the A39/Buckleigh Road route to the site, junction improvement at Silford Cross and improvement at the junction of A39/Buckleigh Road. It is proposed that Daddon Hill/ Laundry Lane will become a Sustainable Transport Link, along which vehicle movements will be restricted to manage the increase in traffic levels through Northam and onto the Heywood Road roundabout from the north.

10.365 The development is of an appropriate scale to accommodate a range of community uses to meet its own needs and to contribute to meeting wider community needs. Improving access to social infrastructure is a key driver in support of the sites development. A site and contributions to a new primary school will be required from the site's development, other sites at NOR02: Site West of Buckleigh Road and NOR04: Tadworthy Road will also contribute to delivery of a new primary school to serve Northam. The school and a neighbourhood community centre, which may require accommodation for health services, should be located to maximise accessibility and ease of access to the wider community.

Policy NOR02: Site West of Buckleigh Road

(1) Land to the west of Buckleigh Road, extending to about 30 hectares and as defined on Policies Map 8A, will be comprehensively planned to deliver a sustainable, high quality mixed use development that includes:

(a) approximately 740 dwellings, providing a mix of housing type and size to reflect local need, including those of the area's elderly population and affordable housing; and

(b) a local centre, including facilities to accommodate community and retail uses.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

(a) integrated pedestrian, cycle and public transport networks that provide connections to neighbouring residential areas;

(b) graduation of development from the north to the southern and western elements of the site providing for a diminishing density of development to achieve an appropriate relationship between the development and the countryside beyond;

(c) enhanced landscaping around boundaries with existing residential development;

(d) enhanced on site management of surface water and drainage so as not to increase flood risk on the site and beyond, including as necessary contributions to secure improvements to the Kenwith Flood Risk Defence Scheme;

(e) a dual access from Buckleigh Road providing a linked route through the site;

(f) retained Public Right of Way across the southern section of the site; and

(g) highway improvements to Buckleigh Road and contributed improvements to the Silford Cross junction and the junction of Buckleigh Road and A39.

10.366 A strategic urban extension of about 30 hectares, to the west of Buckleigh Road, is allocated as a housing focused site with associated uses. Development of the site, together with NOR01: Daddon Hill Farm, will result in a significant expansion of the south-western element of Westward Ho! This will enable the delivery of new infrastructure and support extended highway improvement to the B3236 to minimise consequential congestion through Northam and at the Heywood Road roundabout.

10.367 Approximately 740 new homes will be delivered, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs, including provision to meet the increasingly ageing population of Northam Parish. A dual access from Buckleigh Road will be required which will provide a link through the site. The upgrading of Buckleigh Road and provision of a footway along the site frontage to Buckleigh Road will be required with a secondary link to the northern part of the site to provide an emergency access via a footway/cycleway to Cornborough Road. A footpath/cycle link to Pusehill Road will also be required. Contributions that provide for improvements to the Silford Cross junction and to the Buckleigh Road/A39 junction will also be required from the site, the upgrading of which is necessary to address increased traffic generation from development generated in accordance with Policies NOR01: Daddon Hill and NOR02: Site West of Buckleigh Road.

10.368 A local centre will be provided on site, which will include community and retail facilities. The centre, which should be provided with development of the northern element of the site, should be located to maximise accessibility and ease of access to the wider community.

10.369 The Buckleigh Road site drains toward the Bideford Critical Drainage Area on which basis its development will be required to incorporate a comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme. Contributions to secure improvements to the Kenwith Valley Flood Defence Scheme may also be required, as guided by the Environment Agency to secure appropriate standards of flood defence.

10.370 Parts of the southern section of the site have the potential for archaeological deposits. Prior to approval of detailed plans for development an archaeological assessment and evaluation will be required and any identified remains investigated and if appropriate, protected.

10.371 The allocated site will form part of a new southern edge to the built form of Westward Ho! Development proposals will be expected to respect the sensitive setting and deliver development of a bulk, form and layout that responds to it. Appropriate boundary treatments, maintaining existing features where practical will be required to ensure the site is integrated into its wider setting and respects the sensitivity of any adjoining uses. In particular, the layout, design and landscaping of the western section should reflect its proximity to the AONB, from which it is visible.

Policy NOR03: Land adjacent to Landsdowne Park

(1) Land adjacent to Landsdowne Park, of about 1 hectare, as defined on Policies Map 8A, is allocated for housing, subject to the following:

(a) approximately 20 dwellings, providing a mix of housing type and size to reflect local need, including affordable housing.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

(a) a landscape structure that builds on and enhances existing assets and protects the amenity value of new residents against the impacts of adjoining recreation facilities.

10.372 A greenfield site of approximately 1 hectare adjacent to Landsdowne Park is allocated to provide new homes to help meet the housing needs of Northam. The site is intended to deliver about 20 new dwellings, the nature and mix of which will take account of local needs and demands. The form of development on the built edge of Northam should be reflective of adjoining development.

10.373 The allocated site is bounded to the north and west by established hedge banks which should be retained and enhanced through development. Enhanced landscaping on the sites northern boundary will additionally be required to mitigate against the proximity of the adjoining football pitches and facilities.

Policy NOR04: Tadworthy Road (Northam)

Land north of Tadworthy Road and north of Golf Links Road, extending to about 8 hectares and as defined on Policies Map 8A, is allocated for a residential use with community and leisure facilities, that includes:

(a) approximately 125 dwellings, providing a mix of housing type and size to reflect local need, including affordable housing;

(b) a vehicular route connecting Lakenham Hill to Golf Links Road, providing for a distinct gateway point into Westward Ho! on the site's northern boundary;

(c) areas of green infrastructure providing opportunities for biodiversity enhancement and informal recreation that provide for transparency through the site towards Northam Burrows; and

(d) on the site north of Golf Links Road: football pitch provision, including associated facilities and car parking, to meet existing needs including an adult pitch and two junior pitches, which will be phased to be delivered with the associated housing development.

10.374 Two sites, which combine to about 8 hectares are allocated for housing (land north of Tadworthy Road) and community uses through football pitch provision with associated facilities (land north of Golf Links Road). The housing element of the allocation will be required to be comprehensively developed and its delivery will be phased to the provision of the recreation facilities on the site north of Golf Links Road.

10.375 The Tadworthy element of the allocation currently forms a locally valued gap in the otherwise built form of Northam and Westward Ho! It is however considered to have little value in landscape and visual amenity terms. Through development the site will contribute to the objectives of improving access to the resort, enhancing the resort role of Westward Ho! and reducing vehicle congestion in Northam Square in addition to making a valuable contribution to the area's housing needs and demands.

10.376 Fundamental to the housing sites development will be the delivery of an appropriate road link between Lakenham Hill and Golf Links Road. The link, to be provided on the basis of a boulevard style route, should through the use of landscaping and green infrastructure provide a transparency through the site, allowing for the continuation of views of Northam Burrows from within and beyond the site. A distinct gateway into Westward Ho! will additionally be provided through development, the setting for which will be enhanced by appropriate boundary treatments along Golf Links Roads on each site within the NOR04: Tadworthy Road (Northam) allocation.

10.377 In addition to housing the site(s) should provide for a range of community and leisure uses. The allocation provides an opportunity to contribute to meeting recreational needs within the parish; it is well located and suitable to address existing football pitch requirements. In addition to providing playing pitches, associated facilities and car parking will be required to be secured to maximise the potential for use and limit the negative consequences of off site parking.

Policy NOR05: Westward Ho! - Core Tourist Area

(1) In the coastal resort of Westward Ho! proposals will be supported for:

(a) tourist development that improves the attractiveness of the resort for both visitors and residents; and

(b) other appropriate development that would maintain the tourist character of the resort.

(2) The Core Tourist Area, as defined on Policies Map 8A, will be retained primarily for tourism purposes.

(3) Key tourist sites within the defined Core Tourist Area, which may contribute to the character of the resort, will be safeguarded and retained for complementary retail, leisure or entertainment use.

(4) Development that would diminish the tourist character of the resort will not be permitted.

10.378 The Local Plan provides opportunities for the delivery of additional tourist accommodation and tourism facilities and seeks to resist the loss of such opportunities in significant locations. A Core Tourist Area is identified within which proposals that would detract from the area's tourism function and character will not be permitted. The aim is to maintain the tourist character and viability of the resort. It is necessary to maintain a viable balance between quality tourist accommodation and the provision of tourism services and of tourist attractions and also to integrate development with community facilities.

10.379 To enhance the resort function significant development within the Core Tourist Area will be granted only for tourist purposes on the basis of: quality tourist accommodation, visitor attractions, tourism facilities and complementary service development (retail, leisure or entertainment) available for tourist use. Significant market housing or general employment development will not be acceptable within the Core Tourist Area. The scope and form of enabled development will be further shaped by the presence of flood risk, which within the Core Tourist Area is significant in locations adjoining the Promenade and the area around the slipway.

10.380 The policy supports the provision and retention of complementary services and facilities within the Core Tourist Area. Key sites are in important or link positions and in other locations with the potential to accommodate tourist attractions or that can act as a focus for tourist interest. Tourist accommodation will not be permissible at ground floor level on key sites. Such sites are important in the resort to service tourist needs, to sustain interest and to maintain the character and viability of the resort.

Policy NOR06: Westward Ho! - Tourism and Recreation Sites

Revitalising and enhancing the tourism role of Westward Ho! will be supported through the delivery of a range of schemes that deliver tourism and/or recreational facility enhancements, on the following sites, as allocated on Policies Map 8A:

- (a) Pebbleridge Terrace Car Park, subject to replacement/retention of parking;**
- (b) Westbourne Terrace Car Park;**
- (c) The Triangle, Promenade and Amusement Arcade north of Springfield Terrace;**
- (d) Wilkey's Field; and**
- (e) Village Green and Nelson Road Car Park.**

10.381 The sites identified in Policy NOR06: Westward Ho! - Tourism and Recreation Sites, have the potential to provide a variety of uses that will support the tourist role of Westward Ho! The sites, as defined on the Policies Map, through redevelopment will enhance the appearance and use of the resort by improving the range and accessibility of facilities and attractions. In enabling site redevelopment, at least maintained levels of public parking will be required in addition to any specific needs generated by the development.

10.382 Torridge District Council is preparing a tourism based strategy for Westward Ho! which will provide a framework for the future development of the resort that will include a consideration of how the identified sites could be developed holistically and to maximum advantage in relation to the area's Spatial Vision.

Policy NOR07: Site Adjoining Pitt Hill (Appledore)

(1) Land adjoining Pitt Hill, extending to about 6 hectares and as defined on Policies Map 8B, is allocated for housing development that includes:

- (a) approximately 130 dwellings, providing a mix of housing type and size to reflect local need, including affordable housing; and**
- (b) as necessary the relocation of a Public Right of Way to support its contained presence through the site.**

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

- (a) development located and of a form that minimises any loss of landscape character of the surrounding area;**
- (b) areas of green infrastructure providing opportunities for biodiversity enhancement and informal recreation focused to the south of the site within the coastal and estuarine zone;**
- (c) vehicular access achieved from Wooda Road, by improvement to Pitt Hill and an access from Pitt Hill Road and the provision of a right hand turn from Churchill Way into Wooda; and**
- (d) safeguarding an appropriate vehicular access extending to the northern boundary, to enable the future delivery of the adjoining site on land east of Churchill Way.**

10.383 A site of about 6 hectares adjoining Pitt Hill is allocated for housing. The site will be developed in a comprehensive manner to ensure the necessary highway improvements to Pitt Hill are secured as housing delivery is achieved.

10.384 The development will make a significant contribution to meeting the future housing needs of Appledore, providing approximately 130 new homes, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs.

10.385 A high quality design will be achieved throughout the development, which provides a reflection of the area's historic character with an emphasis on green infrastructure delivery. The layout of development within the site will minimise any consequent landscape impact, particularly in respect of the area to the north of Wooda Road.

Policy NOR08: Land North of Cleveland's Park

(1) Land north of Cleveland's Park, of about 1 hectare, as defined on Policies Map 8A, is allocated for housing, subject to the following:

- (a) approximately 11 dwellings, providing a mix of housing type and size to reflect local need, including affordable housing.**

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

- (a) a landscape structure that builds on and enhances existing assets;**
- (b) vehicular access to be provided only from Cleveland Park; and**
- (c) development should be delivered to a relatively low density to reflect the character of the local area.**

10.386 A greenfield site of about 1 hectare to the north of Cleveland Park and south of Goats Hill is allocated to deliver approximately 11 new homes to help meet the future housing requirements of Northam.

10.387 The form of the new development should be sympathetic to the nature of the existing adjoining development so that it integrates with the existing built form. A relatively low density development will be required to be delivered.

10.388 The site is bounded by well established and mature trees, including those to the northern and eastern boundaries which are subject to Tree Preservation Orders, all of which are safeguarded from loss. The loss of the hedgebanks contained within the site and along the site's boundaries should also be minimised.

Policy NOR09: Land South-West of Heywood Road Roundabout

(1) Land to the south-west of Heywood Road roundabout extending to about 10 hectares and as defined on Policies Map 8A is allocated for housing that includes:

- (a) approximately 210 dwellings, providing a mix of housing type and size to reflect local need, including those of the area's elderly population through an extra care facility and affordable housing.**

(2) The site will be comprehensively developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

- (a) a landscape structure that builds on and enhances existing assets, including the retention of the wooded aspects of the site, which provides for an integration of required green infrastructure;**
- (b) integrated pedestrian, cycle and public transport networks that provide connections to neighbouring residential areas;**
- (c) vehicular access provided from Heywood Road;**
- (d) retention of the contained Public Right of Way;**
- (e) maintained integrity of the contained and adjacent listed buildings, including regard to the protection of their settings; and**
- (f) enhanced on site management of surface water and drainage so as not to increase flood risk on the site and beyond, including as necessary contributions to secure improvements to the Kenwith Flood Risk Defence Scheme.**

10.389 A predominantly greenfield site of about 10 hectares, which lies to the south of A39 and west of Heywood Road, is allocated for the delivery of new homes. The site is intended to deliver approximately 210 dwellings that will be of a nature and mix to meet local housing needs and demands, including accommodation specific to the needs of the area's ageing population.

10.390 Highway access will be required to be provided through the formation of a new junction onto Heywood Road. Recognising the nature of the other roads surrounding the site, vehicular access will not be enabled onto any alternative roads. Pedestrian and cycle links will however be alternatively required. The new site access and the form of development will have regard to the contained listed buildings at Rose Hill and Woodville, the settings of which will be protected under Policy ST15: Conserving Heritage Assets.

10.391 The site to the south west of the Heywood Road roundabout drains towards the Bideford Critical Drainage Area on which basis its development will be required to incorporate a comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme. Contributions to secure improvements to the Kenwith Valley Flood Defence Scheme may also be required, as guided by the Environment Agency to secure appropriate standards of flood defence.

10.392 The comprehensive drainage scheme should be integrated with the required green infrastructure. The site will deliver a high quality development that achieves the integration of green infrastructure with new development that builds upon the contained environmental assets. The strong boundary features will be retained and developed to maintain the containment of the site.

Policy NOR10: Green Wedge

A green wedge from Pusehill Road in the west to Goats Hill Road in the north east is shown on Policies Map 8A to protect the individual identities of the communities on either side. Within this green wedge, development that could lead to or contribute towards the coalescence of these parts of the settlement will be resisted.

10.393 There is a significant sparsely developed gap through Northam from Pusehill Road in the west to Goats Hill road in the north east. To prevent coalescence of these communities, it is important to retain open land between them thus helping to maintain their separate identities, protect their landscape settings and avoid creation of continuous development.

South Molton

The Place

10.394 South Molton is an historic rural market town situated on rolling hills to the west of the River Mole. It is located to the south of the A361, midway between Barnstaple and Tiverton and to the south west of Exmoor National Park. The town is located about 14 kilometres (9 miles) south east of Barnstaple with good access along the A361 leading towards Tiverton and the M5. It is a relatively small town with a resident population of about 5,000 people, but it serves an extensive rural area extending to include parts of Exmoor. The historic core of South Molton is within a conservation area covering 17 hectares, which includes a large number of listed buildings.

10.395 The town is an important local service centre providing a range of retail, education, health and community facilities and employment opportunities. The town centre has a range of independent traders and an active livestock market. South Molton has expanded rapidly over recent years as an agricultural and business centre. Its population has grown substantially since 2001, with approximately 18% growth over the period 2001 to 2010, which is significantly higher than rates of population growth in other towns in North Devon.

10.396 A high proportion of South Molton's work force is involved with land based industries, although tourism is also important to the local economy. Pathfields Business Park is located to the north of the town and continues to expand as a vibrant economic centre. It has a wide range of business and distribution uses serving the surrounding rural area and reflecting its good links to the A361 and M5. However, average household incomes are below the average for North Devon.

10.397 The town's population has a high level of dependency on state benefits for elderly age groups. Many of South Molton's community facilities are at or close to capacity including the town's infant and junior schools and health centres. There is a shortage of equipped play areas and informal open spaces, especially on the western side of town, although there is good access to the community woodland to the north of the town.

The Future

10.398 The strategy for the town is for sustainable employment-led growth through a combination of new housing, business development and community facilities to strengthen the town's role as an important local service centre that is able to meet its own needs and those of the surrounding rural area. The aspiration will be for South Molton to develop as a vibrant centre for jobs, shops, recreation, community and service facilities to support the needs of the town and communities in the surrounding rural area.

10.399 Expansion of Pathfields Business Park will enhance the town as a vibrant economic centre, reflecting its good links to the A361 and M5. The economic strategy for South Molton is to deliver serviced employment land to meet the town's current and future needs and to support appropriately located business development, including potential relocation of the livestock market and associated agricultural based businesses. Delivery of superfast broadband will help to strengthen the local economy.

10.400 The expansion and enhancement of the town centre will strengthen South Molton's vitality and viability as an important local service centre, delivering retail opportunities to meet the needs of the town and its rural catchment area by reducing retail expenditure leakage to other centres. Town centre expansion will also help to deliver enhanced community facilities and services to address the social and economic needs of the town's existing and future residents.

10.401 A range of housing will be provided to meet the community's expanding and changing needs. In addition to existing committed sites, new sites will be delivered to provide the levels of housing growth required to support the town's development as a vibrant and sustainable economic centre. A western extension to the town will provide a high quality development that makes a substantial contribution to the town's housing needs and is supported by necessary physical, social and green infrastructure. It will also deliver a new distributor road that alleviates traffic congestion in the town centre and a new primary school to replace the existing junior school.

10.402 A new sports hub linked to the community college to the south of the town will provide additional and enhanced sports and recreation facilities to meet the growing needs of the town, together with enhancements to the green infrastructure network of public footpaths, cycle routes and bridleways. The community woodland between the town and Pathfields may be designated as a Local Nature Reserve.

The Spatial Vision and Development Strategy to 2031

Policy SMO: South Molton Spatial Vision and Development Strategy

The Spatial Vision

Housing and employment growth at South Molton will promote greater self-sufficiency with increased support and improved access to community facilities for the town and its large rural catchment area. New development will be focused on the western side of town to deliver a mix of high quality sustainable family and affordable housing, employment, key community infrastructure and a new distributor road to reduce traffic congestion in the town centre.

Expansion to Pathfields Business Park will support a diverse range of employment opportunities to capitalise on its proximity to the strategic road network. Relocation of the livestock market to the north of the town together with new associated industries will further develop the town as an agricultural business centre to serve North Devon. Community driven regeneration of the central car park area will facilitate expansion of the town centre to strengthen its retail provision and deliver tourism opportunities and key community infrastructure through high quality design that will capitalise on the town's built and cultural heritage.

South Molton will become a more vibrant, healthy, prosperous, accessible town providing for the needs of all including provision of a new 'sports hub' linked to the community college, an enhanced network of public footpaths, cycle routes and bridleways, extension of the community woodland, superfast broadband and business support. Increased partnership working will deliver key services and facilities including through the community and voluntary sectors. The community will be empowered to make the most of its talents and leadership to deliver the vision.

The Spatial Development Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable growth of high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of South Molton. The spatial vision for South Molton will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 1,240 dwellings, including affordable and extra care homes, to meet the range of the communities' housing needs, with associated development and infrastructure on a continuous basis during the Plan period between 2011 and 2031;

- (b) provision of new site allocations of approximately 950 dwellings and non-strategic housing sites of approximately 50 dwellings;
- (c) an urban extension to the west of South Molton (as part of the provision of new site allocations) to accommodate approximately 890 new dwellings supported by required physical, social and green infrastructure;
- (d) provision of approximately 13.6 hectares of additional employment land to the east and west of Hacche Lane at Pathfields Business Park plus an additional 2.5 hectares for a new livestock market to strengthen the town's role as a vibrant business and employment centre;
- (e) expansion and enhancement of the town centre to strengthen the town's vitality and viability and reduce leakage of spend to other centres;
- (f) social and community facilities required to support new development including provision of a new primary school, site with the expansion of the existing infant school and junior school to become a primary school, provision of a children's centre delivery base, a new medical centre, new sewage treatment works, additional sports pitches, allotments and informal open space;
- (g) a new sports hub to the south of the Community College;
- (h) provision of a new distributor road through the strategic western extension securing enhancement of the town's transport infrastructure to reduce town centre congestion and optimising accessibility to jobs, shops and community facilities within and around the town;
- (i) provision of additional footpaths, cyclepaths and bridleway routes around the town towards providing an orbital route within an enhanced green infrastructure network;
- (j) improvements to highway safety for existing junctions on the A361; and
- (k) support for initiatives to improve and mitigate against any harm to water quality in the rivers and streams.

10.403 The total housing requirement for South Molton over the plan period 2011 to 2031 is for a minimum of 1,240 dwellings. This overall housing requirement will be delivered through a mixture of development completed since April 2011, existing commitments, identified housing allocations and non-strategic housing sites as set out in Table 10.15 'South Molton Housing Provision 2011-2031'.

Table 10.15 South Molton Housing Provision 2011-2031

Housing Land Supply 2011-2031	Number of Dwellings
Allocations⁽¹⁾ :	949
Non-strategic Housing Sites⁽²⁾ :	51
Other Sites Contributing to Supply :	322
Dwelling Completions (2011 to 31st March 2017) :	177
Planning Commitments ⁽³⁾ :	145

Housing Land Supply 2011-2031	Number of Dwellings
Total Supply for South Molton	1,322

(1) Including planning commitments and completions on allocated sites (as of 31st March 2017). (2) See Appendix 5. (3) Including extant planning permissions (with small non-started permissions subject to 15% non-implementation discount), resolution to grant planning permission subject to signing of s106 agreement, permissions that have been implemented and dwellings under construction (as of 31st March 2017).

10.404

The total employment requirement for South Molton over the plan period 2011 to 2031 is for approximately 13.6 hectares of additional land for economic development plus an additional 2.5 hectares for a re-located livestock market. This overall employment requirement will be delivered through the provision of serviced employment land as expansion of Pathfields Business Park (Policy SM03) as set out in Table 10.16 'Employment/Economic Development Land Supply for South Molton 2011-2031'.

Table 10.16 Employment/Economic Development Land Supply for South Molton 2011-2031

Employment/Economic Development Land Supply for South Molton 2011-2031	Hectares of Employment/Economic Development Land Proposed
Land east of Hacche Lane, Pathfields Business Park (SM03)	6.7
Land west of Hacche Lane, Pathfields Business Park (SM03)	9.4
Total Supply for South Molton	16.1 (including 2.5 hectares for a re-located livestock market)

The Development Proposals

10.405 A series of proposals are enabled through the Local Plan to support the delivery of the spatial vision for the town. The spatial extent of proposals are depicted on Policies Map 9 and each is subject to a specific Local Plan Policy, included below, which sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with any site specific development principles.

The Vision for South Molton Strategic Western Extension:

A strategic extension on the western side of South Molton will deliver housing growth for the town, key community infrastructure including a new medical centre, a primary school and a distributor road to reduce traffic congestion in the town centre. The development will be of high quality and sustainable design through its construction and future occupation. The development will incorporate measures that will reduce carbon emissions as well as facilitating opportunities for sustainable travel within and around South Molton. The development will deliver a distinctive sense of place and quality of life enhancing the network of green infrastructure across the site.

Policy SM01: South Molton Strategic Western Extension

(1) Land to the west of South Molton (about 42 hectares), as identified on Policies Map 9, will be developed comprehensively to deliver a sustainable, high quality, mixed use development that includes:

- (a) approximately 890 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs;
- (b) formal and informal recreation facilities;
- (c) a new distributor road between North Road, Nadder Lane, the B3226 and Alswear Old Road;
- (d) a new primary school, early years' provision and a children's centre delivery base; and
- (e) provision within the site for physical infrastructure, community facilities, and green infrastructure required by the development.

(2) The residential development will be delivered as follows:

- (a) area 1 (north of Gunswell Lane) for approximately 250 dwellings including the historic setting of the listed buildings at Quince Honey Farm being safeguarded.
- (b) area 2 (between Gunswell Lane and Nadder Lane) for approximately 160 dwellings.
- (c) area 3 (south of Nadder Lane) for approximately 310 dwellings including pedestrian and cycle links into the adjoining developments of Nadder Meadow and Parklands.
- (d) area 4 (west of Exeter Gate and George Nympton Road) for approximately 170 dwellings including:
 - (i) a new 420 place primary school, early years' provision and a children's centre delivery base to the west of Exeter Gate and south of the B3226; and
 - (ii) pedestrian and cycle links from the primary school to the adjoining development off Alswear Old Road and the new sports hub (SM02).

(3) The site will be developed in a comprehensive manner to deliver the following site specific development principles:

- (a) create a distinctive, safe, sustainable, high quality urban extension and new neighbourhood for South Molton;
- (b) integrate new development within the existing landscape setting of the town and provide an appropriate transitional boundary with the adjoining countryside to the north, south and west;
- (c) enhance and make connections to the existing network of local and strategic green infrastructure through and around the site including the provision of new footpaths, cycleways, public open spaces, wildlife corridors, formal and informal recreation facilities;
- (d) provide a mix of house types, tenures and sizes of open market and affordable homes contributing towards the identified local needs;
- (e) provide a sustainable water strategy that reduces water usage, incorporates sustainable drainage systems and does not increase the risk of flooding elsewhere in the town or downstream;

- (f) connect to a new foul sewage treatment works at Ford Farm if required; and
- (g) provide social and community facilities required to support new development including contributions towards the expansion of South Molton Medical Centre.

(4) The transport and connectivity strategy for the western extension of South Molton will:

- (a) provide a new distributor road between North Road and Alswear Old Road;
- (b) establish a permeable and connected network of streets, footpaths and cycleways across the site that connect to adjoining parts of the town and Pathfields Business Park;
- (c) facilitate connections for motor vehicles, cycles and pedestrians between the proposed development, the town centre and Pathfields Business Park including increased opportunities for public transport links and sustainable travel choices within and around South Molton to reduce reliance on the private motor car;
- (d) contribute towards an orbital footpath and bridleway route around the town; and
- (e) ensure there is no direct vehicular access eastwards on to Gunswell Lane.

10.406 An urban extension to the west of the town will be developed in a comprehensive manner to deliver approximately 890 dwellings including a proportion of affordable housing, a new 420-place primary school, together with early years provision and a children's centre delivery base, and contributions towards the expansion of South Molton medical centre. A new 315-place primary school will be delivered during the early phases of construction to accommodate the existing junior school, with sufficient land safeguarded for its future expansion. The development as a whole could be served through increasing the capacity at the existing sewage treatment works or through a new sewage treatment works located at Ford Farm in order to improve water quality.

10.407 During the plan period, the existing community infants school will expand to become a 420 place primary school to meet the future needs of South Molton. The current site has the capacity to support some expansion up to a 210 place primary school so there will be an additional land requirement of approximately 0.6 hectares to be safeguarded either as part of Policy SM01: South Molton Strategic Western Extension (land north of Gunswell Lane) or as part of any future redevelopment of Quince Honey Farm whilst protecting the setting of the listed building at Beech House.

10.408 The new distributor road will be designed to provide a comprehensive route on the western side of town and should be delivered in phases alongside the residential development. It will connect the B3226 (North Road) with the George Nympton Road, bypassing and helping to reduce congestion in the town centre. Where the new distributor road crosses Gunswell Lane, there will be no vehicular access eastwards into Gunswell Lane, which will become accessed solely from Nadder Lane but remain a pedestrian route towards the town centre.

10.409 A permeable network of streets, footpaths and cycleways through the development will improve connectivity for pedestrians and cyclists to the existing Rights of Way network and contribute to a strategic orbital footpath and bridleway route around the town. A pedestrian crossing along North Road should enable safe pedestrian and cycle access between the development and Hacche Lane facilitating routes towards Pathfields Business Park and the

community woodland. Safe walking routes are required to the existing infants school, the proposed new primary school west of Exeter Gate and the proposed sports hub.

10.410 As a new gateway to the town, the development should be designed to complement its landscape setting and provide a transitional boundary between the development and adjacent countryside that reflects the local landscape character. Enhanced landscaping will be required along the western site boundary. Development will be required to incorporate a comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme integrated within the provision of green infrastructure that will permeate throughout the site, creating linkages with existing biodiversity networks in the area.

Policy SM02: Sports Hub and Football Club

(1) A site of about 2.3 hectares between Alswear Old Road and George Nympton Road, as identified on Policies Map 9, is allocated for residential development that includes:

- (a) approximately 60 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs;**
- (b) vehicular access primarily from George Nympton Road linking through to the new sports hub to the east;**
- (c) pedestrian and cycle access across the site between the new sports hub and the primary school;**
- (d) structural landscaping along the southern boundary; and**
- (e) contributions towards additional physical, social and green infrastructure within the town.**

(2) A site of about 9 hectares east of Alswear Old Road, as identified on Policies Map 9, is allocated for a sports hub that:

- (a) provides a range of new sports pitches;**
- (b) includes a sports pavilion incorporating changing rooms in a single building, which is designed and sited to minimise its landscape impact;**
- (c) provides connections to the existing footpaths along Trigley Lane and through the Sheep Fair Field, and enhancement of biodiversity networks within and around the site;**
- (d) safeguards the dark night sky over Exmoor National Park if flood lighting is provided; and**
- (e) improves the width of Alswear Old Road.**

(3) The residential development west of Alswear Old Road must not commence until a new sports pitch that meets the needs of South Molton Football Club has been provided as part of the new sports hub.

10.411 Residential development of about 60 houses between Alswear Old Road and George Nympton Road will facilitate provision of a new sports hub to the east of Alswear Old Road, including the relocation of South Molton Football Club. The sports hub will provide a range of pitches for outdoor sports, with a combined pavilion, clubhouse and changing rooms to serve these pitches. The building should be designed to meet the needs of a wide range of sports, ages

and genders and sited to minimise its landscape impact and provide convenient access to the range of pitches. Any floodlighting will need to be designed to minimise light pollution and any harm to the amenities of surrounding residential properties, in accordance with Policy DM01: Amenity Considerations and protecting the dark night skies over Exmoor.

10.412 The residential development should include a mix of dwelling types and sizes including a proportion of affordable housing, contributing towards the identified local needs. The main vehicular access must be from George Nympton Road due to the limited width of Alswear Old Road. The pedestrian and cycle access towards the new sports hub and new primary school must be designed so that it is safe for all users.

Policy SM03: Pathfields Business Park

(1) A site of approximately 13.6 hectares east and west of Hacche Lane plus an additional 2.5 hectares for a new livestock market, as identified on Policies Map 9, is allocated for economic development that includes the following site specific development principles:

- (a) at least 2.5 hectares of land safeguarded for the provision of a new livestock market;**
- (b) strategic structural landscaping including tree planting along the northern, southern and western boundaries, as identified on the Policies Map;**
- (c) retention of existing hedgerows; and**
- (d) a sustainable drainage system that does not increase the risk of flooding elsewhere in the town.**

(2) The transport and connectivity strategy for the expansion of Pathfields Business Park includes:

- (a) provision of a road from Bucknell Way, crossing Hacche Lane and linking to the B3226 to the west;**
- (b) provision of, or contribution towards, bus links connecting to the town centre; and**
- (c) connections to the existing network of footpaths and cycleways that connect Pathfields Business Park to the town centre and the community woodland.**

(3) Land at Borner's Bridge on the A361, as shown on the Policies Map, is identified for junction improvements, which must not be compromised by delivery of other developments.

(4) A reserve site of approximately 3 hectares west of Hacche Lane, as shown on Policies Map 9, is safeguarded for future economic development if required during the plan period. The site will be released if:

- (a) the allocated land has been fully developed or committed; and**
- (b) the land is required to meet additional demand.**

10.413 Sustainable growth within South Molton is based upon new employment opportunities alongside the planned housing growth for the town. Employment within South Molton is concentrated at Pathfields Business Park, which has good access to the North Devon Link Road

(A361) and links towards the M5. An extension east and west of Hacche Lane will provide approximately 13.6 hectares of new employment land during the plan period to meet the town's growing employment needs, with an additional 2.5 hectares identified for the relocation of the livestock market. Proposals for retailing and other identified town centre uses should be considered against Policy DM19: Town and District Centres. If the allocated sites are developed out during the early part of the plan period and the local economy identifies the need for additional land for economic uses at Pathfields, a further extension west of Hacche Lane of approximately 3 hectares will be supported including appropriate structural landscaping along the northern boundary.

10.414 The expansion east of Hacche Lane will provide a new road across the site linking Bucknell Way and Hacche Lane. The western expansion of Pathfields Business Park will also require an extension of this new road through the site between Hacche Lane and the B3226. Development east and west of Hacche Lane will also need to deliver access improvements by public transport, walking and cycling between the business park and residential parts of the town. Hacche Lane will become a key route for pedestrians and cyclists between the business park and the recreation ground after the proposed road link from the B3226 to land east of Hacche Lane has been constructed.

10.415 The Borner's Bridge junction on the A361 is a key junction on the strategic road network. However, the expansion of Pathfields Business Park will be required to contribute towards increasing the capacity and improving safety of the Borner's Bridge junction. Any development adjoining this junction must not compromise the opportunity for junction improvements to be delivered.

10.416 The livestock market is fundamental to the role of South Molton as an agricultural centre serving a large rural hinterland. The existing livestock market is expected to relocate from its current town centre location during the plan period to a more suitable site. A site for a new livestock market is required on land off Hacche Lane in order to retain its presence within the town, to take advantage of its accessibility to the A361 and provide opportunities for co-location with associated agricultural businesses. Development east of Hacche Lane will provide approximately 6.7 hectares of new employment land and to the west, approximately 9.4 hectares of new employment land. Part of the expansion to Pathfields will require at least 2.5 hectares safeguarded for the relocation of the livestock market.

10.417 Additional structural planting is required during the early phases of construction to mitigate the visual impact of the proposed development and future expansion westwards, to integrate the development within the landscape setting of the town and deliver biodiversity network improvements. An indicative area for the structural planting is shown on Policies Map 9. Development will be required to incorporate a comprehensive sustainable drainage scheme in accordance with Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience to reduce the risk of flooding elsewhere, especially along the River Mole. The sustainable drainage scheme should be integrated within the provision of green infrastructure that will permeate throughout the site, creating linkages with existing biodiversity networks in the area.

Policy SM04: South Molton Town Centre

Land to the rear of South Street and Broad Street of approximately 3.5 hectares, as shown on Policies Map 9, is identified for the expansion of the town centre in a comprehensive manner to deliver a sustainable, high quality, mixed use development that includes:

- (a) additional retail floorspace and additional leisure and community facilities;**
- (b) pedestrian and cycle linkages through the site to the town centre;**

- (c) additional car parking provision, together with secure cycle parking;**
- (d) comprehensive environmental enhancement, traffic management and service provision; and**
- (e) enhancing the area's built heritage and the special character and appearance of the Conservation Area.**

10.418 Provision of additional retailing and services within and adjoining the town centre will be supported to meet the future needs of South Molton where they complement, extend and diversify the town's retail offer without harming the vitality and viability of the town centre (ST12: Town and District Centres and Policy DM19: Town and District Centres). A new foodstore may be required within South Molton over the plan period to address retail expenditure leakage to other centres and to meet the town's growing retail needs. The town centre and primary shopping frontage are identified on Policies Map 9. The primary shopping area is focused along Broad Street where Policy DM19: Town and District Centres will seek to retain its attractiveness to shoppers.

10.419 The key to regeneration and expansion of the town centre is the relocation of the livestock market to Pathfields, which will provide an opportunity for comprehensive redevelopment and environmental enhancement of the existing livestock market and central car park area. If the livestock market is to remain in the town centre then the site will need to be upgraded to meet current regulations.

10.420 Regeneration of the livestock market and central car park area must be designed to enhance the town's built heritage, including its surrounding listed buildings, locally important buildings and the special character and appearance of the conservation area (ST15: Conserving Heritage Assets and DM07: Historic Environment). The existing level of car parking provision should be increased. Opportunities to enhance pedestrian and cycle linkages within the town centre will be supported.

10.421 The redevelopment and regeneration of the site must be planned carefully to provide a holistic approach to traffic management, rear servicing and car parking within and around the town to improve linkages with employment opportunities, homes and community facilities. South Molton's Transport Master Plan will facilitate visitor management within the town including public transport links with improved parking and access to the town centre.

Local Green Space

Policy SM05: Local Green Space

Land at the recreation ground and community woodland, as shown on Policies Map 9, is identified as a local green space where any development must:

- (a) enhance opportunities for outdoor sport and recreation;**
- (b) protect and enhance the site's recreational value and contribution to the local biodiversity network; and**
- (c) ensure any new buildings or structures are sited and designed to minimise their visual impact.**

10.422 The community woodland and recreational ground south of Pathfields Business Park are in public ownership and provide an important contribution to the green infrastructure network and accessible natural greenspace on the northern side of South Molton, between the town and Pathfields in terms of its biodiversity and recreational value. The recreational ground provides for local sports and play facilities. Development that enhances the site's opportunities for outdoor recreation and/or its biodiversity value will be supported. Any future designation of the woodland as a Local Nature Reserve will be supported, subject to appropriate proposals for management of identified biodiversity value. Development must safeguard the undeveloped open character of Gullacombe Valley.

Green Infrastructure

10.423 South Molton has a deficiency of equipped play areas and informal public open spaces. Provision will be made for additional facilities through the development of the western extension (Policy SM01: South Molton Strategic Western Extension). The community woodland provides a valuable recreation resource and proposals for its expansion and enhanced accessibility will be supported. Management of the site's identified biodiversity value would support its designation as a future Local Nature Reserve. A new sports hub will also be provided to the south of the Community College (Policy SM02: Sports Hub and Football Club). The recreation ground off Hacche Lane and Central Park are identified as hub sites (Policy DM10: Green Infrastructure Provision).

10.424 The green infrastructure network within and around the town will be enhanced through the provision of additional footpaths, cyclepaths and bridleways. Improved linkages between Pathfields Business Park and the town centre are required through Policy SM03: Pathfields Business Park. The creation of a new footpath and cycle link through the proposed western extension (Policy SM01: South Molton Strategic Western Extension) will contribute to an orbital route within an enhanced green infrastructure network. Where opportunities exist, the Local Plan will support the potential for the orbital route to be extended by developing the footpath and cycle link north from Mill on the Mole to Station Road. The Local Plan will also support the aspiration for a strategic walking/cycling route between Barnstaple and Tiverton via South Molton to enhance the network of strategic cycle routes across Devon in accordance with Policy ST10: Transport Strategy. Water quality in the Rivers Mole and Bray and local streams will be improved through the strategic objectives of the Local Plan and in accordance with the Taw River Improvement Project (TRIP) and requirements of Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy.

714	644	532	517	483
939	683	450	432	382
1,653	1,327	1,082	945	827

MONITORING FRAMEWORK

11 Monitoring Framework

11.1 Monitoring and review are key components of the planning system. Local Plans need to be continually reviewed and revised, partly to be able to assess its success and partly to ensure the components of each authority's planning framework are updated to reflect changing circumstances nationally and locally.

11.2 The implementation of the policies contained in the North Devon and Torridge Local Plan will require concerted action by a range of public, private and voluntary sector bodies working in partnership. The role of the document is to provide a clear and robust framework for development in order that investment and action can be co-ordinated to facilitate efficient and effective delivery.

Why do we need to monitor?

11.3 Monitoring is essential to establish both what has happened until the present time and what may happen in the future. It provides crucial feedback into the process of policy-making and helps to address questions like:

- (a) are policies achieving their objectives and delivering sustainable development?
- (b) have policies had unintended consequences?
- (c) are the assumptions behind the policies still relevant?
- (d) are targets being achieved?

11.4 In addition monitoring provides for the initiation of new development of other actions on the basis of previously agreed trigger points. Monitoring will look at implementation, setting out agreed ways in which policies achieve desired results in the required timeframe. It will also assess progress in delivering the Spatial Vision and Objectives through the implementation of policies.

How will the northern Devon Local Plan be monitored?

11.5 An Authority Monitoring Report will be prepared for the two northern Devon Local Planning Authorities. The Authority Monitoring Report will assess progress in preparing the Local Plan against milestones set out in the Local Development Scheme. It will also contain an assessment of the extent to which policies set out in this Local Plan are being achieved and whether targets are being met. Progress against the Local Plan's aims and objectives will be monitored against the indicators set out in the Monitoring Framework (Appendix 3). As well as linking with objectives and policies, indicators in the Authority Monitoring Report will also link to the Sustainability Appraisal indicators in order to identify the significant effects of policy implementation. Any activity relating to the duty to co-operate will also be reported.

11.6 The Authority Monitoring Report will also include an annual updated 'housing trajectory', which shows housing delivery in terms of net additional dwelling completed and estimated future completions for the remainder of the plan period. This information will monitor progress on delivering new housing across northern Devon and will be reviewed as part of the monitoring process. The funds collected through the Councils' Community Infrastructure Levies and what infrastructure it has helped to deliver will also be reported annually.



RURAL STRATEGIES

12 Rural Strategies

Introduction

12.1 Part Two of the Local Plan sets out detailed guidance for the individual rural communities defined as Local Centres and Villages in Policy ST07: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Rural Area.

12.2 Having regard to the strategic policies in Part One of the Local Plan, Part Two sets out a framework for how individual communities will develop over the period to 2031. It sets out the scale and type of development that individual rural communities will accommodate and defines individual settlement development boundaries, where communities have requested them. It also sets out a spatial strategy for each individual settlement to guide development and identify site allocations in and around settlements to deliver specific proposals. In addition to planned development, affordable housing, community services and facilities and employment related development can be supported to address identified needs and to support the rural economy.

12.3 These plans have been developed with rural communities across northern Devon and their success depends on action by businesses and local communities, with the Councils playing a supportive and enabling role.

Local Centres

12.4 Local Centres, as defined in Schedule A of Policy ST07, are smaller towns and larger villages which are well placed to provide localised services and facilities that act as a focal point for the surrounding rural communities. Such settlements will be the primary focus for development in the rural areas. Development will be supported in accordance with the local spatial strategies to: enhance the sustainability of these locally important service centres; meet the community's growth aspirations, and enable wider than local needs to be met.

Bradworthy

The Place

12.5 Bradworthy provides local services and facilities for the village and surrounding rural community. The village is situated 11 km (7 miles) north of Holsworthy. It lies on the western edge of the plan area, close to the boundary with Cornwall.

12.6 Bradworthy lies outside any designated landscape area and there are no sites of national or countywide nature conservation importance close to the built up area. Part of a designated European Special Area of Conservation (Culm Grassland) and Site of Special Scientific Interest lies to the north of the village at Bradworthy Common. The village is within the western culm plateau landscape area where long views are an important characteristic.

12.7 The historic character of the village centre has been retained and forms the basis of the conservation area shown on Policies Map 10. The outstanding feature of the village is its large square of C18th houses and the Grade II* Church of St John the Baptist.

12.8 Local services include an employment area within the village, shops, post office, a primary school, community hall, doctor's surgery and a variety of recreation facilities.

Spatial Strategy

12.9 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Bradworthy and the surrounding rural area.

Policy BRD: Bradworthy Spatial Strategy

The community's spatial vision for the Local Centre is that it should provide the range of facilities and services required by local people, including accommodation, care services and employment, and that growth should be gradual and supported by appropriate infrastructure.

The vision will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 44 dwellings, including affordable homes, to meet the range of housing needs in the local community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning consents and two site allocations with a capacity for approximately 30 dwellings;**
- (b) two additional housing sites within the development boundary;**
- (c) seeking to retain existing services and facilities in the village;**
- (d) support for the provision of services and accommodation for the elderly;**
- (e) provision for additional sports and recreation facilities; and**
- (f) additional employment provision.**

The Development Proposals

12.10 The spatial strategy for the village will be supported in a range of ways including the site specific policies below.

12.11 A development boundary for Bradworthy is defined on Policies Map 10 outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.12 Bradworthy is a focus for employment opportunities for the surrounding rural area. A number of premises have been provided on the industrial estate at Langdon Road. Development on the site is safeguarded for the provision of business uses. Any proposals for alternative uses will be considered against Policy DM12: Employment Development in Towns, Local Centres and Villages. Economic development in Bradworthy can capitalise on enhanced levels of assistance offered by its location in an area subject to Assisted Area status.

12.13 During the life of the Local Plan, there may be a requirement for additional land or premises to accommodate businesses able to provide a service to, or employment for local people.

12.14 The Local Plan does not make a specific allocation for economic development in Bradworthy. If required during the plan period, extension of the existing industrial estate to the north is considered to be the most appropriate location and specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for the village. Vehicular access through the existing employment area is most likely to be appropriate.

Housing

12.15 Additional housing is proposed to meet the needs and demands of the settlement of Bradworthy and its surrounding rural area over the plan period. At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively high level of housing commitment in the village ⁽⁶⁵⁾. The Local Plan identifies three further sites that are considered to be deliverable, two of which are subject to the following allocations and a site to the east of the Langdon Road Industrial Estate which is identified as a non-strategic housing site (Appendix 5). The order of presentation of which does not reflect any priority for release of the sites for development which should be in accordance with the village's spatial strategy.

Policy BRD01: Land North of Elizabeth Lea Close

(1) Land north of Elizabeth Lea Close, as shown on Policies Map 10, is allocated for residential development that includes approximately 15 dwellings with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need, including affordable homes.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) provide vehicular access from Elizabeth Lea Close/North Road;**
- (b) retain, as far as possible, existing trees and hedges on the site; and**
- (c) a design and layout that respects the location of the site bounded by existing dwellings and on two sides by open countryside.**

12.16 A site on the northern side of the settlement is allocated for housing. The site is generally level and bound by established hedgerows, with a number of trees. It has access to the highway

⁶⁵ 36 dwellings from completions since 2011 and sites under construction, with extant planning permission and subject to the completion of a S106 agreement

network and is well related to village facilities, with some further appropriate landscaping, will not harm the landscape setting of the village.

12.17 Access to the site should be served from Elizabeth Lea Close on the south-western corner of the land parcel.

12.18 A number of established residential properties border the site, on the western side. Detailed design, layout and landscaping should minimise the impact of development on these properties. A satisfactory relationship between these properties and new housing is required to protect the amenities of both.

Policy BRD02: Land at Mill Road

(1) Land south of Mill Road, as shown on Policies Map 10, is allocated for residential development that includes approximately 15 dwellings with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need, including affordable homes.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) provide vehicular access from Mill Road;**
- (b) retain, as far as possible, existing trees and hedges on the site; and**
- (c) layout and design that reflects the proximity of existing dwellings and commercial premises.**

12.19 A site to the south of Mill Road, to the south west of the village, is allocated for housing. The site is relatively level and can accommodate a range of dwellings to meet local needs.

12.20 Access to the site should make use of the existing route to Mill Road. The location of the site to the rear of existing properties requires careful attention to design and layout of the dwellings to avoid overlooking or other loss of amenity to existing or new buildings. Maximum use should be made of existing and enhanced vegetation to assist this. Further planting on the southern boundary to help integrate the development into the countryside setting of the village is required.

12.21 Design should also have regard to the impact from the established commercial use to the east of the site.

12.22 In view of the location of the site close to the village centre, and its potential impact on existing property, a form of residential development with low traffic generation may be appropriate, which could include elderly persons accommodation.

Recreation

12.23 A continuing need for additional recreation facilities in Bradworthy has been identified. Land to the north of the village, on either side of North Road, would be suitable for such provision during the plan period. Development will also need to secure safe and convenient pedestrian and cycle access to the village centre.

Bratton Fleming

The Place

12.24 Bratton Fleming is a recognised local centre providing local services, facilities and employment for the village and surrounding rural parishes. The village has a range of services and facilities including a village shop, outreach post office, a primary school, pre-school, village hall, pub, sports club and a variety of recreational facilities.

12.25 The village has a linear settlement pattern along the main road between Barnstaple and the A399 at Four Cross Way. The village is situated approximately 9 kilometres (6 miles) north east of Barnstaple on a ridge extending from the foothills of Exmoor and 4.5 kilometres (3 miles) south west of the National Park boundary. Although not subject to national designation, the setting and surrounding countryside are important characteristics of the settlement. There are a number of County Wildlife Sites and archaeological sites in the vicinity of the village, including those shown on Policies Map 11.

12.26 The village has a mixture of property styles and ages but with few listed buildings.

Spatial Strategy

12.27 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Bratton Fleming and the surrounding area.

12.28 The community's spatial vision for Bratton Fleming is that it should evolve in a sustainable way to strengthen the community's vibrancy, retaining a balanced age profile by ensuring young people remain in the locality and enhancing the services and facilities currently available. The community's vision includes the provision of a new village shop within the plan period.

Policy BRF: Bratton Fleming Spatial Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable growth of high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Bratton Fleming. The spatial vision for Bratton Fleming will be delivered through:

- (a) the provision of a minimum of 44 new dwellings, including affordable homes, to meet the range of needs in the community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning consents, dwellings under construction and a single site allocation;**
- (b) an extension in the centre of the village to accommodate approximately 25 new dwellings;**
- (c) accommodating additional housing on small scale sites (less than 10 homes) within or on the edge of the existing built area of the village in accordance with Policy DM23;**
- (d) supporting the expansion of existing village and parish employment opportunities, and the introduction of new business activities;**
- (e) securing an expansion of the school and pre-school and the provision of additional facilities at the Sports Club;**
- (f) reducing traffic speeds in the centre of the village, in the interests of highway safety;**

- (g) the protection and enhancement of the existing sports pitches;**
- (h) accommodating additional cemetery provision if required;**
- (i) supporting the retention and expansion of village facilities and services to meet the needs of the local community and visitors to the area including the provision of a community shop; and in all cases; and**
- (j) ensuring the setting and character of the village is not harmed by any future development.**

The Development Proposals

Employment

12.29 Bratton Fleming is a focus for economic development opportunities for the surrounding rural area. A series of workshops have been provided, on the Grange Hill Industrial Estate on the eastern end of the village. Development on the site has been built out and is safeguarded for the provision of economic development uses. Any proposals for alternative uses will be considered against Policy DM13: Safeguarding Employment Land.

12.30 During the life of the Local Plan there may be a requirement for additional land or premises to accommodate businesses able to provide a service to or employment for local people, but the Local Plan does not make a specific allocation of economic development land in Bratton Fleming. If required during the plan period, extension to the north of the existing industrial estate is considered to be the most appropriate location with vehicular access through the existing estate and appropriate landscaping along the northern boundary. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Bratton Fleming.

Housing

12.31 A site is proposed off The Glebe, to the south of Old Rectory Lane, for residential development. At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively high level of housing commitments in Bratton Fleming⁽⁶⁶⁾. Additional housing will help to provide the scale and type of development to meet the identified needs and demands of the local community.

12.32 The spatial extent of the proposal is shown on Policies Map 11 and is subject to a specific policy (BRF01: Land off The Glebe) that sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles.

Policy BRF01: Land off The Glebe

(1) Land off The Glebe, as identified on Policies Map 11, is proposed for approximately 25 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

- (a) vehicular access via The Glebe, with additional pedestrian access to the public rights of way network via Old Rectory Lane;**

⁶⁶ 22 dwellings from completions since 2011, under construction and extant planning permissions, including approvals subject to completion of S106

(b) protection of the trees on and bordering the site together with additional planting on the southern edge as an extension to the millennium green and community woodland;

(c) safeguarding the dark night skies over Exmoor National Park; and

(d) enhanced landscaping along the northern and eastern boundaries.

12.33 The site off The Glebe is well related to the village and with suitable design and landscaping can be developed without undue harm to the landscape setting of the village. Development must be designed to minimise light pollution affecting the Dark Sky Reserve over Exmoor.

12.34 The site will provide the majority of new dwellings required in the village over the plan period and should be developed in such a way as to provide a phased supply to meet local needs. This may require a flexible approach to development or review of detailed proposals as community needs are identified.

12.35 Vehicular access to the site should be from The Glebe, which provides good access to the main road network. Pedestrian access via this route should also be available for village services and public transport, together with a connection through the site to the public footpath network via Old Rectory Lane.

12.36 The southern boundary borders the community woodland (Policy BRF02: Local Green Space) and additional planting on this site should extend that woodland for amenity and biodiversity benefits. This woodland planting should be part of the detailed design and landscaping of the development to help integrate it into the countryside.

12.37 A number of established properties border the site. Detailed design, layout and landscaping should minimise the impact of development on properties in Old Rectory Lane and The Glebe. A satisfactory relationship between these properties and new housing is required in order to protect the amenities of both.

Policy BRF02: Local Green Space

Land at the Millennium Green and community woodland, as shown on the Policies Map 11, is identified as a local green space where any development must:

(a) enhance opportunities for outdoor recreation and leisure;

(b) protect and enhance the site's recreational value and/or its contribution to the local biodiversity network; and

(c) ensure any new buildings or structures are sited and designed to minimise their visual impact.

12.38 The Millennium Green and community woodland south of Bratton Fleming are partly in public and partly in private ownership. Both make an important contribution to the village's green infrastructure network and accessible natural greenspace in terms of their biodiversity and recreational value. The Millennium Green and community woodland provide opportunities for local play facilities and allotment gardens. There is currently a waiting list for allotments within the village, so provision of additional allotments will be supported.

12.39 Development that enhances the site's opportunities for outdoor recreation and leisure and/or its biodiversity value will be supported, although development close to residential areas must safeguard the amenities of existing residents in accordance with Policy DM01: Amenity Considerations. Any future designation of the woodland as a Local Nature Reserve will be supported, subject to appropriate proposals for management of identified biodiversity value.

Community Facilities

12.40 Identified community assets and other community facilities, including the public house, are important to meet the needs of local residents. Bratton Fleming Sports Club at the western end of the village and recreation field to the east provides important recreation facilities for the community and the sites are safeguarded for these uses (Policy DM09: Safeguarding Green Infrastructure). The sports club is identified as a hub site. Provision of additional sports and recreation facilities on these sites or on other appropriate sites will be supported where the need is identified.

12.41 The existing cemetery at the churchyard is reaching capacity and additional space may be required during the lifetime of the Plan. No additional site is identified but a new cemetery will be supported once an appropriate site has been identified by the local community.

12.42 Bratton Fleming primary school is an important local community facility. The existing buildings are now at capacity and expansion may be required over the Plan period to meet the growing needs of the area. The Council will support the provision of appropriate additional accommodation for the school and continued development of the pre-school.

12.43 The proposed reinstatement of the Lynton-Barnstaple railway line (Policy BAR16: Lynton and Barnstaple Railway) passes to the north of the village. Business, tourism and leisure opportunities associated with the railway line will be supported where they contribute towards Bratton Fleming's spatial strategy.

Buckland Brewer

The Place

12.44 Buckland Brewer provides local services and facilities for the village and surrounding community. The village is situated about 10 km (6 miles) south west of Bideford, in a largely rural area.

12.45 The village lies outside any designated landscape area and there are no sites of national or countywide nature conservation importance close to the built up area. Buckland Brewer is on rising ground to the west of the Torridge Valley, with extensive views from the western end of the village.

12.46 The historic character of the village centre and surrounding properties has been retained and forms the basis of the conservation area shown on Policies Map 12 which includes the C15th Grade II* Church of St Mary and St Benedict.

12.47 Local services include shops, a primary school, community hall, pub and mobile post office and library. There are also a variety of recreation facilities.

Spatial Strategy

12.48 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Buckland Brewer and the surrounding rural area.

Policy BBR: Buckland Brewer Spatial Strategy

The community's spatial vision for the Local Centre is that it should support a range of facilities and amenities to meet the needs of residents and that it should have a more balanced age profile than at present. The community accepts that significant growth in population, particularly in the younger age groups, is likely to be necessary to help achieve this.

The vision will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 113 dwellings including affordable homes, to meet a range of housing needs in the community with an emphasis on smaller properties for families and single people. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning consents and three site allocations with a capacity for approximately 55 dwellings;
- (b) three additional housing sites within the development boundary, together with smaller infill plots;
- (c) seeking to retain and expand existing services and facilities in the village;
- (d) retention of existing sports and recreation facilities, and
- (e) supporting appropriate employment provision, including live-work units subject to market demand.

The Development Proposals

12.49 The spatial strategy for the village will be supported in a range of ways including the site specific policies below.

12.50 A development boundary for Buckland Brewer is defined on Policies Map 12 outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis. The development boundary includes opportunities for additional development in addition to the sites subject to specific policies.

Employment

12.51 Employment in Buckland Brewer is related primarily to service activities.

Policy BBR01: Land Adjoining Football Pitch

(1) Land to the north of Buckland Brewer, as shown on Policies Map 12, is allocated for economic development to include a mix of unit sizes focused on meeting local business needs.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

(a) a focus on economic uses within the B1 Use Class;

(b) a high standard of unified design and appearance in view of the location of the site in the countryside that provides an acceptable impact on local heritage assets; and

(c) appropriate screening on all boundaries to integrate the development into its countryside setting.

12.52 During the life of the Local Plan there may be a requirement for additional land or premises to accommodate businesses able to provide a service to, or employment for local people. A small site is allocated to accommodate this demand to the north of the village.

12.53 The allocated site of approximately 0.22 hectares can accommodate premises for light industrial or other B1 uses to help provide a range of employment opportunities in Buckland Brewer. Its location will ensure minimal impact on existing residential property and on traffic in the village.

12.54 The site is in a very prominent position, visible from all directions, and its development needs to reflect this. A high standard of design of buildings will be required to ensure visual impact is minimised, including the impact on local heritage assets. Boundary planting will need to be substantial to help integrate new development into the countryside.

12.55 If required, the opportunity could be taken to integrate access arrangements for this site, the football pitch and the adjoining allotments.

Housing

12.56 At 31st March 2017 there was a substantial level of housing commitment in the village ⁽⁶⁷⁾ with permitted sites at Gorwood Road and to the south east of Buckland Brewer in association with a new village hall. Further sites are additionally allocated to meet the spatial strategy for Buckland Brewer over the plan period.

12.57 The identified sites are considered to be deliverable. They will be released to ensure a steady pace of development over the Plan period and in accordance with the spatial strategy. The order of presentation does not reflect any priority for release of the sites.

12.58 Existing commitments include a number of affordable dwellings. During the plan period additional affordable homes may be needed to meet local needs. All sites will be required to meet a range of housing needs in accordance with the spatial strategy and general plan policies. If a more significant need for affordable property is identified land to the south of the settlement, known locally as 'Higher Turnaway', between the roads to Great Torrington and Thornhillhead, is considered suitable. This site is outside the development boundary and will be released only in accordance with Policy ST19: Affordable Housing on Exceptions Sites.

Policy BBR02: Land at Orleigh Close

(1) Land north east of Orleigh Close, as shown on Policies Map 12, is allocated for residential development that includes

- (a) approximately 25 dwellings with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need, including affordable homes; and**
- (b) adequate replacement for any parking spaces lost to obtain satisfactory access to the principal village road through Orleigh Close.**

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) provide vehicular access only from Orleigh Close;**
- (b) a design and layout that provides an acceptable impact on existing properties;**
- (c) provision of a substantial tree and hedge screen on all boundaries with open countryside; and**
- (d) a pedestrian link to land proposed for development to the south east.**

12.59 A site to the north-east of Orleigh Close on the eastern side of the village is allocated for housing. The site is relatively level and can accommodate a range of dwellings to meet local needs. It is well related to the highway network and village facilities and with appropriate landscaping, will not harm the landscape setting of the village.

12.60 This site of approximately 1.1 hectares can make a significant contribution to enabling continuing growth in the village over the Plan period without harming the setting of the village. To ensure this is achieved, development will be expected to follow the substantial completion of the existing commitment in association with the village hall. The site is not expected to be released at the same time as BBR03.

⁶⁷ 93 dwellings from completions since 2011 and sites under construction, with extant planning permission, including 5 units on BBR04: Land to the West of Tower Hill

12.61 The site borders the front of properties in Orleigh Close. Detailed design and layout that avoids overlooking between existing and new properties is essential. Access through the site to Meadow Park will need to be provided.

12.62 Substantial planting on the eastern, currently undefined, boundary is required to minimise the impact on the countryside setting. Existing hedge boundaries will also be reinforced with native planting to create more biodiverse features capable of screening the site.

Policy BBR03: Land to the South East of Orleigh Close

(1) Land to the south east of Orleigh Close, as shown on Policies Map 12, is allocated for residential development that includes approximately 25 dwellings with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need, including affordable homes.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific principles:

- (a) vehicular and pedestrian access from the development adjoining the new village hall;**
- (b) a pedestrian link to the development of site BBR02;**
- (c) a design and layout that provides an acceptable impact on existing properties and future development; and**
- (d) provision of a substantial tree and hedge screen on all boundaries with open countryside.**

12.63 A site to the south-east of Orleigh Close, adjacent to the site subject to Policy BBR02: Land at Orleigh Close, and to the rear of development associated with the new village hall, is proposed for residential development. Vehicular access to this site will be from development associated with the new village hall only.

12.64 This site of approximately 1 hectare can make a significant contribution to enabling continuing growth in the village over the plan period without harming the setting of the village. The site will not be developed before the substantial completion of the existing commitment in association with the village hall. The site is not expected to be released at the same time as BBR02: Orleigh Close.

12.65 Existing hedges should be reinforced and a substantial new boundary created on the northern edge to help integrate the development into the Countryside.

Policy BBR04: Land to the West of Tower Hill

(1) Land to the west of Tower Hill, as shown on Policies Map 12, is allocated for residential development that includes approximately 5 dwellings with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and size to reflect local need.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific principles:

- (a) vehicular access only to Tower Hill;**

(b) a design, including highway design, and layout that provides an acceptable impact on the adjacent conservation area and does not harm the setting of the nearby Grade II* listed Church;

(c) provision of a substantial tree and hedge screen on the western boundary; and

(d) accommodation of the existing public footpath within the development.

12.66 A site to the west of Tower Hill, to the rear of existing properties, is proposed for residential development. Vehicular access will be direct from Tower Hill via an existing track.

12.67 The site of approximately 0.5 hectare is relatively level. Although hedges border the rear of existing properties the western boundary is undefined and substantial appropriate new planting will be required to help integrate the development into the Countryside.

12.68 A public footpath crosses the southern section of the site and joins Tower Hill opposite the Church. This route will be accommodated within the development and its use encouraged.

12.69 The southern and much of the eastern boundaries of the site adjoin the village conservation area. Development, including the vehicular access, will be of an appropriate standard and not harm the setting of the Grade II* listed Church.

Community Facilities

12.70 Buckland Brewer has a range of recreation provision, mainly located to the north of the village. The Local Plan safeguards use of the football pitch, playing field and allotment areas from other uses and the sites remain outside the development boundary to further discourage development pressure.

12.71 Also safeguarded is the area of amenity land adjoining the new village hall to be transferred to Parish Council as the adjacent development progresses. A play area for use by the primary school and amenity land for general use are part of the development which includes a new village hall.

Chulmleigh

The Place

12.72 Chulmleigh is a recognised local centre providing local services, facilities and employment for the town and surrounding community. The town has a range of services and facilities including convenience shops, bank, post office, library, community hall, sports facilities and medical facilities. Chulmleigh is the only local centre that has both a primary school and a secondary school.

12.73 Located on the southern edge of the plan area, Chulmleigh also serves communities in Mid Devon District. It is approximately 11 kilometres (7 miles) south of South Molton and 2 kilometres (1 mile) from the A377 Exeter to Barnstaple road, accessed from the B3096.

12.74 The town has a compact settlement form, having developed beyond its historic ridgeline core around the junction between East Street, Fore Street and South Molton Street. The centre retains much of its historic street pattern and includes a designated conservation area with a number of listed buildings, including the Grade I St. Mary Magdalen's Church.

12.75 Although not subject to any national landscape designation, the setting and surrounding countryside are important characteristics of the settlement, particularly the valley of the Little Dart River to the south. There are a number of County Wildlife Sites in the vicinity of the village, including at Dartridge Wood, shown on Policies Map 13.

Spatial Strategy

12.76 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Chulmleigh and the surrounding area. The community's aspiration for the town is to evolve in a sustainable way over the plan period.

Policy CHU: Chulmleigh Spatial Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable growth of high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Chulmleigh. The spatial vision for Chulmleigh will be delivered through:

- (a) the provision of a minimum of 162 new dwellings to meet the range of needs in the community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning consents, dwellings under construction and the allocation of two sites totalling 115 dwellings and a non-strategic housing site;**
- (b) facilitating delivery of development to provide even, continuous growth to enable services and facilities to adapt and develop gradually;**
- (c) supporting additional business development in accordance with the role of the town as a local centre;**
- (d) diversifying the range of town centre services and facilities to meet local needs and support the role of the town; and**
- (e) retention and enhancement of open space and recreation facilities.**

The Development Proposals

12.77 The spatial strategy for the town will be delivered through site specific policies that identify the range and nature of development to be delivered along with key development principles. A

development boundary for Chulmleigh is defined on Policies Map 13 outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.78 Chulmleigh is a focus for economic development opportunities for the surrounding rural area. A range of business premises are located on and near the Back Lane Industrial Estate. This site remains suitable for a variety of business uses and is included within the development boundary. Policy DM13: Safeguarding Employment Land will apply to proposals for the loss of land in use as, or permitted for, business development.

12.79 The Local Plan does not make a specific allocation of land for additional business uses in Chulmleigh. If required during the plan period, the area in the vicinity of existing premises is considered to be the most appropriate location. The type and form of business premises should be reflective of local market demand. Any development should provide adequate and appropriate access to the B3096/A377, be of a high standard of design, not adversely impact on neighbouring uses and provide appropriate landscaping in accordance with the general policies of the Local Plan.

Housing

12.80 Additional housing is proposed to meet the needs of Chulmleigh over the plan period. At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively high level of housing commitments in Chulmleigh⁽⁶⁸⁾ excluding the July 2014 planning approval on the site of CHU01. The Local Plan allocates one additional site plus a non-strategic housing site at Oldings Meadow for approximately 23 dwellings (see Appendix 5).

Policy CHU01: Land off Leigh Road

(1) Land south of Leigh Road, as shown on Policies Map 13, is proposed for residential development that provides up to 95 dwellings, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types, tenures and sizes to reflect local needs.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) vehicular access direct from Leigh Road;**
- (b) contribution towards improved access in to the town centre for pedestrians and cyclists;**
- (c) appropriate substantial landscaping on the southern and eastern boundary of the site to integrate it within its countryside setting and contribute towards biodiversity gains through enhancing the local biodiversity network; and**
- (d) detailed design and landscaping that minimises the impact of development on existing properties in Leigh Road and Leigh Villas.**

12.81 A site is proposed to the south of Leigh Road, adjacent Leigh Villas, for housing development. The site will help to provide the scale and type of development to meet the identified needs of the local community. It is well related to existing development and, with suitable design and landscaping, development of the scale proposed can be accommodated without undue harm

68 26 dwellings from completions since 2011, under construction and extant planning permissions

to the landscape setting of the village or neighbouring properties. There is little natural vegetation on the site and proposals will need to provide adequate new or reinforced boundary treatment to integrate the development into the largely open landscape. Landscaping within and around the site will be expected to enhance the range of habitats and the local biodiversity network.

12.82 A single, safe, vehicular and pedestrian access to the site is required from Leigh Road subject to suitable design and enhanced pedestrian and cycle links towards the town centre, possibly through improved links to the existing public footpath along Ladywell Lane to the east. A number of residential properties border the site, and a satisfactory relationship between these properties and new housing is required in order to protect the amenities of both. The site may be developed in phases.

Policy CHU02: Land at Back Lane

(1) Land north of Back Lane, as shown on Policies Map 13, is proposed for residential development that provides approximately 20 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) release of the site in phases through the Plan period in response to the needs of the community;**
- (b) structural planting along the northern boundary and a landscaping buffer along the eastern and western site boundaries;**
- (c) vehicular access from Back Lane;**
- (d) a safe and convenient pedestrian route through the site linking to South Molton Street; and**
- (e) appropriate landscaping and screening on all boundaries to integrate the site within its countryside setting and contribute towards biodiversity gains through enhancing the local biodiversity network.**

12.83 Land fronting Back Lane, adjacent to the sports facilities and close to the Community College, is proposed for housing development. The site will help to provide the scale and type of development to meet the identified needs of the local community. The site at Back Lane is a large, open site with good road frontage that is well related to the town. It is flat but has no natural subdivision or boundary with the wider countryside.

12.84 Development is required to ensure that adequate and appropriate landscaping and screening are provided on all boundaries to reduce its impact on the wider countryside setting and minimise any impact from the adjoining business activities to the west and Chulmleigh Academy to the east. This planting will be expected to secure biodiversity gains to enhance the range of habitats and the local biodiversity network in this part of the town where large fields with few hedgerows predominate.

12.85 In order to ensure a supply of suitable land through the plan period, release of this site for development will be phased in order to meet local needs. However, development will need to be coordinated to make use of a single, appropriately sited, vehicular access from Back Lane.

12.86 A safe and convenient pedestrian route from the housing to the junction of Back Lane and South Molton Street will be required. This route should extend through the development to provide a safe alternative access to the Academy. The route could be sited within or around the edge of the residential area.

Community Facilities

12.87 Chulmleigh has a wide range of education, recreation, social and community facilities, many of which have seen significant recent investment. These facilities provide a range of services to the local community and the wider area served by the town.

12.88 Retaining and enhancing these services and facilities is recognised as providing an important component in sustaining the town and enabling it to act as a sustainable location for the level of growth proposed. The general policies of the Local Plan protect such services and facilities and proposals that involve their loss will be considered against these.

Combe Martin

The Place

12.89 Combe Martin provides local services and facilities for the village and surrounding rural community. The village has a range of services and facilities including several convenience shops, a primary school, post office, community halls and a variety of sport and recreation facilities. There is also a medical centre and a public library.

12.90 The village has a long, linear form astride the A399 within the Umber Valley on the edge of Exmoor National Park, about 8 kilometres (5 miles) from Ilfracombe. The village is located within the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty and the Coastal and Estuary Zone (Policy ST09). Land alongside the river is liable to flooding and the valley is in the 'Coastal Slopes and Combes' landscape character type within the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty. The coastline at Combe Martin forms part of a Marine Conservation Zone and Voluntary Marine Conservation Area. The designations recognise the ecological and geological importance of the cliffs and foreshore along this stretch of coastline. Combe Martin Bay has been designated as a Site of Special Scientific Interest to protect the ecology and geology of the coastline.

12.91 A conservation area has been designated covering areas near the beach (Seaside) and around the parish church (Head Town). Combe Martin has a history of silver mining and there are remains of a medieval field system on slopes around the village. A 'Historic Environment Action Plan' for the settlement has been published.

Spatial Strategy

12.92 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Combe Martin and the surrounding area. The community's spatial vision for the Local Centre is that it should evolve in a sustainable way that protects the locally valued natural environment and heritage.

Policy CMA: Combe Martin Spatial Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable growth of high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Combe Martin. The spatial vision for Combe Martin will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 48 new dwellings to meet the range of need in the community, and encouraging the use of vacant properties. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning consents and allocation of two sites totalling 11 dwellings;
- (b) safeguarding the dark night skies over Exmoor National Park;
- (c) protecting the important landscape setting of Combe Martin including the special landscape character and qualities of the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty;
- (d) protecting and increasing local employment opportunities, encouraging small local businesses and protecting tourism facilities;
- (e) developing the seafront area in a manner sympathetic to its heritage and landscape importance and improving the quality of bathing water at Combe Martin beach;
- (f) development of additional sporting facilities, particularly at Hollands Park, and developing the network of public rights of way;

- (g) provision of an extension to the cemetery;
- (h) protection and enhancement of structures associated with the former silver mining activity in the area; and
- (i) enhancement of superfast broadband connections.

The Development Proposals

12.93 The spatial strategy for the village will be supported by site specific policies that identify the range and nature of development to be delivered along with key development principles. A development boundary for Combe Martin is defined on Policies Map 14 outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis. The development boundary includes opportunity for additional development opportunities in addition to the sites subject to specific policies.

Employment

12.94 There are limited economic development opportunities in the parish with the local economy dominated by the tourism industry, including the range of local shops, caravan sites, hotels and self-catering accommodation. This is expected to remain the situation throughout the plan period. Other employment opportunities are available at Mullacott Business Park near Ilfracombe. Proposals for economic development in Combe Martin will be considered against other policies in the plan and the spatial strategy objectives above.

Housing

12.95 Additional housing is proposed to meet the needs and demands of Combe Martin over the plan period. At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively high level of housing commitments in Combe Martin⁽⁶⁹⁾. The Local Plan allocates two additional sites plus a non-strategic housing site off Spurway Gardens for approximately 5 dwellings (see Appendix 5).

Policy CMA01: Land North of Rectory Road

(1) Land north of Rectory Road, as shown on Policies Map 14, is proposed for approximately 5 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) a design and layout that respects the location of the site adjacent to the conservation area and safeguards the historic setting of the listed St Peter ad Vincula Church;
- (b) vehicular access from Park Lane including any necessary improvements to the existing public highway;
- (c) development should not result in the loss of car parking for the hall;
- (d) retaining and enhancing existing boundary trees and hedges to ensure the development is integrated into the landscape; and

⁶⁹ 20 from completions since 2011, dwellings under construction and extant planning permissions including approvals subject to completion of S106.

(e) safeguarding the dark night skies over Exmoor National Park.

12.96 A site is proposed to the north of Rectory Road for housing. The new housing will provide small scale growth in the settlement over the plan period. Although the village is within the AONB, the identified area for housing is well related to the existing settlement.

12.97 Opportunities to provide an improved route for pedestrians along Park Lane will be supported. If provision of a suitable vehicular access requires widening of Park Lane and loss of the existing hedgebank, then a replacement hedgebank of equivalent biodiversity value will be required to compensate. Appropriate planting and hedgebank enhancements will be required along other site boundaries to integrate the site into its landscape setting and provide a transitional boundary between the development and the adjoining countryside.

12.98 The design and layout of new houses will need to respect the character and appearance of the adjoining conservation area and safeguard the historic setting of the Grade I listed Church of St. Peter ad Vincula. The development should avoid unacceptable overlooking of adjoining properties. A satisfactory relationship between these properties and new housing is required in order to protect the amenities of both. Development must be designed to minimise light pollution affecting the Dark Sky Reserve over Exmoor.

12.99 There are other sites within the existing built up area capable of providing additional residential development. These are within the development boundary and include previously developed sites at Rows Garage off Castle Street and the Telephone Exchange area on High Street. These sites, together with undeveloped areas within the development boundary such as at Hollands Park Avenue, provide for a range of site sizes and locations within Combe Martin.

Policy CMA03: Land North of Park Hills

(1) Land north of Park Hills, as shown on Policies Map 14, is proposed for approximately 6 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

(a) vehicular access from Park Hills Road including any necessary improvements to the existing public highway;

(b) retaining and enhancing existing boundary trees and hedges to ensure the development is integrated into the landscape; and

(c) safeguarding the dark night skies over Exmoor National Park.

12.100 A site is proposed to the north of Park Hills Industrial Estate for housing. The new housing will provide small-scale growth in the settlement over the plan period. Although the village is within the Area of outstanding Natural Beauty, the identified area for housing is well related to the existing settlement.

12.101 Appropriate planting and hedgebank enhancements will be required along site boundaries to integrate the site into its landscape setting and provide a transitional boundary between the development and the adjoining countryside. Development must be designed to minimise light pollution affecting the Dark Sky Reserve over Exmoor.

Policy CMA04: Combe Martin Field System

Combe Martin Field System, as shown on Policies Map 14, is identified as a heritage asset, where its historic landscape character and setting will be protected.

12.102 A medieval field system remains on the slopes around the village where hedgerows mark many of the original strips and others have been retained as long gardens. The remains of the field system contribute to Combe Martin's landscape setting and heritage, and are a distinctive characteristic of the landscape in this part of the AONB. The connectivity of hedgerows and pattern of lanes are fundamental to the field system, which is identified as a heritage asset but is not formally protected by any heritage designation. Policy CMA04: Combe Martin Field System protects identified sites on both sides of the village, the larger of which is to the east of the village, adjoining the National Park.

Community Facilities

12.103 Combe Martin has a range of education, recreation, social and community facilities that serve the local community and the village's catchment area. Retaining and enhancing these services and facilities is recognised as important towards sustaining Combe Martin as a sustainable location for the level of growth proposed. The general policies of the Local Plan protect such services and facilities, and proposals that involve their loss will be considered against these policies.

12.104 The existing cemetery at the churchyard is reaching capacity and additional space is likely to be required during the lifetime of the plan. A new cemetery will be supported in the village once an appropriate site has been identified by the local community.

Dolton

The Place

12.105 Dolton provides local services and facilities for the village and surrounding rural community. The village is situated 11 km (7 miles) south east of Great Torrington. It lies close to the southern edge of the plan area.

12.106 Dolton lies outside any designated landscape area and there are no sites of national or countywide nature conservation importance close to the built up area. Areas beside the River Torridge, to the south of the village, are included within a flood zone. The Tarka Trail passes through the village.

12.107 The historic character of the village centre has been retained and forms the basis of a large conservation area shown on Policies Map 15. The C13th Grade II* Church of St Edmund lies at the western end of the conservation area, together with a number of other listed buildings. The designated area includes open land to the south that provides an important setting for the older part of the village.

12.108 Local services include several shops, post office, a primary school and pre-school, community hall, play areas and a sports pitch. The local sewage treatment works has limited capacity for additional development.

Spatial Strategy

12.109 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Dolton and the surrounding rural area.

Policy DOL: Dolton Spatial Strategy

The community's spatial vision for the Local Centre is that it should: sustain and enhance local services, facilities and amenities, protect the natural and built environment and provide suitable housing for all sectors of the community.

The vision will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 45 dwellings, including affordable homes, to meet the range of housing needs in the community, including sheltered housing. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant consents and an additional housing allocation together with a contribution from a community use focused scheme;**
- (b) one additional housing site within the development boundary;**
- (c) seeking to retain and improve existing services and facilities in the village;**
- (d) supporting the provision of suitable employment sites and activities within the village, including appropriate live-work units;**
- (e) retaining features of local distinctiveness wherever possible;**
- (f) providing a car park for the village hall and for general use of village;**
- (g) delivery of superfast broadband connections; and**
- (h) supporting accessible healthcare provision for local people.**

Development Proposals

12.110 The spatial strategy for the village will be supported in a range of ways including the site specific policies below.

12.111 A development boundary for Dolton is defined on Policies Map 15 outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.112 There is a diverse range of employment in the village and service and tourist related activities are important. The village has no identified employment area. The general policies of the Local Plan will facilitate further appropriate economic development in the village. Sites at nearby Winkleigh Airfield may be available to accommodate more significant development to serve the area.

12.113 Subject to evidence of market demand and adequate controls, the inclusion of a limited number of live-work units for local people as part of the housing provision identified below may be appropriate.

Housing

12.114 Additional housing is proposed to meet the needs and demands of the settlement of Dolton and its surrounding rural area over the plan period. At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively high level of existing housing commitments ⁽⁷⁰⁾ within the village. The Local Plan identifies an additional housing site, which is considered to be deliverable.

Policy DOL01: Land at Aller Road

(1) Land north of Aller Road, as shown on Policies Map 15, is allocated for residential development that includes approximately 25 dwellings, including affordable homes, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need.

(2) The site should be developed to meet the following specific development principles:

- (a) vehicular and pedestrian access from Aller Road;**
- (b) retention and reinforcement of existing boundary trees and hedges;**
- (c) pedestrian access to Barfield Close; and**
- (d) design and layout that ensures satisfactory impact on existing dwellings.**

12.115 A site to the north of Aller Road, to the south east of the village, is allocated for housing development; it is likely to meet the needs and demands for additional housing in Dolton for much of the plan period.

12.116 The capacity of the local sewage treatment works will need to be confirmed and any improvements funded by development. For this purpose, and for consideration of the access requirements, development of the site will be considered as a whole.

⁷⁰ 34 dwellings from completions since 2011 and sites under construction, with extant planning permission and approval subject to completion of a S106 agreement

12.117 The sloping site will require improved vehicular access that should also provide for suitable pedestrian access. Additional pedestrian access will be required to Barfield Close to the north.

12.118 Accommodation for the communities ageing population is a key element within Dolton's spatial strategy, a contribution to which should be delivered on this site. The form of development will be determined by a demonstration of local need. Any elderly person focused housing should be located at the western end of the site to maximise accessibility to the village centre.

12.119 The site is on the southern edge of the village and additional landscaping will be required to minimise the visual impact, especially on the southern and eastern boundaries. Development will be designed to protect the tree subject to a Tree Preservation Order in the south east corner of the site.

Community Facilities

Policy DOL02: Land South of Village Hall

(1) Land south of the village hall, as shown on Policies Map 15, is allocated for a mix of community and amenity uses and a limited number of dwellings.

(2) The community uses will include:

- (a) access to the rear of the village hall from South Street;**
- (b) an all weather car park to serve the village hall and village centre for approximately 15 – 20 vehicles located to the east of Atkins House;**
- (c) a pedestrian link to South Street from the new car park and village hall;**
- (d) a public footpath and cycle route from the village hall to Stafford Road; and**
- (e) amenity use of the land south of the village hall.**

(3) A maximum of three dwellings will be supported, the number of which will be determined through scheme design which must respect the sites location within the Conservation Area and adjacent listed building, The provided housing will:

- (a) be located to the south of, but outside the curtilage of Atkins House;**
- (b) provide the development identified in (2) (a) to (d) and the transfer of the remaining land within the Policy area to community ownership; and**
- (c) be accessed from the new route to the village hall car park.**

12.120 The village hall off South Street is a popular and well used venue in the community. It is located within the conservation area and close to listed buildings, in a prominent location on a valley side, on the south side of the village.

12.121 Access and parking arrangements to support the village hall are however poor. Land to the south of the hall is identified to improve these arrangements and to provide other community uses, provision of which will be enabled by a small amount of housing.

12.122 Policy DOL02: Land South of Village Hall is an enabling policy. The additional dwellings are considered necessary to enable the range of community benefits identified in Clause (2).

Permission for the dwellings will be dependent upon appropriate agreements to provide the improved access to, and car park for, the village hall, a safe pedestrian link to South Street, a convenient route to Stafford Road and the transfer of land in to community ownership for amenity uses.

12.123 The site is an important part of the setting of the village and is included in the conservation area for this reason. All development, including the improved access from South Street, will be expected to enhance the conservation area and protect the setting of the listed buildings and important views. The precise number and location of new dwellings will be determined in accordance with this requirement.

12.124 Access to the rear of the village hall is required for servicing, deliveries, emergency vehicles and must be capable of accommodating all visitors. The car park should be located away from the building to enable the space to be used for outdoor activities and to minimise the visual impact within the conservation area.

12.125 The required footpath and cycle link will join Stafford Road in a location convenient for the existing link to Stafford Way. The access to Stafford Road will minimise the loss of existing trees and accommodate all users. Existing trees within or on the boundary of the site will be retained.

12.126 Policy DOL02: Land South of Village Hall does not support any further specific development on the site and additional built development is unlikely to be acceptable in this location.

Other Facilities

12.127 The provision of other community facilities will be supported in accordance with the general policies of the Local Plan.

Halwill Junction

The Place

12.128 Halwill Junction is located 12 km (7.7 miles) south east of Holsworthy astride the A3079, at the southern boundary of the plan area, on the border with West Devon District. It is a linear village, having developed along the line of the old railway and the A3079.

12.129 The village has a range of services including several shops, post office, a community hall and primary school, sports and play provision and a regular doctor's service. Public transport services link the village with larger settlements. There is an employment area off Station Road at the southern end of the village but apart from local services the main activities locally are related to agriculture, forestry and tourism.

12.130 Halwill Junction lies outside any designated landscape area and there are no sites of national or countywide nature conservation importance close to the built up area. The Winsford Centre is a Grade II* listed building and there are a number of designated Ancient Monuments to the north of the village.

Spatial Strategy

12.131 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Halwill Junction and the surrounding rural area.

Policy HAL: Halwill Junction Spatial Strategy

The local community has a vision for the parish that seeks to improve self reliance, improve sustainability and protect the natural environment while maintaining the strong village community and attractiveness of the area to live, work and visit.

New development should be of a scale that addresses local needs, is preferably mainly to the north and east of the A3079 and retains the existing character of the area. Improvements in pedestrian and cycle safety, increased opportunities for sport and improved education and healthcare are also important.

The spatial vision will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 30 dwellings including affordable homes, to meet the range of housing needs in the local community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning consents and one additional site allocation with a capacity for approximately 25 dwellings;**
- (b) identifying a site for additional housing, within the development boundary off Chilla Road;**
- (c) considering the need for a limited number of suitable live-work units;**
- (d) retaining employment premises and support for the provision of additional employment units at Station Road;**
- (e) provision of additional recreation facilities including a bowling green, tennis court and cycling facilities;**
- (f) support for the retention and improvement of village facilities and services to meet the needs of the local community; and**

(g) delivery of superfast broadband connections.

Development Proposals

12.132 The spatial strategy for the village will be supported in a range of ways including the site specific policies below.

12.133 A development boundary for Halwill Junction is defined on Policies Map 16 outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

Policy HAL01: Land at Halwill Industrial Estate

(1) Land at Station Road, as shown on Policies Map 16, is allocated for economic development that includes a mix of unit sizes focused on meeting local business needs.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) a focus on employment premises within the B1, B2 and B8 Use Classes;**
- (b) a high standard of unified and individual design that has regard to the sites prominent location on the approach to the village;**
- (c) retention of existing screening on the road frontage and provision of adequate and appropriate screening on the northern boundary; and**
- (d) location, design, the use and screening of individual premises that provides an acceptable impact on adjoining uses.**

12.134 Land adjacent to the existing workshops is allocated for future employment development. Adequate access to the site is available.

12.135 Additional units should complement existing provision and provide a focus for economic development in the village. The site of about 0.33 hectares, together with the existing business units, is included within the development boundary and the latter will be retained for employment use in accordance with the general policies of the Local Plan.

12.136 The type and form of employment premises should be reflective of local market demand and it is envisaged that the site will be developed primarily with small units.

12.137 The site is on the edge of the village and close to residential development. Development will be of a type that respects this sensitive location and in response to which substantial planting will also be required on the northern boundary.

Housing

12.138 Additional housing is proposed to meet the needs and demands of Halwill Junction and its surrounding rural area over the plan period. At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively high

level of housing commitment in the village ⁽⁷¹⁾. The Local Plan allocates a site that is considered deliverable to meet both future housing and recreational needs.

Policy HAL02: Land East of Chilla Road

(1) Land east of Chilla Road, as shown on Policies Map 16, is allocated for residential development that includes:

- (a) approximately 25 dwellings, including affordable homes, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need; and**
- (b) recreation provision to serve the village, which includes a bowling green and tennis courts.**

(2) The site should be developed to deliver the following specific development principles:

- (a) provide vehicular access from Chilla Road;**
- (b) deliver recreation facilities on the southern section of the site;**
- (c) provide vehicular access to, and an appropriate car park for, the recreation facilities from Dreybury Lane in a manner that avoids the loss of mature trees;**
- (d) provide safe pedestrian and cycle access from the residential development and the recreation development to Dreybury Lane, and between the residential and recreation area;**
- (e) incorporate substantial landscaping on the northern boundary to enhance biodiversity and integrate the new development into the landscape; and**
- (f) an acceptable impact on the setting of the Grade II* Listed Winsford Centre.**

12.139 The 1.9 hectare site to the east of Chilla Road can provide a range of dwellings to meet local needs and demands; reflecting Halwill Junction's Local Centre status and the need to develop and sustain local services. The site slopes gently to the south with established boundaries on all but the north side. It is well related to the highway network and to the village centre and with appropriate landscaping, will not harm the landscape setting of the village.

12.140 The site east of Chilla Road is suitable for residential development and of sufficient size to provide a variety of dwellings to meet the housing needs and demands of the community for much of the plan period. If supported by demand, the site could also include on a limited and controlled basis live-work units. Development of the site in a single phase will not be appropriate. The site is also able to deliver the community aspiration for additional recreation facilities for the village, which will be delivered in a staged manner with the associated housing development.

12.141 The Winsford Centre to the south of the site is a Grade II* listed building. All development on the site of Policy HAL02: Land East of Chilla Road will be required to have an acceptable impact on the setting of the listed building and include measures to mitigate impact as necessary. To help protect the setting of the Winsford Centre, the recreation facilities will be located in the southern part of the site and safe access to these is required independent of the housing development.

71 29 dwellings from completions since 2011 and sites with extant planning permission and approval subject to the completion of a S106 agreement

12.142 The site has little natural screening and mature vegetation. Development will need to protect the existing trees and hedges and provide additional planting and landscaping on the boundaries and within the housing area, particularly between the phases of development and as part of amenity areas.

Community Facilities

12.143 Halwill Junction has a range of recreation provision and community services. The Local Plan safeguards the use of recreation sites and supports additional community facilities where a need is identified.

Hartland

The Place

12.144 Hartland is identified as a Local Centre that provides local services and facilities for the village and surrounding rural community. The village is situated on the B3248 approximately 24 km (15 miles) west of Bideford and 26 km (16 miles) east of Bude in Cornwall. Hartland has an important strategic position in the north west of the plan area serving a wide rural hinterland.

12.145 Hartland lies entirely within the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty in a gently undulating landscape. There are no sites of national nature conservation significance close to the village but part of the extensive Abbey Woods County Wildlife site extends into the plan area.

12.146 The historic core of Hartland lies in the south west of the village and is included within a designated conservation area centred on The Square and Fore Street. The majority of listed buildings are in or around The Square. A village design guide for Hartland has been prepared.

12.147 Hartland has expanded significantly since 2005 with a number of new housing developments on the eastern side of the village. Employment is mainly in agriculture, tourism and services at dispersed locations and there is a small development of industrial units at Harton Cross.

12.148 The village has a range of facilities and services including a post office, several shops, parish hall, GP surgery, primary and a small secondary school and car repair facilities. There are several galleries and potteries, which also cater for the number of visitors to the village and five pubs/clubs.

Spatial Strategy

12.149 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Hartland and the surrounding rural area.

Policy HAR: Hartland Spatial Strategy

The community has a vision for the village that supports a modest level of housing growth with a preference for land on the east side of the village and a pace of development that allows integration into the community. Self-build housing is supported, as is that to meet local needs, including for the elderly.

A desire for all development to reflect the vernacular style is also recognised as important. In addition there is support for the protection of the attractive environment, which together with the surrounding working countryside is considered to be a key economic driver for the area.

Retention and improvement of existing local services, facilities and employment opportunities are also of recognised importance.

The vision will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 104 dwellings, including affordable homes, to meet the range of housing needs in the community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning consents and an allocated site;
- (b) identifying one site for housing to the east of Pengilly Way to accommodate about 40 new dwellings with additional potential being provided at Eastdown Park on the basis of the delivery of a landscape restoration focused scheme;

- (c) a footpath link between Hartland and Harton Cross;
- (d) retention of social and community facilities required to support existing residents and new development;
- (e) improved sports and recreation facilities to support existing residents and new development;
- (f) support for the creation of more appropriate employment opportunities and delivery of superfast broadband connections; and
- (g) giving great weight to conserving landscape and natural beauty in the consideration of proposals for development.

The Development Proposals

12.150 The spatial strategy for the village will be supported in a range of ways including the site specific policies below.

12.151 A development boundary for Hartland is defined on Policies Map 17, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis. As the village is within the designated Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty great weight will be given to conserving landscape and natural beauty in consideration of proposals for development.

Employment

12.152 The small employment area on the edge of the village at Harton Way accommodates a range of local services. Any proposals for alternative uses on this site will be considered against the general policies of the Local Plan.

12.153 The Local Plan does not make a specific allocation of land for additional economic development in Hartland. Economic development in Hartland can capitalise on enhanced levels of assistance offered by its location in an area subject to Assisted Area status. Proposals that come forward during the plan period will be considered against the general policies of the Local Plan.

Housing

12.154 Additional housing is proposed to meet the needs and demands of the settlement of Hartland and its surrounding rural area over the plan period. At 31st March 2017 there was a sizeable level of housing commitment in the village ⁽⁷²⁾. The Local Plan identifies a further site that is considered to be deliverable.

Policy HAR01: Land East of Pengilly Way

(1) Land east of Pengilly Way, as shown on Policies Map 17, is allocated for residential development that provides approximately 40 dwellings, including affordable homes, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need, including a proportion of plots for self build dwellings.

(2) The site will be developed to deliver the following specific development principles:

72 74 dwellings from completions since 2011 and sites under construction, with extant planning permission

(a) provide a safe and convenient pedestrian and cycle link within the site between Pengilly Way and Harton Cross;

(b) minimise the visual impact of the development when viewed from the north by means of layout, location and design of dwellings and appropriate substantial landscaping; and

(c) maximise the retention of the mature trees and hedge along Fore Street/Harton Cross and enhancement of the biodiversity based on existing site features.

12.155 A greenfield site is proposed for residential development to the east of Pengilly Way, adjacent to Fore Street. The development opportunity provided by the 2.5 hectare site reflects the village's Local Centre status and will principally meet the needs of Hartland over the plan period.

12.156 Although within the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty the site has minimal impact on the landscape and scenic beauty of the area and it is well related to the highway network and to village services and facilities. Development of the site will need to avoid the appearance of coalescence between Hartland and Harton Cross.

12.157 This site to the east of Pengilly Way is generally level, set slightly above the surrounding area. The site has been agreed by the local community as the preferred area to be allocated within the Local Plan.

12.158 Safe access to the area is required which should maximise the retention of the distinctive hedge and tree line on the Fore Street/Harton Cross approach to the village.

12.159 A convenient footpath and cycle route across the site to avoid use of the main road will be provided as part of the development.

12.160 The location of the site within the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty requires that development has minimal impact when viewed from the surrounding countryside. Substantial boundary landscaping is required, together with further enhancement of biodiversity based on existing features. Detailed design, layout and landscaping will ensure the development does not provide an urban appearance on its boundary or internally.

Policy HAR02: Land at Eastdown Park

(1) Land at Eastdown Park, as shown on Policies Map 17, is allocated for landscape restoration and housing.

(2) Landscape restoration will:

(a) occupy at least 50% of the site;

(b) be primarily located on the northern portion of the site and on the site boundaries;

(c) comprise woodland planting, reinforcement of existing and establishment of new hedgerows and parkland planting;

(d) be undertaken as part of the initial phase of development; and

(e) be accessible to the public.

(3) Residential development will comprise approximately 20 units of a variety of sizes including opportunities for self build.

12.161 Eastdown Park is a largely vacant and derelict site situated in the rural area and in the AONB about 1 kilometre east of Hartland. The site is about 2.1 hectares. Housing to the south of the site was formerly occupied by MoD personnel, but is now private. Since MoD use of the site ceased, parts have been used by a number of community activities.

12.162 To secure improvement of the appearance of the site in this sensitive location, some housing development will be permitted. The need to restore the appearance of the site is considered to outweigh concerns about the sustainability of development in this location.

12.163 Development on the site will be permitted in order to secure its visual improvement and restore a rural appearance from public viewpoints.

12.164 The site will be planned and developed in a coordinated way and appropriate agreements will be required to secure implementation of the landscape restoration requirements which should be in a single phase at the start of development. The element of landscaping excludes private gardens and amenity space about the dwellings.

12.165 Existing community uses on the site may be retained. All other structures and surfaces should be removed.

12.166 The detailed design and layout of new dwellings or plots should have an acceptable impact on the amenity of existing dwellings on the borders of the site. Adequate vehicle access will be required and provision for a convenient bus stop at the entrance.

12.167 The development will need to make adequate arrangements for sewerage and sewage treatment. The local planning authority will be required to be satisfied that any contamination or waste material arising from previous uses has been removed prior to development.

Sport and Recreation

12.168 Hartland has a limited range of recreation facilities including a football pitch and tennis courts. These and other areas of public open space will be protected from other uses in accordance with the general policies of the Local Plan.

12.169 A number of footpaths and other routes give access to the surrounding countryside.

12.170 The community aspires to see improved recreation and sports facilities, including completion of the refurbishment of the parish hall.

Education, Healthcare and other Facilities

12.171 Hartland provides a range of services including a primary school, private secondary school and parish hall.

12.172 There is a GP surgery which, together with other community facilities, the community is anxious to see retained in the long term. The community also supports proposals that supply additional appropriate housing for older people within the village and the improvement of public transport services.

High Bickington

The Place

12.173 High Bickington provides local services and facilities for the village and surrounding community. The village is situated close to the Taw Valley, about 13kms (8 miles) south of Barnstaple and 11kms (7 miles) east of Great Torrington.

12.174 High Bickington lies outside any designated landscape area and there are no sites of national or countywide nature conservation importance close to the built up area. The village lies on a plateau, above the Taw Valley where long views to the east are important.

12.175 The historic character of the village centre and surrounding properties has been retained and forms the basis of the conservation area shown on Policies Map 18. The Grade I Church of St Mary, which dates in part from the C12th, is on the western side of the village centre and conservation area.

12.176 Local services include, shops, a primary school, community halls, pubs, a post office, play areas, a sports pitch and mobile library. Development to the south of the village at Little Bickington includes housing, employment and a range of community facilities.

Spatial Strategy

12.177 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development, supported by necessary infrastructure, to meet the needs of High Bickington and the surrounding rural area.

Policy HBK: High Bickington Spatial Strategy

The community's spatial vision for the Local Centre is that it should continue to develop to provide a range of facilities and services needed by local residents, in a planned and coordinated manner. These should include affordable housing, a new school, parking facilities for the village, additional shops, amenity areas and improvements to the Conservation Area.

The vision will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 95 dwellings, including affordable homes, to meet a range of housing needs in the community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning consents and 2 site allocations with a capacity for approximately 50 dwellings;**
- (b) two additional housing sites within the development boundary at Little Bickington Lane and North Farm;**
- (c) provision for a village car park and additional shop;**
- (d) provision for a new primary school;**
- (e) retention of existing and additional recreation facilities and amenity open space; and**
- (f) support for additional employment provision to meet local requirements.**

The Development Proposals

12.178 The spatial strategy for the village will be supported in a range of ways including the site specific policies below.

12.179 A development boundary for High Bickington is defined on Policies Map 18 outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.180 The development at Little Bickington has provided 6 small workshop units. Other employment in the village is primarily in service activities.

12.181 Any further requirement during the life of the plan for additional land or premises to accommodate businesses able to provide a service to, or employment for, local people will be considered in terms of the general policies of the Local Plan.

Housing

12.182 Considerable additional housing has been provided in the village since 2011⁽⁷³⁾ and there is a continuing commitment, including at Little Bickington. Further sites are proposed to meet the spatial strategy for High Bickington over the plan period.

12.183 The sites identified are believed to be deliverable. They will be released to ensure a steady pace of development over the plan period and in accordance with the village's spatial strategy. The order of presentation does not reflect any priority for release of the sites.

Policy HBK01: Land at Little Bickington Lane

(1) Land south of Little Bickington Lane, as shown on Policies Map 18, is allocated for residential development that includes:

- (a) approximately 25 dwellings, including affordable homes, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need;**
- (b) an area for use as allotments of approximately 0.2ha; and**
- (c) a serviced site of about 0.6 ha for a doctor's surgery.**

(2) The site should be developed to meet the following specific development principles:

- (a) vehicular access from Little Bickington Road;**
- (b) the site for the doctor's surgery to meet community requirements to be located close to the community centre;**
- (c) the allotment area to be accessible from Little Bickington Road;**
- (d) retention of existing boundary hedges and additional planting within and on the edges of housing areas to enhance biodiversity and integrate the development into the landscape;**
- (e) a pedestrian link to Quarries Lane; and**

73 41 completions since 2011 and 5 units subject to extant planning permission

(f) a layout and design that provides an acceptable impact on the Conservation Area and the Grade I listed Church of St Mary.

12.184 An additional greenfield site for housing and community facilities is proposed at Little Bickington, to the south of Little Bickington Lane. The relatively level site is an extension of the existing development and can provide a range of dwellings to meet local needs and reflect the Local Centre status of the village and help support local services. The site extends to about 1.88 hectares.

12.185 The site south of existing development can provide additional dwellings and community facilities to serve the village. Development of the site in a single phase will not be appropriate unless demonstrated by local need.

12.186 New allotment facilities will be required before development takes place on the site of the existing provision. The site for the doctor's surgery will be identified in consultation with community representatives and provided in the first phase of development.

12.187 Tree planting on site boundaries is necessary to minimise the impact of new development in a largely rural location and to integrate it into the landscape. The pedestrian link to Quarries Lane will enable a footpath route through the development from Little Bickington Road.

Policy HBK02: Land at North Farm

(1) Land to the east of North Road, as shown on Policies Map 18, is proposed for residential development that includes:

- (a) approximately 25 dwellings, including affordable homes, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need;**
- (b) a public car park to accommodate approximately 15-20 vehicles; and**
- (c) premises for a shop to serve the needs of the village.**

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) a single vehicular access from North Road, to the south of the Golden Lion public house;**
- (b) the car park conveniently located for the services and amenities in the village;**
- (c) the shop premises to be located on or close to North Road;**
- (d) tree and hedge planting on the eastern boundary of the site; and**
- (e) design and layout that minimises the impact of development on existing adjoining properties.**

12.188 A site off North Road, to the rear of existing properties and including the buildings of North Farm, is proposed for residential development to deliver additional community benefits. Development requires comprehensive proposals for the area including the relocation of the extensive farm buildings currently on the site.

12.189 Comprehensive and coordinated development of this site provides the opportunity for community benefits including relocation of the extensive farm buildings away from the village centre.

12.190 The western boundary of the site borders the village and the conservation area and the site of the proposed access lies within it. Appropriate design and layout of the access, car park and buildings will therefore be required which reflects local characteristics and enhances the village.

12.191 The eastern boundary of the site has no natural boundaries and the provision of a tree and hedge screen is required to reduce the impact of new development. Existing properties on North Road border the site and the detailed design will need to ensure acceptable impact on the amenities of these properties.

12.192 The car park and shop premises should be provided in the early phases of development.

12.193 Prior to any development taking place the local planning authority will be required to be satisfied that any potential contamination arising from use of the existing farm buildings has been removed.

Recreation and Open Space

12.194 The existing site to the west of Barton Meadow is retained for its present recreation use as is the sports field south of Quarry Road. The community woodland, adjacent to Quarry Road, is also treated as open space for the purposes of the plans general policies.

Policy HBK03: Land South of Community Centre

Land south of the community centre off Little Bickington Lane, as shown on Policies Map 18, is allocated for recreation use to serve the local community and a future primary school.

12.195 The planning permission for comprehensive development at Little Bickington includes sports pitches for dual use by the school and local community. The site of about 1.6 hectares, to the south of the community centre, is identified outside the development boundary on Policies Map 18 and is subject to the following policy.

Education

12.196 The need for a new village primary school has been identified by the education authority and the community. A site has been identified as part of the Little Bickington development.

Policy HBK04: Land at Little Bickington Lane

A site for a new primary school and associated amenity area is shown on Policies Map 18 at Little Bickington Lane.

12.197 A new primary school, which is expected to be incorporated with, and make use of, the Community Hall and the adjoining recreation site (Policy HBK03) will be constructed during the plan period. Attention to surface water drainage will be required within the amenity area. To protect the site from other development proposals it is identified outside the development boundary.

Instow

The Place

12.198 Instow is located overlooking the mouth of the Taw-Torridge estuary either side of Anstey Way (B3233), the Barnstaple to Bideford road, about 4 kilometres (2.5 miles) from Bideford and 9.5 kilometres (6 miles) west of Barnstaple. Instow Town, which provides the primary school and parish church, is separated by the main road. The village as a whole has a range of services and facilities for its residents, including a primary school, parish hall, convenience store, vehicle and marine services and a number of pubs. Local services also meet the needs of visitors to the area, including a hotel and the majority of employment is in tourism sectors. Instow Ward has Assisted Area status.

12.199 The village is situated on a slope rising above the estuary and is prominent on the waterfront, especially when viewed from Appledore. The main village is located within the Coastal and Estuarine Zone (Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy). The whole of the Taw-Torridge Estuary is designated as a Site of Special Scientific Interest, which forms the buffer zone for the Biosphere Reserve. Instow is across the estuary from the Braunton Burrows Special Area of Conservation and there are a number of County Wildlife Sites close to the village.

12.200 Instow's conservation area includes most of the village between Anstey Way (B3233) and the estuary. The gardens at Tapeley Park are included on the Historic England Register of Parks and Gardens of Special Historic Interest. Flood defences protect the majority of the village from tidal flooding although a risk remains to some property from streams joining the river to the north and south of the village.

12.201 The local economy is dominated by tourism related industries. Instow has a relatively high level of second home ownership that adds to the overall level of tourism accommodation in the parish. Other employment opportunities are mostly outside of the parish.

Spatial Strategy

12.202 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Instow and the surrounding area. The local community has a vision for the village that it should remain a thriving community with a range of facilities and activities, keeping its present characteristics. This recognises that Instow is a desirable place to live for retired people but also functions as a commuter village for those working in Barnstaple and Bideford whilst being a tourist destination in its own right. Existing services and facilities support all of these functions.

Policy INS: Instow Spatial Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable growth of high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Instow. The spatial vision for Instow will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 38 new dwellings to meet the range of housing need in the local community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning consents and the allocation of three sites totalling 20 dwellings and two non-strategic housing sites;**
- (b) maintaining the character of the village by appropriately designed and located development;**

- (c) support for the retention of village facilities and services to meet the needs of the local community and visitors to the area;
- (d) capitalise on enhanced levels of assistance offered by the Assisted Areas status;
- (e) provision of a children's play area to serve the village and retention of existing recreation and sports facilities; and
- (f) improved connectivity to Barnstaple through traffic management measures.

12.203 The spatial strategy to improve connectivity to Barnstaple complements the spatial strategy for Fremington and Yelland (Policy FRE: Fremington and Yelland Spatial Vision and Development Strategy) to improve connectivity through traffic management measures at Bickington and Cedars roundabout.

The Development Proposals

12.204 The spatial strategy for the village will be supported through site-specific policies. A development boundary for Instow including Instow Town, is defined on Policies Map 19 outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis. The development boundary includes the majority of the built up area of the village.

Employment

12.205 Employment locally is primarily in service activities including tourism that are important to the role of the village. The Local Plan does not make a specific allocation for economic development land in Instow although the Ward will capitalise on enhanced levels of assistance offered by the Assisted Areas status. Any proposals will be considered in terms of the general policies of the Local Plan.

Housing

12.206 Additional housing is proposed to meet the needs and demands of Instow over the plan period and in accordance with the spatial strategy. At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively modest level of housing commitments in Instow⁽⁷⁴⁾. The Local Plan allocates three additional sites plus two non-strategic housing sites for approximately 13 dwellings (see Appendix 5).

Policy INS01: Land at Barton Cross

(1) Land at the junction of Anstey Way and Rectory Lane, as shown on Policies Map 19, is proposed for approximately 5 dwellings with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types, tenures and sizes to reflect local needs.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) safe vehicular access that takes account of existing junctions from Anstey Way with Rectory Lane and Marine Parade and existing pedestrian crossing facilities;
- (b) protection and enhancement of existing hedges with wildlife or amenity value and additional planting on the southern and eastern boundaries to enhance

74 9 dwellings from completions since 2011, under construction and extant planning permissions

biodiversity, integrate the development into its countryside setting and minimise the impact on existing development; and

(c) no homes to be located adjoining Rectory Lane on land at risk of flooding and to protect setting and views of the listed St. John the Baptist Church from the northern edge of the village.

12.207 A site at the junction of Anstey Way and Rectory Lane is proposed for residential development. The site is in a prominent location at the entrance to the village on sloping land providing a countryside setting to the village when viewed from across the estuary. Development of the lower part of the slope will not harm this setting but substantial planting will be required on the southern and eastern boundaries to provide a transitional boundary between the development and the adjoining countryside.

12.208 The north-eastern part of the site is identified by the Environment Agency as at risk of flooding where vulnerable development will not be permitted. Safeguarding this land from development will also protect the setting of the Grade I listed Church of St. John the Baptist. This area should remain free of vulnerable development and provide a landscaped edge to the site. A high standard of design is required that reflects the characteristics of the village, including protection of views of the Grade I listed Church of St John the Baptist across the northern part of the site and the associated landscape setting of Instow.

Policy INS02: Land at Anstey Way

(1) Land at Anstey Way, as shown on Policies Map 19, is proposed for approximately 5 dwellings.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

(a) a single vehicular access from Anstey Way; and

(b) substantial planting on the northern and eastern boundaries to enhance biodiversity, integrate the development into its countryside setting and minimise the impact on existing development.

12.209 A small infill site east of Anstey Way, between existing dwellings, is proposed for residential development. The slope rising from the eastern side of Anstey Way forms part of the countryside setting of Instow. Development along the lower slopes, adjoining the main road, will minimise any impact on the setting of the village. A high standard of design and layout will be required in this prominent location on the main road that will allow for views through the development to the countryside beyond.

Policy INS03: Land North of Marine Parade

(1) Land at Marine Parade, as shown on Policies Map 19, is proposed for residential development that includes:

(a) approximately 10 dwellings with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types, tenures and sizes to reflect local needs; and

(b) open space including a children's play area.

(2) The site will be developed to deliver the following specific development principles:

- (a) residential development on the southern part of the site;**
- (b) a new equipped children's play area and amenity open space to serve the village;**
- (c) pedestrian and cycle access to the Tarka Trail;**
- (d) no homes to be located on land at risk of flooding; and**
- (e) adequate measures to protect the amenities of users of the adjoining accommodation along the Tarka Trail.**

12.210 The site north of Marine Parade is well related to the services available in the village and the Tarka Trail. A small residential development here will secure community benefits of a children's play area and amenity greenspace with good access to the Tarka Trail. The northern part of the site is identified by the Environment Agency as at risk of flooding where vulnerable development will not be permitted; safeguarding this land from development will also protect the setting of the Grade I listed Church of St. John the Baptist. Residential development will be restricted to the area outside of the flood zone and will comprise a mixture of house types, sizes and tenures to meet local needs.

12.211 A high standard of design will be required on this prominent site. The development will be designed to have a satisfactory relationship between the new houses and adjacent holiday accommodation to protect the amenities of both properties, as well as safeguarding the adjoining ATTURM facility.

12.212 A single vehicular access will be provided to Marine Parade. Safe and convenient pedestrian and cycle access will be required through the site and onto the Tarka Trail, together with a safe pedestrian crossing on Marine Parade. The equipped play area and amenity greenspace will be on the northern part of the site with access to both the Tarka Trail and the residential development, whilst ensuring the area is safe and secure for users.

Community Facilities

12.213 Recreation facilities within Instow include the beach, North Devon Cricket Club, the North Devon Yacht Club, South West Coast Path and the Tarka Trail. All of these facilities are used and valued by local residents and visitors and will be protected for the social and economic benefits they bring to the village and wide area. The Councils will support the provision of appropriate additional or replacement primary school provision for the village at a suitable location.

12.214 Instow is a popular visitor destination and the availability of adequate parking is an issue for the community. Existing off-street parking is limited or unattractive to users. No specific site is identified for additional parking for visitors, users of the Tarka Trail and beach, but the Council will support suitable proposals or the improvement of existing facilities.

North Molton

The Place

12.215 North Molton is a recognised local centre providing local services, facilities and employment for the village and surrounding community including a primary school, community hall, post office, convenience store, garage, sports pitches and pubs. There is little employment in the village other than that related to these services and local agricultural activity.

12.216 The village has a linear settlement pattern and is situated within the foothills of Exmoor, about 1 kilometre (0.6 miles) from the National Park boundary. It is about 4 kilometres (2.5 miles) north of South Molton. The village is situated in a valley that runs east to west with steeply rising ground to the north and south. This landscape setting, and the descent to the valley of the river Mole to the east, help define the character of the village.

12.217 A conservation area is centred on the Church, The Square and the western end of Fore Street, with proposals for extension to include the remainder of Fore Street. Most of the listed buildings in the village are within the conservation area, although much of the remainder of the village retains its traditional character.

12.218 There are a number of County Wildlife Sites around the village, including Holdridge Woods to the south-east. The valley of the River Mole, including a number of properties at the eastern end of the village are subject to flood risk.

Spatial Strategy

12.219 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of North Molton and the surrounding rural area including the fringe of Exmoor National Park. The local community has aspirations to protect the rural character of the village and its existing services and facilities, whilst ensuring adequate and appropriate new facilities and infrastructure are available, and supports the additional development required to help achieve these.

Policy NMO: North Molton Spatial Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable growth of high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of North Molton. The spatial vision for North Molton will be delivered through:

- (a) the provision of a minimum of 141 new dwellings to meet the range of need in the local community and provide additional community benefits. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning consents and allocation of two sites totalling approximately 50 dwellings and a non-strategic housing site;**
- (b) safeguarding the dark night skies over Exmoor National Park;**
- (c) maintaining the character and appearance of the village and its setting by appropriately designed and located development;**
- (d) supporting the retention and expansion of village facilities and services to meet the needs of the local community and visitors to the area;**
- (e) supporting improvements in highway safety in the vicinity of the school including provision of a safe pedestrian/cycle access between the school and the sports club;**

- (f) improvements to the existing sewage treatment works; and**
- (g) support for connection of the village to a mains gas supply.**

The Development Proposals

12.220 The spatial strategy for the village will be supported by site specific policies that identify the range and nature of development to be delivered along with key development principles. A development boundary for North Molton is defined on Policies Map 20 outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis. The development boundary includes opportunities for additional development alongside the sites subject to specific policies.

Employment

12.221 Employment locally is primarily in service activities that are important to the role of the village. The Pathfields Business Park at South Molton is accessible and provides a wide range of economic development opportunities. There is local support for the provision of economic development within the village, with a recent planning permission being granted for five light industrial units on land west of Oakford Villas. During the plan period there may be a requirement for further land to accommodate new businesses, although the Local Plan does not make a specific allocation of employment land in North Molton. If the local economy identifies the need for an alternative site to deliver economic development, Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages would support such development. Proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for North Molton.

Housing

12.222 Additional housing is proposed to meet the needs and demands of North Molton over the plan period. At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively high level of housing commitments in North Molton⁽⁷⁵⁾. The Local Plan allocates two sites plus a non-strategic housing site at South of Oakford Lea for approximately 7 dwellings (see Appendix 5).

Policy NMO01: Land off Back Lane

(1) Land off Back Lane as shown on Policies Map 20, is proposed for approximately 25 dwellings with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local needs.

(2) The site should be developed to deliver the following specific development principles:

- (a) a design and layout that respects the location of the site adjacent to the conservation area and safeguards the historic setting of the listed Court House;**
- (b) a safe and convenient pedestrian route through the site linking to the village centre;**
- (c) retention and enhancement of existing hedgerows to protect the amenities of adjoining residential properties;**
- (d) safeguarding the dark night skies over Exmoor National Park; and**

⁷⁵ 87 dwellings from completions since 2011, under construction and extant planning permissions

(e) adequate contribution towards addressing deficiency in the capacity or performance of the sewage treatment works to enable the development as a whole to proceed.

12.223 A site off Back Lane on the northern side of the village is proposed for residential development to provide a variety of dwellings to meet the needs of the community. The site is well related to the village centre and existing residential properties and development would round off the north-western part of the village.

12.224 The design and layout of new houses will need to respect the character and appearance of the adjoining conservation area and safeguard the historic setting of the Grade II* listed Court House. In view of the site's topography, the development should avoid overlooking of the existing properties in Back Lane to the south and Oakford Close to the west through the enhancement of existing hedge boundaries. A satisfactory relationship between these properties and new housing is required in order to protect the amenities of both. Development must be designed to minimise light pollution affecting the Dark Sky Reserve over Exmoor.

12.225 Development of the site will require an improved vehicular access. If a suitable vehicular access is provided off Back Lane, any loss of the existing hedgebank will require a replacement of equivalent biodiversity value to compensate. Also, any improvements to the highway should retain the rural appearance of a lane as far as possible. If access is from Oakford Villas, appropriate traffic management measures will be required. The development will also require a safe pedestrian and cycle link through the site towards the village centre. Any deficiency in the capacity or performance of the sewage treatment works will need to be identified and resolved as part of the development.

Policy NMO02: Land at Old Road

(1) Land at Old Road as shown on Policies Map 20, is proposed for development to include:

- (a) approximately 25 dwellings with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local needs;**
- (b) community use of areas of strategic landscaping on the upper slopes of the southern part of the site; and**
- (c) a safe and convenient pedestrian and cycle route through the development to the North Molton Sports Club.**

(2) The site should be developed to deliver the following specific development principles:

- (a) strategic planting on the southern portion of the site;**
- (b) vehicular access from Old Road;**
- (c) enhancement of existing hedgerows;**
- (d) safeguard the dark night skies over Exmoor National Park; and**
- (e) adequate contribution towards addressing deficiency in the capacity or performance of the sewage treatment works to enable the development as a whole to proceed.**

12.226 A site at Old Road between existing housing development and the Sports Club on the south side of the village is proposed for residential development to provide a variety of dwelling types to meet the needs of the local community. Lower density development with enhanced landscaping would assist the transition to the area of strategic planting and accessible natural greenspace along the southern part of the site. Development must be designed to minimise light pollution affecting the Dark Sky Reserve over Exmoor.

12.227 The site forms part of the landscape setting of the village. An area of strategic planting and green infrastructure on the southern part of the site is required to integrate the development into its landscape setting, provide a transitional boundary between the development and adjoining countryside, especially when viewed from the village and countryside to the north and as a buffer to safeguard the amenities of the new housing from recreation and leisure uses at the Sports Club. The proposed strategic planting could include a community woodland and informal open space accessible to the local community.

12.228 If provision of a suitable vehicular access requires widening of Old Lane and loss of the existing hedgebank, then a replacement hedgebank of equivalent biodiversity value will be required to compensate. Any improvements to the highway should retain the appearance of a rural lane as far as possible. The development will be required to provide a safe and convenient pedestrian and cycle route through the development to the area of informal open space and North Molton Sports Club. Any deficiency in the capacity or performance of the sewage treatment works will need to be identified and resolved as part of the development.

Community Facilities

12.229 The sewage treatment works at North Molton has limited spare capacity. Investigations into potential improvements will be necessary. Developer contributions will be required towards the costs of improving this infrastructure with any requirements implemented before significant new development can take place.

12.230 The Sports Club and Community Centre provide a wide range of recreation activities for the community and is safeguarded for this use. Opportunities for additional sport and recreation facilities will be supported. The sports club is identified as a hub site.

12.231 The Council will welcome traffic management measures that reduce vehicular traffic near the primary school. Any additional development at the school must include appropriate traffic management measures to ensure access for all users remains safe. The Borne's Bridge junction on the A361 is a key junction serving North Molton. Improvements to highway safety at this junction are proposed as part of the spatial strategy for South Molton (Policy SMO: South Molton Spatial Vision and Development Strategy). The local community would support the village being connected to a mains gas supply. Whilst the plan cannot deliver such major infrastructure for the village, such a desire has been recognised in the spatial strategy for North Molton and is supported by Policy ST22: Community Services and Facilities.

Shebbear

The Place

12.232 Shebbear provides local services and facilities for the village and surrounding rural community. The village is situated 12.5 km (8 miles) north east of Holsworthy and about 13.5 km (8.5 miles) south of Great Torrington.

12.233 Shebbear lies outside any designated landscape area and there are no sites of national or countywide nature conservation importance close to the built up area. The village has a linear form with the parish church and square at the western end providing a focus for the village.

12.234 Local services include employment within the village and at Lake Workshops, a shop, a primary school, community hall, vehicle repair facilities, a doctor's surgery and a variety of recreation facilities. The village has grown significantly since 2000 with a number of new residential developments.

12.235 Access to the village is via rural, mostly narrow, roads. The local sewage treatment plant has very limited capacity and any significant new housing will require enhancement of the capacity of the works.

Spatial Strategy

12.236 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Shebbear and the surrounding rural area.

Policy SHB: Shebbear Spatial Strategy

The local community has a vision for the parish that recognises the opportunities and limitations of its location. In summary the vision is to help Shebbear remain a place where people want to live, and where they can live peacefully and safely. It recognises that the community will need to be largely self sufficient, providing better employment opportunities for younger people and meeting the needs of an ageing local population.

The spatial vision will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 28 dwellings, including affordable homes, to meet the range of housing needs in the local community, including the need to accommodate elderly and retired persons. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning consents and one allocation with a capacity for approximately 30 dwellings;
- (b) identifying a site for additional housing, within the development boundary at Haycross Lane;
- (c) supporting the provision of a limited number of suitable live-work units;
- (d) retaining employment premises and support for the provision of additional employment units at Lake Workshops;
- (e) support for the retention of village facilities and services to meet the needs of the local community and retain the Local Centre status; and
- (f) improvements to local highways for convenience and safety and to local public transport to provide adequate access to Bideford, Holsworthy and Great Torrington for employment, education and shopping.

The Development Proposals

12.237 The spatial strategy for the village will be supported in a range of ways including the site specific policies below.

12.238 A development boundary for Shebbear is defined on Policies Map 21, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis. The employment area at Lake is included in a separate development boundary.

Employment

Policy SHB01: Land at Lake Workshops

(1) Land at Lake Workshops, as shown on Policies Map 21, is allocated for economic development that includes a mix of unit sizes to meet local business needs.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

- (a) a focus on employment premises within the B1, B2 and B8 Use Classes;**
- (b) a high standard of unified design and appearance in view of the location of the site in the countryside;**
- (c) appropriate screening on the southern boundary to integrate the development into its countryside setting; and**
- (d) location, design and screening of individual premises and uses that provides acceptable impact on adjoining uses.**

12.239 Land adjacent to the existing workshops is allocated for further economic development to provide opportunities for local businesses. Adequate access to the site is available.

12.240 A site of about 0.37 hectares is proposed for economic development at Lake. Additional units will complement existing provision and provide a focus for employment activity in the village. The site, together with the existing business units, is included within the development boundary and will be retained for employment use in accordance with the general policies of the Local Plan.

12.241 The type and form of employment premises should be reflective of local market demand and it is envisaged that the site will be developed primarily with small units. Open storage uses are not likely to be appropriate if they provide limited employment or have adverse impact on existing neighbouring uses.

12.242 The site is in a countryside location and proposals will be expected to respect this sensitive location. In particular, substantial planting will be required on the southern boundary to help integrate the development into its rural setting and elsewhere to minimise any impacts on neighbouring property.

Housing

12.243 Additional housing is proposed to meet the needs and demands of the settlement of Shebbear and its surrounding rural area over the plan period. At 31st March 2017 there was only

a relatively modest level of housing commitments within the village ⁽⁷⁶⁾. The Local Plan identifies an additional housing site, which is considered to be deliverable.

Policy SHB02: Land West of Haycross Hill

(1) Land west of Haycross Hill, as shown on Policies Map 21, is allocated for residential development that includes:

- (a) approximately 30 dwellings, including affordable homes, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local needs; and**
- (b) an area for the provision of up to 3 live-work units.**

(2) The site should be developed to deliver the following specific development principles:

- (a) adequate vehicular access to Haycross Hill;**
- (b) improved pedestrian links to the village centre;**
- (c) assessment, and remediation prior to the commencement of development, of any site contamination arising from previous uses;**
- (d) protection of all trees and hedges with wildlife or amenity value and additional planting within and on the edges of the site to enhance biodiversity, subdivide the development and integrate the new development into the landscape;**
- (e) improvements to the sewage treatment works to enable the development to proceed; and**
- (f) the live-work units should be located together and should:**
 - (i) be of a size and type to reflect local market demand,**
 - (ii) be controlled to ensure they remain a mixed residential/employment use; and**
 - (iii) provide identified business use on at least 25% of the floorspace (excluding parking areas).**

12.244 The former Endford Works on Haycross Hill is occupied by West Country Concrete Products. The site has a B2 Class employment use, not ideally suited to its location within the village. Should the present use of the site cease as the owners intend, it is considered to offer the best opportunity to meet the housing needs of the village over the plan period, while additionally addressing amenity impacts generated by the site's current operation. In this case the loss of the employment site is considered acceptable in view of environmental and amenity gains, and having regard to the alternative opportunity for employment generating development at Lake Workshops (Policy SHB01).

12.245 The site is well related to the centre of the village and its range of services.

12.246 The site at Haycross Hill of about 1.25 hectares is suitable for residential development and of sufficient size to provide a variety of dwellings to meet the needs of the community for much of the plan period. Development of the site in a single phase will not be appropriate. However,

76 17 dwellings from completions since 2011 and sites under construction and with extant planning permission

all employment related activities and structures, and any likely contaminants identified on the site, will need to be removed prior to the commencement of residential development.

12.247 While the site has relatively good vehicular access there is no separate pedestrian link to the village centre. The development will be expected to improve the route for pedestrians to the village Square although it is recognised that a segregated route for the entire distance may not be achievable.

12.248 Any deficiency in the capacity of the sewage treatment works will need to be identified and resolved as part of the development. For this purpose, the allocated site should be regarded as a single development.

12.249 The community has expressed a preference for the provision of housing to meet the needs of elderly people from the locality, including the provision of on site support for residents if feasible. Subject to the confirmation of local demand, development of part of the site will be expected to address this need.

12.250 A section of the site is required to accommodate a limited number of purpose built live-work units, subject to confirmation of demand. These units will be subject to appropriate control to ensure that the design provides for a genuine mixed use, they do not become 100% residential and can be satisfactorily accommodated near to housing. Evidence of likely on-going need for the units will be required before planning permission is granted.

Community Facilities

12.251 The village has a Community School and voluntary play group. Shebbear College is located on the edge of the village.

12.252 Recreation facilities are limited to a site next to the village hall and a football field adjacent to Lake Workshops, together with play areas within housing estates. Local Plan policies aim to prevent the loss of these community facilities.

Winkleigh

The Place

12.253 Winkleigh is a thriving village with an active community and a good range of local services and facilities for the village and surrounding rural community. The village is situated on the A3124 approximately 19 km (12 miles) from Great Torrington and 14 km (9 miles) from Okehampton. It lies on the southern edge of the plan area, close to the boundaries with Mid and West Devon Districts, serving residents in parts of both neighbouring districts.

12.254 Winkleigh lies outside any designated landscape or countryside area and there are no sites of national or countywide nature conservation importance close to the built up area. The village is within the high culm ridges landscape area where long views are an important characteristic.

12.255 The historic character of the village centre has been retained and forms the basis of the conservation area shown on Policies Map 22. The Church of All Saints is Grade I listed and there is an extensive designated Ancient Monument centred on the site of Castle Court at the eastern end of the conservation area.

12.256 Winkleigh has expanded significantly during the last 20 years, with estates of houses to the north and south of the village, the latest being the Elms Meadow area adjacent to the bypass. Local services include:- employment within the village, including at Hatherleigh Road, and on nearby sites at Seckington Cross and Winkleigh Airfield, shops, post office, a primary school, community hall and a variety of recreation facilities.

12.257 Capacity within the public sewer network requires investigation before proceeding with additional development.

Spatial Strategy

12.258 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Winkleigh and the surrounding rural area.

Policy WIN: Winkleigh Spatial Strategy

The local community has a vision for the village to become a more sustainable community, building on the existing variety of employment with all development contributing to a sense of place and quality of life, respecting the character of the area and providing an appropriate range of housing.

The vision will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 60 dwellings, including affordable homes to meet the range of housing needs in the community with accommodation for elderly and retired persons and a variety of tenure. The supply of dwellings will be delivered through extant planning permissions and one additional site with a capacity for approximately 55 dwellings;**
- (b) identifying one site for approximately 55 dwellings north of Chulmleigh Road;**
- (c) securing high quality design and development that respects local distinctiveness;**
- (d) supporting the local economy through appropriate expansion of existing businesses and safeguarding of existing business sites, considering the provision**

of live-work units and appropriate use of Winkleigh Airfield to enable wider than local employment needs to be met;

(e) safeguard and enhance social and community facilities required to support existing residents and new development including recreation facilities, community centres and other village assets and healthcare provision;

(f) protection and enhancement of natural and built environment assets;

(g) provision of village parking facilities;

(h) support for improved transport and other village infrastructure to meet existing and future needs, including transport links to Eggesford station; and

(i) support for delivery of superfast broadband connections.

The Development Proposals

12.259 The spatial strategy for the village will be supported in a range of ways including the site specific policies below.

12.260 A development boundary for Winkleigh is defined on Policies Map 22 outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.261 Employment activity occurs in a number of locations at and within close proximity to Winkleigh village, including at Seckington Cross and Winkleigh Airfield. No specific proposal of land for additional economic development is made within the development boundary at Winkleigh. Any proposals for new employment uses, or change of use of existing sites, will be considered against the spatial strategy for Winkleigh, Policy WIN: Winkleigh Spatial Strategy, where relevant and the general policies of the Local Plan.

Policy WIN01: Winkleigh Airfield

(1) Development at Winkleigh Airfield, as defined on Policies Map 23, will be in accordance with a Development Brief, or other supplementary planning document approved by the local planning authority, to ensure restoration and enhancement of the landscape and that provides for:

(a) a continued use of land at the airfield for agriculture; and

(b) other acceptable uses, including B1, B2 and B8 uses, which have no adverse impact on existing business, residential properties or environmental and heritage assets.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following development requirements:

(a) securing landscape restoration in the vicinity of existing buildings and uses and elsewhere on the site;

(b) improved pedestrian and cycle access within and across the airfield;

(c) low density development in landscaped settings;

(d) high standards of design; and

(e) adoption of sustainable development principles.

12.262 The airfield is a site of some 119 hectares about 1.6 km north of the village and roughly mid way between Bideford and Exeter, astride the A3124. It retains a number of structures associated with its World War 2 use as an airfield, including the former control tower which is a designated Ancient Monument, and accommodates a range of employment activities including manufacturing, storage and retail. These have developed in an uncoordinated way, over various parts of the site. The majority of the site remains open and undeveloped.

12.263 Winkleigh Airfield forms a recognised longer term focal point for rural employment development opportunities in the central southern locality of the plan area that will complement Winkleigh's role as a Local Centre. Further employment development will need to accord with the strategic and development management policies of the Local Plan. In addition to supporting appropriate development that meets a local or wider than local need, these require that development will enhance environmental assets and conserve any heritage assets on site.

12.264 In view of the size of the site, complex mix of existing uses, environmental and heritage assets, a detailed planning framework such as a development brief is considered necessary to enable positive proposals for future development and use of the area.

12.265 Development which would provide a stimulus to Winkleigh or the wider local economy, in terms of diversification or the attraction of skilled and higher paid employment in areas such as manufacturing or technology will be particularly encouraged, subject to conforming with Policy WIN01: Winkleigh Airfield. The Local Planning Authority will consider any larger scale economic development proposals in the strategic context of Policy ST08: Scale and Distribution of New Development in Northern Devon, Policy ST11: Delivering Employment and Economic Development and Policy ST13: Sustainable Tourism.

12.266 A Site Development Brief has been prepared for Winkleigh Airfield which will be subject to an early review. Development will be required to be in accordance with this Brief or an alternative form of supplementary planning document or Neighbourhood Plan. The development Brief identifies specific areas for future development that accord with Policy WIN01 and other policies of the Local Plan, as will be the requirement from any successor guidance for Winkleigh Airfield.

12.267 Restoration and enhancement of the landscape and its continued use for agriculture where appropriate, together with access improvements, are recognised objectives. The expansion of existing businesses and new development within areas defined in the development brief will be acceptable providing it helps to achieve these goals. As appropriate to individual sites, landscape restoration may, for example, include repairing and protecting wildlife corridors and features, introduce additional tree planting, retain distinctive aspects of the airfields character and safeguard existing woodland. The Policy includes the important guidelines for individual development proposals.

12.268 Businesses with a significant impact, or that adversely affect existing property, will not be appropriate. The airfield is not considered an appropriate location for residential development as it is detached from the village with its range of services and would lead to further dispersed development in the countryside, contrary to national policy. However within the areas identified for development, proposals for small scale live work development that could provide a locally distinctive form of employment space will be considered on their merits, subject to evidence of demand and suitable controls over their use.

12.269 Appropriate landscaping will enhance the distinctive character of the site, connect established wildlife corridors and enhance wildlife habitats. Existing woodland will be safeguarded.

12.270 The airfield is closely associated with Winkleigh and proposals should not seek to, or result in, a change to the status of the settlement as a Local Centre but may enable wider local needs for employment to be met in accordance with strategic policies of the plan.

Housing

12.271 Additional housing is proposed to meet the needs and demands of the settlement of Winkleigh and its surrounding rural area over the plan period supporting its role as a rural service centre. At 31st March 2017 there were very few housing commitments in the village ⁽⁷⁷⁾. The Local Plan identifies one additional site that is considered to be deliverable. A variety of housing requirements will be met throughout the site, subject to local need, including specialist design or ownership if required.

12.272 There may be an opportunity for the local community to further influence the detailed form of development schemes, within the framework provided by the Local Plan, through the neighbourhood planning process.

Policy WIN02: Land North of Chulmleigh Road

(1) Land north of Chulmleigh Road, as shown on policies Map 22, is allocated for residential development that includes:

- (a) up to 55 dwellings, including affordable homes, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need;**
- (b) a car park to serve the village centre with a capacity of approximately 20 cars;**
- (c) a landscaped buffer zone to provide protection for the setting of the Court Castle ancient monument; and**
- (d) a community woodland of approximately 0.6ha linked to existing tree cover bordering the north western side of the site.**

(2) The site will be developed to deliver the following specific development principles:

- (a) a single vehicular access from the A3124 in a location that avoids the loss of mature trees;**
- (b) no vehicular access to the village car park from Chulmleigh Road;**
- (c) safe pedestrian and cycle access from Chulmleigh Road through the site and to the A3124, and between Kings Farm Lane (southern end) and the A3124;**
- (d) the car park to serve the village centre to be provided as part of the initial development phase, at the southern end of the site, in a form that does not have adverse visual impact on the setting of the ancient monument and does not disturb any surface or sub surface archaeological interests;**
- (e) the landscape buffer zone to be incorporated into the residential development and be located between housing and the village car park to be in place before first occupation of any dwellings;**

77 13 dwellings from completions since 2011 and on sites with extant planning permission

(f) provide an area of new tree planting to create community woodland covering the north western section with pedestrian access links from the site. Details of the woodland, including future ownership and management, will be agreed with the local planning authority;

(g) retention of the mature boundary trees and appropriate new planting within and on the edges of the housing area to enhance biodiversity, subdivide the development and integrate the new development into the landscape, and,

(h) investigation of the capacity of the off site public sewer network to enable the development as a whole to proceed and agreement of measures to resolve any issues, as part of the initial planning permission.

(3) Specified infrastructure and community benefits, including variety of housing, will be secured by appropriate Conditions or Planning Agreements.

12.273 A greenfield site of approximately 3.5 hectares to the north of Chulmleigh Road is proposed for development to incorporate the community aspiration for a village centre car park, landscaped buffer zone to protect the setting of the Ancient Monument at Court Castle mound and an area of community woodland as an enhancement to green infrastructure for the village.

12.274 The site can provide a range of dwellings to meet local needs and reflect the local centre status of the village and help support local services. It is well related to the highway network and to the village centre and will not harm the landscape setting of the settlement.

12.275 Prior to any development taking place the local planning authority will be required to be satisfied that there would be no unacceptable impact on the setting of the ancient monument or on any known or unknown archaeological remains at the site. The form and extent of development must have regard to any known or suspected remains identified by archaeological assessment and evaluation, which will be required to accompany any development proposal. The proposed arrangement of uses on the site is intended to minimise the possibility of adverse effects on these and other interests of importance.

12.276 The site north of Chulmleigh Road is suitable for residential development and of sufficient size to provide a variety of dwellings to meet the needs and demands of the community as identified in the Spatial Strategy.

12.277 The southern part of the site is close to both the conservation area and designated Ancient Monuments. Development proposals must protect the setting of both and not harm any potential archaeological interests in the vicinity. Accordingly, an appropriate archaeological investigation and evaluation of the site is required with protection for any potential or actual remains as part of the development.

12.278 The form and location of the required landscape buffer zone, to be provided as part of the residential development, will be determined by the location of the car park and layout of the housing areas. It will be designed to avoid disturbance between the car park and the housing areas, minimise the impact of the housing on the setting of the conservation area and Ancient Monument and provide biodiversity benefits.

12.279 The landscape buffer zone could incorporate a segregated section of the required pedestrian/cycle link between Kings Farm Lane and the A3124 to improve access to the community centre and sports ground. Similar safe links are required through the site, including from Chulmleigh Road, to the A3124.

12.280 A high standard of design that reflects local characteristics is required. Development as a whole should be compliant with all relevant policies of the Local Plan.

12.281 Any deficiency in the capacity of the off site public sewers will need to be identified and resolved as part of the development.

12.282 Use of the site should be considered as a whole and tree planting planned in association with the residential development. Details of the community woodland, including planting layout, species, public access, ownership and future management should be agreed with the local planning authority as part of an appropriate planning application.

Community Facilities

12.283 Winkleigh has a branch doctors surgery, a pre-school, a primary school and a modern Sports Centre and Recreation grounds with playing pitch and tennis courts on the edge of the village, in addition to a large area of allotments. The centre of Winkleigh has a village hall with stage and a Community Centre, both with kitchen facilities.

12.284 General policies of the plan safeguard existing community uses and support the establishment of new uses where a need is identified.

Witheridge

The Place

12.285 Witheridge is a Local Centre providing services and facilities for local residents and the surrounding rural community. The village is situated along the B3137 between South Molton and Tiverton and is approximately 15 kilometres (9 miles) from each town and 36 kilometres (23 miles) from the Sub-regional Centre of Barnstaple. Local facilities include shops and a post office, medical centre, a primary and pre-school, parish hall, Sure Start Centre and vehicle repair services.

12.286 The village is located on the south-eastern edge of the Plan area with the Mid Devon District boundary abutting the village. Consequently, part of the catchment area for Witheridge falls within Mid Devon and the village looks mainly towards Tiverton as well as South Molton for its higher level service needs.

12.287 The landscape setting of Witheridge is characterised by sloping culm grassland with higher land to the south of the village sloping towards the valley of the Little Dart River to the north. There are several County Wildlife Sites around Witheridge including the semi-ancient woodland at Yeo Copse adjacent to Little Dart River.

12.288 The historic character of the village centre forms the basis of the conservation area shown on Policies Map 24, which includes The Square, an open area between Church Street and West Street and the parish church of St John the Baptist, a Grade I listed building. This historic core of the village also retains a significant number of early and mid 18th Century properties.

12.289 Witheridge expanded significantly during the latter part of the 20th Century, mainly to the south and west, together with an industrial estate to the north- west of the village. There is minimal development extending to the north of the village centre.

Spatial Strategy

12.290 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Witheridge and the surrounding area. The community's aspiration for the village is to evolve in a sustainable way over the plan period.

Policy WIT: Witheridge Spatial Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable growth of high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Witheridge. The spatial vision for Witheridge will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 81 dwellings to meet the range of housing need in the community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning consents and a single site allocation for approximately 65 dwellings which reduces traffic impact on existing residents;**
- (b) retention and enhancement of community facilities required to support existing residents and new development including a new pre-school building, elderly care provision and additional car parking within the village;**
- (c) infrastructure provision required to support future development will be prioritised over affordable housing delivery;**
- (d) support for additional employment provision to meet locally generated requirements;**

(e) initiatives that provide new opportunities for leisure and recreation facilities; and

(f) delivery of superfast broadband connections.

The Development Proposals

12.291 The spatial strategy for the village will be supported through site specific policies. A development boundary for Witheridge is defined on Policies Map 24, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis. The development boundary includes the majority of the built up area of the village.

Employment

12.292 Witheridge is relatively well served with economic development opportunities within the village and a focus for employment opportunities for the surrounding rural area. A range of manufacturing based industries operate from the Old Market Field industrial estate to the north-west of the village adjoining the B3137 as well as Mole Valley Farmers, a well established agricultural engineer. The Old Market Field has been built out and is safeguarded for the provision of economic development uses, where any proposals for alternative uses will be considered against Policy DM13: Safeguarding Employment Land.

12.293 Should all or part of the Mole Valley Farmers site become available during the plan period, then it should be redeveloped for additional economic development uses, utilising the access through the existing industrial estate.

12.294 Although the Local Plan does not make a specific allocation of further employment land in Witheridge, Policy DM12: Employment Development at Town, Local Centres and Villages would support such development if the local economy identifies the need for an additional site to deliver economic development. Proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Witheridge.

Housing

12.295 Additional housing is proposed to reflect the village's Local Centre status and the community's aspirations to help sustain its viability, promote greater self-sufficiency and to meet its local housing needs and demands.

12.296 In addition to existing housing commitments in Witheridge⁽⁷⁸⁾, the Local Plan allocates one site.

Policy WIT01: Land off Butts Close

(1) Land south of Butts Close, as shown on Policies Map 24, is proposed for residential development that includes:

(a) about 65 dwellings with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types, tenures and sizes to reflect local need; and

(b) provision within the site for physical infrastructure, community facilities and green infrastructure required by the development.

(2) The site will be developed to deliver the following site specific development principles:

78 14 dwellings under construction, built since 2011 and extant planning permissions

- (a) vehicular access from Fore Street (B3137) including traffic management measures on roads leading to the site;**
- (b) an opportunity being safeguarded for future vehicular access to the land west of the site;**
- (c) adequate contribution towards upgrading the foul and surface water sewers and sewage treatment works to provide additional capacity to enable the development to proceed; and**
- (d) enhanced landscaping along the southern boundary to ensure the development is integrated into the landscape.**

12.297 A greenfield site is proposed south of Butts Close, adjacent to Fore Street, that was identified by the local community as their preferred location for future growth to meet local needs. Appropriate planting and hedgebank enhancements will be required along the southern site boundary to integrate the site into its landscape setting and provide a transitional boundary between the development and the adjoining countryside. Proposals for additional sports provision, within or adjoining this site, will be required as part of any development. A potential site on the southern edge of the village has been identified by the local community to the east of the B3137, which is within Mid Devon district.

12.298 Vehicular access to the site will be gained from Fore Street (B3137), adjacent to the site on the eastern boundary. Development will need to consider the safety impacts a new site access will have on the existing B3042 / B3137 junction. The development will be required to finance traffic management measures along Fore Street. Development must safeguard the opportunity for a future vehicular access through the site towards land further west, which would represent the primary vehicular access to any future development in this location.

12.299 There is no spare capacity in either foul or surface water sewers and little in the sewage treatment works. The development will be required to upgrade the sewerage infrastructure in order to provide additional capacity to accommodate this development, as well as incorporating a sustainable water strategy.

Community Facilities

12.300 The village is relatively well served by formal and informal open space that is accessible to the public. The main sports provision includes a football and cricket pitch, the recreation ground, tennis courts and multi use games area adjoining the parish hall, together with two equipped play areas. These areas of public open space will be safeguarded from other uses. An extension to the existing cemetery will be required during the plan period.

Policy WIT02: North of St John the Baptist Church

(1) Land north of St. John the Baptist Church, as shown on Policies Map 24, is proposed for development to include additional cemetery space.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) the cemetery extension has the capacity to meet future requirements;**
- (b) the cemetery will be served by the pedestrian access through the existing churchyard;**
- (c) a new landscaped eastern boundary; and**
- (d) enhanced landscaping along the northern and western boundaries.**

12.301 A site of approximately 0.2 ha is proposed to the north of St John the Baptist Church for an extension to the existing cemetery which is reaching capacity and additional provision is required over the plan period to meet the community's future requirements.

12.302 The site will be accessed through the existing pedestrian access off Church Street. The existing hedgerows along the northern and western boundaries should be retained and enhanced where appropriate. A new landscaped boundary will be required along the eastern boundary. This land will be safeguarded from development for other purposes.

Other Issues

12.303 Witheridge's new medical centre is at Cannington Road. The community would support a new pre-school building to replace the existing portable prefabricated building, to be delivered through developer contributions. The community also supports proposals that would supply additional elderly care provision within the village.

12.304 The foul sewerage system in Witheridge is overloaded and has very little spare capacity to cater for further development. Any significant new developments will require major improvements to the sewerage system.

Green Infrastructure

12.305 The Two Moors Way runs through Witheridge, crossing into Mid Devon District to the south of the village. The route of the Two Moors Way through the village is shown on Policies Map 24. The path provides opportunities for public access to the countryside on both sides of the village. It also provides tourism and recreation opportunities within the village for people walking the route in its entirety. Proposals that enhance the local tourist economy and opportunities for enjoyment of the Two Moors Way will be supported.

Woolacombe and Morteohoe

The Place

12.306 Woolacombe is identified as a Local Centre and Morteohoe is a village within the coastal parish of Morteohoe, located on the north-west edge of the plan area. The very significant constraints on development resulting from the nationally protected landscape, nature conservation and land ownership mean that the needs of both settlements are best considered together.

12.307 Both villages are within the North Devon Coasts Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty (AONB) and the Coastal Zone. A number of Sites of Special Scientific Interest (SSSI) are notified along the coast, including Barricane Beach and Morte Point. The rocky coastline between Woolacombe and Morteohoe is part of the Voluntary Marine Conservation Area and Marine Conservation Zone, recognising the ecological and geological importance of the cliffs and foreshore along this stretch of coastline. A large majority of the land around the existing built up areas is owned by the National Trust and is not available for development. These constraints mean that neither settlement has capacity to accommodate any significant development.

12.308 Woolacombe lies at the foot of coastal downland, at the northern end of Woolacombe Sands, a popular sandy beach. The beach and coastline are very important for the local economy and tourism industry. The village is situated approximately 6 kilometres (3.5 miles) south-west of Ilfracombe and 7 kilometres (4 miles) north of Braunton. The main access is along the B3343 from Mullacott Cross. The local centre provides a range of services for local residents and the large number of visitors to the area including shops, post office, primary school, recreation and sports facilities. The village of Morteohoe, about 1 kilometre (0.5 miles) north of Woolacombe, has a smaller range of services and facilities, with an emphasis on meeting the needs of tourists, including a visitor centre. Inland from the main settlements of Woolacombe and Morteohoe are a number of camping / caravan sites and holiday parks which offer more all year round and purpose built tourist accommodation. The Parish has a high level of second home ownership that adds to the overall level of tourism accommodation in the parish.

12.309 Both settlements are broadly linear in form, constrained by the coast and landform. Conservation areas are designated in both settlements. At Woolacombe the Victorian and Edwardian villas along the seafront form the basis of the conservation area while Morteohoe has an historic village character and settlement pattern.

12.310 The South West Coast Path follows the seaward edge of Woolacombe and the cliffs around Morte Point, whilst the Tarka Trail follows former railway routes on the eastern edge of the parish, bordering the AONB.

Spatial Strategy

12.311 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Morteohoe Parish. The community's vision for the future of the parish includes ensuring that the housing needs of local residents are met, retaining and improving the range of services for local people, resolving parking and other highway issues, improving public transport, footpath and cycling facilities, whilst protecting the built and natural environment. The strategy for future development within the parish is based upon the following objectives:

Policy MOR: Woolacombe and Morteohoe Spatial Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable growth of high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Woolacombe and Morteohoe. The spatial vision for Woolacombe and Morteohoe will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 39 dwellings to meet the range of needs in the community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning permissions and new sites, although no additional site allocations are proposed;
- (b) protecting the important landscape setting of both Woolacombe and Morteohoe including the special landscape character and qualities of the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty ;
- (c) protecting the natural and built environment within and adjoining the designated conservation areas;
- (d) safeguarding key tourist accommodation including the significant hotels;
- (e) increasing the range of employment opportunities locally
- (f) providing appropriate housing to meet community needs; and
- (g) safeguarding local services and recreation opportunities for residents and visitors.

The Development Proposals

12.312 The spatial strategy for Woolacombe and Morteohoe will be supported in a range of ways. Development boundaries for the two communities are defined on Policies Maps 25 and 26, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.313 There are limited economic development opportunities in Woolacombe and Morteohoe with the local economy dominated by the tourism industry, including the range of local shops, camping and caravan sites, hotels and self-catering accommodation. This is expected to remain the situation throughout the plan period. Woolacombe is a premier recreational sports and major surfing centre. Maintaining an appropriate level and range of tourist accommodation is important in order to ensure Woolacombe remains a significant tourism destination.

12.314 The range of shops and services in Woolacombe and Morteohoe is enhanced by the tourist and recreation importance of the area, although some activities are seasonal. Facilities that meet the year round needs of local residents are particularly important and their retention will be supported. The Local Plan does not make a specific allocation for economic development land in Woolacombe or Morteohoe although they will capitalise on enhanced levels of assistance offered by the Assisted Area status. Other employment opportunities are available and accessible at Mullacott Business Park south of Ilfracombe, also with Assisted Area status. Proposals for economic development in Woolacombe will be considered against the general policies in the plan and the spatial strategy objectives above.

Housing

12.315 Opportunities for further new residential development in the two villages are very limited. At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively high level of housing commitments mainly through conversion and re-development of previously developed sites in Woolacombe and Morteohoe ⁽⁷⁹⁾. Other windfall sites within the development boundaries may have opportunities for redevelopment if present uses cease. There are no sites allocated for housing development in view of a lack of

79 122 dwellings from completions since 2011, dwellings under construction and extant planning permissions

suitable available sites, together with landscape and ownership constraints. The requirement to provide additional housing to meet local needs and demands, and address aspirations for improvements to local services and facilities still remains.

12.316 Where land is genuinely available for development that meets local needs, has local support, is appropriate in terms of scale and location and is in accordance with other relevant policies of the Local Plan, it will be considered for residential development on an exceptional basis even though located outside the development boundaries within the Undeveloped parts of the Coastal and Estuarine Zone. Acceptable development will also need to meet the respective requirements for a local centre (Woolacombe) or a village (Mortehoe) in Policy ST07: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Rural Area. Other opportunities to secure additional housing to meet local needs will continue to be explored.

Community Facilities

12.317 Woolacombe has a range of education, recreation and community facilities that serve the local community and the village's catchment area. Retaining and enhancing these services and facilities is important towards sustaining Woolacombe as a sustainable location.

12.318 The local beaches and South West Coast Path provide informal sport and recreation facilities within the local green infrastructure network. There is a thriving Surf Life Saving Club. There is an identified need for recreation facilities for young people, such as a skate park. The football pitch and play area at Meadow Playing Fields support three football teams and provides formal recreation facilities for the local community of Woolacombe. The playing field is identified as a hub site. These facilities will be protected from alternative uses and further improvements will be supported. Other existing open spaces and community facilities will also be protected where a need remains.

12.319 The community has identified the need for a variety of improvements to local services and facilities including health services, public transport, footpaths and cycle paths, traffic and parking facilities. Additional play areas and community recycling facilities are also identified as being deficient.

Villages

12.320 The Villages, as defined in Schedule B of Policy ST07: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Rural Area, have an historic significance and basic level of services and facilities that make them a recognised focus for the immediate and surrounding rural communities. Development will be generally limited to meeting the social and economic needs of the local community in accordance with their local spatial strategy and growth aspirations.

Abbotsham

The Place

12.321 Abbotsham is located 2.5km (1.6 miles) west of Bideford, positioned immediately west of the A39 and close to the northern Devon coastline. It is concentrated in settlement form with the majority of housing located to the north of the main village road.

12.322 The North Devon Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty, lies to the west of Abbotsham and extends to cover a number of residential properties to the south west of the village.

12.323 The village has a good range of local services including a primary school, two places of worship, public house, a post office/general store and village hall. Good public transport services link the village with Bideford, Barnstaple and Bude in north Cornwall. Employment in the area is characterised by agriculture and tourism facilities in the form of holiday cottages and camping sites. The Big Sheep leisure/tourist attraction, immediately to the east of the village, also provides year round employment.

Spatial Strategy

12.324 The local community have identified the following vision:

- a. Abbotsham will be a rural village with its own distinctiveness and size that is separate from Bideford and neighbouring parishes;
- b. a parish that values and protects its environment, much of which is located in an Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty;
- c. a forward looking community, ready to accept change to enhance the quality of life for all and to sustain the economic viability of the area; and
- d. a pleasant place to live.

Policy ABS: Abbotsham Spatial Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Abbotsham. The vision will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 23 dwellings, including affordable homes and accommodation to meet the changing needs of the villages ageing population. The supply of housing will be delivered through a single site allocation;**
- (b) identifying a site for additional housing at the Glebe, within the development boundary;**
- (c) support for a pedestrian footbridge over the A39 from the settlement to Atlantic Village, along the existing footpath (subject to Land at Winsford Farm, north of Clovelly Road, Bideford being developed subject to Policy BID01);**
- (d) promoting a footpath and cycleway connecting Bideford to Abbotsham;**
- (e) renovation of village hall and children's playground; and**

(f) support for the retention of village facilities and services to meet the needs of the local community.

The Development Proposals

12.325 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities to address locally generated and quantified needs. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site specific policy below.

12.326 A development boundary for Abbotsham is defined on Policies Map 27, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.327 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale, although the village can capitalise on enhanced levels of assistance offered by Assisted Area status. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Abbotsham.

Housing

12.328 Additional housing is proposed to meet the needs and demands of Abbotsham over the plan period. At 31st March 2017 there were no housing commitments at the village. The Local Plan allocates a site that is considered deliverable to meet future housing needs.

12.329 The spatial extent of the proposal is shown on Policies Map 27 and is subject to a site specific policy (ABS01) that sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles.

Policy ABS01: Land at The Glebe

(1) Land at the Glebe, as shown on Policies Map 27, is allocated for residential development that includes:

(a) approximately 23 dwellings, including affordable homes, with a focus on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

(a) single vehicular access from south-western corner from B3236;

(b) footway and cycleway access from the residential development to village facilities both on and off site (there will be a need for off-site highway works in relation to strategic highway infrastructure and be a requirement for the development to contribute towards such works);

(c) financial contribution towards the enhancement of Abbotsham village hall and children's playground; and

(d) retained and strengthened landscaping on the sites southern boundary to deliver enhanced biodiversity and to integrate the new development into the landscape.

12.330 A greenfield site to the west of the primary school and playing field is allocated for housing development. The site is well related to the village centre and highway network. Development of the site will principally meet the needs of Abbotsham over the plan period and assist in the delivery of enhanced community facilities.

12.331 Enabling Abbotsham residents to continue to live in the community, by providing for changing housing requirements, is viewed as a necessary component in addressing local needs and demands. A contribution to meeting the accommodation needs of Abbotsham's ageing population should be delivered on this site. The form of development will be determined by a demonstration of local need.

12.332 The site has reasonable natural screening and mature vegetation along its boundaries. Development will need to protect the existing trees and hedges and enhanced landscaping will be required on the sites southern boundary to integrate the new development into the landscape.

Other Issues

12.333 Proposals which address the provision of services and facilities in the village will be supported in accordance with the general policies of the Local Plan if the use and its scale and location are appropriate.

Ashwater

The Place

12.334 Ashwater is located in the south-western corner of the plan area, about 11 km (7 miles) to the south of Holsworthy, off the A388. The settlement is fairly compact and centred on a village green from which the main residential roads radiate from. A number of listed buildings are also contained in the area.

12.335 The village has a small range of services including a school, 13th century church, parish hall, post office/general store and public house. Employment in the area is small-scale and mainly related to agriculture and visitor accommodation.

Spatial Strategy

12.336 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Ashwater.

Policy ASH: Ashwater Spatial Strategy

The vision for the village is focused on meeting the economic and social needs of the local community by increasing the range of housing to meet locally generated needs and securing the retention and enhancement of local services and facilities.

The vision will be delivered through the provision of a minimum of 11 dwellings that principally secure new homes for local people in affordable housing need.

The Development Proposals

12.337 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities to address locally generated and quantified needs.

12.338 A development boundary for Ashwater is defined on Policies Map 28, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.339 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general policies of the Local Plan. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Ashwater.

Housing

12.340 No specific sites are allocated in Ashwater for general housing development although a small number of additional dwellings may be accommodated within the defined development boundary. At 31st March 2017 there was a modest level of housing commitment at the village.⁽⁸⁰⁾

12.341 A need for affordable housing has been demonstrated, on the basis of which a 10 dwelling affordable housing scheme was completed during 2014-2015 on a site to the east of

80 12 dwellings from completions since 2011 and sites with planning permission.

the village hall. The site is outside the development boundary and was released only in accordance with Policy ST19: Affordable Housing on Exception Sites.

12.342 Elsewhere, the general approach of the Local Plan relating to defined Villages will apply, which supports development opportunities appropriate to the scale of the locality to address locally generated and quantified needs.

Other Services

12.343 Proposals which address the provision of services and facilities in the village will be supported in accordance with the general policies of the Local Plan if the use and its scale and location are appropriate.

Atherington

The Place

12.344 Atherington is situated on the western side of the Taw valley, approximately 12.5 kilometres (8 miles) south of Barnstaple and 14.5 kilometres (9 miles) west of South Molton. The village is located on either side of the B3227, Great Torrington to South Molton road, identified as an 'Other Strategic Route' in Figure 4.4.

12.345 Village facilities are limited, but include a shop/post office and playing field with pavilion. NWF Agriculture Ltd, an animal feeds supplier based between the village and High Bickington, provides some local employment. The village is not within any designated landscape or nature conservation area, nor are there any such areas nearby.

Spatial Strategy

12.346 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Atherington.

Policy ATH: Atherington Spatial Strategy

The community has aspirations for the village which include additional employment opportunities, improved social amenities for young people, additional smaller housing to attract young people and for a bypass to the south of Atherington from the B3217 near High Town to Easter Hill near the sewage treatment works to remove heavy traffic generated by the feed mill.

There is also concern to protect the character of the village by avoiding subdivision of existing large housing plots and to improve village services such as broadband, electrical cabling and sewage treatment. The spatial strategy will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 7 new dwellings to meet the range of needs in the community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning permissions and a single site allocation for approximately 5 dwellings;
- (b) support for additional employment provision to meet locally generated requirements;
- (c) support for additional community facilities to meet locally generated needs;
- (d) retention of the character of the village and its relationship with the countryside; and
- (e) improved broadband coverage.

Development Proposals

12.347 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities to address locally generated and quantified needs. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site-specific policies below.

12.348 A development boundary for Atherington is defined on Policies Map 29, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.349 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for this use and proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Town, Local Centres and Villages of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general policies of the Local Plan. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the plan and the spatial strategy for Atherington.

Housing

12.350 A site on land north of the B3227 Torrington Road, adjacent to Coronation Cottages, is proposed for residential development. At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively modest level of housing commitments in Atherington⁽⁸¹⁾. Additional housing will help to provide the scale and type of development to meet the identified needs of the local community. The spatial extent of the proposal is shown on Policies Map 29 and is subject to a site specific policy (ATH01: Land North of Torrington Road) that sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles.

Policy ATH01: Land North of Torrington Road

(1) Land north of the B3227 Torrington Road, as shown on Policies Map 29, is proposed for residential development that includes approximately 5 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

(a) vehicular access from the B3227;

(b) a proportionate contribution toward addressing the sewage treatment deficiencies in the village; and

(c) retention and enhancement of existing boundary hedgerows and provision of additional landscaping on the northern boundary to ensure the development is integrated into the landscape.

12.351 The site north of the B3227 is located on the western edge of the village and will provide approximately 5 dwellings. Design and layout should enhance the character of the village and be compatible with the adjoining development. The existing sewage treatment works in the village is at, or close, to capacity. Additional housing on the site will be required to provide a proportionate contribution towards upgrading the treatment works.

12.352 Existing hedges and trees bordering the site will be retained and enhanced where appropriate and a suitable landscaped boundary created on the northern edge to help integrate the site into the surrounding countryside.

Community Services

12.353 The playing field to the south-east of the village provides an important recreation facility for the community and the site is safeguarded for this use (Policy DM09: Safeguarding Green Infrastructure). Retention and enhancement of existing village services will be subject to the general policies of the Local Plan.

81 9 dwellings from completions since 2011, under construction and extant planning permissions.

12.354 The church hall at Atherington and the primary schools at Umberleigh and High Bickington provide important facilities for the local community. Provision of additional, or enhancement of existing community facilities to meet locally generated needs will be supported in accordance with the spatial strategy and general policies of the Local Plan.

Highways

12.355 Roads in the village are narrow and the B3227 is a main route for traffic between South Molton and Great Torrington. Heavy goods vehicles accessing NWF Agriculture Ltd at Wixland negotiate the junction between the B3227 and B3217. The Local Plan will support minor improvements to the highway network where it would help alleviate specific problems without detrimental effects on the character of the village.

12.356 The local community has aspirations for a south-eastern bypass to facilitate access for heavy goods vehicles. It is unlikely that funding would be available for such a proposal during the lifetime of the Local Plan and the level of new development likely to be required in the village to provide such a link would not be appropriate for a village of this size. However, should the strategic highway authority propose a bypass around Atherington then Policy ST10: Transport Strategy would support such a scheme in principle.

Beaford

The Place

12.357 Beaford is located 8 kms (5 miles) south-east of Great Torrington on the A3124, cross county route, with regular bus services to Bideford, Barnstaple and Exeter.

12.358 The village benefits from a reasonable range of facilities and services including places of worship, primary and nursery school, a garage and shop, public house, residential arts centre and village hall. Local employment is mainly associated with these services and agricultural holdings in the surrounding area.

12.359 The historic character of the village has been retained and forms the basis of a large conservation area shown on Policies Map 30, which covers much of Beaford village, including open land to the east. The central area of the village includes a number of listed buildings including the C15th Grade I Church of Saint George and All Saints. There are no landscape conservation designations covering the village.

Spatial Strategy

Policy BEA: Beaford Spatial Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development, supported by necessary infrastructure, to meet the needs of Beaford. The community's spatial vision for Beaford is that local facilities and employment opportunities should be maintained and enhanced and local housing needs should be met. Additionally, in providing for development, the character of the village should be retained and cycle and pedestrian links and safety improvements made.

The vision will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 43 dwellings, including affordable homes, to meet the range of housing needs in the local community, the supply of housing will be delivered through two site allocations, with a capacity for approximately 42 dwellings;
- (b) two additional housing sites allocated within the development boundary;
- (c) improved vehicular access to the village school with associated safe parking facilities;
- (d) additional employment provision, focused on small business units;
- (e) retaining the character of the village and its relationship with the countryside;
- (f) provision of enhanced public open space at Towell Meadow;
- (g) support for improvements to the main highway thoroughfare in terms of improving safety for pedestrians and public highway users; and
- (h) support for the retention of village facilities and services to meet the needs of the local community.

The Development Proposals

12.360 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities to address locally generated and quantified needs. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site specific policies below.

12.361 A development boundary for Beaford is defined on Policies Map 30, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.362 During the life of the Local Plan there may be a requirement for additional land or premises to accommodate businesses able to provide a service to, or employment for, local people.

12.363 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Beaford.

Housing

12.364 Additional housing is proposed to meet the needs and demands of Beaford over the plan period. At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively modest level of housing commitment in the village.⁽⁸²⁾ The Local Plan allocates two sites that are considered deliverable to meet future housing and community needs.

12.365 The spatial extent of the proposals is shown on Policies Map 30, which are subject to site specific policies (BEA01: Land North of Towell Lane/Towell Meadow and BEA02: Land at Rye Park Close, Beaford Garage and Land to the Rear) that set out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles.

Policy BEA01: Land North of Towell Lane / Towell Meadow

(1) Land north of Towell Lane, as shown on Policies Map 30, is allocated for residential development that includes approximately 12 dwellings, including affordable homes, with a focus on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need;

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

(a) housing located towards the southern and eastern boundaries;

(b) vehicular access from Towell Lane, including rear access for existing houses to the south west of the site on Main Street;

(c) retain, as far as possible, existing trees and hedges on the site boundaries and strengthen and incorporate landscaping on the north eastern boundary to enhance biodiversity and integrate the new development into the landscape;

(d) a layout and design that provides an acceptable impact on existing properties and the conservation area;

82 12 dwellings from completions since 2011 and sites with extant planning permission.

(e) retain and enhance the majority of the western part of the site as public open space, including the historic village well; and

(f) provide a footpath link from Towell Lane to Bond Street within the site layout.

12.366 An open area based on Towell Meadow, bounded by Bond Street to the north and Towell Lane to the south, is proposed for residential development. The site is relatively flat with established boundaries on all sides.

12.367 The site can provide a range of dwellings to contribute to meeting local needs and demands and could help to support local services. It is well related to the village centre and to the highway network from Towell Lane and is able to incorporate valuable public open space through the retention and enhancement of existing amenity space at Towell Meadow. A sensitive and high quality design will be required to reflect the Conservation Area status of the western element of the site.

12.368 The north eastern boundary of the site borders open countryside and an additional tree and hedge screen will be required to reduce the impact of the development on the countryside setting of the village.

12.369 Access to the site will be provided from Towell Lane, with a new vehicular access connecting the majority of the residential development in the eastern section of the site. An access road to the south west element of the site will also be required, which will provide rear access for the adjoining existing houses on Main Street.

12.370 The location of the site to the rear of a few existing properties will require careful attention to avoid overlooking or other loss of amenity to existing or new housing.

Policy BEA02: Land at Rye Park Close, Beaford Garage and Land to Rear

(1) Land off Rye Park Close and Beaford Garage, as shown on Policies Map 30, is allocated as a mixed use development that includes:

(a) approximately 30 dwellings, including affordable homes, with a focus on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need, and,

(b) retention of the garage/workshop within a revised format, providing an improved vehicular access to the village school and safe parking facilities.

(2) The site should be developed to deliver the following specific development principles:

(a) provide vehicular access from A3124, through the existing garage frontage;

(b) provide vehicular access to the village school and parking facilities to relieve school related road side congestion;

(c) provide safe pedestrian and cycle access from the residential development to Main Street and through to the village school;

(d) high quality sympathetic design responding to the bordering conservation area and Grade II listed buildings of Chapland's Cottages; and

(e) incorporate landscaping on the western and southern boundaries to enhance biodiversity and integrate the new development into the landscape.

12.371 A site to the south of Beaford, incorporating a petrol filling station, vehicle repair workshop and agricultural land is allocated for a mix of uses. The objectives for the site are to deliver a retained garage and workshop, in a revised format that provides improved vehicular access to the village school with related off-street parking and an enabling level of housing that will make a significant contribution to meeting local housing needs and demands.

12.372 The site, which is suitable for residential development can provide a range of dwellings to meet the villages long term needs and help support local services. The land is well related to the highway network and to the village centre and, with appropriate landscaping, will not harm the landscape setting of the village.

12.373 The capacity of the local sewage treatment works will need to be confirmed and any improvements funded by the development. For this purpose and to ensure the site objectives are delivered, development of the site will be considered as a whole.

12.374 It will be necessary to develop the land sequentially from east to west, commencing with the Beaford Garage land initially, in order to secure safe road access to the wider land parcel. The site is also able to deliver the community aspiration for additional transport facilities for the village school. These components should have proper regard to a subsequent masterplan agreed between the local planning authority and developer/s.

12.375 Development will need to protect existing trees and hedges and provide additional planting and landscaping on boundaries and within the housing area. Site design should also ensure regard is given to the proximity of heritage assets, the need to integrate parking facilities for the school and the safeguarding of residential amenity alongside commercial operating requirements consequent of the sites dual use.

Other Issues

12.376 Retention of existing recreation facilities and village services will be subject to the general policies of the Local Plan. Provision of appropriate additional facilities to meet locally generated needs will be supported in accordance with the spatial strategy and general Local Plan policies.

Berrynarbor

The Place

12.377 Berrynarbor is located to the south of the A399 coast road between Ilfracombe and Combe Martin, a route identified as an 'Other Strategic Route' in Figure 4.4. The village is approximately 5.6 kilometres (3.5 miles) east of Ilfracombe and approximately 4 kilometres (2.5 miles) west of Combe Martin.

12.378 The historic core of the village, on the eastern side of Sterridge Valley is centred around the Grade II* listed Church of St. Peter. The village has a relatively compact settlement pattern that has retained its character within a conservation area. To the north-east, the village has expanded with linear housing development along Barton Lane. On the western side of the valley, low density linear development stretches up Haggington Hill toward Goosewell. To the south of the village, housing development within Sterridge Valley is more dispersed.

12.379 The village lies within the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty, Heritage Coast and within the Coastal and Estuarine Zone (Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy). The coastline to the north forms part of the Marine Conservation Zone and Voluntary Marine Conservation Area, which stretches between Blackstone Beach, Great Hangman (within Exmoor National Park) and Downend at Croyde. The designations recognise the ecological and geological importance of the cliffs and foreshore along this stretch of coastline. Napps Cave has been designated as a Site of Special Scientific Interest for its geological interest and as an important roost for bats. The woodland and hedgerows around Berrynarbor, including Sterridge Valley, provide an important network of habitats for movement and feeding of protected species in accordance with Policy ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets. Hele, Sampson's and Combe Martin bays are also designated as Sites of Special Scientific Interest to protect the ecology and geology of the coastline. There are a number of County Wildlife Sites in the parish, including Northfield Wood to the north-west of the village. These designations are shown on Policies Map 31.

12.380 Facilities in the village include a community shop and post office, public car park, primary school, public house, village hall, church and recreation field.

12.381 The local economy is dominated by tourism related industries with extensive areas of Berrynarbor dedicated to holiday accommodation including Mill Park, Napps, Big Meadow, Watermouth Cove Holiday Park and Watermouth Castle and lodges. Also, Berrynarbor has a relatively high level of second home ownership that adds to the overall level of tourism accommodation in the parish. Other employment opportunities are mostly outside of the parish.

Spatial Strategy

Policy BER: Berrynarbor Spatial Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development, supported by necessary infrastructure, to meet the needs of Berrynarbor.

The local community has a vision for the parish that seeks to maintain the character and appearance of the area for the benefit of both residents and visitors alike, while adopting a positive approach to beneficial development well related to the village that addresses local need. The surrounding high quality landscape, natural and built environment, local community and its facilities are particularly valued and should be protected. The spatial strategy will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 12 dwellings to meet the range of needs in the community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning permissions and new sites, although no additional site allocations are proposed;**
- (b) protection of the special character and appearance of the Conservation Area and its relationship with the surrounding countryside;**
- (c) protection of the natural environment including the special landscape character and qualities of the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty;**
- (d) protection and enhancement of local facilities to meet locally generated needs; and**
- (e) support for superfast broadband connections.**

Development Proposals

12.382 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site specific policies below.

12.383 Berrynarbor has no defined development boundary, so the extent of the Developed Coast (ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy) will be defined by the main built up area of the village. Proposals that are well related to the existing village, appropriate to the scale of the locality will be considered against the general policies of the Local Plan.

Employment

12.384 Any new employment in the parish is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development. Proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages in relation to general employment and Policies DM17: Tourism and Leisure Attractions and DM18: Tourism in relation to tourism. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Berrynarbor.

Housing

12.385 Opportunities for residential development in the village are limited. There are no sites allocated for housing development in the village as the Parish Council wish to consider all future housing proposals on their own merits, although there is recognition that Berrynarbor has significant landscape constraints. The requirement to provide additional housing to meet local needs and demands still remains, as does addressing aspirations for improvements to local services and facilities. At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively modest level of housing commitments in Berrynarbor⁽⁸³⁾.

12.386 Residential development proposals which accord with the relevant policies of the Local Plan, may be supported even though located within the Undeveloped Coast in the Coastal and Estuary Zone. Opportunities to secure additional housing to meet local needs will continue to be explored.

83 15 dwellings from completions since 2011, under construction and extant planning permissions, including approvals subject to completion of S106

Community Facilities

12.387 Retention of existing recreation facilities and village services will be subject to the general policies of the Local Plan. There is community aspiration for a new environmentally friendly school which would be supported, although no site has been allocated and delivery is uncertain. Provision of appropriate additional or replacement facilities to meet locally generated needs, including a new school, will be supported in accordance with the spatial strategy and general Local Plan policies.

Bishop's Nympton

The Place

12.388 Bishop's Nympton is about 5.5 kilometres (3.5 miles) south-east of South Molton, on sloping land on the northern side of the valley of the Crooked Oak. The village is located within an open landscape with important vantage points and uninterrupted vistas over the surrounding countryside. The village is prominent from across the valley.

12.389 A Conservation Area covers a large part of the village except the modern developments to the north and east and contains a number of listed buildings including the Grade I Church of St Mary.

12.390 There is little employment in the village other than the provision of local services. A range of employment opportunities are available in South Molton, including at Pathfields Business Park.

Spatial Strategy

12.391 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Bishop's Nympton.

Policy BNY: Bishop's Nympton Spatial Strategy

The community's vision is for continuing sustainable development in and around the village and that all parts of the parish will continue to be part of a living and working environment supporting the rural community together with the provision of appropriate affordable housing to enable younger residents to remain in the village. The spatial strategy will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 39 dwellings to meet the range of needs in the community. The supply of housing will be delivered through existing commitments and one allocated site at Glebe Field totalling approximately 20 dwellings and a non-strategic housing site;
- (b) protection and enhancement of the character and appearance of the conservation area;
- (c) retention and enhancement of local facilities and services to meet locally generated needs;
- (d) support for additional employment development to meet locally generated needs;
- (e) improvements to the existing sewage treatment works; and
- (f) support for superfast broadband connections.

Development Proposals

12.392 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site-specific policies below.

12.393 Bishop's Nympton has no defined development boundary. Proposals that are well related to the existing village, appropriate to the scale of the locality and address locally generated and quantified needs will be considered against the general policies of the Local Plan.

Employment

12.394 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Bishop's Nympton.

Housing

12.395 The spatial extent of the proposal is shown on Policies Map 32 and is subject to a single site-specific Policy BNY01. The policy sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles. Land at Capitol Farm is identified as a non-strategic housing site for approximately 10 dwellings (see Appendix 5'Schedule of Non-strategic Housing Sites'). At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively high level of housing commitments in Bishop's Nympton⁽⁸⁴⁾.

12.396 The sewage treatment works has limited spare capacity for additional development. Detailed evaluation may be required to establish the level of upgrading required to enable development of the allocated site plus any other developable sites in the village.

Policy BNY01: Glebe Field

(1) The Glebe Field, as shown on Policies Map 32, is proposed for residential development that provides approximately 20 dwellings, including affordable homes, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) design, layout and access that respect the site's location within the conservation area, the setting of adjacent listed buildings and amenities of existing dwellings;**
- (b) vehicular access from the village street;**
- (c) retention of existing trees and boundary hedges and replacement of any hedges lost to secure an acceptable access;**
- (d) adequate contribution towards addressing deficiency in the capacity or performance of the sewage treatment works to enable the development as a whole to proceed; and**
- (e) pedestrian and cycle access from Glebeland Villas through the site to the village street.**

12.397 The Glebe Field lies to the south of the Rectory, a Grade II listed building. The site is also within the conservation area where further development will require an appropriate standard of design and layout to conserve and enhance its character and appearance. Development will

84 17 dwellings from completions since 2011, under construction and extant planning permissions.

replace any boundary trees and hedges lost to achieve an appropriate access with additional planting required throughout the site to help subdivide the development.

12.398 The site is well related to the village centre and will provide a high proportion of new dwellings required in the village over the plan period. It should be developed in such a way as to provide a phased supply to meet local needs. This may require a flexible approach to development or review of detailed proposals as community needs are identified. Any deficiency in the capacity or performance of the sewage treatment works will need to be identified and resolved as part of the development.

Community Facilities

12.399 Bishop's Nympton primary and nursery schools are important local community facilities. Other facilities in the village include a village hall, community shop and post office, public house and equipped play area.

12.400 Retention of existing recreation facilities and village services will be subject to the general policies of the plan. Provision of appropriate additional facilities to meet locally generated needs will be supported in accordance with the spatial strategy and general Local Plan policies.

Bishop's Tawton

The Place

12.401 Bishop's Tawton is situated on the A377, a route identified as an 'Other Strategic Route' in Figure 4. The village is approximately 4 kilometres (3 miles) south of Barnstaple, close to the A361 North Devon Link Road identified as a 'Strategic Route' in Figure 4.4. The village is linear in form, located on rising land on the eastern side of the Taw valley. The surrounding landscape is dominated by Codden Hill to the south-east and by the wide valley of the River Taw to the west. The southern part of the village is dissected by Venn Stream, which flows westwards from Landkey to the River Taw which together create significant flood risk within the village. The village also suffers from localised surface water flooding.

12.402 Bishop's Tawton is not within a designated landscape but is set within attractive countryside. The village is visually prominent from the main road and from parts of Tawstock parish on the opposite side of the Taw valley. There are two County Wildlife Sites on the edge of the village, to the south-east at Codden Hill and to the north at Bishop's Tawton Saltmarsh on the eastern side of the River Taw. On the western side of the River Taw, within Tawstock parish, is Tawstock Court County Wildlife Site, which is visually prominent from the village. There is also a county geological site at the southern end of the village, at the western end of Codden Hill. The village centre retains much of its historic pattern and character and is designated as a conservation area that includes the Grade I listed Church of St. John the Baptist.

12.403 The village has a range of community facilities including a primary school, village hall, playing field with play area and two public houses. There is also a small family butchers. The village is largely dependent on the services, facilities and employment opportunities in Barnstaple. The Macmillan Way West follows a route south of Barnstaple through Bishop's Tawton towards Landkey and onward towards Exmoor National Park.

Spatial Strategy

12.404 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Bishop's Tawton.

Policy BTA: Bishop's Tawton Spatial Strategy

The local community supports limited continued housing development in the village but is concerned about a range of issues including flooding, traffic levels, parking, local footpaths and loss of local facilities. Local priorities include provision of a new village car park, improvements to the village hall, a sports field, better footpaths, support for housing for local people, small business units and additional allotments. The spatial strategy will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 36 new dwellings to meet the range of needs in the community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning permissions and two site allocations at the former engineering works on Village Street and west of Exeter Road totalling approximately 20 dwellings;
- (b) support for development that would not exacerbate the risk of flooding in the village;
- (c) support for additional employment provision to meet locally generated requirements;
- (d) support for improvements to the village hall;

- (e) provision of a new village car park;
- (f) provision of an additional play area and allotments;
- (g) improvements to the existing sewage treatment works; and
- (h) support for a footpath / cycleway beside the River Taw and Tarka railway line.

Development Proposals

12.405 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site-specific policies below.

12.406 A development boundary for Bishop's Tawton is defined on Policies Map 33, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis. All development must be designed to ensure the existing flooding problems in the village are not exacerbated.

Employment

12.407 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy and vision for Bishop's Tawton.

Housing

12.408 The spatial extent of the proposals are shown on Policies Map 33 and are subject to site-specific policies that set out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles. At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively modest level of housing commitments in Bishop's Tawton⁽⁸⁵⁾.

Policy BTA01: Former Engineering Works, Village Street

(1) The site off Village Street, as shown on Policies Map 33, is proposed for residential development that provides approximately 5 dwellings, to reflect local need.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) design and layout that respects the site's location within the conservation area, the setting of adjacent listed buildings and amenities of surrounding dwellings;**
- (b) retention and conversion of the former employment buildings and Reading Room; and**
- (c) assessment and remediation prior to the commencement of development of any site contamination arising from previous uses.**

⁸⁵ 17 dwellings from completions since 2011, under construction and extant planning permissions including approvals subject to completion of S106

12.409 The former engineering works off Village Street is a surviving example of rural industrial premises within the village. The character and appearance of this part of the conservation area will be conserved by conversion of the original brick buildings including the Reading Room. Replacement of the existing garages and other buildings will be acceptable.

12.410 The site will be developed in a comprehensive manner, with provision of adequate vehicular access and parking to meet the needs of the development. Any proposals for this site must ensure that existing flooding problems in the village, or elsewhere downstream, will not be exacerbated by the development.

Policy BTA02: Land off Exeter Road

(1) Land west of Exeter Road, as shown on Policies Map 33, is proposed for development that includes:

- (a) approximately 15 dwellings, including affordable homes, with an emphasis on providing a mix of types and sizes to reflect local need; and**
- (b) provision of additional community facilities including:**
 - (i) a new car park to serve the village;**
 - (ii) a contribution towards improvements to the village hall; and**
 - (iii) a pedestrian / cycle link between the A377 and the new strategic footpath/cycle link alongside the Tarka railway line.**

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) housing development to be located outside of the identified flood zone;**
- (b) a design and layout that respects the location of the site adjacent the conservation area and safeguards the historic setting of the listed Law Memorial Almshouses, including long distance views of and from Tawstock Conservation Area;**
- (c) a contribution to re-establishing functional flood plain alongside the river Taw; and**
- (d) adequate contribution towards addressing deficiency in the capacity or performance of the sewage treatment works to enable the development as a whole to proceed.**

12.411 The site between Exeter Road and the Tarka railway line is well related to the village centre and will help deliver a variety of house types and sizes to meet the local housing need in Bishop's Tawton. In addition to meeting the housing need for the village, the site will also deliver a number of community facilities. The southern and western boundaries are identified as flood plain of the Venn Stream and River Taw.

12.412 No buildings will be permitted in the flood plain, although provision of community facilities may be acceptable there if the design and layout is supported by a detailed flood risk assessment. The development must demonstrate that existing flooding problems will not be exacerbated locally or elsewhere downstream. Contributions will also be required to help facilitate the re-establishment

of a functional flood plain alongside the River Taw, in accordance with Policy BAR21: Flood Management Strategy and upgrading the existing sewage treatment works in the village.

12.413 Provision of any car park will be conveniently located to serve the village, including a safe pedestrian crossing over Exeter Road if required. The design of the new housing and access for vehicles, pedestrians and cyclists will need to respect the special character and appearance of the adjoining conservation area, the setting of the Grade II listed Law Memorial Almshouses on the opposite side of the A377 and long distance vistas between Bishops Tawton and Tawstock Conservation Areas. Policy DM07: Historic Environment will apply in respect of the Historic Environment. A single vehicular access will be required on to the A377, outside the flood zone, with additional safe accesses for pedestrians and cyclists linking to the proposed strategic footpath/cycle link to Barnstaple (Policy BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links).

Other Sites

12.414 Other limited opportunities for new residential development may be available within the defined development boundary, for example by the development of vacant sites or the redevelopment of unused sites or buildings. Any additional sites will be considered against the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Bishop's Tawton.

12.415 The former Venn Quarry, between the villages of Bishop's Tawton and Landkey, is a previously developed site within the Countryside where residential development would not normally be considered acceptable. The site provides the opportunity for connections to the Macmillan Way. If the site were to become available for re-development during the plan period, the re-use of the area for economic development or tourism related industries would be supported in accordance with general policies of the Local Plan. Re-development of the site must ensure visual impact on the surrounding landscape is minimised and the impact on the local highway network would not create adverse traffic issues in Bishop's Tawton or Landkey. A detailed flood risk assessment will be required to demonstrate that existing flooding problems will not be exacerbated locally or elsewhere downstream.

Community Facilities

12.416 Bishops Tawton has a wide range of local community facilities. Retention of existing recreation facilities and village services will be subject to the general policies of the Local Plan. Improvements to the village hall are sought. Provision of appropriate additional facilities to meet locally generated needs will be supported in accordance with the spatial strategy and general Local Plan policies.

12.417 The pedestrian / cycle route to be provided through the mixed use development off Exeter Road (Policy BTA02: Land off Exeter Road) will contribute to the establishment of a strategic footpath / cycle link between Barnstaple and Bishop's Tawton (Policy BAR20: Strategic Green Infrastructure Links). The route will improve connectivity to the Tarka Trail / Macmillan Way through the village as well as improving off-road access between the village and Park School.

Black Torrington

The Place

12.418 Black Torrington is situated 12 km (7 miles) east of Holsworthy off the A3072 and to the south of the River Torridge. The majority of the settlement lies to the south of St Marys Church and is generally bounded by Broad Street and Kneela Hill/Back Lane forming an extended twin linear shape.

12.419 The village has a limited range of services, which includes: a primary school, doctor's surgery/health centre, village hall, two places of worship, public house and equipped play area. There is no public transport service connecting the village to other centres.

Spatial Strategy

12.420 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Black Torrington.

Policy BTR: Black Torrington Spatial Strategy

The community's spatial vision for Black Torrington is to meet local social and economic needs through modest growth with retained village services and facilities.

The vision will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 5 dwellings, to meet the range of housing needs in the local community, the supply of housing will be delivered through a single site allocation;**
- (b) one additional housing site allocated within the development boundary at Long Cross Farm;**
- (c) retaining the character of the village and its relationship with the countryside; and**
- (d) support for the retention of village facilities and services to meet the needs of the local community.**

The Development Proposals

12.421 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities to address locally generated and quantified needs. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site specific policy below.

12.422 A development boundary for Black Torrington is defined on Policies Map 34, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.423 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Black Torrington.

Housing

12.424 Additional housing is proposed to meet the needs and demands of Black Torrington over the plan period. At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively modest level of housing commitment in the village⁽⁸⁶⁾. The Local Plan allocates a site that is considered deliverable to meet future housing needs.

12.425 The spatial extent of the proposal is shown on Policies Map 34 and is subject to a site specific policy (BTR01: Land at Long Cross Farm) that sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles.

Policy BTR01: Land at Long Cross Farm

(1) Land and buildings at Long Cross Farm, as shown on Policies Map 34, is allocated for residential development that includes approximately 5 dwellings, with a focus on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) vehicular access from Bonfire Hill;**
- (b) a design and layout that respects the location of the site bounded on three sides by open countryside;**
- (c) retention of core farm buildings as part of an integrated scheme layout;**
- (d) retention of mature trees and hedgebanks and the provision of additional planting to provide a landscaped development; and**
- (e) development will be limited to the extent of the existing agricultural buildings.**

12.426 A brownfield site with a range of agricultural buildings is proposed for development on the south side of the village. The land rises steeply to the east, with established boundaries, including highways to east and west.

12.427 The site at Long Cross is suitable for residential development and can provide a small range of dwellings to meet the needs of the community.

12.428 Development will be limited to the complex of existing farm buildings. Enabled development does not extend to the wider associated field, which would inappropriately extend the built form of the village and result in a scale of development inconsistent with Black Torrington's Spatial Strategy.

Other Issues

12.429 Proposals which address the provision of services and facilities in the village will be supported in accordance with the general policies of the Local Plan if the use and its scale and location are appropriate.

⁸⁶ 10 dwellings from sites under construction, subject to extant planning permission and approved subject to the completion of a S106 agreement, including 5 units on BTR01: Land at Long Cross Farm.

Bridgerule

The Place

12.430 Bridgerule is located 8 km (5 miles) to the west of Holsworthy and 9.6 km (6 miles) to the east of Bude in north Cornwall. The River Tamar bisects the village; separating the main part of the settlement, to the west of the river from a smaller grouping of buildings, and the primary school and playing field to the east. Both east and western parts of the village are impacted by the extent of flood zone associated with the River Torridge.

12.431 The village has a small range of services, including a village shop, primary school, village hall, places of worship and a public house. Public transport also links the village with larger settlements, including Holsworthy and Bideford and thus accessibility to a wider range of services and facilities. Employment is based upon local services with the main activities related to agriculture and tourism. There is also an established business/industrial estate at Merrifield, located off the B3254 about 1.6 km south of the village.

12.432 Bridgerule lies outside any landscape designation, it is not covered by a conservation area and the extent of designated historic assets within the village is limited; only two listed buildings to the east of Bridgerule. A broad swath of land adjoining the River Tamar falls within the flood zone, which extends, to a limited extent, over the built form of both western and eastern parts of the village.

Spatial Strategy

Policy BRI: Bridgerule Spatial Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development that is focused on meeting local economic and social needs and which is supported by necessary infrastructure.

The vision will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 31 dwellings, including affordable homes, to meet the range of housing needs in the local community; the supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning consents and a single site allocation with a capacity for approximately 10 dwellings;**
- (b) one additional housing site allocated within the development boundary;**
- (c) additional and extended recreation facilities at the Vinnicombe Park playing field;**
- (d) retained employment opportunities and support for additional workspace to support local business development at Merrifield Cross; and**
- (e) the retention of village facilities and services to meet the needs of the local community.**

The Development Proposals

12.433 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities to address locally generated and quantified needs. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site specific policies below.

12.434 A development boundary for Bridgerule is defined on Policies Map 35, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.435 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated at the village for economic development, at which proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Town, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. A site is allocated for economic development to accommodate a limited expansion of the Merrifield Cross Industrial Estate. The focus for new development will be to address locally generated needs, which will be modest in scale.

12.436 The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Bridgerule.

Policy BRI01: Land at Merrifield Cross

(1) Land at Merrifield Cross, as shown on the Policies Map 35, is allocated for economic development, focused on delivering a mix of units to meet local business needs.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following site specific development principles:

- (a) a focus on employment activities in the range of B1, B2 and B8 uses;**
- (b) retention of established screening on the road frontage and enhanced screening on the site's southern boundary; and**
- (c) location, design and screening of premises that ensures the future compatibility with adjoining uses.**

12.437 Land adjacent to the existing industrial units at the former Bridgerule and Whitstone Station is allocated for further employment development to provide opportunities for local business development and expansion.

12.438 A site of about 0.34 hectares is allocated for economic development at Merrifield Cross. Additional workshop units should complement existing provision and provide a resource for local business. The site, together with the existing business units, are located in the Countryside and will be retained for employment use in accordance with the general policies of the Local Plan. It is envisaged that the workshop units provided will primarily be small in scale. Retail development will not be acceptable on the allocated site.

Housing

12.439 Additional housing is proposed to meet the needs and demands of Bridgerule over the plan period. At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively high level of housing commitment in the village⁽⁸⁷⁾. The Local Plan allows for a single housing site that is considered deliverable to meet housing needs.

87 30 dwellings from completions since 2011, sites under construction and an extant planning permission for 9 dwellings on BRI02: Land West of Southfields.

12.440 The spatial extent of the proposal is shown on Policies Map 35 and is subject to a site specific policy that sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles.

Policy BRI02: Land West of Southfields

(1) Land West of Southfields, as shown on Policies Map 35, is allocated for residential development that includes approximately 10 dwellings, -with a focus on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

(a) vehicular access from the highway to the north, with commensurate widening of the road along the entire frontage, to provide safe vehicular and pedestrian access;

(b) a design and layout that respects the location of the site bounded by open countryside; and

(c) retention and enhancement of existing boundary trees and hedgebanks.

12.441 A greenfield site adjoining Southfields is proposed for development. The site is a generally flat field and surrounded by hedgerows on all sides.

12.442 The site Land West of Southfields is suitable for residential development, it can provide a range of dwellings to meet local needs and help support local services. The site has a frontage with the main road running east-west through the village. The road does however narrow at this point and would require widening in order to safely accommodate development.

Bucks Cross

The Place

12.443 Bucks Cross is located 12 km (7.5 miles) west of Bideford, positioned immediately off the A39. It has a linear configuration, with the northern most part of the settlement separated from the rest by the main road.

12.444 The village has a minimal level of services comprising of post office/village shop, village hall and place of worship. A public transport service links the village with Bideford, Barnstaple and Bude in north Cornwall. Employment in the area is provided by land based and tourism facilities in the form of holiday accommodation and caravan/camping sites. The Bideford Bay Holiday Village lies immediately to the north-west of the village.

12.445 The part of the village north of the A39 is covered by the North Devon Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty, although the built-up area is not subject to conservation area status.

Spatial Strategy

Policy BUC: Bucks Cross Spatial Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality minimal development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Bucks Cross.

The vision for the village settlement will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of residential accommodation from any future commitments, including affordable homes, to meet housing needs in the local community;**
- (b) support for the retention of village facilities and services to meet the needs of the local community; and**
- (c) giving great weight to conserving landscape and scenic beauty in considering proposals for development.**

The Development Proposals

12.446 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities to address locally generated and quantified needs. This role will be supported in a range of ways, including where appropriate development of underused and previously developed land within the village.

12.447 A development boundary for Bucks Cross is defined on Policies Map 36, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

12.448 The location of part of the village within the North Devon AONB means that great weight will be given to conserving landscape and scenic beauty in considering proposals for development.

Employment

12.449 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale, although the village can capitalise on enhanced levels of assistance offered by Assisted Area status. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan

policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Bucks Cross.

Housing

12.450 No specific sites are allocated in Bucks Cross for general housing development although a number of opportunities for small scale development may be available within the village. At 31st March 2017 there was a very modest level of housing commitment in the village⁽⁸⁸⁾.

88 1 dwelling with an extant planning permission.

Burrington

The Place

12.451 Burrington is located on a ridge to the western side of the Taw Valley, approximately 18 kilometres (11 miles) south west of South Molton and approximately 19 kilometres (12 miles) east of Great Torrington. The village also has good links to the A377, Barnstaple to Exeter road and is relatively well connected to the Barnstaple to Exeter railway line with stations at the Portsmouth Arms and King's Nympton both in close proximity.

12.452 The village is not located within any designated landscape although there are attractive river valleys to the north, east and south and the elevated position allows extensive views towards Dartmoor. Pennyford Fields County Wildlife Site lies to the south west of the village. The village has a linear development form with a relatively compact conservation area, based around the Church of the Holy Trinity, a Grade I listed building.

12.453 The village has a range of local services including a convenience store, primary school and pre-school, play area and sports pitch, community hall and one pub, The Barnstaple Inn. Employment in the area is based mainly on these local services including car repair businesses, local hotel, a blacksmith, traditional carpenter and in the village centre, Pickards Agricultural Merchants.

12.454 The local sewage treatment facilities need to be upgraded to accommodate any substantial additional development.

Spatial Strategy

12.455 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development that is supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Burrington.

Policy BUR: Burrington Spatial Strategy

The local community vision for the village and parish is that it retains its viability and vibrancy, maintaining and developing the range of facilities and accommodating additional young people and families in the area to allow the continuation of the primary school and pre-school.

To help achieve this vision, the local community accepts the need for a significant amount of additional family housing and housing for younger people as well as additional employment opportunities. The spatial strategy will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 59 new dwellings to meet a range of housing needs in the local community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning consents and three additional housing sites for approximately 50 dwellings;
- (b) support for additional employment provision to meet local requirements;
- (c) retaining the character of the village and its relationship with the countryside and open spaces;
- (d) maintaining and developing village services and facilities;
- (e) improvements to the existing sewage treatment works;
- (f) delivery of superfast broadband connections; and

(g) supporting improved public transport connections serving the village.

Development Proposals

12.456 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site-specific policies below.

12.457 Other proposals that are well related to the existing village, appropriate to the scale of the locality and address locally generated and quantified needs will be considered against the general policies of the Local Plan.

Employment

12.458 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses and the protection of existing employment sites will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Burrington.

Housing

12.459 The spatial extent of the proposals for new development is shown on Policies Map 37 and is subject to site-specific policies that set out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles. At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively low level of housing commitments in Burrington⁽⁸⁹⁾.

12.460 A detailed evaluation of the main sewage treatment works is required to establish what upgrading would be required to enable the development of the allocated sites. Any necessary upgrading or other improvements will require implementation before significant new development takes place.

12.461 The sites will be released to ensure a steady and continuing pace of development over the plan period in accordance with the spatial strategy, allowing the community and services to adapt to growth. There is no preference for the order in which these sites are released for development.

Policy BUR01: Land off Meadow Park Drive

(1) Land off Meadow Park Drive, as shown on Policies Map 37, is proposed for residential development that includes approximately 10 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

(a) a design and layout that safeguards the historic setting of the nearby listed building at Meadow House;

(b) retention and enhancement of existing boundaries to minimise the impact of new development on existing dwellings; and

89 4 dwellings from completions since 2011, under construction and extant planning permissions, including approvals subject to completion of S106

(c) vehicular access from a single point on Meadow Park Drive.

12.462 The site in the Cross Park area can provide a range of housing to meet the needs of the local community although development will respect the generally lower density housing that exists within this part of the village. Vehicular access should be from Meadow Park Drive.

12.463 The site adjoins the Grade II listed building at Meadow House, the setting of which must be protected. A number of existing residential properties border the site. Detailed design, layout and landscaping should minimise the impact of development on these properties. Additional tree and hedge planting is required along the site boundaries designed to help reduce the impact of development on existing properties. A satisfactory relationship between these properties and new housing is required in order to protect the amenities of both.

Policy BUR02: Land Rear of Barnstaple Inn, 'Mayfair' and 'Cavok Cottage'

(1) Land to the rear of Barnstaple Inn, 'Mayfair' and 'Cavok Cottage' as shown on Policies Map 37, is proposed for residential development that includes:

(a) approximately 20 dwellings, including affordable homes, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs; and

(b) an area for allotments of approximately 0.2 hectares.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

(a) design and layout that conserves the setting of nearby listed buildings, the character and appearance of the adjoining conservation area and the character of the village centre;

(b) provision of an additional substantial hedgerow along the northern and western boundaries to integrate the development into its countryside setting; and

(c) vehicular access from both Barton Road and the Village Street.

12.464 The site is part of a larger field where development must incorporate substantial planting along the northern and western boundaries to integrate the site into its landscape setting and provide a transitional boundary between the development and the adjoining countryside.

12.465 The site should be planned comprehensively although it may be developed in phases with separate accesses from adjoining highways. Pedestrian and cycle links through the development will be provided. The development will provide a range of housing, including smaller dwellings, to meet the needs of the local community. A satisfactory relationship between existing properties and new housing is required in order to protect the amenities of both and setting of the Grade II listed Barnstaple Inn and Cavok Cottage as well as the special character and appearance of the adjacent conservation area.

12.466 An appropriately serviced allotment area, approximately 0.2 hectares in size, will be required adjacent to one of the adjoining roads and should be provided prior to the occupation of the dwellings on site. The development should clarify arrangements for its future management.

Policy BUR03: Land South of Hayne View, Balls Corner

(1) Land to the south of Hayne View, Balls Corner, as shown on Policies Map 37, is proposed for residential development that includes approximately 20 dwellings, including affordable homes, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) development along the village street reflecting the character of the village;**
- (b) replacement of the frontage hedge lost to secure an acceptable access;**
- (c) provision of an additional substantial hedgerow along the southern and eastern boundaries to integrate the development into its countryside setting; and**
- (d) retention and enhancement of the public right of way that runs through the northern part of the site.**

12.467 The site is part of a larger field to the south of the village centre where development must incorporate substantial planting along the southern and eastern boundaries to integrate the site into its landscape setting and provide a transitional boundary between the development and the adjoining countryside.

12.468 The site should be planned comprehensively although it may be developed in phases with vehicular access from the main highway through the village. The development will provide enhanced pedestrian and cycle links towards the village centre together with enhancements of the existing public right of way that runs through the northern part of the site eastwards, towards Hayne Barton. The development will provide a range of housing types including smaller dwellings to meet the needs of the local community. A satisfactory relationship between existing properties and new housing is required in order to protect the amenities of both.

Community Facilities

12.469 Burrington has a range of education, recreation, social and community facilities. Retention and enhancement of these services and facilities is recognised as important towards sustaining Burrington as a sustainable location for the level of growth proposed. The general policies of the Local Plan protect such services and facilities, and proposals that involve their loss will be considered against these policies. Provision of appropriate additional facilities to meet locally generated needs will be supported in accordance with the spatial strategy and general Local Plan policies.

Chilsworthy

The Place

12.470 Chilsworthy is situated about 3 km (1.8 miles) north-west of Holsworthy. It is the main settlement in the extensive Holsworthy Hamlets Parish and takes a linear form along the Holsworthy to Bradworthy road.

12.471 The village has a good range of services, including post office, village hall which contains a main sports hall hosting a wide number of leisure activities, place of worship, garage (car-repairs), public house and equipped play areas. Employment opportunities within the Parish are fairly wide ranging and include the Bio-gas Centre, local facilities, builders and tourist accommodation. The new Agri-Business Park will also provide additional employment with further opportunities through associated development throughout the plan period.

12.472 The village is not subject to conservation designations. Land associated with a stream to the east of the village is part of a defined flood zone.

Spatial Strategy

12.473 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Chilsworthy.

Policy HOH: Chilsworthy Spatial Strategy

The community's spatial vision for Chilsworthy is to accommodate local housing needs through the development of modestly sized sites that will contribute to the retention of local facilities and the attractive rural character of the village.

The vision will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 7 dwellings to meet the range of housing needs in the local community, the supply of housing will be delivered through a single site allocation;**
- (b) utilising windfall sites within the defined development boundary to add to housing development opportunities;**
- (c) one additional site for housing at land west of Meadowside, included within the development boundary;**
- (d) retention of the character of the village and its relationship with the countryside; and**
- (e) support for the retention of village facilities and services to meet the needs of the local community.**

The Development Proposals

12.474 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities to address locally generated and quantified needs. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site specific policies below.

12.475 A development boundary for Chilsworthy is defined on Policies Map 38, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.476 During the life of the Local Plan there may be a requirement for additional land or premises to accommodate businesses able to provide a service to, or employment for, local people.

12.477 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development at or adjoining the village. Proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Economic Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Chilsworthy.

Housing

12.478 Additional housing is proposed to meet the needs and demands of Chilsworthy over the plan period. At 31st March 2017 there was only a modest level of housing commitment in the village⁽⁹⁰⁾.

12.479 The Local Plan allocates one site that is considered deliverable to meet the future housing needs and demands of Chilsworthy. The spatial extent of the proposal is shown on Policies Map 38 and is subject to a site specific policy that sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles.

Policy HOH01: Land West of Meadowside

(1) Land west of Meadowside, as shown on Policies Map 38, is allocated for residential development that includes approximately 7 dwellings, with a focus on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles;

- (a) vehicular access from the adjoining highway;**
- (b) retention of existing mature trees and hedgebanks and provision of additional planting to provide a landscaped development;**
- (c) substantial landscaping on the northern boundary to integrate the new development into the landscape; and**
- (d) a design and layout that respects the location of the site bounded on two sides by open countryside.**

12.480 A greenfield site to the west of Meadowside on the northern side of the village is allocated for housing. The site is relatively flat with established boundaries, comprising mature hedgerows and trees on all but the north side.

12.481 The site can provide a range of dwellings to meet local needs, to reflect the village status and help support local facilities. It is well related to the highway network in terms of the road from Chapel Lane running along the south side of the site. Enhanced landscaping will be provided to integrate the site into the landscape and provide biodiversity links with existing features.

⁹⁰ 7 dwellings from completions since 2011 and sites under construction and with extant planning permission, including a single unit on HOH01: Land West of Meadowside.

Other Issues

12.482 Proposals which address the provision of services and facilities in the village will be supported in accordance with the general policies of the Local Plan if the use and its scale and location are appropriate.

Chittlehampton

The Place

12.483 Chittlehampton is close to the B3227, Great Torrington to South Molton road, identified as an 'Other Strategic Route' in Figure 4.4 with good access to the A377 Barnstaple to Exeter road. The village is about 8.5 kilometres (5 miles) west of South Molton and 17 kilometres (11 miles) south-east of Barnstaple.

12.484 The village is established on the side of a tributary valley of the River Taw. It has a linear development form with a compact conservation area centred around The Square and the Grade I listed Church of St Hieritha's. Facilities in the village include a primary school, public house, recreation field, community hall and village store.

12.485 Chittlehampton has relatively few employment opportunities within the village, although Umberleigh has the Murch Bros (Engineers) Ltd. and Murchs' Antiques Emporium, both well established businesses. However locally there are a number of smaller businesses. The majority of the working population travel outside of the parish for employment to areas such as Barnstaple and Pathfields Business Park in South Molton.

Spatial Strategy

12.486 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development, supported by necessary infrastructure, to meet the needs of Chittlehampton.

Policy CHI: Chittlehampton Spatial Strategy

The local community has a vision for the area that it remains an attractive village and a 'working' parish. There is also a strong desire to maintain and preserve the character and appearance of the village. The spatial strategy will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 24 new dwellings to meet the range of needs in the community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning permissions and a single site allocation at Cobbaton Road to deliver approximately 20 dwellings;**
- (b) support for additional employment provision to meet locally generated requirements;**
- (c) improved broadband coverage;**
- (d) retention of the character of the village and its relationship with the countryside; and**
- (e) support for improved and additional recreation and community facilities to meet locally generated needs.**

Development Proposals

12.487 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site-specific policies below.

12.488 A development boundary for Chittlehampton is defined on Policies Map 39, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.489 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of other Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Chittlehampton.

Housing

12.490 The spatial extent of the proposal is shown on Policies Map 39 and is subject to a site specific policy that sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles. At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively low level of housing commitments in Chittlehampton⁽⁹¹⁾.

12.491 A site is proposed off the Cobbaton road, adjacent to Mayflower Close, for residential development. Any additional housing to provide the scale and type of development to help meet the identified needs of the local community will be released in accordance with the spatial strategy.

Policy CHI01: Land at Cobbaton Road

(1) Land off Cobbaton Road, as shown on Policies Map 39, is proposed for residential development that includes approximately 20 dwellings, including affordable homes, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) vehicular access to the Cobbaton road, replacing any hedgerows being lost;**
- (b) an opportunity being safeguarded for future vehicular access to the land north of the site;**
- (c) provision of an additional substantial hedgerow along the northern boundary to ensure the development is integrated into the landscape; and**
- (d) design, layout and landscaping that minimises the impact of development on existing residential properties.**

12.492 The site off Cobbaton road is well related to the village and will provide the majority of new dwellings required in the village over the plan period. The site can be developed without undue harm to the landscape setting of the village with suitable design and landscaping. Proposals to phase the supply of new homes over the Plan period to meet local needs will be supported, which may require a flexible approach to development or review of detailed proposals as community needs are identified.

12.493 New housing will be concentrated to the south-eastern part of the site, adjacent to the existing housing. The northern boundary of this area is undefined and substantial planting will be required to integrate the development into its countryside setting. Planting will extend through the development to reduce its visual impact.

91 8 dwellings from completions since 2011, under construction and extant planning permissions

12.494 The site slopes from north to south. Vehicular access should be from an appropriate location toward the southern end of the site, with a replacement hedgebank of equivalent biodiversity value required to compensate for loss of any existing hedgebank. If over the plan period additional housing is required in the village to meet local needs, the remaining land, to the north-west of the substantial planting, will be considered. Development must safeguard the opportunity for a future vehicular access through the site towards land further north to provide the primary vehicular access to any future development in this location.

12.495 A number of established properties border the site including the Grade II listed Townsend Cottages. Detailed design, layout and landscaping should minimise the impact of development on properties in the immediate area. A satisfactory relationship between these properties and new housing is required in order to protect the amenities of both as well as the setting of the listed buildings. Existing open space or recreation facilities elsewhere within the village should be upgraded to serve the needs of the development.

Community Facilities

12.496 The playing field and village hall to the south of the village provides an important recreation facility for the community and the site is safeguarded for this use (Policy DM09: Safeguarding Green Infrastructure). Provision of additional community facilities and sports and recreation facilities to meet locally generated needs will be supported.

Clawton

The Place

12.497 Clawton is located in the south-western part of the Plan area, about 6.4 km (4 miles) south-east of Holsworthy on the A388. The settlement is compact with pockets of existing development mainly adjoining the strategic road running in a north-south direction.

12.498 The village has a minimal level of services: including nursery/primary school, village hall and place of worship. A daily bus service links Clawton with Holsworthy, Bideford and Barnstaple. Local employment is small-scale and mainly related to agriculture and visitor accommodation with a few service industries, including a micro-brewery and light engineering.

12.499 Clawton lies outside any designated landscape area and there is no conservation area covering the village. A broad corridor of land adjoining the River Claw falls within a flood zone that lies immediately to the north of the development boundary and also comes within the settlement area around the war memorial.

Spatial Strategy

12.500 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Clawton.

Policy CLW: Clawton Spatial Strategy

The local community's vision for the village is to promote the interests of Clawton as a community and in particular to provide affordable housing to meet the established need and facilitate small-scale development around the village, subject to village agreement.

The vision for the village settlement will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 9 dwellings, to meet the range of housing needs in the local community. The supply of housing will be delivered through a single site allocation.**
- (b) support for the provision of a community centre, either through re-use of an existing building (i.e. the old Sunday School) or new build option associated with car parking and a village green;**
- (c) encouraged reuse and enhancement of derelict sites in the village centre (i.e. old Sunday School and East Cottage); and**
- (d) support for the retention of village facilities and services to meet the needs of the local community.**

The Development Proposals

12.501 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities to address locally generated and quantified needs. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site specific policies below.

12.502 A development boundary for Clawton is defined on Policies Map 40, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.503 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the plan and the spatial strategy for Clawton.

Housing

12.504 Additional housing is proposed to meet the needs and demands of Clawton over the Plan period. At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively modest level of housing commitment in the village.⁽⁹²⁾ The Local Plan allocates a single housing site that is considered deliverable to meet housing needs.

12.505 The spatial extent of the proposal is shown on Policies Map 40 and is subject to a site specific policy that sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles.

Policy CLW01: Land at Riverside

(1) Land at Riverside, as shown on Policies Map 40, is allocated for residential development that includes up to 9 dwellings, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) housing located to the eastern part of the site;**
- (b) vehicular access from a single point on the adjoining minor road;**
- (c) provide the site for and contribute to the delivery of a village green;**
- (d) a design and layout that respects the location of the site bounded on three sides by open countryside;**
- (e) retention of existing mature trees and hedgebanks and provision of some additional planting to provide a landscaped development; and**
- (f) pedestrian access to link with footpath network serving the village.**

12.506 A greenfield site at Riverside of approximately 0.4 hectare is allocated for housing development. The site is flat with low hedgerows to roadside and semi mature hedges on the southern boundary.

12.507 The site can provide a small range of dwellings to meet local needs and demands, to reflect the village status and help support local facilities. The scheme will also allow for a village green to be provided within the new housing area, which in the longer term could additionally incorporate sought built community facilities.

⁹² 11 dwellings from completions since 2011, sites under construction and extant planning permissions, including 5 dwellings on part of CLW01: Land at Riverside.

12.508 Access to the housing will be provided from the adjoining minor road immediately to the north from a single point and pedestrian access will also link to the existing footpath network serving the village to the south west.

12.509 Development of the site will also have regard to any potential for archaeological remains given past location for older, possibly medieval structures and need for conformity with Policy DM07: Historic Environment.

Other Issues

12.510 Retention of existing recreation facilities and village services will be subject to the general policies of the Local Plan. Provision of appropriate additional facilities to meet locally generated needs will be supported in accordance with the spatial strategy and general Local Plan policies.

Clovelly and Higher Clovelly

The Place

12.511 Clovelly and Higher Clovelly is located 18 km (11 miles) west of Bideford, on and close to the northern Devon coastline respectively. They lie in the western corner of the plan area, close to the boundary with Cornwall.

12.512 Clovelly has a concentrated settlement form situated within a narrow valley which opens to the harbour front. The main street is narrow and cobbled with a series of terraced buildings and is not accessible by motor vehicle. In contrast, Higher Clovelly is linear in character and split into two groups of development, set inland about 2 km (1.3 miles) from the main village.

12.513 Services and facilities are shared between the two settlements and include a village hall, three places of worship, two public houses, a petrol station with convenience store and playing field. A number of other facilities primarily relate to the tourist function of Clovelly. A public transport service links the villages with Bideford, Barnstaple and Bude in north Cornwall. Employment in the area is provided by tourism services in the form of holiday accommodation and interpretation/visitor centre and land based interests.

12.514 Conservation area status applies to the whole of Clovelly village and the majority of contained buildings are listed. Both settlements are covered by the North Devon Coast Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty and Special Area of Conservation and Site of Special Scientific Interest.

Spatial Strategy

Policy CLO: Clovelly/Higher Clovelly Spatial Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development, supported by necessary infrastructure, to meet the needs of Clovelly and Higher Clovelly.

The vision will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 18 dwellings, to meet the range of housing needs in the local community. The supply of housing will be delivered through a site allocation supplemented by acceptable new proposals;**
- (b) one additional housing site allocated within the development boundary at Lower Burscott Farmyard, Higher Clovelly;**
- (c) conserving and enhancing the historic character of Clovelly;**
- (d) retention of existing services and facilities in the villages;**
- (e) support for the provision of services and accommodation to meet the needs of the community's ageing population;**
- (f) renovation of village hall at Higher Clovelly;**
- (g) additional employment provision; and**
- (h) giving great weight to conserving landscape and natural beauty in the consideration of proposal for development.**

The Development Proposals

12.515 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities to address locally generated and quantified needs. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site specific policy below.

12.516 Development boundaries for Clovelly and Higher Clovelly are defined on Policies Maps 41 and 41A, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

12.517 The location of the villages within the North Devon AONB means that great weight will be given to conserving landscape and scenic beauty in considering proposals for development.

Employment

12.518 Any new employment in the villages is likely to be small scale, although the village can capitalise on enhanced levels of assistance offered by Assisted Area status. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Clovelly and Higher Clovelly.

Housing

12.519 Additional housing is proposed to meet the needs and demands of Clovelly and Higher Clovelly over the Plan period. At 31st March 2017 there were no housing commitments in the villages. The Local Plan allocates a single site that is considered deliverable to meet future housing needs.

12.520 The spatial extent of the proposal is shown on Policies Map 41A and is subject to a site specific policy that sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles.

Policy CLO01: Land at Lower Burscott Farmyard

(1) Land at Lower Burscott farmyard, Higher Clovelly, as shown on Policies Map 41A, is allocated for residential development that includes approximately 10 dwellings, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) provide vehicular access from Burscott Lane to west of farmyard;**
- (b) sensitive design specification that reflects Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty status of the site and wider area;**
- (c) the built form of the development should cover a similar footprint of the existing agricultural buildings without extending into the adjoining fields;**
- (d) extensive landscaping on the southeast and northwest boundaries to enhance biodiversity and integrate the new development into the landscape; and**
- (e) retention of existing mature trees and hedgerows.**

12.521 Redundant farmyard and associated agricultural storage buildings are proposed for residential development on the eastern side of Higher Clovelly. The site is located on a hilltop and surrounded on three sides by open countryside.

12.522 Given the prominent position of Burscott farmyard and high value of surrounding landscape, holding Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty status, it will be necessary for detailed design and layout to be of a high vernacular standard and for the built form to cover the footprint of the existing agricultural buildings. The farmyard has only partial screening and mature vegetation. Development will need to protect the existing trees and hedge banks and provide additional planting and landscaping on the northwest and southeast boundaries.

12.523 Burscott Lane on the western side of the land will provide highway access. Pedestrian access from the site to the primary school at Clovelly from the public right of way outside the site will be integrated into any scheme proposals.

12.524 The development will need to make adequate arrangements for sewerage and sewage treatment. The local planning authority will be required to be satisfied that any organic contamination or waste material arising from previous agricultural use has been removed prior to development.

Other Issues

12.525 Proposals which address the provision of services and facilities in the village will be supported in accordance with the general policies of the Local Plan if the use and its scale and location are appropriate.

Croyde and Georgeham

The Place

12.526 Georgeham Parish is located within coastal downland to the north-west of Braunton. The principal settlements of the parish are the villages of Croyde and Georgeham which are about 2 kilometres (1.5 miles) apart within the Crydda Valley. To the west of Croyde, the Crydda Valley widens to an extensive area of dunes at Croyde Burrows, to the west of which is Croyde Bay. Land rises away from the valley floor to provide attractive settings to both villages which are within the Coastal and Estuarine Zone (Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy). Georgeham in particular, is accessed by narrow lanes and bordering hedgebanks that are a typical local feature throughout the parish. These hedgerows provide an important network of habitats for movement and feeding of protected species in accordance with Policies ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets and DM08: Biodiversity and Geodiversity.

12.527 Both villages lie within the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty and Heritage Coast. The coastline north of Downend at Croyde is part of the Marine Conservation Zone and Voluntary Marine Conservation Area which stretches as far as Blackstone Beach at Great Hangman (within Exmoor National Park). The designations recognise the ecological and geological importance of the cliffs and foreshore along this stretch of coastline. The coastal area also includes an extensive Site of Special Scientific Interest between Saunton Down and Baggy Point including Croyde Beach and Burrows which is of special importance for its geological exposures, rugged cliffs and maritime habitats. The South West Coast Path follows the coastline between Baggy Point and Downend crossing Croyde Burrows. There are a number of County Wildlife Sites in the vicinity of the village, including Croyde Field, Croyde Burrows and Middleborough Hill as shown on Policies Map 42.

12.528 The headland ridges either side of Croyde form part of an archaeological landscape where several pre-historic sites have been identified. The centre of the village has retained its character and a conservation area has been designated in the historic core where cob and stone buildings with thatch or natural slate roofs predominate, together with numerous bridges and stone walling. Similar materials occur in the conservation area at Georgeham, centred around the Grade I listed Church of St George.

12.529 A range of services and community facilities are available in both villages, especially at Croyde where the majority of the tourist trade is focused. Both settlements have a post office, convenience stores, public houses, village halls, play areas and recreation facilities, including the beach at Croyde. The primary school that serves the parish is within the village of Georgeham.

12.530 There are limited employment opportunities within the parish, which has Assisted Area status. The local economy is dominated by tourism related industries with extensive areas of Croyde dedicated to holiday accommodation including Croyde Bay Holiday Resort, Ruda Holiday Centre and Leadengate. Also, both Croyde and Georgeham have a high level of second home ownership that adds to the overall level of tourism accommodation in the parish. Other employment opportunities are mostly outside of the parish.

Spatial Strategy

12.531 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Georgeham and Croyde.

Policy GEO: Georgeham and Croyde Spatial Strategy

The local community has a vision for the parish that seeks to maintain the character and appearance of the area, for the benefit of both residents and visitors alike, while

adopting a positive approach to development well related to the villages that will address local housing and community needs. The natural environment, local community and its facilities are particularly valued. The spatial strategy will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 37 dwellings in Croyde to meet the range of needs in the community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning permissions and a single site allocation totalling approximately 15 dwellings on land off Croyde Road;
- (b) provision of approximately 17 dwellings in Georgeham, to meet the range of needs in the community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning permissions and a single site allocation for approximately 10 dwellings at Frogstreet Hill and a non-strategic housing site;
- (c) protection of the natural environment including the special landscape character and qualities of the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty;
- (d) protection of the character of the conservation areas and other distinctive character areas in the villages such as Leadengate in Croyde;
- (e) support for superfast broadband connections; and
- (f) support for the provision of additional primary school capacity to serve the parish.

Development Proposals

12.532 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site-specific policies below. Development boundaries for Croyde and Georgeham are defined on Policies Maps 42 and 43 respectively outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.533 Any new employment in the parish is likely to be small scale and no specific site is identified for economic development, although the villages can capitalise on enhanced levels of assistance offered by the Assisted Area status. Proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, for general employment and Policies DM17: Tourism and Leisure Attractions and DM18: Tourism, in relation to tourism proposals. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy and vision for Georgeham and Croyde.

Housing

12.534 The spatial extent of the proposals are shown on Policies Maps 42 and 43 and are subject to site-specific policies that set out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles. A site at Fairleigh, Georgeham is identified as a non-strategic housing site for approximately 8 dwellings (Appendix 5'Schedule of Non-strategic Housing Sites'. At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively high level of housing commitment in Georgeham / Croyde⁽⁹³⁾.

93 37 dwellings since 2011, from completions, under construction and extant planning permissions, including approvals subject to completion of S106

Policy GEO01: Land off Frogstreet Hill, Georgeham

(1) Site at Frogstreet Hill, as shown on Policies Map 43, is proposed for residential development that includes approximately 10 dwellings, with an emphasis on providing a mix of house types and sizes to reflect local need.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) all buildings to be located outside the identified flood zone;**
- (b) retention of existing trees and boundary hedges and replacement of the road frontage hedge lost to secure an acceptable access; and**
- (c) design and layout that respects the location of the site and the character of the village.**

12.535 The identified area for housing north of Frogstreet Hill is well related to the existing settlement. Development will provide a range of dwellings of sizes and types that address local community needs. The site slopes gently toward the floodplain along the northern boundary. No dwellings will be permitted on land liable to flooding. A detailed flood risk assessment will be required to demonstrate that the development will not exacerbate flooding locally or elsewhere downstream.

12.536 A single access from Frogstreet Hill will be provided with replacement of the existing hedgerow along the new site frontage by additional planting to maintain a rural character to the development and to ensure the network of habitats for movement and feeding of protected species is retained.

Policy GEO02: Land off Croyde Road, Croyde

(1) A site off Croyde Road, east and west of Leadengate House, as shown on Policies Map 42, is proposed for residential development that includes approximately 15 dwellings, including affordable homes, with an emphasis on providing a mix of house types and sizes to reflect local need.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) access from Croyde Road;**
- (b) replacement of the frontage hedge along Croyde Road and reinforcement of existing boundaries with additional planting, particularly along the southern boundary with Somerthing Lane to provide an appropriate transitional boundary between the development and adjoining countryside;**
- (c) design and layout that respects the location of the site, its landscape setting and the character of the village; and**
- (d) protection of the amenities of adjoining dwellings.**

12.537 The site consists of separate fields east and west of Leadengate House, both visually prominent from higher land surrounding the village particularly to the south, although well related to existing housing development.

12.538 Parts of the former strip field system lie to the south of the allocation. Both sites, to the east and west of Leadengate House, can be developed without undue harm to this and to the setting of or approach to the village. Substantial planting along the southern boundary and appropriate design and layout with Somerthing Lane will be required to integrate the site into its landscape setting, minimise its impact on the AONB and provide a transitional boundary between the development and the adjoining countryside.

12.539 The development will be required to minimise impact on adjoining properties, with a satisfactory relationship between these properties and new housing to protect the amenities of both. Replacement of the existing frontage hedge will need to be provided to maintain a traditional rural appearance of the site.

Communities Facilities

12.540 Georgeham primary school is an important local facility. The provision of additional capacity to meet local requirements or improved pedestrian links to the school are supported providing the impact of development is acceptable locally and does not have an adverse impact on the special qualities of the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty.

12.541 The general policies of the Local Plan seek to retain and protect such services and facilities in both villages, and proposals that involve their loss will be considered against these policies. Provision of appropriate additional facilities to meet locally generated needs, including the extension of the village public car park will be supported in accordance with the spatial strategy and general Local Plan policies. The Local Plan would also support the provision of a safe pedestrian footpath link from Georgeham to the cemetery off Incledon Hill.

East Anstey

The Place

12.542 East Anstey, at the eastern edge of the plan area, is the main settlement of a rural parish with several hamlets. It lies approximately 16 kilometres (10 miles) east of South Molton, close to the Somerset border in attractive countryside on the edge of Exmoor National Park. The route of the former Devon and Somerset Railway, which provided links to Taunton and Barnstaple until its closure in 1966, runs through the centre of the village.

12.543 The village has a limited range of services that include a primary school with pre-school, community hall, sports pitch and equipped play area. The local post office service is shared with adjoining communities, which is available for limited periods, as is a mobile library. The village has some limited employment in car repairs and agricultural sales and repairs with other rural businesses in the surrounding area. A wider range of employment opportunities and services is only available in larger centres such as South Molton and Tiverton and Bampton within Mid Devon District.

12.544 South-west of East Anstey village, along the B3227 between South Molton and Bampton, is the former residential institution of Blackerton, which offered a range of supported living and employment facilities for those with learning difficulties. Following closure of the previous use, planning permission for housing has been secured on parts of the site.

12.545 The village has no designated conservation area and few listed buildings, although the Parish Church of St Michael is Grade II* listed. East Anstey has no public drainage facilities and any new development will need to make appropriate arrangements to deal with foul and surface water.

Spatial Strategy

12.546 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of East Anstey.

Policy EAN: East Anstey Spatial Strategy

(1) The locally developed vision for the community includes a number of elements:

- (a) to reduce the average age of the population by the provision of affordable housing for young people with connections to the parish;**
- (b) to provide small workshops for the development of local businesses;**
- (c) to retain the primary school and pre-school to serve the village;**
- (d) to retain a public house type facility; and**
- (e) to develop community opportunities.**

(2) The local community supports appropriate beneficial reuse of the Blackerton site.

(3) The spatial strategy for East Anstey will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 23 new dwellings, to meet a range of housing needs in the local community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning consents and one additional housing site in the village centre for approximately 3 dwellings;**

- (b) support for additional employment provision to meet locally generated requirements, including the provision of small workshops by conversion of suitable buildings;**
- (c) retention of the character of the village and its relationship with the surrounding countryside;**
- (d) safeguarding the dark night skies over Exmoor National Park;**
- (e) support for maintaining and developing village services and facilities, including additional social and recreation facilities; and**
- (f) delivery of superfast broadband connections.**

Development Proposals

12.547 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site-specific policies below.

12.548 In view of the dispersed nature of the village and parish, East Anstey has no defined development boundary. Proposals that are well related to the existing settlement of East Anstey and to the former Blackerton Care community, are appropriate to the scale of the locality will be considered against the general policies of the Local Plan including Policy DM23: Residential Development in defined Settlements without development boundaries.

Employment

12.549 Any new employment in the area is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals at East Anstey and Blackerton will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for East Anstey.

Housing

12.550 The spatial extent of the proposal is shown on Policies Map 44 and is subject to a site specific policy that sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles. At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively high level of housing commitments in East Anstey⁽⁹⁴⁾.

Policy EAN01 : Land at East Anstey

- (1) Land opposite the Froude Arms, as shown on Policies Map 44, is proposed for approximately 3 dwellings with an emphasis on providing small dwellings to reflect local needs.**
- (2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:**
 - (a) substantial planting on the western boundary to help integrate the site into its countryside setting; and**

94 22 dwellings from completions since 2011, under construction and extant planning permissions.

(b) adequate off road parking to serve the development.

12.551 This small level site has good road frontage and is well related to existing development in East Anstey. A development of smaller units will help deliver the spatial strategy for the village. It is anticipated that this site will be developed after recent commitments at the former residential centre at Blackerton, where planning permission was granted in early 2014 for 22 dwellings, including outline permission for 9 new affordable units.

Community Facilities

12.552 Retention of existing recreation and community facilities will be subject to the general policies of the Local Plan. Provision of appropriate additional facilities to meet locally generated needs, including for additional play and community facilities, will be supported in accordance with the spatial strategy and general Local Plan policies.

East Worlington

The Place

12.553 East Worlington, together with the smaller settlement of West Worlington, is located on the north side of the Little Dart River valley, about 15 kilometres (approximately 9.5 miles) south east of South Molton and about 4 kilometres (2.5 miles) west of Witheridge, on the eastern edge of the plan area.

12.554 There is limited employment in the area, other than that related to agriculture. Services in East Worlington are limited to a primary school and village hall. A wider range of services and facilities are available in Witheridge, South Molton or Chulmleigh but there are no public transport services through the village for easy access. East Worlington has no public drainage facilities and any new development will need to make appropriate arrangements to deal with disposal of foul and surface water.

12.555 The Little Dart River has an identified flood plain, as does the stream to the west of the village. Trixe's Wood and Pedley Wood to the south-east of the river are county wildlife sites. The village has a number of listed buildings, clustered around the Grade II listed St Mary's Church and East Worlington House, which is Grade II*. East Worlington does not have a designated conservation area.

Spatial Strategy

12.556 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of East Worlington and West Worlington.

Policy EWO: East Worlington Spatial Strategy

Local assessment, as summarised in the 2010 Parish Plan, is that East Worlington is a vibrant community content with what it has and the environment in which it lives and works and as such is not looking for major change.

Issues of concern include protection of the local environment, providing for community housing needs, addressing poor mobile phone and broadband coverage and resolving traffic and highway issues such as safety, maintenance and car parking in the village.

The spatial strategy will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 15 new dwellings to meet a range of housing needs in the local community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning consents and one additional housing site for approximately 5 dwellings;**
- (b) support for additional employment provision to meet locally generated requirements;**
- (c) retention of the character of the village, its relationship with the surrounding countryside and protection of the local environment;**
- (d) support for maintaining and developing village services and facilities;**
- (e) delivery of superfast broadband connections; and**
- (f) reviewing the need for additional car parking to serve the village.**

Development Proposals

12.557 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site-specific policies below.

12.558 East Worlington has no defined development boundary. Proposals that are well related to the existing settlement of East Worlington or West Worlington, are appropriate to the scale of the locality will be considered against the general policies of the Local Plan relating to development in villages including Policy DM23: Residential Development in defined settlements without Development Boundaries.

Employment

12.559 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for East Worlington.

Housing

12.560 The spatial extent of the proposal is shown on Policies Map 45 and is subject to one site-specific policy that sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles. At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively low level of housing commitments in East Worlington⁽⁹⁵⁾.

Policy EWO01: Land at Town Barton, East Worlington

(1) Land on the northern edge of East Worlington, as shown on Policies Map 45, is proposed for approximately 5 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) substantial planting on the northern and western boundaries to integrate the site into its landscape setting;**
- (b) a single vehicular access; and**
- (c) design and layout of development that reflects the character of the village.**

12.561 This small site on the northern edge of the village provides the opportunity for continued small-scale development to meet local community requirements. The site is part of a larger field and has no natural boundary to the north and west. Substantial planting will be required to provide an adequate boundary treatment to integrate the development into the surrounding landscape. The site is close to a number of listed buildings and a high standard of design will be required reflecting the village location. A single vehicular access will be required off the road through the village.

95 3 dwellings from completions, under construction and extant planning permissions since 2011

Community Facilities

12.562 Retention of the existing primary school and village hall is important and will be protected by the general policies of the Local Plan. Provision of other appropriate additional facilities to meet locally generated needs will be supported in accordance with the spatial strategy and general Local Plan policies.

12.563 Minor works to improve highway safety will be supported where they respect the character of the village. If a need for additional car parking facilities to meet community needs is confirmed, for example to serve the village hall or primary school, a suitable site will be supported.

Historic Environment

12.564 East Worlington does not have a designated Conservation Area. Should the local community identify the need for a future designation to protect the identified historic core of East or West Worlington during the plan period, then it would be supported.

Filleigh

The Place

12.565 Filleigh has a dispersed settlement pattern including several small groups of dwellings centred around the primary school and village hall, at Church Cross and at Stags Head. The village is approximately 5.5 kilometres (3.5 miles) west of South Molton. The village street originally formed part of the A361 route between South Molton and Barnstaple, which is now a Class C road having been replaced in 1989 by the North Devon Link Road that runs approximately 1.5 kilometres north of the village.

12.566 Filleigh and surrounding area is dominated by Castle Hill house, a Grade II* listed building and its extensive parkland, which is included on English Heritage's Register of Parks and Gardens of Special Historic Interest as Grade I listed. The whole of the village is located within this historic park and garden. The Parish Church of St Paul is also Grade II* listed, as are a number of structures around the Church, Castle Hill and buildings in the village. Much of the area north of the village is a county wildlife site.

Spatial Strategy

12.567 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Filleigh.

Policy FIL: Filleigh Spatial Strategy

The community has a comprehensive vision for the future of the village that is to provide a lively, vibrant community where housing, employment and recreation opportunities are provided and the environment is safeguarded. Specifically, the need is identified to provide housing, including affordable housing, small scale employment opportunities by the conversion of existing buildings or suitably sited new buildings and a new vehicular link to serve the Caberboard factory. The spatial strategy will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 12 new dwellings to meet a range of housing needs in the local community. This supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning permissions and one new housing site for approximately 10 dwellings adjacent to the village hall;
- (b) support for additional employment provision to meet locally generated requirements;
- (c) retention of the special character and form of the village and its relationship with the surrounding countryside;
- (d) protection of listed buildings and their setting, and the character and appearance of Castle Hill historic park and garden including vistas within it;
- (e) maintenance of existing and provision of new village services and facilities, including additional recreation facilities;
- (f) support for appropriate improved vehicular access to the Caberboard factory; and
- (g) delivery of superfast broadband connections.

Development Proposals

12.568 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site-specific policies below. Filleigh has no defined development boundary. Proposals that are well related to one of the groups of existing housing within Filleigh, are appropriate to the scale of the locality and address locally generated and quantified need, will be considered against the general policies of the plan including Policy DM23: Residential Development in defined Settlements without Development Boundaries.

Employment

12.569 Employment in the area is primarily in agriculture and related activities, with several farms within the village although Bray Leino contributes a significant part to the local economy. A number of small businesses are also located at North Aller and Stag's Head. The nearby Pathfields Business Park at South Molton provides a wider range of employment opportunities, together with the Caberboard timber products factory at Hill Village.

12.570 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Filleigh.

Housing

12.571 The spatial extent of the proposal is shown on Policies Map 46 and is subject to a site specific policy that sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles. At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively low level of housing commitments in Filleigh⁽⁹⁶⁾.

Policy FIL01: Land adjoining Filleigh Village Hall

(1) Land to the west of Filleigh Village Hall, as shown on Policies Map 46, is proposed for approximately 10 dwellings, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types, tenures and sizes to reflect local needs.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) a single access from the road through the village;**
- (b) design and layout that protects the setting of the listed buildings at Paynes Cottages and minimises the potential impact on development from use of the adjacent village hall; and**
- (c) substantial planting on the south and west boundaries to help integrate the site into its countryside setting.**

12.572 This site is well related to the village hall and primary school. The principle of residential development is supported as the site can meet the community's need for a variety of housing types and sizes. Development will be expected to achieve this objective.

96 1 dwelling has been built since 2011

12.573 Access is available from the main road. Paynes Cottages are adjoining listed buildings protected as a pair of thatched estate cottages. Design and layout of the new access and residential development should protect the setting of these listed buildings and the character of Castle Hill historic park, together with the amenities enjoyed by nearby dwellings. There is potential for conflicts between the use of the village hall and new housing due to noise and disturbance. Design and layout of the development will need to minimise any potential impacts.

12.574 The site has no natural boundary to the south and west, being part of a larger field. Substantial planting will be required to provide an adequate boundary treatment to integrate the development into the largely open landscape.

Community Facilities

12.575 The village has a limited range of services that includes a village hall, primary school, public house, vehicle repairs and a mobile shop. The general policies of the Local Plan seek to retain and protect such services and facilities and proposals that involve their loss will be considered against these policies. Provision of appropriate additional facilities to meet locally generated needs, for additional play and sporting facilities, will be supported in accordance with the spatial strategy and general Local Plan policies.

Highways

12.576 The local community has aspirations for improved access for goods vehicles to the Caberboard factory and transport depot complex at Hill Village to the south east of Filleigh. It is unlikely that funding would be available for such a proposal during the lifetime of the Local Plan and the level of new development likely to be required to provide such a link would not be appropriate in this location. However, should the Highway Authority propose such a route, it would be considered against Policy ST10: Transport Strategy and general Local Plan policies.

Goodleigh

The Place

12.577 Located approximately 5 kilometres (3 miles) north-east of Barnstaple, Goodleigh is a linear settlement built along the village street. The village is located on the hillside above the Coney Gut, a tributary of the river Taw with extensive views to the south.

12.578 Services in the village are limited to a primary school, village hall, public house, play area and sports pitch, relying on Barnstaple for a wider range of services and facilities. Barnstaple is also the principal location for employment, with few job opportunities in the village. There is a limited public transport service to and from Barnstaple.

12.579 A conservation area has been designated in the older part of the village, centred around the Church of St Gregory, a Grade II* listed building. There are a number of other listed buildings in the village centre. The stream to the south of the village has a flood zone identified by the Environment Agency. Coombe Farm, to the south of the village and Raleigh Wood / Coxleigh Wood and Snapper to the west are County Wildlife Sites.

Spatial Strategy

12.580 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Goodleigh.

Policy GDL: Goodleigh Spatial Strategy

The community reviewed the future of the village through the Rural Alliance Joint Parish Plan, which provides for continued access to local services and the protection of the character of the village. The community supports the provision of additional community facilities, indoor and outdoor recreation and affordable housing if required.

The spatial strategy will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 20 new dwellings to meet a range of housing needs in the local community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning permissions and two additional housing sites to the south of the village hall and at Northleigh totalling approximately 15 additional dwellings;
- (b) support for additional employment provision to meet locally generated requirements;
- (c) retention and enhancement of the character of the village and its relationship with the surrounding countryside;
- (d) support for maintaining and developing village services and facilities, including additional and replacement recreation facilities;
- (e) an increase in the capacity of the sewage treatment works; and
- (f) delivery of superfast broadband connections.

Development Proposals

12.581 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site-specific policies below. A development boundary for Goodleigh is defined on Policies Map 47.

Employment

12.582 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses and specific proposals will be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Goodleigh.

Housing

12.583 The spatial extent of the proposals is shown on Policies Map 47 and is subject to site-specific policies that set out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles.

12.584 At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively modest level of housing commitments in Goodleigh⁽⁹⁷⁾.

Policy GDL01: Land adjacent Village Hall, Coombe Cross

(1) Land adjacent the village hall at Coombe Cross, as shown on Policies Map 47, is proposed for development that includes:

- (a) approximately 10 dwellings, the size and tenure of which will be reflective of local needs;**
- (b) open space and recreation facilities; and**
- (c) a car park of approximately 20 spaces for community use.**

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) residential development on the northern part of the site outside of the identified flood zone;**
- (b) a single vehicular access from the road through the village;**
- (c) design and layout of development that reflects the character of the village;**
- (d) provision of additional car parking close to the village hall;**
- (e) provision of substantial landscaping on the southern edge of the residential development to integrate it into its countryside setting;**
- (f) provision of green infrastructure including public open space on the southern part of the site incorporating connections to the footpath on the western boundary towards Coombe Farm County Wildlife Site; and**

97 10 dwellings from completions, under construction and extant planning permissions since 2011 including approvals subject to completion of S106.

(g) adequate contribution toward addressing any deficiency in the capacity or performance of the sewage treatment works to enable the development to proceed.

12.585 The site slopes down to the south and east toward the stream. The site is well related to the village centre and will deliver a variety of house types and sizes to help meet the local housing need in Goodleigh, as well as a number of community facilities. Co-ordinated planning of the whole site is required to ensure siting and design of community facilities relate well with the residential development. No buildings will be permitted in the flood plain, although provision of green infrastructure would be acceptable there if the design and layout is safe and supported by a detailed flood risk assessment.

12.586 Planting between the proposed housing and the green infrastructure will integrate the site into its landscape setting and provide a transitional boundary between the development and the adjoining countryside. Enhanced landscaping will provide a visual and amenity buffer between the development and the adjoining sewage works to the east of the site. Detailed design, layout and landscaping should minimise the impact of development on properties in the immediate area. A satisfactory relationship between these properties and new housing is required in order to protect the amenities of both.

12.587 The area for green infrastructure could include a village green, sports pitches or allotments, which will be appropriately serviced and made available to the Parish Council or other appropriate body. The location of and access to the allotments, open space and recreation uses should be agreed in association with the design and layout of the dwellings and should be delivered at the same time as the construction of the dwellings. Green infrastructure provision should also incorporate adequate sustainable drainage measures in accordance with Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience, to prevent runoff exacerbating flood risks downstream along the Coney Gut.

12.588 Vehicular access should be from a single point off the main road through the village, designed to contribute towards highway improvements that reduce traffic speeds through this part of the village. The development will provide connections to the existing public rights of way network along the western boundary of the site through to Coombe Farm county wildlife site and providing links towards the strategic footpath and cycle network to the south of the village.

Policy GDL02: Land off Northleigh Hill

(1) Land off Northleigh Hill, as shown on Policies Map 47, is proposed for residential development of approximately 5 dwellings, to meet local needs.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

(a) design and layout that avoids any adverse impact on the amenities of nearby dwellings;

(b) re-location of the existing sports field;

(c) improvement of the existing access on to Northleigh Hill; and

(d) development not being commenced until an alternative playing field has been provided elsewhere in the village.

12.589 This flat, elevated site at the northern end of the village is currently used as a playing field. Loss of this facility will not be acceptable until alternative provision has been provided elsewhere in the village, possibly as part of the proposed green infrastructure on land south of the village hall (GDL01: Land adjacent Village Hall, Coombe Cross).

12.590 A single vehicular access to Northfield Hill is required, achieved by improvement of the current access. Access improvements to enhance visibility should avoid the loss of the mature tree at the site entrance and include appropriate planting to retain a rural appearance.

Community Uses

Policy GDL03: Land adjacent Goodleigh Primary School

Land west of the primary school, as shown on Policies Map 47, is proposed for community facilities in association with the existing primary school including the provision of small-scale residential development to facilitate its delivery.

12.591 Goodleigh Primary School serves the village and surrounding rural area. The school facilities are currently split across two sites off the main village street. The existing access route to the site adjacent to Coombe Close is a single narrow track with no pavements on either side of its entire length, making it potentially dangerous for pedestrians. The access route past St. Gregory's Church and two mobile classrooms of the primary school is again only a single track, which is further impacted upon by car parking along the highway.

12.592 Safe delivery of pupils and their collection from the school is difficult in view of this narrow road and constrained site boundaries. To help address the problems caused by existing school traffic in the area, Policy GDL03: Land adjacent Goodleigh Primary School proposes a vehicle drop off and pick up area that is suitably designed to minimise any impact on the setting of the conservation area. Policy GDL03 will allow limited small-scale residential development of approximately one or two dwellings located on the south-western part of the site to help facilitate the provision of this parking area, subject to an acceptable vehicular access being achieved.

Other Community Facilities

12.593 Local services and facilities within the village include a primary school, village hall, open spaces and a public house. Retention of existing recreation and community facilities will be subject to the general policies of the Local Plan. Provision of other appropriate additional facilities to meet locally generated needs will be supported in accordance with the spatial strategy and general Local Plan policies.

12.594 The proposed reinstatement of the Lynton-Barnstaple railway line (Policy BAR16: Lynton and Barnstaple Railway) passes to the west of the village. Business, tourism and leisure opportunities associated with the railway line will be supported where they contribute towards Goodleigh's spatial strategy.

Kentisbury and Kentisbury Ford

The Place

12.595 The parish of Kentisbury has a dispersed settlement pattern with several small settlements including Kentisbury Town, Kentisbury Ford and Patchole. Kentisbury is located on the southern fringes of Exmoor National Park to the north of the A39 between Barnstaple and Lynton and to the south of the A399 between Aller Cross and Combe Martin, both routes identified as 'Other Strategic Routes' in Figure 4.4. Kentisbury is about 15 kilometres (approximately 9.5 miles) north-east of Barnstaple and about 5.5 kilometres (3.5 miles) south of Combe Martin, on the northern edge of the Plan area.

12.596 The area around Kentisbury Down is within the boundary of Exmoor National Park (outside of the plan area) and part of the parish, north of the A399, is within the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty, Heritage Coast and Coast and Estuary Zone (Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy). The landscape character around Kentisbury includes downland and moorland-edge slopes across the foothills of Exmoor.

12.597 Services in Kentisbury are limited to a primary school, village hall, post office and petrol filling station. A wider range of services and facilities are available in Barnstaple, Ilfracombe or Combe Martin but there are limited public transport services through the village to facilitate easy access.

12.598 There is limited employment in the area, other than that related to agriculture and the local services, although part of the local economy is dedicated to tourism related industries including holiday accommodation at Kentisbury Grange Caravan Park. Also, Kentisbury has a modest level of second home ownership that adds to the overall level of tourism accommodation in the parish. Other employment opportunities are mostly in the main towns outside of the parish.

12.599 The small settlements within the parish have very few listed buildings. The Grade II* listed St Thomas' Church in Kentisbury Town is located within the boundary of Exmoor National Park. Kentisbury does not have a designated conservation area.

Spatial Strategy

12.600 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Kentisbury.

Policy KKF: Kentisbury / Kentisbury Ford Spatial Strategy

The local community has a vision for the community that seeks to maintain the area's character and appearance for the benefit of residents, while adopting a positive approach to development well related to the village that addresses local needs.

The surrounding high quality landscape along the approaches to Exmoor, the natural and built environment, local community and its facilities are particularly valued and should be protected. The spatial strategy will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 6 new dwellings to meet a range of housing needs in the local community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning permissions, with no new sites allocated for housing;**
- (b) support for additional employment provision to meet locally generated requirements;**

(c) retention and enhancement of the character of the villages, their relationship with the surrounding countryside and protection of the high quality local environment including the setting of listed buildings;

(d) delivery of superfast broadband connections;

(e) support for appropriate renewable energy schemes; and

(f) support for maintaining and developing village services and facilities.

Development Proposals

12.601 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways set out in the general policies of the Local Plan.

12.602 Kentisbury has no defined development boundary due partly to its dispersed settlement pattern. Proposals that are well related to the existing settlements of Kentisbury Town, Kentisbury Ford or Patchole, are appropriate to the scale and character of the locality will be considered against the general policies of the Local Plan relating to development in villages including Policy DM23: Residential Development in defined Settlements without Development Boundaries.

Employment

12.603 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is identified for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, in relation to general employment and Policies DM17: Tourism and Leisure Attractions and DM18: Tourism, in relation to tourism. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Kentisbury.

Housing

12.604 Opportunities for residential development in Kentisbury are limited. At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively modest level of housing commitments in Kentisbury parish⁽⁹⁸⁾. There are no sites allocated for housing development in the village as the Parish Council wish to consider all future housing proposals on their own merits. The requirement to provide additional housing to meet local needs and demands still remains, as does addressing aspirations for improvements to local services and facilities.

12.605 Residential development proposals which are appropriate in terms of scale, location and landscape impact, it will be considered for residential development in accordance with Policy DM23: Residential Development in defined Settlements without Development Boundaries, and other relevant policies of the Local Plan. Other opportunities to secure additional housing to meet local needs will continue to be explored.

Community Facilities

12.606 Retention of the existing primary school, post office and village hall is important and will be protected by the general policies of the Local Plan. Provision of appropriate additional facilities to meet locally generated needs will be supported in accordance with Kentisbury's spatial

98 12 dwellings from completions, under construction and extant planning permissions since 2011, including approvals subject to completion of S106.

strategy and general Local Plan policies. Additional open spaces and green infrastructure facilities will also be supported in the parish.

Other Issues

12.607 The establishment of appropriate small-scale renewable energy schemes will also be supported outside of Exmoor National Park where such development would not cause significant harm to the area's special landscape qualities including its tranquillity, dark night skies and the setting of the National Park, in accordance with Policy ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets.

King's Nympton

The Place

12.608 King's Nympton lies to the south of the plan area approximately 9 kilometres (6 miles) north of Chulmleigh and 8 kilometres (5 miles) south of South Molton. The village sits on an elevated location along the eastern valley of the River Mole within an area of gently rolling surrounding countryside.

12.609 The village has a relatively compact settlement pattern which has largely retained its traditional form and historic character. A conservation area covers the majority of the village except the more modern developments to the south. The area includes a number of listed buildings including the Grade I listed St James' Church. Approximately 1 kilometre (0.6 miles) west of the village is King's Nympton Park, a Grade II listed historic park and garden as shown on Policies Map 49. There are a number of County Wildlife Sites in the vicinity of the village, including Park Wood and Park Fields within the historic garden of King's Nympton Park.

12.610 Local services and facilities in the village include a village hall, church, primary school, equipped play area, sports pitch and public house. Employment locally is primarily in services and agricultural related activities, with a number of local residents being self-employed. A range of employment opportunities is available in South Molton, including at Pathfields Business Park.

Spatial Strategy

12.611 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of King's Nympton.

Policy KGN: King's Nympton Spatial Strategy

The local community has a vision for the parish to ensure the tranquillity and beauty of the countryside around the village is preserved whilst facilitating some additional housing and employment, particularly for young people in order to maintain a spread of age groups in the area, and to preserve and enhance the existing community spirit. The spatial strategy will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 20 new dwellings to meet the range of needs in the community including for elderly residents. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning permissions, with no new sites allocated for housing but one non-strategic housing site;
- (b) support for additional employment provision to meet locally generated requirements;
- (c) improved broadband coverage;
- (d) retention of the character and setting of the village, King's Nympton Park and its relationship with the countryside; and
- (e) retention and improvement of recreation and community facilities to meet a local need, including allotments and a village car park.

Development Proposals

12.612 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site-specific policies below. A development boundary for King's Nympton is defined on Policies Map 49, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.613 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development in Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses and new proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for King's Nympton.

Housing

12.614 The majority of the future housing growth for King's Nympton will be delivered through the extant planning permission at Steeple Meadow, on the eastern edge of the village. Land at Skibbows is identified as a non-strategic housing site for approximately 12 dwellings (see Appendix 5). At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively high level of housing commitments in King's Nympton⁽⁹⁹⁾. No additional sites are proposed for housing development but some opportunities for infill may be available within the development boundary.

12.615 Where suitable land is available for development that is appropriate in terms of its scale and location, it will be considered for development in accordance with the requirements of Policy ST07: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Rural Area and other relevant policies. Development that adversely impacts on the historic character and appearance of the village, King's Nympton Park or conservation area will not be supported.

Community Facilities

12.616 Retention of existing recreation and community facilities will be subject to the general policies of the Local Plan. Provision of appropriate additional facilities to meet locally generated needs, including a site for allotments and a village car park will be supported in accordance with the spatial strategy and general Local Plan policies.

99 14 dwellings from completions since 2011, under construction and extant planning permissions

Knowle

The Place

12.617 Knowle is located on either side of the A361 Ilfracombe to Barnstaple road, a route identified as an 'Other Strategic Route' in Figure 4.4. The village is approximately 1.8 kilometres (1 mile) north of Braunton and approximately 11.5 kilometres (7 miles) south of Ilfracombe. Facilities in the village include a petrol filling station with shop and post office, car repairs and a public house. The village is well served by a regular public transport route between Barnstaple and Ilfracombe.

12.618 The village has a relatively compact settlement pattern with very few remnants remaining of the historic core. Therefore, Knowle does not have a conservation area. The Castle Fort to the south west of the village is a Scheduled Ancient Monument.

12.619 The village is situated in the valley of the River Caen, which flows southwards towards Braunton and creates significant flood risk within the village, particularly on those areas to the west of the A361 and either side of the tributary that runs through the village from the north east. The western side of the valley is densely wooded with rising downland on either side of Knowle. The hills and woodland to the west of the village are situated in the Coast and Estuary Zone where Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy would apply. Although the countryside is not within any formal landscape designation, the surrounding countryside is still attractive within the 'Secluded Valleys' landscape character type. The woodland and hedgerows along the valley of the River Caen also provide an important network of habitats for movement and feeding of protected species in accordance with Policy ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets.

12.620 There are limited employment opportunities within the village, although the garage and Knowle Industrial Estate are important to the local economy and will be safeguarded for employment purposes in accordance with Policy DM13: Safeguarding Employment Land. Other employment opportunities are mostly outside of the village.

Spatial Strategy

12.621 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Knowle.

Policy KNW: Knowle Spatial Strategy

The local community has a vision for the village that seeks to maintain its character and appearance for the benefit of residents, while adopting a positive approach to beneficial development well related to the village that addresses local needs. The surrounding landscape and local facilities are particularly valued and should be protected. The spatial strategy will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 26 dwellings to meet the range of needs in the local community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning permissions and a single site allocation for approximately 20 dwellings on the former landfill site near Chalwells;**
- (b) protection of the character of the village and its relationship with the surrounding countryside;**
- (c) protection of local facilities within the village to meet locally generated needs;**

(d) extension of the Tarka Trail along the former railway line between Knowle and Willingcott; and

(e) support for superfast broadband connections.

Development Proposals

12.622 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site-specific policies below. A development boundary for Knowle is defined on Policies Map 50, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.623 Knowle Industrial Estate is located on the north-western edge of the village, adjacent to the River Caen and in close proximity to existing residential properties. Vehicular access to the site is from two accesses off the A361. No specific site is allocated for economic development in the village although Knowle Industrial Estate could provide the opportunity for additional employment uses in accordance with Policy DM12: Employment Development in Towns, Local Centres and Villages of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses, consideration of alternative uses and specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Knowle.

Housing

12.624 The spatial extent of the proposal is shown on Policies Map 50 and is subject to site-specific policies that set out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles. At 31st March 2017, there was a relatively low level of housing commitments in Knowle⁽¹⁰⁰⁾.

Policy KNW01 : Land South of Chalwells

(1) Site south of Chalwells, as shown on Policies Map 50, is proposed for residential development that includes approximately 20 dwellings, including affordable homes, with an emphasis on providing a mix of house types and sizes to reflect local need.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) no buildings to be located within an identified flood zone;**
- (b) vehicular access from the junction with the A361;**
- (c) retention and enhancement of existing tree and hedge planting particularly along the southern boundary adjacent to Knowle Industrial Estate;**
- (d) design, layout and additional planting that minimises the impact of development on surrounding residential properties;**
- (e) contributions towards completion of the gap in the Tarka Trail and strategic cycle network; and**

100 7 dwellings from completions, under construction and extant planning permissions since 2011

(f) provision of a footpath and cycleway links to the public right of way along the southern boundary to link to the route of the former railway line between Willingcott and Knowle.

12.625 This previously developed site is relatively well related to the existing settlement that can be developed without undue harm to the landscape setting of the village with a suitable design and landscaping scheme. The site is adjacent to the defined coast and estuary zone. Development will provide a range of dwellings of sizes and types that address local community needs.

12.626 The site will provide the majority of new dwellings required in the village over the plan period and should be developed in such a way as to provide a phased supply to meet local needs. This could require a flexible approach to development or review of detailed proposals as community needs are identified.

12.627 The site is relatively flat, due in part to the land being used previously as a landfill site for inert materials and recycling of stone, concrete and brick. Any residual contamination on site will need to be re-mediated in accordance with Policy DM02: Environmental Protection. No dwellings will be permitted on land liable to flood risk. A detailed flood risk assessment will be required to demonstrate that existing flooding problems will not be exacerbated locally or elsewhere downstream.

12.628 Vehicular access should be from a single point off the main road (A361) through upgrading the existing junction. The development will need to contribute toward highway improvements to reduce traffic speeds between the village and Chalwells. A separate pedestrian access will also be provided off the existing public right of way along the southern boundary to serve the development, which should also deliver improved pedestrian/cycle links to the former railway line between Willingcott and Knowle where the gap in the Tarka Trail and strategic cycle network is to be completed (Policy ST10: Transport Strategy).

12.629 The site has well established tree and hedge planting along existing boundaries. Vegetation alongside the River Caen contributes to an important network of habitats that should be conserved and enhanced for protected species. The southern boundary adjacent to the industrial estate may require enhancement to minimise the impact of the existing uses on the development. A satisfactory relationship between the industrial estate and new housing is required in order to protect the amenities of both.

Community Facilities

12.630 The general policies of the Local Plan seek to retain and protect such services and facilities, and proposals that involve their loss will be considered against these policies. Provision of appropriate additional facilities to meet locally generated needs, including the re-instatement of the former railway line to extend the Tarka Trail, will be supported in accordance with the Knowle spatial strategy and the general policies of the Local Plan.

Landkey

The Place

12.631 Landkey is a large village located to the south of the North Devon Link Road (A361), identified as part of the 'Strategic Road Network' in Figure 4.3. The village is approximately 5 kilometres (3 miles) south-east of Barnstaple and has a broadly linear settlement pattern on either side of the old main road between Barnstaple and South Molton, now a Class C road. The village is situated on the northern side of Venn Stream and either side of Hartford and Yarnacott streams that flow through the village, together creating significant flood risks within parts of the village.

12.632 The settlement of Landkey consists of Landkey Town to the west, Landkey Newland and Swimbridge Newland in the east. Over recent decades, Landkey has experienced relatively substantial modern housing growth to the north and south of the main road through the village, due in part to proximity to and accessibility of the services and facilities within Barnstaple.

12.633 The village is well served with local services and facilities; it has a shop, post office, primary school and pre-school, public house, village hall and a number of areas of open space, including the Millennium Green to the north. Employment opportunities within the village are based mainly around the local services and facilities. The nearest major employment opportunities are located at Barnstaple and at Pathfields in South Molton.

12.634 Landkey Town to the west retains much of its historic pattern and character and is centred around St Paul's Church, a Grade I listed building with a conservation area covering this part of the village. An extensive Conservation Area around a second historic core covers Landkey Newland, including a number of listed buildings. This conservation area also extends to include Newland House and surrounding fields on the extreme eastern edge of the village, an impressive Victorian Villa with well preserved ancillary outbuildings.

12.635 The village is not within any formal landscape designation, although the setting within the valley of the Venn Stream and surrounding countryside is considered attractive. The Macmillan Way West follows a route south of Barnstaple through Bishop's Tawton to Landkey and onwards toward Exmoor National Park.

Spatial Strategy

12.636 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Landkey.

Policy LAN: Landkey Spatial Strategy

The vision of the local community for the future development of the village is that it retains a green buffer between the village and the settlements of Swimbridge and Barnstaple to recognise its position as a village with its farming heritage whilst embracing the challenges and opportunities to support its growth close to Barnstaple.

The village will grow at a sustainable rate that will maintain the already outstanding village school, protects its local services and maintain the special character and qualities of its conservation area and heritage. The spatial strategy will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 87 new dwellings to meet a range of housing needs in the local community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning permissions and one site allocation totalling approximately 50 new dwellings on land to the south of Birch Road;**

- (b) retention of a green buffer between Landkey and Swimbridge and protection of the open land between Landkey and the proposed development north of the A361 (Policy BAR01) to help maintain their separate identities;
- (c) support for maintaining and developing village services and facilities including play and sporting facilities and provision of a new community centre;
- (d) support for improved public transport connections serving the village;
- (e) retention and enhancement of the historic character and appearance of the village and its relationship with the countryside and open spaces; and
- (f) delivery of superfast broadband connections.

Development Proposals

12.637 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site-specific policies below. A development boundary for Landkey is defined on Policies Map 51, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.638 Any additional employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals for new development and the expansion of existing businesses will be considered in accordance with Policy DM12: Employment Development in Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Landkey.

Housing

12.639 The spatial extent of the proposals is shown on Policies Map 51 and is subject to a site-specific policy that sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles.

12.640 At 31st March 2017, there was a relatively high level of housing commitments in Landkey⁽¹⁰¹⁾.

Policy LAN01 : Land South of Birch Road

(1) Land south of Birch Road, as shown on Policies Map 51, is proposed for approximately 50 dwellings, including affordable housing, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types, tenures and sizes to reflect local needs.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) vehicular access on to Birch Road;
- (b) retention and enhancement of existing boundary hedges including replacement of any road frontage hedge lost to secure an acceptable access;

101 121 dwellings from completions, under construction and extant planning permissions since 2011

(c) protection of the amenities of adjoining dwellings; and

(d) design, layout and landscaping that respects the location of the site and enhances the character of the village.

12.641 The site is well related to the existing settlement along the northern edge of the village in an area of land bounded by Birch Road to the north and Blakes Hill Road to the west. The site is situated to the south of a ridge that runs west to east. The village is not prominent from the A361 (North Devon Link Road) although the land is more prominent as you approach the village from higher land north of the A361. The potential visual impact should be reduced with enhanced structural landscaping along the northern and western site boundaries.

12.642 The eastern part of the site has been developed and provides 26 dwellings. The remaining two fields to the west will deliver approximately 25 additional dwellings. Development will provide a range of housing types and sizes that address local community needs. A satisfactory relationship is required between the adjoining residential properties and new housing in order to protect the amenities of both. The design and layout of new housing will retain and enhance the character and appearance of the village, in accordance with the Landkey/Swimbridge Newland village design statement.

12.643 The site slopes gently towards existing housing along the southern boundary. The development must be integrated into its landscape setting and provide a transitional boundary between the development and the adjoining countryside.

12.644 A new vehicular access to the western part of the site allocation should be from a single point off Birch Road with replacement of existing hedgerows along the new site frontage to maintain the rural character of the road, the village's landscape setting and to ensure the network of habitats for movement and feeding of protected species is retained. A separate pedestrian access will also be provided to Denes Road along the southern boundary to serve the development and provide pedestrian access into the village.

12.645 The site is adjacent to a critical drainage area where it has been identified that land to the north of the ridge is at risk of flooding. Development will be required to provide a sustainable water strategy that reduces water usage, manages surface water run-off through water storage and sustainable drainage systems that reduces the rate of surface water run-off entering the Coney Gut thus reducing the potential flood risk in southern parts of Barnstaple in accordance with Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience.

Community Facilities

12.646 Landkey has a wide range of local community facilities. Retention of existing recreation and community facilities will be subject to the general policies of the Local Plan. Provision of appropriate additional facilities to meet locally generated needs will be supported in accordance with the spatial strategy and general Local Plan policies. The Millennium Green is identified as a hub site. Additional green infrastructure, play areas and sporting facilities will be supported on or adjoining the Millennium Green.

12.647 The local community has identified the need for a new community centre to replace the existing halls and a site adjoining the football club is preferred. The Council will support improvements in public transport facilities to meet local requirements.

Other Issues

12.648 Venn Quarry, to the west of the village, is a large previously developed site within Bishop's Tawton parish that can be accessed from Landkey along the Macmillan Way. Consideration for economic development or tourism related industries for re-use of the former Venn Quarry is outlined within the Bishop's Tawton chapter of the Local Plan.

12.649 Land between Landkey and the proposed Westacott strategic extension on the eastern edge of Barnstaple is identified as a green wedge (Policy BAR22: Green Wedges) to prevent coalescence of these settlements, retain open land between them and help to maintain their separate identities. The local greenspace at Portmore Golf Course (Policy BAR19: Local Green Spaces) will complement this green wedge between Barnstaple and Landkey.

Langtree and Stibb Cross

The Place

12.650 Langtree stands on a ridge and is located 13 km (8 miles) south of Bideford and 5.6 km (3.5 miles) south west of Torrington on the B3227, in the western side of the plan area. The built form of the village is more consolidated on the eastern side in the Church Lane/Fore Street areas, with a linear configuration running out to the west associated with the main road.

12.651 The village has a small range of facilities that include a community/primary school, parish hall, public house, two places of worship and outdoor recreation area.

12.652 Stibb Cross is closely related to Langtree, in terms of shared services and facilities and lies just over a mile to the east of the village. The settlement is based upon the crossroads of the A388 and B3227 in a fairly concentrated form. It does support some locally significant employment land on the eastern and southern sides of the village; together with a car repairs garage and public house.

12.653 A public transport service links the villages with Torrington, Bideford and Barnstaple. Local employment is largely small scale and mainly related to services and land-based in the surrounding catchment area. The villages fall outside any designated landscape area and there is no conservation area covering the settlements.

Spatial Strategy

12.654 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Langtree and Stibb Cross.

Policy LAG: Langtree/Stibb Cross Spatial Strategy

The community's vision for the villages is that it seeks to maintain a range of facilities and services required by local people, including a thriving community/primary school, active parish hall and suitable accommodation for all sectors with a particular emphasis on young families.

The vision will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 31 dwellings to meet the range of housing needs in the local communities. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning consents and two site allocations with a capacity for approximately 18 dwellings;**
- (b) two additional housing sites within the development boundaries;**
- (c) seeking to retain existing services and facilities in Langtree and Stibb Cross;**
- (d) provision of additional sports and recreation facilities;**
- (e) improving footpath/pedestrian links to main village services; and**
- (f) retention of the character of the village and its relationship with the countryside.**

Development Proposals

12.655 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site specific policies below.

12.656 Development boundaries for Langtree and Stibb Cross are defined on Policies Maps 52 and 53, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.657 Any new employment in the villages is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Plan and the spatial strategy for Langtree and Stibb Cross.

Housing

12.658 Additional housing is proposed to meet the needs and demands of Langtree and Stibb Cross over the Plan period. At 31st March 2017, there was a relatively modest level of housing commitments in the village ⁽¹⁰²⁾. Land adjoining the parish hall has been approved for housing development which will provide a mix of affordable and open market houses and associated community facilities. These comprise a recreation field with football pitch on land to the rear of the hall and a changing room. The land is not shown within the development boundary on the basis that it is recognised as a housing exception site.

Policy LAG01: Land West of The Crescent

(1) Land west of The Crescent, as shown on Policies Map 52, is proposed for residential development that includes approximately 10 dwellings, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) provide vehicular access from Fore Street;**
- (b) retention of existing mature trees and hedgerows on perimeter boundaries and provision of additional planting to provide a landscaped development;**
- (c) provide open space for allotments within the layout; and**
- (d) a design that respects the location of the site bounded by existing dwellings and countryside to the south.**

12.659 A vacant greenfield site to the south of Fore Street is proposed for development. The land falls moderately to the south, beyond which lies open countryside and existing residential properties border immediately to the west and east. Hedgerows surround the majority of the site and are worthy of retention.

102 18 dwellings from completions, sites under construction and subject to extant planning permission since 2011

12.660 The site can provide a range of dwellings to meet local needs and help support local services. It has a frontage with Fore Street that runs east to west through the village. Highway access will be accommodated from here and some widening of the junction may be required.

12.661 A number of established properties border the site. Detailed design, layout and landscaping should minimise the impact of development on properties in the immediate area. A satisfactory relationship between these properties and new housing is required to protect the amenities of both.

12.662 In addition to helping to meet local housing need, the site will also deliver the following community aspiration. A small area of open space will be set aside for allotments of approximately 0.1 hectare which is conveniently located to serve the village. Final specifications for the open space will be informed by Parish Council guidance.

Policy LAG02: Land at the Former Cattle Market and Land to North

(1) Land at the former cattle market and north of, as shown on Policies Map 53, is allocated for residential development that includes:

- (a) approximately 8 dwellings with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need; and**
- (b) recreation open space to serve the village.**

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) provide vehicular access from the highway on land to north of former cattle market;**
- (b) retain, as far as possible, existing trees and hedges on the site; and**
- (c) layout and design that reflects the proximity of existing dwellings.**

12.663 A site based upon the former cattle market on the western side of the village is allocated for housing with associated open space for recreational purposes on land to the rear. The site contains an area of underused previously developed land which backs northwards onto agricultural land bounded by hedge banks on three sides. It can accommodate a range of dwellings to meet local needs and is well related to the highway network and village facilities, with appropriate landscaping, the development will not harm the landscape setting of the village.

12.664 Access to the site will be from the adjoining highway frontage, set away from the existing crossroads, that will also serve the new recreation field behind the residential properties. A pedestrian footway adjoins the highway to the south of the site and appropriate footways can be provided to afford a safe route from the development towards the centre of Stibb Cross.

12.665 The western boundary of the site borders open countryside and a tree and hedge screen will be required to reduce the impact of the development on the countryside setting of the village. Trees and hedges bordering the site should be retained in any proposed use. A tree subject to a Tree Preservation Order lies close to the southern boundary of the site and should not be adversely affected by the development.

12.666 Design should also have satisfactory regard to the impact from existing residential properties to the south and east of the allocation area.

Recreation

12.667 A continuing need to enhance outdoor recreation facilities in Langtree has been identified. Land to the east of Latch Lane is proposed to help address this need.

Policy LAG03: Land at Langtree Park

(1) Langtree Park, as shown on Policies Map 52, is reserved for recreation use and will provide:

- (a) safe pedestrian access from the primary school and Latch Lane; and**
- (b) new children's play facilities.**

12.668 This land of approximately 0.4 hectares will help to augment outdoor recreation facilities in the village, in addition to a proposed recreation field to the rear of the parish hall and be sufficient to provide for the needs of the village over the Plan period.

12.669 Planning permission has been gained to construct a footpath along the eastern and northern boundary of the park, between the primary school and Latch Lane. Any future residential development proposals on the northern side of Fore Street will be expected to contribute towards improvements to equipment facilities on the site.

Lower Lovacott and Newton Tracey

The Place

12.670 Lower Lovacott and Newton Tracey are settlements situated approximately 1 kilometre apart and located approximately 7 kilometres (4.5 miles) south west of Barnstaple. Newton Tracey is on rising ground astride the B3232 Barnstaple to Great Torrington road with views to the south. Lower Lovacott is situated on the top of a ridge to the south of Barnstaple, with Newton Tracey on the valley of the Langham stream feeding into the River Taw.

12.671 The two settlements function as a single community with shared services, including a primary school, village hall and parish field located at Lower Lovacott and a public house at Newton Tracey. A public footpath between Lower Lovacott and Newton Tracey facilitates access to these community facilities. There is also a car repair business at Lower Lovacott, but otherwise the community relies largely upon services at Barnstaple to which there is a frequent bus service.

12.672 There is little employment in the settlements other than the identified service activities. A wide range of employment opportunities are available in Barnstaple with good accessibility to Roundswell Business Park, with a more limited range of opportunities in Great Torrington.

12.673 There are a number of listed buildings and other structures in both settlements, the majority at Newton Tracey where the Church of St Thomas of Canterbury is Grade II* listed. Neither settlement has a conservation area and there are no sites designated in the vicinity for their nature conservation interest or landscape value.

12.674 Lower Lovacott has a very small sewage treatment works, the capacity of which is taken up by existing commitments. Newton Tracey does not have any public drainage. Any new additional development will need to ensure the provision of appropriate facilities.

Spatial Strategy

12.675 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Lower Lovacott and Newton Tracey.

Policy HLN: Lower Lovacott / Newton Tracey Spatial Strategy

Following consultation and discussion, the local community is satisfied with the existing facilities in and limited future development around the village. Meeting any confirmed additional affordable housing requirements in Newton Tracey rather than Lower Lovacott is preferred in view of the level of existing commitment in the latter.

The spatial strategy will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 14 new dwellings to meet a range of housing needs in the local community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning consents and one additional housing site in Lower Lovacott for approximately 6 dwellings. Additional opportunities may be available within the development boundaries;
- (b) support for additional employment provision to meet locally generated requirements;
- (c) retention of the character of the villages, their relationship with the surrounding countryside and protection of the local environment;
- (d) delivery of superfast broadband connections; and

(e) support for maintaining and developing village services and facilities.

Development Proposals

12.676 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways. Development boundaries for Lower Lovacott and Newton Tracey are defined on Policies Maps 54 and 55, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.677 Any new employment in the villages is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Lower Lovacott and Newton Tracey.

Housing

12.678 One site for residential development is identified in Lower Lovacott. The spatial extent of the proposal is shown on Policies Map 54 and is subject to a site-specific policy that sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles. At 31st March 2017, there was a relatively modest level of housing commitments in Lower Lovacott/Newton Tracey⁽¹⁰³⁾.

Policy HLN01 : Land South of Orchard Cottages, Lower Lovacott

(1) Land south of Orchard Cottages, Lower Lovacott, as shown on Policies Map 54, is proposed for approximately 6 dwellings, with an emphasis on providing small dwellings to reflect local needs.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) a single vehicular access through the existing road between Orchard Cottages;**
- (b) retention and enhancement of existing boundary trees and hedges;**
- (c) adequate off road parking to serve the development; and**
- (d) adequate contribution towards addressing deficiency in the capacity or performance of the sewage treatment works to enable the development to proceed.**

12.679 Development of this site is phase II of a comprehensive redevelopment of Orchard Cottages in Lower Lovacott. Design of this small development will have regard to the amenities of adjoining properties and the impact of nearby uses on future residents. Development will retain existing trees and enhance existing hedgerows, particularly along the southern and eastern boundaries. Vehicular access to the development should be provided from the north along the

¹⁰³ 14 dwellings from completions, under construction and extant planning permissions since 2011, including approvals subject to completion of S106

new road through Orchard Cottages. Any deficiency in the capacity or performance of the sewage treatment works will need to be identified and resolved as part of the development.

Community Facilities

12.680 Retention of the existing community facilities, including the primary school, parish field and village hall, is important and will be protected by the general policies of the Local Plan. Provision of other appropriate additional facilities to meet locally generated needs will be supported in accordance with the spatial strategy and general Local Plan policies. Additional open spaces will also be supported in the parish.

Merton

The Place

12.681 Merton is on the A386, midway between Bideford and Okehampton, on the southern edge of the plan area. The village has a good range of services including pub, shop and post office, modern community hall and sports pitch, garage/petrol station and primary school.

12.682 Employment is principally in agricultural related activities, village services and locally based trades, together with the nearby timber merchants. Much of the village, which is linear in form with extensive countryside views, is included within a conservation area, the focus of which is The Square and Grade II* Church of All Saints.

Spatial Strategy

12.683 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Merton.

Policy MER: Merton Spatial Strategy

The community has a clear vision for the village to become an economically sustainable community able to support itself in many ways, with additional employment and a mix of population by age, creating a unique community with a strong sense of self and identity within the rural landscape. The community recognises the need for substantial new development to achieve this vision including accommodation for all sectors of the community.

The vision will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 89 new dwellings to meet a range of housing needs in the community including for elderly persons. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning consents and three site allocations with a capacity for approximately 80 dwellings;**
- (b) three additional housing sites within the development boundary;**
- (c) additional employment provision to meet local requirements, including appropriately controlled live-work units;**
- (d) retaining the character of the village, its relationship with the countryside and its open spaces;**
- (e) increase opportunities for recreation and tourism locally; and,**
- (f) improve broadband and mobile phone coverage.**

The Development Proposals

12.684 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. To enable Merton to realise its ambitions, this role will be supported in a range of ways including the site specific policies below.

12.685 A development boundary for Merton is defined on Policies Map 56 outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

12.686 The Merton sewage treatment works has very limited capacity. Prior to planning applications for any of the sites below being supported an evaluation of the sewage treatment works and options for its enhancement and expansion will be required.

Employment

12.687 Additional economic development in the village will be to meet local needs and is likely to be small scale. Provision for additional land for economic development in Merton is made in Policy MER03: Land at Back Lane, in conjunction with additional housing.

Housing

12.688 Additional housing is proposed to meet the needs and demands of Merton and the community's growth aspirations over the Plan period. At 31st March 2017, there was a relatively high level housing commitment within the village⁽¹⁰⁴⁾.

12.689 The development boundary includes sites with planning permission and new allocations for housing to meet the spatial strategy for Merton over the plan period.

12.690 The sites identified are considered to be deliverable. They will be released to ensure a steady and continuing pace of development over the plan period and in accordance with the spatial strategy, allowing the community and services to adapt to growth. The order of presentation does not reflect any priority for release of the sites.

12.691 Adequate sewage treatment facilities will be needed to serve all sites.

Policy MER01: Land to the South of the Primary School

(1) Land south of the primary school, as shown on Policies Map 56, is allocated for residential development that includes approximately 20 dwellings, including affordable homes, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

(a) improvements to allow vehicular access along the minor road to the west of the site; and

(b) substantial landscaping on the southern and eastern boundaries to integrate the new development into the landscape.

12.692 The site to the south of the primary school is well related to the village facilities but has no clear boundary features on the south and eastern edges.

12.693 This site of approximately 0.9 hectares will make a contribution to enabling continued growth in the village over the plan period without harming the setting of the village.

12.694 The minor road giving access to the site requires improvement for the level of traffic likely to be generated. As a minimum this should include the provision of 2 suitable passing bays and resurfacing to a standard suitable for adoption by the highway authority.

¹⁰⁴ 50 dwellings from sites completed, under construction and with extant planning permission since 2011, including 33 dwellings on MER03: Land at Back Lane

12.695 Landscaping on the southern and eastern boundaries should be adequate to integrate the site into the landscape and provide biodiversity links with existing hedges and woodland.

12.696 A contribution to meeting the accommodation needs of the community's ageing population should be delivered on this site. The form of development will be determined by a demonstration of local need.

Policy MER02: Site at Limers Lane

(1) Land east of Limers Lane, as shown on Policies Map 56, is allocated for residential development that includes approximately 25 dwellings, including affordable homes, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

(a) retention of existing boundary hedges and provision of additional landscaping on northern and western boundaries;

(b) design and layout that provides acceptable impact on existing adjoining properties, including the adjacent and nearby listed buildings and reflects the location of the site in the conservation area; and

(c) provision for pedestrian and cycle access, and emergency vehicular access, to Back Lane.

12.697 A site bounded by Limers Lane and Back Lane in the centre of the village, with an access to the A386, is allocated for residential use.

12.698 The site to the rear of the Malt Scoop Inn, which extends to approximately 0.9 hectares, is within the conservation area and the design and layout of development will reflect the character of the village and provide a mix of dwelling type and size. The Malt Scoop Inn listed building is to the south of the site while a listed residential property is located at the eastern end.

12.699 Vehicular access will be from the A386 designed to minimise the visual impact within the conservation area. Pedestrian and cycle access and an emergency vehicular access, will be provided to Back Lane to link with the site of Policy MER03: Land at Back Lane to the north. Emergency vehicular access will be in the form of a single carriageway with removable bollards.

Policy MER03: Land at Back Lane

(1) Land north of Back Lane, as shown on Policies Map 56, is allocated for residential development that includes:

(a) approximately 35 dwellings, including affordable homes, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need;

(b) an area of approximately 0.5 hectare for economic development to provide for appropriate local business needs; and

(c) an area for use as allotments of approximately 0.2 hectares.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) principal vehicular access from Back Lane;**
- (b) pedestrian and cycle access and an emergency vehicular access, from the site of Policy MER02;**
- (c) the area for economic development to meet local needs to be located at the eastern end of the site;**
- (d) design and layout of all uses that provides acceptable impact on existing and proposed adjacent dwellings and reflects the location of the site adjoining the conservation area; and**
- (e) provision of a substantial tree and hedge screen on the northern boundary.**

12.700 A site on the northern edge of the village is allocated for mixed uses including housing and employment to help realise the spatial vision for Merton.

12.701 The substantial site of approximately 1.9 hectares is open and slopes gently toward the village. Development of the site, or of the economic or housing sections, in a single phase will not be appropriate.

12.702 Substantial planting is required on the currently undefined northern boundary to provide a screen to development and enhanced biodiversity. The landscaped area will be continued into the development to subdivide different uses and areas of housing.

12.703 The principal vehicular access will be from the A386 via an improved Back Lane. Provision will be made from the western part of the site for pedestrian and cycle access, and an emergency vehicular access, to the site of Policy MER02: Site at Limers Lane to the south. Emergency vehicular access will be in the form of a single carriageway with removable bollards. A through route between the site of MER02: Site at Limers Lane and the improved access to the A386 will not be provided.

12.704 Acceptable economic development uses will provide for local business needs and may include small units and a limited number of suitably designed and controlled live-work units to meet an identified local demand. Live-work units should be located together, be controlled by appropriate agreement to ensure they remain in mixed residential/employment use and provide identified business use on at least 25% of the floorspace (excluding parking areas).

12.705 Development of the employment area for use by a single occupier, for extensive low employment activities or for B8 Uses (Storage or Distribution) is not likely to be acceptable. Access and services to the edge of the employment area will be delivered by the residential development, unless required earlier.

12.706 Convenient access is required to the allotment area that should be serviced and provided to the Parish Council at an agreed stage in the development of the site, which should be no later than completion of 50% of the site area set aside for housing.

Other Issues

12.707 Retention of existing recreation facilities and village services will be subject to the general policies of the Local Plan. Provision of appropriate additional facilities to meet locally generated needs will be supported in accordance with the spatial strategy and general Local Plan policies.

Milton Damerel and Venn Green

The Place

12.708 Milton Town and Venn Green are located within Milton Damerel Parish which is about 8 km (5 miles) north east of Holsworthy on the A388, in the south western part of the plan area. Milton Town is located to the centre of the parish, north of the River Waldon and concentrated around Holy Trinity Church in a small cluster of houses and redundant farm buildings. The rural settlement contains only two places of worship, the Methodist Church has ancillary rooms for community purposes with no other existing facilities.

12.709 Venn Green lies a mile north west of Milton Town on a cross roads of the A388 taking a linear form that radiates outwards. The settlement has no real services, other than a farm shop located just outside the development boundary which acts as a convenience store with one other for the wider parish. Milton Damerel also contains a number of hamlets including part of Holsworthy Beacon and Strawberry Bank which contribute to the dispersed rural character of the locality.

12.710 A public transport service links the villages to Bideford, Barnstaple, Holsworthy and Torrington. There are no significant commercial operations in the settlements and local employment is generally small scale, mainly related to supplies and services and land-based in the surrounding catchment area.

12.711 The settlements fall outside any designated landscaped area and there is no conservation area for either. The parish also has no recognised open space, village green or playing fields.

Spatial Strategy

12.712 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality minimal development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Milton Town and Venn Green.

Policy MIL: Milton Damerel/Venn Green Spatial Strategy

The vision for the rural settlements will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of residential accommodation from any future commitments, including affordable homes, to meet housing needs in the local community;
- (b) integration of amenity open space/play area into a future development scheme;
- (c) promoting the retention of landscape character in development proposals;
- (d) support for the retention of village facilities and services to meet the needs of the local communities.

Rural settlements have few facilities or services although development opportunities may occur to meet locally generated and quantified need in the individual settlement concerned. This role will be supported in a range of ways.

A development boundary for Milton Town and Venn Green is defined on Policies Maps 57 and 58, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

The Development Proposals

12.713 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways. Development boundaries for Milton Damerel and Venn Green are defined on Policies Maps 57 and 58.

Employment

12.714 Any new employment in the rural settlements is likely to be very small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals will be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Milton Town and Venn Green.

Housing

12.715 No specific housing sites are allocated at Milton Town or Venn Green, although a small number of additional dwellings may be accommodated within the development boundaries, as defined on Policies Maps 57 and 58. At 31st March 2017, there was a relatively modest level of housing commitments in the villages ⁽¹⁰⁵⁾.

Recreation

12.716 A continuing need for additional amenity space, incorporating a play area in the parish has been identified. When an applicable housing development scheme comes forward, suitable recreation provision will be sought, to help address this need in accordance with Policy DM10: Green Infrastructure Provision.

Other Services

12.717 Proposals which address the provision of services and facilities in the rural settlements will be supported in accordance with the general policies of the Local Plan if the use and its scale and location are appropriate.

¹⁰⁵ 12 dwellings from completions and sites subject to extant planning permission since 2011

Monkleigh

The Place

12.718 Monkleigh is located on high ground on the western side of the River Torridge valley; 5.6 km (3.5 miles) south of Bideford and 6 km (4 miles) west of Great Torrington. The village has a fairly concentrated form within the serving road links.

12.719 The village has a small range of services, including a church, village hall, primary school, public house and garage. Public transport services link the village with larger settlements including Holsworthy, Bideford and Barnstaple. Employment is based upon local services with the main activities related to agriculture and tourism.

12.720 Monkleigh lies outside any designated landscape area and there is no conservation area, although the centre of the village around the junction of the A388 does contain a number of buildings of historical and architectural interest. The Grade I listed Church of St George lies on the south east edge of the village. There is also higher grade agricultural land (Grade II) to the north and west of the village.

12.721 The immediate road network is limited, approach roads to the village are narrow with restricted visibility and the main A388 road has a sharp bend within the built up area. There are generally no pavements, which affects pedestrian safety and restricted parking facilities for the primary school.

Spatial Strategy

12.722 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Monkleigh.

Policy MON: Monkleigh Spatial Strategy

The community's vision for the village is to support limited growth in response to local needs having regard to the long-standing limitations of the local road network.

The vision will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 10 dwellings to meet the range of housing needs in the local community; the supply of housing will be delivered through a single site allocation;**
- (b) identifying a site for additional housing at land north of Barton Farm within the development boundary;**
- (c) retain the character of the village and its relationship with the countryside;**
- (d) a new open space/children's play area; and**
- (e) support for the retention of village facilities and services to meet the needs of the local community.**

The Development Proposals

12.723 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways, including where appropriate development of underused and previously developed land within the village.

12.724 A development boundary for Monkleigh is defined on Policies Map 59, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.725 There is no specific site allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. Any new employment in the village settlement is likely to be small scale, although the village can capitalise on enhanced levels of assistance offered by Assisted Area status. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Monkleigh.

Housing

12.726 Additional housing is proposed to meet the needs and demands of Monkleigh over the plan period. At 31st March 2017, there was only a very modest level of housing commitments in the village ⁽¹⁰⁶⁾.

12.727 The Local Plan allocates one site that is considered deliverable to meet the future housing needs of Monkleigh. The spatial extent of the proposal is shown on Policies Map 59 and is subject to a site-specific policy (MON01: Land North of Barton Farm) that sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles.

Policy MON01: Land North of Barton Farm

(1) Land north of Barton Farm, as shown on Policies Map 59, is allocated for residential development that includes approximately 10 dwellings, with a focus on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) provide vehicle access from adjoining highway frontage;**
- (b) retain, as far as possible, existing trees and hedgerows on the site;**
- (c) appropriate layout, design and landscaping that prevents unacceptable harm on the nearby Grade I listed Church and its setting and reflects the proximity of existing dwellings and historic character of the surrounding area;**
- (d) provide safe pedestrian access from the residential area to the nearby primary school; and**
- (e) an open space and play area located within the development site.**

12.728 A greenfield area situated within the built form of Monkleigh is proposed for residential development. The site is relatively flat and has a road frontage on its northern and eastern boundaries and is predominantly bound by existing residential properties.

12.729 The land is well related to the highway network and to the village centre and with appropriate care can be satisfactorily integrated into the built fabric of the settlement.

106 1 dwelling with an extant planning permission

12.730 Land north of Barton Farm is suitable for residential development and will provide a small range of dwellings to meet local needs. The development will also help to deliver the community aspiration to provide a children's play area. Access to the site will be from the adjoining highway frontage to the east which links to the main road/A388 through the village.

12.731 Development will comprise a range of styles to meet the identified need. The site would also be suitable to accommodate housing for older residents in the form of single storey housing as part of the overall mix to support local need.

12.732 Sensitive layout, design and landscaping will be required in light of the nearby Grade I listed Church of St George and the group of historic buildings around the road junction to the west. The majority of boundary hedgerows will be retained in appropriate development proposals, to preserve recognised intrinsic wildlife and habitat value.

Other Services

12.733 Proposals which address the provision of services and facilities in the village will be supported in accordance with the general policies of the Local Plan if the use, scale and location are appropriate.

Parkham

The Place

12.734 Parkham is in the centre of a large rural parish approximately 11 km (7 miles) south west of Bideford and south of the A39, an identified strategic route in Figure 1.1. The village is connected to Bideford and Barnstaple by a limited weekday bus service.

12.735 The village has a range of services including a local farm shop, butchers, primary school, village hall, equipped play area, football pitch and public house. Vehicle repair facilities are also available. Bideford is the nearest location for a wide range of services.

12.736 In addition to local services, employment in the area is principally in agriculture and related activities or tourism. Travel away from the village is necessary for a wider range of employment opportunities.

12.737 The village has a basically linear form, with concentrations of housing around the Church in the north and the Rectory Lane/Barton Road junction in the south. It lies on high land in an undulating landscape above the wooded valley of the River Yeo. There are two listed buildings in the settlement, the Grade II* Parish Church of St James and the Bell Inn, but there is no conservation area.

Spatial Strategy

12.738 The local community through the Parish Plan process has identified a number of issues of importance for the future development of the village within an overall framework of maintaining village facilities without incorporating significant change. These include:

- a. supporting small developments that provide properties for families with young children,
- b. providing additional recreation facilities,
- c. supporting improvements to the village hall,
- d. reducing traffic speeds through the village, and
- e. extending pavements where possible in the village; and progress has been made on some of these issues.

Policy PAR: Parkham Spatial Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Parkham. The spatial vision for Parkham will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 15 new dwellings to meet a range of housing needs in the community. The supply of housing will be delivered through a single site allocation;**
- (b) support for the retention and improvement of village facilities and services to meet the needs of the local community;**
- (c) support for appropriate additional employment to address local needs;**

(d) retaining the character of the village and protection of the local and natural environment; and

(e) improvements to highway safety.

The Development Proposals

12.739 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the below site-specific policy.

12.740 A development boundary for Parkham is defined on Policies Map 60, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

12.741 The village sewage treatment works is operating close to capacity and investigations into the need for improvements will be required prior to the release of new sites for development.

Employment

12.742 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale, although the village can capitalise on enhanced levels of assistance offered by Assisted Area status. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Parkham.

Housing

12.743 Additional housing is proposed to meet the needs and demands of Parkham over the plan period. At 31st March 2017, there was a relatively high level of housing commitments in the village ⁽¹⁰⁷⁾. The Local Plan allocates one site that is considered deliverable to meet future housing needs.

12.744 The spatial extent of the proposal is shown on Policies Map 60 and is subject to a site specific policy that sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles.

Policy PAR01: Land South of Allardice Hall

(1) Land adjacent to Parkham village hall, as shown on Policies Map 60, is allocated for residential development that includes approximately 15 dwellings, including affordable homes, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

(a) a single access from Bableigh Road;

(b) substantial landscaping on the western and southern boundaries to help integrate the development into the landscape;

107 36 dwellings from sites with extant planning permission since 2011

(c) appropriate design and landscaping on the northern boundary to ensure acceptable impact on existing and future uses;

(d) adequate capacity in the sewage treatment works; and

(e) an appropriate pedestrian link to the village centre.

12.745 This is a substantial site in relation to the size of Parkham and is anticipated to meet the needs generated in the village over the plan period, including the need for affordable homes. Development of the site in a single phase will not be appropriate unless demonstrated by local need. Development will comprise a range of sizes and tenures to meet the identified need.

12.746 The northern end of the site adjoins the village hall and children's play area and there is potential for disturbance arising in particular from the use of the hall. The layout, design and landscaping of new housing will be required to secure a satisfactory relationship between the uses.

12.747 The western and southern boundaries of the site have no natural screening and are largely undefined in the landscape. Substantial planting is required to minimise the impact on the wider countryside. A low voltage overhead line crosses the northern part of the site which may be relocated. Design of the access will include suitable landscaping to replace the existing hedge.

12.748 Development should provide a safe pedestrian route to connect with the existing pavement which terminates outside the primary school.

Services and Facilities

12.749 Retention of existing recreation facilities and village services will be subject to the general policies of the Local Plan. Provision of appropriate additional services and facilities to meet locally generated needs will be supported in accordance with the spatial strategy and general Local Plan policies.

Highway Issues

12.750 The Council will support proposals to improve highway safety in the village, including the provision of additional footpaths where practical and appropriate.

Pyworthy

The Place

12.751 Pyworthy is approximately 3 km (1.9 miles) south west of Holsworthy, south of the A3072, an identified strategic route in Figure 1.1.

12.752 There are limited services within the village, although a significant number are provided in near by Holsworthy. The village has a primary school, village hall, equipped play area with open space and an all weather sports pitch. The village pub has recently closed.

Spatial Strategy

12.753 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development, supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Pyworthy.

Policy PYW: Pyworthy Spatial Strategy

The local community is supportive of an appropriate scale of continuing sustainable growth and is concerned to retain the services that are available in the village and expand these where possible. There is considered to be a need to provide affordable housing to help retain younger people in the village.

These issues will be addressed through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 10 new dwellings to meet a range of housing needs in the community. The supply of housing will be delivered through a single site allocation;
- (b) support for the retention of village facilities and services to meet the needs of the local community;
- (c) support for appropriate additional employment to address local needs;
- (d) retaining the character of the village and protection of the local and natural environment; and
- (e) Improved broadband coverage.

The Development Proposals

12.754 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site specific policy below.

12.755 A development boundary for Pyworthy is defined on Policies Map 61, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.756 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Pyworthy.

Housing

12.757 Additional housing is proposed to meet the needs and demands of Pyworthy over the plan period. At 31st March 2017, there was a very modest level of housing commitments in the village ⁽¹⁰⁸⁾. The Local Plan allocates one site that is considered deliverable to meet future housing needs.

12.758 The spatial extent of the proposal is shown on Policies Map 61 and is subject to a site specific policy that sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles.

12.759 Sewage treatment capacity is thought to be available for the amount of development proposed but this will need to be confirmed before release of the site.

Policy PYW01: Land adjacent to Pyworthy Village Hall

(1) Land adjacent to Pyworthy village hall, as shown on Policies Map 61, is allocated for residential development that includes approximately 10 dwellings, -with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

(a) layout and access arrangements that safeguard appropriate vehicular access from Derriton Road to the northern boundary of the site;

(b) substantial landscaping on the northern and eastern boundaries to help integrate the development into the landscape; and

(c) appropriate design and landscaping adjacent the village hall to ensure acceptable impact on existing and future uses.

12.760 This is a substantial site in relation to the size of Pyworthy and is expected to meet the needs generated in the village over the plan period. Development of the site in a single phase will not be appropriate unless demonstrated by local need. Development will comprise a range of styles to meet the identified need.

12.761 The western end of the site adjoins the village hall and there is potential for disturbance arising from that use. The layout, design and landscaping of new housing will be required to secure a satisfactory relationship between the uses and prevent curtailment of the appropriate use of either.

12.762 The northern boundary of the site has no natural screening and is undefined in the landscape. Substantial planting is required to minimise the impact on the wider countryside.

12.763 Development of the site will safeguard an appropriate vehicular access between Derriton Road and its northern boundary to accommodate possible future development to the north.

Other Issues

12.764 Retention of existing recreation facilities and village services will be subject to the general policies of the Local Plan. Provision of appropriate additional services and facilities to

108 3 dwellings from completions and sites subject to extant planning permission since 2011

meet locally generated needs will be supported in accordance with the spatial strategy for Pyworthy and the general Local Plan policies.

Rackenford

The Place

12.765 Rackenford is a small, relatively isolated village on high moorland in the extreme east of the plan area. The village is approximately 7 kilometres (4.5 miles) north-east of Witheridge and some 15 kilometres (9 miles) west of Tiverton within Mid Devon District. Rackenford is approximately 3 kilometres (2 miles) south of the North Devon Link Road (A361), identified as part of the Strategic Road Network.

12.766 The village has a linear settlement pattern with most properties fronting the village street, which runs north to south. The existing buildings have a mixture of design styles and ages with a small number of listed buildings, including the Grade I listed All Saints Church, although the historic core of the village does not have a conservation area.

12.767 The village is located above the valley of the Little Dart River, the majority of which forms an extensive County Wildlife Site, including Old Bell Farm and Lower Bulworthy. Rackenford Common extends into the western side of the village.

12.768 Local services and facilities within the village include a primary school, shop with post office and public house. The community currently lacks a village hall, although the Stag Inn and Stag Hall are currently used for community meetings and uses. The sewage treatment works has capacity for approximately 15 additional dwellings. Development in the village above this level will require contributions towards increasing the capacity of the plant.

12.769 Agriculture and related activities are the main sources of employment in the area, together with the local services. The village has a number of home-based workers although the majority of employment opportunities are outside of the parish.

Spatial Strategy

12.770 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Rackenford.

Policy RAC: Rackenford Spatial Strategy

The local community has a vision for the village that it will remain a lively place, retaining at least the same level of services and employment opportunities and accepts that some new development is necessary to achieve this.

Maintaining the linear character of the village and retaining its relationship with the open countryside are also important, as is the need to ensure new development is of a design that reflects local characteristics and protects the historic features. There is support for additional community facilities in the form of open spaces and a new village hall and for farm diversification projects in the locality. The spatial strategy will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 17 new dwellings, to meet the range of needs in the community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning permissions and three additional site allocations for approximately 12 dwellings on the eastern side of the village;**
- (b) support for additional employment provision to meet locally generated requirements;**
- (c) improved broadband coverage;**

- (d) retention and improvement of existing recreation and community facilities to meet a local need, together with provision of new allotments, a village car park and a community hall;
- (e) improved highway safety at the junction of Rackenford Cross and Old Bell Hill;
- (f) improved traffic management to the south of Coles Yard by restricting new access points and avoiding intensification of use of existing accesses;
- (g) infrastructure provision required to support future development will be prioritised over affordable housing delivery; and
- (h) the setting and historic character of the village and its relationship with the countryside not being harmed by any future development.

Development Proposals

12.771 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site-specific policies below. A development boundary for Rackenford is defined on Policies Map 62, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.772 No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale. Specific proposals will be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Rackenford.

Housing

12.773 The spatial extent of the proposals is shown on Policies Map 62 and is subject to site-specific policies that set out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles. At 31st March 2017, there was a relatively low level of housing commitments in Rackenford⁽¹⁰⁹⁾.

Policy RAC01: Land at Rackenford Cross

(1) Land at Rackenford Cross, as shown on Policies Map 62, is proposed for residential development that includes:

- (a) approximately 6 dwellings;
- (b) safety improvements to the junction at Rackenford Cross and Old Bell Hill; and
- (c) an area of up to 0.2 hectares for use as allotments.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) a single vehicular access from the road through the village; and

109 1 dwelling has been built since 2011

(b) retention and enhancement of existing boundary trees and hedges including provision of substantial landscaping along the eastern boundary.

12.774 Design of this small development will have regard to the amenities of adjoining properties and the impact of nearby uses on future residents. Development will retain existing trees and enhance existing hedgerows. Vehicular access to the development should be provided from the road through the village. Development will also contribute toward junction improvements at Rackenford Cross. Works to create a safe access in to the site and junction improvements at Rackenford Cross will be required to re-instate the hedgebanks along the northern and western boundaries. The eastern boundary is undefined and substantial planting will be required to integrate the development into the surrounding countryside.

12.775 The area for allotment use will be appropriately serviced and made available to the Parish Council or other appropriate body for future management. The location of and access to the allotments should be agreed in association with the design and layout of the dwellings and should be delivered at the same time as the construction of the dwellings.

Policy RAC02: Land at Prospect Farm

(1) Land at Prospect Farm, as shown on Policies Map 62, is proposed for approximately 3 dwellings to reflect local needs.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

(a) frontage development along the Village Street, reflecting local characteristics with further housing development; and

(b) retention and reinforcement of existing boundary hedgerows including provision of substantial landscaping along the eastern boundary.

12.776 Development will retain existing trees and hedges except where removal is essential to secure a safe access. The eastern boundary is undefined and substantial planting will be required to integrate the development into the surrounding countryside. The design of this development must have regard to the existing character of the village, the adjacent Grade II listed Ebenezer Bible Christian Chapel and to the amenities of adjoining properties.

Policy RAC03: Land at Coles Yard

(1) Land at Coles Yard, as shown on Policies Map 62, is proposed for approximately 3 dwellings to reflect local needs.

(2) The site will be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

(a) improvements to the existing vehicular access from the Village Street;

(b) retention and reinforcement of existing boundary hedgerows including provision of substantial landscaping along the eastern boundary; and

(c) assessment and remediation prior to the commencement of development of any site contamination arising from previous uses.

12.777 The continued use of Coles Yard as a haulage yard is of some concern to the local community in terms of its impact on the local highway network and surrounding residential properties, in this central part of the village. The current landowner has expressed a desire to relocate the business to a site on the outskirts of the village and to redevelop the site for housing. A re-location of the business to a more suitable site would be supported by Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages.

12.778 Redevelopment of the site should retain existing trees and hedges except where removal is essential to secure a safe access. The existing access on to the Village Street is poor but small-scale residential development that would not increase the traffic generation over and above the former use as a haulage business is considered acceptable. The eastern boundary is undefined and substantial planting will be required to integrate the development into the surrounding countryside. The design of this development must have regard to the existing character of the village and amenities of adjoining properties including the existing dwelling at Coles Yard if retained.

12.779 The long-term use of Coles Yard by a haulage firm may have resulted in the presence of hazardous materials that, if identified, would need to be remediated prior to development in accordance with Policy DM02: Environmental Protection.

Community Facilities

12.780 Local services and facilities within the village include a primary school, shop with post office and Stag Inn public house and Stag Hall which currently provide important meeting spaces for the local community. Retention of existing recreation and community facilities will be subject to the general policies of the Local Plan. Provision of appropriate additional facilities to meet locally generated needs, including a site for a new village hall, open space and public parking will be supported in accordance with the spatial strategy and general Local Plan policies. New allotments are proposed as part of the development at Rackenford Cross, Policy RAC01: Land at Rackenford Cross. The local community has identified a potential site to the south of Meadow View.

Policy RAC04: Land South of Meadow View

Land south of Meadow View, as shown on Policies Map 62 is identified for the provision of additional community facilities including:

- (a) a new car park to serve the village;**
- (b) a new community / village hall; and**
- (c) an area of public open space including a new equipped play area.**

12.781 Land south of Meadow View, on the western edge of the village is proposed for additional community facilities. Provision of any new community hall, open space, children's play area and car park will be conveniently located to serve the village. Detailed design, layout and landscaping should minimise the impact of development on the amenities of properties in the immediate area, including the historic setting of the Grade I listed All Saints Church.

Historic Environment

12.782 Rackenford does not have a designated conservation area. Should the local community identify the need for a future designation to protect the historic core of the village during the plan period, then it would be supported.

Sheepwash

The Place

12.783 Sheepwash is about 15 kms (9 miles) south of Great Torrington in a rural location above the Torridge Valley. Most of the village, which retains a nucleated form around the original crossroads, is within a Conservation Area centered on The Square and the Grade II* listed Church of St Lawrence.

12.784 The village retains a shop/post office but otherwise has a limited range of services including a pub and community hall. Other than local services and tourism, which includes cycling and walking based on the Tarka Trail and other long distance routes; there is little employment in the village.

Spatial Strategy

12.785 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Sheepwash.

Policy SHP: Sheepwash Spatial Strategy

The community's spatial vision for Sheepwash is that the significant cultural, built, historic and archaeological features of the village and local landscape are enhanced, including through the secured high quality design of new buildings. Additionally, new facilities, a new village hall, playing fields and off street car parking, will be delivered to meet the needs of all sections of the community,

The vision will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of residential accommodation, focused on meeting a range of community based housing needs;**
- (b) support for the retention of existing and provision of additional, village facilities and services to meet the needs of the local community;**
- (c) support for additional employment provision to meet local requirements;**
- (d) retain the character of the village and protection of the local historic and natural environment; and**
- (e) Improve broadband coverage.**

The Development Proposals

12.786 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities to address locally generated and quantified needs. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site specific policies below.

12.787 A development boundary for Sheepwash is defined on Policies Map 63, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.788 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12:

Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Sheepwash.

Housing

12.789 No specific sites are allocated in Sheepwash for general housing development, although a small number of additional dwellings may be accommodated within the development boundary. At 31st March 2017 there was relatively modest level of housing commitments in the village. ⁽¹¹⁰⁾

12.790 If a need for affordable dwellings is identified, land to the west of Lime Court is considered suitable. This site is outside the development boundary and will be released only in accordance with Policy ST19: Affordable Housing on Exceptions Sites.

12.791 Elsewhere, the general approach of the Local Plan relating to defined Villages will apply, which supports development opportunities appropriate to the scale of the locality.

Transport

12.792 Opportunities to improve public transport services to the village will be supported. All new or improved transport infrastructure should be designed to reflect its location in the countryside or Conservation Area as appropriate.

Other Services

12.793 Proposals which address the provision of services and facilities in the village will be supported in accordance with the general policies of the Local Plan, if the use and its scale and location are appropriate.

110 17 dwellings from completions since 2011, sites under construction and with extant planning permission

Shirwell

The Place

12.794 Shirwell has two distinct small centres. Shirwell Cross on the A39, a route identified as an 'Other Strategic Route' in Figure 4.4 with Shirwell village approximately 600 metres to the north-east. Shirwell is approximately 7.5 kilometres (5 miles) to the north-east of Barnstaple and 4.5 kilometres (4 miles) west of Bratton Fleming.

12.795 The village has a limited range of facilities including a primary school, village hall and two motor vehicle repairs businesses. There are limited employment opportunities available locally in terms of employment estates although the parish does benefit from a number of small businesses. The nearest major employment opportunities are located at Barnstaple, to which there is a regular bus service.

12.796 Shirwell is located within gently rising, open 'downland' countryside. Shirwell Cross has a generally linear settlement pattern whereas Shirwell village is more compact. Youlston and Longtimber Woods to the east of the village is a County Wildlife Site. Youlston Park, which borders Shirwell Cross to the north of the A39, is a Grade II listed Historic Park and Garden as shown on Policies Map 65, which forms part of the setting of the Grade I listed Youlston Park House. Shirwell village includes the Grade I listed St Peter's Church.

Spatial Strategy

12.797 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Shirwell.

Policy SHW: Shirwell Spatial Strategy

The community's strategy is to enable sustainable and acceptable growth in the settlement that meets a local need, including the need for affordable housing, but has minimal landscape impact. The spatial strategy will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 8 new dwellings to meet a range of housing needs in the local community to be delivered through extant planning permissions, with no new sites allocated for housing;**
- (b) support for additional employment provision to meet locally generated requirements;**
- (c) retention of the character of the village and its relationship with the surrounding countryside and open spaces;**
- (d) protection of listed buildings and their setting, and the character and appearance of Youlston historic park and garden including key vistas;**
- (e) maintenance and development of village services and facilities; and**
- (f) delivery of superfast broadband connections.**

Development Proposals

12.798 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways.

12.799 Shirwell has no defined development boundary. Proposals that are well related to the existing settlements of Shirwell Cross or Shirwell village and are appropriate to the scale of the locality will be considered against the general policies of the Local Plan including Policy DM23: Residential Development in Defined Settlements without Development Boundaries. The impact of proposals on the setting of the historic Youlston Park and the wider historic environment will also be important considerations.

Employment

12.800 Any new employment in the parish is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses and specific proposals will be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Shirwell.

Housing

12.801 Opportunities for residential development in the village are limited. There are no sites identified for housing development in the village but the requirement still remains to provide additional housing to meet local needs and demands, and help retain local services and facilities. At 31st March 2017, there was a relatively modest level of housing commitments in Shirwell⁽¹¹¹⁾.

12.802 Where land is available for development, is appropriate in terms of scale and location, and accords with the relevant policies of the Local Plan, it will be considered for residential development. Opportunities to secure additional housing to meet local needs will continue to be explored.

Community Facilities

12.803 Shirwell has a primary school, village hall and church. The general policies of the Local Plan protect existing services and facilities, and proposals that involve their loss will be considered against these policies. Provision of appropriate additional facilities to meet locally generated needs will be supported in accordance with the spatial strategy and general Local Plan policies.

¹¹¹ 9 dwellings from completions, under construction and extant planning permissions since 2011, including approvals subject to completion of S106.

St Giles on the Heath

The Place

12.804 St Giles on the Heath is located on the A388 route in the southwest of the Local Plan area, approximately 7kms (4.5 miles) north of Launceston in Cornwall and 14.5kms (9 miles) south of Holsworthy. The area is mainly agricultural lying between the valleys of the Rivers Tamar and Carey.

12.805 The village has a range of services meeting day to day needs including a primary school, community centre, community shop and post office and public house. Recreation facilities include a playing field and play area. There is limited public transport to access services elsewhere.

12.806 There is limited employment in the village.

Spatial Strategy

12.807 Through the preparation of the current Parish Plan the local community have identified a number of issues of importance for the future development of St Giles on the Heath which include:

- a. meeting the identified need for housing in the parish;
- b. increased provision for recreation, leisure and health services;
- c. protection of the local natural and built environment;
- d. improvement of pedestrian and traffic safety and meeting community transport needs;
- e. provision of local retail opportunities; and
- f. increasing access to broadband service.

Policy STG: St Giles on the Heath Spatial Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development to meet local social and economic needs, supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of St Giles on the Heath. The spatial vision for St Giles on the Heath will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of residential accommodation, focused on affordable homes, to meet a range of housing needs in the local community;**
- (b) support for the retention of village facilities and services to meet the needs of the local community;**
- (c) support for additional employment provision to meet local requirements;**
- (d) retain the character of the village and protection of the local and natural environment; and**
- (e) improve broadband coverage.**

The Development Proposals

12.808 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities to address locally generated and quantified needs. This role will be supported in a range of ways.

12.809 A development boundary for St Giles on the Heath is defined on Policies Map 66, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.810 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development in Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for St Giles on the Heath.

Housing

12.811 No specific sites are allocated in St Giles on the Heath for general housing development although a small number of additional dwellings may be accommodated within the development boundary. At 31st March 2017, there was a modest level of housing commitments in the village⁽¹¹²⁾.

12.812 A need for affordable housing has been identified and a site north of the village hall and playing field is considered suitable for a total of approximately 12 dwellings. This site is outside the development boundary and will be released only in accordance with Policy ST19: Affordable Housing on Exception Sites.

12.813 Elsewhere, the general approach of the Local Plan relating to identified Villages will apply, which supports development opportunities appropriate to the scale of the locality to address locally generated and quantified needs (Policy ST07: Spatial Development Strategy for northern Devon's Rural Area).

Other Issues

12.814 Proposals which address the provision of services and facilities in the village will be supported in accordance with the general policies of the Local Plan if the use and its scale and location are appropriate.

112 15 dwellings from completions since 2011, sites under construction and subject to extant planning permission

Sutcombe

The Place

12.815 Sutcombe is a small rural village about 8 kms (5 miles) north west of Holsworthy on sloping land above the River Waldon. The village has a compact form, centred around the parish church of St Andrew.

12.816 The village has a primary school and village hall, but no convenience shop or other retail facilities.

12.817 There is little employment in the village or parish other than that related to agriculture and most employed residents travel out of the area.

Spatial Strategy

12.818 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development, supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Sutcombe.

Policy SUT: Sutcombe Spatial Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Sutcombe.

The Parish Plan identified a good sense of community within the parish and appreciation of the landscape and tranquil location. The lack of public transport, limited facilities and no children's play area were identified as concerns. The community has identified the need to provide a range of dwelling sizes to secure a more balanced local population and encourage local economic and environmental sustainability.

The community's aspiration will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 23 new dwellings, including affordable homes, to meet a range of housing needs in the community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning consents and 2 new site allocations with a combined capacity for approximately 20 dwellings;**
- (b) support for appropriate additional services and employment to address local needs;**
- (c) provision of a children's play area in conjunction with housing development; and**
- (d) retaining the character of the village and it's countryside setting.**

The Development Proposals

12.819 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities to address locally generated and quantified needs. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site specific policies below.

12.820 A development boundary for Sutcombe is defined on Policies Map 67, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.821 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Plan and the spatial strategy for Sutcombe.

Housing

12.822 Additional housing is proposed to meet the needs and demands of Sutcombe over the plan period. At 31st March 2017, there was a modest level of housing commitments in the village⁽¹¹³⁾ The Local Plan allocates two sites that are considered deliverable to meet future housing needs.

12.823 Development of the sites may trigger a review of the discharge consent at the sewage treatment works. Any improvements required as a result of this process will need to be funded by development.

12.824 The spatial extent of the proposals is shown on Policies Map 67 and is subject to site specific policies that set out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles.

Policy SUT01: Land to North of Sutcombe Primary School

(1) Land north of the primary school, as shown on Policies Map 67, is allocated for residential development that includes approximately 10 dwellings, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

(a) a single vehicular access from the village road; and

(b) substantial landscaping on the western and southern boundaries to integrate the new development into the landscape and protect the amenities of existing development.

12.825 The site to the north of the primary school is well related to the village centre but has no clear western boundary.

12.826 Development will accommodate a range of housing sizes to meet the needs of the community. A single vehicular access is required and provision for the highway to continue to the western boundary of the site.

12.827 The site has no natural western boundary and a substantial area of landscaping is required to integrate the site into the countryside. Landscaping will be extended into the development to subdivide the residential areas.

Policy SUT02: Land adjacent to the Parish Hall

(1) Land north of the village hall, as shown on Policies Map 67, is allocated for:

113 7 dwellings from completions since 2011 and sites subject to extant planning permission

(a) residential development that includes approximately 10 dwellings, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need; and

(b) a children's play area to serve the development and village.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

(a) A joint vehicular access with the village hall, if possible;

(b) Widening of the village road over the full frontage of the site;

(c) Substantial landscaping on the eastern and southern boundaries to integrate the new development into the landscape;

(d) Location of the childrens' play area in a safe and convenient location to serve the village; and

(e) Appropriate design and landscaping adjacent to the village hall to ensure acceptable impact on existing and future uses.

12.828 Development will accommodate a range of housing sizes to meet the needs of the community.

12.829 A shared access with the village hall is preferred if achievable. Development should provide for the widening of the village road across the frontage of the site to improve safety and provide for easier drop off/collection of children at the village school.

12.830 The site has no natural boundary to the east and, in part, the south. Appropriate boundary treatment is required to integrate the site into the countryside. The layout, design and landscaping of new housing will be required to secure a satisfactory relationship with the village hall to prevent curtailment of appropriate use of either.

Other Issues

12.831 Proposals which address the provision of services and facilities in the village will be supported in accordance with the general policies of the Local Plan if the use and its scale and location are appropriate.

Swimbridge

The Place

12.832 Swimbridge is a relatively large village located to the south of the North Devon Link Road (A361), identified as part of the 'Strategic Road Network' in Figure 4.4, and on either side of the old main road between Barnstaple and South Molton, now a Class C road. The village is approximately 7 kilometres (4.5 miles) south-east of Barnstaple and 13 kilometres (8 miles) north-west of South Molton. The village is situated in the valley of Venn Stream, with hills to the north and south of the main settlement. Swimbridge also extends up Station Hill to Archipark, Hooda Close and Yarnacott Corner to the north.

12.833 The village has a shop and post office, primary school and pre-school, public house, village hall and a number of areas of open space, including the Glebe Field to the south west. In addition to these local services, the village provides some employment opportunities within well established businesses operating from the Old Tannery site. The nearest major employment opportunities are located at Barnstaple and South Molton.

12.834 The village centre retains much of its historic pattern and character and is centred around St James' Church, a Grade I listed building. A conservation area covers a large part of the village apart from the modern developments to the south-east and north. It also includes the area of open space to the west of the village centre, which provides important views to the surrounding green hills and is considered to be important to the setting of Swimbridge.

12.835 The village is not within any formal landscape designation, although its setting within the scenic valley of the Venn Stream and surrounding countryside is considered attractive. A number of properties either side of the Venn Stream are within an identified area of flood risk, although flood defences have been completed.

Spatial Strategy

12.836 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Swimbridge.

Policy SWM: Swimbridge Spatial Strategy

The vision of the local community for the future development of the village is that it grows in a sustainable and organic fashion, supporting and developing the existing commercial activity and protecting the existing open spaces within and around the village.

The spatial strategy will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 15 new dwellings to meet a range of housing needs in the local community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning consents and small scale new developments within the development boundary. There are no new sites allocated for housing;**
- (b) support for additional employment provision in the village to meet local requirements and for the improvement of existing commercial premises;**
- (c) retention of the local historic character of the village and its relationship with the countryside and open spaces;**
- (d) support for maintaining and developing village services and facilities including play and sporting facilities;**

- (e) support for improved public transport connections serving the village;
- (f) delivery of superfast broadband connections; and
- (g) support for appropriate renewable energy schemes.

Development Proposals

12.837 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways. A development boundary for Swimbridge is defined on Policies Map 68 outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.838 Any additional employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals for new development and the expansion of existing businesses will be considered in accordance with Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The retention of existing business premises will be considered in accordance with Policy DM13: Safeguarding Employment Land. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Swimbridge.

Housing

12.839 At 31st March 2017 there was a relatively low level of housing commitments in Swimbridge⁽¹¹⁴⁾. There are no additional sites proposed for housing development but some opportunities for infilling may be available within the development boundary.

12.840 Where suitable land is available and is appropriate in terms of its scale and location, it will be considered for development in accordance with the general policies of the Local Plan. Development that adversely impacts on the historic character of the village, or is adversely affected by potential flooding, will not be supported.

Other Issues

12.841 Retention of existing recreation and community facilities will be subject to the general policies of the Local Plan. Provision of appropriate additional facilities to meet locally generated needs, including increased use of the Glebe Field for additional play and sporting facilities will be supported in accordance with the spatial strategy and general plan policies. The Glebe Field is identified as a potential hub site.

12.842 The Council will support improvements in public transport facilities to meet local requirements. The establishment of appropriate small scale renewable energy schemes will also be supported, in accordance with Policy ST16: Delivering Renewable Heat and Energy.

114 17 dwellings from completions since 2011, under construction and extant planning permissions

Tetcott

The Place

12.843 Tetcott is a small, relatively isolated village about 8kms south of Holsworthy, to the west of the A388, close to the Cornish border. Much of the village and the surrounding land is part of the extensive Tetcott Manor Estate.

12.844 A post office and substantial modern village hall are the only significant local services. Employment locally is mainly in agriculture or related activities. The village is on higher land in rolling countryside with extensive views beyond existing buildings.

12.845 The Grade I Listed Church of the Holy Cross and Grade II* Tetcott Manor are to the north west of the village. Within the village Higher Lana Farmhouse and property at Lower Lana are listed. There is no conservation area in the Village.

12.846 The sewage treatment plant serving Tetcott has limited capacity.

Spatial Strategy

12.847 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Tetcott.

Policy TET: Tetcott Spatial Strategy

The community has a vision for the village that enables it to develop as a more inclusive community with a wider range of accommodation to broaden its age structure and provide greater opportunities for social interaction and local employment without harming the rural characteristics and setting of the area.

The community accepts that achieving the vision requires a relatively high level of new development having regard to the existing scale of the village. It has determined that the need to secure the long term sustainable viability of the Tetcott Manor Estate, which manages some 1,820 hectares (4,500 acres) of countryside in the area through 14 farms, and provides a range of local employment and accommodation within the village, is essential to help achieve a more sustainable future for the settlement.

The spatial strategy will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 27 new dwellings to meet a range of housing needs in the community. The supply of housing will be delivered through 4 additional site allocations within the development boundary with a total capacity of approximately 27 dwellings;
- (b) design and scale of development that reflects the existing characteristics of the village;
- (c) provision of a village green and village square;
- (d) provision of additional car parking to serve the village;
- (e) protection of the countryside setting of, and views from, the village; and
- (f) support for additional local services and employment.

The Development Proposals

12.848 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities to address locally generated and quantified needs. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site specific policy below.

12.849 A development boundary for Tetcott is defined on Policies Map 69 outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.850 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Tetcott.

Housing

12.851 The spatial extent of the proposals are shown on Policies Map 69 and are subject to a site specific policy that sets out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles and community facilities.

12.852 Adequate sewage treatment facilities will be required to enable any of the identified sites to be supported.

Policy TET01: Land at Tetcott

(1) Sites at Tetcott, as shown on Policies Map 69, are allocated for residential development that includes approximately 27 dwellings, including affordable homes, with an emphasis on providing a mix of housing types and sizes to reflect local need.

(2) The sites should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

(a) Site west of Lower Lana

(i) approximately 10 dwellings;

(ii) vehicular access from a suitable new route through the site that links existing bordering public highways; and

(iii) substantial boundary planting on the northern and eastern boundaries to help integrate the site into the countryside.

(b) Site to the north of Lana Cottages

(i) approximately 5 dwellings;

(ii) a single vehicular access;

(iii) provision of rear access and parking for Lana Cottages; and

(iv) substantial boundary planting on the northern and western boundaries to help integrate the site into the countryside.

(c) Site to the south of the Village Hall

- (i) approximately 7 dwellings;**
- (ii) protection of the setting of the village piggeries buildings;**
- (iii) acceptable impact on the setting of the listed building at Higher Lana Farmhouse; and**
- (iv) substantial boundary planting on the southern, eastern and western boundaries to help integrate the site into the countryside.**

(d) Village centre site

- (i) approximately 5 dwellings;**
- (ii) provision of a Village Green at the north western end of the site;**
- (iii) provision of a Village Square in front of the village hall; and**
- (iv) detailed design of dwellings and community facilities that protects the amenity of adjacent properties.**

12.853 All sites for development are within the same ownership. Individual parcels of land for development are relatively small to ensure acceptable impact on the existing settlement. They will be released to ensure a steady and continuing pace of development over the plan period and in accordance with the spatial strategy, allowing the community to adapt to growth.

12.854 Together, the sites will provide a range of dwellings to meet locally generated needs and demands. Housing density, size and form will vary between the sites.

12.855 Sites (a), (b) and (c) are prominent and visible locations on the edge of the village and development needs to provide for their integration into the landscape by appropriate design and landscaping. In addition, site layout will ensure that views out of the village to the countryside are maintained.

12.856 The detailed design and layout of the Village Green and Village Square will have regard to the amenity of neighbouring uses and the safety of users in view of the proximity to highways.

12.857 Community facilities will be provided by the development of the identified sites. In view of the small scale of individual sites and the need to ensure they provide for locally generated and quantified needs over the plan period, community facilities may not be provided early in the plan period. In order to justify the scale of development proposed in the village, the local planning authority will require to be satisfied that individual developments will contribute to the identified facilities.

Other Issues

12.858 Retention of existing recreation facilities and village services will be subject to the general policies of the Plan. Provision of appropriate additional services and facilities to meet locally generated needs, particularly by use of the areas adjacent to the village hall, will be supported in accordance with the spatial strategy and general Local Plan policies.

12.859 In addition to the provision of off-road parking required by Policy TET01: Land at Tetcott (Site to the North of Lana Cottages) further such provision will be supported elsewhere in the village, for example for the properties in Lana Park.

Umberleigh

The Place

12.860 Umberleigh is a dispersed rural settlement, approximately 4 kilometres (2.5 miles) west of Chittlehampton and approximately 14 kilometres (8.5 miles) south of Barnstaple. The village is located either side of the River Taw, as shown on Policies Map 70, along the A377 and the B3227 (Great Torrington to South Molton road) both of which are identified as 'Other Strategic Route' in Figure 4.4. The village is also well connected to the Barnstaple to Exeter railway line with a dedicated station. The river is the boundary between the parishes of Atherington and Chittlehampton.

12.861 Local services include a post office, primary school, village hall, public house and railway station. Employment in the area is mainly based on these local services including agricultural machinery sales and repairs. A large majority of the village is within the indicative flood zone as identified by the Environment Agency. The extent of flood risk within the village severely limits development opportunities.

12.862 Umberleigh has a dispersed settlement pattern of development, with no recognised centre. There is no conservation area within the village and a single listed building at Umberleigh Mill on the A377. Mill Wood and Fisherton Wood County Wildlife Sites are located on the western edge of the village, adjacent to the A377.

Spatial Strategy

12.863 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development that is supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Umberleigh, within the constraints imposed by the extensive risks of flooding.

Policy UMB: Umberleigh Spatial Strategy

The local community has a vision that the area remains an attractive village within a 'working' parish, retaining links with agriculture, industry, commerce and tourism. The spatial strategy will be delivered through:

- (a) support for a limited number of new dwellings well related to existing dwellings to meet a range of housing needs in the community;
- (b) support for additional employment provision to meet locally generated requirements;
- (c) retention and conservation of the village's historic environment, heritage assets and character, and its relationship with the countryside;
- (d) support for additional recreation and social facilities to meet locally generated needs; and
- (e) improved broadband coverage.

Development Proposals

12.864 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. Umberleigh has no defined development boundary. Proposals that are well related to the existing settlement

and appropriate to the scale of the locality will be considered against the general policies of the Local Plan.

Employment

12.865 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will be considered in terms of other Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Umberleigh.

Housing

12.866 Opportunities for residential development in the settlement of Umberleigh are very limited due mainly to the dispersed development pattern and the severe risk of flooding. Therefore, the village has neither a defined development boundary nor site-specific allocations, although the requirement to provide additional housing to meet local needs and address aspirations for improvements to local services and facilities still remains. Appropriate windfall development will be supported. At 31st March 2017, there were no housing commitments in Umberleigh.

12.867 Where suitable land is available for development, is appropriate in terms of its scale and location in relation to flood risks and has no significant impact on listed buildings in the village, it will be considered for development in accordance with general policies of the Local Plan. Opportunities to secure additional housing to meet local needs will continue to be explored.

Community Services

12.868 The village hall and primary school within Umberleigh provide important facilities for the local community. Provision of additional or enhancement of existing community facilities to meet locally generated needs will be supported in accordance with the spatial strategy and general policies of the Local Plan.

Welcombe and Daracott

The Place

12.869 Welcombe Parish borders Cornwall in the west of the plan area. The parish includes a number of small settlements in close proximity, which together provide a range of services for local people. The parish has no well defined village centre. The principal settlements at Welcombe and Daracott are combined to form a designated village, as shown on Policies Map 71.

12.870 The area is within the North Devon Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty. Local employment relates principally to agriculture, tourism and local services. Services available locally include a community shop, village hall, pub and equipped play area.

12.871 Neither Welcombe or Daracott have public foul drainage facilities.

Spatial Strategy

12.872 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development, supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Welcombe and Daracott.

Policy WDA: Welcombe / Daracott Spatial Strategy

The local community supports equal opportunity for all residents and the provision of sufficient housing, including affordable housing, to meet the needs of the community over the Plan period to avoid further reduction in local population.

The vision will be delivered through:

- (a) support for a limited number of new dwellings focused on affordable homes, to meet a range of housing needs in the community;**
- (b) ensuring new residential development is well related to existing dwellings;**
- (c) support for the establishment of a Community Land Trust to assist with the provision of affordable housing in Welcombe and Daracott;**
- (d) retention of the character of the village(s), including its relationship with the countryside;**
- (e) support for appropriate additional services, recreation facilities and employment to address local needs; and**
- (f) giving great weight to conserving landscape and natural beauty in the consideration of proposals for development.**

The Development Proposals

12.873 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities to address locally generated and quantified needs.

12.874 Located within the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty, Welcombe and Daracott are not suitable for significant new development unless a local need is demonstrated. There is no support from the local community for a significant scale of new growth. In view of the location within the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty, great weight will be given to conserving landscape and scenic beauty in consideration of proposals for development.

12.875 Taken together the dispersed settlements may continue to provide the range of services to retain Village status. The individual settlements are not of sufficient size or have a form that warrants development boundary definition.

12.876 In respect of the settlements known as Welcombe and Darracott the general approach of the Local Plan relating to identified Villages will apply, which supports development opportunities appropriate to the scale of the locality.

West Down

The Place

12.877 West Down is located approximately 8 kilometres (5 miles) south of Ilfracombe and approximately 7 kilometres (4.5 miles) north-east of Braunton. The village is approximately 1 kilometre (0.6 miles) east of the A361 Ilfracombe to Barnstaple road and approximately 2.5 kilometres (1.5 miles) south of the A3123 at Mullacott, both identified as 'Other Strategic Routes' in Figure 4.4, although the village is accessed along narrow winding lanes.

12.878 The village has a relatively compact settlement pattern, centred around the Grade I listed St Callixtus's Church although the historic core of the village does not have a conservation area. West Down lies outside of any designated landscape, but is situated on a downland plateau between valleys of tributaries of the River Caen and is set within attractive countryside within the 'Downland' landscape character type. The village is not visually prominent from the main road (A361) although parts of the village are visible across the Caen valley from the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty and Coast and Estuary Zone to the west. There are two County Wildlife Sites in close proximity of the village, at Buttercombe Wood to the south-west and Snowball Meadow / Roborough Wood to the south.

12.879 Local services and facilities in the village include a primary school and pre-school, community shop, public house, allotments, community field and village hall with an outreach post office. There are limited employment opportunities within the village, which has Assisted Area status, with the local economy dominated by agriculture, although the parish includes Mullacott Business Park. West Down has a relatively high level of second home ownership that may contribute toward tourism in the parish. Other employment opportunities are mostly in the main towns, outside of the parish.

Spatial Strategy

12.880 Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of West Down.

Policy WED: West Down Spatial Strategy

The local community has a vision for the parish that seeks to capitalise on its many assets such as its location, character, the talents of its residents and above all community spirit. The community will overcome recent losses in services and facilities and become one that is so far as possible self-sustaining.

The future availability of the open space at Chapel Meadow will be enjoyed by all parishioners and with an improvement in employment prospects, would increase the attractiveness of West Down as a place to live. In those circumstances the availability of affordable housing for local people and their children to enable them to remain in the parish will be an objective over the Plan period.

The spatial strategy will be delivered through:

(a) provision of a minimum of 21 dwellings to meet the range of needs in the community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning permissions and a single site allocation for approximately 15 dwellings off Ilfracombe Hill;

(b) protection of the character of the village and its relationship with the surrounding countryside;

(c) support for additional employment provision to meet locally generated requirements;

(d) support for improved and additional recreation and community facilities to meet locally generated needs; and

(e) support for superfast broadband connections.

Development Proposals

12.881 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities. This role will be supported in a range of ways including the site-specific policies below. A development boundary for West Down is defined on Policies Map 72, outside of which the principle of residential development is only supported on an exceptional basis.

Employment

12.882 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale as opportunities for larger scale employment within the parish will be delivered at Mullacott Business Park where an area is identified for additional economic development under Policy ILF04: Mullacott Business Park. Economic development in West Down including Mullacott can capitalise on enhanced levels of assistance offered by the Assisted Area status.

12.883 No specific site is identified for economic development within the village although the former Foxhunters garage site, Policy WED01: former Foxhunters Garage adjoining the A361 could provide an opportunity for employment uses. Proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development in Towns, Local Centres and Villages, in relation to general employment and Policies DM17: Tourism and Leisure Attractions and DM18: Tourism Accommodation, in relation to tourism. The expansion of existing businesses and specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy and vision for West Down.

Policy WED01: Former Foxhunters Garage

The site at former Foxhunters Garage, as shown on Policies Map 72, is proposed for economic development that includes:

(a) contributions towards improved accessibility to the former railway line between Willingcott and Knowle to complete part of the gap in the Tarka Trail and strategic cycle network; and

(b) a single vehicular access on to the A361 with a re-instated hedge bank along the eastern boundary.

12.884 The former Foxhunters garage off the A361 has recently closed for business. However, the site is well related to the main road network and is well served by a regular public transport route between Ilfracombe and Barnstaple. The re-development of the site for economic development or tourism related industries would be supported in accordance with the general policies of the Local Plan. Proposals for retailing and other identified town centre uses should be considered against Policy DM21: Local and Rural Shops.

12.885 The site is within the defined Coast and Estuarine Zone and forms part of the Developed Coast where Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy would apply. Should the site be

re-developed for employment purposes, vehicular access should be provided from the A361, including the re-instatement of the hedgebank along the eastern boundary. A detailed flood risk assessment will be required to demonstrate that existing flooding problems will not be exacerbated locally or elsewhere downstream.

12.886 Any redevelopment should provide a contribution toward improved pedestrian / cycle access to the former railway line between Willingcott and Knowle, where the gap in the Tarka Trail and strategic cycle network is to be completed (Policy ST10: Transport Strategy).

Housing

12.887 The spatial extent of the proposal is shown on Policies Map 72 and is subject to a site-specific policy that set out the range and nature of development to be delivered along with identified development principles. At 31st March 2017, there was a relatively low level of housing commitments in West Down⁽¹¹⁵⁾.

Policy WED02 : Land off Ilfracombe Hill

(1) Site off Ilfracombe Hill, as shown on Policies Map 72, is proposed for residential development that includes approximately 15 dwellings, including affordable homes, with an emphasis on providing a mix of house types and sizes to reflect local need.

(2) The site should be developed in accordance with the following specific development principles:

- (a) separate vehicular and pedestrian accesses from Ilfracombe Hill;**
- (b) an opportunity being safeguarded for future vehicular access to the land south of the site;**
- (c) enhancement of the existing hedgerows along the western and southern boundaries to ensure the development is integrated into the landscape;**
- (d) design, layout and additional planting that minimises the impact of development on existing residential properties;**
- (e) the historic setting of the listed building at The Old Vicarage being safeguarded; and**
- (f) adequate contribution toward addressing deficiency in the capacity or performance of the sewage treatment works to enable the development to proceed.**

12.888 The site is well related to the existing settlement and with a suitable design and landscaping scheme can be developed without undue harm to the landscape setting of the village. The site slopes from north to south. Development will provide a range of dwellings of sizes and types that address local community needs. The site will provide the majority of new dwellings required in the village over the plan period.

12.889 Vehicular access to the development should be from a single point off Ilfracombe Hill through upgrading the existing track to the south of Pearldean, with a future access being safeguarded to land to the south, outside of the development boundary. A separate pedestrian access to Ilfracombe Hill will be provided along the existing public footpath through the site to provide access to the development from the village centre.

¹¹⁵ 7 dwellings from completions, under construction and extant planning permissions since 2011

12.890 The western boundary will require enhancement of the existing hedgerow to integrate the development into its countryside setting. Enhanced landscaping on the southern part of the site will provide a visual and amenity buffer between the development and the adjoining sewage works to the south-west of the site. A number of established properties border the site, including the Grade II listed Old Vicarage. Detailed design, layout and landscaping should minimise the impact of development on properties in the immediate area. A satisfactory relationship between these properties and new housing is required in order to protect the amenities of both.

Historic Environment

12.891 West Down does not have a conservation area. Should the local community identify the need for a future designation to protect the historic core of the village during the plan period, then it would be supported. There are other historic assets outside the village core, including a field pattern retaining medieval strip farming.

Community Facilities

12.892 West Down primary school and pre-school is an important local community facility. Other facilities in the village include a community shop, public house, allotments and village hall with an outreach post office. Additional open spaces, equipped play areas and green infrastructure facilities will be supported on the community field at Chapel Meadow, off Farriel Lane.

12.893 The general policies of the Local Plan seek to retain and protect such services and facilities, and proposals that involve their loss will be considered against these policies. Provision of appropriate additional facilities to meet locally generated needs will be supported in accordance with the West Down spatial strategy and general policies of the Local Plan.

Woolfardisworthy (Woolsery)

The Place

12.894 Woolsery is a substantial village south of the A39 Strategic Route and the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty, approximately 13 kilometres (8 miles) west of Bideford. The surrounding area is largely agricultural with the parish area extending to the coast at Bucks Mills. The village is located on the high plateau, inland from the coast.

12.895 The settlement has a range of services including a modern village hall, primary school, convenience store and post office, vehicle repairs/petrol station, play area and sports pitch. Hotel and pub facilities in the village have closed.

12.896 Local employment is primarily in the service sector, related to agriculture or in tourism activities in the area and there is no dedicated employment area in the village. Bideford is the nearest location for a wider range of employment activities and services and there is a limited regular bus service connection.

12.897 The village has a number of listed buildings including, and concentrated around, the Grade I listed Parish Church of Allhallows, but no conservation area.

12.898 The local sewage treatment works has limited capacity for up to approximately 15 additional dwellings and any development above this level will require detailed investigation of capacity.

Spatial Strategy

12.899 The local community has identified, through the preparation of the current and previous Parish Plans, the importance of retaining the local community spirit in the parish and has identified a number of issues of importance for the future development of Woolsery which include:

1. the need for smaller, affordable, housing to assist young people and families to remain in the village;
2. improvements in local healthcare provision;
3. protection and expansion of local services and facilities, including the provision of allotments;
4. support for increased local employment opportunities;
5. improvements to public transport provision and the reduction in use of private cars in view of their environmental impacts and use of narrow rural roads;
6. protection of the countryside around the village; and
7. reducing dependence on fossil fuels.

Policy WFD: Woolfardisworthy (Woolsery) Spatial Strategy

Over the period to 2031, the Local Plan will enable growth of high quality development supported by necessary infrastructure to meet the needs of Woolsery. The spatial vision for Woolsery will be delivered through:

- (a) provision of a minimum of 14 new dwellings to meet a range of housing needs in the community. The supply of housing will be delivered through extant planning**

permissions supplemented by acceptable new proposals within the development boundary;

(b) support for the retention and improvement of village facilities and services to meet the needs of the local community;

(c) support for appropriate additional employment to address local needs;

(d) retaining the character of the village and protection of the local and natural environment; and

(e) support for improved public transport services and measures to reduce car use.

Development Proposals

12.900 Villages have a role in providing services and development opportunities to address locally generated and quantified needs. This role will be supported in a range of ways.

12.901 A development boundary for Woolsery is defined on Policies Map 73. The general approach of the Local Plan relating to identified villages will apply, which supports development opportunities appropriate to the scale of the locality.

Employment

12.902 Any new employment in the village is likely to be small scale, although the village can capitalise on enhanced levels of assistance offered by Assisted Area status. No specific site is allocated for economic development, although proposals will be considered in terms of Policy DM12: Employment Development in Towns, Local Centres and Villages, of the Local Plan. The expansion of existing businesses will also be considered in terms of the general Local Plan policies. Specific proposals would be supported if they accord with the general policies of the Local Plan and the spatial strategy for Woolsery.

Housing

12.903 No specific sites are allocated in Woolsery for general housing development although a number of opportunities for small scale development may be available within the village. The general approach of the Local Plan relating to identified villages will apply, which supports development opportunities appropriate to the scale of the locality.

12.904 A need for affordable property has been identified. Any sites considered suitable outside of the development boundary will be released only in accordance with Policy ST19: Affordable Housing on Exception Sites.

Services and Facilities

12.905 Retention of existing facilities and village services will be subject to the general policies of the Local Plan. Provision of appropriate additional services and facilities to meet locally generated needs, including allotments and medical services, will be supported in accordance with the Woolsery Spatial Strategy and general Local Plan policies.



13 Development Management Policies

Sustainable Development - Environmental Protection

Amenity Considerations

Policy DM01: Amenity Considerations

Development will be supported where:

- (a) it would not significantly harm the amenities of any neighbouring occupiers or uses; and
- (b) the intended occupants of the proposed development would not be harmed as a result of existing or allocated uses.

13.1 Development must have regard to the importance of protecting residential and other amenities. People are entitled to enjoy their own homes or public places without undue disturbance or intrusion from neighbouring uses. Good neighbourliness and fairness are some of the yardsticks against which proposals can be measured.

13.2 Some types of development, particularly employment uses, can damage the environment of residential areas by creating unacceptable levels of traffic and pollution such as noise, smell, dust or vibration. Similarly, unneighbourly uses such as sewage treatment works should not be permitted near residential areas, as these are likely to result in problems of nuisance to nearby residents. Conversely, new residential development or sensitive uses should not be permitted within close proximity to potentially unneighbourly uses as it may prejudice their functioning and cause future problems.

13.3 Amenity considerations relating to the extent that people are entitled to enjoy their own homes or public places without undue disturbance or intrusion from neighbouring uses include:

- (a) privacy and daylight: securing adequate privacy and preventing the loss of daylight through overshadowing can be achieved by ensuring adequate distance between properties, use of screen walls, natural greening, fencing, orientation, angles, and careful arrangements of windows;
- (b) light intrusion: poorly designed lighting can result in the spillage of light into the countryside, impact on residential amenities and increase sky glow. Development proposals need to minimise unnecessarily obtrusive and glaring light by design, direction and appropriate levels of brightness;
- (c) noise and vibration: it is particularly important to minimise the impact of noise and vibrations in sensitive locations and buildings such as residential areas, hospitals, schools and areas valued for their tranquillity including Sites of Special Scientific Interest, the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty, Heritage Coast and the wider countryside. Noise and vibration problems may be resolved by careful attention to site layout, sound insulation measures and barriers including the orientation of buildings, vegetation and bunds; and
- (d) unpleasant emissions: these emissions are defined as smell, fumes, smoke, soot, ash, dust or grit. The source of emissions can originate from a variety of uses including industrial uses and food preparation uses such as restaurants and take-aways.

13.4 These amenity considerations are material to planning considerations and should be taken into account in assessing all development proposals. Policy DM01: Amenity Considerations is primarily concerned with protecting residential amenities; however it is equally applicable to proposals that would have a harmful effect on existing residential and non-residential development. It is particularly important to ensure that existing industries or businesses are not faced with additional costs in order to overcome any environmental health problems following the location of a new development such as housing.

13.5 Mixed use development reduces the need to travel but raises potential conflict between uses. These can be reduced by the careful consideration of siting within larger development.

13.6 In addition to the amenity considerations, the siting of development will also be influenced by other policies in this Local Plan, including Design (Policies ST04: Improving the Quality of Development and DM04: Design Principles) and issues relating to public health and safety and the implications of pollution in the environment (Policy DM02: Environmental Protection).

Environmental considerations

Policy DM02: Environmental Protection

Hazards

(1) Development will be supported where it does not cause an unacceptable risk to public health and safety due to:

- (a) coastal erosion or land instability;**
- (b) its siting on known or suspected contaminated land which is unsuitable for the use proposed; or**
- (c) the storage or use of hazardous substance;**

unless taking account of appropriate remedial, preventative or precautionary measures to remove, reduce or mitigate risk to an acceptable level.

Pollution

(2) Development will be supported where it does not result in unacceptable impacts to:

- (a) atmospheric pollution by gas or particulates, including smell, fumes, dust, grit, smoke and soot;**
- (b) pollution of surface or ground water (fresh and salt) including rivers, canals, other watercourses, water bodies, wetlands, water gathering grounds including catchment areas, aquifers, groundwater protection areas, harbours, estuaries or the sea;**
- (c) noise or vibration; and**
- (d) light pollution (sky glow, light intrusion and light spillage), where light overflows on to areas not intended to be lit. Areas particularly sensitive to light pollution include tranquil areas of open countryside, in particular areas of nature conservation value and Exmoor National Park's Dark Sky Reserve.**

Air Quality Management Area

(3) Development and traffic proposals that help to deliver measures identified within a Local Air Quality Action Plan or improved overall air quality will be supported.

13.7 Pollution in the environment has significant implications for people's health and quality of life. Generally there are three types of hazards which have implications for the location of development:

- (a) natural hazards, such as coastal erosion, land instability or naturally occurring carcinogens (e.g. radon gas), which may threaten existing or proposed development;
- (b) man-made hazards including contamination from past activities which may also threaten existing or proposed development; and
- (c) proposed developments which create a hazard to the existing land uses, local people or the wider environment due to the nature of their activities.

13.8 The main concern of planning is how these hazards may affect the current and future uses of land. These hazards and the possible pollution effects from proposed development will be planning considerations insofar as they affect development and the use of land.

13.9 Where the Councils consider a development may raise such issues, the relevant statutory hazard/pollution control authorities will be consulted at an early stage in the planning process. Key consultees include the Councils' own Environmental Health (North Devon)/ Environmental Protection (Torridge) Services, the Environment Agency, Health and Safety Executive, Public Health England and Coal Authority.

13.10 The Government encourages the full and effective use of land that has previously been developed. Previously developed land, and occasionally greenfield land, may have been contaminated by past activities or is unstable, for example, through mining activity. Where land is suspected or known to be contaminated or unstable, new development will not be permitted unless it is demonstrated that the site is safe for the intended use or that any problems have been adequately dealt with (as detailed in paragraphs 13.19 and 13.20). It should be recognised that in developing a contaminated site, some contaminants such as gases may escape creating risks to health and safety and the environment over a wide area. The contamination of a site may also result in the pollution of groundwater and the wider water environment.

13.11 It is vital that uses with the potential to cause hazards are properly sited and controlled to overcome any risk to human health and safety and the wider environment. Similarly, uses that may be affected by hazards should either be kept away from its sources or protected by other means. It is particularly important to locate new development away from an existing pollution installation where it would lead to the imposition of very high standards of emission control at considerable expense to the industry involved. Such a financial burden may lead to the closure of a business and the loss of jobs. It is also important to ensure that a proposal does not result in a deterioration of air quality to below national standards as a result of, for example, traffic generation and heating services associated with development. Air quality statements will be required to be submitted with planning applications in such circumstances.

13.12 Specific to the South West peninsula is the naturally occurring hazard radon gas, a known carcinogen. Radon is a naturally occurring radioactive gas present in variable amounts in rock and soils. It is recognised there is a possible risk of raised radon levels in older properties, though modern buildings techniques protection and remediation measures can address potential problems. Appropriate account should be taken of the potential accumulation of radon in buildings in any development proposals.

13.13 Exmoor National Park has been recognised as Europe's first International Dark Sky Reserve by the International Dark Sky Association. It is one of the few areas of southern England still relatively free from mass sources of light pollution, allowing exceptionally starry skies. The experience of the night sky is a valued quality of Exmoor and an important part of the wilderness experience. Local councils, landowners, businesses and communities have made a commitment to work together to reduce the impact of light pollution on Exmoor's Dark Sky Reserve.

13.14 Lighting from towns such as Barnstaple, Ilfracombe and South Molton is often reflected from clouds and the skyline of the north coast of Exmoor is brightly lit as a result of lighting in South Wales. Sympathetically designed development will help minimise light pollution and sky glow from northern Devon settlements. Across northern Devon, lighting should be designed to safeguard Dark Skies over Exmoor National Park.

13.15 'Light pollution' refers to the effect of over-lighting resulting from poorly designed lighting schemes and excessive levels of light. It is commonly subdivided into sky glow, glare and light spillage (or trespass). 'Sky glow' is the glow (often coloured, depending on the light source) caused by a scattering of artificial light by dust particles and water droplets in the sky and can be seen over considerable distances. It is closely related to the ratio of light thrown upwards by lights in the area. 'Glare' is the uncomfortable brightness of a light source when viewed against a darker background. A light source's luminous intensity in candelas (cd) gives an indication of levels of glare. 'Light spillage' is the spill of light beyond the boundary of the property on which a light is located. It can be estimated from the luminous intensity in candelas of the light source but a more accurate guide is measured at the boundaries or windows of properties.

13.16 The Campaign for the Protection of Rural England has identified northern Devon as one of the most tranquil areas in Devon and the UK. The area is recognised for its low levels of light and noise pollution, where Lundy Island is particularly tranquil. Where Design and Access Statements are required, development will be expected to demonstrate how lighting has been designed to minimise the impact of light spillage and pollution into the surrounding environment.

13.17 Pollution will affect wildlife, impacts on designated sites, protected species and migration/feeding routes should be avoided or minimised. Some species of bats are particularly sensitive to light pollution. Water quality is very important to tourism and shellfish stocks (Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy). Potential pollution impacts from major development are required to be screened and scoped through an Environmental Impact Assessment.

13.18 The Water Framework Directive introduced a holistic approach to the management of water quality and requires all inland and coastal water to reach at least 'good' status by 2015. This requires water management planning at river basin level and there is a need for development to ensure that water quality is not adversely impacted and opportunities for improvement are sought.

13.19 Environmental hazards and pollution must be identified early in the development process to ensure that appropriate mitigation measures are taken. This should take the form of a source – pathway – receptor assessment. Where for example the sources of the hazard (e.g. heavy metal contamination), the receptors (e.g. public water supply borehole) and the pathway connecting the two (e.g. contaminated groundwater plumes) are considered. Risks proposed can then be assessed and suitable mitigation put in place to reduce the risks to an acceptable level. The Councils require the investigation and remediation proposals to be undertaken by the developer either before planning permission has been granted or by means of planning condition.

13.20 Where a risk to public health and safety is identified, the Councils will require appropriate information to enable a sound planning decision to be made. Outline applications will not usually be appropriate for these types of development and a Health Impact Assessment will be required. This assessment will need to include a detailed technical appraisal of the site and development

and its relationship to the surrounding area. It will also need to include appropriate remedial, preventative or precautionary measures to remove, reduce or mitigate potential problems in developing the site for the use proposed.

13.21 Part IV of the Environment Act 1995 introduced the concept of local air quality management. Local authorities are required to review and assess local air quality against national standards and objectives. The Councils are required to take a proactive role in assessing and controlling air quality within their area. Braunton village centre has been designated as an Air Quality Management Area. The area has been designated in relation to a likely breach of the nitrogen dioxide (annual mean) objective as specified in the Air Quality Regulations 2000. The Air Quality Management Area Order came in to effect on 11 July 2011. An Air Quality Action Plan will be prepared to address the likely breach. The Councils will not support development where anticipated traffic generation would make air quality worse.

Waste Management and Reduction

Policy DM03: Construction and Environmental Management

(1) All development that will generate a significant volume of construction and operational waste will be required to demonstrate through a waste audit statement how the waste will be minimised, and residual waste will be reused or recycled on site, or segregated for reuse and recovery elsewhere in accordance with the waste hierarchy.

(2) Development adjacent to an existing or planned waste management facility will be required to demonstrate that the proposed development does not prevent, hinder or unreasonably restrict the operation of the waste development.

(3) Development that will generate a significant volume of operational waste will be required to demonstrate that its impact on the highway network is not severe and must provide adequate site access for the type and volume of vehicles that will be using the development.

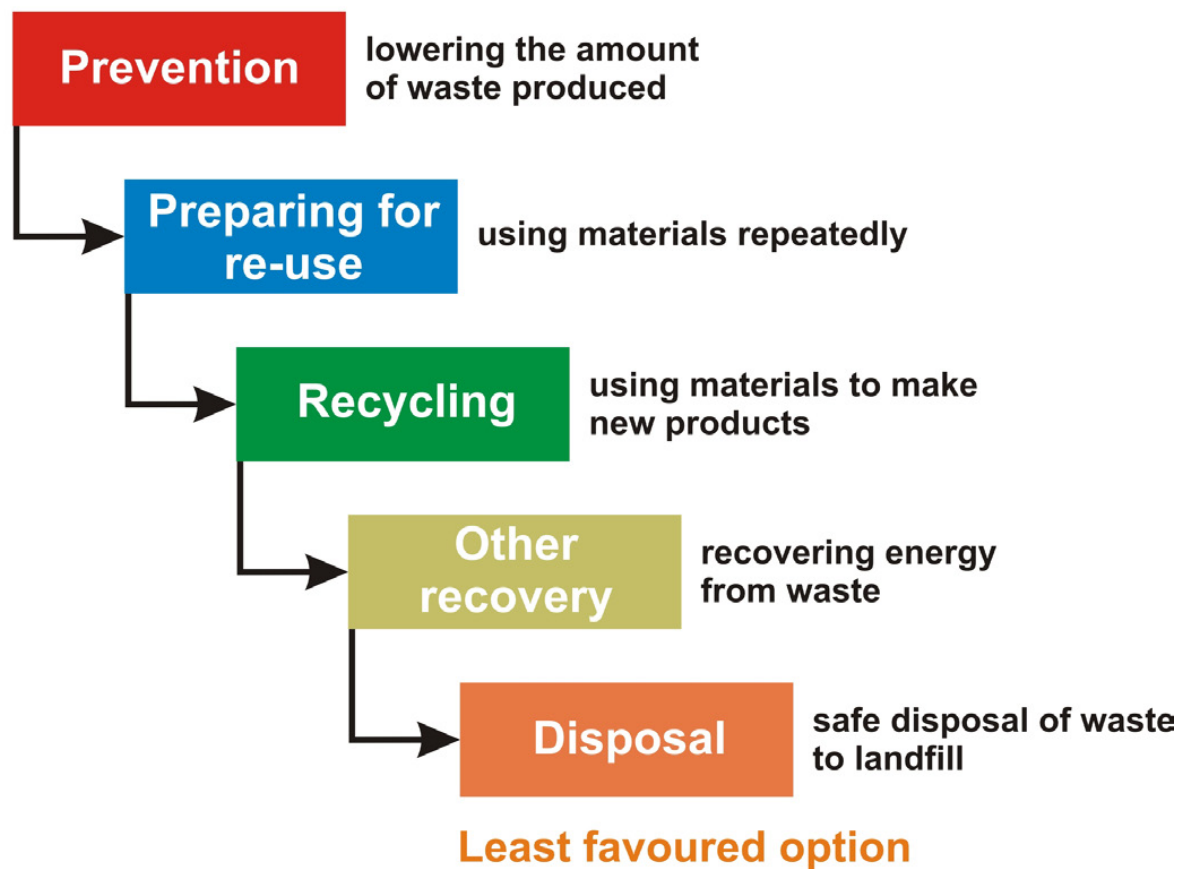
(4) Management of waste from proposed development will be expected to accord with the Devon Waste Plan.

13.22 The current planning guidance is the National Planning Policy for Waste and the National Waste Management Plan for England.

The Waste Hierarchy

13.23 Ranked according to environmental impact, Article 4 of the revised EU Waste Framework Directive (contained in law through the Waste (England & Wales) Regulations 2011) sets out five steps for dealing with waste. Prevention, which offers the best outcomes for the environment, is at the top of the priority order, followed by preparing for re-use, recycling, other types of recovery (including energy recovery) and disposal (e.g. landfill), in descending order of environmental preference. The approach has been further endorsed by the Government Review of Waste Policy in England (2011).

Figure 13.1 Waste Hierarchy

Most favoured option

13.24 The definitions of each of the stages can be found in Article 3 of the revised EU Waste Framework Directive. Non-exhaustive lists of disposal and recovery operations can be found in Annexes I and II of the Directive.

Prevention means measures taken before a substance, material or product has become waste, that reduce:

- (a) the quantity of waste, including through the re-use of products or the extension of the life span of products;
- (i) the adverse impacts of the generated waste on the environment and human health;
- or

- (ii) the content of harmful substances in materials and products;

(b) re-use means any operation by which products or components that are not waste are used again for the same purpose for which they were conceived;

(c) preparing for re-use means checking, cleaning or repairing recovery operations, by which products or components of products that have become waste are prepared so that they can be re-used without any other pre-processing;

(d) recycling means any recovery operation by which waste materials are reprocessed into products, materials or substances whether for the original or other purposes. It includes the reprocessing of organic material but does not include energy recovery and the reprocessing into materials;

(e) recovery means any operation, the principal result of which is waste serving a useful purpose by replacing other materials which would otherwise have been used to fulfil a particular function, or waste being prepared to fulfil that function, in the plant or in the wider economy; and

(f) disposal means any operation which is not recovery even where the operation has as a secondary consequence the reclamation of substances or energy.

13.25 To minimise waste and the impact of waste on the environment, the Local Planning Authorities expect future developments to support the waste management hierarchy. The waste hierarchy gives top priority to preventing waste in the first place. When waste is created, it gives priority to preparing it for re-use, then recycling, then other recovery such as energy recovery, and last of all disposal.

13.26 To ensure waste is dealt with at as high a level as possible on the waste hierarchy and to protect amenities and prevent pollution, the waste implications of all new development must be considered. It is also important that existing waste management facilities are safeguarded from the development of non-waste related uses.

13.27 Planning applications relating to the use of land and buildings for the purposes of waste management are determined by Devon County Council. The Devon Waste Plan, prepared by the County Council, forms part of the Development Plan. Any waste management development must be in accordance with the adopted policies in that document.

Managing waste from development

13.28 All development will make a contribution, financial or otherwise, sufficient to meet the waste management need associated with their proposals. On-site facilities for separating or storing waste should be designed within a development and to meet adequately the needs of that development.

13.29 Where waste storage facilities are required, its provision might include on-site treatment facilities such as community composting, or in the case of industrial operations, the management of specific wastes produced on site. On smaller sites, provision will include collection points for segregated waste. The Councils expect all development proposals to design for the storage of waste bins / wheelie bins.

13.30 To assess waste resulting from a development's construction phase, a waste management plan will be required for all major developments and other developments that will generate a significant volume of waste. Site waste management plans must demonstrate how construction will take place in accordance with the waste hierarchy. Devon County Council, as the waste local authority, will provide advice on the threshold requirements for and potential content of a site waste management plan. In addition, development may need to produce a Construction Environment Management Plan as set out in the Environment Agency's Pollution Prevention Guidelines⁽¹¹⁶⁾.

13.31 The Local Planning Authority requires all major developments to submit a waste audit statement to identify how the waste and its impacts will be managed and minimised during the operational phase. This phase broadly begins with occupation and covers the daily operation of the development.

13.32 All development will be assessed against extant guidance and in particular Making Space for Waste, published in June 2010 by the Association of Directors of Environment, Economy, Planning and Transport. This report establishes specifications for the minimum standards for the

116 Pollution Planning Guidance 6 – Working at construction and demolition sites (Environment Agency 2010)

type, and scale of facilities and vehicular manoeuvrability needed for new residential, commercial and mixed-use developments.

Safeguarding Existing Waste Management Facilities

13.33 The introduction of new development near to an existing or permitted waste management facility may lead to the existing or potential future capacity of the facility being compromised. Therefore, any potential conflicts between the proposed development and existing or permitted waste management facilities need to be considered. It will be necessary for the developer to provide a report addressing any potential conflicts between the development and existing waste facilities.

13.34 To safeguard existing or permitted waste management facilities the Local Planning Authorities will consult the County Council on any planning applications adjacent to such a site. Information on existing waste management facilities is available from the Waste Planning Authority. Consideration will be given to whether there is any potential conflict between the facilities and the proposed new development. Policy W10 (Protection of Waste Management Capacity) of the Devon Waste Plan sets out how the County Council assess proposals adjacent to waste management facilities. Any mitigation required to minimise the adverse impact will be the responsibility of the developer of the new proposal.

Design Principles

13.35 All development will be expected to be of high quality. It will need to integrate effectively with its surroundings, reinforce local distinctiveness and conserve and where appropriate enhance cultural and heritage assets and their settings.

Policy DM04: Design Principles

(1) Good design seeks to guide overall scale, density, massing, height, landscape, layout, materials, access and appearance of new development. It seeks not just to manage land use but support the creation of successful places and respond to the challenges of climate change. Development proposals need to have regard to the following design principles:

(a) are appropriate and sympathetic to setting in terms of scale, density, massing, height, layout appearance, fenestration, materials and relationship to buildings and landscape features in the local neighbourhood;

(b) reinforce the key characteristics and special qualities of the area in which the development is proposed;

(c) are accessible to all, flexible to adaptation and innovative;

(d) contribute positively to local distinctiveness, historic environment and sense of place;

(e) create inclusive environments that are legible, connected and facilitate the ease of movement and permeability through the site, allowing everyone to easily understand and find their way around;

(f) retain and integrate existing landscape features and biodiversity to enhance networks and promote diversity and distinctiveness of the surrounding area;

(g) provide public and private spaces that are well designed, safe, attractive and complement the built form, designed to minimise anti-social and criminal behaviour;

- (h) provide safe and appropriate highway access and incorporate adequate well-integrated car parking, pedestrian and cycle routes and facilities;**
- (i) ensure the amenities of existing and future neighbouring occupiers are safeguarded;**
- (j) incorporate appropriate infrastructure to enable connection to fast ICT networks;**
- (k) optimise the efficient use of land, and provide well-designed adaptable street patterns and minimise functionless open spaces;**
- (l) create and sustain an appropriate mix of uses and support local facilities and transport networks;**
- (m) consider opportunities for public art; and**
- (n) provide effective water management including Sustainable Drainage Systems, water efficiency measures and the reuse of rainwater.**

(2) All major residential proposals will be expected to be supported by a Building for Life 12 (BfL12)⁽¹¹⁷⁾ (or successor) assessment. High quality design should be demonstrated through the minimisation of "amber" and the avoidance of "red" scores.

13.36 All new developments should achieve high quality design that is sustainable and inclusive, both in the short term and over the lifetime of the development. Good design will result in variable densities that need to have regard to the above design principles: (a)-(n). Design must respect its context (including heritage assets as set out in Policy DM07: Historic Environment), promote or reinforce local distinctiveness and take opportunities to improve the character and quality of an area. In support of achieving high design standards in respect of character, function and sustainability, all major residential developments will be evaluated using the Building for Life 12 (BfL 12) assessment. To demonstrate the achievement of an optimum design outcome, 'amber' scores of a BfL 12 assessment should be minimised and 'red' scores avoided. To ensure the attainment of good design and the required design standards, early and meaningful engagement with the Local Planning Authority is encouraged.

13.37 Neighbourhood Plans, Village Design Statements, Conservation Area Character Appraisals and similar documents prepared by local communities, will be used to achieve high quality design.

13.38 Spaces in the public realm should be safe, attractive and uncluttered, working effectively for all sectors of the community including the mobility impaired and the elderly. They should also be well related to the surrounding buildings. Streets form an important part of the public realm and their style and appearance should reflect principles of good design identified in the 'Manual for Streets 2' and Historic England's 'Streets for All'⁽¹¹⁸⁾.

13.39 Layouts should be designed to promote accessibility for all and local permeability by creating places that connect with each other and are easy to move through, putting people before traffic and integrating land uses and transport. The design and layout of a development will also be expected to incorporate features to increase safety and reduce opportunities for crime and anti-social behaviour, such as by increasing the amount of natural surveillance within a development. Secured by Design (or successor standards) will support new development to create a safer and more secure environment.

¹¹⁷ www.designcouncil.org

¹¹⁸ <https://historicengland.org.uk/images-books/publications/streets-for-all/>

13.40 Adequate parking provision for new development will be based on accessibility to the main towns through the public transport network, recognising that opportunities to reduce car usage are greatest where alternative transport options are available.

13.41 New development should promote adaptability in order to respond to changing demographic, economic and technological conditions. The form of a building should allow for flexibility in order to adapt to changing lifestyles and circumstances.

13.42 Development proposals can promote legibility by providing recognisable routes, interactions and landmarks to help people find their way around. Master planning of new developments should reflect the principles of Sport England's 'Active Design' ⁽¹¹⁹⁾

Highways

Policy DM05: Highways

(1) All development must ensure safe and well designed vehicular access and egress, adequate parking and layouts which consider the needs and accessibility of all highway users including cyclists and pedestrians.

(2) All development shall protect and enhance existing public rights of way, footways, cycleways and bridleways and facilitate improvements to existing or provide new connections to these routes where practical to do so.

13.43 An effective transport network is essential to the local economy and social well-being of residents. New roads will be designed to allow for the safe, easy and expedient movement of vehicles appropriate to the function of the route (particularly for larger vehicles such as buses, refuse collection and goods vehicles) which should be achieved through appropriate design, such as the width of the carriageway, radius of bends and adequate visibility as agreed with the Highway Authority and in accordance with 'Manual for Streets 1 and 2' ⁽¹²⁰⁾

13.44 The transport impact of any development will need to be assessed, with any impacts minimised through sustainable development principles, such as creating genuinely safe and attractive routes for walking, cycling and reaching local facilities with ease. Any residual impacts should be minimised through practical measures, such as, but not limited to, modification of the transport infrastructure to provide additional capacity, or offsetting any impact through other measures including bus infrastructure improvements.

13.45 Development proposals that would give rise to significant levels of vehicular movement and are likely to create or exacerbate a particular traffic problem or have an impact on the local highway network must be accompanied by a Transport Assessment and a Travel Plan. Other development proposals, where it is agreed that the resulting transport issues are limited, should be accompanied by a Transport Statement and a Travel Plan. Transport Assessments, Statements and Travel Plans should be appropriate to the scale and impact of the proposed development.

13.46 Applicants are advised to undertake pre-application discussions with the planning authority in order to establish whether or not a development is likely to have an impact on transport networks and to identify the appropriate level of assessment necessary to accompany any planning application.

¹¹⁹ <https://www.sportengland.org/facilities-planning/active-design/>

¹²⁰ <https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/manual-for-streets>

13.47 Ensuring adequate car parking facilities are provided to cater for new residents and businesses can also contribute towards the safe and free flow of traffic. Development must provide for adequate parking that actively aims to reduce the likelihood of inappropriate parking on the highway which could conflict with the aforementioned aims. Policy DM06: Parking Provision, provides further detail on parking requirements.

Parking Provision

Policy DM06: Parking Provision

(1) Development proposals will be expected to provide an appropriate scale and range of parking provision to meet anticipated needs, having regard to the:

- (a) accessibility and sustainability of the site;**
- (b) availability of public transport;**
- (c) provision of safe walking and cycling routes; and**
- (d) specific scale, type and mix of development.**

(2) Proposals must encourage the use of sustainable modes of transport through careful design, layout and integration to the existing built form.

13.48 The Local Plan recognises that due to the rural nature of northern Devon and the limited availability of public transport, there is likely to be a continuing dependence upon the private motor car. As such it is important that development proposals provide adequate parking provision to meet anticipated needs. There is a recognition that the scale and nature of provision will vary between development proposals dependant upon the location and nature of the development. As such, the Local Plan adopts a flexible criteria based approach to provision that enables development proposals to respond to local circumstances.

13.49 Development should incorporate adequate parking provision of a scale and type to meet the anticipated needs that will be generated by the proposed uses and reflecting the context of the site including its sustainability and accessibility. Policy applies to all types of parking provision for all forms of transport and proposals should have regard to the parking provision likely to be required by all users. Proposals should consider the provision that is required for motor vehicles such as cars, buses, lorries and motor cycles along with bicycles and other forms of transport. Regard should also be given to the specialist parking needs of certain parts of the community such as those with disabilities or parents with young children.

13.50 Parking provision should be carefully designed and integrated into development proposals having regard to the principles of Policy DM04: Design Principles.

13.51 Recognising the transition to a low carbon economy and a move to lower emission transport, regard should be given, as part of the provision of an appropriate range of parking, to providing electric vehicle charging infrastructure.

13.52 Policy DM06: Parking Provision seeks to encourage the use of sustainable modes of transport. Proposals should maximise opportunities to integrate access to public transport provision and to encourage safe walking and cycling. Such opportunities might arise through the provision of bus stops in accessible locations, introduction of additional bus routes or services or the provision of safe, accessible and integrated cycle ways and footpaths.

13.53 For major development proposals the scale and nature of parking provision should be informed and linked to a Transport Assessment and Travel Plan as required by Policy ST10: Transport Strategy.

Historic Environment

Policy DM07: Historic Environment

(1) All proposals affecting heritage assets should be accompanied by sufficient information, in the form of a Heritage Statement, to enable the impact of the proposal on the significance of the heritage asset and its setting to be properly assessed. As part of such an assessment, consideration should be given, in order of preference, for avoiding any harm, providing enhancement, then minimising and mitigating any harm.

(2) Proposals which conserve and enhance heritage assets and their settings will be supported. Where there is unavoidable harm to heritage assets and their settings, proposals will only be supported where the harm is minimised as far as possible, and an acceptable balance between harm and benefit can be achieved in line with the national policy tests, giving great weight to the conservation of heritage assets.

(3) Proposals to improve the energy efficiency of, or to generate renewable energy from, historic buildings or surrounding these heritage assets will be supported where:

- (a) there is no significant harm or degradation of historic fabric including traditional windows; and**
- (b) equivalent carbon dioxide emission savings cannot be achieved by alternative siting or design that would have a less severe impact on the integrity of heritage assets.**

13.54 The historic environment is a non-renewable resource of great cultural, social, economic and environmental value. It contributes significantly to the quality of life and to the character of northern Devon. For this reason, there is a presumption in favour of preservation in-situ of heritage assets and their settings, including important views and vistas.

13.55 National planning policy provides guidance on the identification, significance and protection of heritage assets. These assets, which may be designated or undesignated include:

- conservation areas, listed buildings and scheduled ancient monuments;
- historic parks and gardens;
- archaeological remains;
- locally listed buildings;
- historic cores of settlements which are not conservation areas;
- historic buildings currently not included on the local or national lists; and
- landscape features including ancient woodland and veteran trees, field patterns, water courses, historic hedgebanks/hedgerows/orchards and trees subject to tree preservation orders.

13.56 The contents of the Heritage Statement should be proportionate to the effects of the proposal. It should describe and explain the nature of the significance of the asset(s) affected. It should outline the proposed works, identify the potential for harm to significance arising from these works, and if necessary mitigation measures. Developers will be required to make a proportionate but systematic assessment of the impact on setting as set down in the guidance

from Historic England: The Setting of Heritage Assets (2015), or any replacement guidance. In some circumstances mitigation may take the form of preservation by record and this may be secured by condition. A Heritage Statement may form part of a Design and Access Statement.

13.57 Heritage assets by their nature are often locally distinctive and contribute positively to the character of the area. Proposals directly relating to heritage assets should maintain locally distinctive features and materials. Proposals for new development should seek opportunities to draw on the historic environment in order to maintain and enhance local character and distinctiveness. Areas of archaeological importance will be safeguarded. Guidance on how to assess and protect such assets if uncovered during archaeological investigation of a site, or its subsequent development, will be provided through a supplementary planning document.

13.58 A significant pressure is to reduce carbon dioxide emissions by improving energy efficiency of historic buildings and generation of renewable energy on the roof or in curtilage of a listed building. Opportunities to address these issues within or surrounding heritage assets without harming their historic integrity will be supported, provided that opportunities for alternative design, siting and renewable energy technologies have been investigated to identify the proposals that would have least impact on the historic fabric and integrity of heritage assets. Details of alternatives investigated and any assessment of their relative impacts on heritage assets would need to be provided alongside any development proposals considered against Policy DM07(3). Traditional doors and windows that form an integral part of a heritage asset's historic fabric should be safeguarded.

Biodiversity and Geodiversity

Policy DM08: Biodiversity and Geodiversity

(1) Development should conserve, protect and, where possible, enhance biodiversity and geodiversity interests and soils commensurate with their status and giving appropriate weight to their importance. All development must ensure that the importance of habitats and designated sites are taken into account and consider opportunities for the creation of a local and district-wide biodiversity network of wildlife corridors which link County Wildlife Sites and other areas of biodiversity importance.

European Sites

(2) The highest level of protection will be given to potential and existing Special Protection Areas, candidate and existing Special Areas of Conservation and listed or proposed Ramsar sites. Proposals having an adverse impact on the integrity of such areas that cannot be avoided or adequately mitigated to remove any adverse effect will not be permitted other than in exceptional circumstances. These circumstances will only apply where there are:

(a) no alternative solutions;

(b) imperative reasons of overriding public interest; and

(c) necessary compensatory provisions secured to ensure that the overall coherence of the Natura 2000 network of European sites is protected.

(3) Development will only be supported where any necessary mitigation is included such that, in combination with other plans or projects, there will be no adverse effects on the integrity of European Nature Conservation Sites.

National Sites

(4) Development proposals within or outside a Site of Special Scientific Interest or Marine Conservation Zone which would be likely to affect the designation adversely, either individually or in combination with other developments, will not be supported unless the benefits of the development at this site clearly outweigh both the adverse impacts on the site and any adverse impacts on the wider network of Sites of Special Scientific Interest and Marine Conservation Zones.

Local Sites

(5) Development likely to affect adversely locally designated sites, their features or their function as part of the ecological network, including County Wildlife Sites, County Geological Sites and sites supporting Biodiversity Action Plan habitats and species, will only be permitted where the need for and benefits of the development clearly outweigh the loss, and the coherence of the local ecological network is maintained.

Protected Species and Habitats

(6) Adverse impacts on European and UK protected species and Biodiversity Action Plan habitats and species must be avoided wherever possible, subject to:

- (i) the legal tests afforded to them where applicable; or otherwise unless**
- (ii) the need for and benefits clearly outweigh the loss.**

Ancient Woodland and Veteran Trees

(7) Development must avoid the loss or deterioration of ancient woodland and veteran trees, unless the need for, or benefits of development on that site clearly outweigh the loss.

Avoidance, Mitigation and Compensation for Biodiversity and Geodiversity Impacts

(8) Development should avoid adverse impact on existing features as a first principle and enable net gains by designing in biodiversity features and enhancements and opportunities for geological conservation alongside new development. Where adverse impacts are unavoidable they must be adequately and proportionately mitigated. If full mitigation cannot be provided, compensation will be required as a last resort.

13.59 New development will contribute towards a net gain in northern Devon's biodiversity. It is vital that all stages of the development process are informed by appropriate ecological information, from site selection and design to long-term management and monitoring, in accordance with relevant British standards⁽¹²¹⁾. Necessary survey work must be undertaken at relevant times of years. All likely effects on biodiversity and geodiversity should be considered, both positive and negative including direct and indirect, cumulative, onsite and offsite impacts over the lifetime of the development. Consideration should also be given to disturbance effects during construction, operational and restoration phases. The value of biodiversity and geodiversity assets will include their contribution to the local biodiversity and green infrastructure networks. The protection given to designated sites will be in accordance with their status within the hierarchy of designated sites. Policy DM08: Biodiversity and Geodiversity will be managed in a way that is proportionate to the scale of development concerned.

13.60 Biodiversity should be protected and enhanced where possible, with any potential adverse effects addressed sequentially in accordance with the 'mitigation hierarchy':

121 BS42020: Biodiversity in Planning and Development

- a) avoid
- b) reduce, moderate, minimise
- c) rescue and translocate
- d) compensate and offset.

The 'mitigation hierarchy' will not apply in respect of protected species and criteria c) and d) will not be appropriate in respect of statutory designations and critical environmental assets. Protected species are considered in Paragraph 13.64 below.

13.61 All development will be expected to provide a net gain in biodiversity where possible. Where biodiversity assets cannot be retained or enhanced on site, the Councils will support 'biodiversity offsetting' to deliver a net gain in biodiversity off-site in accordance with adopted protocols.

13.62 The DEFRA metric⁽¹²²⁾ will be used to assess the extent of any net gain and acceptability of developments having an impact on biodiversity. Biodiversity assets should be retained or enhanced on site where feasible. Alternatively, a 'biodiversity offsetting' approach may be supported where net gains in biodiversity are delivered in accordance with DEFRA metric proposals (when adopted). Critical environmental assets such as ancient woodland and veteran trees cannot be relocated or replaced so must be retained and enhanced on site. Veteran trees are trees which are of cultural, historical, landscape and nature conservation value because of their age, size or condition. They can be found as individuals or groups of trees within ancient wood pastures, historic parkland, hedgerows, orchards, parks or other areas.

13.63 Compensation for loss of biodiversity habitat is a last resort, but may be necessary where adverse effects cannot be overcome and any unavoidable losses are outweighed by other planning considerations. Extent of loss will be assessed using the DEFRA metric reference above. Where justified, appropriate compensatory measures should demonstrate a net gain of the relevant local biodiversity resource in both the short and longer terms. Any compensatory provision should be delivered elsewhere on a development site where feasible. If off-site provision is required, it should be delivered as close to the development site as possible to avoid the erosion of local biodiversity networks. Compensatory measures, particularly off-site measures, should be delivered through legal agreements.

13.64 European protected species will be conserved by protecting and enhancing the key habitats on which they depend, including for feeding, burrowing, commuting, roosting and hibernating. Key foraging areas and commuting routes for bats include river valleys, hedgerows and scrub land and their flyways will be protected from adverse impacts of lighting. Adverse impacts on protected species (see Glossary) will only be supported in exceptional circumstances of imperative reasons of overriding public interest.

13.65 The key characteristics and extent of all landscape and seascape character types and areas within northern Devon are identified in the Joint Landscape Character Assessment⁽¹²³⁾ and the North Devon and Exmoor Seascape Character Assessment⁽¹²⁴⁾ respectively. These key characteristics will be conserved and enhanced. The special qualities of the AONB are also identified and conserved through the AONB Management Plan (Policy ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets), whilst the unspoilt character and appearance of the undeveloped coast and estuary is safeguarded by Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy. Development outside

122 Technical Paper: The metric for the biodiversity offsetting pilot in England, DEFRA (2012) or subsequent revisions

123 Joint Landscape Character Assessment for North Devon and Torridge Districts (Land Use Consultants, November 2010)

124 North Devon and Exmoor Seascape Character Assessment (Land Use Consultants, November 2015)

Exmoor National Park must safeguard the tranquillity and special qualities of the Exmoor National Park International Dark Sky Reserve by minimising light pollution through sky glow.

Policy DM08A: Landscape and Seascape Character

(1) Development should be of an appropriate scale, mass and design that recognises and respects landscape character of both designated and undesignated landscapes and seascapes; it should avoid adverse landscape and seascape impacts and seek to enhance the landscape and seascape assets wherever possible. Development must take into account and respect the sensitivity and capacity of the landscape/seascape asset, considering cumulative impact and the objective to maintain dark skies and tranquillity in areas that are relatively undisturbed, using guidance from the Joint Landscape and Seascape Character Assessments for North Devon and Torridge.

Development within or affecting the setting of the North Devon Coast AONB or affecting the setting of Exmoor National Park

(2) Great weight will be given to conserving the landscape and scenic beauty of designated landscapes and their settings. Proposals affecting the North Devon Coast Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty (AONB) or Exmoor National Park or their settings should have regard to their statutory purposes including to ensure that their landscape character and natural beauty are conserved and enhanced. Development should be appropriately located to address the sensitivity and capacity of these designated areas and will not be permitted where it would conflict with the achievement of their statutory purposes.

(3) Proposals within or affecting the setting of the AONB should be informed by, and assist in the delivery of, the North Devon Coast Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty Management Plan. Major development within the AONB will be refused subject to the tests of exceptional circumstances and where it can be demonstrated that the development is in the public interest as set out in national policy.

Heritage Coast

(4) Development within the Heritage Coast should maintain the character and distinctive landscape qualities of the area.

Safeguarding Green Infrastructure

Policy DM09: Safeguarding Green Infrastructure

Development involving the loss of green infrastructure including public open space will only be supported where:

- (a) alternative green infrastructure is provided of at least equivalent size, quality and accessibility to that being lost; or
- (b) the green infrastructure network in the locality can be retained or enhanced through redevelopment of a small part of the site; and in either case
- (c) there is no net loss in sustainable travel options.

13.66 Open spaces provide important opportunities for sport, recreation, and nature conservation as well as contributing to the character of our towns and villages. Public open spaces contribute to the green infrastructure network. Northern Devon's residents and visitors have opportunities for access to the countryside including its beaches and moors, which contribute to opportunities for healthy living. However there is a general deficiency of open space, including more formal open space, provision throughout northern Devon in relation to identified open space standards. As a result and in view of its value to the local community, existing open spaces will be protected from other forms of development. This level of protection extends to both informal and formal open spaces including playing fields, allotments, parks, playgrounds and cemeteries.

13.67 There is not a surplus of the vast majority of different types of green infrastructure against the adopted standards at the start of the plan period; further growth will further reduce any surplus. The loss of public open space will only be acceptable where development provides alternative provision that is of at least equal size, quality, accessibility, usefulness and attractiveness to that being lost. The partial loss of an area of open space may be acceptable where it improves the quality, accessibility and viability of an existing facility. Such improvements could include additional facilities such as a clubhouse/changing rooms, seating area, play equipment or car parking.

Green Infrastructure Provision

Policy DM10: Green Infrastructure Provision

Development will provide new accessible green infrastructure, including public open space and built facilities, to meet at least the green infrastructure quantitative and accessibility standards, as set out in Table 13.1 and Infrastructure Delivery Plan, to meet the needs of its intended occupants.

Table 13.1 Summary of Green Infrastructure Standards

Typology	Requirement from new development (Urban) ha/1000 population	Requirement from new development (Rural) ha/1000 population	Accessibility Standards (Urban and Rural)
Allotments	0.15	0.15	Up to 480 metres or 10 mins walk time (U) Up to 600 metres or 12-13 mins walk time (R)
Amenity and Natural Greenspace	2.0	-	Up to 480 metres or 10 mins walk time
Play Space (Children)	0.05	0.07	Up to 480 metres or 10 mins walk time (U) Up to 600 metres or 12-13 mins walk time (R)
Play Space (Youth)	0.02	0.07	Up to 600 metres or 12-13 mins walk time
Parks, Sport and Recreation Grounds	1.3 (publicly accessible provision)	1.3	Up to 600 metres or 12-13 mins walk time

13.68 New development will be required to make provision for public open space, recreation, sport facilities and green infrastructure. Where possible, facilities should be provided on site as an integral part of the development. Relevant local open space standards which have been established from the Green Infrastructure Strategy for North Devon and Torridge⁽¹²⁵⁾ take account of urban and rural locations. A summary of green infrastructure requirements is set out in Table 13.1. Urban areas comprise Barnstaple, Bideford and the Main Centres defined in Policy ST06: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Main Centres. Regard should be had to the Green Infrastructure Strategy for a comprehensive interpretation of the overall approach towards green infrastructure provision. Built facilities will be delivered including through funding contributions from Community Infrastructure Levy.

13.69 Provision of accessible green infrastructure delivers opportunities for communities to meet their diverse recreational needs, such as parks, play areas, allotments and sports pitches, as well as contributing to local green infrastructure networks, the character of settlements and a sense of place. Open space provision will often be multi-functional by providing sustainable drainage systems, habitat connectivity, opportunities for healthy living and links to walking and cycling networks, as well as accessible natural greenspace. Delivery of public open space will help to secure a net gain in biodiversity (Policy ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets) and will contribute to delivery of ecosystem services.

13.70 Major developments, including non-residential uses, will generally be expected to provide new green infrastructure on site. Provision off site or contributions towards more comprehensive planned provision elsewhere will only be supported where it best delivers identified community needs and aspirations. The delivery of green infrastructure in strategic developments should be phased alongside the delivery of new housing.

13.71 All residential developments will provide new or enhance existing green infrastructure in accordance with locally adopted green infrastructure standards. The type and total green infrastructure provision will depend upon the intended occupants for any development and the amount, accessibility and quality of existing provision within the surrounding area. In certain circumstances it may involve enhancement of hub sites that serve a wider catchment area.

13.72 Small parcels of open space will not be supported where they are:

- (a) not large enough to meet their intended purpose (e.g. a sports pitch without an adequate buffer zone);
- (b) not attractive or usable (due to their design, size, topography or shading);
- (c) not safe (e.g. a play area located close to a busy road or not adequately overlooked by surrounding properties);
- (d) not multi-functional; or
- (e) likely to harm amenities of surrounding properties.

13.73 The Councils will have regard to Natural England's Accessible Natural Greenspace Standards (ANGSt) and Woodland Trust access standards, which require accessibility to natural greenspaces of strategic scales within set distances. Adjoining each urban area, the Councils will support designation of Local Nature Reserves where required, to provide at least 2 hectares per thousand population. For strategic scale development schemes where it is neither possible nor appropriate to provide additional natural greenspace consistent with the standards, other approaches should be pursued which could include changing the management of marginal space on playing fields and parks to enhance biodiversity amongst other means.

125 Green Infrastructure Strategy for North Devon and Torridge District Councils 2013 - 2031

13.74 Developments proposals will need to indicate how and by whom open space provision and any associated facilities is to be delivered and the means by which the future management and maintenance of such will be secured.

Planning Enforcement

Policy DM11: Planning Enforcement

Unauthorised development will be investigated by the Local Planning Authority, acting proportionately to the scale of the suspected breach of planning control. Enforcement action will be taken where it is appropriate to do so and in the public interest.

13.75 Managing development and the investigation of suspected breaches is an important function of a Local Planning Authority. Unauthorised development can be detrimental to the local environment and be a source of social tension. Failure to enforce planning conditions or address unauthorised development can reduce the effectiveness of a Local Planning Authority and undermine public confidence in the planning system.

13.76 When undertaking investigations, the Local Planning Authorities will act in proportion to the scale of the suspected breach to which it relates. The Local Planning Authority will then take enforcement action where it deems such action to be appropriate, having regard to the scale of the breach and the impact on public amenity.

13.77 To ensure that enforcement is managed proactively and in a way that is appropriate to northern Devon, the Local Planning Authorities will publish a Local Enforcement Plan. This document will set out the Councils' approach to enforcement, including timescales for action and detailing how the Councils will respond to suspected breaches.

Telecommunications

Policy DM11A: Telecommunications

Proposals for new or upgraded telecommunications equipment and installations will be permitted (where planning permission or 'prior approval' is required) where:

- (a) the telecommunications equipment and installation would not have a significant adverse effect on its landscape setting, landscape character, heritage and visual amenity by reason of its siting and design or as a result of cumulative impact with nearby development;**
- (b) opportunities have been sought to share masts or sites with other providers and, where appropriate, the erection of antennae on existing buildings or other structures; and**
- (c) the proposal conforms to the International Commission on Non-Ionising Radiation Protection (ICNIRP) guidelines, taking account where appropriate of the cumulative impact of all operators' equipment located on the mast/site.**

13.78 Telecommunications installations involve tall structures that have the potential to be visually obtrusive and can lead to adverse landscape impacts on the surrounding area, either on their own or cumulatively with other developments such as wind turbines. Therefore, new development which does not currently benefit from deemed planning consent should demonstrate

that the proposal, where possible, seeks to minimise the visual impact of any new structures or antenna and that there is not an unacceptably adverse environmental impact, both in isolation and cumulatively.

Enabling a Vibrant Economy

Employment Development

13.79 North Devon and Torridge District Councils are committed to enabling well paid quality employment across northern Devon to help raise the overall prosperity of residents. Great importance is attached to creating a supportive climate for businesses to enable growth and development in a sustainable manner and to improve skills and widen the economic base of the area.

13.80 Traditionally employment development has focused on use classes B1 (business), B2 (general industry) and B8 (storage and distribution). It is recognised that there is also scope for other uses to be considered as employment with job creation potential which can contribute to meeting the areas economic objectives. The strategic approach to employment land is set out in Policy ST11: Delivering Employment and Economic Development, the following policies provide more detail to assess proposals for employment development.

Policy DM12: Employment Development at Towns, Local Centres and Villages

To support additional job creation in settlements identified by Policy ST06 and Policy ST07, economic development will be supported on:

(a) existing and allocated employment land and other suitable sites within development boundaries and the principal built form of Local Centres and Villages without development boundaries; and

(b) new employment sites of an appropriate scale to the settlement, adjacent or well related to the development boundary/settlement to meet an identified business need and contribute to the area's economic objectives, where the Council is satisfied that there is an insufficient supply of sites in the area and the development cannot be accommodated within the development boundary/settlement;

provided that:

(c) the proposal and any associated employment activities can be carried out without undue detriment to residential amenity, public highway users, town centre vitality, landscape character and the environment generally including any buildings or features of designated importance; and

(d) the development has an adequate and safe access and does not give rise to excessive or inappropriate traffic and will contribute to the general aim of reducing the need to travel by private car.

13.81 Economic development, including new buildings, extensions to existing buildings and change of use or conversions of existing buildings, will be acceptable in principle, on allocated sites and other sites within defined development boundaries and within the principle built form of Local Centres and Villages without development boundaries. Not all employment uses fall neatly within the B1, B2 and B8 use classes. Many are ad hoc (sui generis) uses that could fit reasonably well within employment areas, especially those related to wholesaling and the motor and building trades. Such uses may be acceptable in the right circumstances.

13.82 The Councils are committed to achieving qualitative as well as quantitative improvements to the areas economic function, which should be reflected in the quality of proposals for new or extended business premises. High quality development will be required that does not have an unacceptable adverse impact through the loss of residential amenity, environmental value, pollution, degradation of air quality or traffic safety. Policy ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets will apply in relation to natural environment assets.

13.83 To further support economic development, land release adjacent to or well related to defined development boundaries, and the principal built form of Local Centres and Villages without development boundaries will be allowed to meet a specific business need that could not otherwise be met. The resultant development would need to clearly address the areas economic objectives, be accompanied by an appropriate business plan and no other more appropriate alternative siting option is available. In this circumstance, support would be provided to further extend the employment land supply beyond that required to meet identified needs.

13.84 The Councils' Economic Development Teams will support the delivery of businesses' objectives. An Economic Strategy (2014-20) has been adopted, which defines six priorities to support economic growth and prosperity in northern Devon. In tandem, a Northern Devon Employment Land Review (2013) assessed the need for employment land over the plan period and examined the portfolio of employment land during the same timescale.

Policy DM13: Safeguarding Employment Land

In order to maintain a range of suitable and available sites and buildings for employment, non-employment development uses will not be supported on allocated sites or in buildings previously used for employment or in buildings currently used for employment unless:

- (a) there is sufficient quality and quantity of employment sites available in the local area to provide opportunities for local employment uses; or**
- (b) it can be demonstrated through appropriate marketing that the site no longer provides a realistic prospect for employment uses; or**
- (c) the existing use is causing harm to surrounding uses and the new use will not cause harm for the existing neighbouring uses; and in all cases**
- (d) a sequential test has been applied for redevelopment of the site based on the following order of preference:**
 - (i) employment based redevelopment;**
 - (ii) mixed use including employment generating redevelopment;**
 - (iii) non-employment generating redevelopment.**

13.85 Existing and allocated employment sites provide the land supply necessary to support economic growth and secure the continuing presence of valuable employment assets. The loss of employment sites, whether in existing use or land allocated for employment could negatively impact on achieving Local Plan objectives that seek to ensure the presence of appropriate infrastructure to achieve a rejuvenated economy. In protecting the existing employment land resource the need to allocate additional employment land is reduced and the value of previous infrastructure investment is retained.

13.86 National planning policy however, determines that planning policies should avoid the long term protection of employment sites where there is no reasonable prospect of a site being used for that purpose. It is therefore necessary to provide criteria against which proposals for non employment development will be assessed.

13.87 In relation to existing employment sites, it is considered that they should generally be protected. A sequential approach will be taken to the reuse of employment sites. Development proposals for non-employment uses will only be supported on an employment site if it can be demonstrated that, firstly, an employment use and, secondly, a mixed-use development generating some employment is not achievable.

13.88 The Local Planning Authorities will require evidence of comprehensive and appropriate marketing to be submitted with a planning application that proposes the alternative use of an employment site. Appropriate marketing includes marketing at a reasonable price or rent, with appropriate conditions attached, for at least 12 months prior to the application submission at each stage of the sequential approach. In cases where the building or site is unused, supporting information of the steps taken to explore regeneration opportunities for employment uses will usually be required.

13.89 Employment land allocations, as detailed in the settlement chapters of the Local Plan, should not be considered unachievable in the short-medium term, especially in consideration of on-going fluctuations in the national economy. The retention of allocated sites will be considered through Local Plan review.

Employment Development outside Development Boundaries

13.90 The Councils recognise the importance of retaining and providing employment opportunities in the rural area as a means of ensuring a diverse and healthy rural economy. Employment development, agricultural development, tourism and energy developments all have a role in the rural economy. The Local Plan seeks to ensure that extensive opportunities remain for rural economic diversification that provides necessary employment to sustain rural communities. The economic aims for the rural area are to:

- (a) facilitate rural economic diversification and intensification;
- (b) promote necessary agricultural change and enable appropriate development;
- (c) accommodate sustainable tourism and countryside recreation; and
- (d) ensure that new economic development delivers local economic benefit.

Policy DM14: Rural Economy

To support the rural economy, new small scale economic development at Rural Settlements and in the Countryside will be supported on the following basis:

- (a) change of use or conversion of a permanent and soundly constructed building; or**
- (b) sites or buildings adjoining or well related to a defined settlement or a Rural Settlement; or**
- (c) the proposed employment use has a strong functional link to local agriculture, forestry or other existing rural activity;**

provided that:

(d) there is no adverse impact on the living conditions of local residents;

(e) the scale of employment is appropriate to the accessibility of the site and the standard of the local highway network; and

(f) proposals respect the character and qualities of the landscape and the setting of any affected settlement or protected landscape or historic assets and their settings and include effective mitigation measures to avoid adverse effects or minimise them to acceptable levels.

13.91 Small scale economic development is needed to promote employment diversification and reduce commuting. A range of employment activities, particularly associated with tourism, recreation and rural diversification can be accommodated in countryside locations without adverse effects on the character of the rural area. Proposals relating specifically to farm diversification will be considered against Policy DM15: Farm Diversification.

13.92 Policy DM14: Rural Economy applies to development in the countryside and on the edge of towns and villages. It provides the opportunity for the development of small businesses, the improvement and expansion of existing businesses outside defined employment areas and for employment development in other appropriate locations.

13.93 Wherever employment development, conversion, or expansion proposals are consistent with the spatial strategy of the Local Plan and can meet the policy criteria applied by the second part of Policy: DM14, they will be permissible in principle. In supporting economic development, it is important that safeguards ensure that proposals are appropriate in scale, type and design and would not result in development that negatively impacts on local residents.

Farm Diversification

13.94 Farm diversification can sustain and enhance the viability of farm enterprises, which has become an increasingly important element of farm enterprises during recent years of fluctuating agricultural incomes.

13.95 The principal aims for farm diversification are to promote development that meets the changing requirements of the agricultural economy and to exercise strict control over unnecessary new development in the countryside. The objective where relevant is to control the scale and impact of development, limiting development to that which is necessary for business and food production purposes and justified by the scale of operation proposed.

Policy DM15: Farm Diversification

In support of the agricultural sector, proposals for farm diversification schemes will be supported where:

(a) the scale of development is justified by the operational needs of the enterprise and will reinforce the viability of the existing farm business;

(b) the prospects for the reuse of vacant buildings, underused, or redundant agricultural buildings or their sites have been explored fully and opportunities exhausted;

(c) any new buildings are sited close to existing buildings and can be satisfactorily assimilated into the surrounding countryside having regard to form, bulk, design, landform, landscaping, special landscape qualities and character;

(d) the development will not detract unreasonably from the amenities of the occupiers of accommodation in the vicinity; and

(e) there is no resultant unacceptable increase in traffic on approach roads or detriment to the safety of users of the public highway.

13.96 Farm diversification, by its very nature can cover a wide range of elements, from tourism accommodation to small scale food processing and alternative crop production. Diversification schemes must be capable of supporting the farm economy in the long term and be compatible with the main farming activities of the farm business. The Local Planning Authorities will expect an appropriate farm diversification plan to be submitted with the proposal, which must set out the short and long term business plan of the existing farm business and explain how in functional and financial terms the proposal will support the long-term viability of the farm business.

13.97 In considering agricultural proposals, the Local Planning Authorities will take into account all of the following:

- (a) the need to maintain agricultural efficiency;
- (b) the scale of the enterprise being undertaken;
- (c) the potential for disturbance to any nearby protected buildings;
- (d) the need to safeguard environmental quality and control impact; and
- (e) the permitted development rights that exist.

13.98 The Local Plan supports the reuse of redundant or disused rural buildings for a range of uses (Policy DM27: Re-use of Disused and Redundant Rural Buildings). Schemes that secure the repair and sensitive re-use of historic farm buildings and retention of traditional farmsteads are particularly important. It is appropriate that opportunities to utilise existing buildings are fully examined prior to considering the need for new build.

13.99 New and replacement agricultural buildings should be sited well away from protected buildings. Protected buildings are habitable and /or institutional buildings used by the public and specified for the purpose of the GPDO (General Permitted Development Order). Development likely to cause nuisance or serious disturbance will not be permitted in close proximity to residential accommodation, though the occupiers of converted buildings are expected to tolerate routine agricultural operations. Regard must also be given to the provisions of Policy ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets including the need to conserve the best and most versatile agricultural land.

13.100 The locational policy criterion in respect of siting is not intended to prevent agricultural enterprise moving out of villages. Where an existing farmstead is inconveniently located, new agricultural development may be guided to an edge of village location or other site well related to landform so that local character and distinctiveness may be maintained.

Policy DM16: Equine Development

Horse-related facilities and equestrian enterprises in the countryside will be supported where:

- (a) priority is given to the re-use of existing buildings and where justified new buildings or ancillary development is well related to existing buildings;**

- (b) well integrated, with the surroundings and is of a scale and design so as not to harm the character and landscape of the rural area;**
- (c) the operation is not detrimental to the amenity of nearby residents; and**
- (d) the development is convenient for suitable existing riding areas where necessary access is acceptable without detriment to the safety of users of the public highway.**

13.101 Equine related activities are popular and pressures for related development are anticipated in the following forms: change of use of land to recreational use, stabling and feed storage, livery and equestrian centres for manège, etc. Policy DM16: Equine Development, sets out the principal issues in respect of equine related development, the focus of which is to minimise adverse impacts on the character of the countryside.

13.102 New equine facilities can have a negative impact on the rural nature of the area, by their appearance, scale, materials or design. Individually and cumulatively equestrian developments could significantly alter the character of an area. New buildings will be required to be designed and located to minimise impact taking into account local landscape character and special landscape qualities. Building clutter should be minimised, including through the reuse of vacant, underused or redundant buildings where operationally practical.

13.103 Grazing areas and stables must allow access to suitable riding areas where these are required, and the adequacy of the bridleway network to serve proposals will be a material consideration. Acceptable schemes will indicate adequate provision for water, feed, and manure storage in association with stabling. The traffic, noise, and odour implications of site operation are important, particularly where there is nearby habitation. Where horse box traffic, horse drawn vehicles, or substantial traffic volumes are likely in association with events, they will be considered in relation to the capacity of the road network, in the interests of highway safety and site access.

Tourism

Policy DM17: Tourism and Leisure Attractions

(1) Development of new, and the expansion or rationalisation of existing tourism, visitor or leisure facilities will be supported within or adjacent to defined settlements located outside the Coast and Estuarine Zone and within the Developed Coast where:

- (a) the scale of the proposal is appropriate to the size of the settlement; and**
- (b) there will not be an unacceptable impact upon:**
 - (i) the local road network; nor**
 - (ii) identified environmental and heritage assets; and**
- (c) any rationalisation would facilitate the retention or improvement of the remaining tourism, visitor or leisure facilities.**

(2) Elsewhere, within the Undeveloped Coast and in the Countryside beyond the Coast and Estuarine Zone, development of new or the expansion or rationalisation of existing tourism, visitor or leisure facilities will be supported where:

- (a) the location is justified;**
- (b) existing buildings are reused or converted wherever feasible;**

(c) the local road network can accommodate the type and scale of traffic to be generated and maintain the safety of public highway users;

(d) it is designed to respect and enhance the key characteristics of the relevant landscape character types; and

(e) environmental and heritage assets are not subject to significant harm, and are conserved or enhanced, with particular respect to the setting and special qualities of nationally important landscapes, biodiversity and heritage designations.

13.104 Tourism and leisure attractions form an important part of northern Devon's economy and tourism offer. Such attractions should, subject to the consideration of Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy, be located within or close to defined settlements (Policy ST06: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Strategic and Main Centres and ST07: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Rural Area), although it is recognised that small scale attractions can help to support a sustainable rural economy including through farm diversification (Policy DM15: Farm Diversification). The scale of any proposal should be appropriate to the scale of the settlement with larger tourism attractions being located at the Sub-regional, Strategic the Main Centres or resorts where there are greatest opportunities for access by sustainable travel options. Major tourism and leisure developments that generate a significant amount of traffic movements will require a Transport Assessment and a Travel Plan (Policy ST10: Transport Strategy). Where rationalisation is proposed it will be expected to secure the improvement of the remaining facilities.

13.105 Tourism and leisure attractions will also be supported outside defined settlements where a Countryside location is justified. Attractions that could justify a Countryside location include those related directly to a heritage asset (e.g. a listed building or working mill), a landscape feature (e.g. a fishing lake or spectacular viewpoint), a rural environment (e.g. a farm park or an historic landscape) or those needing to be located within an area of woodland (e.g. a mountain bike trail). Proposals for development in the Undeveloped Coast will be required to be further justified in accordance with Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy. Large tourism and leisure proposals may also be too large to be located immediately adjoining a settlement, in which case any Countryside location should identify opportunities for access by sustainable travel options. An interpretation, education and visitor centre for the Biosphere Reserve will be supported in a sustainable location.

13.106 Wherever possible, new and extended tourism and leisure attractions should deliver opportunities to enhance education and appreciation of northern Devon's environment and heritage for all sections of the community, including tourists and visitors. In all cases, the local road network must be able to accommodate the type and volume of traffic likely to be generated as well as safeguarding or enhancing environmental and heritage assets (Policies ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets and ST15: Conserving Heritage Assets) including landscape character.

Policy DM18: Tourism Accommodation

(1) Development of new, and expansion or rationalisation of existing tourism accommodation will be supported within the Sub-regional, Strategic, Main and Local Centres where it:

(a) improves the quality or increases the diversity of northern Devon's tourism offer;

(b) is located and designed to protect and enhance the character and setting of the settlement; and

(c) any rationalisation would facilitate the retention or improvement of the tourism accommodation.

(2) Outside the Sub-regional, Strategic, Main and Local Centres, the development of new and the expansion or rationalisation of existing tourism accommodation will be supported where it:

(a) is related directly to and compatible in scale with an existing tourism, visitor or leisure attraction; or

(b) reuses or converts existing buildings; or

(c) improves facilities for or diversifies the range or improves the quality of existing tourism accommodation;

and in all cases:

(d) the scale and character of the proposal is appropriate to the size of the existing settlement or tourism attraction;

(e) the local road network can accommodate the type and scale of traffic to be generated and the safety of public highway users is maintained;

(f) is designed to respect and enhance the key characteristics of the relevant landscape character types;

(g) identified environmental and heritage assets are not subject to significant harm, are conserved or enhanced, with particular respect to the setting and special qualities of nationally important landscapes, the Undeveloped Coast, biodiversity and heritage designations; and

(h) protects and enhances the setting and special qualities of the Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty and provides an overall environmental enhancement when assessed throughout a year.

(3) Applications for the removal of occupancy conditions on holiday accommodation will only be permitted where:

(a) it is capable of being occupied permanently without need for major extension or alteration; and

(b) there is compelling evidence to demonstrate that such a restriction is no longer justified.

13.107 Policy DM18: Tourism Accommodation provides a focus on improvement of tourism accommodation whether by new facilities or extension of existing accommodation which satisfactorily aligns with strategic policy principles. Although there has been a decline of bed space capacity in some resort areas, a continuing long term trend for growth in short breaks and special interest activity holidays has helped to stabilise the sector and place a strong emphasis on improving overall quality of accommodation. There are opportunities for high quality built accommodation, eco-friendly accommodation, study centres, barn conversions and accommodation for disabled visitors.

13.108 In the Countryside, new proposals for tourism accommodation will often be directly related to an existing visitor or leisure attraction. Smaller forms of serviced accommodation, such as guest houses and bed and breakfast establishments may be acceptable in rural areas where they involve the adaptation or conversion of a building or help to improve existing facilities. Restricting occupancy to tourist accommodation will limit permanent residential occupation in the Countryside, which would conflict with the principles of sustainable development and ensure that the accommodation contributes to the local economy. Any proposals affecting the Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty or Exmoor National Park will need to accord with Policy ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets and other relevant Local Plan policies.

13.109 Proposals for the removal of holiday occupancy restrictions will be supported when it can be demonstrated to the satisfaction of the Local Planning Authority that the accommodation is no longer required to meet the tourism needs of the locality. The Local Planning Authority will require applications for the removal of occupancy conditions to demonstrate there is no demand for the property in the locality. Marketing will be considered to be appropriate when the property has been presented to the market at a reasonable price, with appropriate conditions identified and for a period of at least 12 months prior to the application's submission.

Town Centres and Retail

13.110 National planning policy recognises the importance of successful town centres and that they should be at the heart of their communities. The Local Plan accordingly aims for town centres to sustain and enhance the range and quality of retail provision within an efficient, competitive and innovative sector and to ensure the availability of good quality shops and services to which residents and visitors have easy access by a choice of means of transport. The objectives are to :

- (a) maintain and enhance the vitality and viability of town centres;
- (b) use investment, development and enhancement proposals to boost the economy and environment of the town centres; and
- (c) focus development, especially retail and leisure development, in locations where the proximity of facilities both encourages competition from which all consumers are able to benefit and maximises the opportunity to use means of transport other than the car.

13.111 Barnstaple and Bideford are the main comparison and convenience goods centres in northern Devon. The other centres, Braunton, Great Torrington, Holsworthy, Ilfracombe and South Molton additionally provide a range of retail and service outlets consistent with their role as Main Centres, as set out in Policy ST12: Town and District Centres. District Centres at Northam, Appledore, Westward Ho! and Roundswell (Barnstaple) further provide an important retail and service role. It is important that the retail centres within all the main settlements remain attractive to the retailer and to the consumer. This will require positive management to provide an attractive, safe, and accessible environment.

Policy DM19: Town and District Centres

(1) To increase Town and District Centre viability and vitality, development proposals for retail, leisure, commercial, office, tourism, cultural, community and residential development will be supported within defined Town and District Centre boundaries subject to satisfactory regard to (2) and:

- (a) the retention and enhancement of the Town and District Centres historic character;**

(b) the proposed development being readily accessible by sustainable transport modes; and

(c) the effective use of upper floors is maintained or secured.

(2) Within the Town and District Centres, the retail function will be safeguarded and enhanced. Development and change of use of ground floor premises to alternative uses will be supported unless:

(a) the Primary Shopping Area's character is undermined through the loss of key retail opportunities or the resultant fragmentation and isolation of the remaining shops;

(b) within Primary Frontages, defined on the Policies Map, the proportion of units in A1 use is below or would fall below 60%;

(c) within the Primary Shopping Area the proposal would harm the vitality or viability of the town centre where the overall proportion of units in A1 use is below or would fall below 50%; and

(d) there would be a detrimental effect on the visual character and amenities of the surrounding area.

13.112 Primary Shopping Areas are defined at all Town and District Centres and Primary Shopping Frontages are defined in Bideford, Barnstaple and Ilfracombe. In Braunton, Great Torrington, Holsworthy, South Molton, Northam, Appledore, Westward Ho! and Roundswell the Primary Shopping Areas are aligned with the Town and District Centre boundaries defined on the Policies Map, whilst in Bideford, Barnstaple and Ilfracombe the Primary Shopping Areas extend to the balance of the Town and District Centres beyond the Primary Shopping Frontages.

13.113 The Primary Frontages and Primary Shopping Areas provide a retail focus, which the policy seeks to retain. Policy DM19: Town and District Centres, also facilitates diversification of use to maintain buoyant town centres. A mix of leisure, tourism, cultural, community and residential development will be acceptable provided the viability of the commercial activities is not undermined.

13.114 Within and on the edge of the Town Centres, there are opportunities for comprehensive development and redevelopment of areas of vacant and underused land that have the potential to add significantly to the attraction and use of the Town Centres. Where opportunities are identified in settlement chapters, piecemeal development that would undermine the scope for a more comprehensive approach will not be permitted.

13.115 The presence of non-retail uses including for commercial and for housing purposes in the upper floors of premises can increase activity, add to vitality and secure more responsible building maintenance. Such proposals will be encouraged where the operation of ground floor retailing is not prejudiced and the amenities of occupiers are unlikely to be detrimentally affected.

Policy DM20: Development Outside Town and District Centres

(1) Within Barnstaple, Bideford, Braunton, Great Torrington, Holsworthy, Ilfracombe, Northam and South Molton a sequential approach to proposals for main town centre uses will be applied on the following preferential basis:

(a) Town or District Centre

(b) Edge of Town or District Centre**(c) Out of Town or District Centre**

(2) Edge of centre and other out of centre proposals must be well connected to the Town or District Centres and accessible by public transport, walking and cycling. Proposals must also demonstrate that no suitable alternative sites are available in a sequentially preferable location.

(3) On the edge of or outside Town and District Centres, proposals for new shops of more than 250 square metres (gross) retail floor area, or extensions to existing shops which will increase their size by more than 250 square metres (gross) retail floor area, must be accompanied by an impact assessment in accordance with national policy requirements.

13.116 National planning policy requires Local Planning Authorities to apply a sequential approach on a “town centre first” basis to the location of new retail and leisure provision, guiding it to available sites within town centres, then the edge of town centres, and only then to out of centre locations. Policy DM20: Development Outside Town Centres, reflects the required sequential approach and sets a floorspace threshold of 250 square metres (gross), as recommended by the Retail and Leisure Assessment, over which an impact assessment will be required for proposals outside of town centres.

13.117 In considering development proposals in edge of centre or out of centre locations, the Local Planning Authority will assess whether there are alternative suitable sites in more sustainable locations according to the stated order of preference. Additionally, the nature, scale, car parking requirements, accessibility and market demands of the proposal will be taken into account in addition to the range of other safeguards provided by Development Management policies in relation to: amenity, landscape and heritage impacts and highway safety.

Rural and Local Shops

13.118 Town and District Centre shops are supplemented by a range of local shops in small groups and by individual units within villages and in residential neighbourhoods. Village and neighbourhood shops provide important access to day-to-day retailing for residents, but are small enough that they complement rather than compete with town centres.

13.119 Retail outlets in the countryside, including farm shops can provide necessary economic support to maintain business viability, while also extending the range of available rural services. Retail development in the countryside needs to be strictly controlled.

Policy DM21: Local and Rural Shops

(1) Within development boundaries, or within the principal built form of Policy ST07 identified settlements without development boundaries and within Rural Settlements, the development of individual shops or small groups of shops to serve neighbourhood or village needs will be supported provided that:

(a) it is of a scale and location appropriate to serve the shopping needs of the local community;

(b) the operation of the retail unit(s) would not be detrimental to the amenity of neighbouring residents; and

(c) the local highway network can accommodate additionally generated traffic and the safety of public highway users is maintained.

(2) In the open countryside proposals for small scale retail development, which are ancillary to the main function of an existing enterprise will be supported provided that:

(a) the location and scale of the development would not harm the vitality and viability of Town or District Centre or village shopping facilities;

(b) the development would not lead to an unacceptable impact on the local road network; and

(c) there would not be an unacceptable adverse impact to the character and appearance of the countryside or historic environment.

(3) The change of use of local shops will be supported provided that:

(a) there is suitable alternative or replacement provision in the locality; or

(b) it is demonstrated that the business is no longer viable and cannot reasonably be made so.

13.120 In principle, the Local Planning Authorities will support the provision of shops on a small scale outside Town Centres, where located within development boundaries, the principle built form of Policy ST07 defined settlements without development boundaries or within Rural Settlements, and are intended to serve the local community. Development that would detract from the function of town centres or be detrimental to the amenity of neighbouring uses will not be permitted. Sporadic development is not acceptable.

13.121 Proposals for new shopping facilities in villages will be supported provided that they are of a size and nature that is related to the needs of the local community. The Local Planning Authorities will resist shopping proposals intended to attract shoppers from beyond the village and its natural catchment area. Generally, housing will be the predominant neighbour. There should be sufficient parking, safe access, and no unacceptable impact on the amenity of neighbouring uses.

13.122 The second part of the Policy DM21: Local and Rural Shops, enables limited and small scale retail development in the Countryside where, provided on an ancillary basis to the main function of the enterprise, ancillary retail could support: tourism or recreational enterprise, employment development on the basis of a factory shop or farm shops, all of which would extend the scope of the established economic activity and provide employment and service in the rural area.

13.123 In the interest of rural diversification, the policy criteria will be applied flexibly to individual retail use proposals. The Local Planning Authorities will seek to limit the scale of the retail activity to ensure it remains ancillary to the main function of the enterprise. In determining proposals the Local Planning Authorities will have regard to the potential impact on nearby shops, which may result in restriction, through planning condition, on the range of the goods to be sold.

13.124 The third part of the policy mitigates against the loss of retail use where necessary to maintain a basic level of service. In determining proposals that would result in the loss of a local shop, the Local Planning Authorities will have regard to the need for the facility and the support of the local community. Applicants will need to demonstrate that the existing facility cannot be

maintained as a viable business or that adequate alternative provision is available within the locality to serve the local community.

Shop Front Design and Signage

Policy DM22: Shop Front Design and Signage

(1) Development altering existing and proposing new shop frontages will be supported where:

- (a) the local character and features of traditional shop fronts are retained and enhanced, the local street scene is conserved and they are appropriate to the design and character of the building on which they are installed;**
- (b) shop fronts and fascia signage relate to individual buildings rather than retail frontages as a whole;**
- (c) excessive signage is avoided; and**
- (d) any security shutters are internally mounted.**

(2) Illumination of shops, businesses and community facilities is only supported where the premises are open during the evening. Where illumination of premises is justified, shop fronts will be illuminated internally and signage illuminated externally using energy efficient lighting systems.

13.125 Northern Devon's historic town and village centres retain examples of traditional retail frontages that contribute towards their special character and charm. Traditional shop fronts help to give a degree of local distinctiveness, easily lost where businesses wish to establish a standardised national shop front and signage scheme. New shop fronts in existing buildings should respect the character of the building and the traditional pattern of shop fronts in the locality by virtue of materials, style and scale. New retail stores should design the shop front as part of the building itself in accordance with the strategic design policy (Policy ST04: Improving the Quality of Development) and guidance within adopted Conservation Area Character Appraisals and Management Plans.

13.126 Businesses operating out of two or more adjoining buildings should have separate shop fronts and signage for each building, particularly where each retains a traditional shop front. This will help to retain and enhance traditional building patterns and conserve the character and appearance of town centres, most of which are designated as conservation areas (Policy ST15: Conserving Heritage Assets). Proliferation of signage on individual shop fronts should be avoided to retain the traditional character and appearance of northern Devon's town and village centres and to avoid clutter. Fascia signs should include the property number (for example, 15 High Street). No signage should be permitted above fascia level, apart from signage relating to separate uses on the upper floors.

13.127 Illumination of shop fronts and signage is not required during the day and it should be restricted to trading hours to reduce energy consumption (Policy ST05: Sustainable Construction and Buildings) and light pollution at night (Policy DM02: Environmental Protection) when businesses are closed. It is appropriate for businesses and community facilities (including public houses, restaurants, cash points) that are open during the evening to illuminate their premises for identification and public safety through internally illuminated shop fronts and externally illuminated signage. Where illumination is required it should utilise energy efficient lighting systems and minimise light pollution (Policy DM02: Environmental Protection).

13.128 Security can be provided through the use of laminated glazing systems that can eliminate the need for additional security barriers. Traditional shop fronts can also assist with security by stall risers reducing the likelihood of ram-raiding attempts. Where security shutters are required, they should be internally mounted mesh shutters to allow window displays to remain visible, retaining the vitality of town centres and adding interest to the street scene. Externally mounted roller shutters and solid shutter systems can have an adverse impact on the character and appearance of town centres, eroding vitality, creating a heavily defensive feel and projecting a “fear of crime”.

Delivering a Balanced Local Housing Market

Residential Development in defined Settlements without development boundaries

13.129 Reflecting local preference, the Local Centre of Bratton Fleming and a number of defined Villages do not have development boundaries. Development in settlements without boundaries will be supported where the economic and social needs of the community are addressed within the context of the locally specific vision and spatial strategy, as detailed in Part Two of the Local Plan.

Policy DM23: Residential Development in defined Settlements without development boundaries

(1) Residential development in Local Centres and Villages without development boundaries will be supported on allocated sites and where:

- (a) the site is located within the principal built form of the settlement and is not protected for any other use; or**
- (b) the site is well related to the main built form of the settlement and provides an affordable housing focused development in accordance with Policy ST19.**

(2) Subject to the above qualification development proposals should:

- (a) not harm the settlement’s rural character, setting, form or the surrounding countryside;**
- (b) be proportionate to the settlement’s size, form and level of facilities available in the Local Centre or Village; and**
- (c) conserve the special landscape character and qualities of areas designated for their local, national or international importance including the setting of Exmoor National Park.**

13.130 The extent of development will relate to the principal built form of the settlement, within which residential development may be permissible through infill, conversion, redevelopment and development on greenfield sites not otherwise protected. Residential development will be further enabled on allocated sites as defined in Part Two of the Local Plan and exceptionally in accordance with Policy ST19: Affordable Housing on Exceptions Sites. Development delivering employment and community services will be supported in accordance with DM12: Employment Development in Towns, Local Centres and Villages, DM14: Rural Economy and ST22: Community Services and Facilities. In all instances development will be considered in the context of the local spatial strategy, and the potential impact on the settlement's character and setting.

Rural Settlements

13.131 To enable small rural communities to meet locally generated needs, local occupancy dwellings in settlements qualifying as Rural Settlements may be permissible. Qualifying settlements will be formed by an obvious grouping of dwellings physically separate from urban areas or other defined settlements, which meet the qualifying criteria, set out in Policy ST07: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Rural Area.

Policy DM24: Rural Settlements

In qualifying Rural Settlements, proposals for local occupancy dwellings to meet a locally identified housing need will be supported where:

- (a) the development site forms part of a small closely grouped or contiguous built form of housing that is physically separate from urban areas of other defined settlements;**
- (b) the scale is proportionate to the settlement's size, form and character;**
- (c) the site is within or directly adjoining the built form of the settlement;**
- (d) the size of the dwellings are no larger than can be justified by the established need;**
- (e) it would not harm the settlement's rural character and setting; and**
- (f) secure arrangements are made to ensure the dwellings remain available to meet the locally identified housing needs of the local community both initially and in the long term provided the need exists.**

13.132 In Rural Settlements residential development will be supported by means of infilling, the conversion or replacement of appropriate buildings, re-development and small scale rounding off. Any acceptable development scheme should maintain the settlement's rural character and setting. The requirements of Policy ST14 (Enhancing Environmental Assets) should also be met as appropriate.

13.133 The primary purpose for allowing limited housing in Rural Settlements is to sustain their vitality and to meet the needs of the local community by identifying that a 'locally identified need' can be demonstrated. Speculative development will not be supported in view of sustainability considerations. New dwellings will be allowed either as affordable housing or subject to secure arrangements to ensure occupancy is limited both initially and in the future to:-

- (1) at least one adult in the household was resident continuously in the Rural Settlement for a minimum of five years immediately prior to occupation; or
- (2) at least one adult of the household was resident in the Rural Settlement for five years within the previous ten years immediately prior to occupation; or
- (3) at least one parent, guardian, child or sibling, of at least one adult in the intended household, has been resident in the Rural Settlement for a minimum of 5 years immediately prior to occupation; or

(4) at least one adult in the household has been in continuous employment for at least 16 hours per week in the Rural Settlement for at least five years immediately prior to occupation; and in all cases

(5) at least one adult in the household needs a separate home (defined as those setting up a new household as a result of co-habitation, marriage, divorce or separation, or those that have, or are about to leave, tied accommodation on retirement) or whose present accommodation is sub-standard or unsuitable to their present circumstances because of their age, an impairment, medical condition or to meet the needs of a growing family, or there is no suitable accommodation available.

13.134 Restricting the occupation of new dwellings in this manner will help ensure there is a stock of homes to meet the housing needs of the local community. A cascade approach will be applied to any property not let or sold within 6 months. Where it can be demonstrated that there is no demand for the property within the rural settlement, a cascade will apply to subsequently require the property to be marketed to those with a local connection (as set out in criteria 1 to 4 of the paragraph above) to the parish within which the dwellings resides, the adjoining parishes or within a relevant grouping of parishes formally recognised by the Local Planning Authority (such as the Rural Alliance). Ultimately, any property not let or sold within a further 6 month period will cascade to the wider Local Planning Authority area. The new dwelling will be subject to a legal agreement, including details that the value of the property will reflect the local occupancy restriction at any point of sale. Affordable housing to meet the specific needs of lower income groups in the local community will be permitted for one or more dwelling through policy ST19: Exception Sites.

Residential Extensions and Ancillary Development

13.135 Extensions to residential properties and ancillary development can be an efficient, affordable and practical way of adapting to household change. Proposals for extensions and ancillary development do however require careful consideration to avoid disruption to the established pattern and form of development. It is essential that good design is encouraged and where planning permission is required, control applied to proposals that are inappropriate in scale or incongruous with their surroundings.

Policy DM25: Residential Extensions and Ancillary Development

(1) The extension of a residential dwelling and other ancillary development, beyond that enabled through permitted development, will be supported subject to:

- (a) the form, scale, setting and design of the proposal respecting existing development, its context, setting and surroundings;**
- (b) adequate residential amenity space and parking provision being maintained; and**
- (c) there being no significant adverse impact on the amenity of the occupants of neighbouring properties.**

(2) Annexe accommodation will be physically attached to the main house and be commensurate in scale to the needs of the intended occupants.

13.136 Policy DM25: Residential Extensions and Ancillary Development, provides that proposals will be assessed to ensure that the bulk, massing and style are in keeping with the scale and character of the “host” house and neighbouring properties. Unduly dominant or overbearing

development will not be acceptable. Particular regard will be given to the need to protect the amenity of adjacent properties and to control the impact on the character and appearance of the landscape and streetscape.

13.137 In providing for an extension or ancillary development, the resultant residential amenity space and parking provision must be adequate for the cumulative needs of the existing and proposed development.

13.138 Support will be provided for annexe accommodation where the scale of development is commensurate with the needs of the intended occupant(s), which must be achieved without harm to amenity and local character considerations. Annexe accommodation will be required to be physically attached to the main house.

Replacement Dwellings in the Countryside

13.139 Notwithstanding the general policy of restraint in relation to housing in the countryside, the suitable replacement of existing dwellings is considered acceptable where properties are dilapidated or obsolescent and are not suitable for improvement or alteration. Policy DM26: Replacement Dwellings in the Countryside, does not however apply to derelict buildings where the residential use has been abandoned; such 'replacement' would be regarded as a new dwelling.

Policy DM26: Replacement Dwellings in the Countryside

Proposals for the replacement of an existing dwelling in the Countryside will be supported, subject to:

- (a) the replacement dwelling respecting the character of the surroundings and is no more visually intrusive than that of the existing dwelling; and**
- (b) the new dwelling offering a positive enhancement to the quality of design and /or level of sustainability when compared to that being replaced.**

13.140 Proposals to replace existing dwellings in the Countryside will be assessed on the justification for the proposal as well as on issues such as scale, design, position and visual impact of the proposed new building. In view of the strong environmental and rural character considerations in the Countryside, it is important that the consequent visual, landscape and amenity impacts of replacement dwellings are minimised.

13.141 Replacement may provide the opportunity for development to better harmonise with the locality. Where a replacement is built on a different footprint, the original building must be removed and the site reclaimed.

Re-use of Rural Disused and Redundant Buildings

13.142 Northern Devon is predominantly rural in nature and the countryside contains many buildings that are no longer required for their original intended use. These buildings often contribute to the character of the countryside but are also an asset that offers an opportunity to meet social or economic needs in a sustainable manner. National planning policy supports the reuse of rural buildings for economic or residential use subject to the proposal having regard to the principles of sustainable development and recognising the intrinsic character and beauty of the countryside. Reflecting Government policy to deliver a sustainable pattern of development, reduce social exclusion and strengthen the role of established communities, it is important to guide such development to locations with good access to community services and facilities by alternatives to the private car and by encouraging the use of public transport, cycling and walking. With respect

to residential re-use, national policy further stipulates that proposals should offer an enhancement to the immediate setting of the building.

Policy DM27: Re-use of Disused and Redundant Rural Buildings

The conversion of redundant and disused rural buildings will be supported where:

- (a) such conversion would not harm any intrinsic qualities and historic interest of the building;**
- (b) the proposal will have a positive impact on the immediate setting of the building and the wider rural character is protected;**
- (c) development can be achieved without significant external alteration, extension or substantive rebuilding;**
- (d) suitable highway access can be provided and the surrounding highway network can support the proposed use(s); and**
- (e) any nature conservation interest within the building or wider site is retained.**

13.143 Policy DM27: Re-use of Disused and Redundant Rural Buildings supports the reuse of redundant or disused rural buildings for residential, tourism or economic uses subject to satisfying a range of criteria and compliance with other relevant Local Plan policies. For the conversion of rural buildings within Rural Settlements, the local occupancy requirements set out in Policy DM24: Residential Development in Rural Settlements, will not apply. Additionally permitted development rights allow, subject to a 'prior notification' procedure, a range of changes of use to some existing rural buildings.

13.144 A fundamental principle underpinning the policy is protection of the rural character. Development proposals will be expected to make a positive contribution to rural character. The conversion should be undertaken in a sympathetic manner which retains important aspects of the original character and any distinctive elements of the building's design. The conversion must ensure that the immediate setting of the building is enhanced. Development proposals should pay particular regard to matters such as highway access, landscaping, means of enclosure and the provision of domestic paraphernalia to ensure that these are designed in such a manner so as to offer a positive contribution to the setting of the building and not detract from the wider rural character of the countryside. The Local Planning Authorities may apply restrictions on permitted development rights to ensure that environmental impacts are minimised and the character of the building is retained in the long term.

13.145 Policy DM27: Re-use of Disused and Redundant Rural Buildings requires that the building is physically capable of conversion and re-use for the intended purpose. This must be achievable without significant alteration, extension or substantive rebuilding. The Local Planning Authorities will expect the outcomes of a structural survey by a suitably qualified person, demonstrating that the building is structurally sound, to be submitted in support of any proposal.

13.146 Redundant or disused rural buildings can often serve as habitats for a range of wildlife including bats and barn owls. Some of these are protected species, subject to legal protection through a range of national and European legislation. Consequently, proposals for rural building conversion should be accompanied and informed by a habitat survey by a suitably qualified person and provide appropriate mitigation measures as necessitated by development. Policy DM08: Biodiversity and Geodiversity will apply.

13.147 If considered necessary, supplementary documentation may be provided to accompany the Local Plan to help applicants interpret and respond positively to the requirements of Policy DM27: Re-use of Disused and Redundant Rural Buildings.

Rural Worker Accommodation

Policy DM28: Rural Worker Accommodation

(1) Proposals for the provision of accommodation in the countryside for a rural worker will be supported where:

- (a) it can be demonstrated that there is an essential operational need for a full time worker to be resident at or near the place of work;**
- (b) the size and nature of the development is such that it can be sustained by the scale of the operation, reflective of the location and setting and proportionate to the needs of the intended occupants;**
- (c) the accommodation needs cannot be met by any other means including:**
 - (i) accommodation in a nearby settlement; or**
 - (ii) by an existing dwelling at or near the site; or**
 - (iii) through the conversion of a suitable redundant or disused building on site; and**
- (d) appropriate highway access can be provided.**

(2) Where the enterprise is well established, of a sufficient size to support a full-time worker, economically viable and has clear prospects of remaining so, support will be given to the provision of a permanent new dwelling.

(3) Where the enterprise does not meet the criteria set out to support the provision of a new permanent dwelling, the provision of temporary accommodation will be considered for an initial period of three years.

(4) New accommodation provided for rural workers will be, and all existing dwellings at the rural business may be, subject to occupancy restrictions and, where it is felt appropriate by the Local Planning Authority, may be subject to a legal agreement tying its use to the specific rural business.

(5) Applications for the removal of occupancy conditions or ties on dwellings for rural workers will only be permitted where there is compelling evidence to demonstrate that such a restriction is no longer justified.

13.148 Recognising the principles of sustainable development and the broader spatial strategy of the Local Plan, rural workers will usually be expected to be housed within rural settlements, existing dwellings in the Countryside or have accommodation provided through the conversion of redundant or disused rural buildings. In line with national planning policy, the Local Plan does recognise however that, exceptionally, there are occasions when the provision of a new dwelling in the Countryside to house a rural worker might be justified to support the operational requirements of an enterprise.

13.149 The Local Plan will enable the provision of a new dwelling to house a rural worker where it can be demonstrated that there is an essential need for a worker to be at or near the location of the rural enterprise to support its operational needs. Such a need might be justified where, for example, either livestock or agricultural processes require essential care and attention at short notice. Where the dwelling is justified on this basis, it will be expected to be located within 'sight and sound' of the livestock concerned. Security concerns alone will not be sufficient to justify the provision of a new dwelling.

13.150 Development proposals will need to be supported by compelling evidence to justify the essential operational need for the dwelling and to demonstrate that the accommodation need can only be fulfilled through the construction of a new dwelling. The recent disposal of a dwelling, or a building capable of conversion, on the rural enterprise will normally be considered to demonstrate a lack of need.

13.151 To ensure that the provision of a dwelling is a sustainable proposition, proposals will be expected to demonstrate that the rural enterprise is well established and financially capable of supporting a rural worker. The Local Planning Authorities will expect evidence to be submitted in the form of audited accounts in support of proposals that demonstrates that the rural enterprise is financially viable and capable of sustaining a rural worker along with a dwelling of the size proposed.

13.152 In cases where a rural enterprise is not well established, the provision of temporary accommodation such as a caravan or mobile home will be considered for an initial period, normally of three years. The provision of temporary accommodation for this period will offer the opportunity for the business to become established whilst offering the opportunity for its operational needs to be met. The operational need for the temporary dwelling will have to be demonstrated on the same basis as for the provision of a permanent dwelling. The Local Planning Authorities will also require evidence to demonstrate that the enterprise giving rise to the need has been planned on a sound financial basis with a costed business plan provided.

13.153 To ensure that the accommodation provided is affordable to rural workers, the size of the proposed dwelling will be expected to be such that it can be sustained by the scale of the rural business. As the dwelling will be provided exceptionally in the countryside, its scale and nature should also be reflective of its setting and wider rural context. Development proposals should also deliver appropriate vehicular access, whilst not detracting from the character of the countryside, including landscape features such as extensive hedgerows.

13.154 Dwellings provided in the Countryside for rural workers are enabled on an exceptional basis so as to support a prosperous rural economy. As such, all dwellings enabled through this policy will be subject to occupancy restrictions to ensure that the accommodation remains available to rural workers and is not recycled as open market housing. The Local Planning Authorities will normally control occupancy by means of a planning condition imposed on the planning permission, which ensures the dwelling remains tied to the agricultural or other appropriate rural occupational use and is not sold or rented to occupants who are not rural workers. Where it is felt appropriate, the Local Planning Authority may also tie the occupancy of the dwelling to the associated enterprise. Such circumstances will be set out in a Supplementary Planning Document. Further occupancy restrictions may also be imposed on all other existing dwellings on the holding to ensure that these are not capable of being detached from the enterprise.

13.155 To prevent the proliferation of dwellings in the Countryside, there is a presumption that the occupancy of dwellings exceptionally permitted to accommodate rural workers will remain restricted to such occupants in the long term. The removal of occupancy conditions imposed on dwellings for rural workers will only be enabled where it is robustly demonstrated that there is no long term need for the dwelling to accommodate a rural worker, either as part of the enterprise for which it was originally intended to support or otherwise in the locality.

13.156 To demonstrate that the dwelling is no longer required to accommodate rural workers, the Local Planning Authorities will expect applications for the removal of occupancy conditions to be supported by strong evidence demonstrating no demand for the property in the locality. Applicants will be expected to submit information to show that the dwelling has been marketed, at an appropriate price reflecting the occupancy restriction, for a period of at least 18 months and that there was no demand for the property over that period. The marketing strategy, along with the price at which the dwelling will be marketed, should be agreed with the Local Planning Authority prior to commencement of the marketing exercise.

13.157 If considered necessary, supplementary documentation may be provided to accompany the Local Plan to help applicants interpret and respond positively to the requirements of Policy DM28: Rural Worker Accommodation.

Farmer Family Attached Accommodation

13.158 The Councils recognise the importance of the agriculture industry for the northern Devon economy. There is a need to engage younger people in the farming industry so as to ensure the long term sustainability and longevity of the sector and enable a transition of knowledge, skills and expertise to new generations of farmers. To help with this transition, on working family farms the Local Plan supports the provision of self-contained accommodation to house members of the principal farmer's family who are employed on the holding.

Policy DM29: Farmer Family Attached Accommodation

Provision of a self-contained residential unit for occupation by members of the farmer's family employed on the working farm will be supported, subject to:

- (a) the form, scale, setting and design of the proposal respecting existing development, its context, setting and surroundings;**
- (b) the accommodation needs are unable to be met through the conversion of a suitable existing redundant or dis-used building on site;**
- (c) the accommodation being commensurate in scale to the needs of the intended occupants;**
- (d) the accommodation is attached to the main dwelling; and**
- (e) a planning condition restricting occupancy to members of the farmer's family directly employed on the farm holding.**

13.159 Attached accommodation enabled through the policy shall be provided as an extension to the main dwelling. In the interests of protecting the open nature of the countryside, the policy only supports the provision of an attached residential unit if it is not possible to convert an existing redundant rural building under Policy DM27: Re-use of Disused and Redundant Rural Buildings, to meet the housing needs.

13.160 Recognising that accommodation enabled under this Policy will often be provided in an isolated rural location it is important that proposals are designed in a manner sympathetic and sensitive to their context. The form, scale, setting and design of the residential unit should have regard to the existing dwelling and other built development in the locality and respect the wider context, setting and surroundings of the holding.

13.161 Proposals will need to be supported by evidence to demonstrate that one or more of the intended occupants of the attached accommodation are employed on the holding and that combined their employment on the holding is equivalent to at least one full-time worker. Evidence will also be required to demonstrate that there is an operational agricultural enterprise upon the holding. A planning condition will be applied restricting occupancy of the accommodation to members of the farmer's family directly employed on the farm holding.

Sites for Traveller Accommodation

13.162 National planning policy requires that adequate provision is made to meet the accommodation requirements of travellers. The strategic approach for delivering traveller accommodation is set out in Policy ST20: Providing Homes for the Travelling Community. Policy DM30: Sites for Traveller Accommodation, provides the detailed basis for assessing individual development proposals and allocations for traveller accommodation.

Policy DM30: Sites for Traveller Accommodation

(1) Sites for traveller accommodation will be allocated within a separate North Devon and Torridge Traveller Site Allocations Development Plan Document.

(2) Sites for traveller accommodation will be identified and planning applications will be supported, providing the sites meet all of the following criteria:

- (a) the development is commensurate and proportionate to the scale and nature of the nearest settled community;**
- (b) it does not have an unacceptable landscape, visual or environmental impact;**
- (c) it offers an acceptable level of amenity to prospective occupants and will have no significant detrimental impact to the amenities of neighbouring occupiers;**
- (d) the site is located where occupants can gain reasonable access to local services and facilities including health and school provision;**
- (e) it does not place undue pressure on local infrastructure and services;**
- (f) the health and safety of occupants and visitors will not be at risk through unsafe access to the site, noise pollution or unacceptable flood risk;**
- (g) adequate on-site provision is afforded for vehicle parking and manoeuvring along with appropriate storage space, ancillary facilities and residential amenity space;**
- (h) the site is capable of being provided with essential services; and**
- (i) the scale of employment activity is balanced to the residential component of the proposal.**

(3) Proposals seeking to deliver transit accommodation will be required to demonstrate that they offer adequate, safe and convenient access to the strategic highway network.

(4) Proposals seeking to deliver accommodation for travelling show people will be required to offer adequate provision for the on-site storage, maintenance and testing of associated equipment.

13.163 The policy applies a sequential approach to the consideration of suitable locations for traveller accommodation. The approach is intended to steer provision to the most sustainable locations whilst also recognising that traveller accommodation often has different requirements to that for the settled community.

13.164 Development proposals will be supported where there is an identified need for the scale and nature of accommodation provision proposed and it is demonstrated that the need cannot be reasonably met by any existing or planned provision.

13.165 Development proposals are subject to a range of requirements to ensure they will provide an adequate and suitable living environment for the intended occupants whilst respecting the interests of the settled community.

14 Glossary

Term	Definition
Accessible Natural Greenspace standard (ANGSt)	Natural England's standard is for access to good quality natural greenspace near to where people live, providing a broad range of benefits to them and the quality of their lives, including all the ecosystem services we depend upon. It seeks to improve the naturalness of and connectivity with green infrastructure including woodlands, orchards and moorland with public access and public open spaces managed for biodiversity.
Adopted	The final confirmation of a Local Development Plan Document as having statutory status by a Local Planning Authority.
Allocations	Proposals that a certain site or area of land should be developed for particular uses and/or buildings. They are shown on a Policies Map, contained within the Local Plan. There will be related policy setting out any parameters for the site contained within the Local Plan.
Affordable Housing	Housing provided for households whose needs are not met by the local housing market and defined as 'Affordable housing' in Annex 2 of the National Planning Policy Framework (or any subsequent revised definition provided through updated national planning policy or guidance).
Amenity and Natural Greenspace	Partly or wholly accessible spaces open to free and spontaneous use by the public and not managed solely for a specific function, including those spaces with nature and wildlife interest.
Archaeological Interest	Evidence of past human activity, the evolution of places and the cultures that made them.
Assisted Areas	Areas defined by the Government where regional aid can be offered to undertakings, typically businesses, under European Commission state aid rules.
Authority Monitoring Report	A report prepared to show progress made in preparing the Local Plan and the effectiveness of its policies.
Biodiversity	The whole variety of life on earth. It includes all species of plants and animals, their genetic variation and the ecosystems of which they are part.
Biodiversity Offsetting	Conservation activities that are designed to give biodiversity benefits to compensate for losses.
Biosphere Reserve	A designation by the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organisation (UNESCO) which identifies an area of world class natural value that demonstrates the best example of people working in harmony with nature for the benefit of all.
Buildings for Life	A national standard for housing and neighbourhood design. Development projects are scored against Building for Life criteria that covers: social wellbeing, quality of life through reducing crime, improving public health, easing and transport problems.

Term	Definition
Climate Change	Long term changes in temperature, wind and other aspects of the Earth's climate, often regarded as a result of human activity and release of carbon dioxide through fossil fuel consumption.
Coastal and Estuarine Zone	The extent of the area adjoining the coastline and Taw-Torridge estuary with a broadly coastal and estuarine landscape character extending inland to the A39, A361 and A3123 and upstream to the normal tidal limit.
Code for Sustainable Homes	The national standard for the sustainable construction of new homes with 6 code levels, linked to Building Regulations and used by architects and builders as a guide to development, and by home buyers to assist in their choice of home.
Community Facilities	A wide range of local facilities and services accessible to members of the public including schools, libraries, local shops, healthcare facilities, places of worship, meeting halls, public houses, sports facilities and public open spaces.
Community Infrastructure Levy	A levy that local authorities can choose to charge on development in their area. The money can be used to support development by funding infrastructure that the Council, local community and neighbourhoods require.
Comparison Goods	Shops that sell items where some comparison is likely to be made before the purchase of goods (e.g. clothing, carpets, electrical goods).
Convenience Goods	Convenience retailing is the provision of everyday essential items, primarily food.
Countryside	The area beyond: (a) development boundaries, as identified on the Policies Map; and (b) the principal built form and sites allocated for development in defined Settlements without development boundaries and Rural Settlements.
County Geological Sites	Quarries, cliffs and natural rock exposures that are considered to be especially important as educational, historical and scientific resources for the geodiversity (geology and geomorphology) they exhibit. Also known as Regionally Important Geological Sites (RIGS).
Critical Drainage Areas	Areas with localised flooding identified by the Environment Agency where new development will utilise Sustainable Drainage Systems to reduce current runoff rates by creating additional water storage areas contributing to a reduction in flood risk downstream.
Critical Environmental Capital	Environmental assets, especially natural habitats, that cannot be restored or replaced to an equivalent value elsewhere, such as ancient woodland.

Term	Definition
Decentralised Generation	Small-scale energy generation connected directly to a local distribution system rather than the national grid. Generally associated with the co-generation of heat and electricity enabling overall carbon emissions reductions.
Defined Settlement	A settlement designated through the Local Plan Policy ST06 as a Sub-regional Centre, Strategic Centre or Main Centre and Policy ST07 as a Local Centre or Village.
Demand Management Measures	Demand management for transport covers a range of measures aimed at reducing the adverse impacts of car use, particularly that of single-occupancy private vehicles and peak flows. It is a general term for strategies that result in more efficient use of transportation resources, including travel by means other than private cars. Demand management can be a cost effective alternative to increasing capacity and resilience on the network as well as an approach to transport that has the potential to deliver better environmental outcomes, improved public health, stronger and more prosperous communities.
Designated Rural Area	An area designated under Section 157 of the Housing Act 1985 as being a rural area.
Developed Coast	Areas within the Coastal and Estuarine Zone with a predominantly developed character, which are the areas within development boundaries as identified on the Policies Map; the principal built form and sites allocated for development in defined Settlements without development boundaries; Rural Settlements; Defence Estate sites; and large previously developed sites or those parts of sites with a substantial level of permanent structures such as sewage treatment works and the developed part of static caravan sites.
Development Management Policies	Policies in Part 3 of this Plan setting out criteria for the protection of the natural, built and residential environment. They will not repeat national planning policy.
Development Plan	The Development Plan sets out land use planning policies and development proposals against which planning applications will be considered. The Development Plan comprises adopted Local Plans, Neighbourhood Development Plans and Regional strategies until such are revoked.
Devon Character Areas	Distinct geographical areas sharing a distinct and unique landscape character recognisable at a county scale, such as the Exmoor Fringe, identified through the Devon Landscape Character Assessment.
District Centres	Areas that provide a range of town centre uses including shops, services and facilities to meet the day to day needs of the local community.
Duty to Co-operate	A requirement of the Localism Act for public bodies to co-operate in the preparation of their plans and strategies.

Term	Definition
Economic Development	Development, including those within the B Use Classes, public and community uses and main town centre uses (excluding housing development).
Ecosystems	Environments consisting of all living things in a particular area and the non-living things with which they interact such as soil, air, water and sunlight.
Ecosystem Services	The benefits provided by natural systems including provisioning services; regulating services; cultural services; and supporting services.
Employment Land Review	Analysis of the demand for employment land and premises over the Plan period, a review of the quality and suitability of existing and proposed employment sites, and assessment of the need for additional employment land over this period.
Environmental Report	The report produced for the SEA that identifies, describes and evaluates the likely significant effects of implementing Local Plan policies and proposals.
Examination	An examination chaired by an independent inspector in to objections to the Local Plan and the overall “soundness” of Local Plan documents.
Exception Site	A site, which is developed predominantly for affordable housing where there is a normal presumption against housing development.
Farmer	A person operating or managing a farm.
Flood Risk	Identified probability of flooding from any water sources including fluvial, tidal, surface and ground water flooding.
Functionality	The significance of a settlement in relation to its role and function rather than size in respect of population.
Geodiversity	The variety of rocks, minerals, fossils (the geology), together with the variety of soils, natural processes and landforms (the geomorphology) found in a particular area.
Green Infrastructure	Green infrastructure is a network of multi-functional green space, urban and rural, which is capable of delivering a wide range of environmental and quality of life benefits for local communities. Green infrastructure includes parks, open spaces, playing fields, woodlands, street trees, allotments and private gardens. (NPPG Reference ID: 8-015-20140306)
Gross Internal Area	The Gross Internal Area is defined as the total floor space measured between the internal faces of perimeter walls. This includes partitions, structural elements, ducts, flights of stairs and voids above stairs. The Gross Internal Area should be measured and denoted in square metres (m ²).

Term	Definition
Habitats Regulations Assessment	A legal requirement to assess the impact of plans and proposals on the nature conservation importance of designated European habitats.
Heritage Assets	Identified buildings, sites or landscapes having a degree of historic significance due to their heritage interest, whether formally designated or not.
Historic Environment	All aspects of the environment resulting from the interaction between people and places through time, including all surviving remains of past human activity, whether visible, buried or submerged, and landscape and planted flora and fauna.
Housing Market Area	Geographic areas defined by household demand and preferences for housing. They reflect the key functional linkages between places where people live and work.
Housing Trajectory	A bar graph showing the projected annual delivery of new homes across northern Devon over the Plan period (2011-2031), summarising the total delivery of homes anticipated from specific sites built since 2011, existing commitments and Local Plan allocations identified through the Strategic Housing Land Availability Assessment.
Hub Sites	Larger parks and recreation grounds, currently or capable of performing a range of functions and facilities for outdoor sport and recreation, typically more than 2 hectares in size with more than one sports pitch, changing rooms, play facilities for children and young people, a village hall or pavilion, car parking and space for events or informal recreation.
In-fill	Development of a small gap in an otherwise developed frontage between two existing buildings and sufficient to accommodate a maximum of three dwellings at a sensible density.
Infrastructure	A collective term for services such as roads, electricity, sewerage, water, schools, health facilities, flood defences and types of green infrastructure.
Infrastructure Delivery Plan	Sets out the critical infrastructure that is required to support the objectives, policies and spatial strategy set out in the Planning Strategy and details how, when and where this will be delivered.
Jobs	Employment for local people from a variety of land uses and activities within all employment sectors including tourism, retailing and agriculture.
Key Stakeholders	Organisations and service providers with an interest in northern Devon, parish and town councils, local community groups and neighbouring authorities.
Landscape Character Area	A defined geographical zone exhibiting a specific local Landscape Character Type, such as the Torridge river valley.

Term	Definition
Landscape Character Type	Categories of common landscape character (such as secluded valleys) distributed in discrete Landscape Character Areas across a wider geographical area.
Lifetime Homes	A home built with design features that create a flexible blueprint for accessible and adaptable housing in any setting. Designs incorporate features that allow for flexible living over the lifetime of the occupants and property.
Local Centres	Large villages in northern Devon which function as locally important rural service centres and will be the focus for development in rural areas.
Local Green Space	An open area of local significance which is demonstrably special to a local community because of its beauty, historic significance, recreational value, tranquillity and/or the richness of its wildlife, as defined by the NPPF.
Local Housing Needs	The scale, type, size and tenure of housing needed in a town, village or rural settlement, including affordable housing needs, together with the housing needs of the wider area served by the respective main and local centres including, where appropriate, parishes within adjoining districts.
Locally Generated Need	A household with a local connection to the defined Rural Settlement, satisfying the criteria set out in paragraph 13.133, including the need for a new home by virtue of the lack of suitability and availability of alternatives.
Locally Important Building	Buildings and structures that are not identified on the statutory list of buildings of special architectural or historic interest but are identified by the Councils in accordance with qualifying criteria to be enhancing the local street scene by contributing positively to the character, diversity and local distinctiveness of northern Devon's historic environment.
Local Transport Plan (LTP)	An integrated strategy, prepared by local highway authorities (such as Devon County Council) in partnership with the community, seeking funding to help provide local transport projects. The LTP sets out the resources predicted for delivery of the targets identified in the strategy.
Low Carbon	Efficient use of all resources (in particular energy) resulting in a reduction in carbon emissions. Includes the use of renewable and alternative energy sources, minimisation of waste and local production of goods, materials and energy.
Main Centres	The largest settlements in northern Devon (beyond Barnstaple and Bideford), which function as major service centres where the majority of growth is proposed: Braunton/Wrafton, Great Torrington, Holsworthy, Ilfracombe, Northam and South Molton.
Main Town Centre Uses	Retail development (including warehouse clubs and factory outlet centres); leisure and entertainment facilities, the more intensive sport

Term	Definition
	and recreation uses (including cinemas, restaurants, drive-through restaurants, bars and pubs, night-clubs, casinos, health and fitness centres, indoor bowling centres, and bingo halls); offices; arts, culture and tourism development (including theatres, museums, galleries and concert halls, hotels and conference facilities) (NPPF Annex 2).
Major Development	Planning applications for development involving any one of the following: a. The mining and working of minerals or the use of land for mineral-working deposits; b. Waste development; c. The provision of dwelling houses where: i. the number of dwelling houses to be provided is 10 or more; or ii. the development is to be carried out on a site having an area of 0.5 hectare or more and it is not known whether the development falls within paragraph (c(i)); d. The provision of a building or buildings where the floor space to be created by the development is 1000 square metres or more; or e. Development carried out on a site having an area of 1 hectare or more.
Marine Conservation Zone	Protected marine areas designated by Defra to protect nationally important wildlife, habitats, geology and geomorphology, including the seas around Lundy.
Marine Management Organisation	Organisation established under the Marine and Coastal Access Act (2009) with responsibility for marine licensing and preparing marine plans.
Master Plan	A type of planning brief outlining the preferred usage of land and buildings, as a framework for planning applications.
Material Considerations	Any consideration relevant to the use and development of land and which is taken into account in determining a planning application.
Minor Development	Planning applications that fall below the limits set out in Major Applications referred to above.
National Planning Practice Guidance (NPPG)	The Government's national planning guidance for new development that supports and informs the National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF) and how these policies are expected to be applied.
National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF)	The Government's planning policies for England and how they should be applied.

Term	Definition
Nature Improvement Area	A large part of the River Torridge catchment area designated by Natural England to restore it towards an integrated network of wildlife-rich habitats.
Neighbourhood Plans	Community-led development plans prepared by parish and town councils or neighbourhood fora for particular neighbourhoods, in general conformity with the strategic policies of this Local Plan, to shape future development in a local community, being supported by the majority of the neighbourhood in a local referendum.
Net Dwelling Density	Net dwelling density is calculated by including only those site areas which will be developed for housing and directly associated uses, including access roads within the site, private garden space, car parking areas, incidental open space and landscaping and children's play areas, where these are provided.
Non Allocated Developable Sites	Sites identified as 'developable' (considered to be suitable and available for residential development and with a realistic prospect that development will be achievable over the Plan period) through the Strategic Housing Land Availability Assessment (SHLAA), which are within the defined development boundary, but are not subject to a site specific allocation and did not have extant planning permission at 1 April 2013. These sites are included within the overall housing supply up to 2031 but are not shown on the Policies Maps.
North Devon Council	The operating name for North Devon District Council.
Northern Devon	The area comprising Torridge and North Devon districts (excluding the part within Exmoor National Park).
Open Space	All space of public value, including public landscaped areas, parks, allotments and playing fields, and also including, not just land, but also areas of water, such as rivers, lakes and reservoirs, which offer opportunities for sport and recreation or can act as a visual amenity.
Other Strategic Routes	Main roads of strategic local importance not included within the Strategic Road Network, including the A39.
Planning Obligations	Legal agreements between a planning authority and a developer, or undertakings offered unilaterally by a developer, that ensure certain extra works related to a development are undertaken.
Pitch	A unit of land designed to accommodate a single family, household, or extended family, which shares cooking arrangements. As a single caravan or lorry is typically a sleeping unit, it is common to have more than one vehicle on a single pitch.
Plot	The area of land set aside for accommodation by one family unit and the area of land set aside for the storage and maintenance of their equipment would collectively form a plot.
Previously Developed Land	Defined by NPPF as land which is or was occupied by a permanent structure, including the curtilage of the development land and any

Term	Definition
	associated fixed surface infrastructure. This excludes: land that is or has been occupied by agriculture or forestry buildings; land that has been developed for minerals extraction or waste disposal for landfill purposes where provision for restoration has been made through development control procedures; land in built up areas such as private residential gardens, parks, recreation grounds and allotments; and land that was previously – developed but where the remains of the permanent structure or fixed surface structure have blended into the landscape in the process of time.
Protected Species	A species of animal or plant which it is forbidden by law to harm or destroy. Includes International, European and National protection.
Policies Map	Shows policy designations and allocations in the Development Plan on an Ordnance Survey map at a recognised scale.
Primary Frontage	The central part of a Primary Shopping Area, typically along the High Street, where there is a high proportion of retail uses.
Primary Shopping Area	A defined town centre area where retail and other town centre uses are concentrated.
Recreational Routes	Strategic footpaths, cycleways and bridleways forming part of a green infrastructure network, such as the South West Coast Path and Tarka Trail.
Regulation 123 List	The list sets out the types of infrastructure that may be funded by Community Infrastructure Levy (CIL) in North Devon and Torridge.
Renewable Energy	Energy produced from a sustainable source that avoids the depletion of the earth's finite natural resources, such as oil or gas. Sources in use or in development include energy from sun, wind, hydropower, ocean energy, biomass and energy from waste.
Rural Enterprises	Land based businesses operating in the open countryside, such as agriculture, forestry and associated farm diversification activities.
Rural Parish	A parish designated as a rural area under Section 157 of the Housing Act 1985.
Rural Settlements	A small, closely grouped cluster of housing that contains at least one identified local service or community facility.
Rural Worker	A person employed in agriculture, forestry or other rural enterprise.
Section 106 Agreements	A type of planning obligation or legal agreement attached to a planning permission.
Shoreline Management Plan	A plan providing a large scale assessment of the risk to people and to the developed, historic and natural environment associated with coastal processes.
Site Allocations	Site allocations are the sites, which are proposed for development to meet identified needs (generally housing, employment and retail

Term	Definition
	floorspace) and which are subject to specific development criteria in addition to requirements provided through general Development Management Policies.
Small Scale Economic Development	Development for employment or commercial purposes of a scale not exceeding 250 square metres gross external floor area or a site area of 0.1 hectares.
Soundness	The policies in development plan documents will be tested thoroughly during an independent examination. The presumption will be that the development plan document is sound unless it is shown to be otherwise as a result of evidence considered at the examination.
Spatial Planning	A system that brings together and integrates policies for the development and use of land with other policies and programmes, which influence the nature of places and how they function. This will include policies that impact on the use of land but which are not capable of being delivered solely or mainly through the granting of planning permission and may be delivered through other means.
Special Areas of Conservation	Sites designated under the European Community Habitats Directive to protect internationally important habitats and species.
Specialist Accommodation	Accommodation that incorporates an intrinsic element of care, support or supervision for the residents.
Stakeholders	People who have an interest in the activities and achievements of the Council, including residents, local communities of interest, partners, employees, customers, shareholders, suppliers, opinion leaders, regulators, developers and their agents, and “hard to reach” groups.
Starter Homes Exception Sites	Sites comprising of underused or unviable industrial and commercial land, or other forms of unviable or underused brownfield land defined through national planning policy or guidance as falling within the scope of being considered capable of being a Starter Home exception site, which are not previously identified for housing and provide for the delivery of Starter Homes.
Statement of Community Involvement	The SCI sets out how each Council intends to achieve continuous community involvement in the preparation, alteration and continuing review of development plans in their area. It will also deal with community involvement in the development management process.
Strategic Centre	Bideford, as a focus for employment and services, where significant levels of housing and employment development will be accommodated to meet the needs of the town and surrounding area.
Strategic Environmental Assessment (SEA)	The European SEA Directive requires a formal environmental assessment of certain plans and programmes which are likely to have significant effects on the environment. Local authorities are advised to take an integrated approach towards Sustainability Appraisal and Strategic Environmental Assessment to avoid unnecessary duplication and confusion. Together they will play an important part in testing the

Term	Definition
	soundness of Local Development Documents, ensuring that they contribute towards sustainable development objectives.
Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA)	An assessment of risks from all forms of flooding to guide the location of development.
Strategic Housing Land Availability Assessment (SHLAA)	A technical document agreed by a Stakeholder Panel that assesses the suitability, availability and achievability of potential sites for future housing provision and identifies a trajectory for future delivery of housing.
Strategic Housing Market Assessment (SHMA)	A study into the long term housing demand, supply and needs of a market area. A market area can be defined as the geographic area within which the majority of households move.
Strategic Road Network	The main roads identified in the Local Transport Plan, which in northern Devon are the A361 from Barnstaple towards the M5, and the A30.
Strategy	An overall plan, which can be for the short, medium or long term, and clearly shows, what is going to be achieved.
Sub-Regional Centre	Barnstaple, as the strategic employment, retail and service centre for northern Devon, where significant levels of development will be accommodated to meet the needs of the town and surrounding area.
Sustainability Appraisal	Sustainability Appraisal (SA) and Strategic Environmental Assessment (SEA) are processes used to ensure that the principles of sustainable development are considered in the preparation of planning policy documents. SA and SEA are iterative processes which should be undertaken in parallel with the preparation of any planning documents, and should be used to inform decisions on options, and the content of the planning documents themselves.
Sustainable Communities	Sustainable communities “meet the diverse needs of existing and future residents, their children and other users, contribute to a high quality of life and provide opportunities and choice. They achieve this in a way that makes effective use of natural resources, enhance the environment, promote social cohesion and strengthen economic prosperity” (source: The Egan Review; skills for sustainable communities, ODPM 2004).
Sustainable Development	Environmentally responsible development, commonly defined as “development that meets the needs of the present without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs” (source: Brundtland Report, 1987).
Sustainable Drainage Systems (SUDs)	SUDs are designed to control the quantity of run-off from a development, to improve the quality of the run-off and to enhance the nature conservation, landscape and amenity value of the sites surroundings.

Term	Definition
Tourism Accommodation	Tourism accommodation includes any type of accommodation for use within the tourism industry and takes many different forms including hotels, guest houses, bed and breakfast premises, hostels, and self-catering accommodation including holiday homes, touring and static caravan sites and camping sites. It caters for a variety of standards and budgets. It does not include second homes.
Town Centres	Defined in the NPPF as: area defined on the local authorities proposals map, including the Primary Shopping Area and areas predominantly occupied by main town centre uses within or adjacent to the Primary Shopping Area.
Tranquillity	The quality of calm experienced in places with mainly natural features and activities free from man-made disturbance including noise and light pollution.
Travellers	Defined in the national Planning Policy for traveller sites; the collective name for 'gypsies and travellers' and 'travelling showpeople'.
Travelling Showpeople	Defined in the National Planning Policy for Traveller Sites; members of a group organised for the purposes of holding fairs, circuses or shows (whether or not travelling together as such). This includes such persons who on the grounds of their own or their family or dependants' more localised pattern of trading, educational or health needs or old age have ceased to travel temporarily or permanently, but excludes Gypsies and Travellers.
Undeveloped Coast	The area within the Coastal and Estuarine Zone that is outside the Developed Coast.
Use Class	A group of land use categories defined by the Use Classes Order and within which permitted development rights may be exercised.
Valued Environmental Assets	Areas, networks and buildings, which are of, recognised value through, international, national and locally defined designations.
Viability and Vitality	In terms of retailing, vitality is the capacity of a centre to grow or to develop its level of commercial activity. Viability is the capacity of a centre to achieve the commercial success necessary to sustain the existence of the centre.
Villages	Defined settlements in northern Devon with an identifiable community, either individually or through a cluster of settlements, with a local shop and/or a primary school and a range of local community services and facilities.
Waste Audit Statement	Document demonstrating how the demolition, construction and operational phases of the development will minimise the generation of waste and provide for the management of waste in accordance with the waste hierarchy, as well as identifying the measures taken to minimise the generation of hazardous waste.

Term	Definition
Waste Management Plan	Also known as 'Site Waste Management Plan'. A document demonstrating how waste minimisation and management on a construction site is planned, implemented, monitored and reviewed.
Well Related	Sites adjoining the main built up form of a settlement, particularly in relation to villages without identified development boundaries and 'exception sites' outside defined development boundaries.
Windfall	Defined in the NPPF as: sites which have not specifically been identified as available in the Local Plan process. They normally comprise previously developed sites that have unexpectedly become available.

Appendix 1 Superseded Policies

North Devon Local Plan (adopted July 2006) saved policy number	Name of Policy to be superseded
STY1	Sub-regional Centre
STY2	Area Centres
STY3	Local Centres
DVS1A	Sustainable Development
DVS1	Design
DVS2	Landscaping
DVS3	Amenity Considerations
DVS4	Public Health & Safety
DVS5	High Pressure Gas Main and Air Safeguarding Zone
DVS6	Flooding and Water Quality
DVS7	Sustainable Urban Drainage Systems
ENV1	Development in the Countryside
ENV2	Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty
ENV3	Heritage Coast
ENV4	Exmoor National Park
ENV5	Coastal Preservation Area
ENV6	Areas of Great Landscape Value
ENV7	Agricultural Land
ENV8	Biodiversity
ENV9	International Nature Conservation Sites
ENV10	Sites of Special Scientific Interest
ENV11	Protected Species
ENV12	Locally Important Wildlife or Geological Sites
ENV13	Nationally Important Archaeological Remains
ENV14	Locally Important Archaeological Sites
ENV15	Historic Parks and Gardens
ENV16	Development in Conservation Areas
ENV17	Listed Buildings
ENV18	Locally Important Buildings
TRA1A	Promoting Sustainable Transport Choices
TRA6	General Highway Considerations

TRA7	Non Residential Parking
TRA8	Residential Parking
TRA8A	Safeguarding Public Car Parks
TRA9	Telecommunications
HSG1A	Total Housing Provision
HSG1	The Sequential Approach
HSG2	Development Boundaries
HSG3	Small Villages in Priority Areas for Rural Regeneration
HSG4	Residential Development in Identified Rural Settlements
HSG5	Residential Density
HSG6	Mixed Accommodation
HSG7	Affordable Housing In Residential Schemes
HSG8	Affordable Housing in Rural Areas
HSG9	Permanent Dwellings in the Countryside
HSG9A	Permanent Dwellings in the Countryside for Rural Based Industries
HSG10	Temporary Accommodation on New Farm or Forestry Enterprises
HSG11	Occupancy Conditions
HSG12	Extensions to Small Dwellings in the Countryside
HSG13	The Modification of a Holiday Condition in a Converted Rural Building
ECN1	Employment on Non Allocated Land in Barnstaple and the Area Centres
ECN2	Safeguarding Employment Land
ECN3	Employment Within or Adjoining a Rural Settlement
ECN4	Employment Development Relating to Agriculture
ECN5	The Re-use of Buildings in the Countryside
ECN6	Farm Diversification Schemes
ECN7	Agricultural Buildings
ECN8	Serviced Accommodation
ECN9	Self Catering Accommodation
ECN10	Caravanning & Camping
ECN11	Improvement to Self Catering Accommodation
ECN12	Holiday Occupancy Conditions
ECN13	Visitor Attractions
ECN14	Large Scale and Innovative Projects
ECN15	Renewable Energy

COM1	Retailing Proposals
COM2	Local Shops, Public Houses and Post Offices
COM3	Protecting Local Shops, Public Houses and Post Offices
COM4	Community Facilities
REC1	Indoor Sport and Leisure Facilities
REC2	Sport and Recreation Facilities in Villages
REC3	Sport and Recreation in the Countryside
REC4	Safeguarding Former Transport Routes
REC5	Public Open Space
REC6	Preventing the Loss of Open Space
REC7	Water Based Recreation
REC8	Public Art
BAR1	Residential Development on Previously Developed Sites
BAR2	Residential Development on Greenfield Land
BAR3	Roundswell Strategic Employment Land
BAR3A	Herton Technology Park
BAR4	Primary Shopping Areas
BAR5	Secondary Shopping Areas
BAR6	Town Centre Expansion
BAR6D	Transshipment Facility
BAR7	Local Shopping Centres
BAR8	Formal Planning Pitches
BAR9	Community Parks & Woodlands
BAR10	Recreational Activities at Portmore
BAR11	Parking for Pilton Schools
BAR12	Roundswell School
BAR13	North Devon College
BAR14	Seven Brethren Regeneration
BAR16	Pedestrian and Cycle Routes
BAR17	Park and Ride Schemes
FRE1	Sampsons Plantation
FRE2	Fremington Army Camp
FRE4	Redevelopment at Yelland Quay
FRE5	Community Parks & Woodland

FRE6	Community Centre
INS1	Public Open Space Provision
INS2	North Devon Yacht Club
SMO1	Residential Development on Previously Developed Sites
SMO2	Residential Development on Greenfield Sites
SMO3	Pathfields Business Park
SMO3A	Livestock Market
SMO4	Hill Village
SMO5	The Town Centre
SMO6	Town Centre Expansion
SMO7	Community Park and Woodland
CHM2	Back Lane Industrial Estate
WIT1	Residential Development
WIT2A	Public Open Space Provision
WIT2B	Camping Area
WIT3	Footpath Link
BNY1	Residential Development at Joeys Field
BNY2	Village Car Park
BIT1	Public Open Space
BIT2	Village Car Park
BUR1	Residential Development
BUR2	Village Car Park
LAN1	Residential Development
SWM1	Residential Proposals
ILF1	Residential Development on Previously Developed Site
ILF3	Residential Development on Greenfield Sites
ILF4	Workshop Units at Killacleave
ILF5	Primary Shopping Frontage
ILF6	Secondary Shopping Frontages
ILF7	Harbour Development
ILF8	Ilfracombe Harbour Shopping Area
ILF9	The Bus Station
ILF11	Public Open Space Provision at Larkstone, Killacleave and Slade Valley
ILF13	Extension at Ilfracombe Cemetery

BRA1	Braunton Great Field
BRA2	Residential Development on Previously Developed Sites
BRA3	Residential Development on Greenfield Sites
BRA4	Wrafton Glebefield
BRA5	Employment at Velator
BRA6	Braunton Village Centre
BRA7	Public Open Space Provision
CBM1	Combe Martin Field System
CBM2	Residential Development on Previously Developed Sites
CBM2C	Residential Development on Land off Spurway Gardens
CBM3	Parkhills Industrial Estate
CBM4	Riverside Walk
CBM5	Public Open Space Provision
CBM6	Combe Martin Cemetery Allocation
WOO2	Woolacombe Shopping Core Area
WOO3	Woolacombe's Hotels
BER1	Land Adjacent Village Car Park
BRF1A	Residential Development in Bratton Fleming
BRF2	Bratton Fleming Industrial Estate
CRY1	Public Open Space Provision
KNW1	Residential Development
NMO1	Lower Poole
NMO2	Residential Development North of Back Lane
NMO3	North Molton Sports Ground
NMO4	Community Woodland
NMO5	Former Primary School
WED1	Public Open Space

North Devon Local Plan Proposals Map and Inset Maps 1 to 24

Torridge District Local Plan (adopted September 2004) saved policy number	Name of Policy to be superseded
DVT1	Development in Strategic Centres
DVT2	Development at Rural Settlements
DVT2C	Development in the Open Countryside
DVT3	Building conversion in the Countryside
DVT4	Replacement buildings in the Countryside
DVT5	Mixed use development
DVT6	Local distinctiveness
DVT7	Design considerations
DVT8	Landscaping
DVT9	Open space
DVT11	Impact of development on amenity
DVT12	Pollution and hazardous substances
DVT13	Noise emission and disturbance
DVT14	Areas at risk
DVT15	Adverts and advance directional signs
DVT16	Infrastructure provision
DVT17	Transport routes
DVT18	Impact of development on traffic
DVT19	Access and parking
DVT19	Car park redevelopment
DVT20	Cycle and pedestrian routes
DVT21	Telecommunications development
DVT22	Lines, pipes, and cables
DVT24	Sewerage and drainage
ECD1	Employment land
ECD2	General employment areas (GEAs)
ECD3	Employment development outside GEAs
ECD4	Reuse of employment sites
ECD5	Agricultural development
ECD6	Tourist development criteria
ECD7	Westward Ho!

ECD8	Holiday and seasonal occupancy
HSC1	Housing development
HSC2	Affordable housing
HSC3	Housing and residential estate layouts
HSC4	House extensions and annexes
HSC6	Exceptions housing for local needs
HSC8	Agricultural workers' dwellings
HSC9	Removal of occupancy conditions
HSC10	Temporary agricultural dwellings
HSC11	Gypsy site provision
HSC12	Protection of sport and recreation facilities
HSC13	Play facilities in new housing development
HSC14	Recreation development criteria
HSC14A	Access to the countryside
HSC15	Horse related activities
HSC16	Development in town centres
HSC17	Primary and secondary shopping frontages
HSC18	Shop fronts
HSC19	Major retail development
HSC20	Local shops
HSC21	Retail outlets in the countryside
HSC21A	Farm shops
HSC22	Community service development and local services
HSC23	Community hall development
HSC24	Public art
ENV1	Conservation interest
ENV2	Development affecting historic buildings and structures
ENV3	Development affecting conservation areas
ENV4	Archaeological preservation
ENV5	Countryside protection and landscape conservation
ENV6	Designated landscape areas
ENV7	Protection of important nature conservation interests
ENV9	Important wildlife corridors
ENV10	Mitigation and enhancement

BID2	East-the-water
BID3	Old Barnstaple Road
BID5	Moreton park
BID7	Westcombe Lane
BID8	Livestock market
BID9	Diddywell Road
BID10	East-the-Water employment
BID13	Bideford port
BID14	Bridge Street
BID15	Bideford pannier market
BID16	East-the-Water wharves
BID17	Richmond dock
BID26	Middle dock
BID18	Bideford to Appledore railway
BID19	Adjoining Torridge pool
BID24	Seven Oaks
BID27	Kenwith Valley LNR
BID28	Site at Staddon Hill
WHO1	Tourism and recreation sites
WHO3	Recreation development criteria
GT1	South of Juries Lane
GT4	Hatchmoor
GT6	Donnacraft and Hatchmoor fields
GT8	Site west of School Lane
GT9	Great Torrington Commons and conservator lands
GT10	Taddiport
HOL3	East of Deer River
HOL5	East of Trewyn Road
HOL6	Former station site
HOL7	Livestock market site
HOL8	Site west of community college
HOL10	North of Meadow View
HOL11	Site north of South Arscott
HOL12	North of Stanhope Park

BRD3	East of North Road
HAJ1	East of Station Road
HAJ2	Former Winsford hospital
HAJ3	East of Chapel Farm
HTD1	Eastdown Park
HIB1	West of Barton Meadow
HIB2	Mill Lane
HIB3	North of the village
WINK1	Winkleigh airfield
WINK2	War memorials field
WINK4	Southeast of the village
BEA1	Towell Meadow
LNG2	Land adjoining community school and hall
PRK1	South of village

Torridge District Local Plan Proposals Map and all Inset Maps

Appendix 2 Housing Trajectory

SOURCE OF HOUSING SUPPLY	11/12	12/13	13/14	14/15	15/16	16/17	17/18	18/19
Barnstaple								
Allocations								
BAR01: Westacott Strategic Extension	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
BAR02: Larkbear Strategic Extension	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
BAR02a: Old Torrington Road, Roundswell	0	0	0	0	38	11	9	70
BAR03: Tews Lane, Roundswell	0	0	0	0	0	0	70	90
BAR04: Mount Sandford Green	0	0	0	0	0	0	12	20
BAR05: Westaway Plain, Pilton (east of Shearford Lane)	0	0	0	0	0	36	6	0
BAR05: Westaway Plain, Pilton (west of Shearford Lane)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
BAR06: South of North Devon District Hospital	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
BAR07: North Lane, Bickington	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
BAR08: Former School Site, Roundswell	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
BAR09: Glenwood Farm, Roundswell	0	0	0	0	23	44	39	40
BAR12: Anchorwood Bank	0	0	0	0	0	0	23	43
Non-Strategic Housing Sites								
Telephone Repeater Station, Rackfield	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Old Laundry, Lower Raleigh Road	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Land adj. Aviemore Industrial Estate	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Land west of Goodleigh Road	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	6
Whiddon Park, Mount Sandford	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Land north of Bickington Road, adj. Mead Park, Bickington	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Land between Oliver Road and Valley Close	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Land west of Oakland Park South, Sticklepath	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	152	60
Completions (excluding Allocations)	38	68	103	83	44	39	0	0
Bideford								
Allocation								
BID01: Bideford West Urban Extension	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
BID02: Cleave Wood	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
BID03: Land adjoining Manteo Way	0	0	0	1	13	0	4	8
BID04: Site South of East-the-Water	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
BID05: Land adjoining Caddsdawn Business Park	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
BID09: South of Clovelly Road	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Non-Strategic Housing Sites								
Land at Brunswick Wharf, East-the-Water	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Car parks, Bridge Street	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Land at Kingsley School	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Land at Nuttaberry, East-the-Water	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	92	54
Completions (excluding Allocations)	150	89	24	251	155	97	0	0

19/20	20/21	21/22	22/23	23/24	24/25	25/26	26/27	27/28	28/29	29/30	30/31	Lapse Rate ⁽¹⁾	Total 2011-2031 ⁽²⁾
0	30	50	50	63	72	133	120	120	120	100	92	0	950
0	70	75	75	75	75	75	75	75	75	75	75	0	820
10	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	138
76	70	44	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	350
20	20	20	20	20	20	20	3	0	0	0	0	0	175
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	42
21	21	28	15	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	85
0	20	30	40	15	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	105
0	0	15	20	30	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	65
0	20	30	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	50
33	31	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	210
45	35	26	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	172
0	0	0	0	0	10	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	10
0	0	0	6	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	6
0	0	9	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	9
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	6
0	0	0	0	5	6	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	11
11	25	25	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	61
0	0	0	0	16	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	16
14	20	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	34
93	59	83	20	0	0	15	0	0	0	0	0	8.85	473
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	375
20	60	70	50	95	115	135	139	90	75	75	75	0	999
0	30	60	60	60	40	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	250
8	34	31	0	0	0	0	40	40	40	40	47	0	306
0	0	0	30	50	50	50	50	50	50	50	50	0	430
0	30	30	30	30	10	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	130
20	60	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	60	0	0	0	700
0	20	32	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	52
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	20	30	0	0	0	0	50
0	8	10	10	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	28
0	20	40	36	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	96
32	21	57	48	20	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2.25	322
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	766

SOURCE OF HOUSING SUPPLY	11/12	12/13	13/14	14/15	15/16	16/17	17/18	18/19
Braunton and Wrafton								
Allocations								
BRA01: Wrafton South Eastern Extension	0	0	0	0	0	22	45	48
BRA02: Wrafton Glebefield	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
BRA02A: Land East and West of Staggers Lane	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	6	10
Completions (excluding Allocations)	7	3	30	20	17	6	0	0
Fremington and Yelland								
Allocations								
FRE01: Fremington Army Camp	0	0	0	0	2	163	80	32
FRE02: Yelland Quay	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	25	73
Completions (excluding Allocations)	20	34	3	2	3	1	0	0
Great Torrington								
Allocations								
GTT01: The Former Creamery Site	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
GTT03: Hatchmoor Common Lane	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
GTT04: Adjacent to Dartington Fields	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
GTT05: North of Burwood Lane	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
GTT07: East of School Lane	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	37	7
Completions (excluding Allocations)	1	12	3	34	7	47	0	0
Holsworthy								
Allocations								
HOL02: Land south of Under Lane – Phase I	0	0	0	0	0	23	23	28
HOL03: Land Between Rydon Road and Trewyn Road	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	9
HOL05: Land between Dobles Lane and North Road	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
HOL06: Land East of North Road	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
HOL07: Land off Menors Place	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	32	22
Completions (excluding Allocations)	54	10	20	19	108	43	0	0
Ilfracombe								
Allocations								
ILF01 (a)(i): Southern Extension (Channel, Bowden & Winsham Farms)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
ILF01 (a)(ii): Southern Extension (Worth Meadows)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
ILF02: Land at The Shields/Fernway	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

19/20	20/21	21/22	22/23	23/24	24/25	25/26	26/27	27/28	28/29	29/30	30/31	Lapse Rate ⁽¹⁾	Total 2011-2031 ⁽²⁾
35	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	150
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	10	20	20	0	0	50
0	0	0	20	40	40	40	40	40	0	0	0	0	220
14	6	12	0	0	0	0	0	23	0	0	0	1.65	69
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	83
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	277
0	30	30	40	40	40	30	30	10	0	0	0	0	250
55	58	49	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1.05	259
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	63
10	30	40	57	40	9	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	186
0	0	25	25	29	25	25	10	0	0	0	0	0	139
0	0	0	0	20	40	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	60
20	40	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	60
0	0	0	0	33	35	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	68
10	0	14	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1.05	67
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	104
17	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	91
0	18	30	33	35	14	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	139
20	20	20	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	60
0	20	20	40	30	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	110
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	15	0	0	0	0	0	15
12	1	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2.25	66
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	254
20	40	40	40	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	50	0	750
0	0	0	25	50	50	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	125
20	20	11	9	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	60

SOURCE OF HOUSING SUPPLY	11/12	12/13	13/14	14/15	15/16	16/17	17/18	18/19
Ilfracombe (continued)								
Non-Strategic Housing Site								
Berkeley Hotel, Wilder Road	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	11
Former Montebello Hotel, Fore Street	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Former Chambercombe Bakery	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Former Biclescombe Nursery	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	38	25
Completions (excluding Allocations)	34	70	21	37	15	19	0	0
Northam								
Allocations								
NOR01: Daddon Hill Farm	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
NOR02: Site West of Buckleigh Road	0	0	0	0	2	33	25	25
NOR03: Land adjacent to Landsdowne Park	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
NOR04: Tadworthy Road (Northam)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
NOR07: Site Adjoining Pitt Hill (Appledore)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
NOR08: Land north of Cleveland Park	0	0	0	0	0	0	6	0
NOR09: Land South-West of Heywood Road Roundabout	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Non-Strategic Housing Sites								
Land at Kingsley Avenue, Appledore	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Land adj. Appin House, Buckleigh Road, Westward Ho!	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Land east of Churchill Way, Appledore	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Land at Amberley, Limers Lane, Northam	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Land between Watertown and Staddon Road	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	38	27
Completions (excluding Allocations)	15	20	31	22	11	44	0	0
South Molton								
Allocations								
SM01 (a): Strategic Western Extension (Area 1)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	15
SM01 (b): Strategic Western Extension (Area 2)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SM01 (c): Strategic Western Extension (Area 3)	0	0	0	0	0	0	3	25
SM01 (d): Strategic Western Extension (Area 4)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SM02(1): Sports Hub and Football Club	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Non-Strategic Housing Sites								
Tyre Depot, East Street	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Former Tannery, 77 East Street	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Quince Honey Farm, North Road	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	5
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	38	57
Completions (excluding Allocations)	14	5	21	27	39	71	0	0

19/20	20/21	21/22	22/23	23/24	24/25	25/26	26/27	27/28	28/29	29/30	30/31	Lapse Rate ⁽¹⁾	Total 2011-2031 ⁽²⁾
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	11
0	0	0	0	0	12	13	0	0	0	0	0	0	25
6	0	7	7	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	20
0	0	0	8	7	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	15
42	55	46	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	4.2	202
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	196
25	75	75	100	100	75	50	0	0	0	0	0	0	500
75	117	110	100	55	40	40	40	40	40	0	0	0	742
7	7	0	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	18
0	10	25	30	30	30	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	125
0	25	25	25	25	25	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	129
3	0	0	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	11
20	40	40	40	50	20	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	210
0	0	0	14	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	14
0	0	0	10	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	10
0	0	0	0	0	20	31	0	0	0	0	0	0	51
0	0	0	6	6	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	12
0	0	0	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	5
45	6	6	10	12	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	3.75	140
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	143
30	30	30	30	30	30	30	25	0	0	0	0	0	250
0	0	0	25	25	25	25	25	25	10	0	0	0	160
25	50	50	50	50	37	19	0	0	0	0	0	0	309
0	0	0	10	20	20	20	20	20	20	20	20	0	170
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	20	40	0	0	60
0	0	0	14	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	14
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	6	0	0	0	0	0	6
9	0	0	0	0	8	9	0	0	0	0	0	0	31
30	19	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	3.6	145
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	177

SOURCE OF HOUSING SUPPLY	11/12	12/13	13/14	14/15	15/16	16/17	17/18	18/19
Bradworthy								
Allocations								
BRD01: Land North of Elizabeth Lea Close	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
BRD02: Land at Mill Road	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Non-Strategic Housing Sites								
Land east of Langdon Road Industrial Estate, Bradworthy	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	10
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	7	2
Completions (excluding Allocations)	1	0	2	11	1	1	0	0
Bratton Fleming								
Allocations								
BRF01: Land off The Glebe	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	3	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	1	2	1	0	0	0	0
Buckland Brewer								
Allocations								
BBR02: Land at Orleigh Close	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
BBR03: Land to the South East of Orleigh Close	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
BBR04: Land to the West of Tower Hill	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	3
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	4	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	1	0	0	19	21	0	0	0
Chulmleigh								
Allocations								
CHU01: Land off Leigh Road	0	0	0	0	0	21	20	20
CHU02: Land at Back Lane	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Non-Strategic Housing Sites								
Oldings Meadow	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	2	2
Completions (excluding Allocations)	2	11	1	1	1	3	0	0
Combe Martin								
Allocations								
CMA01: Land North of Rectory Road	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
CMA03: Land North of Park Hills	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Non-Strategic Housing Sites								
Land off Spurway Gardens, Combe Martin	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	1	0	2	5	7	1	0	0

19/20	20/21	21/22	22/23	23/24	24/25	25/26	26/27	27/28	28/29	29/30	30/31	Lapse Rate ⁽¹⁾	Total 2011-2031 ⁽²⁾
0	0	0	5	5	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	15
7	10	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	17
18	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	28
0	7	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.3	20
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	16
0	15	10	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	25
2	5	9	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1.2	18
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	4
15	12	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	27
0	0	0	16	9	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	25
1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	5
1	20	22	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.15	47
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	41
20	14	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	95
3	0	3	0	3	0	3	0	4	0	4	0	0	20
0	0	0	0	12	11	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	23
0	2	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.6	7
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	19
0	0	0	0	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	5
0	0	0	6	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	6
0	0	0	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	5
1	0	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.45	4
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	16

SOURCE OF HOUSING SUPPLY	11/12	12/13	13/14	14/15	15/16	16/17	17/18	18/19
Dolton								
Allocations								
DOL01: Land at Aller Road	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
DOL02: Land South of Village Hall	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	2	1
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	1	0	1	1	0	0	0
Halwill Junction								
Allocations								
HAL02: Land East of Chilla Road	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	2	3	13	0	0	0	0	0
Hartland								
Allocations								
HAR01: Land East of Pengilly Way	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
HAR02: Land at Eastdown Park	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	8	5
Completions (excluding Allocations)	22	3	14	3	10	8	0	0
High Bickington								
Allocations								
HBK01: Land at Little Bickington Lane	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
HBK02: Land at North Farm	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	2	2
Completions (excluding Allocations)	18	1	2	1	16	3	0	0
Instow								
Allocations								
INS01: Land at Barton Cross	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
INS02: Land at Anstey Way	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	3
INS03: Land North of Marine Parade	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	5
Non-Strategic Housing Sites								
Mollands Garage	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Sands Residential Care Home	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	5	1	0	2	0	0	0
North Molton								
Allocations								
NMO01: Land off Back Lane	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
NMO02: Land at Old Road	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

19/20	20/21	21/22	22/23	23/24	24/25	25/26	26/27	27/28	28/29	29/30	30/31	Lapse Rate ⁽¹⁾	Total 2011-2031 ⁽²⁾
0	10	10	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	25
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	3	0	0	0	0	0	3
2	0	11	5	5	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	31
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	3
0	0	0	10	15	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.15	25
0	0	10	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.15	11
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	18
3	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	2	0	0	0	0	40
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.15	14
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	60
0	0	0	10	12	10	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	32
0	0	0	16	9	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	25
1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.15	5
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	41
0	0	0	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	5
3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	6
5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	10
0	0	0	0	0	7	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	7
0	0	0	0	6	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	6
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.15	1
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	8
0	0	0	0	0	0	12	13	0	0	0	0	0	25
0	12	13	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	25

SOURCE OF HOUSING SUPPLY	11/12	12/13	13/14	14/15	15/16	16/17	17/18	18/19
North Molton (continued)								
Non-Strategic Housing Sites								
Land South of Oakford Lea, Oakford Villas	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	10
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	1	8	4	0	0	0	0
Shebbear								
Allocations								
SHB02: Land West of Haycross Hill	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	6	3
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	3	1	0	1	0	0	0
Winkleigh								
Allocations								
WIN02: Land North of Chulmleigh Road	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	2
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	5	0	1	0	0
Witheridge								
Allocations								
WIT01: Land off Butts Close	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	2	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	4	3	0	1	0	1	0	0
Woolacombe and Morteohoe								
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	52	30
Completions (excluding Allocations)	4	2	2	12	8	2	0	0
Abbotsham								
Allocations								
ABS01: Land at The Glebe	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Ashwater								
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	1	7	2	0	0	0
Atherington								
Allocations								
ATH01: Land North of Torrington Road	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2
Completions (excluding Allocations)	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

19/20	20/21	21/22	22/23	23/24	24/25	25/26	26/27	27/28	28/29	29/30	30/31	Lapse Rate ⁽¹⁾	Total 2011-2031 ⁽²⁾
0	0	0	4	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	7
13	4	3	10	20	15	0	0	0	0	0	0	1.05	74
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	13
20	10	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	33
1	0	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.45	12
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	5
0	20	20	15	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	55
5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.75	7
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	6
20	20	25	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	65
0	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.45	5
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	9
5	3	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1.2	92
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	30
10	13	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	23
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.15	2
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	10
0	0	0	0	0	0	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	5
6	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.45	8
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1

SOURCE OF HOUSING SUPPLY	11/12	12/13	13/14	14/15	15/16	16/17	17/18	18/19
Beaford								
Allocations								
BEA01: Land North of Towell Lane / Towell Meadow	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
BEA02: Land at Rye Park Close, Beaford Garage and Land to Rear	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	1	0	1	0	0	0	0
Berrynarbor								
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	9
Completions (excluding Allocations)	3	0	0	1	2	0	0	0
Bishops Nympton								
Allocations								
BNY01: Glebe Field	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Non-Strategic Housing Sites								
Capitol Farm, Bishops Nympton	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2
Completions (excluding Allocations)	1	9	0	0	0	1	0	0
Bishops Tawton								
Allocations								
BTA01: Former Engineering Works, Village Street	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
BTA02: Land off Exeter Road	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	1	9	0	1	1	0	0	0
Black Torrington								
Allocations								
BTR01: Land at Long Cross Farm	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Bridgerule								
Allocations								
BRI02: Southfields	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	3	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	13	1	1	3	0	0	0
Burrington								
Allocations								
BUR01: Land off Meadow Park Drive	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
BUR02: Land Rear of Barnstaple Inn	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
BUR03: Land South of Hayne View	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

19/20	20/21	21/22	22/23	23/24	24/25	25/26	26/27	27/28	28/29	29/30	30/31	Lapse Rate ⁽¹⁾	Total 2011-2031 ⁽²⁾
4	0	5	0	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	14
0	0	20	10	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	30
0	0	9	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	10
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	9
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	6
10	10	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	20
0	0	0	8	0	0	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	10
2	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.9	6
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	11
0	0	0	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	5
0	0	8	7	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	15
0	1	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.15	5
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	12
1	2	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	5
1	0	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.15	5
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	5	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	9
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	3
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	18
0	0	0	5	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	10
0	0	0	0	0	10	10	0	0	0	0	0	0	20
0	0	0	0	0	0	10	10	0	0	0	0	0	20
0	2	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.6	4
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

SOURCE OF HOUSING SUPPLY	11/12	12/13	13/14	14/15	15/16	16/17	17/18	18/19
Bucks Cross								
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Chilsworthy								
Allocations								
H0H01: Land West of Meadowside	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	1	0	0	0	0
Chittlehampton								
Allocations								
CHI01: Land at Cobbaton Road	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	3
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0
Clawton								
Allocations								
CLW01: Land at Riverside	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	1	2	0	0	0
Clovelly/ Higher Clovelly								
Allocations								
CLO01: Land at Lower Burscott Farmyard	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Croyde								
Allocations								
GEO02: Land off Croyde Road	0	0	0	0	0	0	10	6
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	3	7	1	10	1	7	0	0
East Anstey								
Allocations								
EAN01: Land at East Anstey	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	6
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	5	4	0	0
East Worlington								
Allocations								
EWO01: Land at Town Barton	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	2	1	0	0	0	0

19/20	20/21	21/22	22/23	23/24	24/25	25/26	26/27	27/28	28/29	29/30	30/31	Lapse Rate ⁽¹⁾	Total 2011-2031 ⁽²⁾
1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.15	1
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	6	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	7
1	0	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.15	5
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1
0	0	0	0	0	10	10	0	0	0	0	0	0	20
2	1	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.45	7
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1
3	0	0	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	9
1	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.3	3
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	3
0	0	5	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	10
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	19
0	1	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.3	3
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	29
3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	3
0	0	7	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	13
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	9
0	0	0	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	5
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	3

SOURCE OF HOUSING SUPPLY	11/12	12/13	13/14	14/15	15/16	16/17	17/18	18/19
Filleigh								
Allocations								
FIL01: Land adjoining Filleigh Village Hall	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Georgeham								
Allocations								
GEO01: Land off Frogstreet Hill, Georgeham	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Non-Strategic Housing Sites								
Fairleigh, Georgeham	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	1	2	0	0	0	0	0	0
Goodleigh								
Allocations								
GDL01: Land adjacent Village Hall, Coombe Cross	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
GDL02: Land off Northleigh Hill	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	2
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	1	0	0	2	0	0
Kentisbury/ Kentisbury Ford								
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	1
Completions (excluding Allocations)	1	0	0	0	3	1	0	0
Kings Nympton								
Non-Strategic Housing Sites								
Land at Skibbows	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	2	5
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	2	1	1	0	0	0	0
Knowle								
Allocations								
KNW01: Land south of Chalwells	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	1	0	0	3	1	0	0	0
Landkey								
Allocations								
LAN01: Land South of Birch Road	0	0	0	19	7	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	22
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	10	18	3	0	2	0	0

19/20	20/21	21/22	22/23	23/24	24/25	25/26	26/27	27/28	28/29	29/30	30/31	Lapse Rate ⁽¹⁾	Total 2011-2031 ⁽²⁾
0	0	0	5	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	10
0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.15	1
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	5	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	10
0	0	8	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	8
1	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.3	2
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	3
0	0	0	5	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	10
0	0	0	0	0	0	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	5
0	4	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1.05	7
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	3
2	1	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.6	7
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	5
0	4	4	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	12
1	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.45	10
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	4
0	0	0	10	10	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	20
1	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	5
0	0	0	0	6	6	6	7	0	0	0	0	0	51
44	20	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.9	88
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	33

SOURCE OF HOUSING SUPPLY	11/12	12/13	13/14	14/15	15/16	16/17	17/18	18/19
Langtree and Stibb Cross								
Allocations								
LAG01: Residential Development West of The Crescent	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
LAG02: Former Cattle Market and Land to North	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	8	4
Completions (excluding Allocations)	1	0	0	1	0	1	0	0
Lower Lovacott and Newton Tracey								
Allocations								
HLN01: Land South of Orchard Cottages, Lower Lovacott	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	2	0	3	0	0	0	0
Merton								
Allocations								
MER01: Land to the South of the Primary School	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
MER02: Site at Limers Lane	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
MER03: Land at Back Lane	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	1	6	0	1	1	0	0
Milton Damerel/Venn Green								
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	0
Monkleigh								
Allocations								
MON01: Land North of Barton Farm	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Parkham								
Allocations								
PAR01: Land South of Allardice Hall	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	3	2
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Pyworthy								
Allocations								
PYW01: Land adjacent to Pyworthy Village Hall	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	1
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	1	0	0	0	0

19/20	20/21	21/22	22/23	23/24	24/25	25/26	26/27	27/28	28/29	29/30	30/31	Lapse Rate ⁽¹⁾	Total 2011-2031 ⁽²⁾
0	0	0	5	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	10
0	0	0	8	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	8
1	0	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.15	15
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	3
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	6	0	0	6
3	6	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	9
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	5
0	0	0	10	10	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	20
0	10	23	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	33
0	0	0	15	20	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	35
2	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	8
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	9
4	5	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.15	11
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1
0	0	0	5	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	10
1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.15	1
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
14	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	14
10	11	10	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	36
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
10	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	10
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1

SOURCE OF HOUSING SUPPLY	11/12	12/13	13/14	14/15	15/16	16/17	17/18	18/19
Rackenford								
Allocations								
RAC01: Land at Rackenford Cross	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
RAC02: Land at Prospect Farm	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2
RAC03: Land at Coles Yard	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0
Sheepwash								
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	2
Completions (excluding Allocations)	2	1	0	1	1	1	0	0
Shirwell								
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	1	2	0	0	4	0	0	0
St Giles on the Heath								
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	12	0	0	0	0
Sutcombe								
Allocations								
SUT01: Land to North of Sutcombe Primary School	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SUT02: Land adjacent to the Parish Hall	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	3	2	0	0	0	0	0
Swimbridge								
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	10	0	0	1	1	0	0	0
Tetcott								
Allocations								
TET01: Land at Tetcott	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Umberleigh								
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
West Down								
WED02: Land off Ilfracombe Hill	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	9
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	3	1
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	1	0	1	0	0

19/20	20/21	21/22	22/23	23/24	24/25	25/26	26/27	27/28	28/29	29/30	30/31	Lapse Rate ⁽¹⁾	Total 2011-2031 ⁽²⁾
0	0	0	3	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	6
1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	3
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	3	0	0	0	0	0	3
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1
2	4	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.15	11
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	6
1	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.3	2
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	7
1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2	0.15	3
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	12
0	0	0	10	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	10
0	0	5	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	10
0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.15	2
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	5
5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	5
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	12
3	15	10	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	28
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
8	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	17
0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.3	5
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2

SOURCE OF HOUSING SUPPLY	11/12	12/13	13/14	14/15	15/16	16/17	17/18	18/19
Welcombe/ Darracott								
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Woolfardisworthy								
Commitments (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	0	4	1
Completions (excluding Allocations)	0	0	0	0	0	-1	0	0
Rural Settlements and Countryside								
Commitments	0	0	0	0	0	0	128	135
Completions	41	34	37	104	61	51	0	0
Windfall Estimate	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Lapse Rate⁽⁹⁾							1	14
Annual Completions /Projections	455	441	375	734	641	812	1,088	1,115
Cumulative Total	455	896	1,271	2,005	2,646	3,458	4,546	5,661
Annualised Housing Requirement	861	861	861	861	861	861	861	861
Cumulative Housing Requirement	861	1,722	2,583	3,444	4,305	5,166	6,027	6,888
Monitor	-406	-826	-1,312	-1,439	-1,659	-1,708	-1,481	-1,227

19/20	20/21	21/22	22/23	23/24	24/25	25/26	26/27	27/28	28/29	29/30	30/31	Lapse Rate ⁽¹⁾	Total 2011-2031 ⁽²⁾
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.3	7
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	-1
120	47	33	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	29.25	434
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	328
0	90	90	90	90	90	90	90	90	90	90	90	0	990
28	18	13	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	74
1,355	1,838	1,968	1,726	1,653	1,327	1,082	949	829	700	600	501		20,189*
7,016	8,854	10,822	12,548	14,201	15,528	16,610	17,559	18,388	19,088	19,688	20,189		
861	861	861	861	861	861	861	861	861	861	861	861		17,220
7,749	8,610	9,471	10,332	11,193	12,054	12,915	13,776	14,637	15,498	16,359	17,220		
-733	244	1,351	2,216	3,008	3,474	3,695	3,783	3,751	3,590	3,329	2,969		

Base date for planning commitment and dwelling completion data is 1st April 2017 (1) Adjustment to account for aggregated Lapse Rates on Unimplemented Small Site Commitments @ 15%.

(2) Figures reflect the application of the Unimplemented Small Site Commitments, rounded to the nearest whole number * Total Column will not sum due to rounding of individual values.

Figure 2.1 Housing Position

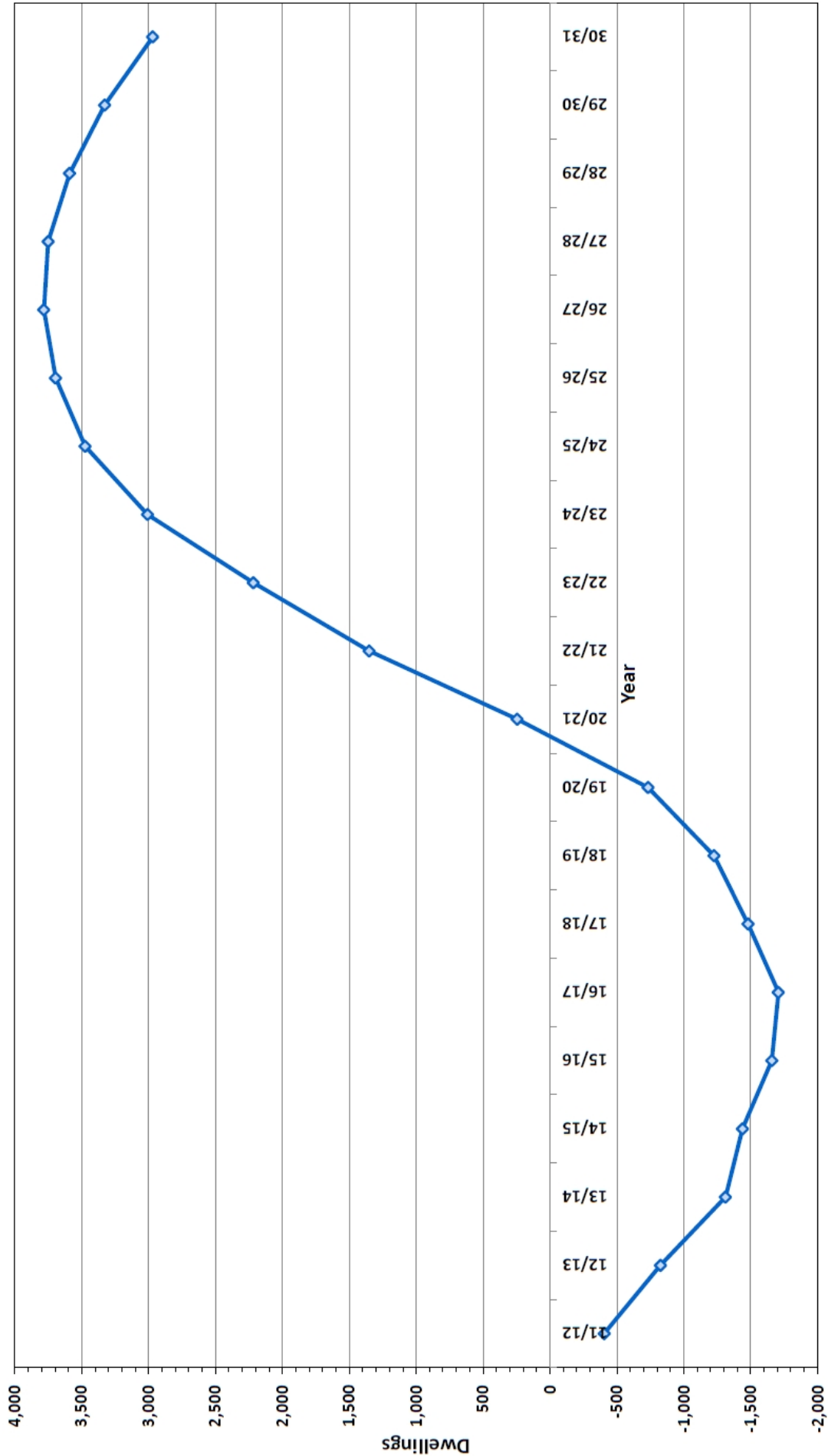
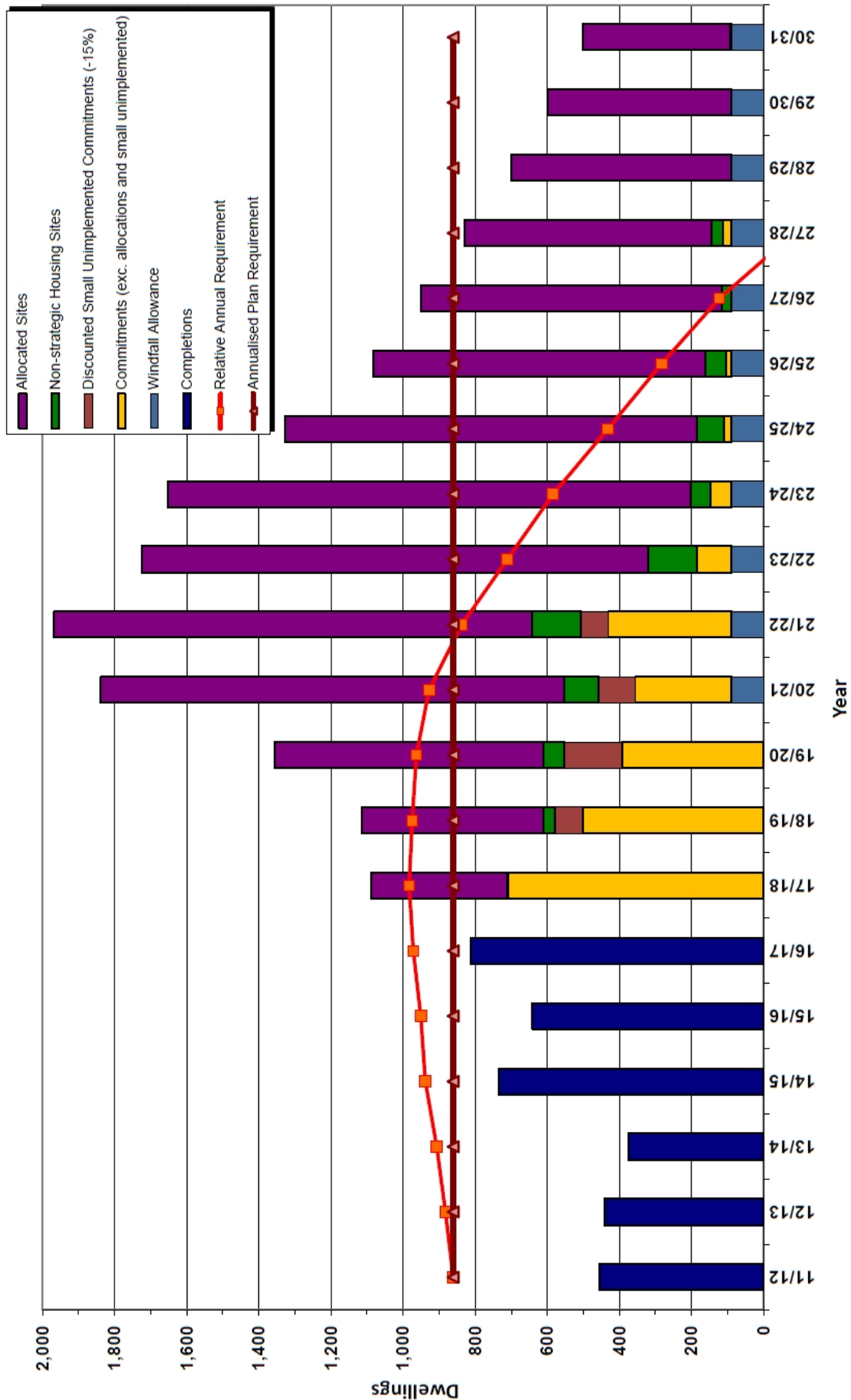


Figure 2.2 North Devon and Torridge Housing Trajectory



Appendix 3 Monitoring Framework

Aim 1: A Vibrant Northern Devon Economy – where excellent opportunities support diverse low carbon growth and moves towards an economy that supports our world class environment

Strategic Objective	Key Policies	Indicators	Targets
(a) a rejuvenated economy, supported by appropriate infrastructure that provides excellent opportunities for all through an extended range of well paid and skilled jobs	Spatial Strategy Policies: ST06 - ST10 Vibrant Economy Policies: ST11 - ST13 Policy ST23: Infrastructure	1. Amount of new land and floorspace delivered for economic development by location and use class	1a. Delivery of 84.9 hectares of land for economic development on allocated sites over the period 2011-2031 at an average rate of 4.25 hectares per annum
(b) innovation and entrepreneurship will be encouraged through enhanced ICT opportunities and the promotion of new ways of working to create the conditions in which businesses can grow and prosper	Policy ST11: Delivering Employment and Economic Development	2. Amount of land for economic development lost to non-economic development by location and use class	1b. Additional economic development delivered on unallocated sites in sustainable locations
(c) economic development in urban and rural areas shall regenerate and diversify the local economy without adverse environmental impacts to create high quality employment environments	Spatial Strategy Policies: ST06 - ST10	3. Amount of previously developed land redeveloped for economic development uses	2. No net loss of land for economic development
(d) excellent learning opportunities and local facilities will deliver the skills appropriate for innovation and growth in important and enterprising economic sectors	Policy ST11: Delivering Employment and Economic Development Policy ST23: Infrastructure	4. % working population with no NVQ qualification	3. Additional economic development delivered on sustainably located previously developed land and identified regeneration sites
(e) town and village centres are sustainable vibrant places	Spatial Strategy Policies: ST06 - ST10 Policy ST12: Town, District and Local Retail Centres	5. Amount and proportion of retail, office and leisure developments completed within defined town centres	4. Improved skill levels within the working population
(f) sustainable growth in the maritime, engineering, tourism and leisure economies	Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy; Policy ST13: Sustainable Tourism	6. Vacancy rates in town centres	5. Maintain town centres as the primary focus for town centre uses
(g) an agricultural sector, which is rejuvenated and supported to maintain and enhance its essential contribution to the well being and land use management of the rural area	Policy ST11: Delivering Employment and Economic Development	7. Range of services and facilities in town centres and rural communities	6. Net decrease in % vacant retail units within the defined town centres
(h) an economy that supports and complements the area's world class environment	Policy ST11: Delivering Employment and Economic Development	8. Number of tourism related schemes delivered 9. Number of rural employment / diversification schemes delivered 10. Superfast broadband	7a. No net decline in range of town centre uses within the defined town centres 7b. No net loss of key rural services and facilities 8a. Net increase in and enhancement of facilities for sustainable tourism 8b. Net increase in and improvement of tourism focused uses at Westward Ho! and Ilfracombe with: i. no net loss of tourism related uses

		exchanges upgraded	in the Core Tourist Area; ii. delivery of tourism/ recreation facilities within Policy NOR06 sites; iii. diversification of leisure, tourism and commercial facilities on regeneration sites in Ilfracombe 9. Net increase in rural employment premises and delivery of diversification schemes 10. Exchanges upgraded in accordance with Connecting Devon and Somerset delivery programme
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Aim 2: A World Class Environment – where important assets are valued and enhanced for future generations

Strategic Objective	Key Policies	Indicators	Targets
(a) the undeveloped coastline, estuarine and important countryside assets of northern Devon are protected and enhanced	Policy ST09: Coast and Estuary Strategy Policy ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets	1. Condition assessment of SSSI units 2. Biodiversity delivered through biodiversity offsetting credits	1. Net increase in % of SSSI units with favourable condition or unfavourable recovering condition 2. Net gain in biodiversity
(b) important wildlife habitats, protected landscapes and our distinctive heritage are conserved and enhanced and the decline of biodiversity is reversed	Policy ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets Policy ST15: Conserving Heritage Assets	3. Bathing water quality 4. Number of planning permissions granted contrary to the advice of the Environment Agency on flood defence / water quality grounds	3. Improvement in water quality 4. No planning permissions granted contrary to the advice of the Environment Agency
(c) land is used efficiently and effectively – optimise how ecosystem services provide and result in productive living landscapes and townscape that adapt to our changing needs	Policy ST02: Mitigating Climate Change Policy ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets	5. Nitrogen dioxide levels at Braunton village centre	5. Improvement in air quality recorded in Braunton village centre
(d) high quality sustainable building and construction minimises the risks arising from climate change and new development is designed and located to mitigate and adapt to the effects of climate change	Policy ST02: Mitigating Climate Change Policy ST05: Sustainable Construction and Buildings	6. Capacity for approved renewable energy generation	6. Potential to deliver increased levels of renewable energy generation through consented development
(e) the demand for travel is managed – location of development minimises the need to travel, improves accessibility to jobs, facilities and services and measures associated with new development allow for achievement of the highest standards appropriate to the world-class environment of northern Devon	Policy ST02: Mitigating Climate Change Policy ST08: Scale and Distribution of New Development in Northern Devon Policy ST10: Transport Strategy		
(f) demand for resources including energy and water are managed sustainability for efficient and effective use	Policy ST02: Mitigating Climate Change		

(g) development improves water quality in rivers, lakes, estuary and coastal waters to help deliver the South West River Basin Management Plan objectives	Policy ST02: Mitigating Climate Change Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience		
Aim 3: A Balanced Local Housing Market – where a choice of decent housing of all types is available and new development meets community needs			
Strategic Objective	Key Policies	Indicators	Targets
(a) a choice of decent, well-designed housing for the range of needs of our existing and future communities	Policy ST03: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience Policy ST04: Improving the Quality of Development Strategic Housing Policies: ST17- ST21	1. Number of new homes delivered in the last 12 months 2. Type, size and tenure mix of new homes delivered and amount and type of specialist accommodation delivered	1. Annualised rate of 861 new dwellings delivered across northern Devon 2. Enhanced mix of property types, sizes and tenures in accordance with local needs
(b) a range of affordable housing tenures appropriate to meet local needs	Policy ST18: Affordable Housing on Development Sites	3. Number of affordable homes delivered by size, tenure and type	3/4. Delivery of 30% affordable housing on major development sites, and across new housing developments above the national size thresholds including through off-site contributions
(c) rural housing needs for all localities to be met in sustainable locations	Policy ST02: Adapting to Climate Change and Strengthening Resilience Policy ST07: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Rural Area	4. % of new homes delivered as affordable homes and % delivered on qualifying developments	5. No 'reds' for Building for Life standards achieved for major residential developments
(d) the provision of appropriately located infrastructure to support a growing population	Policy ST22: Community Services and Facilities Policy ST23: Infrastructure	5. Building for Life standards achieved for major residential developments	6. Net increase in Traveller pitches available to meet assessed need
(e) a balance between housing, employment and infrastructure provision, which are secured in step with growth to anticipate demographic trends	Policy ST22: Community Services and Facilities Policy ST23: Infrastructure	6. Number of Traveller pitches (permanent and transit) delivered 7. Distribution of new homes delivered between the main towns, local centres and villages 8. Number of homes and amount of land for economic development delivered since April 2011 9. Proportion of new homes delivered in the last 12 months compared to the managed annualised	7. Delivery of new development in sustainable locations: 7a. 50% of new homes delivered within Barnstaple and Bideford 7b. 40% of new homes delivered within the main centres (including Fremington/Yelland) 7c. 10% of new homes delivered within the Local Centres, Villages and Rural Settlements 8. Delivery of approx. 17,200 new homes and 85 hectares of land for economic

		dwelling requirement	development over the Plan period
		10. Housing trajectory setting out (i) the actual net additional dwellings in previous years; (ii) the projected net additional dwellings for future years; and (iii) the (managed) annualised dwelling requirement for each year	
Aim 4: Mixed Communities – where there is a strong community spirit and the opportunity for an excellent quality of life			
Strategic Objective	Key Policies	Indicators	Targets
(a) growth that improves the sustainable self-sufficiency of communities	Policy ST06: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Strategic and Main Centres Policy ST07: Spatial Development Strategy for Northern Devon's Rural Area	1. Number of new and expanded schools, nurseries and children's centres delivered	1. Delivery of new and expanded schools, nurseries and children's centres 2. Delivery of new and extended community facilities with housing
(b) sustainable and accessible transport links are available where needed – there are improved opportunities to access the full range of services and facilities	Policy ST10: Transport Strategy Policy ST22: Community Services and Facilities	2. Number of new and expanded community facilities within or in addition to mixed use development schemes delivered	3. Progress towards delivery of strategic infrastructure funded by CIL
(c) the investment in low carbon futures and in modern healthcare, social, sports, recreational, leisure and cultural services and facilities fulfils the requirements of our growing and changing population	Policy ST22: Community Services and Facilities Policy ST23: Infrastructure Policy DM10: Green Infrastructure Provision	3. Delivery of strategic infrastructure requirements on Regulation 123 list funded through CIL contributions	4. Delivery of new infrastructure for local communities funded by Section 106 contributions 5a. Delivery of new green infrastructure, reflecting the North Devon and Torridge Green Infrastructure Strategy
(d) vulnerable and disadvantaged groups are fully supported by buoyant community and voluntary sectors	Policy ST22: Community Services and Facilities Policy ST23: Infrastructure	4. Amount of Section 106 monies received and spent	5b. Green infrastructure standards met by type and accessibility within new housing developments
(e) inequalities within the most deprived areas are reduced and the gap between the fortunes of neighbourhoods is reduced	Policy ST18: Affordable Housing on Development Sites	5. Green infrastructure projects including new sports facilities, public open spaces, play areas, footpaths / cycleways, allotments and accessible natural greenspaces	6. No inappropriate development in locally defined Green Spaces and Wedges that would dilute the basis of designation
(f) there is a good work life balance – with live work opportunities and more opportunities for residents and visitors to lead healthy lives including access to high quality accessible greenspace	Policy ST08: Scale and Distribution of New Development in Northern Devon Policy ST23: Infrastructure		7. Net decrease in recorded crime
(g) community environments are safe and secure – crime and anti-social behaviour are tackled effectively	Policy ST04: Improving the Quality of Development		
(h) everyone has access to a wide range of high quality education and training opportunities	Policy ST22: Community Services and Facilities		

Appendix 3 Monitoring Framework

	Policy ST23: Infrastructure	6. Development within Local Greenspaces and Green Wedges	
(i) the built environment is designed to promote healthy living and support an ageing population	Policy ST04: Improving the Quality of Development		
(j) the separate identities and characteristics of individual settlements are protected	Policy BAR22: Green Wedges Policy NOR10: Green Wedge	7. Incidence of recorded crime	
(k) public access to environmental assets is improved to support collective and individual wellbeing	Policy ST14: Enhancing Environmental Assets		

Appendix 4 Policies Map Legend

North Devon & Torridge Local Plan (2011-2031)
Adopted October 2018



Policies Map Notation

	Agricultural Business Park (HOL01)		Minerals Safeguard Zones
	Area Outside Plan Boundary		Mixed Use Proposal
	Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty (ST09 & ST14)		New Sewage Treatment Works Proposal (SM01)
	Bideford Port (BID06)		New/Upgraded Road
	Braunton Air Quality Management Area (BRA)		Park & Change Proposal
	Cemetery Extension (ILF01 & WIT02)		Pedestrian/Cycle Bridge Proposal
	Coast & Estuary Zone (ST09)		Railway Station Proposal (BAR16)
	Conservation Area (ST15)		Policy Reference
	County Geological Site (ST14)		Town/District Centre & Primary Shopping Area (ST12)
	County Wildlife Site (ST14)		Primary Shopping Frontage
	Development Boundary (ST06 & ST07)		Regeneration Proposal (BID07)
	Education Proposal		Reserve Employment Proposal (ILF04 & SM03)
	Employment Proposal		Site of Special Scientific Interest (ST14)
	Existing Strategic Footpath/Cycle Route (ST10)		Special Area of Conservation (ST14)
	Footpath/Cycle Route Proposal		Candidate SAC (ST14)
	Green Infrastructure (ST14)		Sports Hub
	Green Wedge (BAR22 & NOR10)		Sports Pitch
	Heritage Coast (ST09 & ST14)		Structural Planting
	Historic Parks & Gardens (ST15)		Town Centre Expansion (BAR11 & SM04)
	Housing Proposal		Tourism & Recreation Proposal (NOR06)
	Landscape Restoration (HAR02 & WIN01)		Tourist Area (ILF05 & NOR05)
	Local Green Space		UNESCO Biosphere Buffer (ST14)
	Local Nature Reserve (ST14)		UNESCO Biosphere Transition Zone (ST14)
	Lynton to Barnstaple Railway (BAR16)		
	Medieval Field System (ST15 & CMA04)		

Appendix 5 Schedule of Non-strategic Housing Sites

5.1 The sites listed in Appendix 5 are allocated as non-strategic housing sites. These sites are all developable (suitable, available and achievable) SHLAA sites that are located within the development boundaries shown on the Policies Maps. Non-strategic housing sites contribute to the Local Plan's housing supply and planning applications upon them will be considered with respect to Policies ST06 and ST07, as well as other relevant policies within the Local Plan.

Site Address	SHLAA Reference(s)	Assumed Dwelling Yield (Net)
Land at Brunswick Wharf, East-the-Water, Bideford	SHA/BID/38	52
Car Parks, Bridge Street, Bideford	SHA/BID/37	50
Land at Kingsley School, Bideford	SHA/BID/126	28
Land at Nuttaberry, East-the-Water, Bideford	SHA/BID/18	96
Land Between Watertown and Staddon Road, Appledore	SHA/NOR/2 (part)*	5
Land at Kingsley Avenue, Appledore	SHA/NOR/3	14
Land adjoining Appin House, Buckleigh Road, Westward Ho!	SHA/NOR/35	10
Land East of Churchill Way, Appledore	SHA/NOR/135	51
Land at Amberley, Limers Lane, Northam	SHA/NOR/137	12
Land East of Langdon Road Industrial Estate, Bradworthy	SHA/BRD/18	28
Telephone Repeater Station, Rackfield, Barnstaple	SHA/BAR/065	10
Old Laundry, Lower Raleigh Road, Barnstaple	SHA/BAR/200	6
Land adj. Aviemore Industrial Estate, Sticklepath, Barnstaple	SHA/TAW/153	9
Land West of junction of Goodleigh Road and Gorwell Road, Barnstaple	SHA/BAR/584	6
Whiddon Park, Mount Sandford, Barnstaple	SHA/LAN/482	11
Land North of Bickington Road, adj. Mead Park, Bickington, Barnstaple	SHA/FRE/138	61
Land Between Oliver Road and Valley Close, Gorwell, Barnstaple	SHA/BAR/467	16
Land West of Oakland Park South, Sticklepath, Barnstaple	SHA/FRE/607	34
Berkeley Hotel, Wilder Road, Ilfracombe	SHA/ILF/249	11
Former Montebello Hotel, Fore Street, Ilfracombe	SHA/ILF/327	25
Former Chambercombe Bakery, Ilfracombe	SHA/ILF/328	20
Former Bicclescombe Nursery, Ilfracombe	SHA/ILF/253	15
Tyre Depot, East Street, South Molton	SHA/SMO/030	14
Former Tannery, 77 East Street, South Molton	SHA/SMO/428	6
Quince Honey Farm, North Road, South Molton	SHA/SMO/332	31
Oldings Meadow, Chulmleigh	SHA/CHU/165	23
Land off Spurway Gardens, Combe Martin	SHA/CMA/244	5
Mollands Garage, Instow	SHA/INS/208	7
Sands Residential Care Home, Instow	SHA/INS/357	6
Land South of Oakford Lea, Oakford Villas, North Molton	SHA/NMO/025	7
Capitol Farm, Bishop's Nympton	SHA/BNY/387	10
Fairleigh, Georgeham	SHA/GEO/563	8

Site Address	SHLAA Reference(s)	Assumed Dwelling Yield (Net)
Land at Skibbows, King's Nympton	SHA/KNY/522	12
NORTH DEVON		353
TORRIDGE		346
TOTAL		699
*Extends only to the land within the defined development boundary adjoining Staddon Road		



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